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Happy New Year comrades! As I emerge from my holiday stupor, I have decided to list some of the interesting disputes, campaigns and elections coming up this year. I'm calling it my 2026 Watch List. Am I missing something crucial? Let me know!

1. TWU - Our Roads, Our Skies, Our Future

In May last year, the TWU announced their planned "Our Roads, Our Skies, Our Future" [https://substack.com/redirect/6a996348-fdf2-4a31-8293-25627ab1e807?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] campaign. The TWU spent the last 8

years aligning the expiry dates of 200 EBAs. This year, the expiry of agreements covering an estimated 60,000 workers will pave the way for workers at a variety of aviation and transport companies to simultaneously take protected industrial action. Companies that will likely be targeted include Qantas, Aldi, Amazon, Qube, Linfox, Toll, Virgin Australia, Boral, K&S Freighters and Cleanaway [https://substack.com/redirect/ef9a007f-856f-47f2-8182-ace193fe5bab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

With Australian law severely limiting when workers can take protected industrial action, and outright banning secondary boycotts, lining up EBA expiry dates may be the best strategy for the possibility of sector wide industrial action. Workers in the USA are also using this strategy. The United Auto Workers have lined up contracts at the "Big Three" auto manufacturers (Ford, General Motors and Stellantis) to expire on 30 April 2028, with an aim to strike on May Day 2028. The UAW has called for other unions to join them [https://substack.com/redirect/a3b2cbd4-85e9-41b3-b10e-0305d36f511e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

2. Tasmanian public sector workers

In September, Tasmanian Premier Jeremy Rockliff put forward a "take it or leave it" offer of a 3%, one year agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/19243c48-860e-47b8-849f-9de2129e3112?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Unions - including HACSU, the CPSU, and the AEU - commenced industrial action in response. In the lead up to Christmas, HACSU was holding stoppages almost every day; the AEU has held two half-day strikes [https://substack.com/redirect/7fcce102-d80d-404c-a5bc-c7ea984a5550?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and the CPSU has also participated

in stoppages and work bans. In addition to fighting for a better pay increase, public sector workers in Tassie have concerns about workloads [https://substack.com/redirect/d128d50f-a6b4-4f10-8f6f-17e763ce1b71?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; occupational violence [https://substack.com/redirect/a27aa484-169c-4553-9f3d-646f7e656c8b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; and recruitment and retention

issues [https://substack.com/redirect/396f6b97-32f8-4d6a-bf1f-8a5bce995067?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] within the public sector due to low pay. With either side not looking like they are prepared to budge on their demands - I will definitely be following this closely over the coming weeks. To add to the government's industrial worries, 2026 is also an public sector EBA campaign year for the ANMF in Tasmania [https://substack.com/redirect/5682eb82-c9cc-4980-bab5-15103123da5b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

with plenty of concerns from nurses and midwives including ambulance ramping and transfer of care protocols; safe staffing levels and of course wages and conditions.

3. Re-unionisation of the Pilbara?

In early 2025, there were a number of articles heralding [https://substack.com/redirect/e39427ca-2f1e-4303-a716-e336bf9f325d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the re-unionisation of the Pilbara [https://substack.com/redirect/3bf075d4-05b9-4986-95ab-cf8429f87538?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], with predictable lines from politicians, lobbyists and mining companies. But the organising work is slow and steady. The Western Mine Workers Association (a collaboration between the AWU and MEU) listed their 2025 achievements [https://substack.com/redirect/663a5531-bb35-4bdf-abb3-a4a8cfc20256?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

on social media including a significant increase in members (over 5000 members); recovery of \$1 million for members through underpayments and settlements; and over 300 site visits. EBA campaigns at Rio Tinto's Paraburdoo and BHP's Mining Area C and South Flank have thus far been thwarted by the bosses. Late last year CFMEU members at Freo Cranes commenced industrial action, including a 24 hour strike in December [https://substack.com/redirect/2cefd8d2-a275-4f6a-a631-09eb396ce97b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

To the best of my knowledge, the dispute remains ongoing. I commit to redoubling my efforts to overcome my east coast bias this year, and welcome any Western Australians to reach out with updates from the Wild West.

4. Public school teachers in Victoria

Will 2026 see the first public school teachers' strike in over a decade [https://substack.com/redirect/fe7fbea3-c00e-4868-b1db-c4f68e06eb72?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]? The Victorian Government Schools Agreement (VGSA) which covers public sector teachers in both primary and secondary schools expired on 31 December. Negotiations with the government have already been underway for 6 months. Teachers are seeking a 35% wage increase over 3 years as well as improvements to conditions, action on workload and class sizes. In December, the AEU's Council authorised the Executive to prepare and finalise an application for a protected action ballot order should there be insufficient progress on key issues in negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/5644fc4a-7247-4068-90f0-02fb7131388b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

I suspect the Allan Government would prefer their election year not to be marred by teachers striking. We have been in this situation before. In late 2021 when negotiating the last VGSA, 97% of teachers who voted in the protected action ballot were in favour of strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/99e4b324-82e6-4dab-87b1-772640afbec4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. By early 2022, the tail end of the pandemic, teachers were held in high esteem by the community and it was again an election year. The circumstances felt promising for strike action to push for a competitive deal [https://substack.com/redirect/a6f9abc3-f62e-4fd3-9f9d-5ff4efe1c555?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The AEU was gunning for a 21% wage increase over 3 years. After some limited work bans, an offer was put to members to vote on. The deal includes 2% annual wage increases (far below inflation rates) as well as some action on workload and an increase in time-in-lieu for camps and excursions. A slim majority of 61.8% of members voted in favour of the deal [https://substack.com/redirect/6f3f200d-8f99-49f5-86f3-a7cb92c2bc08?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], with some schools recording no votes as high as 90%. Many teachers were disappointed. Since then, there has been a change in AEU leadership, a severe shortage of teachers, and an atmosphere of a lingering crisis in schools. Will things be different this time? Workers across Victoria should be backing teachers to fight for a decent deal this time around.

5. UWU elections
Remember in November how the member council of the United Workers Union put up a vote of no confidence against current Secretary Tim Kennedy [https://substack.com/redirect/b1a75f13-6a4b-42f2-8d0e-5369d52c5dfd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]? And how in October three UWU organisers were sacked [https://substack.com/redirect/ddfd1da9-db82-49d4-b886-dfaad3feb72c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] either for "serious misconduct" or for refusing to sell a shit deal to members depending on who you ask? And remember in 2023 how two other UWU organisers were sacked allegedly because they attempted a majority support petition [https://substack.com/redirect/02bb8d9e-4a2e-4501-a899-3b8d9ac4b07e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to unionise the union office?

Well, surprise surprise, where there is smoke there is fire. The UWU quadrennial elections will be held this year, and there are plenty of internal tensions in play. Undoubtedly more to come on this.

6. The CFMEU
It has been almost 18 months since the CFMEU was put under administration. A report [https://substack.com/redirect/9634915f-f4a2-46a7-80a6-10adbbba66e24?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from Mark Irving noted that 75% of organisers in NSW have been replaced since administration and approximately 50% in both Queensland and South Australia. A purge in late November in Victoria led to around 11 organisers leaving the Branch, not all willingly. No new charges have been laid against any organiser or delegate to my knowledge. But decades of organisational knowledge and experience have left the union. Many staff employed by the union have also left. The Administration has required all staff to sign an "agreed statement of expectations" which includes items such as supporting all decisions of the Administrator and not publicly criticising or attacking the Administrator. One industrial officer refused to sign and was sacked after 19 years of service. Mark Irving claimed in his report that the union has "stabilised". Certainly not for those who work for the union. But perhaps the union has stabilised for Irving and The Administrator's control. Throughout the first year of administration, many of the public statements made by leaders within the CFMEU called for "business as usual". As an outside observer, it appears to me that the constant call for "business as usual" from organisers, influential delegates and other leaders contributed to stopping the membership from actively responding to the administration of the union. While the intentions may well have been to protect the union, by seeking to continue to control the well disciplined membership - they may have stymied the only thing that can protect a union: an organised rank and file. Now that any opposition to administration is reason enough for an organiser or staff member to be thrown on the scrapheap, can the rank and file of the union build a significant opposition against administration? Will the departure of trusted organisers push workers into action? Or is it too late? I will be watching on with interest and concern.

7. VAHPA
In a show of never-say-die organisational skills, rank and file members of VAHPA at a Special General Meeting in December voted against a proposed merger [https://substack.com/redirect/756cf3fb-0858-4091-9bf5-b440fc1093fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with one of

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MSAV - Public sector health professionals

MSAV members across the Victorian public health sector will take strike action today [https://substack.com/redirect/5736820a-caa1-4aa1-87f6-078b8e892244?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and rally in the Treasury Gardens at 11am before marching to Parliament House. It's been over a year since the state government offered MSAV members a 3% pay rise, and they have refused to budge an inch from the wages policy for these workers. In addition to wages, MSAV members have concerns about career and professional development. Stage 1 protected industrial action started on 10 March [https://substack.com/redirect/fc56a67f-0eaa-4239-8521-5715ca40d66a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with workers wearing union t-shirts and putting up posters and other union materials at work. Stage 2 protected industrial action commenced last Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/a7f14d28-3ad6-430e-8ba4-1245d51428a2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (23/3) with a range of bans including bans on answering telephones; administrative bans including billing, invoicing and processing PBS claims; and bans on the performance of any non-clinical and non-patient facing duties. All bans have been developed to hit government revenue and management, with no adverse effects for patients. Today's strike action is the next step for these essential health workers. Get along to the rally and support them if you can!

RTBU NSW - Aurizon

The dispute at Aurizon continues. In early March, workers overwhelmingly rejected the proposed agreement put out to a vote by Aurizon with 97% of RTBU members voting no. Subsequent meetings between the union and Aurizon resulted in minimal movement from Aurizon, so more work bans were put in place. Aurizon refused to pay workers participating in partial work bans, and RTBU members responded with stop work action on 22-23 March. The RTBU alleges that during this stop work action, Aurizon created a safety risk [https://substack.com/redirect/eb68283d-447a-4e5f-b082-65b3c4f93094?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] by knowingly directing trains onto the main line despite being aware crews were about to stop work as part of a protected industrial action. The RTBU has reported the incident to the regulator. Many work bans are still in place, and the RTBU will be meeting with Aurizon again this week in Newcastle.

ASU/Professionals Australia Vic - Coliban Water

Last Wednesday (25/3), union members at Coliban Water downed tools for 2 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/c0bfee5d-8431-4940-b257-1d2596485490?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The bosses at Coliban are refusing to give workers a decent pay rise, despite their real wages plummeting by 13% since 2021 [https://substack.com/redirect/de1eef3-af9e-458d-9179-6109e2111a28?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Bosses have also been threatening to stand workers down or withhold pay if workers display campaign messages in email auto-replies or in chalk on work vehicles. During their stopwork action last week, workers also endorsed further strike action which will take place today (1 April). To support workers, you can sign this petition [https://substack.com/redirect/7ae4fa40-1edc-4868-92fa-f088cd3a4e84?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CFMEU Victoria - Prince Engineering

Mobile crane workers at Prince Engineering in Portland commenced industrial action last week with a two hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/eba59a89-5c50-4d82-ab32-ad514c7f425f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers at the crane yard are earning \$18 less per hour than workers doing the same job in Melbourne. Some workers have been with Prince Engineering for 30 years. Workers will hold a 4 hour stoppage today (1 April) and will rally at the Aluminium Smelter gates from 10:30am. If I have any readers in Portland - please do get along! Workers will also be holding a 4 hour stoppage tomorrow (2 April); and have instituted bans on overtime and call backs.

Professionals Australia - DXC

Industrial action at DXC is going ahead [https://substack.com/redirect/ac7fbc86-baf7-47ef-90bc-d97241d4803c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Yesterday (31/3), Professionals Australia members commenced work bans and a series of stoppages, and tomorrow they will strike for 24 hours. The origin of the dispute lies in 2023 when DXC attempted to terminate legacy enterprise agreements, without negotiating a new EBA, which would have forced workers onto contracts with the minimum standards covered by the award. Workers organised and fought back, and have now been in subsequent negotiations for a new EBA with the IT services company for 14 months [https://substack.com/redirect/272a1b90-6f3a-421f-a3c5-80afa8944530?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. DXC has proposed agreements with no wage increases [https://substack.com/redirect/e8ca5849-ddff-4cd3-b8eb-2fa8210b9a30?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and diminished conditions. While

ASU members at DXC had also been considering industrial action, the AFR has reported [https://substack.com/redirect/e8ca5849-ddff-4cd3-b8eb-2fa8210b9a30?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] that they called it off after their members were offered a 30% rotating shift allowance. DXC's client list includes banks; several major government departments and large businesses across all sorts of industries (think Endeavour Energy, Ventia, Rheem, etc).

QUTU - Public school teachers

In late 2025, Queensland's public school teachers participated in two 24 hour strikes, and overwhelmingly voted down the state government's offer of an 8% pay increase over 3 years. The dispute between the QUTU and the state government was subsequently referred to the QIRC for arbitration. Last week the QUTU provided an update on the arbitration process [https://substack.com/redirect/705d80b0-0db5-4a35-9b02-222c71c399ba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. We are at Stage 3 (Evidence preparation & submissions). The next stage is the Hearings stage that will run for 2-3 weeks; and will not begin before October. It may take until 2027 - an agonising wait for teachers. The QUTU has filed an application for an interim 3% pay increase [https://substack.com/redirect/efd6d0f1-5926-46e9-9e5a-f8db53f1a3bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and cost of living allowance. A quick reminder that while teachers cannot take industrial action during arbitration; there is nothing stopping the government from making a new offer [https://substack.com/redirect/79e6f1b3-c65d-4d33-b003-fe1f8d3170e8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] - they could have a new agreement finalised for teachers with decent pay and conditions long before 2027 if only they cared to.

In short

HACSU Victoria - Disability support workers

Last Wednesday (25/3), disability workers in Bendigo rallied outside Premier Jacinta Allen's office [https://substack.com/redirect/5c3f367c-9b46-43f7-9173-fde0f0a7551b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Cuts to subsidies by the Victorian government put 11 group homes in Bendigo at risk of closure [https://substack.com/redirect/efa84cb4-8c95-46ca-9baf-db8fef70b588?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. These are the homes of approximately 75 NDIS recipients, and employ 150 disability support workers. HACSU members who are disability support workers are also fighting for better pay and conditions.

UWU - Padre

Padre workers and supporters have called for a boycott of Padre coffee [https://substack.com/redirect/b43dfe7c-25b6-4bf1-a8c6-680eeba19561?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. A leafleting action was held on Saturday (28/3) outside Padre outlets and at the Melbourne International Coffee Exhibition. Supporters spoke to prospective customers asking them to reconsider purchases, and explaining that Padre is owned by a private equity fund valued at over \$1.5 billion but will not negotiate a fair EBA with workers. Padre have not provided a counter offer since receiving a log of claims from workers months ago. Padre workers in Brunswick (Victoria) took strike action in October 2025 [https://substack.com/redirect/613258db-d397-4d5d-8d52-c64659bfa2e2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

AEU/CPSU/HACSU Tasmania - Tasmanian public sector workers

Following a bumper week of industrial action including a rally and march on Parliament House in Hobart on Thursda [https://substack.com/redirect/93a0bd58-fec5-4123-a9d7-bf2989e16e80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]y (26/3), it's my understanding that unions and workers are considering revised offers from the state government. I don't have any further information at the time of writing, but would expect to hear more on this soon. Stay tuned.

PABO Watch

ETU WA - BHP

High-voltage ETU members at BHP in the Pilbara have overwhelmingly voted in favour of taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/cfcabc45c-65d4-4d23-8006-f3693a981402?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. I haven't been able to confirm if or when action might kick off, but the ETU would need to provide BHP with 5 days notice of any action. Maybe after Easter? Workers are fighting for a fair agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/f27b7150-9428-4f6f-937b-6ac2f2805ed4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], rather than being employed under individual contracts with subpar conditions.

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

The AEU ACT Branch Council passed a motion last week [https://substack.com/redirect/ceeac5a0-7203-423e-a38d-d6826e4c97d5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] that they had no confidence that the Education Directorate could resolve the current dispute between the directorate and teachers and so authorised Branch Secretary Patrick Judge to apply for a protection action ballot with a view to taking protected industrial action in Term 2. The ACT teachers' EBA

expired yesterday (31/3). Term 2 starts on 21 April.

ASU Vic - Metro city councils MEA

The ASU have reported that members at 8 metro city councils have “overwhelmingly endorsed industrial action” [https://substack.com/redirect/cdb72f4a-e3c9-4656-bf48-6a9404e19d65?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This paves the way for industrial

action in the multi-employer agreement negotiations. No other details at this stage - stay tuned.

NTEU Tasmania - University of Tasmania

The NTEU have advised that it will be applying for a protected action ballot [

https://substack.com/redirect/62ec429b-fec3-41c3-86f2-5249dde8425c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for its members at the University

of Tasmania. UTAS has been dragging its feet in making an offer around wages and has failed to accept the union’s proposed AI clause.

Wins/resolutions

CPSU/MEAA - ABC

On Monday (30/3) a mediated session at the FWC between unions and ABC Managing Director Hugh Marks took place. This follows last week’s 24 hour strike [https://substack.com/redirect/0419b3eb-2779-4fc1-b77d-ce4115c6bb9b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. It was

reported yesterday afternoon [https://substack.com/redirect/024cdc26-900b-4990-b8d3-c52aa2fb8d5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that an improved offer (10.5% over

3 years with 4% in the first year up from 10% over 3 years) was “endorsed by all bargaining representatives, including union delegates from both the CPSU and MEAA”. The offer includes a 10.5% wage increase over 3 years with 4% in the first year (up from the previous offer of 10% over 3 years). The offer also includes improvements to leave and automatic pay progression. The offer still needs to be endorsed by workers before it is finalised, but it looks like this could be a done deal.

That’s all I’ve got this week. I will be taking a little Easter break, so there won’t be a report next week. I’ll be back on deck with a full update on 15 April. If you need some extra reading material VAHPA Pulse [https://substack.com/redirect/d31af66c-372f-45d0-a4f0-f9506665a5d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] has a new post [

https://substack.com/redirect/f79fcaa8-5ffa-41ad-9693-d613a88d18c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] this week with an update on

bargaining and a forthcoming PABO; and Class Struggle [https://substack.com/redirect/abd4b0e8-a0c2-4281-8b02-f21bd312ccbb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] has a great piece about building momentum to win [https://substack.com/redirect/a14c559c-7c1b-48ec-b8aa-a0417cf96e98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the Victorian teachers’ EBA campaign. I hope you all have a great break over Easter, and if not - decent penalty rates.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3J1cG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVn1YMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1Ua3l0ekV5TlRJeUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056UTVPRGt5T1RVc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd05qVXl0VEk1TlN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhswDJWdFlXBHNjbjAuVWF0UlpvQUhZnlhUVUhc2FDVDk3cEtMR21va2lzeExsSlZLQmF3d1hDRSIsInAi0jE5MjcXmJyUyMiwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3NDk4OTI5NSwiZXhwIjoyMDkwNTY1Mjk1LClJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ._bqbzbSVx4np-r7JfQmKQKjxXjdJ3xZ95MScfJqgmZI?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-1-july>

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

The ANMF has reached an in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/5dba273f-9b81-4d5f-85a3-2b4ac8be2b8f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] with the SA government for public sector nurses and midwives. The agreement includes a 16% wage increase - 3% in January 2027, 3% in July 2027 and 4% in July 2028, and the 6% increase [https://substack.com/redirect/88c0c281-5af5-43a1-8f4f-40a4bb95bc01?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] already agreed to in February (4% backdated to 1 January and 2% from 26 October). This falls short of the 23% the ANMF was aiming for [https://substack.com/redirect/772b6bbe-4f4a-46df-8954-0e0697a65419?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], but is an improvement on the offer of 10.75% over 3 years rejected by the ANMF earlier this year. The ANMF is recommending members accept this deal [https://substack.com/redirect/94be469c-eeef-448d-a815-2eab0d461fff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] as it is the best that can currently be achieved and will avoid the risks and timelines associated with arbitration. But it's certainly not a ringing endorsement. Key amongst disappointments is the failure of the state government to "count the babies" [https://substack.com/redirect/26272d4d-a554-4e99-b775-ed432bdc1072?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] meaning that midwives' patient loads for ratios do not include their tiniest patients. While the ANMF executive have accepted this in-principle agreement, it still needs to be endorsed by nurses and midwives across the public sector... and based on Facebook comments there are plenty of ANMF members who are planning on voting no. Industrial action has been suspended while workers vote.

AMWU Vic - Campbell's Soup

AMWU members at Campbell's Soup have been undertaking industrial action for 6 weeks [https://substack.com/redirect/d951d474-1e8a-4617-a507-cc195ad9aee1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], but negotiations remain at a standstill. Bosses won't budge from their offer of a 7.7% wage increase over 3 years and an increase in the number of casuals at the factory. According to Campbell's, workers are seeking an 18% increase over 3 years - which bosses claim they can't afford [https://substack.com/redirect/010ecf1f-1eb1-450c-ade4-f2a7e9ed433f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. I'm no business analyst, but a quick google shows that while Campbell's (like many companies) is facing a bit of a pressure due to inflation and supply chain issues (join the club) it is still a hugely profitable global company. Local management is also emotively complaining about the loss of raw food due to industrial action. Time to get back to the negotiating table and make a decent offer so AMWU members can get back to making soup!

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

Last Wednesday (24/6), the AEU announced that at the start of Term 3 "all bans and limitations will recommence [https://substack.com/redirect/8063e03f-7b7e-442b-bccd-d195e50b8951?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]". I believe this will include a ban on attending one hour of meetings per week; a ban on principal members attending principal area forum meetings; a ban on responding to emails from the Department of Education; a ban on implementing any new Department programs and initiatives; and a ban on providing written comments on student reports. Term 2 has just come to an end in Victoria, and many parents are opening school reports with no comments in them as a result of the previous round of work bans. A reminder to upset parents that this could have been avoided by the Allan government getting their act together and providing a decent offer to teachers in a more timely manner. It is also worth reiterating that the amount of paid time available to teachers to "do reports" is woefully inadequate. Most school reports are completed at kitchen tables, after hours, completely unpaid. No money, no allowance, no time in lieu - nothing. So if anyone in your network is jumping on to the Herald Sun pile on [https://substack.com/redirect/6bccb3e9-3a34-4a68-b2c1-157dcd85bf3b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] about teachers denying parents important data about their kids, please ask them to redirect that angst towards Education Minister Ben Carroll and ask him to sort out a fair deal for teachers including adequate paid time for preparation, marking and reporting.

Offshore Alliance - DOF

I mentioned last week [https://substack.com/redirect/dc44f14c-e2f7-4c49-8828-2dd1eac1e687?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] that the Offshore Alliance had warned DOF was trying to hire scabs [https://substack.com/redirect/a72684a6-6e79-412a-89b8-cda8f8847112?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], but did not realise the extent of it. An article in [https://substack.com/redirect/db4dab6b-dc28-4dbb-8dcc-87179d422a86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] The Australian [https://substack.com/redirect/db4dab6b-dc28-4dbb-8dcc-87179d422a86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] outlines that recruiter Airswift was advertising specifically for foreign workers in response to industrial action. After being contacted by The Australian, Airswift said "the wording in the advertisement was inadvertently included and did not accurately reflect the purpose of the recruitment". Dubious. It looks like the LinkedIn post has now been taken down.

MEU NSW - Wambo washery

The lockout of MEU members [https://substack.com/redirect/0fed3c39-7df6-4a52-977b-e06b0fdf831f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] employed by Peabody at the Wambo washery continued into this week. The original notification from Peabody indicated the lockout ending today (1 July), but it could be extended. At the time of writing, it was not clear what the next step in the dispute will be. Workers on the picket line were visited by ACTU President Michele O'Neil [https://substack.com/redirect/719329de-37f4-4265-99b8-72134a2fa2e3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and local ALP MP Dan Repacholi [https://substack.com/redirect/c248cb56-7631-427f-9380-2ee1407e6b58?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Workers are not happy with the proposed wage increase put forward by Peabody and are prepared to fight for a better deal.

Professionals Australia ACT - Public sector professionals
Professionals Australia members across the ACT public sector including forensic scientists, medical physicists, pharmacists and engineers commenced indefinite industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/e04d532a-271c-442b-88c8-878dd8a61bc7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Monday (29/6) These workers are all part of the broader ACT public sector negotiations, dissatisfied with the territory government's below-inflation offer of 3% annual wage increases, delayed improvements to superannuation and no backpay. Workers across the public service are frustrated with the negotiations. For forensic scientists at the ACT Government's Analytical Laboratory a breaking point was the Government ignoring a claim requesting a hazard allowance [https://substack.com/redirect/ef4b452f-fe92-4710-99c9-1d98f74ac7df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The claim was not rejected, just ignored. The indefinite action includes [https://substack.com/redirect/d303a901-8ada-47ab-ab93-898730ce8547?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] bans on correspondence, electronic messaging, phone calls, out-of-hours work and external meetings.

ASU Vic - Metropolitan Melbourne councils

Industrial action continues at all 8 metropolitan Melbourne councils currently fighting for a multi-employer agreement. This includes low level bans like wearing union campaign t-shirts and stopping work to share information about the dispute with community members. The ASU is working to progressively implement further bans in consultation with members in different work groups. ASU members at Maribyrnong [https://substack.com/redirect/5a122819-ca33-4f86-a2f2-f4be8d508067?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and Merri-Bek have already implemented additional bans including street cleaning and library bans. As reported last week, the ASU has alleged the Hume City Council illegally docked workers for participating in partial work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/7af075ee-dcce-4fe1-bef7-f49646053f1f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] earlier this year. I have been informed that some Merri-Bek workers have also received pay docking notices for their additional bans which the union is examining.

Professionals Australia/ASU - DXC

Workers at DXC have rejected the tech contractor's latest offer [https://substack.com/redirect/7a7375eb-6d2c-41dc-95e7-3df6cf34d813?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. 74% of voters voted no in the recent ballot. While the deal included a one off \$1000 payment, it had standby rates going backwards; no backpay and no cost of living increase. Professionals Australia also shared that while DXC agreed to a number of clauses in negotiations, it then deleted them without notifying anyone [https://substack.com/redirect/2aeba79d-08f1-4a9f-8360-28fd6d8e6bad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] before putting the agreement out to vote. These clauses included important items like workplace delegates' rights; union induction access and union secondment leave. Subpar behaviour and a subpar agreement.

In short

NTEU Tasmania - University of Tasmania

The NTEU shared a comprehensive bargaining update [https://substack.com/redirect/07ec975e-c53f-4ac3-b0e9-b1132a6bc039?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from UTas which shows progress on workload; leave provisions; secure work and AI. Still no progress on salaries - NTEU has lowered its bar, but the University says it needs to be below 3.4%. In this economy?!! I don't believe there is any current industrial action in place. Know more? Let me know!

AMWU/ETU WA - BHP (Mining Area C & South Flank)

Both the AMWU [https://substack.com/redirect/f342424c-a353-4109-99dd-661bd22ab2a0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and ETU [https://substack.com/redirect/0aafb198-a7cd-4218-b976-daf4156d56b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Both the AMWU [https://substack.com/redirect/f342424c-a353-4109-99dd-661bd22ab2a0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and ETU [https://substack.com/redirect/0aafb198-a7cd-4218-b976-daf4156d56b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Both the AMWU [https://substack.com/redirect/f342424c-a353-4109-99dd-661bd22ab2a0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and ETU [https://substack.com/redirect/0aafb198-a7cd-4218-b976-daf4156d56b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Both the AMWU [https://substack.com/redirect/f342424c-a353-4109-99dd-661bd22ab2a0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and ETU [https://substack.com/redirect/0aafb198-a7cd-4218-b976-daf4156d56b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] are recommending a no vote on the agreement put out to a vote by BHP. The Western Mineworkers Alliance [https://substack.com/redirect/39fbd748-18a5-49e8-aa22-a423cbcb3841?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (AWU and MEU) isn't publicly recommending either a yes or no vote, just saying it is important to vote. The ballot closes on Friday (3/7). This agreement covers workers at Mining Area C and South Flank, so a different agreement to the one covering workers in port operations that I wrote about last week.

CEPU Tasmania - TasWater

The CEPU has formally lodged a dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/9178acca-7f63-4994-b9d6-ece93eb74500?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with TasWater over a plan to reduce the presence of operators at water and sewerage treatment plants. TasWater's plan would see monitoring shift to remote systems and automation [https://substack.com/redirect/2abcb86d-f34d-46ad-a2ba-b70df25f832b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The dispute has been lodged as Environment Tasmania demonstrated that TasWater released more than half a billion litres of improperly treated sewage [https://substack.com/redirect/c68a514c-0259-49fb-bb0b-b0e24af176e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] into the state's waterways in 2024-2025.

CFMEU SA - Unknown major builders

The SA Branch of the CFMEU put up a video [https://substack.com/redirect/e56e6f1c-945e-483e-b66d-9f20afacd891?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on the weekend saying that protected action ballots had been voted up at 5 major builders, and that protected industrial action would kick off this week across "several major sites". I have been unable to confirm any more concrete (ha ha) details at the time of writing. There are ballot results for the CFMEU on the FWC website for Built, Lendlease, Multiplex, Watpac and Hansen Yuncken so I assume those are the 5. Are you a CFMEU member in SA who can shed light on this? Get in touch!

PABO Watch

Offshore Alliance - UGL Varanus Island

Union members employed by UGL on Varanus Island are voting in a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/c438a426-7d62-4ab9-a6db-d52a4026485c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. According to the Alliance, the pay offer from UGL is 16% less than workers' demands, with miserable 2% wage increases in the second, third and fourth years of the agreement. Workers are fighting for an industry standard agreement with decent pay and allowances as well as training pay, overcycle rates and cyclone pay during cyclone stand downs. Varanus Island is Santos' gas processing base off the coast of WA near Karratha. The ballot closed yesterday (30/6) but no results were available at the time of writing.

CFMEU ACT - GSOs

Canberra's General Service Officers have overwhelmingly endorsed industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/6f74aeb6-2097-47cf-a676-97415da897c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Of the 300 who voted in a protected action ballot, 99% were in favour of industrial action. These CFMEU members are another cohort of workers involved in the broader ACT public sector negotiations. GSOs manage maintenance, waste management, parks and sports grounds in the ACT and are seeking a 12% wage increase over 3 years.

ASMOF Vic - Public hospital doctors

On Monday (29/6), a meeting of more than 2000 ASMOF members endorsed the union applying for a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/374b304f-a33b-4dad-9bdd-4ed566089cff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Only 12 members voted against it. The last major industrial action by doctors in Victoria - a stop work meeting - was over 20 years ago. ASMOF has been in negotiations for a new agreement for 10 months but have now reached a stalemate. Key issues are understood to be high workloads; unsafe hours and poor pay [https://substack.com/redirect/11681e2e-c453-47ce-9690-8bbc113385b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

That's all I've got this week. In closing I'll just mention that I saw the UFU Victorian Branch posted about the Workplace Relations Legislation Amendment (Building Cooperative Workplaces No. 1) Bill 2026 [https://substack.com/redirect/798e9f84-c036-40b1-9597-edacd6751a55?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which has now passed both houses. According to the Firies, Greens Senator Barbara Pocock successfully moved an amendment that means for agreements being dealt with by the FWC through intractable bargaining, conditions cannot go backwards - they can only stay the same or improve. For the UFU in Victoria [https://substack.com/redirect/2edf6730-3a73-410d-ab72-1af09e2fac7a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], this means their own intractable bargaining negotiations will now focus on wages, with existing conditions protected. Intractable bargaining is not my strong point, so please get in touch if I've missed something here! And any union lawyers reading this (I know a few of you subscribe!) let me know if there are other elements of the Bill that workers should be aware of.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzZGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMmMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNJNk1qQTBNall3TwpBMExdSnBZWFpT2pFM09ESTROVFV5TURnc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE5ETTUNVEl3T0N3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDNpKV0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhsWDJldFlxbHNjbjAuQ2RFc3hjRndpeU9MLWIitVHk5YUdTVFJzNVJuNkpzw1lSNkdad3RKWVlGOCIsInAiOjIwNDI2MDIwNCwicwYiMjA5NTe3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNmMsIm1hdCI6MTc2Mjg1NTIwOiwicwIjZlZWhwIjoyMDk4NDNMxmJA4LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.Y8H5hvkdG6CURkrsgd2na8UkBssBtATHKPG1IzUUeko?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-1-october>

ETU NSW - Ampcontrol

60 workers at Ampcontrol walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/a7b7ce3e-9f1f-4e45-bdba-ae77fdce6fd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] last week and rallied at the switchboard manufacturers' headquarters in Tomago. Other than the fact workers are rallying for a fair deal, I don't have much in the way of details on this dispute. Get in touch if you know more!

UWU WA - DBCA

On Saturday (27/9) park rangers in WA took strike action. UWU members have been trying to negotiate a new EBA for 18 months [https://substack.com/redirect/72efc43a-5b96-446a-831b-2f0fc3c68f0a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], but the Department of Biodiversity, Conservation and Attractions (DBCA) remain "inflexible". Workers feel underpaid, overworked and ignored [https://substack.com/redirect/3f4a3f4b-08b3-48bd-aa49-1f58840c08d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] by the government, and are fighting for a fair deal that recognises their variable and unsociable hours of work.

AMWU QLD - Superior Pak

True to their word, AMWU members at Superior Pak in Bundaberg stayed out on strike all last week [https://substack.com/redirect/a8603dfe-9060-4118-83a8-98b8b46553da?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. I'm not sure if more industrial action is planned for this week or not. Workers are fighting for a fair EBA that recognises workers' skills, and delivers decent wages, respect, and safe working conditions.

ETU NSW - Schindler

Schindler workers' strike continues, with workers rallying outside HQ last Tuesday (23/9). The ETU has characterised Schindler's approach to negotiations as "disrespectful, deceitful, and downright difficult." Workers are fighting for pay parity with Schindler employees in other states.

NSWNMA - Public sector nurses & midwives

The NSWNMA's Special Case in the NSW IRC commenced yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/2acc40f6-aef3-4a73-909b-1411603404fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (30/9). The hearing will run for 6 weeks until early November with closing submissions scheduled for 9-11 December and a decision to be handed down in 2026. The special case is based on the Log of Claims endorsed by members including [https://substack.com/redirect/c0cc6307-92d0-49ba-a06d-2873b4c6a32b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] a 35% wage increase over 3 years; an allowance for PTS members and an increase to sick leave from 10 to 20 days. Separately to the Special Case, 88.2% of participating NSWNMA public sector branches voted in favour of accepting the government's interim offer. The offer included an interim 3% wage increase (back paid to 1 July 2025); night duty penalty rate increase to 20%; consultation required before published roster changes are made and other improvements. The interim offer is now being drafted into the award and will still need to pass through the IRC before the wage increase and other benefits flow to nurses and midwives. The interim offer doesn't have bearing on the Special Case.

AMWU Victoria - Bucher Municipal

Workers at Bucher Municipal took their first ever industrial action last Thursday (25/9). Workers are fighting for improved working conditions and paths for reclassification and progression.

TWU QLD - Cleanaway

TWU members at Cleanaway in Townsville took strike action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/1e1b0ba7-bb1d-4d2d-8961-1664181b4c48?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (26/9). Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal, having already voted down a lowball agreement. Workers want to ensure their pay keeps up with local competitors, as well as securing safer rosters and improved consultation clauses [https://substack.com/redirect/708ec824-4866-4101-9994-66c5a8393d20?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The TWU is demanding Cleanaway come back to the table with a decent deal after negotiations broke down.

ASU Victoria - Central Goldfields Shire Council

Last Wednesday, ASU members at the Central Goldfields Shire Council commenced industrial action for the first time [https://substack.com/redirect/7f4cad51-8bba-4cb3-b1a8-4bd93482aa3b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The union has been in negotiations for 9 months [https://substack.com/redirect/e372740f-4391-4476-90de-e071d1e34973?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and the major sticking point in the dispute is wages. The Council has offered 3% annual increases, but the ASU is fighting for 3% [https://substack.com/redirect/b9fc7659-071c-497b-a429-9057a71556ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] or [<https://substack.com/redirect/b9fc7659-071c-497b-a429-9057a71556ab>]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]\$55 per week each year - which ever is greater [[https://substack.com/redirect/b9fc7659-071c-497b-a429-9057a71556ab?](https://substack.com/redirect/b9fc7659-071c-497b-a429-9057a71556ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This ensures workers on lower wages who have been hit hardest by cost of living increases receive a decent wage increase. This could be as much as \$1024 per annum for a Band 2A worker. Industrial action has commenced with writing slogans on vehicles and leafleting, but could escalate to stop work action if the Council doesn't come to the table with an improved offer.

UFU SA - SA firefighters

Monday (29/9) marked the start of "Stage Five" of the UFU SA's campaign [

[https://substack.com/redirect/8540f972-9b66-4045-978d-40e780fc7ae0?](https://substack.com/redirect/8540f972-9b66-4045-978d-40e780fc7ae0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This includes a "sign bombing mosaic", large campaign signs and more bans. It is proposed that October will be a month of protest for the firies commencing with a shop stewards meeting next week. The UFU has been in negotiations with the SA Government for a fair deal for over 12 months.

HACSU Tasmania - The Hobart Clinic

The Hobart Clinic, the last private mental health inpatient facility in Southern Tassie, announced they will close at the end of October [[https://substack.com/redirect/a9d29136-8d4e-4af8-a85b-e05aaa43e950?](https://substack.com/redirect/a9d29136-8d4e-4af8-a85b-e05aaa43e950?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]]. HACSU are holding a community rally tomorrow (Thursday 2 October) outside the Executive Building on Murray Street. Please get along and join the union and workers in their call for the government to intervene and keep the clinic open. Long term readers of this report will recall coverage of a dispute at The Hobart Clinic in early 2024 when management spent precious resources on legal fees [

[https://substack.com/redirect/f49f6f62-bb1c-44ea-944d-f28ccab7d8ee?](https://substack.com/redirect/f49f6f62-bb1c-44ea-944d-f28ccab7d8ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to get the FWC to intervene and suspend industrial action. Management also categorized workers wearing pink campaign t-shirts as "a serious risk to our patients" [[https://substack.com/redirect/b167c9e6-433a-4bcd-9bc8-a99e92b93360?](https://substack.com/redirect/b167c9e6-433a-4bcd-9bc8-a99e92b93360?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

UFU WA - WA firefighters

Worthwhile having a listen to a radio interview with UFU WA Secretary John Marsh [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d24b19f1-1cfa-4409-98cd-45d34c711350?](https://substack.com/redirect/d24b19f1-1cfa-4409-98cd-45d34c711350?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] about the current dispute between firies and the WA State Government. Negotiations have been underway for 8 months, a second offer was made a week ago and is currently being revised. It is expected to be back with the UFU by 9 October. Key sticking points in the dispute include a low base rate of pay; severe staffing issues and workers feeling like they are not being treated with respect. A lot of technical information in this dispute, so I encourage you to listen to the interview for more specific detail. Firies' demands include [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a0ef968d-3cbd-4d1e-811a-a354364b5f3f?](https://substack.com/redirect/a0ef968d-3cbd-4d1e-811a-a354364b5f3f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] parity with availability & on-call allowances; fair base wages; a funded work-value review; backpay on unpaid overtime as a result of the annualised wage review; tiered deployment allowances; leading firefighter and station officer classification reform; and specialist classification allowances for additional skills and roles.

Professionals Australia QLD - Department of Transport and Main Roads

Engineers and other technical professionals in Queensland's Department of Transport and Main Roads

walked off the job again on Monday [[https://substack.com/redirect/623b40a0-5d57-4a36-a07d-bd262f8b0945?](https://substack.com/redirect/623b40a0-5d57-4a36-a07d-bd262f8b0945?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (29/9). This follows earlier strike action in August and workers instituting work bans in July. Workers are seeking a 15% pay increase in order to keep up with wages of interstate counterparts. Professionals Australia director Sean Kelly warned that "If we're going to deliver the herculean infrastructure task required to host the Olympics and Paralympics, we need engineers flowing into the state, not fleeing it."

Monday's strike followed months of disappointing negotiations. The strikers were supported by ETU and AMWU members [[https://substack.com/redirect/b6b19eb4-fe68-4472-b83a-27ada4fb9002?](https://substack.com/redirect/b6b19eb4-fe68-4472-b83a-27ada4fb9002?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] who are also in dispute with the Department.

AMWU/CEPU Tasmania - Fonterra

Maintenance workers at Fonterra factories in Spreyton and Wynyard commenced industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/775e3da8-2942-4d37-9c50-98294ee4e345?](https://substack.com/redirect/775e3da8-2942-4d37-9c50-98294ee4e345?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in September. AMWU and CEPU members have been participating in rolling stoppages and call-out bans; and union members rallied outside the Spreyton factory on Monday (29/9). The workers are fighting for pay parity with Fonterra workers on the mainland; 10 days personal leave; better provisions around call-backs and a shutdown allowance.

AMWU Vic - Ford

I thought Ford had been completely shuttered in Geelong and Broadmeadows but seemingly not because AMWU members at Ford are taking industrial action for the first time in 25 years! Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal to keep up with the cost of living. I'd love any information on what is

happening at these two sites - both in terms of industrial action, but also operationally. This also seems like too good an opportunity to not share this excellent archival footage [https://substack.com/redirect/0e81bba2-0bc7-4aeb-ac05-3f0bcb9a8d6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the 1973 strike at Ford in Broadmeadows.

Unions - AUKUS

Over 40 organisations have signed the Port Kembla Declaration [https://substack.com/redirect/c0e8c4df-5e8c-45a7-a0f0-8c4d0c349a6f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which calls on the Federal Government to rule out Port Kembla as a potential nuclear submarine base site as part of the AUKUS deal. Union groups that have signed onto the declaration [https://substack.com/redirect/c97bc957-157a-4257-86e2-0c715c225be9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] include the ASU (Illawarra Subdivision); Illawarra Teachers Association; Illawarra Union Singers; IEU (South Coast Branch); MUA (Port Kembla branch); NTEU (Wollongong University Branch); Shoalhaven Teachers Association; South Coast Labour Council; South Illawarra Teachers Association; Southern Highlands Teachers Association and Unions Shoalhaven. Port Kembla is the home of the 1938 Dalfram Dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/4f22aeab-82ad-4969-bcb2-3eb1e182e3c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] where wharfies refused to load pig iron on boats to Japan fearing (accurately) that the iron would be used to bomb China, and possibly even Australia. As the MUA's Garry Keane says "Our union has always supported peace over confrontation and the Dalfram dispute is a prime example of that – we will stand by those principles and do everything we can to oppose a nuclear submarine base in Port Kembla." [https://substack.com/redirect/c0e8c4df-5e8c-45a7-a0f0-8c4d0c349a6f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] Three preferred locations for a new submarine base on the east coast were flagged in 2022 - Port Kembla, Brisbane and Newcastle [https://substack.com/redirect/169b53e5-0b57-42b6-9afb-3adbb8973fa3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Might be time for unionists in Brissy and Newcastle to organise similar opposition? If that work is already underway - let me know! That's all I've got this week! I am going to take a week off from the report next week, but I will be back on Wednesday 15 October with a full update. Thanks so much for reading. Get in touch to share what I've missed, or what's kicking off in your workplace or union.

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UYzBPVEU1TnpJNExDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05Ua3l0amM0Tnpnc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNU1EZ3dNemczT0N3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAuMXpwZzc1NHZPeVEwd0dMMjBxakw5eEMzQW9GYWwMQ0hzSWxfZ29WTExLVSIzInAiOjE3NDkxOTcyOCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImldCI6MTc1OTI2Nzg3OCwiZXhwIjoyMDc0ODQzODc4LClJpc3MiOiJWdWI6MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.CUKJqqXMzOvtxzW2lsLrmv7XFV1TybsPfDz7x4d0tTc?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-10-december>

RAFFWU - Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books

Workers at Harry Hartog and Bekelouw Books (HHBB) will commence strike action on Saturday (13/12) at 11am [https://substack.com/redirect/d7c42479-9b8b-4b4b-ae41-b6e6f763c58e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The strike is expected to continue on Sunday as well. The dedicated workers at HHBB have been stuck on a “zombie” agreement with terrible conditions including no penalty rates on evenings, weekends and public holidays. RAFFWU members at HHBB are fighting for a fair deal including a living wage of \$31 per hour; penalty rates; protection against unfair treatment; improved leave provisions and job security. For Sydneysiders, get along and support RAFFWU members by joining their rally [https://substack.com/redirect/76dad959-bd47-486b-ac4f-62863394b4fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on Saturday at the Norton Street Plaza outside the Berkelouw Leichardt shop. RAFFWU has also started a strike fund [https://substack.com/redirect/c6df3701-b9fb-49e8-b16e-d0d28b601617?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to support striking workers. Please donate if you can.

HSU/UWU NT - Public sector health workers

Last Wednesday (3/12) public sector healthcare workers across the Northern Territory stopped work for 1 hour [https://substack.com/redirect/cbcfcbe8-85bc-4572-86d5-9be1189157a0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for decent wage increases that “reflect the complexity, intensity, and responsibility [https://substack.com/redirect/b12ecc7d-ef09-45a0-be20-89b21d9640c1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]” of the work being performed. Workers also have concerns about staffing levels. Unions argue that the offer made by the Territory government will not address worker fatigue, improve retention or appropriately recognise workers’ skills [https://substack.com/redirect/c4e6b86d-c13e-4e7b-8049-afb5f97bd6ca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Regardless of what unions think, the Territory government has put the offer (including a wage component of 13.65% over 4 years) out to be voted on by workers. The ballot closes on Monday (15/12).

UWU QLD - Queensland Health

Hundreds of radiation therapists and nuclear medicine scientists from Queensland’s public hospitals walked off the job for two hours last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/b2a4186e-beba-4dc3-9fcf-15a390b308f4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (3/12). The latest offer from Queensland Health includes proposals that would see some workers lose up to \$30,000 in take home pay due to the scrapping of a retention bonus [https://substack.com/redirect/39ebe401-82f7-49e3-871c-fee345b0fdf9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] introduced in recognition of radiation therapy skills and the need for Queensland to retain these crucial health workers. Queensland Health is refusing to budge from its offer of an 8% pay increase over 3 years, and applied to the QIRC for conciliation in late October after stalling negotiations for months.

ANMF Vic - Healthscope

ANMF members will implement work stoppages in theatres [https://substack.com/redirect/dfffccb2-4f3e-4c58-b7e3-7941ce9477ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] at Healthscope facilities today (10/12) from 11am - 3pm. Following nurses and midwives voting down the last offer from Healthscope, the ANMF has been eager to get back to negotiations but Healthscope has not yet agreed to meet. In addition to theatre stoppages; ANMF members continue wearing campaign t-shirts; talking to patients and media about the dispute; ensuring to take all breaks and a number of work bans.

HWU Vic - Public sector health workers

On Thursday (19/12), HWU members who work as cooks, cleaners, orderlies, ward clerks, theatre technicians, phlebotomists and allied health assistants walked off the job and marched to Parliament House in Melbourne [https://substack.com/redirect/1f81645c-4902-43be-91e2-f1205110af33?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. It was the first industrial action taken by HWU members in the public sector for 25 years and involved workers from 80 public health services. 20 meetings with the Victorian Hospital Industrial Association have resulted in broad agreement on many “non-cost” items, but wages remain the major sticking point. HWU members view the last offer from the state government (3% annual wage increases on a 4 year agreement) as “an insult”. The HWU has warned that industrial action will escalate in the new year if the state government doesn’t make a suitable offer.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU WA - Ventia

On Thursday (4/12), union workers at the BP refinery in Kwinana walked off the job to hold a stop work meeting [https://substack.com/redirect/45da8814-b554-43bf-9602-be558eefb683?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] demanding fair wages and decent

conditions from Ventia. According to the ETU, workers employed by Ventia at BP Kwinana are earning \$80 less a week in real terms than they did in 2018 [https://substack.com/redirect/eb5e3f8a-c1cb-4016-a22a-39ab5e5e6dcc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The three unions are committed to lifting standards across Kwinana and ensuring every worker is paid what they are worth.

AWU - Experience Co

Skydivers at the Experience Co struck for 48 hours commencing on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/a10a041a-be56-4532-a602-a9a7098cbbc8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (5/12). The industrial action took place at 8 sites across the east coast. Industrial action has continued this week with work bans instituted from Monday (8/12) including not jumping with cameras and refusing to do tandem jumps with anyone weighing more than 85 kilograms. The industrial action comes after 10 months of negotiations for the first EBA at the business. Some offers have included cuts of between -\$20,000 and -\$100,000 a year, while the latest proposal would slash the minimum annual wage for skydiving instructors from \$57,000 to just \$49,000, with earnings dependent on a very low “per jump” piece-rate [https://substack.com/redirect/b81560e0-7a91-48b5-b302-1d8817889f69?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A bargaining meeting was expected to be held on Monday (8/12), and the union has not ruled out further industrial action.

Professionals Australia/UWU - Ambulance Victoria

The Herald Sun has reported that industrial action at Ambulance Victoria, including “deferring and delaying [https://substack.com/redirect/d96113e2-aa17-45a2-8e7e-df59be8db8e6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” the processing of invoices is causing Ambulance Victoria to lose out on \$1 million a day. Both corporate staff who are members of Ambulance Managers and Professionals Association (a division of Professionals Australia) and maintenance staff with UWU [https://substack.com/redirect/86fd90a4-fcee-4313-b882-bcfbde410034?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] are currently undertaking a range of work bans and industrial action.

AMWU/CPSU/UWU Vic - CSL Behring

Workers at CSL in Broadmeadows went on strike for 24 hours on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/5b982613-b82f-4262-8bf4-1f92b9f604b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (5/12). Members of the AMWU [https://substack.com/redirect/bf80db9e-7fe6-401e-b178-f84696cccf18?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], CPSU [https://substack.com/redirect/780d76db-3250-48b0-b2af-10d2c8466997?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and UWU [https://substack.com/redirect/247682f2-7cfe-4016-9b73-2711923f3505?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] participated in the strike. Workers have already voted down one offer from CSL, but the bosses have put a “revised” offer out to vote. The revised offer includes a 10.5% wage increase over 3 years and minor improvements to back pay, sick leave and catch-up pay [https://substack.com/redirect/c64f9f36-a17a-477d-9c7e-febc96637cfe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Unions are fighting for at least a 13% wage increase to achieve parity with CSL Seqirus, another division of the business. In addition to a fair wage increase workers are also pursuing improved rostering rights; working from home rights (where appropriate); improved career progression and the trialling of a 4 day work week where workers would get the same pay for working 80% of the time provided they achieve the same productivity

AEU Tasmania - Public sector teachers

For the second time in two months, public school teachers in Tasmania are set to take strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/82932777-44be-4672-b5b8-b90e76ac82fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to demand fair pay; workload relief and solutions to what the union calls “the growing school violence crisis”. On Friday (12/12), teachers will not commence work until 12 noon [https://substack.com/redirect/0532409d-4fba-462a-beca-e27519722b79?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], instead spending the morning at AEU stop work actions across the state. In addition to the stop work, a number of work bans will be implemented as well. AEU members will “cease all communication, sign-in processes, and administrative work relating to school closures, staffing or supervision arrangements associated with the industrial action”. The AEU has also directed that principal members are not to complete duty of care transfer or an Absent Without Duty forms for stop work actions. Tasmanian workers are encouraged to get along and support local teachers at rallies on 12 December [https://substack.com/redirect/1bf1485b-2b9d-466c-9a3a-c869dbb04f4d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] starting at 9:30am in Hobart (St David’s Park); Launceston (Royal Park) and Burnie (South Burnie Foreshore).

AMWU/CFMEU NSW - UGL

Workers at Vales Point Power Station commenced strike action last week - the first picket line at Vales Point since 1981. Workers are fighting for pay parity with UGL employees doing similar work in

other states. The gap in wages is up to \$10 an hour.

PSA SA - Correctional officers

Correctional officers at 7 prisons across South Australia commenced a 24 hour stoppage on Monday (8/12) and voted for another 24 hour stoppage yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/4ff02b39-3790-407f-90cb-1c340a75d0a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (9/12) with media reports that PSA members had resolved to continue strike action “indefinitely” [https://substack.com/redirect/eb4964ac-4c18-4ab1-83da-4e9fa00d8a4e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The union claims the stoppages are in response to several violent incidents in prisons, the most recent on Sunday at the Yatala Labour Prison. The Department of Correctional Services has refuted this saying the industrial action was organised prior to the assault. Regardless, Correctional Officers in South Australia’s prisons have a number of concerns including violence, low pay and and a “recruitment emergency” [https://substack.com/redirect/eb4964ac-4c18-4ab1-83da-4e9fa00d8a4e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Two prisons in SA - Mt Gambier and the Adelaide Remand Centre are run privately and are not affected by the strike action. The PSA shared on social media that they understood the SA Government had contacted the Mt Gambier prison seeking an “alternative workforce” [https://substack.com/redirect/2c62a933-5089-420e-a4a3-30ecb627cb2b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] - scab labour to break the strike. It must be acknowledged that while correctional officers are on strike, the people in those jails are in “lockdown” and stuck in the cells 24 hours a day - a horrible thing to have to endure. We can only hope the SA Government comes to the table ASAP with a better deal for correctional officers.

AMWU NSW - Progress Rail

AMWU members at Progress Rail have held two 24 hour stoppages in the last fortnight. The most recent stoppage was held on Friday (5/12). Workers are fighting for a fair wage increase.

CEPU/RTBU Tasmania - TasRail

Workers at TasRail will commence industrial action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/f444cb4a-ec7c-4b0a-a9d2-9a2a371b5716?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (12/12). Unions have been in negotiations with TasRail for 8 months, but attempts to improve wages and conditions have failed at the negotiation table. Workers are fighting for a fair deal, for themselves and to improve the attraction and retention issues at TasRail

HACSU Tasmania - Public sector healthcare workers

HACSU members in Tasmania continue their industrial campaign demanding a fair deal from the state government. On Thursday (4/12) pharmacy staff, podiatry staff and medical physicists at the Royal Hobart Hospital stopped work for 1 hour [https://substack.com/redirect/433caf9c-d4b8-4be9-adf1-9683222e4b7d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. On Monday (8/12), workers at the Roy Fagan Centre, a specialised inpatient facility supporting elderly people with mental health conditions stopped work for 1 hour [https://substack.com/redirect/c1394e7d-8d01-458c-85e8-0e5a9f9bf802?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers at the centre are angry with the state government for their failure to negotiate a fair wage increase, and refusal to negotiate an occupational violence allowance. And yesterday (9/12), cleaners, food services workers, trades staff, administration staff, hospital aides and theatre support staff at the Launceston General Hospital stopped work for 1 hour over the government’s lousy wages offer. I think the frequency of HACSU’s stoppages across Tasmania may require me to upgrade this from an industrial campaign to an industrial onslaught!

The Services Union QLD - Urban Utilities

Urban Utilities workers walked off the job again yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/c550d4ec-358c-4a3a-b716-f7e79f4f7232?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (9/12) after management forced a second Enterprise Agreement to a ballot. The Services Union is urging workers to vote no on the agreement as it is largely unchanged from the proposed EBA workers voted down in September aside from being longer and some short term incentives. Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal to keep up with the cost of living, and to achieve parity with workers at Brisbane City Council - the largest shareholder of Urban Utilities.

CFMEU WA - Freo Cranes

CFMEU members at Freo Cranes in the Pilbara walked off the job for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/41c0fab6-5833-49a9-be3d-398e0e2b93eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] commencing at 6am on Friday (5/12). 150 workers participated in the action, with more industrial action likely before Christmas.

MEU NSW - Glencore

The MEU has been successful in its application for an intractable bargaining declaration [https://substack.com/redirect/6b962079-65a1-416c-a019-2da43c12824e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The union has been in negotiations with the multinational since March 2024, and MEU members at the Ulan Underground mine commenced industrial action in June 2025 [<https://substack.com/redirect/677ea6b6-fe01-4037-aeac->

82b13f514811?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The MEU and Glencore will now participate in a 21 day post declaration negotiation period. A media release from the MEU says this will run from 5 December - 26 December and that the MEU “remains ready to participate in genuine negotiations”.

ETU WA - TK Elevators

ETU members at TK Elevators in Perth have been participating in work bans for several weeks - working full shifts, but with bans in place. Yesterday (9/12), management decided to refuse to pay workers if they continued the partial work bans. In response to this overreach from the employer, workers have withdrawn their labour [[https://substack.com/redirect/f826a707-97dc-4b72-88a8-d391a93d43eb?](https://substack.com/redirect/f826a707-97dc-4b72-88a8-d391a93d43eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The ETU has an important reminder for anyone inconvenienced: “The responsibility for disruption sits squarely with management. Pay workers for the work they do. It is not complicated.”

That’s all I’ve got this week. A quick reminder for comrades in Melbourne if you can get down to Trades Hall on Thursday morning to support VAHPA rank and file as they attend their Special General Meeting please do! Thursday 11 December, Trades Hall, Lygon Street Entrance from 10am [

[https://substack.com/redirect/952cc472-0297-422f-87a0-d21bcda3a421?](https://substack.com/redirect/952cc472-0297-422f-87a0-d21bcda3a421?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UZ3hNVEk0TkRRd0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05qVXpNVEkxTlRRc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNU5qZzBPRFUXtkN3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuLTRpTnM1SVI4MWl3NlJqWwNmclFaFpHWHliMDdJNFVheHJXNnBseF9wYyIsInAiOjE4MTEyODQ0MCIwIjE6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.GVe_kOnKU-Ra0nF4VmOmfmZBhuGyMPdZPea6hMcYwn0?3Mi0iJwdWI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.GVe_kOnKU-Ra0nF4VmOmfmZBhuGyMPdZPea6hMcYwn0?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-11-june>

AMWU Vic - Crown Equipment

Over the weekend, workers at Crown Equipment in Wodonga, Mulgrave and Truganina commenced industrial action. It is understood workers are implementing bans on overtime and call outs. Workers are fighting for decent wages and improved working conditions.

SASMOA - SA Doctors

SA doctors are due to walk off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/a4af2d0b-5c8f-4f3f-9397-3f6a466f8e11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on Wednesday 25 June. The stop work action would see approximately 2500 - 3000 doctors stop work for one hour from 8:30 am [https://substack.com/redirect/a6edcfff1-259f-4fb1-8b15-0264fd48728e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

This escalation follows a prolonged stalemate in negotiations that have been underway for eight months. SASMOA is seeking a 10% annual wage increases over three years. In addition to improved wages and conditions [https://substack.com/redirect/2eb4b79b-a4a6-4ac5-afca-7da71dfd4db1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]

doctors are also seeking the government to provide them with an appropriate workforce plan.

ETU WA - Ventia

ETU members employed by Ventia at Barrow Island have been participating in industrial action since 14 March - by my count that is 90 days today. Bargaining for a new EBA commenced in September last year. Workers are seeking parity with maintenance workers on other Chevron assets. Time for Ventia to come to the table with a fair deal.

QNMU - Public sectors nurses & midwives

On Thursday (5 June), nurses and midwives in Queensland's public hospitals commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/2338b70f-0b14-4874-8ea4-7d5cb5acdffd3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] for the first time in 23 years.

QNMU Secretary Sarah Beaman reiterated that "The government promised us nation-leading wages and conditions, and we are taking action to make them deliver their promise." In "Stage One" industrial action, nurses and midwives will wear pink campaign t-shirts and distribute campaign materials. The union has warned that industrial action will escalate if the government doesn't respond.

HSU SA - Allied health workers

Allied health workers in SA have been fighting for a dedicated EBA for better wages and conditions for over 9 months. This week, workers will participate in stopwork actions to increase the pressure on SA Health [https://substack.com/redirect/1ebc527b-bb60-4fff-92b5-c75f0628c9ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

Yesterday (10/6) HSU members from Central Adelaide rallied at the RAH Amphitheatre. Today (11/6), HSU members from Southern Adelaide will rally at the Flinders Medical Centre from 12 noon; and regional members will walk off the job for an hour at 12 noon. Finally on Thursday (12/6) a rally will be held at the Lyell McEwin Hospital in Elizabeth Vale for Northern Adelaide members. Please get along to one of the rallies if you can.

Professionals Australia - SA Health

Medical physicists and radio pharmaceutical scientists employed by SA health walked off the job for an hour and half yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/12649c3c-6b22-40a4-baff-813a67abff01?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (10/6). The Professionals

Australia members have been taking industrial action in the form of work bans for some months [https://substack.com/redirect/5fff67846-e270-4f4c-839b-2252a6a53f85?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

The workers are seeking a 30 to 40% wage increase in order to have pay parity with interstate colleagues. Without a significant pay increase it is likely South Australia will lose these highly qualified professionals to other states. Work bans thus far have been about working to rule, ensuring breaks are taken and finishing work on time. Yesterday's stopwork was an escalation of tactics in order to increase pressure on the state government.

HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

HACSU members who work in the public mental health sector will participate in a second statewide stopwork next week on Tuesday 17 June. Workers are meeting at Victorian Trades Hall at 11am before marching to Parliament House. HACSU members are fighting for a decent pay deal and improvements to super, leave, classifications and safety. Get along and support the stopwork if you can. Meanwhile, mental health nurses who are members of the ANMF will be meeting today to discuss an updated offer "with improved timings for nurse wage increases. [https://substack.com/redirect/db2a9460-c3f4-4667-bf72-8c358d012168?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]" ANMF members had endorsed the government's offer in late March [https://substack.com/redirect/adc8daeb-cb3e-449d-ab3d-9876b5bad9d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] but had remained in discussions about timing.

ANMF Vic - Epworth Medical Imaging

Nurses at Epworth Medical Imaging walked off the job last week. Nurses in Geelong stopped work for 4 hours on Thursday (5 June) followed by nurses in Richmond stopping work for 4 hours on Friday (6 June). Nurses at Epworth Medical Imaging commenced protected industrial action in April, but the stopwork actions are an escalation in tactics. The nurses are fighting for 4.5% annual pay increases and a lead apron allowance [https://substack.com/redirect/37ac5db1-557c-483d-ac09-82fa11e501b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Management says they cannot go any higher than 4% per annum, despite nurses in the Epworth hospital receiving a 24% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/971defda-fc9a-4b49-999c-4235a7480af9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

ETU QLD - Getinge

Sparkies who maintain and repair medical equipment used to sterilise surgical tools and other medical supplies have been locked out by their employer Getinge for 2 weeks. Getinge is contracted by Queensland Health to provide this vital maintenance work at a number of Queensland hospitals. Workers are fighting for 5% annual wage increases to bring them in line with their Victorian counterparts.

QTU - Public sector teachers

Much like Queensland's nurses, public school teachers in the sunshine state were assured by the Crisafulli Government was committed to "nation leading" wages and addressing the teacher shortage crisis. But as yet there has been no indication from the government of any greater wage increase than the blanket offer to the public sector of 3% in 2025 and 2.5% in 2026 and 2027. Consequently, the QTU is holding a rally to call on the government to value teachers [

https://substack.com/redirect/16317668-790d-45ed-aac9-e45b0e1de298?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

The rally will be held on Tuesday 24 June at 5 pm at Parliament House in Brisbane.

QNMU - Virtus Health

A management wage offer at Queensland Fertility Group has been voted down. 90% of nurses who voted said NO to the offer. Nurses will instead be commencing Stage 1 industrial action this week (campaign t-shirts and sharing campaign materials). The offer from the boss was less than interstate colleagues earn. Industrial action was endorsed unanimously.

CRU/ETU NSW - Sydney Trains

The dispute at Sydney Trains continues, but by the looks of it is now a three-cornered legal stoush. I understand that both the Combined Rail Unions and Sydney Trains have applied for a voting request order arguing that the ETU's refusal to agree to the in-principle agreement is "unreasonable" [https://substack.com/redirect/74818aaf-ca34-431c-9ab4-6a989ca7c2da?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

Meanwhile, the ETU have applied for good faith bargaining orders against Sydney Trains at the RTBU. It is worth noting the FWC "cooling off period" that suspended all industrial action ends on 1 July, and that by August, Sydney Trains could apply for intractable bargaining declaration.

HACSU Tasmania - Roy Fagan Centre

Mental health workers at the Roy Fagan Centre in Hobart walked off the job for 1 hour yesterday (10/6). After more than a year of negotiations, an in-principle agreement was reached over 2 months ago, but no formal offer has been made. The main issue in the dispute is the conditions for ward aides who work 12 or 12.5 hour shifts, but unlike the nurses they work alongside - do not receive paid meal breaks and receive significantly lower shift penalties. Workers are walking off the job to put the pressure on for a formal offer that ensures a fair deal for workers.

AEU Victoria - Public sector school teachers

AEU members are set to rally outside the Victorian Education Minister Ben Carroll's office [https://substack.com/redirect/dc1ef628-c0c7-4479-9fa3-11451f4e4ea7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on Thursday 19 June at 4:15pm.

The rally is in response to the government's decision to "strip \$2.4 billion out of public schools by pushing back its commitment to fully fund the Gonski reforms by three years. [https://substack.com/redirect/f83eee28-59da-4a19-873f-c7612b00ab2b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]"

The 2025-26 Victorian state budget has made Victoria's public schools the lowest funded, and its teachers the lowest paid in the country [https://substack.com/redirect/1a09c5c4-5e7f-416e-a411-a5e89c6ed6ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

The union's anger at the government over schools funding occurs as the log of claims for the next EBA is being developed. The current Victoria Government Schools Agreement expires on 31 December 2025.

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AWU/AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU NSW - Snowy 2.0

While the temperature in the hills drops, workers from five blue-collar unions continue their campaign of industrial action at Snowy 2.0. Workers have been participating in intermittent 24-hour stoppages at Tantangara, Marcia and Lobs Hole. They are fighting for better conditions, fairer rates of pay, and an industry standard agreement- including a standard inclement weather clause.

That's all I've got this week. It feels worth mentioning that over half of the disputes in this week's report are in the health sector. And this doesn't include disputes like NSW public sector nurses and midwives and psychiatrists that are still very much underway, but I haven't provided an

update on this week. It is staggering to me that healthcare workers are having to fight so hard not just for a decent deal for themselves, but to make sure the hospitals, clinics and health services we all rely on are safe and accessible. So a special shout out this week to our union comrades in the health sector - we're all standing with you in your struggle. Thank you for looking out for all of us.

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UWTF0ak13TwpJMExDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05EazFPVEV3TnpJc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE1URXl0ekEzTWl3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAucV9oSlJDQVpVd0ZkUUdUdGQteGLEWmxBUXRtR2haaU9oUkFVTmw0WWZfbyIsInAiOjE2NTYyMDIyNCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc0OTU5MTA3MiwiZXhwIjoxNzUyMTgzMDcyLCJpc3MiOiJwdWItdmCisInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.PY8TbprstJ8F_Nre9qKQmVEMuIxcmPWRQeUs5Anw200?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-11-march>

AFLUE/RTBU QLD - Pacific National

On Monday (9/3), AFULE and RTBU coal train drivers at Pacific National in Queensland commenced a 24 hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/8291cfe0-0e67-4c83-98cd-cc1156fa1e9c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from 12 noon. This was a direct response to Pacific National locking out workers [https://substack.com/redirect/1b42fcd7-6281-4864-9c9f-d76af0477cc9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last week in retaliation for their overtime bans. Workers have not been frightened by Pacific National's bully tactics. Overtime bans are ongoing, and workers commenced an indefinite ban on shift alterations yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/f4ef27e6-b6b3-47e0-a188-7ccd05377592?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Pacific National has advised workers who refuse to alter their shifts will be locked out. A second 24 hour stoppage is planned for 18 March. Bargaining sessions are scheduled to take place tomorrow (11/3) and Monday and Tuesday next week.

Tasmanian Public Sector Unions - Tasmanian State Government

Three unions remain in dispute with the Tasmanian State Government after intensive negotiations did not result in acceptable offers from the government. While the government maintains it has offered deals equal to that received by the police union, the AEU, CPSU and HACSU all argue that additional allowances given to the cops equate to an extra 1% in wages [https://substack.com/redirect/ddee5170-edf9-4a26-810b-8ea13abe3434?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], which was not represented in recent offers from the state government. Given this context, unions are ramping up pressure on the government.

AEU

On Wednesday (4/3), the AEU announced a number of work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/4403d5dc-adb6-4e07-a217-3cc1a1d9b6f0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. These included not reporting staff participation in industrial action; wearing union t-shirts and distributing union materials; and not creating or distributing materials related to any departmental promotional activities. Also crucially, the bans include not administering or supporting NAPLAN assessments or NAPLAN practice. The NAPLAN ban really hits the government where it hurts, denying the state and federal government accurate data on students' results. AEU Tasmanian Branch President David Genford commented that [https://substack.com/redirect/ca952375-2138-4d5c-80c0-b0af7fce355a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] "The effort that goes into NAPLAN simply isn't worth the workload that's been put on our teachers and even the pressure that's put on our students." Amen! On Friday (6/3), the state government provided an offer for a new agreement to the AEU at 5:01pm along with a request to withdraw industrial action. The AEU's Executive has recommended this offer be rejected, and advised members that bans were going ahead [https://substack.com/redirect/099a51ea-6efd-40c5-8c95-dfb48311bf84?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and that if a decent offer isn't made by 20 March, 24 hour strikes will go ahead [https://substack.com/redirect/d8d78ec0-0d87-4229-8528-824fafc21180?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. AEU members on the North West Coast plan to walk off the job on 24 March; members in Launceston on 25 March followed by members in southern Tasmania on 26 March. I think it's fair to say that AEU members across Tasmania are fed up. The NAPLAN testing window is from 11 - 23 March [https://substack.com/redirect/fdfd3a36-d755-4244-ba12-2da131f29a89?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CPSU

The CPSU has also imposed a deadline on the state government. If a decent offer isn't made by 20 March then CPSU members across the state will escalate industrial action with secretary Thirza White describing what would occur as "unprecedented strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/303743d0-9e44-41ee-aa09-aceff043e08b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]". CPSU members in Prospect held a stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/11aaf14f-0996-4aa2-8903-ef3fd51d9be6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] yesterday (10/3); and the union is also gravely concerned about proposed cuts by the state government [https://substack.com/redirect/26e90085-0320-421a-91dd-c74d17dcb46a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including dismantling the Department of State Growth which would result in 250 jobs being cut.

HACSU

HACSU members continue to participate in work bans and stoppages. Today (11/3) cleaners at the Royal Hobart Hospital will strike for 4 hours, with more workers to strike for between 4 - 8 hours across the week. Members of HACSU have endorsed moving to "stage 4" action which includes stoppages of 8 - 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/7d2e0b1d-f298-4697-837b-ec657814ad36?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] if a decent offer isn't

forthcoming from the government by 20 March. While Health Minister Bridget Archer has condemned HACSU's industrial action as "going too far [https://substack.com/redirect/7d2e0b1d-f298-4697-837b-ec657814ad36?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]", HACSU's state secretary Robbie Moore countered that "The workers have decided on these bans. They have designed these bans so that they impact on government revenue and have less of an impact on the community." TWU - Amazon

On Thursday (5/3), TWU members protested at Amazon depots and offices [https://substack.com/redirect/2da7f609-353d-44d4-b8be-9f467cb4d08c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] across Australia. TWU members are fighting back against what the union describes as "the Amazon effect" a "multi-pronged, cost-cutting attack on industry standards [https://substack.com/redirect/90b47406-0445-4b8e-9255-c00782e735be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]". Gig-workers doing deliveries through Amazon Flex have little to no workplace protections as independent contractors, but impact the whole transport/logistics industry by putting downward pressure on wages and conditions. The pressure on drivers to fulfil quick shipping demands of consumers is causing huge issues for safety and fatigue management in the industry, while wages stagnate.

UWU NT - Northern Territory firefighters

As reported last week, UWU members in the NT Fire and Rescue Service commenced industrial action on Friday (6/3). After UWU provided notice that industrial action would be going ahead, the state government put out their substandard agreement to a vote [https://substack.com/redirect/c4a66d2b-0ace-4dba-a503-50a52ed23a0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. As UWU's NT Secretary Erina Early noted: "Putting a substandard agreement to a vote is not negotiation, it's an attempt to sidestep the issues firefighters have been raising for months. Our firefighters are united, they are angry, and they are determined to fight for a fair deal." The ballot to vote on the proposed agreement closes on 20 March. Industrial action continues.

In short

ETU NSW - Prosegur

ETU members at Prosegur have been undertaking protected industrial action for over a week. Workers are fighting for their first ever EBA to improve wages, and weekend and late-night shift allowances. On Thursday, ETU members held a rally at Prosegur in Macquarie Park.

ETU NSW - Dynelec

ETU members at Dynelec have now been on strike for over 5 weeks. Dynelec are refusing to listen in negotiating meetings, so the ETU have now resorted to reaching out to companies that supply Dynelec [https://substack.com/redirect/b737620c-4837-409b-9a28-f5a1f1086f6e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and asking for support. Workers are fighting for an 18% wage increase over 3 years as well as basic safety allowances, proper support for apprentices and improved carers leave.

PABO Watch

ASU Vic - Metropolitan local councils

The ASU has applied to the FWC for a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/8a68d207-aae6-4603-ad3b-f804113e0b38?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] for members at 8 councils in the Melbourne metropolitan area: Melbourne, Merri-bek, Yarra, Darebin, Hume, Hobsons Bay, Maribyrnong and Greater Dandenong. The union received approval to bargain for a multi-employer agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/34189c21-6a46-4127-af49-58c1c58d1cec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] late in 2025, and is expected to start bargaining shortly. If the ballot is successful, and workers do take strike action it will likely be the biggest local council strike in Australian history [https://substack.com/redirect/d34200a0-f6ef-492a-8684-e83b75a56e6f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], with potential to be hugely disruptive.

Wins/resolutions

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU WA - Ventia

The ETU has shared that the dispute at the BP Kwinana Refinery has resolved [https://substack.com/redirect/f1a0516a-acdc-4cfe-8b4c-87f754abf872?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Following industrial action, workers have won an immediate increase of 7.1% with back pay to July 2025. While acknowledging this falls short of the 17% commencement increase they were fighting for, they note "With an expiry locked in for 31 March 2027, you can bet we'll be back in 12 months to secure the rest." That's all I've got this week - a bit of a shorter report! So time to answer a question I get sent from time to time: What is the best way to send me information about disputes? The short answer is whatever is easiest for you! You are welcome to send me a message here on substack [<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen>]; DM me on instagram [https://substack.com/redirect/2e6c6693-f76f-49a6-b043-c92aa41c7443?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]; or email me [<mailto:mssarahmissen@gmail.com>]. But I have just created a new "Report a dispute" form [

[https://substack.com/redirect/bd24426d-1422-402b-9255-d92361643cc9?](https://substack.com/redirect/bd24426d-1422-402b-9255-d92361643cc9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/bd24426d-1422-402b-9255-d92361643cc9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)] which asks all the questions I would if I was talking to you in the pub. So, if something is happening at your workplace, but you're not quite sure what information to share, this might be a great option for you. I cannot emphasise how much I rely on workers all over the country to share information and provide insights every week to help put this report together, so please get in touch in whatever way is easiest for you. Thanks for sharing with me.

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNJNk1Ua3d0RGt5TURnNUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056TXh0e1Ext1RBC0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd05EY3hNRFU1TUN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhsWDJWdFlxbHNJbjAuZXRYewNGMUJlVjFjREpNaWNuSWVoQk1adjc2VmhrZ3d4U1NaQzI2Sk1DQSIzInAiOjE5MDQ5MjA4OSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3MzE3NDU5MCwiZXhwIjoyMDg4NzUwNTkwLCJpc3MiOiIjWdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.eBtTeN4haHaMduXUsaG4Z8b7r_qswac-bgTYmEHLAa0?

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AMWU/ETU NSW - Coca-cola Northmead

An escalation of industrial action has seen workers at Coca-cola's factory in Northmead take 24 hours strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/4831a7f9-8e36-4e94-98bd-7266cddeb142?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] starting at midnight last Thursday (6/3). The ETU's State Secretary Allen Hicks estimated that the action would have a serious impact on the supply chain. Workers are fighting for a fair agreement that includes a decent wage increase to keep up with the cost of living, and other employers in the industry.

ASU/USU - Maurice Blackburn

Lawyers at Maurice Blackburn were due to implement a historic work ban on time recording [https://substack.com/redirect/92875c80-3e4d-4e8d-a9ca-5b3bc6f489fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on Thursday (6/3) but when faced with the choice between servicing clients but being unable to bill them, or just not servicing them all - MB chose to not service clients at all and instead essentially locked out its lawyers. Technically, Maurice Blackburn issued "non-payment notices [https://substack.com/redirect/b54d05a0-7e0e-4e6d-8669-35047c435dc6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]" a legal option for employers when employees are participating in partial work bans where they advise no payment will be made, but must also state that the employer will not accept any work from the employee until they resume normal duties. Lawyers from the firm in Melbourne rallied in the Flagstaff Gardens, and support staff nationally also stopped work for up to 3 hours. The striking lawyers had updated their "out of office" automatic email replies to include information about the dispute, and that lawyers had been directed not to perform any work in response to the ban on time recording, however Maurice Blackburn updated all out of office emails [https://substack.com/redirect/5742ee5d-774e-47c6-a60b-c499530293ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to a generic response saying the email would be reviewed soon, and to call a 1800 number for any urgent matters. Lawyers and support staff at Maurice Blackburn are fighting for a decent pay increase, but also crucially for 10 days reproductive leave. The hypocrisy of Maurice Blackburn [https://substack.com/redirect/75cf9d1f-a584-4b57-bb07-8e5083c568a0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] refusing their workforce 10 days of reproductive leave has been noted given their support of other unions fighting for this entitlement for workers [https://substack.com/redirect/cb930a4e-fa2c-42e7-b14c-3ac5ecab99e0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers at Maurice Blackburn will be meeting this week to discuss the next steps in their EBA campaign.

AMWU/ETU Vic- Nestle

Bans and stoppages are ongoing at Nestle in Campbellfield and Broadford. Workers are angry [https://substack.com/redirect/e55ab900-9821-4da2-a3e4-f08c7727388?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] about the proposed changes to rosters - including 12 hour shifts, and are demanding better pay and more consultation on changes at work.

MUA - Teekay

Industrial action continues on the Absolute 1 bunkering barge (operated by Teekay) at the Port of Fremantle. The MUA shared that Teekay has made a number of unlawful threats [https://substack.com/redirect/2c22b360-313e-4bba-b4f4-9a55e0201e42?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to workers which are being examined by the MUA's legal team. Workers have had their pay cut by \$10,000 since Teekay took over the contract operation at Fremantle [https://substack.com/redirect/e6ea44d9-690e-4642-9ad5-21d3cbf2238d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The MUA is determined to keep fighting until the EBA is sorted.

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HACSU/ANMF Vic - Public sector mental health workers

HACSU members at every public mental health service except Northern Health and St Vincent's (who took action on 26/2) held a 15 minute stop work action at 2pm on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/ff1f0c40-0d8a-4b3e-9956-4cda4d68c130?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (7/3) in addition to ongoing work bans. HACSU members at Barwon Health walked off the job yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/8fec1529-2ebc-4e8d-9450-a59c5f92f6d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (11/3) from 1pm - 3pm, and workers at Austin Health are due to take action this Friday (14/3). ANMF members working in mental health continue to take "stage 1" protected actions [https://substack.com/redirect/6634424e-a8ee-4498-81d6-c677652e306c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] including wearing campaign t-shirts; distributing campaign materials; refusal to be redeployed; refusal to work overtime; refusal to attend management meetings unless fully backfilled; and some administrative and

data entry bans. Workers are fighting for a better pay deal as well as improvements to conditions to assist with staffing and chronic burnout of the workforce.

AMWU/CEPU SA - BAE

Workers at BAE held another series of work stoppages on Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/6fff1476-0840-49f1-aa4e-b30a73977092?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (6/3), having also held stoppages on 4 March. Workers are fighting for 6.5% annual wage increases, and pay parity with other workers in the industry.

ETU WA - Ventia

ETU members employed by Ventia at Chevron's Barrow Island are set to commence industrial action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/c84384dc-3c53-4d98-9340-3b40e617e8be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (14/3) after Ventia cancelled a scheduled EBA meeting. Workers are fighting for a decent, industry standard EBA.

AMWU/ETU WA - Alstom Metronet

Workers at Alstom Metronet in Bellevue walked off the job on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/9a4ea6b4-85a4-475b-800f-13ab623736e2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (7/3) as promised. In late February, the ETU shared that Alstom applied for a bargaining dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/12df3174-e7b0-4c05-b29d-7da16c73d762?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] under Section 240 in the FWC. Workers are fighting for a 23% wage increase over 3 years and a 36 hour week.

UWU - SA public sector disability and health workers

A month of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/5c0b81da-6af9-4c49-abe9-41872fe07ebb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] by UWU members in the public health sector is having an impact. UWU has shared photos of overflowing hospital bins as hospital support staff continue work bans. Hospital workers and disability support workers are fighting for fair pay and secure jobs.

HSUWA - Public sector health workers

After being voted up by workers, the 2024 WA public sector health workers agreement has been lodged with the WAIRC and is awaiting registration. Pay increases will start being paid at the end of the month. Workers won a 5% increase in the first year (with back pay to 1 July 2024); 4% in the second year and 3.75% in the third year [https://substack.com/redirect/067a73d5-3046-425e-beaa-5a52f934a9ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. This is a total of 12.75% over 3 years - equal to what the WA police received in their negotiations, and just above the 12.5% increase that RTBU Transit Officers, CPSU/CSA members and WA nurses won.

ASU Vic/Tas - VicRoads

Workers at VicRoads have voted up the proposed EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/6637d24c-f271-44f1-abcd-5364b32970ae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The ASU called the deal "the best VicRoads pay outcome in more than 20 years". Workers participated in a range of work bans throughout December.

IWWWD

International Working Women's Day rallies were held around the country last week. I wrote a short reflection on the CFMEU women at the rally in Melbourne [<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen/note/c-98838319>]. A group of rank and file CFMEU women have also put out a statement for IWWWD [https://substack.com/redirect/93d23bca-cdf2-462d-877a-697e97a545ba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which shares their thoughts about their union, their work and the Administration. The NSWNMA shared that the gender pay gap, in NSW has risen every year for the last 3 years and is the highest it has been in over a decade [https://substack.com/redirect/656203f0-2348-481e-9c3f-16535f3c484a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] - and placed the blame squarely on Chris Minns' shoulders as he refuses to accept the NSWNMA's claims for a decent pay increase for nurses and midwives. And as mentioned earlier in the report, Maurice Blackburn workers were on strike for reproductive leave [https://substack.com/redirect/75cf9d1f-a584-4b57-bb07-8e5083c568a0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Women workers have never been handed anything by the bosses. Everything we have has been fought for and won. That's all I've got this week. If you've got any further information on any of these disputes, or one that I've missed - please get in touch!

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3J1cG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UVTRPRE0xT1RBd0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05ERTNNA1V4TURRc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM016STJNVEV3TkN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdpVFV4TnpZaUxDSnBkV01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswdJWdfLXBHNjBjAuS1ZhdnZHV09we1VWT1pfdThmQ0k2Vmhub2V6WHlabkN4ZDFtQWlzM3E3WSIsInAiOjE1ODgz

NTkwMCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc0MTcyNTEwNCwiZXhwIjoxNzQ0MzE3MTA0LCJpc
3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.MB1F_BO_Ow9TQ_JBCUEoQVuA47xzFaIB8bT294MnBSA?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-12-november>

UWU - Queensland Health

2000 health workers in Queensland's hospitals commenced industrial action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/f0abdc8-de43-4b6c-9383-1792a374ed62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (7/11). UWU members have comprehensively rejected the state government's offer of an 8% wage increase over 3 years. The Crisafulli government has rejected every claim put forward by the union over 6 months of negotiations, and have also proposed taking away attraction and retention allowances. Medical imaging staff, pharmacists, oral health professionals and clinical assistants participated in the 24 hour action which included administrative bans including refusing to process billing or issue invoices [https://substack.com/redirect/f5c6d79a-7f8c-42c8-9165-f51df9ce9f85?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers are asking community members to show their support by signing a petition [https://substack.com/redirect/ed73579f-45d0-499c-8ce1-5cfa07330c7c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

PSA SA - Public sector workers

The public sector EBA campaign continues in South Australia. Today (12/11), workers from the SA Housing Trust will rally outside Nick Champion's office in Smithfield [https://substack.com/redirect/3e1b8735-313f-4bb9-acce-6d28ea0742fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Champion is the state Minister for Housing, and workers are demanding fair pay for public servants and safe housing for all. The PSA is also preparing for a mass rally of all public sector workers on Wednesday 26 November [https://substack.com/redirect/cff673ef-1e01-450e-8a0a-314fbf972b0c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Billed as the "first all of sector PSA March in decades" workers will meet at Hindmarsh Square at 12:30pm before marching to Parliament. If you live or work in Adelaide, get along and support the PSA in their fight for a 20% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/8d893460-5495-4248-894d-9c2fe3843436?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

CFMEU WA - Freo Cranes

CFMEU members at Freo Cranes in the Pilbara have commenced industrial action in pursuit of decent wages and conditions. Keen to hear more about this one if anyone has any info!

QTU - Public sector teachers

On 1 November the QTU's State Council voted in favour of holding another 24 hour strike [https://substack.com/redirect/b46d9061-22f7-412c-aad8-4b7e4a12f1dd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] within 3 weeks. But seemingly a combination of public pressure and a stern letter from the Department of Education [https://substack.com/redirect/c61caa0c-8d89-4bf0-970f-2a4ef68bbdb5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] about disrupting end of year exams has resulted in the union instead deciding to hold statewide after school rallies [https://substack.com/redirect/f759a39c-0ab1-414e-96c4-b1f078b4eac9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] tomorrow (13/11). With only 23 days before the end of the school year, time is running out to put industrial pressure on the Crisafulli government to put forward a better deal. The Brisbane rally [https://substack.com/redirect/220d3186-1ee5-4e04-b239-aa7d973e30f3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] will be held at Parliament House on Thursday 13 November from 4:30pm. Get along to support teachers if you can.

MEU NSW - Bloomfield

Workers at Rix's Creek have been on the grass for 6 weeks, and not to alarm anyone but it is also 6 weeks until Christmas. So, as a declaration of their commitment to the fight, they have installed a Christmas tree on the picket line.

UWU NT - Public sector health workers

It hasn't been revealed when, but sometime in the next week(ish), over 1000 UWU members in the NT public health sector will walk off the job for 1 hour [https://substack.com/redirect/560f2e4a-530e-485d-9965-e0c583a6b2a2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Cleaners, caterers, personal care assistants, radiographers and sonographers will down tools in pursuit of a satisfactory offer from the Territory government [https://substack.com/redirect/b2ab963b-82fd-4872-aaa4-0e14a99d34ba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. After languishing under the previous government's wage freeze, the government has offered public sector workers a 3% annual wage increases in a 4 year agreement. This offer was voted down by workers, but the government refuses to return to the negotiating table and has instead lodged a dispute with the FWC. The Government also refuses to explain why police were given a special deal including a 5% increase in the first year and 4% increase in the second year followed by 3% increases in years 3 and 4. In addition to concerns about wages, workers are also seeking action on a number of OHS issues

including breaks.

UPFU WA - WA Firefighters

91% of UPFU WA members have rejected a second pay offer [https://substack.com/redirect/1f9fe295-5f47-42e7-92c9-c9f3b2178bf5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the state government. Discussions between the union and the state government about the EBA have been going on for over 12 months [https://substack.com/redirect/a658f43d-8ebd-4b31-95ac-21d03c483a8d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Wages are a key concern - the union is seeking a \$2 per hour raise for senior firefighters; the Government's initial offer fell short at 40 cents. A well attended members meeting last week urged union secretary John Marsh to "lean into" the government [https://substack.com/redirect/d1ff2807-f086-4c1c-bbfa-c6d49e73c50b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for a third and improved offer. I believe industrial action is ongoing.

MEAA/SDA/TWU - Amazon

Yesterday (11/11), union members rallied at Amazon sites [https://substack.com/redirect/ae466682-ccd9-41ec-a522-5d2578de2113?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] across Australia demanding the company pay its fair share for decent jobs, stop its attack on workers and support Australian media. The MEAA, SDA and TWU have committed to campaigning together for better regulation of Amazon and its exploitative practices. The unions have released a "10-point claim on Amazon" [https://substack.com/redirect/a3de2a50-5011-40c1-8d36-d0d123684dda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which comprises demands to pay fair wages; pay its fair share of tax; pay for creative and media content used to train AI; stop excessive worker surveillance; use technology to create sustainable jobs; create secure and sustainable jobs; respect workers' right to a voice at work through their unions; improve practices before being rewarded with lucrative government contracts; empower workers to speak up on safety and to pair fair superannuation.

ANMF VIC - Healthscope

At a meeting between the ANMF and Healthscope on 6 November, Healthscope rejected the union's proposal [https://substack.com/redirect/4e35e67d-bef0-4f65-8fbe-c089597f0fb7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that workers should be able to have an independent vote on the proposed salary packaging proposal. The ANMF also shared in an update to members [https://substack.com/redirect/4e35e67d-bef0-4f65-8fbe-c089597f0fb7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that Healthscope will not budge on its positions that any wage increases are contingent on the salary packaging proposal being included in the agreement. The ANMF was due to hold a meeting of Healthscope members on Monday (10/11) to discuss negotiations and next steps. To the best of my knowledge, industrial action is still ongoing at this stage.

RTBU QLD - Pacific National Coal

RTBU member drivers at Pacific National Coal commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/6da2d640-dbfd-4b32-a762-4cc7ac9357b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Monday (10/11). Following months of negotiations, Pacific National saw fit to make an offer that stripped back conditions and ignored key issues raised by workers. More than 97% of members consequently voted in favour of taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/6239c0b9-1d3d-402a-b7d8-b93a64ee102b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Industrial action will include roster alterations, overtime bans and strikes. Workers are fighting for a fair wage increase and adequate time to rest and recover from shift work.

ETU QLD - Monadelphous

Workers at Monadelphous commenced industrial action last week. In Gladstone, ETU members held a 24 hour stoppage on Tuesday (4/11) and three 1-hour stoppages on Wednesday (5/11). Workers are fighting for a better EBA offer from the boss.

HSU WA - GenesisCare

HSU members from GenesisCare will hold a stopwork rally [https://substack.com/redirect/f5f2d8e9-8f0f-42a7-b10d-1fb79f1e2e37?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] outside the Fiona Stanley Hospital today (12/11) from 12 noon. Workers commenced their industrial campaign last week for a fair deal. Get along and support them if you can.

ETU WA - TKE

Workers at TKE commenced industrial action last week. Workers stopped work for 24 hours as well as commencing partial bans on returning elevators and escalators into service around Perth. ETU members are fighting for industry standard wages and conditions.

NTEU QLD - QUT

Following rallies and organising, NTEU members at QUT have stopped around 20 forced redundancies [https://substack.com/redirect/5d4f2138-d4be-47b8-bec9-0f64762ba377?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and paused proposed school mergers. Workers at the QUT have just this week endorsed their log of claims [https://substack.com/redirect/dd492a42-dd4d-43da-b103-2765bcf653fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] ahead of their EBA expiring on 31 December. Negotiations are expected to kick off in earnest in the new year.

UWU QLD - Star Casino Brisbane

UWU has shared the news that a new EBA for workers at the Star Casino in Brisbane has been finalised. The social media post spruiks an improved consultative, but doesn't mention any other wins. A quick look at the EBA [[https://substack.com/redirect/67d824f8-d060-4e28-8c08-5bb1856d4832?](https://substack.com/redirect/67d824f8-d060-4e28-8c08-5bb1856d4832?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and a back of the envelope sum indicates 4% wage increases on at least the introductory base rate in both 2026 and 2027. UWU members undertook industrial action earlier in the year, including several stop work actions [[https://substack.com/redirect/cc4af806-7eb1-49b4-a325-8d0a4a4bd26f?](https://substack.com/redirect/cc4af806-7eb1-49b4-a325-8d0a4a4bd26f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - the first of which was the first ever strike by workers at the casino.

VAHPA - Special General Meeting

Rank and file VAHPA members have finally been successful in their pressure on the union to call a Special General Meeting. The SGM will include an opportunity for discussion about the proposed merger of VAHPA and HACSU. The meeting will be held on Thursday 11 December at 11am at Trades Hall (54 Victoria Street Carlton). If you're a VAHPA member, please get along to have your say. If you know any VAHPA members - make sure to let them know about the meeting! You can read all about the Special General Meeting in the latest article from VAHPA Pulse [[https://substack.com/redirect/c224fc13-8b86-4e33-9ae6-483b973b626e?](https://substack.com/redirect/c224fc13-8b86-4e33-9ae6-483b973b626e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

UWU - UWU

I missed an article a few weeks ago in the Courier Mail headlined "Power over people: union kingmaker faces member revolt" [[https://substack.com/redirect/6f5759fb-dce3-4090-ba4c-d3855ad40c54?](https://substack.com/redirect/6f5759fb-dce3-4090-ba4c-d3855ad40c54?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In short, the article alleges that 3 UWU organisers in Queensland who were organising school cleaners and teachers' aides were recently sacked. Members wanted to reject the state government's 8% wages offer and strike for a better deal. However, union leadership wanted workers to "accept the deal and leverage political power in the next EBA to get an ALP government in power". The inference is that 3 organisers were not (or did not want to be) successful in "selling" this plan to members - and were sacked. An UWU spokesperson rejected this when questioned by the Courier Mail, instead claiming that all 3 organisers had been terminated for "serious misconduct". UWU members have started a petition [[https://substack.com/redirect/48883766-4c87-430f-8097-15c3ed7cf63f?](https://substack.com/redirect/48883766-4c87-430f-8097-15c3ed7cf63f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] demanding the reinstatement of their organisers and noting their concern about the operation of their union: "We have no words to express the growing disillusionment shared by many school cleaners and teacher aides within the union. We feel increasingly marginalised and unrepresented by UWU leadership. Despite our dedication, our voices have been silenced, posts expressing concern or criticism are routinely deleted, comment sections disabled, and members blocked or removed from online platforms meant to foster dialogue." Sunlight is the best disinfectant, so I thought it worthwhile sharing this in today's report. If I missed this, I suspect many others interested in the state of our unions did too. UWU is due to hold its quadrennial elections in 2026.

That's all I've got this week. Thanks as always to the readers who shared information and filled in gaps. I honestly couldn't get this newsletter out each week without your support and assistance.

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3J1cG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UYzROVGswTkRnMkxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05qSTRPVE16TVRrc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNU5EUxlpVE14T1N3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hWaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnphV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdF1XbHNjbAuzEtqRi15Szg4aWt2V3ZKSmxYM3haamNrQkx3NnFMc3QyREdNbTNDX2o4WSIsInAi0jE3ODU5NDQ4NiwiY6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImldhCI6MTc2Mjg5MzMxOSwiZXhwIjoyMDc4NDY5MzE5LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI6MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJ1Y3QifQ.8u7hi1pGJaSM54f9AnK-pE0ozrv2Gf9PSXdqQGGERGA?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-13-august>

AMWU/AWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU/The Services Union/TWU QLD - Townsville City Council

Disruptions to council services are ongoing [https://substack.com/redirect/ecf8cdf4-355f-444d-af0c-30cc777cd08b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] as the dispute at the Townsville City Council continues. Last Wednesday (6 August) workers from the AMWU, AWU, CFMEU, ETU, PPTEU & TWU held their third major stoppage with approximately 400 workers rallying outside a council administrative building [https://substack.com/redirect/a593178f-89e7-4475-9571-1ea7427c2e15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers are seeking a 20% uplift to their base wage rates. The Services Union is now holding a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/e11d8230-fe22-4a83-9be9-1d5a5330f152?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to be able to participate in industrial action of their own. The Services Union, which covers mainly white-collar workers in councils, is frustrated that different “streams” of workers are being offered different pay increases.

UWU NSW - Crown Casino

Last Friday (8 August), 70 UWU members at Crown Casino in Sydney walked off the job for four hours [https://substack.com/redirect/6db999cd-8b53-46dd-9802-8e7e76ff15b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. This industrial action, the first ever taken at Crown in Sydney, kicked off at 6:30pm disrupting the casino’s busiest time of day. Workers at the casino are paid just 7 cents above minimum wage and earn \$7.94 per hour less than their colleagues in Melbourne. Workers want more than Crown’s most recent offer of a 9.25% wage increase over 3 years. Workers are fighting for decent pay rises, fair career progression and respect.

QTU - Public school teachers

Last Wednesday (6 August) an estimated 50,000 public school teachers in Queensland struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/dcb1c0ff-92c2-44d6-915b-97fd82bef4d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Teachers in Brisbane rallied at Parliament House, and elsewhere in the state they held union meetings. Teachers and their union are adamant they will not accept the state government’s wages policy offer of 8% over 3 years. The QTU was due to return to negotiations with the government on Thursday (7 August) [https://substack.com/redirect/56dc663e-7330-46e6-8e48-3eb8107711d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Yesterday (12 August), the QTU announced a series of after school rallies [https://substack.com/redirect/ff777966-e86e-4876-912b-337295f19de0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which kicked off in Bundaberg. Teachers will rally in Gladstone on Friday, with rallies to follow on the Gold Coast and in Cairns.

ETU NSW - KONE

Workers at KONE in Newcastle walked off the job again [https://substack.com/redirect/f1207d0b-6296-49ec-b502-f11d62ebf53f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on Thursday (7 August) and Friday (8 August). On Wednesday (6 August), ETU members had returned to work after the bosses agreed to meet for negotiations. But when they returned to work, workers were met with “punitive repercussions” and verbally abused by a manager. Following this disgraceful behaviour, workers imposed a series of work bans before walking off the job.

The Services Union - Cairns Regional Council

Workers at Cairns Regional Council will stop work for 1 hour this Thursday (14/8). Workers will assemble on Spence Street at 2pm to send a strong message to Council. TSU members want fair pay, respect and decent agreement.

QNMU - Public sector nurses and midwives

The QNMU has paused all industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/5fd7ed9e-dae4-4ba6-a325-1406da97a8a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in the public sector. The pause commenced yesterday (12/8) at 9am and will remain in place until 2 September. The pause was prompted by the “strong recommendation” of the QIRC’s Deputy President who indicated that such a pause would be a show of good faith during the remaining scheduled conciliation meetings. According to media reports [https://substack.com/redirect/7598b4bd-51bf-4fbd-a63f-ea8544fb7427?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] several key sticking points have advanced in negotiations including backpay, overtime, classification pay points and remote area incentives. QNMU Secretary Sarah Beaman said that if they were unable to “secure a satisfactory outcome [https://substack.com/redirect/757c3661-8707-466e-bb40-3ff9a72da5c1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]” industrial action would resume. “If this happens,” she said, “we will escalate to Stage 3 strike action across the state.” [https://substack.com/redirect/757c3661-8707-466e-bb40-3ff9a72da5c1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] It is understood Stage 3 actions

could include stoppages and strikes.

ETU/MUA WA - CBH

On Friday (8 August), workers at CBH Kwinana Grain Terminal held another 2 hour stoppage [

[https://substack.com/redirect/f0dc0a42-f121-4b9f-b725-358901f83ebc?](https://substack.com/redirect/f0dc0a42-f121-4b9f-b725-358901f83ebc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f0dc0a42-f121-4b9f-b725-358901f83ebc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], and BBQ. In addition to the stoppages, a number of work bans are in place. Workers are seeking a decent wage increase to keep up with the cost of living; increased shift loadings for night shifts and weekends; access to training and job grading. Negotiations began in March, but CBH is “disappointed” by the industrial action. Unions have not ruled out further industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/f885c13c-0beb-420b-9d23-f5207ea9494c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

QPFU - Queensland firefighters

The Queensland Professional Firefighters Union has made an in-principle agreement with the state government. The agreement includes the state wages policy (3% increase in the first year and 2.5% in the second and third years) as well as “an additional \$32.44m in allowances over the three-year agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/2536a3dc-5980-40ff-8b81-c68c53d8a94b?](https://substack.com/redirect/2536a3dc-5980-40ff-8b81-c68c53d8a94b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2536a3dc-5980-40ff-8b81-c68c53d8a94b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]”. The agreement also includes an “operational adjustment” when workers respond to electrical vehicle and home battery fires due to the increased risks. What the agreement will not include is any backpay, as negotiations went longer than the government’s cut off date. Rank and file firefighters will still have to endorse the agreement. 95% of QPFU members who voted in the ballot were in favour of industrial action for a better deal [[https://substack.com/redirect/aae08b5c-8d59-4040-bc9f-cdc0bf333552?](https://substack.com/redirect/aae08b5c-8d59-4040-bc9f-cdc0bf333552?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/aae08b5c-8d59-4040-bc9f-cdc0bf333552?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

AWU/AMWU/ETU - Qantas

Qantas engineers continue their industrial action with rolling stoppages and work bans in pursuit of a decent agreement. Workers are asking supporters to send a message to Qantas CEO Vanessa Hudgens via this petition [[https://substack.com/redirect/7b6986f0-b19b-47cd-ab38-1cdedc39e69e?](https://substack.com/redirect/7b6986f0-b19b-47cd-ab38-1cdedc39e69e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7b6986f0-b19b-47cd-ab38-1cdedc39e69e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Workers are seeking a 15% wage increase in the first year and 5% annual increases in subsequent years to make up for years of wage stagnation and to keep up with the cost of living.

AMWU NSW - Komatsu

AMWU members at Komatsu Rutherford have been participating in intermittent strike action for almost a month [[https://substack.com/redirect/df94a20d-bab9-4b48-a636-ca6a2b07d88c?](https://substack.com/redirect/df94a20d-bab9-4b48-a636-ca6a2b07d88c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/df94a20d-bab9-4b48-a636-ca6a2b07d88c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The current offer from Komatsu does not bring workers to parity with Komatsu workers at Moss Vale and Rockhampton. The union has attempted to negotiate, including a shorter-term agreement, but without success. Workers are committed to fighting for a fair deal.

AMWU NSW - Opal

Workers at Opal in NSW have held three stoppages over the past fortnight [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b434741b-15d8-4068-be68-63c0892f51ab?](https://substack.com/redirect/b434741b-15d8-4068-be68-63c0892f51ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b434741b-15d8-4068-be68-63c0892f51ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Workers are striking for a decent agreement. Opal’s current offer is only a 10.5% wage increase over 3 years. In other crappy behaviour from Opal they have rejected EBA clauses that are from the industry award, and also refused to recognise an AMWU member under the Agreement. Typical boss divide and conquer behaviour. AMWU members are committed to keeping on fighting for fair wages and conditions.

NSWNMA - Public sector nurses and midwives

The dispute between the NSW Government and the NSWNMA has been going on for so long, that the state government has made an interim offer [https://substack.com/redirect/6940b115-ab40-48ac-add7-a13fd87c2353?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. According to the union this doesn’t affect the Special Case due to be heard in the IRC later in the year. The interim offer includes night duty penalty rate increases to 20%; two consecutive days off; no night duty immediately before annual leave and a 3% interim pay rise with backpay to 1 July 2025. This interim offer will be voted on by branches over the coming weeks. The NSWNMA is running a webinar for members this afternoon outlining what’s in the interim offer, as well as an update on the Special Case - members should check their emails for details.

ETU QLD - Getinge

Workers at Getinge have hit 8 weeks on strike. On Monday (11/8) workers were joined by other ETU members (making the most of an RDO [https://substack.com/redirect/f20fb434-a1a8-4d90-bf98-6fb59e19e29c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]) on a picket line at Getinge HQ in Morningside. Workers are fighting for a fair deal from Getinge, including pay parity with Getinge workers in other states.

ASU Vic - CFA

Professional, technical and administrative staff at the CFA ramped up industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/a839460f-d2af-45b4-8331-befbafdde473?](https://substack.com/redirect/a839460f-d2af-45b4-8331-befbafdde473?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a839460f-d2af-45b4-8331-befbafdde473?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] towards the end of July with stoppages, refusing non-emergency meetings and blocking false alarm charges to attack the

AMWU/ETU NSW - Confluence Water

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers rallied outside

ASU Vic - Brophy

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the FWC in June. Brophy's

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - a real slap in the face to

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at the same time and place at the Executive Leadership Team meeting. Would love to hear a report back on how that went if any Brophy

HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] working on the Public Mental

Health EBA. The social post reminded members that HACSU work bans [

MEU NSW - Glencore

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for the same

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to replace the striking workforce;

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF KD9-eM].

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzZdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haww_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNH0XpkRjllwWkNJNk1UY3d0emd6TlRNeUXDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05UVXdNelF5TWpnc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE5qVTNNRE15T0N3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdpVFV4TnpZaUXDsnPkV0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhsWDJwZF1xbHNjbjAuTlZvbG5ONUhps295X3NYLTVMU3VBZjRtSDl0SklnUDB5aXpUdnNYb2dmZyIsInAiOjE3MDc4MzUzMiwicyI6Mja5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzIxNmZmIm1hdCI6MTctNTAzNDIyOCwiZXhwIjoyMDcwNjEwMjI4LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.aWxkGTphQYHkpCvzP1SI1eL-Hgabyu6nLtQsmUMNVsg?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-13-may>

AWU/CFMEU/TSU/TWU QLD - Western Downs Council

Around 160 council workers [https://substack.com/redirect/d20fec91-d263-4a18-9d90-5f69637e1229?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at Western Downs Council planned to hold a 2 hour stoppage last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/0f8a0486-4e9f-4cc7-a9ff-665a235f371a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (6 May). When unions notified the Council, management immediately moved to lock out workers [https://substack.com/redirect/805f60f8-d5bd-4f30-8c4b-8242e099e53d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Like they didn't even try to lie about it or obfuscate - the Council literally put out a media release [https://substack.com/redirect/9634d2e5-df23-4c30-afa7-179b3c2b0194?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] saying "Council has confirmed it will be locking out employees". The Council's CEO Jodie Taylor claimed she made the decision to lock out workers to "minimise disruption [https://substack.com/redirect/97a34f14-7cdc-4de2-9c06-fcb4f389abe5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" - there's the obfuscation, because what is more disruptive - a two hour stoppage or a lockout? Unions correctly identified this move for what it is - an intimidation tactic [https://substack.com/redirect/97a34f14-7cdc-4de2-9c06-fcb4f389abe5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Despite the heavy handed response from bosses, workers went ahead with their strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/e36ce90d-a75a-4678-9758-78f1f1571888?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - the first at the Council in perhaps as long as 50 years. Members of the 4 unions involved in the dispute have rejected the Council's offer of a 11% wage increase over 3 years. Workers are seeking a 16% wage increase (6%/5.5%/4.5%) which is in line with other councils in the area.

CPSU - ACT public sector workers

Industrial action in the ACT public sector is about to kick off following a strong endorsement by members in a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/cdaddb54-0753-457d-820f-2a275d62e6b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. CPSU members at Housing ACT will be the first to take action with a 1-hour strike tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/52f3347d-837f-4699-981a-bb0cca1e74d9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (14/5). It is expected more industrial action will follow, including from other unions in the public sector. Union members have already rejected two offers [https://substack.com/redirect/c190a8ba-1f6c-495a-83b2-ab7a8224849f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the ACT Government. Workers are seeking a fair pay increase [https://substack.com/redirect/c190a8ba-1f6c-495a-83b2-ab7a8224849f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to keep up with the cost of living, maintenance of conditions, job security and investment in the public sector [https://substack.com/redirect/6cfbcea1-f064-4275-8208-3681b5f86eda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

HACSU Tas - Dental Assistants & Sterilisation Technicians

More oral health workers who are members of HACSU have walked off the job in support of Dental Assistants and Sterilisation Technicians. These vital public sector workers are fighting to be appropriately classified in line with their qualifications, and to receive backpay. Workers have been waiting for the state government to deliver on their promises for 18 months. Stop-work actions this week have included the Southern Dental Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/4abce7a2-d0ef-4812-ac9e-29f2a3bd319a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Friday (8/5), the Sorell Dental Clinic [https://substack.com/redirect/00820046-aad1-4f6d-8b3c-7bed0497a950?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Monday (11/5) and the Northern Dental Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/0113e51e-55ba-4c2e-b46c-7db8128496a7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] yesterday (12/5).

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

Public school teachers in the ACT are planning industrial action alongside other public sector workers. Starting tomorrow (14/5), AEU members will implement a ban [https://substack.com/redirect/a302b6c1-1070-4557-8c24-991146f3890c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on written student report comments, or replacements for comments such as phone calls, parent meetings or learning journeys. This ban will remain in place throughout Term 2. On 15 and 22 May [https://substack.com/redirect/bc96524e-61a8-4f40-93c7-788cbb9c809?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], AEU members will wear campaign merchandise to school. Teachers will also participate in a two-hour stop-work action [https://substack.com/redirect/a302b6c1-1070-4557-8c24-991146f3890c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from 8:30-10:30am on 22 May. If

actions over the next fortnight do not result in an improved offer, industrial action will escalate from 25 May [https://substack.com/redirect/7c5542df-645c-44af-a261-43477c0da1bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The escalation could include full day strike action. Teachers are fighting for a fair pay deal as well as action on workload and staff wellbeing.

AMWU Vic - Campbell's Soups

On Thursday (7/5), AMWU members at Campbell's Soups factory near Shepparton walked off the job for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/0662534a-6c9d-4998-be7b-cd23555316ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

Bosses are seeking to cut the permanent workforce at the factory in favour of a more casualised workforce. Workers have been offered a 7.7% wage [https://substack.com/redirect/ef3cb12a-a65e-4097-8b54-538f81f4b9f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] increase over 3 years, but only if they accept an increase of the current casual cap of 15% of the workforce to "an indefinite number".

This dispute is as much about fighting for secure jobs as it is about wages and conditions. Campbell's Soup is owned by the Arnotts Group which reported over \$1.6 billion in revenue last year.

AMWU/ETU/RTBU/TSU QLD - Queensland Rail

Unions were in the FWC for two days of negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/d0ac14ae-284f-456f-a118-0915046ccb57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on Thursday and Friday (7 & 8 May). While there was some progress made, significant issues remain unresolved [https://substack.com/redirect/d0ac14ae-284f-456f-a118-0915046ccb57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

As such, unions are continuing with industrial action. As the AMWU State Secretary notes, this is turning into a political football [https://substack.com/redirect/66c821b1-ba23-4120-9bd5-164f2d06ff9f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

The state government, Queensland Rail and the media are all amping up the pressure on unions and alleging that disruptions to the NRL Magic Round [https://substack.com/redirect/9fe49fb1-9fe4-40cb-8d23-5d8e48c0b096?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] this weekend will be the fault of workers.

The truth of the matter is that the refusal of Queensland Rail to accept partial work and instead essentially locking out ETU and AMWU members is what has reduced the availability of rolling stock and caused the cancellations of services. FWC Deputy President Nicholas Lake found the disruption earlier in the month was "of Queensland Rail's own making" [https://substack.com/redirect/89257db8-b935-4351-ab48-38f132320406?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

This remains the same now. After bargaining finished on Friday night, Queensland Rail and the state government again notified the RTBU (and I assume other unions) that they were going to apply to the FWC (again) to have industrial action suspended. At the time of writing, no decision in that matter had been made (that I can see!). Stay tuned for this ever evolving story. And remember - blame the bosses, not the workers.

MEU - Peabody

Workers from the Wambo coal mine washery stopped work [https://substack.com/redirect/94658c03-83a0-4749-9c65-993c288e6433?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] from Friday through to Sunday (8-10 May). Peabody have offered a measly annual wage increase of 2.5% as well as unfair changes to bonus arrangements. The MEU wants Peabody to come back to the negotiating table [https://substack.com/redirect/d13a7e87-3d20-4e3f-b7c4-a72f23177fe6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] with a less insulting offer.

Workers also struck [https://substack.com/redirect/6533d491-8985-4227-b912-dc0db1bd1c14?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] the previous weekend (1-3 May).

Last week I incorrectly reported that an unfair tier structure was part of this dispute. The unfair tier structure [https://substack.com/redirect/82cbd7cb-a5f3-4637-ab82-9866cdf154d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] is part of a separate dispute with Glencore at a number of mines (including Wambo). The workers in the washery are under a separate agreement.

The workers in the washery are under a separate agreement.

ASU/Professionals Australia - DXC

Union members at DXC commenced rolling 24 hour strikes [https://substack.com/redirect/e2b573ba-5365-4800-9e1f-9a13434329b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on (8/5) which were set to continue through to yesterday (12/5). According to tech outlet CRN, DXC have offered workers a 2.5% wage increase in the first year of a new agreement (with no backpay) followed by 3% increases in the second and third years [https://substack.com/redirect/91118ae9-7a69-4944-85e2-41ec3e68ff4d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Most DXC workers have not had a pay rise for 5 years. The dispute has also intensified [https://substack.com/redirect/f57b51fc-56ff-45d0-8a87-95f728dc7b56?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] as details of wage theft

("underpayments") come to light, as well as the company using scab labour during the previous round of industrial action. The decision to strike this past weekend was a strategic one, with DXC clients the AEC and ATO in peaks of activity due to the Farrer by-election and preparations for the budget respectively.

ANMF Vic - Public school nurses

School nurse ANMF members continue their industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/42dafbe9-6b85-45df-9ce4-9ca96975ce11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. They have been negotiating a new EBA since June 2025, almost 12 months. All they are seeking is pay parity with their colleagues in the rest of the public health system. Currently, school nurses are paid between 20% less than other nurses, and this could blow out to 30% by the end of 2027 if they are paid according to the state government's wages policy. In addition to the wages and conditions of school nurses, the ANMF is seeking a commitment from the state government to ensure workloads are safe.

AEU Victoria - Public sector school teachers

Since the suspension of stoppages announced last week, negotiations between the AEU and the state government have continued [https://substack.com/redirect/703bc684-5880-4d9e-952d-116d325f28a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], including over the weekend. The suspension of stoppages has frustrated and angered many AEU members, with rank and file groups organising motions [https://substack.com/redirect/082ab1e8-a5ba-4b8c-b94e-8ef758d120de?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to be passed at regional and sub-branch meetings, with demands for mass meetings and strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/d8dac9ed-2026-47bb-9b1f-5f0e9adb6cb0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. As far as members are aware, no formal offer has been made to the AEU as yet. AEU Branch Council is set to meet on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/8db3e461-c572-4cfe-811e-e1fe2c3fa831?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (15/5) which could be an opportunity for an offer to be presented for endorsement. Stay tuned.

In short

ETU - Goldwind

Industrial action continues [https://substack.com/redirect/54fe66f7-94dc-4212-9941-522b3954d5aa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] at 5 Goldwind wind farm sites across NSW, Victoria and Tasmania. Work stoppages have now commenced. The ETU says workers are ready to negotiate, but the bosses are refusing to meet with delegates.

USU NSW - Liverpool City Council

Last night (12/5), the Liverpool City Council held an extraordinary council meeting to vote on proposed job cuts. USU members at the council met on Tuesday (12/5) morning and implemented a number of bans [https://substack.com/redirect/460deb07-6e4f-4fca-9485-b7f61585b215?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] including a ban on participating in the creation of reports for Council meetings and on presenting at these meetings, and a ban on participating in media or photos with the Mayor or councillors. USU members were invited to join Liverpool City Council workers at a rally outside the council meeting at 4:30pm [https://substack.com/redirect/ff6744b7-2335-4bfa-b77d-2dce0b857344?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

At the time of writing, I don't know how the meeting went.

Union news

VAHPA - Public sector allied health workers

VAHPA members started voting in a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/a97ca5e9-8b5f-4d70-a9aa-f7291f7bbbd1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on Monday (11 May). VAHPA has been in negotiations for 8 months [https://substack.com/redirect/33cbec17-eaad-41f2-a20c-31fe4fef9013?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and the government is yet to make an offer. VAHPA is seeking a 36.18% wage increase over 3 years. The union held two online town hall meetings [https://substack.com/redirect/0465e88a-0919-4a4f-b98f-9c1709a9e6cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to discuss industrial action yesterday (at the time of writing, I haven't had any reports back from these meetings). In other VAHPA news, rank and file group VAHPA Pulse have announced that they will be putting forward a ticket in the VAHPA elections [https://substack.com/redirect/b460f601-31ef-4ea5-b84b-f46619df735a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which are scheduled to be held this year. VAHPA Pulse intends to put forward a full ticket covering all leadership positions (President, Vice President, Secretary and Assistant Secretary) as well as the 5 "ordinary" positions on the Branch Committee of Management.

Wins/resolutions

HACSU Tasmania - RHH

HACSU members at the Royal Hobart Hospital have been taking industrial action for several months. There are a number of issues in dispute at the hospital, but one issue has now finally been resolved [https://substack.com/redirect/85a203f6-724e-4205-a148-d8a2e784c191?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. 5 Central Sterilising Department workers have been trying to secure permanent employment for over 12 months, but management have just ignored them. 4 of the 5 workers have now been made permanent, with the fifth worker set to join his

comrades as a permanent member of staff once he has been working at the RHH for 36 months. Let's hope the rest of the issues in dispute can be satisfactorily resolved too.

That's all I've got this week! I've been feeling uneasy about the One Nation victory in Farrer on the weekend - and I'm sure I'm not the only one. This is really not the place for electoral politics, but I also know that One Nation, and Pauline Hanson, are really anti-worker (along with all their other antis). The question is what do we as workers and unionists do about this? Keen to hear your thoughts.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UazNNe1F4T1RZNExDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056ZzJNakUxTlRjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE1ERTFOe1UxTn13aWFTnpJam9pY0hwUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhsWDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuWGJ5NXcwLWNFcUZlbFNwcFltR3Zzd3kwZnZub0R2ZGVhRjRtWjJla1NDRSIsInAiOjE5NzM0MTk2OCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3ODYyMTU1NywiZXhwIjoyMDk0MTk3NTU3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.k8zLjOUy7WWpnTqXkw0jKVIfhjfnuLdmx2PcHD4yi28?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-14-may>

AMWU NSW - Keolis Downer

Mechanics and maintenance workers at Keolis Downer Northern Beaches took strike action for 48 hours starting on 2 May. This follows three hour stoppages held at the Brookvale and Mona Vale depots in April. The workers are fighting for pay parity with other bus maintenance workers in the state - as they earn up to 17% less than other workers.

AEAWA - St John's Ambulance

Members of the Ambulance Employees Association of Western Australia commenced industrial action on 29 April [https://substack.com/redirect/99980598-88a0-4ef7-a3e0-79039d0d3a8d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The action follows an

“overwhelming” rejection of a proposed EBA. Paramedics are concerned about the ramping crisis [https://substack.com/redirect/5e300810-98bc-409a-a742-61f5fb017323?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in WA, as well as forced overtime

[https://substack.com/redirect/0dbd6455-5924-4dc4-8e21-17aa7b0daf5b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers will not be taking strike

action [https://substack.com/redirect/976b870d-a6f2-46a3-aa87-065b4b02e0be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] but instead will be painting

campaign messages on ambulance vehicles, wearing union T-shirts, prioritising personal fatigue management, ceasing to respond to work communications outside of work hours and starting vehicle and equipment checks only during paid hours.

USU - Riverina Water

Last Tuesday (6/5), USU members at Riverina Water walked off the job [

https://substack.com/redirect/5a9cb40f-3b4c-4fd0-943d-b09f1b43cf57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers are angry. That outdoor

staff are rostered for 38 hours per week while indoor staff only work a 35 hour week. The union claims this equals to 4.1 weeks of unpaid work per year and that outdoor workers earn nearly 8% less than indoor workers. Workers voted to return to work the next day as CEO Andrew Cracken Thorpe announced an extraordinary meeting of the board would be held [

https://substack.com/redirect/60848a49-2844-40a6-8221-5e2ef5acf1b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in response to the action. The

meeting was due to be held yesterday (13/5).

HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

Stoppages in support of HACSU's EBA campaign for public sector mental health workers continues.

Recent stoppages include the Royal Melbourne Hospital and Royal Children's Hospital [

https://substack.com/redirect/1d95513f-8b93-4d1c-bf6f-45d15b557a08?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on 7 May and Goulburn Valley

Health [https://substack.com/redirect/477b3ed4-15c8-405b-9708-4479f1728039?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on 29 April.

The Services Union/AWU QLD - Noosa City Council

Union members at Noosa City Council participated in [https://substack.com/redirect/773b6b96-9aa9-4e17-b2d8-ca3888cd74a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] [

https://substack.com/redirect/773b6b96-9aa9-4e17-b2d8-ca3888cd74a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] a half day strike on 1 May [

https://substack.com/redirect/773b6b96-9aa9-4e17-b2d8-ca3888cd74a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. In retaliation to this fourth

round of industrial action Noosa City Council CEO Larry Sengstock advised that all workers

participating in the industrial action would be subject to an unpaid lockout from 1 May to 4 May [

https://substack.com/redirect/7eebc491-57e5-440c-a001-a34d6150d32b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. In anyone's book a lockout over a

holiday weekend (let alone Labour Day) is a dog act. Union members are fighting for an 18.5% wage

increase over 3 years, with a 9.5% increase in the first year in order to keep up with the wages of

workers in neighbouring council areas.

AWU WA - Department of Biodiversity, Conservation and Attractions (DBCA)

AWU members employed as firefighters by the Department of Biodiversity, Conservation and Action

(DBCA) have commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/a2cf268e-9c76-484e-ba79-7cb337d34b1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], however due to the

nature of their work the action is limited to working to rule, including no overtime or working on

public holidays. This industrial action has already caused the states' prescribed burns program to

fall behind schedule. Firefighters employed by the DBCA have been in negotiations for a new agreement

for two years. According to the AWU, the 300 firefighters employed by the Department are paid

approximately 15-20% less than other comparable government workers.

QNMU - Public sector nurses & midwives

Despite the QLD Government's threat to not pay back pay if nurses strike, the QNMU have not ruled out strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/01322aa6-f66c-432a-ac59-7ff1b534c463?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Nurses and midwives want to hold the LNP to their promise of "nation leading wages and conditions", but the best Crisafulli has come up with thus far is an average of 2.67% per annum over the next 3 years. The QNMU is holding consultation meetings with members over the course of this week [https://substack.com/redirect/43360b1f-c9eb-4409-bda7-f6099a830287?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] - presumably to determine next steps.

CFMEU QLD - Qube

Qube's crane crew commenced industrial action last Thursday (8/5) [https://substack.com/redirect/265cb501-fbfc-4f11-9217-70d1d3de409d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers have been in negotiations since February. They are demanding a fair deal and that Qube pay market rates.

USU - Kiama Council

Waste services workers at Kiama Council took strike action last Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/be3d1d61-7080-4dee-ab09-515a2b670344?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (5/5). It appears the action was in relation to the council's decision to put waste services out to contract. Discussions between the union workers and council on the morning of the strike apparently resulted in an "agreed plan forward". The strike caused disruptions [https://substack.com/redirect/051e386c-54e9-4236-9533-6699bb8acea1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to the cleaning of public amenities and facilities, commercial and public place waste collection as well as household waste collection.

HACSU Victoria - Forensicare

Last Wednesday (7/5), HACSU members at Forensicare held a two hour stop work meeting and rally in Clifton Hill. In April, Forensicare workers voted to take protected industrial action in concert with other public sector mental health workers in Victoria. HACSU members at Forensicare fighting for 5% annual pay increases, improved allowances, and for classifications and structures to be modernised and updated [https://substack.com/redirect/41599414-88f7-49ca-94e7-2ddc53a67e95?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

AMWU/ETU/UWU SA - PepsiCo

Union workers at PepsiCo in South Australia commenced rolling four hour stoppages last Thursday (8/5) [https://substack.com/redirect/5f6a51c4-f7be-4f6b-92ff-168d1886b328?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a decent pay increase to keep up with the cost of living. PepsiCo workers in South Australia are paid 12% less than their colleagues in Queensland. The agreement South Australian workers are paid under expired in February [https://substack.com/redirect/0a5c2dc3-5e7f-4467-9d1e-dde38a261630?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] - it included only 2.6% annual wage increases leaving workers struggling to keep pace with inflation

HACSU Tasmania - Tolosa Street Adult Mental Health Service

On 30 April, mental health workers at Tolosa Street mental health service walked off the job for 1 hour in response to the state government's proposal to the sale and privatisation of the facility. Tolosa Street is one of only six public mental health facilities in Tasmania workers are calling for the cancellation of the sale of the facility and for the government to commit to maintaining and expanding public mental healthcare.

ANMF Vic - Aurora Healthcare

ANMF members at two Aurora Healthcare hospitals commenced industrial action on 29 April. Workers at Brunswick Private and South Eastern Private hospitals are participating in a range of activities [https://substack.com/redirect/c113a843-65c9-4b85-bdc2-612ef842dc98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] including a uniform ban; a ban on undertaking administrative or food service duties; a ban on overtime; a ban on attending management meetings unless fully backfilled; a refusal to implement any workplace or system changes proposed by management and adding information about the industrial action to all emails. Bed closures may also take place in some circumstances. The current EBA for these nurses expired in July 2024. Nurses are fighting for decent pay and conditions, comparable to those found in the public system.

HACSU Tasmania - Royal Hobart Hospital

Perioperative technicians at the Royal Hobart Hospital walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/7cef6c77-8873-44c9-8e3f-7b587b471dcf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] for one hour on 24 April. The stop work action is part of the campaign to increase staffing to improve workload and safety. HACSU members have been calling for an exemption from the state government's hiring freeze and to increase staffing for almost a year.

FWO - May Day

The old curmudgeons at the Fair Work Ombudsman put out a statement [

[https://substack.com/redirect/9685aae3-6e61-4f9e-bf77-8e5289a8b23e?](https://substack.com/redirect/9685aae3-6e61-4f9e-bf77-8e5289a8b23e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9685aae3-6e61-4f9e-bf77-8e5289a8b23e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on 30 April about the May Day rally that was held in Sydney on 1 May. Instead of celebrating the revolutionary possibilities of May Day, the Ombudsman took the time to remind bosses of their responsibility to do in workers for taking unprotected industrial action and that it is “unlawful to do something that prevents the Administrator of the Construction & General Division of the CFMEU from effectively administering the scheme of administration.” The May Day rally in Sydney went ahead.

ANMF VIC - Epworth Medical Imaging

ANMF members at Epworth medical imaging commenced industrial action of fortnight ago. The ANMF has described this as “stage one” industrial action so it is likely workers are wearing union T-shirts, putting up posters, talking to patients and potentially some administrative bans. The ANMF is fighting for 4.5% annual wage increases as well as improved entitlements including a \$9 lead apron allowance.

HSU NSW - Cootamundra open

Following industrial action by HSU members in February alongside a community campaign, NSW Minister for Health Ryan Park has reversed his decision to close the Cootamundra Hospital’s Pathology Laboratory [[https://substack.com/redirect/42626624-0e6d-45a3-aa48-0b2b6026b257?](https://substack.com/redirect/42626624-0e6d-45a3-aa48-0b2b6026b257?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/42626624-0e6d-45a3-aa48-0b2b6026b257?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The lab will now remain open!

John Setka - FWC

In February the Fair Work Ombudsman commenced legal action [https://substack.com/redirect/7458c849-ae30-4042-8a8d-8d76aa96b7b6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] against former CFMEU Victorian Secretary John Seca for allegedly taking adverse action against former head of the ABCC Stephen McBurney. The adverse action is based on comments to the media and on social media [[https://substack.com/redirect/1ba2a885-3b57-4c9a-981c-f42fc2910ded?](https://substack.com/redirect/1ba2a885-3b57-4c9a-981c-f42fc2910ded?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1ba2a885-3b57-4c9a-981c-f42fc2910ded?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] where Setka threatened to block or delay construction projects linked to the AFL unless McBurney was sacked from his role at the AFL. Setka has failed to turn up at two Federal Court hearings [https://substack.com/redirect/0945b529-44e2-41f4-8257-fe0bf49fd6c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], most recently a case management hearing scheduled for last Friday (9/5) instead sending a medical certificate that he is too unwell to attend meetings. The hearing will recommence on June 2

HWU Administration

The HSU National Executive and Diana Asmar reached an agreement on 2 May that Asmar would step down voluntarily [[https://substack.com/redirect/0c5eaf45-1775-4e03-9b69-17a7b40a66ff?](https://substack.com/redirect/0c5eaf45-1775-4e03-9b69-17a7b40a66ff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0c5eaf45-1775-4e03-9b69-17a7b40a66ff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] to avoid lengthy court processes. This agreement doesn’t effect the FWC’s prosecution against HWU leadership for financial misconduct. The HSU National Office will support the FWC in these prosecutions. The administration of the HWU will oversee the union until the branch elections due to occur in 2026.

A bit of a marathon report after taking a couple of weeks off the report! Thanks to all the comrades who checked in with me. I am feeling much better, but suffering from some keyboard induced RSI! So please forgive any typos in the report this week... the vast majority was typed via a dictation tool!

In solidarity, Sarah

PS: BREAKING NEWS

As I put the finishing touches on the report last night, an article dropped in the AFR [

[https://substack.com/redirect/4657dd8e-c921-440d-a0dd-bcd5eca4b039?](https://substack.com/redirect/4657dd8e-c921-440d-a0dd-bcd5eca4b039?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4657dd8e-c921-440d-a0dd-bcd5eca4b039?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] revealing that the CFMEU’s ACT Branch was placed into administration by CFMEU Administrator Mark Irving. Michael Hiscox, who had been acting as Branch Secretary has apparently had his delegation “terminated”, which would mean he is now back as Assistant Secretary. Ben Davison (Sally McManus’ former chief of staff at the ACTU, Van Badham’s boyfriend and an AustralianSuper director) who has apparently been working for Mark Irving for some time will take over the ACT Branch as Executive Officer. Irving has claimed the reason for putting the branch into administration is a decline in membership and “a projected \$500,000 loss”. It is worth noting this is taking place less than 2 weeks after Michael Hiscox and WA Branch Secretary Mick Buchan put out a statement of concern [https://substack.com/redirect/7a98d15a-74ea-438d-8689-84ba0e667fa7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] about a proposed restructure of the CFMEU National Office. Mick Buchan is now the only remaining elected Branch Secretary of the CFMEU Construction & General Division.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZWlhaWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UWxpORFkzTlRnNUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05EY3h0ek13Tmpra0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM09EY3dPREYtT1N3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdpVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpKV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhSWDJWdFlxOHBNBjAud3hGMm9ra21CaGtuR2RxZXo3S194N1R3bXNpWEtrR0hWWFdGWWhuR2tYRSIsInAiOjE2MzQ2NzU4OSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzZmXmNzMsImldhCI6MTc0NzE3MjA2OSwiZXhwIjoxNzQ5NzY0MDY5LClJpc3MiOiIjWdWlTmCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.E1VHOo5ZK0OwlgfQaIaIMtjdeyIaRpgWBL510XzxPVI?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-15-april>

ETU WA - BHP

Specialised high voltage electricians at BHP in the Pilbara are set to commence industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/6229f9ef-9a51-4e1f-a513-ff84f179411e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] tomorrow (16/4). The industrial action will be a series of work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/4819d953-3ba1-4304-b398-fe2c74ed71b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. For 2 weeks ETU members will refuse overtime, call-outs and stepping up as supervisors, as well as an indefinite ban on mentoring new employees. Workers are seeking to improve pay, lock in existing conditions and have travel time, higher duties and on-call time recognised.

ASU Vic - Melbourne metropolitan councils

Industrial action at 8 Melbourne councils has kicked off [https://substack.com/redirect/8f048fce-6b9b-4ea4-ba53-36c0a9cca789?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as ASU members fight for a multi-employer agreement. On 7 April, waste workers at Darebin, Hume and Merri-bek councils and parking officers at Yarra, Maribyrnong and Melbourne struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/8d3f8cb7-3773-45ff-be1c-ab8feb9dc9d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

ASU members at those 6 councils, plus Greater Dandenong and Hobsons Bay commenced a variety of work bans on 8 April [https://substack.com/redirect/d6e73aa2-0f6e-48db-8d99-539d0cb6c473?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. These included bans (some indefinite, and some periodic) on responding or actioning requests received through council CRM systems; processing or issuing parking permits, pet registrations, planning permits, building permits or occupancy certificates; delivering inductions or training for new staff; opening after-hours library return chutes; street cleaning and more. Full details of work bans are available here [https://substack.com/redirect/f6613f10-14d8-46f2-b9b2-470efb2761aa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Workers are fighting for decent pay increases after real wages have declined during the cost of living crisis. The ASU is asking for a 10% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/c0b3cb23-ff9c-4d3e-8cb5-c89b1991e1f3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the first year of the agreement, and a 4% increase in the second.

RTBU QLD (& others!) - Queensland Rail

A big thank you to the comrades at RTBU Queensland for this explainer video [https://substack.com/redirect/152fba46-2cfa-4e18-875e-c1d4d6e4523f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for the whole Queensland Rail kerfuffle. To the best of my reading of multiple news articles and FWC decisions, the video is accurate. Train controllers decided to take low level protected industrial action. Queensland Rail responded by shutting the network down and essentially locking out workers [https://substack.com/redirect/a560c694-29dd-49c8-b82f-05bfa2a960cc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Then Queensland Rail took the RTBU to the FWC [https://substack.com/redirect/32da970f-b3fb-44a5-ae7-d598dd1f5ca4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to try and get industrial action suspended under s424 of the Fair Work Act (that action has to be suspended if it endangers health or safety; or is likely to damage the economy). Disregarding the fact that you can't do a ban on overtime if the whole network has been shut down by the bosses? It really doesn't make a lot of sense. Anyway, the FWC dismissed the s424 claim and then ordered a conference for all parties on 8 & 9 April. At the conference, Deputy President Lake "stressed [https://substack.com/redirect/cf45424f-007b-47f1-ab7b-c0bca1be1f16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" their view that Queensland Rail should provide the 6 draft agreements ASAP. The RTBU, The Services Union, Professionals Australia, the CFMEU and the PPTU have agreed to no industrial action until 27 April to allow Queensland Rail time to focus on drafting these agreements. The ETU is pressing for a standalone agreement and they may still be participating in work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/feafab76-fe45-4204-a386-2791d59e324c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The AMWU agreed to pause industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/c8b83054-4abb-4dfa-80a6-0376dc5f0f2c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Friday (10/4). Lots of moving parts here - please get in touch with corrections and updates!

NSWNMA - Public sector nurses and midwives

After three months of deliberations the NSW IRC has advised that the NSWNMA's Special Case has been listed for a hearing tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/412e51b0-3ee8-41af-9fbf-cf6dcc3f7b08?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (16/4) at 9:30am. It is expected that the IRC will deliver a decision on pay and conditions for public sector nurses and midwives. You can tune in and watch the livestream [<https://substack.com/redirect/505ce397-1122-4ef1-beb9->

ab230e9266f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] if you're keen. The first negotiating meeting in this campaign was held way back in June 2024 (not a typo I promise) and a range of industrial action was held in 2024, including strike action. Since then, it has been a long process for the NSWMA of preparing for the special case, presenting evidence at the IRC and then waiting. Fingers crossed for a decent outcome for our NSWMA comrades.

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

Last week the AEU Branch Executive met and endorsed escalating industrial action in Term 2 [

[https://substack.com/redirect/eb207d19-3bb6-4ff3-818e-df5d6691ab4a?](https://substack.com/redirect/eb207d19-3bb6-4ff3-818e-df5d6691ab4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/eb207d19-3bb6-4ff3-818e-df5d6691ab4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Term 2 kicks off on Monday 20

April. A range of work bans [[https://substack.com/redirect/b53c7aa3-c14e-4476-9ae3-e6630255d5c7?](https://substack.com/redirect/b53c7aa3-c14e-4476-9ae3-e6630255d5c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b53c7aa3-c14e-4476-9ae3-e6630255d5c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] will be introduced including a ban on attending one hour of meetings per week; a ban on principal members attending principal area forum meetings and the 2026 Government Schools Principal Conference; a ban on responding to emails from the Department of Education; a ban on implementing any new Department programs and initiatives; and a ban on providing written comments on student reports. In addition to these bans, more stopwork action will kick off in the first week of May. Rolling stoppages will see AEU members in specific areas stopping work for a half day and rallying before returning to work for the afternoon. While negotiations with the state government have continued over the school holidays, according to Branch Secretary Justin Mullaly, "things are not progressing sufficiently [

[https://substack.com/redirect/eb207d19-3bb6-4ff3-818e-df5d6691ab4a?](https://substack.com/redirect/eb207d19-3bb6-4ff3-818e-df5d6691ab4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/eb207d19-3bb6-4ff3-818e-df5d6691ab4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]".

MSAV - Public sector health professionals

MSAV members rallied in Melbourne on 1 April - their first strike action since 2012. I think some work bans are in place, but I am not certain. Workers are fighting for a 28% wage increase over 4 years [[https://substack.com/redirect/bdf30e48-68aa-4cd6-be0f-a8fd6ca1a1a7?](https://substack.com/redirect/bdf30e48-68aa-4cd6-be0f-a8fd6ca1a1a7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/bdf30e48-68aa-4cd6-be0f-a8fd6ca1a1a7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] as well as improvements to conditions. Their EBA expired months ago [[https://substack.com/redirect/f5e3a0fc-f1b0-423f-90e7-0f1fcabc60b15?](https://substack.com/redirect/f5e3a0fc-f1b0-423f-90e7-0f1fcabc60b15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f5e3a0fc-f1b0-423f-90e7-0f1fcabc60b15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] and the state government has offered them nothing more than the woeful 3% wage increase mandated by the wages policy. Are you a MSAV member who can update me on this dispute? Please get in touch.

CPSU/MEAA - ABC

A couple of small updates on the EBA negotiations at the ABC. The Age reported yesterday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e11f7699-4ecf-4195-8015-f90a6d53c6cb?](https://substack.com/redirect/e11f7699-4ecf-4195-8015-f90a6d53c6cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e11f7699-4ecf-4195-8015-f90a6d53c6cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] that the MEAA believed the ABC was backpedalling on automatic pay grade rises to staff on pay band 5, and a members meeting was being held to discuss the potential for more industrial action. According to the MEAA website [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2d3eeea4-46ee-42da-bd08-2566e4950af9?](https://substack.com/redirect/2d3eeea4-46ee-42da-bd08-2566e4950af9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2d3eeea4-46ee-42da-bd08-2566e4950af9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]: "While the parties have reached in-principle agreement, it's not over until we have settled drafting and formally voted to endorse. So now is not the time to take the pressure off, and the following protected industrial actions will remain ongoing until drafting is finalised and the access period opens: refusing performance appraisals; out-of-office automatic replies; email signatures; wearing MEAA t-shirts." At the time of writing, I can't see any formal statements about this from the ABC or MEAA or CPSU. Any ABC workers reading this? Get in touch!

Professionals Australia - DXC

Professionals Australia members at DXC struck for 24 hours on 2 April [

[https://substack.com/redirect/9543d692-c1e9-4303-b6e3-2097c8685124?](https://substack.com/redirect/9543d692-c1e9-4303-b6e3-2097c8685124?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9543d692-c1e9-4303-b6e3-2097c8685124?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Workers also instituted work bans on overtime, standby and callout work for 3 days as well as bans on servicing customer requests and attending meetings. It has also been reported that workers are refusing to submit timesheets, making it difficult to bill clients. DXC tried to bribe mainframe workers with a \$975 a day payment [

[https://substack.com/redirect/6022cab7-a99f-4080-b9f6-f503b2f6a337?](https://substack.com/redirect/6022cab7-a99f-4080-b9f6-f503b2f6a337?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6022cab7-a99f-4080-b9f6-f503b2f6a337?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] over Easter to cross the picket line and deal with urgent system changes. Professionals Australia members stuck fat and rejected the bribe collectively. DXC workers have gone 5 years without a pay rise. All they are fighting for is for management to bargain fairly and provide a decent pay increase that will help them keep up with the cost of living. Professionals Australia is asking supporters to sign this petition [

[https://substack.com/redirect/54035185-cd3f-4a9c-a006-b3ca4a19901d?](https://substack.com/redirect/54035185-cd3f-4a9c-a006-b3ca4a19901d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/54035185-cd3f-4a9c-a006-b3ca4a19901d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] to back these workers.

HACSU Tasmania - Ambulance Tasmania

HACSU members at Ambulance Tasmania rejected a pay offer from the government and commenced industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/e5863056-7d79-4fef-8cd3-dea7647fe706?](https://substack.com/redirect/e5863056-7d79-4fef-8cd3-dea7647fe706?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e5863056-7d79-4fef-8cd3-dea7647fe706?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on 7 April. Having listened to this podcast [[https://substack.com/redirect/6dde8c38-c829-47bc-95a5-378ad4208b6d?](https://substack.com/redirect/6dde8c38-c829-47bc-95a5-378ad4208b6d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6dde8c38-c829-47bc-95a5-378ad4208b6d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] with paramedic Jan, I'm not

surprised. Ambulance Tasmania is sending out ambulances with only one officer; they are short staffed; not getting breaks and always finishing late. It's not just paramedics out on the road, comms team staff are also suffering under poor conditions like not being able to leave their posts for bathroom breaks. Horrendous! Industrial action at this stage includes overtime bans and bans on billing patients [https://substack.com/redirect/65f3f428-d2b0-4176-b015-5a136ab57d98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but could escalate.

TWU WA - Brownes

On 1 April, TWU members at Brownes Dairy struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/aa741ed4-1c51-4377-bdb3-b68770247f00?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Workers are fighting for better pay and conditions; improvements to job security; and better parental leave. Negotiations have been ongoing since 2025. And while Brownes are quick to boast about being like a family and claim to prioritise the well-being of their employees [https://substack.com/redirect/9fa597e7-7869-4c91-a8ff-86ada178ecee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the bosses still saw fit to call the cops on workers who were striking [https://substack.com/redirect/86a36073-cb97-4f1b-afe1-cebb2418a639?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Shameful behaviour.

UWU - MSS

Security guards at Casey Hospital stopped work for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/31fa79d8-2577-4c45-a7ba-8bb5dc14293?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 8 April. This is the latest stoppage by these workers in their fight for a fair pay rise that reflects the dangerous and demanding nature of their work. I believe the first stoppage by these workers was in September 2025 [https://substack.com/redirect/9d272ccd-dda5-48e5-bc1e-6077565c57ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Security guards at Casey Hospital are paid less than guards elsewhere in the public health system - earning up \$10 [

https://substack.com/redirect/c84684c6-fc76-4e49-9a64-e5799d681e86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] less [

https://substack.com/redirect/c84684c6-fc76-4e49-9a64-e5799d681e86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] per hour [

https://substack.com/redirect/c84684c6-fc76-4e49-9a64-e5799d681e86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

UWU is calling for the Victorian government to intervene and ensure contractors in public hospitals pay fair and competitive wages. In short

AWU Vic - Hytec

AWU members at Hy-Tec Concrete have been stood down without pay for participating in partial work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/c56e3415-ddcc-4023-99d0-6402c63f3496?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The AWU has set up a donation page [https://substack.com/redirect/4e7030cb-eb19-4045-9f46-bd1c1b3d524c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to help these workers out. No

other details available at this stage. If you know something, let me know!

RTBU NSW - Aurizon

RTBU members who drive coal trains for Aurizon struck for 30 hours this week [

https://substack.com/redirect/3e0aa3a9-e3e9-4e13-a0cf-1e8334cd8da5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The strike started on Sunday night (12/4) and finished yesterday (14/4). The stoppage was in response to stalled negotiations which have been dragging on for months. Aurizon sent a letter to workers [

https://substack.com/redirect/a42cc699-8437-4569-9060-874f949deb2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the day before the strike which

included threats to call emergency contacts or even emergency services for welfare checks if workers did not turn up to work.

UWU Vic - Vinidex

UWU members at Vinidex, a PVC pipe manufacturer in Sunshine, commenced industrial action earlier this month [https://substack.com/redirect/48f2147d-f83e-4fa0-ba09-250f124065d2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Workers are fighting for fairer annual leave conditions and better conditions. UWU is asking supporters to sign a petition [

https://substack.com/redirect/a8b01d4b-4e62-4df8-ab86-cee604454449?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to CEO of Vinidex's parent company

Aliaxis demanding bosses come to the table with a fair deal.

Wins/Resolutions

AEU/CPSU/HACSU Tasmania - Tasmanian Public Sector

While the ambos are still in dispute, several other sections of the Tasmanian public sector have reached agreement with the state government. AEU members are currently voting on the government's latest offer [https://substack.com/redirect/0aac770f-f987-420c-a5d6-aaf516851f4e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which includes an 8.75% pay

increase over 3 years (3/3/2.75) as well as an increase to base salaries. You can see all the details

CFMEU WA - Freo Cranes

<https://substack.com/redirect/c937526f-d83c-42cf-b802-a1aff473e038?>

<https://substack.com/redirect/a576f95c-2014-48ab-8b0a-aa3fe310f418?>

That's all I've got this week! I am going to try and collate events for International Workers

In solidarity, Sarah

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNH0XpkRjllwWkNjNk1UazBNVGM1TnprMEXdSnBZWFpT2pFM056WXlNREl6T1Rrc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd056Y3pPRE01T1N3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXNdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT21Ka2FYTmhZbXhsWDJwF1XbHNjbJuaK5meFpsdHBxeVZFODM0dnhzOXlmcXg0Q3JrUzVtNlZYd1JDOFYtTlRPSVSiInAiOjE5NDE3OTc5NCwicYl6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzZmXzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3NjIwMjM0SwiZlXhwIjoyMDkxNzcyMzk5LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.kou7MbwenUSOXMSNI-U2W-UPzv1jhVyL8bo1Hbe8_ks?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-15-january>

ANMF Victoria - St Vincent's Private

Nurses and midwives at St Vincent's Private escalated their industrial campaign last Wednesday (8/1) with bed closures [https://substack.com/redirect/ae8a452d-1311-48b3-8b49-e7ded77bfd52?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The protected industrial action allows ANMF members to "close one (1) in every three (3) beds, subject to the following exemptions: cardiac, neurosurgery, oncology, maternity/obstetrics, paediatric, neonatal and palliative care patients or emergency patients, patients in intensive care, high dependency and coronary care units or emergency patients where their condition is expected to deteriorate within 48 hours if they were not admitted to an inpatient bed." St Vincent's management tried to assert this action was unlawful, but nurses and midwives have stood strong. Nurses have been undertaking industrial action at St Vincent's since November as part of their campaign for ratios and improved conditions.

CRU - Sydney Trains

Sydney Trains and the NSW Government continue to frustrate the combined rail unions. First up, Sydney Trains docked the pay of RTBU members [https://substack.com/redirect/6eb15220-1842-4e45-9081-3430c6181bd8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] who had participated in industrial action. On Friday (10/1) the government made an offer which ripped up dozens of claims already agreed to by both parties. The RTBU believes this offer was made on the direction of NSW Treasurer Daniel Mookhey. [https://substack.com/redirect/1a763cd7-bc8e-4902-a788-7b326f7667b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] The unions have been back in the Commission this week where a revised offer was presented which brought back some but not all of the previously discarded clauses. Importantly, the current offer removes Section 35A - a condition won in the 2022 EA which ensures risk assessments are conducted by workers. There are also some other changes around consultation and the introduction of new systems into the network. The wages component of the offer is a 13% increase over 4 years - the unions have been fighting for 32% [https://substack.com/redirect/f7a4327c-7fba-4263-b1d9-390eacff0af1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Regardless of wages, the removal of Section 35A will make this an unpalatable offer to workers. It is understood Sydney Trains have asked for unions to accept or reject the offer by Thursday, but plan to put it out to ballot regardless of the unions' views. Industrial action on the network is set to step up again today [https://substack.com/redirect/c192e4c0-cf15-49ae-9151-1a1784edba84?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as train drivers will reduce speeds to 23km/hour on some sections of the network. Existing work bans will also continue. Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to receive the full report straight to your inbox.

TWU SA - Veolia

94% of TWU members at Veolia who do waste collection in the Adelaide council districts of Gawler, Playford and Salisbury have voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/8ed0eb89-68c0-450a-a433-54d0709088ae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The three councils have an arrangement through the Northern Adelaide Waste Management Authority to collectively manage waste collection. The current contract is with Veolia, but is due to shift to a different contractor in September. Workers and their union are concerned about job security with the change in contractors, and are fighting for decent redundancy provisions as well as the carry over entitlements and conditions to the new contractor. The TWU wants the Councils, through the Northern Adelaide Waste Manage Authority to come to the table and help ensure a fair transition for workers when the new contractor commences operations [https://substack.com/redirect/9640b5b4-b434-4635-8730-ca06195ace70?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

MUA - Qube

Yesterday (14/1), the MUA notified Qube of the removal of protected industrial action from 7am this morning [https://substack.com/redirect/5e1c7b7b-dc39-4232-b38c-2201bcb71352?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. As yet there doesn't appear to be any public comments from Qube or the MUA about the status of EBA negotiations. I would expect to get some further information later today. Last week, the MUA offered a compromise position [https://substack.com/redirect/6296e33f-2d05-4ed3-8169-39d13d9ce023?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but this was rejected by Qube. According to the MUA the compromise "hinges upon non-cost outcomes around two final issues during negotiations." The union's media release revealed one of these issues to be income protection insurance, and hinted the other related to "discrimination against workers who took industrial action". Meanwhile, Shipping Australia called for the Federal Government to intervene in the dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/70107b83-2762-4ce4-a393-17928fd9f870?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], terminate industrial action and send the dispute to the FWC for arbitration.

ASMOF - NSW Public Psychiatrists

Psychiatrists in the NSW public health system have been in negotiations with the NSW Government for 16 months over pay and staffing levels. According to ASMOF there is a 30% pay gap [https://substack.com/redirect/ae80abcc-0afa-416d-a0aa-7a99fa78de42?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] between NSW's public psychiatrists and their colleagues in other states. This has led to a severe staffing crisis with one-third of positions vacant [https://substack.com/redirect/375ee7da-0506-4027-b5db-09f735d8719d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Late last year when the NSW Government found out that psychiatrists were planning to resign en masse, they lodged a dispute in the IRC which made orders [https://substack.com/redirect/9e802b14-288e-429d-809e-5dd15a68079e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to prevent ASMOF from participating in the organisation of mass resignations, and directed the Federation to advise members not to resign. Talk about not having the right to withdraw your labour!! Even so, over 200 of 295 public psychiatrists in NSW have sent in resignations [https://substack.com/redirect/e672f6e9-e0c7-4001-ab34-01f2970d0228?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] - effective 21 January. Minister for Health Ryan Park begged psychiatrists via a press conference to not resign [https://substack.com/redirect/b3061a91-a754-485f-9717-3c6b1755e100?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], but refuses to come to the table with a better offer. ASMOF was back in the NSW IRC yesterday, and will be holding a press conference today at 11am [https://substack.com/redirect/a56da7ca-f197-4f52-a954-85a4bb8b2f48?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Stay tuned.

AMOU/AIMPE - Smit Lamnalco

AMOU and AIMPE members who work on tug boats at Gladstone Port commenced industrial action yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/d717081d-4107-4695-bda1-3e3965a75521?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (14/1). The action is expected to run through to 28 January and would include bans on overtime, work during rostered leave and other work bans. The National Organiser at AIMPE, Sam Littlewood was quoted in DCN explaining that the aim of the action was "improving conditions to ensure there is predictability in crew start and finish times, and also predictability for periods of rest while on duty. None of the notified action will have the effect of stopping towage being conducted in the port. [https://substack.com/redirect/0df01841-b303-4aac-83a7-74fbc4334b78?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]" Smit Lamnalco filed a bargaining dispute with the FWC last week, but as of yesterday had not received a response from the Commission. Queensland's nurses, teachers & cops

The Queensland Council of Unions' General Secretary Jacqueline King has called on the QLD Government to fund "fair and decent" pay rises and commit to a central wages policy for all public sector workers [https://substack.com/redirect/27c1081d-e7f7-4d22-874e-e975487bd4f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. In comments to The Australian King said the alternative was "a year of rolling industrial and strike action across hospitals, schools, police and other services." The agreement with public sector nurses expires on 31 March, and negotiations with the government are set to kick off in earnest this week. The cops and teachers will follow with both their agreements expiring on 30 June. The QNMU have shared their key areas of focus [https://substack.com/redirect/7a66f183-bad8-4d43-8677-83591fb4b38b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] including maintaining nation-leading wages and conditions; gender pay equity; addressing workforce shortages; a pipeline for nurse practitioners and support for NUMs and team leaders. Stay tuned for more on Queensland public sector negotiations over the coming months.

That's all I've got this week. A bit of a shorter report, but some big disputes underway. It's not lost on me that all of these workers - nurses; public transport workers; garbos; wharfies; and psychiatrists - are the "frontline" workers we heard about so often during the worst years of the pandemic. These workers really keep our society functioning, and are now fighting not just for a fair deal for themselves, but for better and safer services for all of us. Please keep this in mind if your train is late or your bin isn't collected!

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmXrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UVTBPREUwTURjMUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM016WTRPRFk1TnpFc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjMk9EUXlNamszTVN3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV01pT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhswDJWdFlXBHNjbjAudUdvSmVPSENPWxP0bXVmw1BjX1NkBG11YXFiaTBvN1hrWkR4REliVVVhTSIsInAiOjE1NDgxNDA3NSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzZmXzMsIm1hdCI6MTczNjg4Njk3MSwiZlhwIjoXNzMSNDc4OTcxLCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnR0cmVkaXJlY3QifQ.SJdRynH6wot0zFz5Lvqqx53wxWshb01Kx-QnQ1_tcXM?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-15-july>

AWU/AMWU/ETU - BHP

Union members at BHP Port Hedland will strike for 8 hours tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/b18f9a20-e58f-497d-9905-f0fd6235d29c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (16/7). Around 200 workers are expected to down tools from 2pm - 10pm [https://substack.com/redirect/a27263af-07c3-4eb3-a539-cc48d70c873e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which unions estimate will cost BHP \$40-50 million in lost revenue [https://substack.com/redirect/69e504c0-01e6-472c-bf37-d057e0743bd1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A 5 hour bargaining session [https://substack.com/redirect/f5337aff-ff23-4169-ad8b-4c540e018432?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with the FWC on Tuesday failed to reach any agreement. The next bargaining session is scheduled for 21 July. Unions are arguing that a fair agreement could be covered by 10 cents per tonne of iron ore shipped from the port [https://substack.com/redirect/d115a5ec-af99-4898-b587-aa12d6ec021e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The Chamber of Commerce and Industry [https://substack.com/redirect/f1141c49-2483-423a-8d69-b4aadcd615ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and Kerry Stoke's The West Australian [https://substack.com/redirect/8edb22d0-59c2-4ab0-ae2a-796c71630fbd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] have called on the Federal Government and the ALP more generally to intervene in the dispute and stop the strike from going ahead. The last significant multi-union strike at Port Hedland took place in 2000 [https://substack.com/redirect/999f99f0-dafd-4bce-b1b9-dd2658a9cce4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

The ballot for workers to vote on the in-principle agreement agreed by the ANMF SA Branch and the SA state government opens on Monday (20/7) [https://substack.com/redirect/2af65304-3ea6-476e-b95d-0db13f7a9a38?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and will close on 29 July. The ANMF has put out a video warning that a no vote could lead to a lengthy arbitration process [https://substack.com/redirect/353f06f0-fe4c-4f12-a399-281736e9c1ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A social media campaign "Vote No on SA Nurses and Midwives EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/2e48e198-6bce-4c19-bc9f-5ea157470960?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" is sharing aspects of the in-principle agreement that some members are unhappy about including ratios, a failure to count babies as patients in midwifery and reclassification issues. They have also critiqued behaviour of the ANMF Branch accusing the branch of silencing members during online meetings [https://substack.com/redirect/7042bd3c-79b9-4fdd-9b62-7bfe76ec14b1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and using union-busting language [https://substack.com/redirect/657b6cab-8ad8-4a06-8c6b-e566c963b6c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. As always, hard to gauge from my kitchen table! Always eager to hear from workers on the shop floor.

UFU Tasmania - Tassie Firies

UFU members in Tasmania commenced industrial action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/33f821cb-3987-475b-8e67-70229ba9652e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (10/7). Firies will undertake unannounced building evacuations, hydrant testing, and internal on-call work bans amongst other actions. The actions are expected to last at least 8 days. Actions have been devised to cause disruption, but not compromise community safety [https://substack.com/redirect/d41c1cc4-afba-4cba-9c04-e1f2c96c08cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The UFU has been in negotiations with the state government for 18 months. Key claims include [https://substack.com/redirect/12eed7ba-4227-450e-b181-ce6b44b2476a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] a wage increase of around \$16,000 to bring base wages in line with other state service employees and the introduction of minimum safe staffing levels.

ETU WA - UGL

ETU members at both Karratha Gas Plant (and Pluto) and Varanus Island have been taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/0786600b-033b-47f8-b191-bfac7d3b174e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of two separate EBA campaigns against UGL. Workers at the Karratha Gas Plant started industrial action on 20 May, and a third, subpar agreement put out by management will be voted on from 17-20 July. Meanwhile, workers at Santos' Varanus Island commenced industrial action last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/8a9a3c7e-0dd3-4c1a-99d9-4de9d1429ddc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (8/7) and were due to vote on a

subpar agreement put out by management from 17-20 July. However, the bosses advised a revised offer for Varanus Island would be forthcoming, so industrial action there was suspended from Monday afternoon [https://substack.com/redirect/d40fc798-a17a-4ca3-88d1-ab3a7887e635?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (13/7). Action at VI will resume on Thursday (16/7) if a suitable offer is not received. The ETU recommended a no vote on both agreements due to "UGL's continued lowballing shitfuckery". There have been reports that UGL has attempted to source scab workers [https://substack.com/redirect/e7aabee3-4911-4900-b01d-7ce331f32910?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] at both sites.

ASU SA - City of Port Adelaide Enfield

ASU members at the City of Port Adelaide Enfield have voted down the bosses' proposed agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/cde6c577-5621-46cd-9cfd-4d188c64219a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. This is the third agreement rejected by workers. On Thursday (9/7) ASU members participated in strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/10167037-20a7-4d13-a832-6e1b336883fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting to protect conditions, get fair wage increases and ensure job security [https://substack.com/redirect/6c3d4c9b-dad2-4d2e-8c4d-beea8bdfc6ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. One of the key concerns in the proposed agreement is a clause that allows unilateral redeployment of workers.

HACSU Victoria - Possibility

HACSU members at Possibility, a disability services provider, in Bendigo will walk off the job and rally at Premier Jacinta Allen's office tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/66c3d1b1-a566-4810-8d23-27ee7c49edf9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (16/7). In June, a proposed EBA at Possibility was rejected by 86% of HACSU [https://substack.com/redirect/558d1bdd-7edb-4e3e-a4ae-c21c5dc57261?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] members who participated in the ballot. If you're planning to be in Bendigo tomorrow, or have friends/family/comrades in the area, HACSU would welcome supporters to join the rally. The rally will meet at 12:30pm at Bendigo Trades Hall before rallying at the Premier's Bendigo office at 1:20pm.

AMWU - Acciona

AMWU members in Acciona's Mechanical and Electrical division have commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/e9bb8330-3712-48a0-a88f-2e732573cc78?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. According to an AMWU Victorian branch workers across the country "from the desalination plant in South Australia, to a barge in Western Australia and projects in Queensland" are involved. The AMWU has been negotiating with Acciona since September last year. Keen to hear more about this dispute if any readers have more information to share.

In short

CPSU Victoria - Ravenhall & Fulham prisons

Correctional Officers at Ravenhall and Fulham prisons participated in strike action yesterday (14/7). CPSU members at both facilities walked off the job from 6am - 11am and from 6pm - 10pm [https://substack.com/redirect/10f7194a-8cc4-4804-b199-ff18d237339f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Both prisons are operated by American multinational GEO Group. Workers are fighting for a wage increase of 18% over three years as well as an increase in paid parental leave from 2 weeks to 8 weeks.

ASU SA - Women's Legal Service SA

Last Tuesday (7/7), workers at the Women's Legal Service in SA held a one-hour stoppage. Industrial action commenced at the service in April as ASU members fight for their first EBA. Workers are fighting for fair pay and a decent EBA so they can continue to provide vital legal support.

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

School teachers in Victoria will strike again on 23 July. The AEU Victoria Joint Primary & Secondary Council met yesterday (14/7) and passed a resolution calling a 24 hour strike for Thursday 23 July [https://substack.com/redirect/bc20eb64-ff0c-4056-81e1-b23fb171194c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The AEU's negotiations with the state government resumed last week [https://substack.com/redirect/fb87255f-232b-49c8-8758-519ec31e4eb4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. AEU members in Victoria returned to classrooms after the school holidays on Monday (13/7) with work bans back in place [https://substack.com/redirect/4e2cd810-fbb7-4f70-91a3-d027c6c4aff2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

MEU NSW - Peabody

Peabody has locked out 19 workers [https://substack.com/redirect/d97a83a8-ad43-468f-847a-337591ca2575?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] at the Wambo Washery for another 14 days. 17 bargaining meetings have taken place [https://substack.com/redirect/62fa05d7-d517-47b6-b59b-9932dba4a1a9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to try and reach an agreement, but Peabody refuses to put a fair deal on the table. Workers remain united and committed to securing an

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlCG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZlwhaww_dG9rZW49ZXlKMmMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1qQTNNREV3TWpVMUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09EUXd0alE0T0RZC0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE5UWXdnRGc0Tml3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdpVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhsWDJwZFlxbHNjbjAua0xwUmVUDXg3UHk4Tk9uM2poWVFWV2R6V0VFZ19TWlZXVlEySld3XzJEVSIsInAiOjIwNzAxMDI1NSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzZmXzMsIm1hdCI6MTc4NDANDA2NDg4NiwiZXhwIjoyMDk5NjQwODg2L2Jpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.xOJ92JtLkgvIXt93YF90fAsC8raMBXgs2QA00kt-2C8?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-15-october>

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Nurses and midwives in SA will kick off industrial action on 30 October with a stop work rally [https://substack.com/redirect/eee1cd90-5de4-422d-a1f7-2aa596b3e6a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on the steps of Parliament House. ANMF members rejected the state government's offer [https://substack.com/redirect/fd4a125e-7be6-4bf7-b845-4660134ecfab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of a 13% pay increase over 4 years, and the government failed to provide an improved offer by the union's deadline of 17 September. ANMF members are asking supporters to sign a petition [https://substack.com/redirect/27713d27-9988-42b0-b086-438348aeb72a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] demanding respect and a fair deal from the state government.

AMWU Vic - Bucher Municipal

Last Thursday (9/10) workers at Bucher Municipal took industrial action for the second time. Workers are demanding improved working conditions and paths for reclassification and progression, but management is refusing to come to the negotiation table.

UPFU WA - WA firefighters

On 2 October, WA firefighters marched through the streets of Perth [https://substack.com/redirect/19c72779-b5ca-44c8-b3b6-0f8a96cc6bef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of their industrial campaign for a new EBA. Negotiations for the EBA have been underway since last October, with the union participating in over 20 bargaining meetings. Firies are fighting for an increase to their base rate as well as a comprehensive health and wellness program and other improvements to conditions. A key issue for firefighters is a large shortfall in firefighters, with the gaps being plugged with overtime. Improved wages and conditions would help with this shortfall.

AMWU SA - Aurizon

On Friday (10/10), workers at Aurizon walked off the job. Workers have voted down an unacceptable EBA that did not address cost of living pressures or working conditions. This has left workers with no option but to pursue industrial action to demonstrate to the bosses that they need a better deal.

UWU Vic - MSS

On 2 October security guards employed by MSS who work at Homes Victoria sites and public hospitals, rallied and marched in Melbourne [https://substack.com/redirect/cbbb0888-2f34-4757-9c7d-7a8d358d9ca2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] before delivering letters demanding action from the government. The security guards earn up to \$500 less per fortnight than other security guards, and have to deal with complex situations and increased levels of violence. Workers want decent wages and to be listened to about OHS issues. While guards are employed by MSS, they are working in the public system - it has just been contracted out by the government. Workers have asked supporters to sign their petitions - for guards at Homes Victoria a petition to Housing Minister Harriet Shing [https://substack.com/redirect/47b49398-ea65-4507-ae6e-9630ea635206?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and for guards in public hospitals a petition to Health Minister Mary-Anne Thomas [https://substack.com/redirect/60ae29a2-b688-4b0b-b364-f79ffe34a486?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU QLD - Re.Group

TWU members at Re.Group's Bli Bli facility struck for 24 hours on 3 October [https://substack.com/redirect/c384e58d-0306-43d3-bd76-516a777f62d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The workers who undertake the processing of yellow-lid bin recycling for over 400,000 homes on the Sunshine Coast have been fighting for a fair EBA deal for over 12 months, but Re.Group have been reluctant to engage in bargaining. Currently, workers are only receiving the minimum wage. Workers are fighting for 6% annual wage increases, but have only been offered a deal described by workers as "insulting". [https://substack.com/redirect/32608a23-8747-4f44-bf37-9cd799a25a37?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] Workers are being paid between 14-22% less than similar workers based in Noosa.

UFU Vic - Victorian firefighters

The UFU's long campaign for a new EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/74609ebf-a0bc-4a05-911b-926e08918c2c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] continues. On 5/10, UFU members in Melbourne rallied [https://substack.com/redirect/70746679-4aca-4b96-9b4e-52cd7ddfb89e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] outside the new Town Hall station in the CBD, hoping to welcome Premier Jacinta Allan to her press conference with a line up firies holding confutes demanding a fair deal. Rather than facing workers, Allan snuck in through a side door. UFU members have also been mobilising to speak directly to the community [https://substack.com/redirect/a315f4f0-e87f-4594-badb-fe21bc36050a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] about their concerns about aging fire trucks, cuts to budgets and growing risks to public safety.

MEU - Glencore

MEU members have been locked out of the Ulan Underground Mine [[https://substack.com/redirect/926a2980-13fd-4567-9b83-296f1e71b7ce?](https://substack.com/redirect/926a2980-13fd-4567-9b83-296f1e71b7ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] since 3 October. The original 7 day lockout was extended for another 7 days following the union lodging an intractable bargaining application with the Fair Work Commission. Negotiations between Glencore and the MEU have been underway for over a year, and workers have been participating in industrial action since June, including one 24 hour strike [[https://substack.com/redirect/7ba8f947-9267-4582-9d15-9837e790d925?](https://substack.com/redirect/7ba8f947-9267-4582-9d15-9837e790d925?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The MEU will be in the FWC on Thursday [[https://substack.com/redirect/6c4db327-e553-42a9-9521-322d828118ce?](https://substack.com/redirect/6c4db327-e553-42a9-9521-322d828118ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (16/10) in the first step of their intractable bargaining application. Workers are fighting for the same base pay rates as workers at the Ulan West mine, also owned by Glencore.

AEU Victoria - Early childhood educators

AEU members at Victorian kindergartens have escalated their industrial campaign for a new EBA. As Term 4 commenced last week, early childhood educators will not prepare, write or distribute transition to school statements for students starting primary school next year [

[https://substack.com/redirect/bd20fbc7-d19b-4cf2-a78e-592374fc21d6?](https://substack.com/redirect/bd20fbc7-d19b-4cf2-a78e-592374fc21d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The statements are sent to prep teachers to provide an overview of students' abilities. Early childhood educators have explained the preparation of the reports take up to four times as long as the time they are paid to develop the statements, resulting in hours of unpaid work. Early childhood educators have also implemented a ban on overtime. These new bans follow a 24 hour strike in September. Workers are fighting for a 35% wage increase.

PSA SA - Public Sector Workers

PSA members will rally at Parliament House today [[https://substack.com/redirect/ee1fcbe5-daf5-4c22-9523-f6ee4eaea860?](https://substack.com/redirect/ee1fcbe5-daf5-4c22-9523-f6ee4eaea860?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (15/10) as part of their public sector EB25 campaign for salaried workers. The EA covers close to 40,000 workers including administrative services officers, the Country Fire Service, Country Arts Trust, dental officers, grant funded scientists, interpreters, legal officers, medical scientists, correctional officers, professional officers and technical services officers. Workers have rejected the state government's offer and are now stepping up in their campaign. A stop work action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/bbc7f6b5-cf04-4142-bf53-c7ae5196b603?](https://substack.com/redirect/bbc7f6b5-cf04-4142-bf53-c7ae5196b603?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] was held in Port Augusta last Thursday (9/10) and today public servants in Adelaide will hold a stop work meeting on the steps of Parliament House at 12:30pm [[https://substack.com/redirect/ee42fe61-8f7f-4204-9565-82c65d772d17?](https://substack.com/redirect/ee42fe61-8f7f-4204-9565-82c65d772d17?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Get along and support them if you're in town!

AEU/CPSU/HACSU Tas - Public sector

In September, the Tasmanian government made a "first and final wages offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/88d2d6b4-6ad9-4777-b17b-0aa538c4c3ae?](https://substack.com/redirect/88d2d6b4-6ad9-4777-b17b-0aa538c4c3ae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" to unions in relation to 16 state sector agreements with expiry dates between 30 December 2025 and 28 February 2027. The offer was a one-year rollover offer with a 3% salary increase and maintaining all other agreement terms and conditions. I haven't been able to easily locate responses from each union involved, but at the very least members of the CPSU [[https://substack.com/redirect/abf56bb8-907e-4088-9037-fca9ecd77a31?](https://substack.com/redirect/abf56bb8-907e-4088-9037-fca9ecd77a31?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], AEU [

[https://substack.com/redirect/23817487-1aa7-41b4-8936-10e508ebbb1b?](https://substack.com/redirect/23817487-1aa7-41b4-8936-10e508ebbb1b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and HACSU [

[https://substack.com/redirect/36c32293-9861-4fd5-b95c-778fda7b771b?](https://substack.com/redirect/36c32293-9861-4fd5-b95c-778fda7b771b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] have rejected the offer. Stay tuned to see if any industrial action occurs as a result.

TWU NT - CDC

Bus drivers in the Northern Territory are planning to strike for 24 hours on Monday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/67d878a4-ebcf-497d-b692-148293f9ac05?](https://substack.com/redirect/67d878a4-ebcf-497d-b692-148293f9ac05?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (20/10). This follows weeks of low level industrial action including wearing union hi-vis vests and displaying posters on buses. The TWU has been in negotiations for months for a new EBA for drivers. Bus drivers are seeking improved wages and conditions, including increased penalty rates, as well as improvements in safety [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a11e8a1a-2f25-481e-acf1-b3fd81820dcf?](https://substack.com/redirect/a11e8a1a-2f25-481e-acf1-b3fd81820dcf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Union members will ensure school and special needs runs continue during the strike.

ETU/MUA WA - CBH

On 8/10, CBH once again locked out workers at the Kwinana Grain Terminal [https://substack.com/redirect/6576269f-a64f-4d41-b10b-49ef90882d9c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Unions and CBH did not come to an agreement during the “cooling off period”, in fact management put forward a substandard offer which was deemed both “unfair and unworkable” [https://substack.com/redirect/6189431d-f5fa-44b5-be29-25f9c99c6381?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and was rejected by all but 3 workers. Despite no industrial action having taken place over the last 5 weeks, CBH reinstituted the lockout as soon as possible, as well as bringing in scab labour. The MUA has called for support from their Japanese comrades at Zenkoku-Kowan who have issued a letter of support [https://substack.com/redirect/501aacf0-e694-4c1c-a390-c25685d55ed6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] highlighting that “Most concerning is the news that scab labour is being used on or in connection with the Ken Ann, and will be sailing to Hakata, Japan.” Japan is one of Australia’s most important grain markets, so the potential of delays to grain export at both ends of the shipping route will not be welcome news.

HWU Vic - Public sector health workers

The HWU has announced that 98% of their membership in public health have voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/01439c5a-b1cd-4913-964a-5c318af214af?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], with 93% voting in favour of strike action. I believe this will be the first industrial action undertaken by members since the branch was put into administration.

MEU NSW - Bloomfield

MEU members at Bloomfield’s Rix’s Creek mine have been undertaking industrial action since late September [https://substack.com/redirect/bddf4bba-e53b-40ff-becc-81015593cff3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The action includes both work bans and stoppages. Bloomfield’s offer of a 16.75% wage increase was rejected by workers. Workers are committed to their programme of industrial action until they are successful in winning a fair deal, including improvements to accident pay.

VAHPA/HACSU Vic Merger

Last Tuesday (7/10), VAHPA and HACSU - two Victorian branches of the HSU - announced on social media [https://substack.com/redirect/529a7c78-8897-4fdf-a39b-f61e069dc5d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] that their Committees of Management had “voted in favour of a Memorandum of Understanding to unite.” The week before, rank and file newsletter VAHPA Pulse had reported that they had received credible information informing them about the plan for an amalgamation [https://substack.com/redirect/6306cf34-2f24-4eee-a859-371a27de8d51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. I have heard that a merger was openly talked about within union offices over the last couple of years, viewed as a done deal. And yet, I have also heard from union members that are frustrated and disappointed with the lack of consultation about a major decision for their union. I emailed through a few questions to VAHPA asking for comment on the lack of consultation, and whether there was any plan for consultation or a vote going forward - but did not hear back from them by deadline. Amalgamations have been a regular occurrence in the union movement in Australia, reaching all the way back to the formation of the Amalgamated Shearers Union of Australasia [https://substack.com/redirect/661f3c46-bc27-461f-aab1-750be19237cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in 1887, but the lack of consultation and communication with members - at least from what has been reported to me - seems odd. Interested to hear from more VAHPA and HACSU members on this issue!

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU Vic - John Holland

Last Wednesday (8/10), workers on the West Gate Tunnel and Metro Tunnel in Melbourne, both John Holland projects in Victoria, stopped work over safety concerns [https://substack.com/redirect/7cf3f840-64b1-48d3-8591-768147e35da8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. While workers did not go home, they did sit in the sheds [https://substack.com/redirect/338ed8a4-387a-4072-b00a-d0aba2a62160?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] while the concerns were addressed.

At the West Gate Tunnel the major concern was inadequate emergency response procedures and on the Metro Tunnel, concerns over air quality. The additional focus on safety on John Holland sites in Melbourne may be related to John Holland signing an agreement with the AWU on the massive Torrens to Darlington tunnel project in SA. Valued at \$15 billion it will be the largest infrastructure project in the state’s history. According to the AFR the CFMEU is “challenging John Holland’s proposed project deal in the Fair Work Commission” [https://substack.com/redirect/d5e88bab-6f7a-4933-8e0f-bbe6c2d31ee3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

NTEU NSW - University of Newcastle

NTEU members at the University of Newcastle are set to strike for 3 hours on the afternoon of 23 October [https://substack.com/redirect/8baf653c-282f-4eff-8668-67c6c79fa03a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers are striking in response to “University management’s continued refusal to consider almost every claim their bargaining team has put forward.” More broadly, workers are fiercely opposed to management’s proposal to cut a dozen

courses and 140 jobs. The fight is both for secure jobs, safe workloads and decent working conditions, but also to preserve the educational offerings of the university.

AWU Vic - Forest firefighters

Forest firefighters in Victoria have recommenced industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/4aa2bfd5-d1b3-41b3-9466-e2d61d0938ee?](https://substack.com/redirect/4aa2bfd5-d1b3-41b3-9466-e2d61d0938ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4aa2bfd5-d1b3-41b3-9466-e2d61d0938ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. In May, following months of negotiations and work bans, AWU forest fighters reached an agreement with DEECA for pay equalisation with Park Victoria, backpay and 3% annual increases. At that point workers paused industrial action. After 3 months of waiting, DEECA returned to the negotiating table in August, only now backpay was removed from the deal and 3% annual increases were slashed to 1.5% every 6 months. Workers have rejected this and resumed industrial action. In addition to reinstating work bans, workers are applying for further industrial action and planning a rally for late October. Stay tuned.

ASMOF NSW - Psychiatrists

The NSW IRC has decided that public sector psychiatrists should receive a 20% pay increase. The 20% increase will be paid as an Attraction and Retention Allowance [

[https://substack.com/redirect/07e1ed6f-2c2c-48d6-8e5c-13d82df282fb?](https://substack.com/redirect/07e1ed6f-2c2c-48d6-8e5c-13d82df282fb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/07e1ed6f-2c2c-48d6-8e5c-13d82df282fb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] in a bid to address vacancy rates and retention and will be paid for 12 months [[https://substack.com/redirect/d145918f-0836-4e95-9007-48682a0af81e?](https://substack.com/redirect/d145918f-0836-4e95-9007-48682a0af81e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d145918f-0836-4e95-9007-48682a0af81e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Justice David Chin referred to the payment as a “discrete stop-gap measure” [[https://substack.com/redirect/a57a9712-8052-4f6c-9f71-49ad264e01fa?](https://substack.com/redirect/a57a9712-8052-4f6c-9f71-49ad264e01fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a57a9712-8052-4f6c-9f71-49ad264e01fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The Increase includes the 10% abnormal duties allowance that has been paid since 3 February, and the total increase would be “absorbed into any subsequent salary increases determined by the commission” [[https://substack.com/redirect/a57a9712-8052-4f6c-9f71-49ad264e01fa?](https://substack.com/redirect/a57a9712-8052-4f6c-9f71-49ad264e01fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a57a9712-8052-4f6c-9f71-49ad264e01fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

Psychiatrists and doctors in NSW’s public health system remained concerned [[https://substack.com/redirect/3777bfe2-6bd1-4cc7-8e41-8cffd4f05f02?](https://substack.com/redirect/3777bfe2-6bd1-4cc7-8e41-8cffd4f05f02?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3777bfe2-6bd1-4cc7-8e41-8cffd4f05f02?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] about both their working conditions, and conditions for patients. ASMOF remains committed to getting a better outcome for psychiatrists and all doctors in NSW.

ETU NSW - Schindler

Workers at Schindler in the greater Sydney area have returned to work following 5 weeks of indefinite stoppages [[https://substack.com/redirect/08f2b3f5-c539-457a-bee8-961dee2b77cb?](https://substack.com/redirect/08f2b3f5-c539-457a-bee8-961dee2b77cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/08f2b3f5-c539-457a-bee8-961dee2b77cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The ETU is still pursuing Schindler to agree to some allowances, but through industrial action has forced the bosses to agree to many of the workers’ claims. To understand the effect of 5 weeks on the grass, the ETU is aware of 700 escalators and lifts that were out of service across Sydney by the time workers resumed work. Nothing runs without workers!

That’s all I’ve got this week. But before I leave you, two quick notices. Today marks 55 years since the West Gate Bridge collapsed killing 35 workers - the worst industrial incident in Australia’s history. For Melburnians, if you’re reading this first thing on Wednesday morning, consider heading down to the annual memorial service at 11:30am [[https://substack.com/redirect/2e278623-f318-43f1-a5dc-8b4d74ccf502?](https://substack.com/redirect/2e278623-f318-43f1-a5dc-8b4d74ccf502?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2e278623-f318-43f1-a5dc-8b4d74ccf502?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] under the bridge on Douglas Parade, Spotswood. For Brisbanites, the MUA and Queensland Unions are holding a “Welcome Home Hamish” [[https://substack.com/redirect/2052bb31-ea4e-4aea-95b6-a91cbe575cb0?](https://substack.com/redirect/2052bb31-ea4e-4aea-95b6-a91cbe575cb0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2052bb31-ea4e-4aea-95b6-a91cbe575cb0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] night on Friday (17/10) which will act as a fundraiser for APHEDA. Hamish is of course MUA member Hamish Paterson who joined the Global Sumud Flotilla to Gaza. The night will kick off at 5:30pm at the William Galloway Auditorium in South Brisbane. \$20 waged/\$10 unwaged with all profits to APHEDA to continue their work in the Gaza strip [[https://substack.com/redirect/06d204b9-db35-4c5f-9e4a-2511b6108792?](https://substack.com/redirect/06d204b9-db35-4c5f-9e4a-2511b6108792?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/06d204b9-db35-4c5f-9e4a-2511b6108792?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. There’s one line that comes to mind - mourn the dead, fight like hell for the living.

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

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View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-16-april>

ASMOF NSW - Public sector doctors

ASMOF went ahead with 3 days of strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/532068d8-e320-4bdf-a0c8-78247dd81947?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (staffing to public holiday levels) last week (8-10 April) in contravention of IRC orders. The action was not without incident with reports of hospital security guards harassing staff wearing or displaying campaign material [https://substack.com/redirect/ec9811f7-d7ac-4a74-b41a-88ff3a26e0fd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and the NSW government having to walk back claims [https://substack.com/redirect/76c86917-a2ee-410f-8f26-0183ce92a36f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] that hundreds of cancer patients had chemotherapy appointments cancelled. According to the SMH, in negotiations last Monday (7/4) the government offered to negotiate a separate deal for junior doctors with an acknowledgement that their pay did not match their skills and level of education. ASMOF rejected this offer. ASMOF did offer to call off the strike for an interim 10% wage increase backdated to June, but this was not taken up by the government. The dispute is still ongoing [https://substack.com/redirect/70aa9f89-1ded-4dd5-b184-32d5bb12ac71?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

HACSU Tasmania - St Mary's Community Health Centre

Workers at St Mary's Community Health Centre have been undertaking industrial action for 3 weeks [https://substack.com/redirect/5d6d4c2b-02f0-4796-a535-0b872b046b19?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. On Friday (11/4), workers ramped up their campaign by walking off the job for one hour [https://substack.com/redirect/a10a085f-b8f8-457a-8cba-4a195cf3b08a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a fair deal and sustainable working conditions. HACSU members are demanding action on unsafe workloads and chronic understaffing.

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TWU QLD - Cleanaway Noosa

Industrial action continues at Cleanaway Noosa with strike action affecting bin services. Due to ongoing safety concerns, TWU organisers have been conducting inspections and found roadworthy defects on almost all vehicles along with other safety issues. Cleanaway refuse to put forward a decent pay offer. Time for Cleanaway to clean up their act on wages and safety.

AMWU NSW & RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Another Keolis Downer bus dispute, this time in the Northern Beaches. Maintenance workers at the Brookvale and Mona Vale depots held two 3 hour stoppages on Friday (11/4) [https://substack.com/redirect/a8ea4aa6-228b-45a3-b8f8-957a7d0aa02d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. These workers are earning up to 17% less than other bus maintenance workers in the state and are fighting for pay parity [https://substack.com/redirect/88806b00-2a23-418b-801b-461f535434ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The bus drivers at Keolis Downer in Newcastle have entered their third week of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/d18df28c-ea09-4e69-a3f1-a12776fb53f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], still refusing to turn on Opal card readers and participating in uniform bans. They too are seeking a decent pay deal and reasonable working conditions.

UFU Vic - Fire Rescue Victoria

Corporate, technical and administrative workers at Fire Rescue Victoria commenced rolling stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/bda96546-4dd2-4e6a-af9f-ed528cef867d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on Thursday (10/4) and Friday (11/4), with all workers stopping for the last two hours of their shift from Monday to Thursday this week. In addition to these stoppages workers are putting banners and chalking messages on FRV vehicles [https://substack.com/redirect/39dc6290-5750-4fce-a940-97eb5bca504b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a fair deal - they haven't had a pay rise for 5 years. UFU members in the FRV Corporate division have also declared they have no confidence [https://substack.com/redirect/a582bf98-2666-4915-9f12-e453e03e578b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] in FRV Commissioner Gavin Freeman, or Acting Deputy Secretary of Corporate Services, Tony Matthews.

MUA - Qube

Workers at Qube ports around the country have endorsed new agreements [https://substack.com/redirect/90af4525-a201-418f-849d-0d6e77424c9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], with some workplaces reported voting the agreement up unanimously [https://substack.com/redirect/6b3bdeb6-30b2-4719-a21e-089f433de3bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The new agreements include 5.5% annual wage increases over 4 years; 1% above the legislated minimum superannuation

guarantee; shifts allocated at 2pm instead of 4pm; 10 hour breaks between shifts; and other improvements to rostering, planned time off and public holiday arrangements. MUA members at Qube participated in a range of stoppages, bans and restrictions over December 2024/January 2025. The MUA reports that despite the endorsement of the agreement and the MUA offering a “peace deal”, Qube is still attempting to sue 20 wharfies and MUA officials; and the union is consequently suing Qube company director.

NSWNMA - Ramsay Health Care

NSWNMA members at Ramsay Health Care have voted in favour of a proposed agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/fc52c6d9-25db-471c-98ff-2f0632cba68d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Ramsay operates 39 facilities, including many hospitals, across NSW. Workers had voted down 3 previous agreements. This agreement includes a 16% pay rise over 3 years, with 9.5% paid in the next 12 months and back pay from July 2023. In addition to the wage increase, the NSWNMA shared that the agreement includes reduced patient loads for nurses in-charge; restrictions on non-clinical duties; increased paid parental leave; increased penalty rates for casuals and improved rights and paid leave for branch officials. NSWNMA members participated in over 250 days of industrial action in their campaign for an improved agreement.

AUWU - Work for the Dole

On Monday (14/4), Australian Unemployed Workers’ Union members and supporters gathered outside the Department of Employment and Workplace Relations to call for the abolition of work for the dole and mutual obligations. 14 April is the anniversary of the death of Josh Park Fing [https://substack.com/redirect/948057d6-09e1-4e40-bfaf-4ab11a75e653?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], a teenager who was killed whilst working on a Work for the Dole site in Toowoomba [https://substack.com/redirect/d973b64f-f904-4dc1-8769-3bca9cf4789b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in 2016. Work for the Dole participants do not have the same rights as other workers with plenty of stories of unsafe work practices [https://substack.com/redirect/f4414180-b6fa-4a24-b166-4db318287163?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and bosses unreceptive to workers’ concerns. There is also little evidence that work for the dole actually fulfills its stated objective of building skills to help find secure work [https://substack.com/redirect/0ef03434-ad2d-47d4-8ad5-75cb4ebf7160?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CFMEU Manufacturing Division Deamalgamation Ballot

The CFMEU Manufacturing Division has been successful in its ballot to leave the CFMEU [https://substack.com/redirect/44556ebc-bdd5-4f33-adba-af957a0a0369?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The breakdown of votes was 3,553 voting yes to leave the CFMEU and 324 voting no. 9,262 members were eligible to vote in the ballot, which by my calculations means only 42% of eligible voters participated. A few observations on this: First, in January, Michael O’Connor was quoted as saying “the overwhelming majority of our members want nothing to do with the toxic culture of the construction division of the CFMEU and we expect the yes vote to be carried with a big majority.” [https://substack.com/redirect/30b2e270-fb10-403a-a051-95cedb836285?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] 42% is hardly an overwhelming majority, which does pose the question, was leaving the CFMEU a widely, deeply felt issue amongst the rank and file? Or simply a bureaucratic, ego-driven shitfight between officials? Second, the desire for “independence [https://substack.com/redirect/ac7f1f79-c5a5-46dc-bcdc-cc07c017311d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” was one of the major arguments from the Manufacturing Division, yet it is understood that the Division has already been shopping around for prospective merger partners. Are the rank and file being kept abreast of these discussions? Third, with only 9,262 members eligible to vote, that means the financial membership of the union is around that figure. A union that small will struggle to survive these days, thus the need for a new merger. 9,262 is slightly less than the 10,000 members the Manufacturing Division claims on its website. But a 2021 article in The Age refers to a TCFUA official and her “15,000 member union [https://substack.com/redirect/3e5fe6d5-5e68-4157-b9cf-18814d1a9458?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” that merged into the CFMEU in 2018. I assume this is a mistake by the journalist, and that he meant the total CFMEU Manufacturing Division plus TCFUA at the time of the merger was 15,000 (the TCFUA’s 2018 annual return [https://substack.com/redirect/724f0cf3-0bb8-4cb3-94c7-5d8db4ac26fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] lists 3,014 members). If the figure of 15,000 members is correct, then the CFMEU Manufacturing Division has lost over 5,000 members (about a third!) in 7 years. Of course, many unions have lost members over this time, but a third is a significant chunk. Will membership numbers continue to decline? How small can a union be these days? The “super unions [https://substack.com/redirect/17ba953e-1cd7-48c8-ba0b-b1461cfb811a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” created through amalgamations in the 80s and 90s were meant to build more powerful and effective unions, and minimise demarcation disputes. I doubt the officials who negotiated the merger of FEDFA, UMFA, ATAIU, OPPWF and the BWIU ever foresaw it ending like this. The new union will be called the Timber, Furnishing and Textiles

Union (TFTU).

International Workers Memorial Day

28 April is International Workers Memorial Day - a day to remember workers killed, disabled, injured or made unwell by their work. Get along to a public event if you can. If not, it's a great day to have a union meeting and talk about safety issues at your own workplace or even kick off the process of electing an HSR.

Canberra: 9am, National Workers Memorial, Parkes [https://substack.com/redirect/e049274c-1e98-49a5-97be-7baa0a44281e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Sydney: 12 noon, Reflection Park, Darling Harbour [https://substack.com/redirect/3c5131df-8811-4124-a26b-c65e88b469e6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Brisbane: 10am, Emma Miller Place, 109 Roma St, Brisbane [https://substack.com/redirect/871ea843-72fb-460e-8f01-452de4ec948c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Gold Coast: 11am, Pratten Park, Old Burleigh Road, Broadbeach [https://substack.com/redirect/871ea843-72fb-460e-8f01-452de4ec948c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Townsville: 6pm, Perfume Gardens, Townsville City [https://substack.com/redirect/04dea4d8-9438-4107-8247-fede6756bceb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Adelaide: 9:30am, Tarntanyangga/Victoria Square [https://substack.com/redirect/44b1f110-2ee8-4f15-8409-d77068508e51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Adelaide: 10:00am, Memorial Service, Pilgrim Uniting Church, 12 Flinders St [https://substack.com/redirect/44b1f110-2ee8-4f15-8409-d77068508e51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Adelaide: 1:00pm, Workers' Memorial Service, Deceased Worker' Forest, Cnr Park Terrace & Port Road [https://substack.com/redirect/44b1f110-2ee8-4f15-8409-d77068508e51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Launceston: 8am, Workers Commemorative Park, Elizabeth Gardens, Invermay [https://substack.com/redirect/db8c0180-5fe4-4703-bcd4-1b4a5205825e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Melbourne: 10:30am, Argyle Square, Lygon Street, Carlton [https://substack.com/redirect/6d6f53b0-ffd5-4b5d-8a35-a504dcda46d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Perth: 10am, Solidarity Park, Harvest Terrace, West Perth [https://substack.com/redirect/901242bc-57d5-4b47-8599-706cc6a7bcf4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Mourn the dead, fight like hell for the living.

That's all I've got this week. I'm going to try and collate a list of May Day events to share next week, so if there's something happening for May Day in your neck of the woods - send me a message!

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades and subscribe.

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MEU - Glencore

Last Wednesday (9/7) miners at Glencore's Ulan Underground mine started a 24 hour strike [https://substack.com/redirect/a40fc332-3897-4c0c-959a-a5a822beaa52?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. EBA negotiations with the multi-national have been underway for over a year, and still no agreement has been reached. Workers are fighting for the same base pay rates as workers at the Ulan West mine, also owned by Glencore. The mines are part of the same Ulan Coal Complex and according to a quick google, appear to be a 3 minute drive from each other. The pay disparity hasn't been publicly released, but industry experts estimate the wage gap is between 15-18% [https://substack.com/redirect/7653262b-14e3-4069-94f6-d3933e203ddb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers rejected Glencore's "final" offer in February. Time for Glencore to return to negotiations with a fair offer.

AMWU NSW - Komatsu

Workers at Komatsu in Rutherford held a 1-hour stoppage on Thursday (10/7). Komatsu offered Rutherford workers less than their colleagues at Moss Vale and Rockhampton. AMWU members rejected this offer, and took industrial action to push Komatsu to make a decent offer. Stay tuned for updates.

MEAA/CPSU - ABC

MEAA members have rejected an offer from the ABC [https://substack.com/redirect/7164492b-6136-4599-836e-301559bdc8b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which would give them a 3% pay increase from the first pay period after the expiry of the current agreement. The catch? The pay increase would be "contingent" on both the CPSU & MEAA agreeing to not take industrial action for 12 months from the expiry of the current EBA. Essentially, the ABC asked workers to jump in the ring with both arms tied behind their backs. ABC journalist and MEAA media section President Michael Slezak says workers at the ABC want action on insecure contracts; career progression and sustainability and to end racism in the workplace. The last agreement won workers an 11% pay increase over 3 years and a \$1500 sign on bonus.

QNMU - Virtus Health

Nurses at Queensland Fertility Group will escalate their industrial action to Stage 2 actions today. QNMU members at 6 clinics run by Virtus Health will walk off the job at 2pm today for a 4-hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/654b417c-9c21-416b-b752-70c9e34e21c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Nurses voted down a proposed agreement and started Stage 1 industrial action in June. The QNMU has been negotiating with Virtus Health for 10 months, but the company refuses to come to the table with a fair pay deal. Queensland Fertility Group nurses earn less than their interstate colleagues, and their wages have not kept up with the cost of living. Nurses are asking patients and supporters to sign a petition [https://substack.com/redirect/b3dc21b7-e261-4b5a-a8ea-7c8623cdb9d5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in support of their fight for a fair deal.

MEU - Peabody

The lockout at Metropolitan Mine is over, but the dispute continues [https://substack.com/redirect/6ca20102-dfe3-420c-afc2-b4b53ff7a244?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The lockout ended as planned last Wednesday (9/7) but a 5-hour strike on the evening shift turned into a 12 hour strike [https://substack.com/redirect/0e646736-7779-419b-a4f1-c5d370938291?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers who were scheduled for 12 hour shifts on Thursday (10/7) also went on strike. The strike was then extended again suspending production until 5:30pm on Friday (11/7) [https://substack.com/redirect/328b2012-37b2-47a5-934f-88e26a676dd8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. I haven't heard any updates on the situation this week. The MEU has participated in 3 mediation sessions at the FWC but no agreement has been reached. In addition to a fair pay rise, workers are also fighting to defend a job security clause which prevents permanent jobs being replaced by labour hire.

AWU Vic - Bestbar

Workers at Bestbar, a concrete steel reinforcement supplier, have taken industrial action for the first time in 20 years. The AWU have been in negotiations for 6 months, but the best offer yet has been 8.5%, and workers want 10%.

AMWU/ETU - Qantas

It has been reported that engineers at Qantas are set to step up industrial action again. Engineers took industrial action on numerous occasions last year, including a 24 hour strike in December [https://substack.com/redirect/15f24e24-6700-45af-b257-7f3493217e61?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. There hasn't been much news on this dispute for months, but according to HR Leader, Qantas has withdrawn its pay offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/51c549d4-0565-4660-aaec-e5cba1e9c078?](https://substack.com/redirect/51c549d4-0565-4660-aaec-e5cba1e9c078?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/51c549d4-0565-4660-aaec-e5cba1e9c078?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] prompting the Qantas Engineers Alliance to escalate their industrial campaign.

TWU WA - Ventia

On Friday (11/7), court security and custodial officers [https://substack.com/redirect/57b27cb8-0cde-4879-ab82-9c57c34a3aeb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] walked off the job for 8 hours. This is the 4th strike by WA's court security and custodial officers employed by Ventia with their first action taking place in November 2024. The TWU has now accused Ventia of backflipping on key safety agreements and "dishonouring" previously agreed items. TWU members are fighting for pay parity with their counterparts employed by G4S. Despite doing the same work, workers at Ventia earn about 24% less than G4S employees. In addition to decent wages, workers are fighting for safe staffing levels and rosters.

CFMEU QLD

On Thursday (10/7), the CFMEU Administrator Mark Irving released Geoffrey Watson's report on "Violence in the Queensland CFMEU [https://substack.com/redirect/ab3d01b5-7357-4443-8d95-4ea6d5708a22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" as well as Irving's response [https://substack.com/redirect/42699a68-2a1f-4d11-9e6b-6bb9a8a78c1c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to the report. On Sunday (13/7), Queensland Premier, David Crisafulli announced [https://substack.com/redirect/058071f5-dc62-4ab5-a18d-ef55217168e0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that his state government will launch a Commission of Inquiry [https://substack.com/redirect/61e41d24-572f-41f6-8fc0-6925eab447e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] into the CFMEU Queensland branch. Watson's report is a mix of concerning allegations about violence and sexism, and a terrible re-hashing of ABCC talking points about the CFMEU's "attitude to industrial prosecutions". Watson marvels that "many large trade unions had not been prosecuted for a single breach" while 213 cases had been brought against the CFMEU. Watson claims that the reason the union broke industrial laws was in order to maintain an "outlaw reputation". It seems likely that Crisafulli and his government will latch upon these elements of the report, and muddy them with the allegations of violence, in order to demand a return to the ABCC and to push down wages and conditions. The first recommendation from Watson's report is that any CFMEU member who is prosecuted for a breach of industrial laws must justify "why they should not be disciplined for their unlawful conduct." Discipline, according to Watson, can include getting sacked and losing your union membership. It is clear that for all the salacious allegations in the nearly 12 month long administration of the CFMEU, at the core of it all is the desire from the state, the courts and sadly most corners of the labour movement to de-fang the CFMEU. As Watson records in his report "One politician asked a very good question - "the CFMEU is so aggressive, but the AWU is not. Both are building unions - why the difference?"". The short answer is that the CFMEU has been prepared to break industrial laws and push back against bosses for a better and safer deal for workers, and the AWU hasn't.

CPSU Vic & PSA SA

The early reports I shared last week were correct. The rank and file "A Voice For Members" ticket was successful winning a clean sweep of all 5 executive positions and 23 out of 34 branch council positions [https://substack.com/redirect/ec4a9b37-4957-4bbe-a8f7-cd3b61fc55d3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

A Voice For Members have their work cut out for them with responding to the Silver Review into the public service and opposing job cuts in an uncertain economic climate in Victoria. A Voice For Members' ambitious policy platform [https://substack.com/redirect/9a5d6ce7-f915-458b-9786-93b7e15f5f40?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] includes an aim to increase membership by 25% by 2028; organisers in major regional centres; open member meetings with the secretary and assistant secretary; pegging Executive wages to to the VPS 6.2 level (\$162k) as well as term limits for Executives (3 terms/12 years). This is a hell of a shake up to the status quo. The PSA in South Australia is also in the midst of a contested election. Can PSA Change [https://substack.com/redirect/acc2c069-f255-4411-8641-2f8838a7f917?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] replicate A Voice For Members results? We should find out later today or tomorrow.

One final thing from me this week: a recommendation (or perhaps insistence) to read Shane Reside's wonderful piece in Overland [https://substack.com/redirect/67712f6a-6416-43bd-a3b0-b0a9bc68a12f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] about the Painters and Dockers on Garden Island in Sydney winning their first collective agreement. The Painters and Dockers are back, they're (mostly) Filipinos, and they're fucking killing it [https://substack.com/redirect/01d95830-25e1-45c8-b404-50490ccc2996?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] tells the story of the successful campaign that won workers a 10.5% pay increase, improved conditions, domestic violence solidarity leave and a possible "Australian-first in migrant working-class struggle". I'm not going to spoil the story any further - because it is a wonderful one and I know it will give anyone reading this a boost as it did me. Read it now!

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UWTRNemM1TVRrNUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05USTJNVFV6TXprc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE5ERTFNVE16T1N3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT21Ka2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAudFo1SmNHb2lLWWEzeVByV3l1QzZ1a0ZfNTNiUHN5YktncVphM3FYbkxrYyIsInAiOjE2ODM3OTE5OSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc1MjYxNTMzOSwiZXhwIjoyMDY4MTkxMzM5LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.-MeuowY2B4Nsh1omaGa9TlK17K0J2-UGs1KVb3yacCE?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-16-september>

AMOU/MUA Tasmania - TasPorts

AMOU and MUA members at TasPorts commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/ca6bec4a-f116-44c5-a69f-6782207e9dc6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at 6am on Saturday (12/9). Workers participated in a 4 hour stoppage on Saturday morning [https://substack.com/redirect/6ca8d68a-8396-4f1d-ade8-45ccb20ccf1c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (12/9) and a range of ongoing work bans are in place. Workers are fighting for a fair wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/9d397bc9-7b9f-448e-b431-10c9d26a2283?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; pay rates comparable with equivalent workers interstate; and an increase in superannuation contributions from 12.5% to 15%. Workers were originally poised to take action in early August, but it ended up being suspended.

NTEU Qld - QUT

NTEU members at the Queensland University of Technology have commenced industrial action this week [https://substack.com/redirect/7048a4e7-e286-4747-b5d7-8d9ec70d71b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers will stop work for two hours today (16/9) from 11:30am - 1:30pm. In addition to that stoppage a number of work bans have been implemented including a ban on meeting with supervisors, managers and Deans; periodic bans on using Outlook, Canvas and Salesforce; wearing NTEU merchandise and interrupting work to make statements about taking protected industrial action. The NTEU began negotiations with QUT in December 2025 [https://substack.com/redirect/8b540edf-dfec-48fc-89fe-b101dcb98418?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and the university is yet to make a counter offer on pay and no agreement has been made on fixing workloads or improving change management provisions. The QUT has also applied to the FWC [https://substack.com/redirect/8b540edf-dfec-48fc-89fe-b101dcb98418?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to have them mediate the negotiations, rather than working with the union directly. Workers are fighting for a 20% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/bc14043a-51b9-4cfa-a9c7-aecf3d5d5732?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; protection from AI; workload protections; and improvements to leave.

AMWU/AWU/ETU - BHP

On 8 September, BHP and unions with members at Port Hedland met at the FWC [https://substack.com/redirect/90e60935-d22b-460b-91e5-cb135f34747f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but no agreement has been reached as yet. BHP offered a \$25,000 “transition payment” [https://substack.com/redirect/64814053-6d8a-4140-83d0-df947fc9372e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and a 17% wage increase over the proposed 4 year agreement. According to the ETU WA Branch secretary Adam Woodage, under the proposal 40% of the workforce would be “going backwards” [https://substack.com/redirect/9a96388c-c436-4481-9e20-4a12d5ddb34c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Woodage went on to say that “There were two major tiers of conditions, we want everyone on the good tier... they want everyone on the shit tier”. The sticking point is that the base wages being offered by BHP are below what most workers are currently paid, and relies on an assumption that take home pay will be topped up with performance payments. In addition to that problem, unions do not want existing inequalities in wages between workers to be resolved by cutting some workers wages (obviously). The West Australian reported late yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/281b4f90-7f72-4d35-a27b-eff43402d89e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that the AMWU, AWU and ETU are applying to the FWC for an intractable bargaining declaration. If granted, this would kick off an arbitration process run by the Commission.

NTEU QLD - University of Queensland

Last Tuesday (8/9), NTEU members at the University of Queensland struck for half a day [https://substack.com/redirect/6a26f5b9-7734-45de-8cf3-8b2ec9fa6733?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers have also been participating in a ban on meetings with supervisors, managers and Deans as well as a ban on participation in staff appraisal processes. Workers are fighting for a 20% pay increase over 3 years, but the University is offering only 12% over 4 years. Other key sticking points in negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/3833118f-9589-4792-9b3e-7172a7651849?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] include the NTEU’s claim for 17% superannuation for casuals; action on workload; and an end of year shutdown. Bargaining with the university commenced in February this year.

TWU - FedEx, Border Express, K&S, SCT, PFD, Sadliers, Goldstar & Qube

As I reported last week [https://substack.com/redirect/5b1c1391-339a-441d-8d68-4d4025287414?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], thousands of transport workers at

FedEx, Border Express, K&S, SCT, PFD, Sadliers, Goldstar and Qube struck for 24 hours last Thursday (10/9). Workers are fighting for pay in line with industry standards [https://substack.com/redirect/a1ca8354-03cd-4b3b-a3c4-faebc5134d0d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]; job security and a say in the future of their industries. FedEx seems determined to distinguish itself as one of the worst companies in Australia. In response to Thursday's strike action, FedEx locked out 3000 workers [https://substack.com/redirect/620c6a9a-c915-4efb-af94-9dc60cd62fe4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] across the country on Friday (11/09).

NTEU QLD - Griffith University

NTEU members at Griffith University have held two 30 minute stoppages recently. The first was on 26 August [https://substack.com/redirect/7b5f17f0-9092-4cd0-a6a9-e285ead44699?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], and the second on 9 September [https://substack.com/redirect/c6f0d645-507c-4dde-a7c2-3f8d178a1e95?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a 20% wage increase, but Griffith University has neither responded to this claim, nor put a counter offer [https://substack.com/redirect/557c50ce-f5ca-477f-b196-a709628059b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. As with both QUT and UQ, workers at Griffith are also fighting for protections against AI; action on workload; 17% superannuation for casuals and improvements to leave.

HACSU Vic - Scope

On Friday (11/9), workers from 35 disability housing homes walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/f4f54279-2590-4c77-9ff6-7b0e57ea6d9f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] and rallied outside Scope's headquarters. Workers and their union have been in negotiations for a new EBA for 2 years. This article in [https://substack.com/redirect/e66489e1-64f9-4fae-b3de-e0443e7729be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]The Age [https://substack.com/redirect/e66489e1-64f9-4fae-b3de-e0443e7729be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] provides helpful background information about this dispute which boils down to public services being outsourced to private providers resulting in worse wages for workers and I am assuming in all likelihood worse standards of care for people with disabilities. Well worth a read if like me you're not across the issues in this space.

MUA NSW - Sydney Ferries

The MUA's dispute with Sydney ferries operator Transdev continues. While the MUA has invited Sydneysiders to enjoy free ferry rides on the greatest harbour in the world [https://substack.com/redirect/da17d0ae-a9a2-48bc-b49e-aa3c9b6e0c8a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], Transdev maintains that the MUA cannot turn off Opal card readers as part of their industrial action and that passengers must tap on and tap off [https://substack.com/redirect/d48745ef-e342-4916-9b80-ac92d096133d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Transdev really doesn't seem to want to win the PR war of this industrial dispute, because their next move was to cancel ferry services along the Parramatta River over the weekend [https://substack.com/redirect/fd09f4b7-b648-4660-b20a-dfa6f60ee19c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (12-13/9). While Transdev claimed this was linked to industrial action, the MUA said it was retaliation, and Deputy Branch Secretary Paul Garrett countered that "If Transdev chooses to cancel services, that is a decision being made by the company, not by the workers. The workers are ready to do their jobs and will be at work across the weekend being paid to leave boats tied up to the wharf. [https://substack.com/redirect/49da85df-9a8e-497c-ae7e-144094797989?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]" MUA members are fighting for a decent deal and wages that keep up with the cost of living.

ASMOF Vic - Public hospital doctors

Public hospital doctors were planning to strike for 24 hours yesterday (15/9), but the action was called off on Monday (14/9). According to ASMOF [https://substack.com/redirect/08579591-c846-4c63-b7f8-36f0970fcd52?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]: "On Friday, the Government advised us that if it did not believe hospitals could be sufficiently staffed during the stoppage, it would use technical and patient safety mechanisms available to it to seek to stop the action. That has occurred. Following legal advice and discussions in the Commission today, ASMOF Victoria has withdrawn tomorrow's planned 24-hour stoppage." It would seem that patient safety is enough of an issue for the state government to suspend industrial action, but not enough to address key claims [https://substack.com/redirect/de878c81-2711-488e-86aa-b58c11574be5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] from ASMOF including banning shifts longer than 12.5 hours, capping consecutive night shifts at four in a row and introducing doctor-to-patient ratios.

MUA QLD - River City Ferries

The dispute between River City Ferries and the MUA continues with more stoppages on CityCat ferries. A 24 hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/dc7b9cc2-7f30-4858-b7f8-8099c1a1c438?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] was held from 4am on Thursday (10/9). There will be 2 two-hour stoppages held today (16/9) and tomorrow (17/9) [https://substack.com/redirect/d3f45af8-da1e-495e-ab29-801a9a4ead4d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] targeting peak hours of 8am-10am and 4pm-6pm. Workers are fighting for a 6% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/8565858c-136c-4b57-840c-b80fe0552fdb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] in the first year of a new agreement followed by 4.75% or the FWC increase, whichever is greater; as well as backpay from the expiry of the current agreement and improvements to conditions.

AEU/CFMEU/CPSU/Professionals Australia - ACT Public Sector

Workers in the ACT public sector have rejected the Territory Government's most recent pay offer [https://substack.com/redirect/7ba41185-8ca3-4234-a856-d64cf0192e36?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Unions ran a "vote no" campaign on the offer which included top-up payments if inflation hit certain levels, but did not budge from the base 9% pay increase over 3 years. 63% of those who participated in the vote rejected the offer. Several unions, including the CPSU [https://substack.com/redirect/12489249-676c-489a-89db-1011637f46c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and AEU [https://substack.com/redirect/8d7e2667-5e35-4b06-a0f2-437ce65302ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] have threatened to escalate industrial action. Professionals Australia are first out of the barriers though with ACT pharmacists striking for two hours yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/0592c022-6f81-42f3-8b00-f17aeceb329a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (15/9).

ASU Victoria - Melbourne metropolitan councils

A reader reached out seeking updates on the ASU's negotiations with 8 Melbourne metropolitan councils for a multi-employer agreement. I don't have a lot of new information but industrial action is continuing. Some harder hitting bans including street cleaning through the City of Yarra and residential bin collection in Hume and Merri-bek are back on. Merri-bek is shamefully docking workers wages up to 15% [https://substack.com/redirect/4a68e76d-3ad0-466d-a9af-147dc0f27bf1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] if they participate in industrial action. Hume has also commenced docking wages of workers who participate by up to 11.5% [https://substack.com/redirect/b3b02914-3f0e-42ae-bbb5-d914643d87f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

The ASU had been pressuring the state government to amend rate capping legislation to address underlying policy issues that are exacerbating low pay for council workers, but with the election fast approaching this is no longer a live option, but the union is still lobbying the government to contribute to a solution. An update from the ASU on 8 September [https://substack.com/redirect/cbf3a4fe-da4f-4673-9e0b-dd50a969cd1e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] reported that "conversations with the State Government continue to progress positively and we remain optimistic of their involvement in securing a fair deal", but noted that there was no firm commitment from the government, nor a pay offer from councils.

In short

ASU - Jetstar

Having overwhelmingly voted in favour of industrial action, ASU members at Jetstar commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/e8969037-aa9e-4d69-b209-23addc405ac1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on Saturday (12/9). Workers are wearing campaign badges and stickers [https://substack.com/redirect/05337f51-5644-4821-81c0-20a69e19fa65?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] while working and talking to customers about their campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/0196f19a-1761-49ab-b9ee-629aa01cbf5f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

CEPU SA - Service Stream

Workers have voted down another unendorsed proposed agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/cffdf8b3-b89b-4a31-ad2b-275e2decbb98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] from Service Stream. Workers previously voted down a subpar agreement in July [https://substack.com/redirect/bdb8ad13-15e3-454a-b6b1-819cac384a08?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/5b9a4631-f811-4769-8e9e-ae3b51670e9b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] at Service Stream continue. A rally in support of workers [https://substack.com/redirect/aeb53087-ff6b-418d-800c-9f26b5e6b2d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] was held on Friday (11/9) at the Edinburgh RAAF base

UWU - Bridgestone

UWU members working as tyre fitters at Bridgestone commenced a 6 day strike [https://substack.com/redirect/4adab1e7-bc9e-4a06-be28-52ca15b7f99c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on Thursday (10/9). Workers are

fighting for a fair deal that will keep up with the cost of living. UWU members are asking supporters to sign a petition [https://substack.com/redirect/5af3b7af-e6e9-4665-868f-934dc6b495ae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] calling on Managing Director Heath Barclay to provide workers with a decent offer.

PSA SA - SA Pathology

PSA members working in Immunology at SA Pathology have taken industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/69316188-b3bf-4377-bbc8-2eaa4443ef4c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. I don't have any specific details, but workers are fighting back against increasing workloads that are affecting staff wellbeing and service quality. Know more? Get in touch!

VAHPA - Public sector allied health

Week 2 of VAHPA's "Four Weeks To Fix It" [https://substack.com/redirect/aa539c9c-b547-49c7-a18b-55e68245831d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] campaign is encouraging members to put up campaign posters, chalk messages and distribute campaign materials at the start of shifts.

AMWU/ETU Vic - CSL

The Victorian branches of both the AMWU [https://substack.com/redirect/45941ebd-ecc0-44e9-9238-faebf5818e77?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and ETU [https://substack.com/redirect/e37f71a5-2a15-451a-83c4-11e59dd08a5b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] posted notices advising that industrial action at CSL that had been scheduled for 11 September was ordered by the FWC to stop, not occur and not be organised [https://substack.com/redirect/903dc46d-6855-4f60-a4f6-0fc3077b6f60?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. I believe this dispute is limited to an agreement covering workers in "metals" classifications. Would love to know more about this dispute!

CEPU SA - Kone

CEPU members at Kone have commenced industrial action in pursuit of a better deal. Workers held stop work meetings yesterday (15/9) and voted to escalate industrial action.

HACSU Tasmania - Wellington Clinics

HACSU nurses working across medical specialist clinics at the Wellington Clinics at Royal Hobart Hospital stopped work yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/f93d0c4e-f663-42d0-a3eb-355f80237349?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (15/9). Nurses took stopwork action to protest against a decision not to extend fixed-term nursing contracts at the clinics. 50% of the nursing workforce are on fixed term contracts, representing approximately 5 full time equivalent positions. Health Minister Eric Abetz has termed the cuts "operational efficiencies".

IEU Vic - Overnewton College

Teachers at Overnewton will strike for half a day [https://substack.com/redirect/5fb49eea-f24b-4317-9a08-72b8ec416dd3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] tomorrow (17/9). The teachers have already been implementing a range of work bans for over a week [https://substack.com/redirect/433328ab-a560-4542-8691-14aba1349236?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including ignoring dress code and

wearing oodles and slippers to work [https://substack.com/redirect/442ad137-1bdd-49a7-9b82-c03026920cf5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Parents at the school have created a petition in support of the teachers, but argues that any wage increase for teachers should not be funded by an increase to fees [https://substack.com/redirect/f6521dce-e00d-45bf-8f0e-f6bf7a6687f0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

PABO Watch

TWU NSW - Certis

The TWU in NSW has advised a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/6ca4b3ab-c77b-4bf4-ad0b-9ff177aed027?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for its members at Certis is open from 11 September - 18 September. I believe this is for Certis members at Sydney Airport but not 100% sure.

Union news

New Leadership at HWU

New leadership is in place for the HWU [https://substack.com/redirect/f4e035d9-29af-438f-bad7-4cb8d3a67639?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], a Victorian branch of the HSU. The HWU "Unity Team" led by Jake McGuinness has won every position across the branch, although only one position - the Branch Committee representative from Western Victoria - was contested. The finalisation of the elections marks the return of the union to members after it was put into administration in December 2024 following allegations of fraud and mismanagement made against former Secretary Diana Asmar. Prior to becoming Secretary, McGuinness was Lead Organiser of the HWU while it was under administration. McGuinness was Communications Director during Asmar's tenure, but was stood down by Asmar [https://substack.com/redirect/14e23f3f-0172-4eb8-8653-eb541925046d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] after he spoke out against her. The four person executive team is rounded out by Gavin Sharpe, previously an HWU

organiser, as Assistant Secretary, and two rank and file members Donna Azzopardi and David Baird as President and Vice President respectively. Diana Asmar's civil trial was scheduled to commence on 31 August but has been delayed due to "health issues". [https://substack.com/redirect/aa17d2fd-21bf-46dd-9ad5-f2ce7a49d804?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

Resolutions/wins

AWU/The Services Union QLD - Western Downs Regional Council

An in-principle agreement has been made between unions and the Western Downs Regional Council. A formal ballot on the agreement opened yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/7c8c58c9-d4b8-4d8f-8faa-41b015479048?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and will close on Thursday (17/9). An AWU organiser described it as a "significant agreement" [https://substack.com/redirect/dd8e046d-00d1-424d-9a77-c910f563b4b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

with wage increases of up to 16% over 3 years, and a new increment scheme that will see workers properly remunerated for their skills and experience. The Services Union noted that the agreement includes wage increases of 3% more than the original offer [https://substack.com/redirect/ee5dd218-d3f9-48b1-bbac-6a27ee1a37f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] as well as improved conditions and benefits.

AMWU/ETU NSW - Valmet

Union members at Valmet have reached an in-principle agreement. It took just two days of partial work bans at one site with 100% ETU membership to drag the bosses back to the negotiating table with an improved offer. The in-principle agreement includes "significant" wage increases and the removal of a pay averaging system that disadvantaged newer employees. Another reminder that if you don't fight, you lose!

ASU/AWU/CPSU Victoria - Parks Victoria

After fighting for more than 12 months, unions at Parks Victoria have reached an in-principle agreement. According to the CPSU, the deal includes a 3% pay increase, a \$5000 one-off payment and a structural wages uplift that will boost base levels of pay. The ASU shared that their members will get a boost to their pay of between 4.5% - 6% [https://substack.com/redirect/21210f92-dca7-4261-afbd-2314d602e112?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] depending on grade. When workers commenced industrial action in May, for the first time in 15 years. Actions included 24 hour strikes (including one last week [https://substack.com/redirect/f9271172-5b7e-4a7a-953e-9d6319203b22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]); closure of parks and various work bans.

That's all I've got this week. I'm excited to have finished writing so I can go and listen to the People's History of Australia's new podcast episode all about the 1998 maritime dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/5f70e39e-6192-48b0-915c-b6ad4d1bc4b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

Have a listen and let me know your thoughts!

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNJNk1qRTFPREEzTlRRMkxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09EazFNRGcyTnpNc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneU1UQTBOBFkzTXl3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdF1XbHNjbjAuOEFObWNBVnpKYzk0S2pLNx15Mkx6ZmEyQTRmWWZVVHhRmc3UG1wWklvdyIsInAiOjIjXNTGwNzU0NiwiY6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxZmMsIm1hdCI6MTc4OTUwODY3MywiZlhwIjoyMTA1MDg0NjcZLCJpc3MiOiIjWdWIjMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.x1-_NS2HiMHkz4qu0JyCDk8MFzfu3Upzf1ldohdUKSM?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-17-december>

Reader survey

This is the last Disputes Report for 2025, and I need to ask for a favour. I love putting the report together, but as I get better at it and have more readers sharing information with me, the job of writing the report each week has become much bigger! My first report in November 2023 covered 11 disputes and was 527 words long. In comparison, last week's report covered 19 disputes but was over 2000 words long. In order to make this project sustainable, it would be incredibly helpful to hear from the people who read this report about how best to focus my efforts in 2026. I would be incredibly grateful if you could take the time to complete this survey and give me some feedback. Click here to complete the survey and let me know your thoughts! [https://substack.com/redirect/f6adb3a2-3ebf-4c42-bc96-f2a3a727424b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

PSA SA - Public sector workers

Prison officers ended up striking for 4 days last week [https://substack.com/redirect/bb345d77-1341-42e3-8788-10a2691d687b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], with the courts' sheriff officers joining in with a 24 hour stoppage on Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/388950b7-c95d-4aad-87a7-37bee71aef16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (11/12) grinding the court system to a halt with the Supreme, District, Magistrates and Coroners courts closing for the day. The industrial action resulted in the state's treasurer meeting with PSA officials to discuss a new pay deal. A report in the Advertiser on Friday (12/12) said that "details of the new offer have not been made public as the PSA leadership puts the offer to members before making a decision. [https://substack.com/redirect/ba364be6-014c-4af5-9838-acb1127ca322?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" It's been radio silence on the PSA's social media pages since Friday, and no media reporting of an outcome that I have seen... If you've got an update - I'd love to hear it!

AEU Tasmania - Public sector teachers & support staff

On Friday (12/12), most Tasmanian public schools closed in the morning as teachers and support staff walked off the job for the second time in two months [https://substack.com/redirect/31948c9e-8291-401b-b2ce-20378383f813?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Rallies were held in Hobart, Launceston and Burnie. Unions are fighting for a 21.5% pay rise over three years for public sector workers, but the government refuses to budge from the "take it or leave it" 3%, one year agreement offer. David Genford the President of the Tasmanian Branch remarked to the Hobart rally "This is a Government that is able to find money when they want to - they found money for their many electoral promises, money for a stadium, they need to find money for public sector workers, to treat you with respect and to show that you actually mean something to them. [https://substack.com/redirect/22ca38c7-114b-4ac3-af46-8fd5434f68d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" I haven't been able to find out if any more industrial action is likely this year but suspect it is unlikely with Term 4 finishing tomorrow (18/12). Term 1 2026 commences in Tassie on 5 February.

RAFFWU - Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books

As promised (threatened?) workers at Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books went on strike over the weekend [https://substack.com/redirect/9bfda858-c784-45e8-a5fb-3bf3cba04f0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (13-14/12). More than 110 booksellers participated in the strike [https://substack.com/redirect/583b2c70-6d56-42b9-8bae-0679c0afd9a8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A large crowd of workers and community members joined the strikers at a rally in Leichardt, NSW on Saturday. Prior to the strike, workers had already implemented work bans on attending meetings with managers, receiving stock and re-stocking shelves. RAFFWU was scheduled to have a bargaining meeting on Monday (15/12), and had said that if the bosses didn't come with a fair offer, members would vote on further action in the lead up to Christmas. At the time of writing, no further details have been revealed - but stay tuned! Workers are fighting for a much improved EBA after being stuck on a "zombie" agreement for over a decade.

HACSU Tasmania - Public sector health workers

Another two stoppages by Tasmanian public sector health workers over the past week. Workers from across Tasmania, but particularly from the Launceston Hospital rallied outside Health Minister Bridget Archer's office on Thursday afternoon [https://substack.com/redirect/5ca58517-968c-40c1-9b0c-0e9c8445900c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (11/12). A cleaner at the rally referred to the government's offer to public sector workers as "a slap in the face". On Monday (15/12), HACSU members at the Bridgewater Dental Clinic walked off the job for two hours in protest against the government's failure to provide a reasonable offer [https://substack.com/redirect/582059ec-0c79-425c-b30c-9032dcd40f10?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - including an additional allowance for oral health and dental therapists working at Risdon Prison and the Ashley Youth Detention Centre. HACSU is calling on the state government to return to the negotiating table with a better deal for workers.

AMWU NSW - Downer EDI Rail & Progress Rail

Last Wednesday (10/12) brought a united picket line [https://substack.com/redirect/a227f63a-0301-4010-a158-d39dafa7eff4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for AMWU members at Downer EDI and Progress Rail. Workers at Downer EDI Rail commenced stop work action the previous Friday (5/12) following a rail car shunting ban. I'm not sure if this stoppage continued. The action on 10 December was the third stoppage held by workers at Progress Rail. I don't have a lot of details about these disputes. If you know more, let me know!

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Newcastle's bus drivers held a 24 hour stoppage on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/dabda56a-7e9a-4f47-8fe5-f87beffd9f04?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (12/12). The stoppage followed RTBU members decisively voting down Keolis Downer's proposed EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/af64156a-e56f-4795-9dd8-ef9861653277?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

According to the RTBU the proposed agreement cut wages and conditions as well as leading to concerns about safety and rostering. Workers commenced industrial action on Newcastle's buses in April [https://substack.com/redirect/cbaa9906-4579-4295-8d0c-324a1e02b99b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] this year.

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Yesterday (16/12), more than 200 nurses and midwives rallied in front of Flinders Medical Centre in the most recent stopwork action. The ANMF has announced their next big EB rally will take place on 5 February 2026 [https://substack.com/redirect/76349cb8-9585-4f75-bf74-3f0c1f5990df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Nurses and midwives will assemble at Parliament House at 1pm before marching to Hindmarsh Square. The last big rally was held in October, followed by regional and metro stop work rallies at individual hospitals. ANMF members rejected the state government's offer of a 13% pay increase over 4 years in October. No further offer from the government has been received. The ANMF is fighting for a "competitive" salary increase [https://substack.com/redirect/f16b2dc1-705f-4c25-bdee-835b6e15e121?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - a 23% increase by 2027 with a further uplift of 3-4% if the agreement extends into 2028. There are also a number of outstanding claims relating to allowances and ensuring babies are counted as patients for nurse to patient ratios.

UWU - Ambulance Victoria

Maintenance workers at Ambulance Victoria walked off the job for 24 hours on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/10bec0cd-8c8b-4f19-b2d2-dadd79a758da?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (12/12). The EBA expired in October [https://substack.com/redirect/d8acb961-2821-4d30-a68b-b98c25131591?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and workers have been participating in work bans since late November, but inaction from Ambulance Victoria has forced workers to escalate their action. The action meant workers did not attend the workplace or address minor or major faults. Broken down ambulances would instead have to be retrieved by tow trucks. UWU members are fighting for a fair deal that reflects the skill and responsibility of their work, and to end the two-tier pay structure in practice at Ambulance Victoria [https://substack.com/redirect/df02f62b-f060-4b73-9c83-dd9a6423b8f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CFMEU WA - Freo Cranes

Crane crews across the Pilbara struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/458ba705-96ed-4b16-95ed-6bf67277f3f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last Wednesday (10/12). This is the second 24 hour strike taken by workers at Freo Cranes in as many weeks. The CFMEU members are feeling strong and are committed to keep the pressure on to win a fair deal - better wages and conditions.

HACSU Tasmania - Child Safety, Youth Justice and Advice Referral Line workers

HACSU members working in Child Safety, Youth Justice and the Advice Referral Line will stop work today (17/12) in response to chronic understaffing and unsafe workloads. Understaffing is so out of control that some workers are doing the work of an entire team. Vacancy controls mean that when workers leave, roles are not being advertised or backfilled. This is having devastating consequences for vulnerable members of the community. Workers are demanding immediate action including urgent recruitment, backfilling all vacancies, ensuring safe staffing levels and enforceable workload caps. Workers also want measures to address occupational violence and to improve safety supports.

UWU - MSS Security

On Friday (12/12) security officers at Canberra airport participated in rolling 15 minute stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/a458c507-f8ac-469d-8654-25529ab4af03?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from 5am to 6am and 7am to 8am. MSS Security has put out a sub-par offer to workers. The deal is far below what workers at Sydney airport receive [[https://substack.com/redirect/f53fe64d-d7ac-4ab8-8478-11fcab0e265f?](https://substack.com/redirect/f53fe64d-d7ac-4ab8-8478-11fcab0e265f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In addition to this lousy deal, MSS also tried to intimidate workers from taking protected industrial action by implying that workers could face broad pay cuts and other “consequences” for taking industrial action. This is grubby behaviour typical of MSS, and not unknown to workers at Canberra airport. An UUU organiser was arrested [[https://substack.com/redirect/503d9004-163f-4282-921e-26c6cb21d4be?](https://substack.com/redirect/503d9004-163f-4282-921e-26c6cb21d4be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for trespassing whilst visiting members on site earlier this year. UUU members at Canberra airport are committed to standing together for a fair deal that keeps up with the cost of living.

AMUU/AUU/CFMEU/ETU/MUA - Woodside

I had heard that industrial action was possibly going to kick off prior to Christmas on Woodside’s Pluto 2 gas project. However, Monday’s (15/12) AFR reported that the Offshore Alliance (MUA and AUU) have notified Bechtel (the lead contractor on the project) of rolling one hour stoppages commencing on January 5 [[https://substack.com/redirect/0dff1805-ba5e-4169-8b80-f1e7f647123b?](https://substack.com/redirect/0dff1805-ba5e-4169-8b80-f1e7f647123b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and it is understood the AMUU, CFMEU and ETU will follow suit. In an effort to avoid any industrial action either before or after Christmas, Bechtel has put another offer out to ballot. The deal includes a 20% wage increase over 3 years as well as a sign on bonus of \$10,000. A tempting package in the lead up to the silly season. Unions have been pushing for a 30% wage increase, and workers have already voted down two offers from Bechtel.

ANMF Vic - Healthscope

On Friday (12/12), after notifying Healthscope of new bans, bed closures and stoppages, Healthscope announced that they would start docking workers’ pay if they participated in the data bans; bans on management meetings and bans on receptionist/administration and food services duties [[https://substack.com/redirect/1023fd0c-b6aa-42da-ab9c-4197ff2f8bbe?](https://substack.com/redirect/1023fd0c-b6aa-42da-ab9c-4197ff2f8bbe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Not to be discouraged, ANMF members have continued with protected industrial action this week! ANMF members at Healthscope participated in a 4 hour stoppage on Monday [[https://substack.com/redirect/77bcaa89-6540-42b1-8796-5dc267ebfd1a?](https://substack.com/redirect/77bcaa89-6540-42b1-8796-5dc267ebfd1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (15/12) and yesterday (16/12) members at Cath Lab and DOSA nurses at Melbourne Private and DOSA nurses at Knox participated in a second 4 hour stoppage [[https://substack.com/redirect/c5f77346-f3a0-483b-b650-8c77ee845f64?](https://substack.com/redirect/c5f77346-f3a0-483b-b650-8c77ee845f64?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Additional ongoing bans commenced on Monday (15/12) including those which Healthscope has said they will dock workers pay for participating in as well as a ban on any Nurse or Midwife in Charge of a ward or unit taking a patient load. Finally, bed closures [[https://substack.com/redirect/4ca1914d-2a27-44d4-8714-cc0892ece7ed?](https://substack.com/redirect/4ca1914d-2a27-44d4-8714-cc0892ece7ed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] commenced from 7am on Monday (15/12). The ANMF will attend a conference regarding the matter at the FWC today (17/12).

VAHPA Special General Meeting

The VAHPA Special General Meeting took place last Thursday (11/12) at Trades Hall. The main item for discussion was the proposed merger of VAHPA with another Victorian Branch of the HSU, HACSU. When the time came to vote on a motion about the merger; 267 members voted against the merger ; 6 in favour of the merger and 3 abstentions. That’s a decisive 96.7% of attendees against the merger. For a detailed report about the meeting check out VAHPA Pulse’s account [[https://substack.com/redirect/7e4214e5-ad0f-4dbe-b622-b52d2f9a6946?](https://substack.com/redirect/7e4214e5-ad0f-4dbe-b622-b52d2f9a6946?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. So what now? VAHPA Pulse have also outlined some next steps [[https://substack.com/redirect/675290df-fc7f-4308-bd2c-a07953d23e90?](https://substack.com/redirect/675290df-fc7f-4308-bd2c-a07953d23e90?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], because one thing is for certain - this fight isn’t over.

ANMF WA

The ANF WA has finally added midwives to their acronym officially becoming the ANMF WA [[https://substack.com/redirect/7238fabb-d4ab-43ad-bb5f-adb1f45f768a?](https://substack.com/redirect/7238fabb-d4ab-43ad-bb5f-adb1f45f768a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at their AGM held on 20 November. The ANF in WA has been an outlier over the past decade by not including the very important “M” for Midwives in its name. South Australia was the first state to change to the ANMF acronym in 2010, with the NSW Nurses and Midwives Association adding the “M” in 2012 and then the federal union and Victorian branch jumping on the band wagon in 2013. Queensland added “M” to their QNU in 2017. The social media post [[https://substack.com/redirect/7238fabb-d4ab-43ad-bb5f-adb1f45f768a?](https://substack.com/redirect/7238fabb-d4ab-43ad-bb5f-adb1f45f768a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which drew my attention to this name change also revealed that the AGM where the name change was announced, was also the first ANF WA AGM since 2008 to achieve quorum! Yikes!

Is industrial action at a nine year high??

Ewin Hannan from the Australian [[https://substack.com/redirect/4cbb5fea-7c10-4930-9ae8-00719daac94e?](https://substack.com/redirect/4cbb5fea-7c10-4930-9ae8-00719daac94e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM) j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] reports that “the number of industrial disputes doubled in the September quarter to a nine-year high of 87”. Alas, don’t get

excited for a strike wave just yet. The Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS) publishes quarterly reports on the number of industrial disputes, the number of workers involved, and the number of work days “lost” to industrial action. The number of disputes includes workplaces large and small, and is less significant than the number of strike days. According to the ABS, in the three months to 30 September [https://substack.com/redirect/0b08a97c-c130-4914-9192-411c1fd65973?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], 55,100 days were lost to industrial action. This compares to 46,600 in September 2024 and 37,100 in September 2023. There is a small uptick, but we are a long way from half a million strike days recorded in the September quarter 1987 when Australia’s population was much smaller.

TWU QLD - DHL Express

And finally, some good news. TWU members at DHL Express at Brisbane airport have voted up a new EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/2699998c-59e4-4eb1-bb69-687b59badf05?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

According to the TWU, the deal includes more than \$4 an hour extra in the first year; a 17% wage increase over 3 years and a \$2000 sign on bonus. By the end of the agreement, the lowest paid workers covered by the agreement will be earning \$12,000 more than they would have if they had accepted the initial offer from DHL. Workers organised and conducted industrial action to achieve this outcome, including two 24 hour strikes. That’s all I’ve got this week, and in fact that’s all I’ve got for 2025! I will be taking a break over the summer holidays and will return to Disputes Report in 2026. Thank you so much for reading this year, and a special thank you to all the workers who have got in touch with me to share information, insights and help get this report out each week. I honestly couldn’t do it without your help.

In solidarity, Sarah

PS Please complete my survey! [https://substack.com/redirect/7bb4bee5-04c6-4765-a038-a40b8df72045?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

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View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-17-june>

AWU/ETU/MUA WA - Inpex

On 2 June, union members at all 3 of Inpex's Ichthys gas facilities walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/72116228-fdb2-42d0-b1ca-ae1043a24a4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are seeking better conditions and annual wage increases of 3%. Initial industrial action was 2 two-hour stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/c0c63497-1896-4b85-9dfc-4e23cb590d5a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and bans on overtime and shift swaps. On 8 June, unions accused Inpex of reneging on an offer around a classification framework and escalated to daily stoppages of 8 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/f049eaed-229d-415b-8a00-22f64493115d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Inpex responded by launching proceedings in the FWC under section 424 [https://substack.com/redirect/5ecfd2f2-dd28-4eba-aea8-456b401046c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of the FWA - that industrial action must be suspended if it would "cause significant damage to the Australian economy or an important part of it." On Friday (12/6) the unions wound back industrial action to 2 two-hour stoppages at the beginning and the end of shifts [https://substack.com/redirect/3f3c1659-3970-4fac-a7a3-fb40eb7142ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but also rejected the latest offer from Inpex. The FWC rejected Inpex's application [https://substack.com/redirect/cb1cc78d-7096-454e-8336-0d52f41e9805?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to have the industrial action suspended on Saturday (13/6). The Offshore Alliance declared that industrial action would continue [https://substack.com/redirect/7f1f920a-923a-48c1-a5aa-cff747d320c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] "until a benchmark industry standard EBA is agreed". On Monday (15/6) the Alliance posted on social media that Inpex had failed to meet deadlines agreed in the FWC, and that a notice to extend protected industrial action beyond 23 June was being sent. Stay tuned.

ASU/AWU/CPSU Vic - Parks Victoria

CPSU members at Parks Victoria walked off the job for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/72a0ca22-a15d-4652-bcdb-3fcb4c8d83c0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Thursday (11/6) as an escalation in the campaign for a decent deal from the state government. ASU members held a one hour stopwork rally [https://substack.com/redirect/1f7c2ee2-3dcf-45cb-92aa-cc9670eecbc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last Monday (8/6) at Brimbank Park. There was some [https://substack.com/redirect/5e1ec707-73da-4fd8-940f-adf3e306f8f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] media [https://substack.com/redirect/81824c09-c918-4a79-bd73-56a8d3cc0504?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] coverage [https://substack.com/redirect/92341afe-b46f-4f5a-9f7f-f69d08548421?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] about the potential closure of national parks and campgrounds over the King's Birthday long week (6-8 June) as part of the dispute with Parks Victoria. While the AWU went so far as to accuse the CPSU of "winding back" [https://substack.com/redirect/05bc7539-f56d-4bd6-bcef-1199a40dfde2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] its actions over the long weekend, it is understood that the CPSU altered its plans due to legal technicalities raised by Parks Victoria [https://substack.com/redirect/809150db-f964-451c-9566-c4d80770a842?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The technicalities related to the difference between actively "closing" parks versus just not opening them. The CPSU made the call that rather than wasting time in the Commission arguing semantics, they would just escalate to a 24 hour strike instead. A range of indefinite bans remained in place over the long weekend including bans on rubbish collection; cleaning facilities and fireplaces and taking meal breaks in the field. These indefinite bans remain in place. It is worth noting that according to protected action ballots the AWU has 55 members at Parks Victoria, the ASU has 43 members, while the CPSU has 304 members. After a year of bargaining, all union members at Parks Victoria want a fair deal from the state government - including pay parity with their public sector colleagues.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer Northern Beaches

Bus drivers in the Northern Beaches local government area of Sydney have commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/8a315238-796b-4f5a-a4f7-5928406f3378?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. As a first step, RTBU members have stopped wearing their uniforms. The action is unlikely to cause any disruption to passengers, and it is hoped will nudge Keolis Downer into a better offer. Workers are seeking a decent wage increase to keep up with the cost of living and improved conditions. It is worth noting that no agreement was reached between Keolis Downer Hunter and the RTBU after more than a year of

negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/ec6c3b23-25b2-4a53-8556-1cab51758047?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and industrial action including stoppages on Newcastle's buses. An intractable bargaining declaration [https://substack.com/redirect/ad04a890-3f52-44db-a03a-26a65e0b0957?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] was issued in April.

MSAV/VAHPA Victoria - Public sector health workers

Yesterday (16/6) members of MSAV and VAHPA joined forces for a combined rally during joint 24 hour strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/c4e26d69-3f68-456c-a3c9-472378484735?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers and their supporters gathered in front of the Department of Health's building before marching to Parliament House. I have heard rally estimates of between 2500 - 5000 people, and seemingly equal numbers from both unions if t-shirt colour can be relied on! MSAV has been in negotiations with the state government for 14 months and is seeking a 28% wage increase over 4 years. VAHPA has been in negotiations for 8 months and is seeking a 38.16% wage increase over 3 years.

UWU NT - Correctional officers

Last Tuesday (9/6), Correctional Officers at the Darwin Correctional Centre and Berrimah Correctional Centre walked off the job for 12 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/89aae9a8-1311-4520-a0c7-591cc4877036?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The Northern Territory Government and the Department of Corrections applied to the FWC for the action to be stopped, but the FWC dismissed the application and the strike went ahead. The action caused prisoners to be stuck in their cells, and consequently disruption to court proceedings [https://substack.com/redirect/f448e71d-1e28-45dc-8d74-7dc68be30bf8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The Northern Territory Government has put a revised offer out to ballot. The offer includes a 13% wage increase over 4 years. The vote on the proposed agreement opened on Monday (15/6) and closes on 29 June. UWU is recommending members vote no as the agreement does not deliver decent pay outcomes and fails to guarantee safe staffing levels.

UWU - Secure Journeys

UWU members at Secure Journeys commenced industrial action on 4 June [https://substack.com/redirect/e6f9239c-05f1-4e71-97b2-9e139b00019b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Secure Journeys is the contractor that has been running Australia's immigration detention network for Border Force for the last 12 months. Workers are concerned about many workplace issues [https://substack.com/redirect/fa4031c3-d4ca-4bf0-a992-24ec911ca988?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at the detention centres - low pay; dangerous rosters; under-staffing and under-resourcing. After 10 bargaining meetings, Secure Journeys have not moved on any claims. In addition to pay, the biggest issue is rostering and fatigue management. Workers are regularly working eleven 12-hour shifts in 15 day blocks. Industrial action commenced [https://substack.com/redirect/08e3b192-bddd-4f09-ad92-e2efec2ab35c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with a one-hour stoppage on 4 June; followed by 2 one-hour stoppages on 5 June. Last week this escalated to 2 two-hour stoppages on 11 and 12 June.

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

AEU members in Victoria are currently voting on whether to accept the in-principle agreement recommended to them by the branch council and executive. This "ratification process [https://substack.com/redirect/0a8bde6d-9768-47f7-abc5-80a7941ffea9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" takes place at a sub-branch (school) level - where sub-branches either support or reject the offer. This voting period ends at 5pm tomorrow (18/6). If supported, the agreement will then go to a ballot of all employees as per the FWA. If rejected, the state government will withdraw its offer and negotiations will recommence. So how's voting shaping up? According to Socialists in Schools [https://substack.com/redirect/cd4dc00c-01cc-49a0-9679-9c614a739a9c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] no votes have been recorded at 17 different schools. But this is a small snapshot when there are over 1500 schools across the state. Annoyingly, we'll have to wait and see.

TWU Tasmania - Kinetic

Bus drivers in Hobart and Launceston struck for 6 hours on Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/47157ccc-d21e-48bf-9fd7-16f14496078d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (11/6). This is an escalation from a two hour stoppage held in April [https://substack.com/redirect/807e51a8-0185-46cc-994c-91d497c83e85?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The TWU members are employed by Kinetic who have a contract with the state government to run public buses. Kinetic's drivers are paid up to \$250 less per week [https://substack.com/redirect/7074d6f3-80c9-4ca7-a35f-a6738f8c46fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] compared to bus drivers employed by another contractor, Metro. Workers are fighting for pay parity. The state government has said it would be inappropriate for them to get involved in a "private dispute" however the union argues that regardless of government contracting arrangements, this is public transport and

the state government has a responsibility to ensure workers are paid appropriately.

Professionals Australia - DXC

Tech outlet CRN had an exclusive interview [https://substack.com/redirect/c2484e32-b060-4883-87f0-9fc2222bbd1b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with a worker from DXC about the ongoing dispute. The interview is well worth a read, but for the purposes of this report it confirms that industrial action is ongoing. A fourth round of strike action took place last week. DXC is telling workers that if they don't agree to the proposed offer by August, their current agreements will lapse and they will be pushed back onto the Award (this is not true). Apparently about 85% of the agreement has been agreed to but key items remain unresolved including DXC's insistence on cutting standby rates. The worker summed up the negotiations calling on DXC to stop mucking around: "You know what needs to be done. Stop blaming your masters in the US for being unable to reach an agreement."

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

On Thursday (11/6) ACT's school teachers went on strike for 24 hours. According to the AEU, this was the first full day strike by teachers in the Territory in more than 15 years [https://substack.com/redirect/82f5d400-f5ca-4d67-a631-ad34209ec34f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. All public schools in the ACT

were closed for the day [https://substack.com/redirect/d017ed49-300c-4fec-a3e3-1b8dcc110902?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], with no on-site supervision available. The action followed a 2 hour strike by teachers in May. AEU members are fighting not just for wage increases but for action on workload and staff shortages. Teachers and their supporters met in Civic Square before marching to Glebe Park.

UWU Vic - Crown Melbourne

Crown put another subpar agreement out to vote, and UWU ran a successful "no" campaign. It is understood that the agreement was voted down by a substantial margin. I have had reports of pretty terrible behaviour from Crown during the voting period - refusing to allow the union to run meetings; putting up signs on digital noticeboards saying "the union is lying to you"; and pressuring workers to vote yes. Bargaining has been going on for close to a year I believe, and Crown is refusing to budge from its position, despite 2 weeks of intensive bargaining facilitated by the FWC. Workers previously took strike action on New Years' Eve and Valentine's Day. The proposed agreement does not meet workers expectations for wages, conditions, or job security. The atmosphere at Crown is terrible, morale is low and workers are not happy.

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

ANMF members walked off the job for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/697ffa6c-0257-4c4b-98d3-e475ad3eda74?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] at the Lyell McEwin Hospital in Adelaide on 4 June in a return to significant industrial action in their fight for a decent EBA offer from the state government. Tomorrow (18/6), ANMF members at the Flinders Medical Centre will commence a 24 hour strike [https://substack.com/redirect/d23a2435-fb93-4328-a6cd-f70a929568a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. In February, the ANMF accepted an interim administrative wage increase and paused industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/98b75468-7b1e-4835-a666-e41e05fc1738?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in the lead up to the state

election. Negotiations have been ongoing since then, but have now hit another stalemate [https://substack.com/redirect/1ceb7f18-7d5f-43bd-9425-0f99a658ad28?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

In short

MEU NSW - Peabody

The dispute at the Wambo coal mine washery continues. MEU members in the washery have been taking industrial action for over a month [https://substack.com/redirect/e5c6c2bc-d9b6-47f0-ab43-18e309f762d3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a fair agreement with a decent wage offer. Peabody has only offered 2.5% annual wage increases [https://substack.com/redirect/37c7f587-604b-4780-9e43-e72ac61f14e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

AMWU Vic - UGL

AMWU members employed by UGL at the Viva oil refinery in Geelong commenced industrial action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/3fd13f6b-c8fe-482e-97f0-d797b886f07e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (12/6). This is the same refinery where there was a major fire in April [https://substack.com/redirect/0ed6be67-a4c5-4e5a-831e-8665910885e3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers held a 4 hour stoppage and commenced indefinite bans on overtime call-backs. UGL is trying to strip conditions including redundancy and income protection and force workers back onto the award. More stoppages are expected.

ETU NSW - Stowe

On Thursday morning (11/6), ETU members at Stowe voted to commence strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/7c133b0f-4409-4276-bf4d-16916e4b1fcf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with 24 hour stoppages for the rest of the week. Workers met again on Monday morning (15/6) and voted to continue striking for another 48 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/d94a6ed5-cbef-45a0-b56b-2eff5c62f4c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The stoppages are causing significant disruption including shutting down construction of the \$1.3 billion Microsoft data centre in Kemps Creek. Workers are fighting for a better offer from management with higher wages and improved conditions. Time for Stowe to listen to its workers.

ETU QLD - Cleanco

Workers at Cleanco Barron Gorge took industrial action on 5 June [https://substack.com/redirect/95e30ead-6850-41db-93e9-c4bb160d12a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of their EBA campaign. I believe these ETU members work on the Barron Gorge Hydroelectric Power Station [https://substack.com/redirect/49d40610-b875-4d62-9cfe-a70fc7d6f5e0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

ASU Vic - Metropolitan Melbourne city councils

ASU members from 8 metropolitan Melbourne city councils will walk off the job today [https://substack.com/redirect/fdae708a-86dc-484f-a72b-4bbd6d58c3b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (17/6). This will be the second strike in pursuit of a decent multi-employer agreement. Workers from Merri-bek Council rallied outside council chambers in Coburg [https://substack.com/redirect/5d3869b4-0c1f-44cc-9e07-4d5d8b2ab78c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] before last week's Council meeting urging increased budget allocation for labour costs.

ETU QLD - Department of Transport and Main Roads

The dispute between workers at the state government at the Department of Transport and Main Roads continues. ETU members in Cairns participated in industrial action on 8 June. Industrial action commenced at TMR in September [https://substack.com/redirect/6ad4107c-bc0f-409e-9760-ae49dee00750?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last year.

AMWU QLD - RACQ

In the first week of June following a unanimous yes vote in a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/74933815-ca3c-4361-aaab-3ed793feca9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], AMWU member patrol workers at the RACQ commenced partial work bans. But the RACQ refused to accept partial work, essentially locking workers out [https://substack.com/redirect/622362f0-e9e5-4d6e-a5bf-7934356b0190?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Bosses have followed this up by lecturing workers [https://substack.com/redirect/808264e1-ad5f-4f93-a40f-ec346ba72f72?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to not mention the dispute to RACQ members or explain that delays are related to industrial action. Workers are fighting for pay parity [https://substack.com/redirect/a67b4546-d740-4c71-936b-eda8405ddc6a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with RACQ auto workshop mechanics.

HSU WA - Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital

Mortuary technicians at the Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital in Perth took stop work action [https://substack.com/redirect/e91979fc-ff86-477b-a0fd-d42c84cb63fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in early June. Management have put forward a proposal for 24/7 rosters. HSUWA members are fighting to ensure appropriate parameters are adopted to make sure workers are supported through the change.

AMWU NSW - NRMA

On Monday (15/6) morning, NRMA patrol officers marched to NRMA headquarters to hand deliver their claims. AMWU members are demanding a 17% wage increase over 4 years [https://substack.com/redirect/c4f521bc-5720-47f6-b7b4-adc972d786c0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers and their union have been in bargaining for 6 months [https://substack.com/redirect/48b49593-c876-4e41-9e70-696144668eb9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but no deal has been reached. On Monday evening, 260 AMWU members at the AMWU commenced a 48 hour strike. It has been 20 years since workers at the NRMA last went on strike.

PABO Watch

AMWU WA - UGL/Alcoa

AMWU members employed by UGL at Alcoa Wagerup and Pinjarra have voted in favour of industrial action. 98.9% of members [https://substack.com/redirect/e2423a76-bb3f-4678-aeff-b8b4a6c172c8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] who participated in the ballot were in favour of taking action. The protected action ballot comes after months of bargaining and a subpar offer [https://substack.com/redirect/e694fe7c-70c7-42b1-9996-cdd017f02d9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the bosses.

AMWU/ETU WA - BHP

90% of AMWU members and 100% of ETU members at BHP's Port Hedland operation have voted in favour of taking strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/5dad71fd-ee02-442a-8949-cc8e088d652c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The unions have accused BHP of progressively ripping away conditions [https://substack.com/redirect/5f88be2e-77ae-422c-8ee1-80786dfe92a6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including rent subsidies, transport to-and-from work, meals while on shift and healthcare support. Workers are fighting for an agreement with clear criteria for classification, enforceable conditions and parity for workers at the port with the same skills and experience. Negotiations have been underway for 6 months [https://substack.com/redirect/e2f0272d-3732-4f98-8fd1-95ad39dfcd18?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but BHP has not been cooperative. It is telling that BHP had already started trying to recruit scabs [https://substack.com/redirect/d44162c0-dd5c-4cc5-8e86-32ed89cf5ae5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] before the ballots had even been counted! No notice of industrial action has been given yet, but definitely one to keep an eye on.

Unions news

HWU Administration

An eventful fortnight for HWU members as the HSU National Office attempted, but ultimately failed, to stop elections from taking place. On 3 June, the administrator of the HWU released a statement [https://substack.com/redirect/2020dd4d-65d9-4c67-8f54-9b62f6524784?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

advising that “the union is functioning effectively” and confirming that “the union is ready to be returned to democratic control.” The statement ended by announcing that nominations for the election of new branch leadership would open on 15 June. However, on 11 June a post on HWU social media [https://substack.com/redirect/925173fe-8ff1-456c-a885-d46623329640?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

advised that the HSU National Office had applied to the Federal Court to have the scheme of administration extended by 12 months; for the scheme of administration to be amended and for the 2026 elections to be deferred. In a short video [https://substack.com/redirect/a5980dc8-a360-4da7-b15b-8c4bd838d4e3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

the Administrator, Charlie Donnelly shared that the court application would remove his power as administrator and replace him with a board of the National Executive’s choosing. The Board would take control of the branch, and delay elections. But why? The original statement from Donnelly notes that since the HWU was placed under administration in December 2024 there has been a dramatic turnaround in the organisation’s financial position and membership has increased from 10,674 to more than 14,500. “The union is financially secure, operationally strong, growing its membership and delivering results”. In his video Donnelly alleges the court challenge must be to “keep power in the hands of appointed professionals instead of elected members”. Yesterday, a video [https://substack.com/redirect/43cc51c6-5db8-48bc-b711-0ea701cd56df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

on HWU social media featuring organiser Jake McGuinness shared that an interlocutory hearing took place in the Federal Court on Monday (15/6) and in his words “the HSU National were unable to put forward a credible argument and Justice Dowling has dismissed their application.” The HSU National website [https://substack.com/redirect/fbdb141b-167c-44bd-b9cf-05e42bfa694d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

now has a link to nomination forms for elections across the whole union - including HWU. For all the HSU election information head to the AEC website [https://substack.com/redirect/d247861c-85cc-4d48-b585-567ed661de32?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Now the question remains, who was the HSU National Executive trying to keep out of power?

NTEU elections

The NTEU also holds its elections this year. The election for National President, Secretary and Assistant Secretary was uncontested [https://substack.com/redirect/89375e78-29b4-4348-9185-f5168d54529c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and so already resolved. I am aware of at least two tickets that are not the incumbents contesting the Victorian Branch election - “Made by Members [https://substack.com/redirect/4fce3786-0902-4b96-8b41-7042522ea4c8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” and “Branches Lead [https://substack.com/redirect/ad540bf7-191f-4ea7-a24f-25b6c60c251c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]”.

I’m not sure if other state NTEU branches are shaping up for contested elections? It is so hard to find information about this so please get in touch if you know of other tickets running.

RTBU elections

And in even more election news, the AEC has issued election notices for the 2026 RTBU elections [https://substack.com/redirect/f0d7b9a3-ec77-4bd0-b7d8-eb6d778afcb1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtd2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The elections are for National Officers as well as 6 state branches (NSW, QLD, SA/NT, Tasmania, Victoria and WA). Nominations are open from 6 July - 27 July 2026.

Wins/resolutions

HACSU Tasmania - Ambulance Tasmania

87% of HACSU members have endorsed a new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/ff60e125-617e-4480-a259-9fe6351acb66?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] with Ambulance Tasmania. This brings a long dispute to an end - industrial action commenced 9 months ago. The agreement includes the now standard 8.75% wage increase over 3 years and according to Premier Jeremy Rockliff “structural adjustments, a modernised classification structure and improved conditions.” HACSU state secretary Robbie Moore confirmed that the agreement addresses key issues around rostering and single officer responses. The agreement will soon be lodged with the Tasmanian Industrial Commission.

Big report this week! There really is a lot going on at the moment. I’m sure I’ve missed stuff so please let me know what. Thanks to all the readers who have been in touch over the past fortnight helping me get across some of these disputes and sharing information and insights. I can’t say it enough: this newsletter is a collaborative project!

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMwMyVn1YMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1qQXlNamMyTURNMkxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09ERTJ0RFUxTmpRc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE16RTRNVFUYTkN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbAUNzBuYzJWJT09OundickRoZXNjLWVHYmZlVGZma0VhVS11OE9ieksZNWxUYyIsInAiOjIwMjI3NjAzNiwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc4MTY0NTU2NCwiZXhwIjoyMDk3MjIxNTY0LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.ysM2TREmn7kxPXAcnqsWuLANz95wrugaDVdUfN_9Dug?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-17-september>

ASU SA - City of Salisbury

ASU members at the City of Salisbury (northern suburbs of Adelaide) commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/caf2cd68-e363-4f40-95b1-7bf2543d5e15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Thursday (11/9). Initially the action includes uniform bans and the wearing and displaying of ASU merchandise and materials, with the potential to escalate to other work bans including refusing to handle any cash or issue fines or charge for any services. Workers at the council are the lowest paid metropolitan council workers in SA, and are fighting for a 10% increase over 2 years (6% in the first year and 4% in the second). Management originally offered 6.2% over 2 years which they then increased to 7.5% over 2 years following threats of industrial action. This offer was not endorsed by workers, but management pushed it out to a vote anyway. The offer was rejected, but instead of negotiating, management opened another vote within a week for an 8% increase over 2 years. Following a union meeting on 10 September to endorse industrial action, management have been attempting to intimidate workers by saying that if the ballot fails this time backpay will be taken off the table and other grubby tactics. Workers are sticking together for a decent deal, and have committed to escalating industrial action with an aim to avoid impact to the community, but maximise impact on management.

Independent Transport Union - CDC buses

Members of the Independent Transport Union at CDC buses struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/995458ef-9614-4c76-9a18-0c4dabaad096?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Friday (12/9), Monday (15/9) and Tuesday (16/9). Workers from both the ITU (an employee association established in 2023) and the TWU have rejected the most recent offer from CDC [https://substack.com/redirect/2d4e409b-842d-47f7-99d6-3fe0279803cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - a 13% wage increase over 3 years. It's not clear to me what level of membership the ITU have and whether it is large enough to cause substantial disruption. It is also not clear what the next steps for the TWU are. Would love to hear from any bus drivers on both those questions!

HSU SA/NT - Public sector allied health workers

Public sector allied health workers in the NT are due to commence industrial action today [https://substack.com/redirect/2b6744d6-a096-43a0-a798-e4fd166b94e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (17/09). After 6 months of negotiations, the NT Government has made a pay offer of 12.55% over 4 years which the HSU has described as "abysmal". The government has disregarded workers' advice and put this offer out to a vote. The HSU is running a no campaign in addition to members taking industrial action. The first phase of industrial action will include administrative bans, limiting meeting attendance, and a ban on entering Medicare codes or other billing information. Workers are fighting for an 18.5% pay increase over 3 years; a \$2500 professional development allowance and better incentives for regional and remote work [https://substack.com/redirect/d36efec8-5b8c-4a4d-a927-6517320d8439?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CPSU NT - Corrections facility managers

After 201 days of unsuccessful negotiations, corrections facility managers in Darwin, Berrimah, Alice Springs and the Barkly and Datjala work camps commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/c67d68ce-f1c4-46e6-a534-b620ae64e506?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 8 September. CPSU members voted to participate in work stoppages, banning on-call work and a range of other actions. There are a number of issues in the dispute, including the Corrections Commissioner requesting a 24-hour roster and certain entitlements being made contingent on a 24-hour roster being accepted. The CPSU is also concerned that there is no "substantive" increase to base pay, with the Department instead offering an increase to an embedded overtime allowance. Workers are also concerned about privatisation, changes in the broader public service and over-crowding in the prison system.

AWU/CFMEU/TWU/The Services Union QLD - Southern Downs Regional Council

Last Thursday (11/9), union members at Southern Downs Regional Council went on strike for the first time in 40 years. Approximately 200 workers walked off the job and rallied in Warwick and Stanthorpe. After months of negotiations, the Council's offer is a disappointing 11.5% wage increase over 3 years, with the first pay rise from February 2026 for outdoor staff. Workers are also not happy with the Councils' proposals to extend ordinary working hours to Sundays "by agreement" with individual workers and also introducing maximum term employment into the agreement. Yesterday evening (16/9), The Services Union reported that an improved offer had been received [https://substack.com/redirect/7da1d9e1-7d49-4eea-853b-1afb139d7c4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which would include a 15% pay increase over 3 years with back pay to 1 July 2025; increased paid parental leave and the protection of Sundays. TSU members have until Thursday 5pm to vote on this offer. I am unsure what is happening

with AWU, CFMEU and TWU members.

HACSU Tasmania - Ambulance Tasmania

HACSU members at Ambulance Tasmania have commenced industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/6122a711-1c66-4717-b5e4-2394cbeb8e50?](https://substack.com/redirect/6122a711-1c66-4717-b5e4-2394cbeb8e50?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6122a711-1c66-4717-b5e4-2394cbeb8e50?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] after the state government reneged on paying back pay to specialist paramedics. Specialists include community paramedics; police ambulance clinician early response and secondary triage paramedics who took on extra responsibilities for years without additional pay. In April, an agreement was made with the government to start paying these workers appropriately, and to provide backpay, but according to the union the state government has backflipped [[https://substack.com/redirect/9e76de53-6ee7-4b1c-bd4f-c2b70d53c3a1?](https://substack.com/redirect/9e76de53-6ee7-4b1c-bd4f-c2b70d53c3a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9e76de53-6ee7-4b1c-bd4f-c2b70d53c3a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Members' industrial action is a ban on taking part in the rollout of any expansion of integrated care activities, including rolling out community paramedics in rural areas. The HACSU Executive also passed a resolution committing to the same ban for the union as a whole.

AEU Victoria - Early childhood educators

Over 1200 kindergarten teachers walked off the job for 24 hours [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d95d98f6-c56e-409f-b373-abee634115a7?](https://substack.com/redirect/d95d98f6-c56e-409f-b373-abee634115a7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d95d98f6-c56e-409f-b373-abee634115a7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] yesterday (16/9). Kinder teachers are fighting for a 35% wage increase to make salaries competitive with school staff, and improved conditions to address workload and burdensome administrative requirements. After 15 months of negotiations, the state government has failed to even make the educators an offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/3ecdabc5-7fb9-40ec-a287-ed1eaa3352bd?](https://substack.com/redirect/3ecdabc5-7fb9-40ec-a287-ed1eaa3352bd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3ecdabc5-7fb9-40ec-a287-ed1eaa3352bd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The teachers have endorsed more stopwork actions and work bans if necessary, and threatened to include bans on transition statements for kids finishing kinder.

ETU/MUA WA - CBH

I missed this last week, but at a conciliation conference at the FWC on 5/9, CBH, the ETU and the MUA all agreed to a "two week cooling off period" [[https://substack.com/redirect/04a5ca42-8dcd-4731-9ab5-e9b9fbe7c7d4?](https://substack.com/redirect/04a5ca42-8dcd-4731-9ab5-e9b9fbe7c7d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/04a5ca42-8dcd-4731-9ab5-e9b9fbe7c7d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The lockout of workers at the Kwinana Grain Terminal ended at 7am on Saturday 6 September, and the unions will not participate in any industrial action during the cooling off period. It is understood bargaining is still ongoing, but whether there has been any movement between the two sides demands remains to be seen. CBH's most recent offer was annual wage increases of 2.5%, with the unions aiming for 6% [

[https://substack.com/redirect/f15d6a24-71e7-4b79-b3df-5e1618c65649?](https://substack.com/redirect/f15d6a24-71e7-4b79-b3df-5e1618c65649?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f15d6a24-71e7-4b79-b3df-5e1618c65649?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

HACSU Victoria - Forensicare

HACSU members at Forensicare are still fighting for a fair deal. They are holding a stop work action on Thursday (18/9) at T. H. Westfield Reserve (Cnr Yarra Bend and Heidelberg Roads in Clifton Hill) from 1pm - 3pm. Get along to support public sector forensic mental health workers.

ASMOF NSW - Public sector doctors

The NSW Government's interim pay offer to doctors in public hospitals has been rejected [

[https://substack.com/redirect/dd18791b-8693-4bb1-bc2b-c2fc26c6462d?](https://substack.com/redirect/dd18791b-8693-4bb1-bc2b-c2fc26c6462d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/dd18791b-8693-4bb1-bc2b-c2fc26c6462d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. 6000 doctors participated in the ballot, with 75% voting no. The offer was for 3% annual pay increases for two years - a 3% increase backdated to 1 July 2024, and a 3% increase backdated to 1 July 2025. The offer however, was conditional on the union guaranteeing to not take any industrial action while their broader Award matter is in the IRC. ASMOF did not advocate members vote one way or the other, instead urging members to just vote and providing arguments for both the yes [

[https://substack.com/redirect/7f9dc527-f081-46c2-a849-da2047d480b0?](https://substack.com/redirect/7f9dc527-f081-46c2-a849-da2047d480b0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7f9dc527-f081-46c2-a849-da2047d480b0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] and no [

[https://substack.com/redirect/6383a71c-500e-4d16-8c93-af6979f1fb66?](https://substack.com/redirect/6383a71c-500e-4d16-8c93-af6979f1fb66?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6383a71c-500e-4d16-8c93-af6979f1fb66?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] cases. The union has committed to meeting with members and delegates to work out the next steps in their campaign. The arbitration case to "expose the Government's failure to value doctors and address systemic workforce shortages properly" [[https://substack.com/redirect/dd18791b-8693-4bb1-bc2b-c2fc26c6462d?](https://substack.com/redirect/dd18791b-8693-4bb1-bc2b-c2fc26c6462d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/dd18791b-8693-4bb1-bc2b-c2fc26c6462d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] continues.

ETU NSW - Schindler

The dispute at Schindler continues with workers racking up 11 consecutive days on strike today.

Workers continue to fight for job security, parity with interstate colleagues and respect. The union is running a no campaign on a proposed agreement put forward by management.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer Hunter

Bus drivers in Newcastle will hold a four hour stopwork meeting [

[https://substack.com/redirect/91f8f716-2355-4d34-b5db-1977341a44ea?](https://substack.com/redirect/91f8f716-2355-4d34-b5db-1977341a44ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/91f8f716-2355-4d34-b5db-1977341a44ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on Monday (22/9) to decide on the next steps in their EBA campaign. RTBU President Peter Grech told the media that the first protected

action ballot order has been extended, and that a stoppage or strike is likely in the coming weeks [[https://substack.com/redirect/f21232bd-be66-431f-8025-ccfa6333aff0?](https://substack.com/redirect/f21232bd-be66-431f-8025-ccfa6333aff0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f21232bd-be66-431f-8025-ccfa6333aff0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Grech also noted that opal card readers had already been switched off. Workers are fighting for a new EBA with a decent pay increase to keep up with the cost of living as well as 72 hours' notice for shift changes. Bus drivers have previously struck for 24 hours in April; implemented work bans in June; and disabled opal card readers.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU QLD - Queensland Government

The dispute between direct hire tradesmen and the Queensland Government continues. On Thursday (11/9), ETU State Secretary Peter Ong called for the sacking of the Queensland Transport Minister [[https://substack.com/redirect/76191264-3095-4351-a665-f61c0380e7ab?](https://substack.com/redirect/76191264-3095-4351-a665-f61c0380e7ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/76191264-3095-4351-a665-f61c0380e7ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] over safety failures resulting from the use of contract labour during protected industrial action. Stoppages continued throughout the week with the ETU sharing photos from the Department of Transport and Major Roads [[https://substack.com/redirect/da2ef5aa-27c4-46de-ab16-e2fcc1893ddc?](https://substack.com/redirect/da2ef5aa-27c4-46de-ab16-e2fcc1893ddc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/da2ef5aa-27c4-46de-ab16-e2fcc1893ddc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]; QBuild [[https://substack.com/redirect/85609944-348e-4526-a3bd-4107b9781a76?](https://substack.com/redirect/85609944-348e-4526-a3bd-4107b9781a76?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/85609944-348e-4526-a3bd-4107b9781a76?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and RoadTek [[https://substack.com/redirect/460e8750-90a2-4a3a-be0d-c28a6f69ba2a?](https://substack.com/redirect/460e8750-90a2-4a3a-be0d-c28a6f69ba2a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/460e8750-90a2-4a3a-be0d-c28a6f69ba2a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

AWU Vic - Alcoa

I first reported on the Alcoa smelter in Portland back on 6 August [

[https://substack.com/redirect/69452c36-252e-4dc8-b272-091e9fcc0815?](https://substack.com/redirect/69452c36-252e-4dc8-b272-091e9fcc0815?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/69452c36-252e-4dc8-b272-091e9fcc0815?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] when industrial action seemed imminent. On Monday the Fair Work Commission dismissed an application by Alcoa to suspend industrial action. The AWU had notified of plans for regular six hour stoppages on the night shift and two full day stoppages. Alcoa claimed that this would cause substantial disruption to an important part of the Australian economy; the commission rejected this [[https://substack.com/redirect/3a4a8587-1b20-45ec-947c-5243a15cc86a?](https://substack.com/redirect/3a4a8587-1b20-45ec-947c-5243a15cc86a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3a4a8587-1b20-45ec-947c-5243a15cc86a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The AWU reports [[https://substack.com/redirect/9e330aec-a765-4abf-85c7-363222a332b3?](https://substack.com/redirect/9e330aec-a765-4abf-85c7-363222a332b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9e330aec-a765-4abf-85c7-363222a332b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] that industrial action will

continue as negotiations remain deadlocked.

HACSU Tasmania - RHH

Environmental Services workers (cleaners) at the Royal Hobart Hospital stopped work for an hour on Monday (15/9) in an escalation of their long fight to be paid an appropriate allowance for training new staff. Management continues to disrespect workers by referring to training on infection control, safety procedures and standards as "buddying". Whatever the government tries to call it, in addition to the stop work action, workers have implemented a ban on all forms of "buddying" or training until they are paid the proper allowance.

UWU Tasmania - Education Facility Attendants

Kitchen workers, cleaners and maintenance staff in Tasmanian government schools are taking strike action today. Fourteen public schools are expected to close as United Workers Union members demand action on workload. UWU organiser Amy Brumby told ABC Hobart [

[https://substack.com/redirect/254b0b4b-850d-41f0-8179-82eaaccc168d?](https://substack.com/redirect/254b0b4b-850d-41f0-8179-82eaaccc168d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/254b0b4b-850d-41f0-8179-82eaaccc168d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] that the Education Facility Attendants agreement expired three years ago and that staff wanted action on workload and additional resources to keep schools safe and clean.

TWU QLD - DHL Express

Last week [[https://substack.com/redirect/80d76495-20e9-4025-a6f6-620c0a556b7f?](https://substack.com/redirect/80d76495-20e9-4025-a6f6-620c0a556b7f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/80d76495-20e9-4025-a6f6-620c0a556b7f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] I reported on the bosses at DHL Express at Brisbane Airport sending workers home without pay for wearing union campaign badges on the job. According to a TWU Facebook post, [[https://substack.com/redirect/3511095d-ef26-4af9-8df5-dcdc0553f811?](https://substack.com/redirect/3511095d-ef26-4af9-8df5-dcdc0553f811?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3511095d-ef26-4af9-8df5-dcdc0553f811?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] the union took this to the FWC and it has been recommended that workers be paid their lost wages. The broader dispute around the workers EBA is yet to be resolved, but we'll take some interim good news!

TWU NT - CDC

Bus drivers working for CDC in the Northern Territory have commenced industrial action this week [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d2aebbcf-d6ba-4ec1-8a87-34a5d25b27fe?](https://substack.com/redirect/d2aebbcf-d6ba-4ec1-8a87-34a5d25b27fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d2aebbcf-d6ba-4ec1-8a87-34a5d25b27fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Bus drivers are seeking improved wages and conditions, as well as improvements in safety [[https://substack.com/redirect/71e243e6-9507-45c0-920b-59c3fcddf709?](https://substack.com/redirect/71e243e6-9507-45c0-920b-59c3fcddf709?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/71e243e6-9507-45c0-920b-59c3fcddf709?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Industrial action includes displaying posters in buses as well as wearing union campaign hi-vis vests. The TWU has been in negotiations for months, but CDC have failed to bring conditions in line with industry standards.

UFU SA - SA firefighters

Firies in SA moved to Stage 3 of industrial action on Monday (15/9). I don't understand most of their bans as they appear to be quite technical, but you can read all the detail [[https://substack.com/redirect/c7a5d2b1-b34d-41ab-93b8-4d4084dd4903?](https://substack.com/redirect/c7a5d2b1-b34d-41ab-93b8-4d4084dd4903?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c7a5d2b1-b34d-41ab-93b8-4d4084dd4903?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on the UFU website. Worth noting that SA firefighters literally saved some cute ducklings [https://substack.com/redirect/e3415802-ae06-42be-bfb8-8fcf1c5df812?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last week so it is definitely time for the state government to come to the table with a decent deal!

UWU SA - Public sector health support workers

UWU members who work as health support workers and disability support officers rallied outside Premier Peter Malinauskas' office yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/506ed1dd-9de5-4622-840d-392de8a0a9b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (16/9). Workers have rejected the state government's most recent offer and are demanding an offer that brings immediate improvement to wages [[https://substack.com/redirect/5ef3c674-79c2-45a8-9faf-68f306681618?](https://substack.com/redirect/5ef3c674-79c2-45a8-9faf-68f306681618?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5ef3c674-79c2-45a8-9faf-68f306681618?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Workers are fighting for a fair deal to ensure cost of living relief; parity with workers in other states; and appropriate penalty rates and allowances.

UWU WA - DBCA

Park Rangers in WA (employed by the Department of Biodiversity, Conservation and Attractions) have been in negotiations for a fair deal for 18 months. As negotiations drag on, UWU members are taking industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/bbef8532-1fa0-4dc3-89d3-6369d86fc4fa?](https://substack.com/redirect/bbef8532-1fa0-4dc3-89d3-6369d86fc4fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/bbef8532-1fa0-4dc3-89d3-6369d86fc4fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. While they will continue working, they will refuse to collect fees until the government comes to the table with a decent offer. AWU members who are employed as firefighters by DBCA participated in industrial action back in May [[https://substack.com/redirect/c7aa5615-d5d8-4333-a081-fe1984b4abc5?](https://substack.com/redirect/c7aa5615-d5d8-4333-a081-fe1984b4abc5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c7aa5615-d5d8-4333-a081-fe1984b4abc5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] in pursuit of a better deal - but I am uncertain on the outcome of that dispute. Any readers from DBCA or WA who might have more info on either dispute- please get in touch!

The Services Union - Scenic Rim Regional Council

The Services Union has endorsed an improved offer [https://substack.com/redirect/3437351f-3dea-48fa-bf1a-245dee175ea0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from Scenic Rim Regional Council. The offer includes [https://substack.com/redirect/4697cfd4-7573-45ae-a9b1-2a91f122dd98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] a 5% increase this year (backdated to 30 June) followed by 4% increases in 2026 and 2027. The offer also includes improved paid parental and natural disaster and extreme weather leave. TSU members commenced industrial action in July when the Council was refusing to budge from 4% annual increases with no backpay. The final agreement will now be drafted before a final ballot of workers.

AWU NSW - Snowy 2.0

Tunnelling workers on the Snowy 2.0 project have voted up a new agreement [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2314b5ce-1b9e-4a3a-a09b-5c105f740313?](https://substack.com/redirect/2314b5ce-1b9e-4a3a-a09b-5c105f740313?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2314b5ce-1b9e-4a3a-a09b-5c105f740313?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Workers will receive an immediate 8.5% wage increase followed by increases of 2.25% every six months from January 2026 through to 2029. The agreement also includes increased shift penalties and allowances. Workers on the project participated in industrial action including 24 hour strikes in May and June. The aim had been to win pay parity with tunnelling workers in Melbourne as well as improved allowances and conditions. AWU NSW State Secretary Tony Callinan told the media that "you would be splitting hairs to say people in Melbourne are now getting more than people at Snowy."

CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU QLD - CPB/UGL

On Friday (12/9), the Queensland Industrial Relations Commission recommended that UGL ensure affected areas of the Cross River Rail Woolloongabba site are swabbed and clean of all asbestos and is safe for workers to return to work [[https://substack.com/redirect/391a8d9d-e01e-45e5-92bb-0894b49b1914?](https://substack.com/redirect/391a8d9d-e01e-45e5-92bb-0894b49b1914?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/391a8d9d-e01e-45e5-92bb-0894b49b1914?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The ETU was forced to issue a notice of a WHS dispute in relation to the suspected presence of asbestos dust after workers spent weeks attempting to resolve the issue on site, ultimately refusing to work in the suspect areas.

Bosses refused to do appropriate testing and continued to refute members' concerns. [

[https://substack.com/redirect/fd1befc8-5c46-4f58-b949-535ced7c4eec?](https://substack.com/redirect/fd1befc8-5c46-4f58-b949-535ced7c4eec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fd1befc8-5c46-4f58-b949-535ced7c4eec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] The regulator also failed to take the issue seriously. This serves as an important reminder that even with something as deadly as asbestos, workers cannot rely on bosses and regulators to do the right thing. The only way to protect ourselves at work is by organising together.

That's all I've got for you this week. There was a noticeable flurry of new subscribers to Disputes Report over the weekend, and I haven't quite worked out what prompted it! If it's your first week here reading the report - welcome! If there's a dispute kicking off in your neck of the woods, or if you can shed any light on where the extra subscribers came from - please leave a comment below!

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWNoaW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVn1YMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UY3p0e1EzTmpZekxDSnBZWFpT2pFM05UZ3d0VGt3TURFc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE9UVTVOVEF3TVN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuUk11YUJXUHNWeHJNaV9kZUtQS2I2dUZuLUZZa3BfcHh0RlFRVWdTdXlpRSIsInAiOje3Mzc0NzY2MywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc1ODAxOTAwMSwiZXhwIjoyMDczNjM1MDAxLCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.2xs5GZ16pw51JepfJ3QcmaJl7EzQCZtA5JntAyM8pCk?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-18-february>

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses & midwives

On 4 February, the ANMF rejected a fourth offer [https://substack.com/redirect/2aea0aeb-1b9a-43b0-80d3-e963632dce9f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the state government. The offer included a pay increase of 10.75% over 3 years. The next day (5/2), nurses and midwives went ahead with their planned mass stopwork rally [https://substack.com/redirect/2be4cc5b-3566-49e4-8ab6-143da6963c39?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in Adelaide. The ANMF has now endorsed a “staged and sustainable site-based engagement process for the implementation of heightened Industrial Action [https://substack.com/redirect/b652637c-26a4-43c3-95b7-83a0da36e1b0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]”. First cab off the rank is a 24 hour stoppage tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/f6eb4585-3b17-4aa5-a599-cbcfd69a1263?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (19/2) at the Lyell McEwin Hospital.

NTEU WA - Curtin University

NTEU members at Curtin University are set to commence industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/1523aa47-f713-4ce9-815b-bc7835d3b216?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] when the semester starts next week on 23 February. Workers will stay home on certain days of the week and run lectures and tutorials online. Negotiations for a new EBA commenced in July last year, but no meaningful progress has been made. Key issues in the dispute are unsustainable workloads; wages; and limitation on work-from-home. Workers have demanded a 20% wage increase over 4 years as well as action on workloads and improved job security. NTEU members held a stop work action and rally in November last year.

HWU Victoria - Public sector healthcare workers

HWU members in the public sector are set to strike today (18/2). Workers will be rallying outside the new Footscray Hospital from 11am this morning [https://substack.com/redirect/0df68978-ffc7-40f9-a14c-3bb8f95aa3f0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of their industrial campaign for a fair deal from the Allan government. Get along and support HWU members today if you can! In addition to the strike today, workers are walking off the job for 20 minutes each day [https://substack.com/redirect/a1fc4c72-70c7-4dc1-a9ad-f6c64e63da59?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as well as participating in other work bans. According to a report in The Australian last week, senior government officials have “canvassed the option” [https://substack.com/redirect/bb0b33a0-fca1-40c4-b261-5a8709cb6a2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of the Victorian Hospital Industrial Association applying to the FWC to attempt to suspend industrial action on the basis that it is harming the community.

HACSU Tasmania - Ashley Youth Detention Centre

On 4 February, just one day after strike action at the Ashley Youth Detention Centre, an incident occurred at the centre [https://substack.com/redirect/0810c8b5-6040-4abc-8fa8-349cbeef092a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with emergency services responding to a fire, two workers injured and two young people taken into custody. According to HACSU, the facility was short staffed and management did not follow short-staffing protocols. HACSU has implored the government to listen to their concerns about safety for both workers and young people at the facility, and have not ruled out further industrial action

RTBU NSW - Aurizon Coal

RTBU members at Aurizon Coal in Newcastle, Wollongong, Muswellbrook and Quirindi have commenced a range of work bans in their fight for a decent EA. The RTBU has been in negotiations for over 9 months. After a strong protected action ballot result, workers have implemented a range of actions including bans on using personal devices for work; data entry; weekend overtime and fuelling work cars. Workers are seeking a 20% wage increase in the first year, and 5% in the second to keep up with the cost of living, as their last agreement had below inflation level increases. Workers are also fighting for improved access to annual leave and protections against casualisation, automation and AI.

UWU QLD - Queensland Health

On Friday (13/2), over 200 medical imaging workers walked off the job for 2 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/96a68f77-165c-4bf0-8125-fa0507fb1d76?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The UWU members are spread across 14 hospitals and resorted to strike action after negotiations with Queensland Health stalled. UWU has been in negotiations for months, but Queensland Health has refused to accept or negotiate any items on the log of claims. UWU members across Queensland Health have taken 120 days of rolling industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/cbbfe31d-b2b8-4905-9e84-1a6e6195a7fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

HACSU Tasmania - Royal Hobart Hospital

On 5 February, HACSU members in environmental services walked off the job for 1 hour [https://substack.com/redirect/b722c806-0cfb-41f0-8ee5-253abf751d8f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers were demonstrating their frustration with the bosses' decision to include another middle management position that will undertake work already completed by supervisors. HACSU members see this as a waste of hospital funding, and it would be better spent on more permanent cleaner positions. I feel this is probably deeply relatable to many workers who wonder what many middle managers do all day, and just wish they would let us get on with the job!

HACSU Tasmania - Public sector healthcare workers

More broadly for HACSU members in the public sector it has been a busy week! On Monday (16/2), phase 3 industrial action by HACSU members commenced. This included 127 workplace bans [https://substack.com/redirect/a9108c3b-91b1-4a56-b3cc-1e747d244d8a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] targeting the Department of Health and the state government - mostly geared to hit revenue. On Monday afternoon a letter was sent to HACSU by the government offering a week of "insense" negotiations and indicating they were looking at a comparable offer to what the Tasmanian police received last year. A meeting of HACSU delegates on Monday, endorsed suspending industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/3901db8d-dee6-4e5a-b11b-9adcc9fd4cad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and for the union to participate in the negotiations.

MUA - Carnival

More concerning reports emerged from the MUA over the last week about Carnival cruise ships on the coast of Australia. Whistleblowers on a Carnival ship contacted the MUA alleging [https://substack.com/redirect/112c3b65-f9df-4584-8e40-7c4a8bb482b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] unsafe drinking water, company doctors forcing crew to work whilst sick and cases of skin infections in cramped quarters. Officials from the Australian Maritime Safety Authority (AMSA) boarded a ship in Darwin to complete inspections [https://substack.com/redirect/f0dfd0b7-0dc4-473d-afe9-414d83aa45da?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] following the reports. While Carnival said AMSA found no deficiencies [https://substack.com/redirect/47c83aa7-59aa-4978-8e05-49853b0a8474?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], it has been pointed out to me that perhaps that is because while the drinking water is gross, it probably won't kill workers - so more of an issue with the minimum acceptable standards than the crew enjoying safe and comfortable working conditions. Definitely expect more to come on this campaign.

IEU Victoria - Catholic schools' teachers

Something fishy is going on at the Victorian Catholic Education Authority. Last year, the IEU collected over 19,000 signed statements of support [https://substack.com/redirect/05546e53-c980-4e62-b184-9100d219877a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from teachers across the Catholic system in Victoria. This means those teachers are in favour of a Single Interest Authorisation - allowing teachers in the Catholic system to bargain collectively as if they were employed by a single employer, rather than by school or parish. 19,000 signed statements of support should be a clear majority of the estimated 32,000 - 35,000 employees understood to be in the Catholic system in Victoria. But the VCEA is disputing this saying the correct number of workers in the system is 45,000, and so 19,000 is not a majority. According to The Age [https://substack.com/redirect/220ed201-239f-4f75-a835-f5f372112712?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], as recently as a week ago the VCEA's own website stated its workforce was 32,500 workers. So is it bad maths, or bad faith?

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

The AEU has thrown down the gauntlet [https://substack.com/redirect/c37b25e8-8126-44c8-8824-91f3d361f928?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. On Friday (13/2), the union's Victorian branch council passed a resolution that declares that "upon successful completion of the protected action ballot, a 24 hour statewide stop work of teacher, paraprofessional, education support, assistant principal, and principal members will be held on Tuesday 24 March 2026." There is of course the usual proviso that this strike will only happen if the Allan government doesn't put forward a "fair and decent deal [https://substack.com/redirect/26e08c96-6ae1-4152-86c8-4a9cb0f47c4d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]". The union has reported an extra 1500 members have joined the union [https://substack.com/redirect/70ac77f8-6265-4a25-8064-88fa18818420?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in January, and there's still time for teachers to join and participate in the protected action.

In short

ETU NSW - Dynelec

ETU members at Dynelec have now been on strike for 3 weeks [https://substack.com/redirect/b21d6a33-a113-40c4-a5a0-90b997cfc4ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for an 18% wage increase over 3 years. Dynelec initially offered 11.5%, but then dropped that back to 10.5%. On 5 February, the ETU reported that members at Dynelec had voted down

the bosses proposed new agreement for a second time. 86% voted no [https://substack.com/redirect/fe2f226f-2433-4c45-a59a-9b00b72c9a4d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

AWU - Skydive Australia

Skydivers struck again on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/7f9b7e4a-683d-49a1-8453-60093f56c7c3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (13/2). According to the AWU, bosses abandoned negotiations last week. The union has been negotiating on behalf of members for over a year [https://substack.com/redirect/907c8c66-b16b-41ba-bb80-8dbb123f793a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and management still refuses to put forward a decent offer.

USU - Blacktown City Council

On 11 February, USU members at Blacktown City Council held a 24 hour strike. According to the Daily Telegraph, a council spokesperson said the strike was in response to “new security measures installed this week at the Rooty Hill Council depot.” [https://substack.com/redirect/cc8419fa-7456-44b2-b8f9-095884adeeea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] I reached out to the USU to clarify this but haven’t heard back. The industrial action was anticipated to impact [https://substack.com/redirect/5ca9a01a-8d31-49d6-8d31-174b5c561dee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] park maintenance and mowing;

cleaning and waste services; some civil maintenance works; bin collections and close two splash parks.

UWU Victoria - Crown Casino

UWU members at Crown Casino have gone on strike twice in the last week. The first 24 hour stoppage was on Valentine’s Day (14/2) and a second 24 hour stoppage took place yesterday (17/2) to coincide with Chinese New Year. Workers are fighting against Crown’s attempts to introduce a two-tiered wage system. UWU members are fighting for a fair agreement that respects workers. UWU members have not ruled out escalating industrial action.

The Services Union - Urban Utilities

Negotiations between The Services Union and Urban Utilities have broken down [https://substack.com/redirect/fa9b39de-aa29-4177-ae43-7feb1266efec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and industrial action commenced yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/0247e680-0cee-4a80-b4e9-18a0c0c06e2e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (17/2). The industrial action

includes rolling one-hour stoppages for the rest of the week; an indefinite ban on overtime; and a 30 day ban on training, supervision and collaboration with contractors. Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal to keep up with the cost of living, and to achieve parity with workers at Brisbane City Council - the largest shareholder of Urban Utilities.

Wins/resolutions

CEPU/RTBU Tasmania - TasRail

On 4 February unions came to an in-principle agreement with TasRail. The proposed agreement includes a 16.25% wage increase over 3.7 years; improvements to the classification structure; recognition of a 4-day week; an increase of paid family and domestic violence leave to 20 days and paid parental leave “finally” recognised in the EBA. Workers had been in negotiations with TasRail for 9 months. Earlier media reports suggested unions had been aiming for wage increases of 31% over 3 years [https://substack.com/redirect/c1ee2bf1-2bd6-4b75-aa54-8c5444431744?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. I am not familiar with the agreement, so am unsure if there were other improvements that counteracted less than hoped for wage increases.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU WA - Ventia/BP

Last Wednesday (11/2), AMWU, CFMEU and ETU members at the Ventia run BP refinery in Kwinana commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/03ca4a17-45ff-49fd-9415-d8a283ec94d5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. After months of negotiations, Ventia made a frankly bonkers decision and asked maintenance crews to identify cost savings in their work areas [https://substack.com/redirect/2100f28e-c3fb-4248-bdcd-27918bcc720f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to cover the cost of a wage increase. Worth pointing out that in 2024, Ventia’s profit was \$227.9 million [https://substack.com/redirect/449c1c82-2c56-412b-bc8a-39b411e439d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. No wonder workers upped the ante and walked off the job. I have heard a whisper that the industrial action may have been successful in getting Ventia to meet all of the workers demands, but nothing publicly released as yet. Will keep an eye on the FWC Agreements in Progress.

AMWU/CEPU Tasmania - Cascade

The CEPU reported a win at Cascade Brewery on 4 February, and I assume AMWU members have come to the same agreement. A social media post sums up the win as “Same Pay, Less Work, More Beer”. Workers have won 12 extra RDOs a year with no pay cut; and the carton allowance has been increased from one a fortnight to one a week. Looking at the proposed agreement on the FWC website [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a8180825-9df2-44be-b3a4-30e4b61eb225?](https://substack.com/redirect/a8180825-9df2-44be-b3a4-30e4b61eb225?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a8180825-9df2-44be-b3a4-30e4b61eb225?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)], workers will also receive 4% wage increases on 1 July in 2026 and 2027. CFMEU members at the brewery had also been in dispute and participating in industrial action - it is not clear to me if they are covered by this in-principle agreement; or if they are still in dispute. I am INCREDIBLY EAGER to get my hands on one of those iconic Same Pay, Less Work, More Beer shirts produced to commemorate the dispute. If any Tassie readers can hook me up - please get in touch!

PSA SA - Public sector workers

77.6% of respondents [[https://substack.com/redirect/990e8706-1dc3-4934-b44c-54086666282a?](https://substack.com/redirect/990e8706-1dc3-4934-b44c-54086666282a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/990e8706-1dc3-4934-b44c-54086666282a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] voted in favour of the proposed new 2026 Salaried Enterprise Agreement. The short 18-month agreement gets workers a 10.8% cumulative wage increase [[https://substack.com/redirect/1776cd45-8b92-4b53-a0ca-6b011d1ed406?](https://substack.com/redirect/1776cd45-8b92-4b53-a0ca-6b011d1ed406?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1776cd45-8b92-4b53-a0ca-6b011d1ed406?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] with backpay to August.

Negotiations for the next agreement will start in July [[https://substack.com/redirect/f6dd6874-d990-4ea6-ada9-890d572d64e2?](https://substack.com/redirect/f6dd6874-d990-4ea6-ada9-890d572d64e2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f6dd6874-d990-4ea6-ada9-890d572d64e2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] when the still new leadership of the PSA hope to build on this result.

A quick correction, and an update

In my last report, I incorrectly reported that a Facebook page called “Workers First Collective [[https://substack.com/redirect/d0e02792-85ef-4b59-8187-2db7cbc0ee62?](https://substack.com/redirect/d0e02792-85ef-4b59-8187-2db7cbc0ee62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d0e02792-85ef-4b59-8187-2db7cbc0ee62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]” was an official UUU election ticket led by current National President Jo-Anne Schofield. Workplace Express subsequently confirmed [[https://substack.com/redirect/1e07a157-d406-4f6f-9bcd-0f4199eb73b2?](https://substack.com/redirect/1e07a157-d406-4f6f-9bcd-0f4199eb73b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1e07a157-d406-4f6f-9bcd-0f4199eb73b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] that Schofield is not affiliated with that page, although it is supportive of her. As I was writing this correction, a reader sent through a link to what does appear to be the official second ticket in the UUU elections. “United For You [[https://substack.com/redirect/0b4cf134-3dd1-4c5d-99e2-ca16346d7b6c?](https://substack.com/redirect/0b4cf134-3dd1-4c5d-99e2-ca16346d7b6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0b4cf134-3dd1-4c5d-99e2-ca16346d7b6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]” describes itself as a “team of UUU delegates, activists and members”. Their platform includes 6 major points: more organisers with a plan to win; improved advice, representation and support; stronger delegates, stronger members; a respected member voice; no membership fee increases; and a union that wins. The ticket is headed by Jo Schofield, and includes ALP powerbroker Gary Bullock (UUU’s “Director of Finances & Political Power”), and UUU Early Childhood Education Director Carolyn Smith amongst others. Since my last report, Members First [[https://substack.com/redirect/86aba5a0-c2eb-4937-a97e-6e482c6f31b4?](https://substack.com/redirect/86aba5a0-c2eb-4937-a97e-6e482c6f31b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/86aba5a0-c2eb-4937-a97e-6e482c6f31b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] (the other election ticket) have held their campaign launches in Melbourne, Brisbane and Adelaide. For a glimpse into the launches, you can read Members First’s candidate Caterina Cinnani’s speech from the Melbourne launch [[https://substack.com/redirect/050d1b72-9f99-4ac0-97fd-b8861f693435?](https://substack.com/redirect/050d1b72-9f99-4ac0-97fd-b8861f693435?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/050d1b72-9f99-4ac0-97fd-b8861f693435?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)].

That’s all I’ve got this week. But I do want to put on the record how disgusted I was by the blatant police brutality [[https://substack.com/redirect/dd7b084b-41f1-4f44-9c30-13f6951d32d8?](https://substack.com/redirect/dd7b084b-41f1-4f44-9c30-13f6951d32d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/dd7b084b-41f1-4f44-9c30-13f6951d32d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] inflicted by the state upon protestors last week in Sydney. The actions of the police have been called out by several unions including the NSW NMA [[https://substack.com/redirect/a18da3d9-575b-4590-a623-08887870cc45?](https://substack.com/redirect/a18da3d9-575b-4590-a623-08887870cc45?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a18da3d9-575b-4590-a623-08887870cc45?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)], the MUA [[https://substack.com/redirect/fd8aaec3-01a0-4715-8d0b-26690e42df51?](https://substack.com/redirect/fd8aaec3-01a0-4715-8d0b-26690e42df51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fd8aaec3-01a0-4715-8d0b-26690e42df51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)], and the ASU [[https://substack.com/redirect/e3e870a6-e4d3-4a6f-9ac1-7b4831d10863?](https://substack.com/redirect/e3e870a6-e4d3-4a6f-9ac1-7b4831d10863?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e3e870a6-e4d3-4a6f-9ac1-7b4831d10863?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. I particularly appreciated this video [[https://substack.com/redirect/7753cca6-45c9-4183-b45d-597a41995438?](https://substack.com/redirect/7753cca6-45c9-4183-b45d-597a41995438?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7753cca6-45c9-4183-b45d-597a41995438?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] from MUA Veteran Bobby Lee. In 2020, I wrote a short piece cataloguing some examples of police violence against workers in disputes [[https://substack.com/redirect/3f257b62-bc9a-4cc2-80a6-e2daadd549b2?](https://substack.com/redirect/3f257b62-bc9a-4cc2-80a6-e2daadd549b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3f257b62-bc9a-4cc2-80a6-e2daadd549b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] from the 1890s to the 2010s which may be of interest. But the article I want to leave you with this week is from History in the Streets [[https://substack.com/redirect/191b18a4-650f-4e3a-9157-f8fe48f80da3?](https://substack.com/redirect/191b18a4-650f-4e3a-9157-f8fe48f80da3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/191b18a4-650f-4e3a-9157-f8fe48f80da3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. The author, Tim, was at the demonstration in Sydney on 9 February, and shares some historical examples of police violence, but more importantly how we can organise and fight back [[https://substack.com/redirect/52e285ad-620a-4cb6-8465-00c8b137f672?](https://substack.com/redirect/52e285ad-620a-4cb6-8465-00c8b137f672?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/52e285ad-620a-4cb6-8465-00c8b137f672?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. He writes: “We Can Win. The history of struggle shows innumerable cases where people have stood up, fought back, organised despite and against police repression. Energy, courage and determination can do incredible things.”

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UZzRNa1EwTVRZMUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056RXpOakF5T0RZc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd01qZzV0akk0Tml3aWFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhsWDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuQ00xRXdSa1FtSkR0anRjLWVHV2VqODNEU1Znc2l3WjZxMFBKOWd6WFoyUSIsInAiOjE4ODI0NDE2NSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3MTM2MDI4NiwiZXhwIjoyMDg2OTM2Mjg2LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.vq44tb3T9VGFTIdav83tfmG8U4xAf0hdqR4W0T46HPA?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-18-june>

TWU Vic - CDC/Dysons

Approximately 600 bus drivers at CDC [https://substack.com/redirect/34f812c9-0566-4e4f-926c-2b0600838d62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] took another 24 hours of strike action on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/9b0b2612-6f3f-4656-84c1-f96806d3cf9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (16/6). Originally, it had been planned for drivers at both CDC and Dysons to take 2 days of strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/8c4734c2-d379-407a-ae2e-6db6a7fa735c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. By Wednesday (11/6) it was down to 1 day of industrial action at both companies [https://substack.com/redirect/079b6546-6cbf-4ba4-97c6-0714543583cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. On Friday (13/6) it was reported in Australasian Bus and Coach that a new agreement had been voted up by Dysons drivers [https://substack.com/redirect/c4a0ae55-b642-4dda-a325-e01787c32de4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and as such they would not participate in industrial action. The report claims that it was a close vote with only 51% endorsing the deal, which apparently contains the original pay offer from Dysons of “13 per cent over three years, increases to allowances and a commitment on overtime parity.” It is unclear what the status of CDC negotiations is. Feels like something is going on here - if you're a bus driver with further details, please get in touch!

CRU/ETU NSW - Sydney Trains

On Friday (13/6) the FWC ordered that the in-principle agreement made between the Combined Rail Unions and the state government be put to workers to vote on [https://substack.com/redirect/d28aa887-6674-4436-b5c5-07168c9cb0ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The ETU attempted to block the agreement being put to a vote [https://substack.com/redirect/4cd1f5cc-ef77-4279-8967-c001dd33c52d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] due to being excluded from attending some meetings by the RTBU and more significantly in relation to a claim regarding classification structures. Having been unsuccessful, the in-principle agreement will be voted on by workers in the first week of July. This will most likely bring to an end a long running dispute - the first industrial action took place in September 2024. Workers have won a 12% pay increase over 3 years.

HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

Mental health workers from public hospitals; Forensicare as well as public sector workers from in-patient units, continuing care units, community teams, emergency mental health teams, CATT teams and hospital outreach post-suicide engagement teams participated in a statewide stop work action yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/acabd783-0fc0-4c11-82d8-6cd2f2f93b33?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (17/6). Workers rallied outside Trades Hall in Melbourne before marching to Parliament House. Negotiations for a new agreement commenced in July last year, and industrial action has been underway since February. This is the second, statewide strike. Workers are fighting for a fair deal from the government that ensures all workers in the sector get the pay and conditions that they deserve.

USU/ETU NSW - Riverina Water

USU & ETU members were due to meet last Thursday (12/6) to discuss a “compromise position” [https://substack.com/redirect/9deb0aea-5caa-43fd-b586-86499230ef7d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] from Riverina Water. While the position doesn't resolve the discrepancy of hours workers between indoors and outdoors employees at the agency, it was tentatively accepted by the USU and ETU. The deal would see outdoors workers who currently work 38 hours per week move to a trial of a condensed 4-day working week. The compromise position also delivers an extra 1% wage increase with a total 14% wage increase over 3 years (6%, 4%, 4%). Unions and Riverina Water will head back to the NSW IRC on Friday (20/6) to ascertain next steps.

CFMEU QLD - QUBE

On Friday (13/6), workers voted down the latest offer from QUBE. Workers have been on indefinite strike with a 24/7 picket since 28 May. In addition to putting forward a substandard offer, QUBE has been bringing in labour hire workers to try and break the strike and hiring security guards to block permit holders from carrying out safety inspections [https://substack.com/redirect/60bd52a9-0942-4108-95af-d27ca64d42fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. All round very poor behaviour. What can you expect from a company founded by a grub like Chris Corrigan?

ASU Victoria - Council Multi Employer Bargaining (MEB)

I thought it would be timely for a quick update on the ASU's multi-employer bargaining campaign in the local council sector. [https://substack.com/redirect/c3a2c796-8740-46d6-a0cd-75526ac1e402?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]

For the Metro agreement, where 10 metropolitan EBAs all expire this month: Workers at the City of Melbourne & Maribyrnong have won employer ballots [https://substack.com/redirect/7f6f5022-575f-42cf-8626-50c5d479d7e8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] for MEB Darebin, Brimbank, Yarra and Port Phillip are all at various stages of putting single-employer EBAs to vote in an attempt to avoid MEB. Worryingly, the Brimbank EBA may have been voted up by a slim majority [https://substack.com/redirect/7caeed0a-09ac-492a-9c89-9bef4c0f4d44?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], but that is still to be confirmed.

Greater Dandenong has consented to MEB and Hobsons Bay is “not actively opposing the application” 8 councils (Brimbank, Darebin, Hume, Maribyrnong, Melbourne, Merri-bek, Port Phillip and Yarra) contested the ASU’s FWC application [https://substack.com/redirect/784dcb15-5944-4392-9ced-8b3e2e4f1e30?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], but ultimately the ASU was successful [https://substack.com/redirect/2279467f-e08a-48b8-b01a-10c816399b8b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in clearing the first hurdle at the Commission. The next FWC hearing will be after 4 July when all EBAs have expired.

There is also plenty going on in the regions:

Bargaining is underway [https://substack.com/redirect/0c2ba0fe-5672-4cf3-b9fb-980698d0c778?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] for a multi-employer agreement at Ararat Rural City and Central Goldfields Shire Councils with agreement already reached on the superior redundancy clause, transfer of business entitlements, parental leave and flexible working arrangements.

Workers at Warrnambool, Golden Plains, Horsham, Southern Grampians and Colac Otway all want to pursue multi-employer bargaining [https://substack.com/redirect/0c2ba0fe-5672-4cf3-b9fb-980698d0c778?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and are building support through petitions. The Councils have all refused to get on board with MEB and are commencing single employer bargaining.

Warrnambool City Council are trying to push through a new single-employer EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/92ba4a3b-5a6f-4c22-82bb-29b46859de51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to deny workers the right to participate in MEB. The ASU is running a NO campaign to try and vote down the agreement.

CFMEU Vic - BMS

Crane operators at the Golden Plains Windfarm in Rokewood have been participating in stoppages for two weeks [https://substack.com/redirect/7ed8e00f-371b-46df-894f-e4420ce511a2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The union has been in negotiations with BMS since December for decent pay and industry standard conditions [https://substack.com/redirect/2f73f591-7d28-4d2c-a511-690d748d8935?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

AWU/AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU NSW - Snowy 2.0

Last Wednesday (11/6) workers at Snowy 2.0 walked off the job and also gave notice [https://substack.com/redirect/d8bef4b3-ab18-41fd-af57-700844b597d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] of 5 consecutive 24 hour strikes to start on Monday (16/6). The strikes did not go ahead though, as FWC Deputy President Tony Slevin recommended a “pause” in industrial action for a fortnight [https://substack.com/redirect/66c4705c-ecbf-4a74-afe4-ffb076d1faac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to allow for “intensive bargaining”. Unions agreed to this recommendation. Contractor Webuild was to provide a draft agreement to unions on Friday (13/6) and three days of bargaining were to take place this week. The FWC also recommended that Webuild facilitate paid meeting time for workers to hear a report back on negotiations.

AWU - AMWU/ETU/CFMEU - Pluto 2

It appears there are some industrial tensions brewing at Pluto 2. Pluto Train 2 is the expansion of a second LNG train at the existing Pluto LNG onshore facility near Karratha. According to a “Pluto 2” website [https://substack.com/redirect/84265eba-fc95-4251-9f9c-5b17eb3196a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] claimed to be run by union members, the CFMEU, ETU and AMWU [https://substack.com/redirect/0d0ed7b3-454a-48b9-a761-66932c2fc52b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] first attempted to initiate bargaining on a new agreement in October last year, and then again in March 2025. But then apparently the AWU initiated bargaining and attempted to claim sole coverage of workers on the project. It would appear this has escalated to the AWU under the guise of the Offshore Alliance promising unrealistic wage claims [https://substack.com/redirect/9af0ba7c-002e-4552-9658-67702c45ca8c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in an attempt to win favour on site. Would love to hear from any Pluto 2 workers for their perspectives.

IEU Vic - Strathcona Girls Grammar

Teachers at Strathcona Girls Grammar reached an in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/0a17d757-d710-45ab-bc1a-fdfe00f56319?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-18-march>

QNMU - Mater Hospital

On Thursday (12/3), nurses and midwives at Mater Hospitals in Townsville and Brisbane walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/b3faf75f-ff34-453b-a845-0e4e9be7eed4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for the first time in 13 years. Mater's nurses and midwives are fighting for pay parity [https://substack.com/redirect/f7afefa5-47ce-4040-8c31-db204d152689?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with their colleagues employed by Queensland Health. This has been refused by Mater management, despite the fact Mater recently offered Queensland Health pay parity to their doctors [https://substack.com/redirect/09fc37fb-aca1-4fc7-89a8-d732975a11f4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In addition to the failure to offer pay parity, QNMU members are also disappointed [https://substack.com/redirect/d98208dd-8d19-44a3-ac09-36f225aa1895?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that the offer from Mater is a two year deal (not the three they asked for); does not include nurse to patient ratios; has no paid reproductive leave; and has no commitment to increasing Sunday penalty rates. The QNMU was back at the negotiating table [https://substack.com/redirect/9d88faae-2fde-476b-a245-1b70b315ad4b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with Mater yesterday (17/3).

MEAA - ABC

Crikey has reported [https://substack.com/redirect/06b3e329-b22d-4adc-9d61-3bbfaffa785b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that MEAA members were expected to commence industrial action on Monday (16/3). The first round of actions include workers editing email signatures to include campaign graphics and bans on participating in performance appraisals and completing HR training modules. The commencement of industrial action follows a town hall meeting on 4 March where management offered a \$1000 sign on bonus on top of [https://substack.com/redirect/f6615f3d-0b54-4ccc-9f2f-de6688fc924e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] an offer of a 10% wage increase over 3 years, pay progression up to band six, 16 weeks parental leave for supporting partners and increased sick and compassionate leave. The AFR reported [https://substack.com/redirect/f6615f3d-0b54-4ccc-9f2f-de6688fc924e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that ABC HR said this was their final offer. The EBA expired in October last year.

AEU/CPSU/HACSU Tasmania - Tasmanian Public Sector

Public school teachers across Tasmania will strike next week [https://substack.com/redirect/80dfe0f7-5f15-4f7e-ab7c-2a54e48d6af3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] if a decent offer is not made by 20 March; and a range of work bans including facilitating NAPLAN testing remain in place. On Thursday (12/3) CPSU members in the south of Tasmania took stopwork action [https://substack.com/redirect/f9d8f7b4-de6c-413c-a167-32b11cb2432d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] rallying on the lawns of Parliament House. CPSU members in Child Safety and Parks will stop work today [https://substack.com/redirect/0989b4ce-43bc-460c-9659-ddc40e7d0f2b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (18/3). HACSU has continued regular stopwork actions including workers at Beaconsfield District Health for 1 hour last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/dabb7df7-d591-4c93-918e-b8861c99b480?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (11/3); Royal Hobart Hospital (RHH) theatre and sterilisation workers for 4 hours on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/edb1a6f5-4e88-408b-90b4-84649e9a9ecc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (13/3); RHH pharmacists, pharmacy technicians and pharmacy support staff for 4 hours on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/dbbb7da0-fa4c-4404-aac4-f231b406a3ff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (16/3); and Launceston General Hospital health workers including theatre cleaners and sterilising department staff for 4 hours yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/bfc799fc-b8c1-4ab7-9641-18586a2e4b16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (17/3). Tick tock Jeremy Rockcliff, time to make public sector workers a decent offer!

AWU/CFMEU/ETU QLD - Glencore

On Friday (13/3), workers at Glencore's copper refinery in Townsville walked off the job. Workers have been in negotiations for 12 months, but after yet another failed bargaining meeting on Thursday, it was time for workers to act. The ETU claims that while Glencore argues the most recent offer to workers includes a 15% wage increase over 4 years [https://substack.com/redirect/8286e4b1-c06c-4c00-aac4-c96439b395d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], this is only due to tricky accounting- rolling a \$3,000 annual bonus into the calculation. In reality, the wage

increase is closer to just 3% over four years. Workers are seeking a 15% uplift in wages [https://substack.com/redirect/ba1d59b8-3ea4-44df-8a00-b829d2cf48c9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to achieve pay parity with workers at the nearby Sun Metals zinc refinery as well as 5% annual increases over the life of the agreement. Glencore received a \$600 million government bailout last year to protect these jobs [https://substack.com/redirect/79c24cb2-273c-4e88-9ce4-12ee23883dca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] - but is wasting money on short term contractors, and even considering bringing workers in from overseas [https://substack.com/redirect/8286e4b1-c06c-4c00-aac4-c96439b395d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] rather than making the wages at the refinery decent enough to attract workers.

MUA - DP World

Next week on Tuesday (24/3) the MUA are planning to hold a rally on the lawns at Parliament House in Canberra. The rally is for Secure Maritime Jobs, and is in response to DP World's plans [https://substack.com/redirect/6480b004-7904-48fa-b0cb-b62a80267935?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to automate its four container terminals in Melbourne, Sydney, Brisbane and Fremantle. It is believed the move to automation will not speed up the ports, so the only benefit will be to increase profits for DP World. The MUA's position is clear: no loss of jobs, no loss of pay and no automation unless by agreement. Automation and AI [https://substack.com/redirect/1549163d-6902-45a8-a197-45673be9a2e5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] are changing the world of work for many. Just last week Atlassian cut 500 jobs in Australia [https://substack.com/redirect/4e41875d-f9b8-4d40-a581-31d31331e11c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (by email!) due to its "changing labour needs". So this is real one struggle, one fight territory. Canberra based comrades, get along to Parliament House for the rally next Tuesday at 11am. And if I may gently call in some union comrades - while we rally against automation at the ports, it might be time to rethink the use of AI generated art on union social media accounts.

In short

NTEU NSW - University of Newcastle

NTEU members at the University of Newcastle are striking for 24 hours today [https://substack.com/redirect/32228811-9ed2-433e-9d23-881efeb9034a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (18/3). Workers will rally outside NUSpace from 8am, and a press conference will be held at 12 noon followed by a rally. This follows strike action held on the campus in October [https://substack.com/redirect/81b6fbb4-c3bd-4a58-8cb0-788abddd866a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and November [https://substack.com/redirect/3594e1a6-3098-4d98-8f09-3621bf2755aa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] last year. The NTEU has been in negotiations with UoN for over 12 months [https://substack.com/redirect/6379cc38-f3ca-4d82-a29b-814f97086a0d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for fair pay and superannuation equity [https://substack.com/redirect/6b0a2c9d-466d-403f-ae1e-bdb5f2cf7d7c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

TWU NSW - TGE

Yesterday (17/3), TWU members at TGE (Team Global Express) in Villawood voted to stop work [https://substack.com/redirect/c3ccd14b-d6e1-4881-9753-f0285b2a46d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] "until ongoing safety risks and concerns are addressed". No other details on this one, so if you know more - get in touch!

UWU NT - Alice Springs correctional officers

Correctional Officers will strike for 12 hours on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/d480db2d-d751-430e-a082-404917e17db1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (20/3). The Office of the Commissioner for Public Employment put a revised offer out to vote yesterday (17/3). That offer is not supported by the UWU, and includes a dismal 3% wage increase over the 4 year agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/c1b874fe-1177-484b-a311-ed69857ffc59?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Negotiations have been underway since August 2025, and the current agreement expired in December.

PABO Watch

ETU WA - BHP

"They thought that the days of their employees taking industrial action in the Pilbara were history. They were wrong. [https://substack.com/redirect/70291ed7-2e8d-4202-9092-3d378d919e67?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]" So says ETU WA Branch Secretary Adam Woodage as 60 high-voltage electrical workers prepare to vote in a protected action ballot. If voted up, the protected industrial action could include a variety of things including work stoppages between 15 minutes and 48 hours and on-call and overtime bans [https://substack.com/redirect/3ad9bb5b-d061-4439-a9d9-8f625e0b2277?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The ETU members voting on industrial action are all employed on individual contracts where pay rates vary by as much as 30%

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVGVZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXLKMMMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkRj1lwWkNjNk1Ua3hNa1F4TXpJeUxDSnBZWFpT2pFM056TTN0emxsT0Rnc01tVjRjQ0k2TVRnd05UTXh0VFU0T0N3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXpVFV4Tnp2aUxDSnpkV01pT21Ka2FYTMhZbXh5dWJdF1XbHNjbjAuVUFZBRUJPOUlpsjZpeXNzQXBtT1ZrdjdyX2RXQnpTR1ZMWTMwR2pGSUs1dyIsInAiOjE5MTI0MTMyMiwiYmIwMjA5NTc2NiwiZjE6dHJ1ZSwidG9DE4MzNmXzMsIm1hLmdhC16MTc3Mzc3OTU0CwiZXBhIjoyMGR5bG5mZSU1NTg4L3Jpc3MiOiJwdWtMcIsInNjYiIjE6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJLY3QifQ.drjPeKrngrSvTgc0IuciIwrd5IbIb04v-j1Ngg9DRsb1A?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-19-march>

ASMOF NSW - Public sector psychiatrists

Arbitration between ASMOF and the NSW Government in relation to NSW public sector psychiatrists began in the NSW IRC on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/5e62335a-7039-48c8-9127-48ec3a004041?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (17/3). Earlier this year, 200 psychiatrists resigned over the poor working conditions in the public sector, and those resignations were on top of over 100 vacancies [https://substack.com/redirect/b88a06b9-ce91-4dba-a7ca-94363b7ad940?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the sector. Staff shortages are an enormous problem with beds closed and waiting times growing. ASMOF have outlined many issues facing the sector including a growing reliance on locums, burnout and staffing shortages. Psychiatrists are calling for an urgent recruitment drive to fill all vacancies; funding training and registration fees to attract new doctors; a 25% pay increase; the establishment of a formal Psychiatry Workforce Committee to oversee staffing and recruitment and the implementation of a dispute resolution process to improve working conditions [https://substack.com/redirect/81d3666c-b84a-440d-b5fb-8529293f3722?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The NSW Premier has said the psychiatrists' pay demands are "unaffordable" and that the government's offer of 10.5% over 3 years was "generous".

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Last Thursday (13/3) buses in Newcastle operated by Keolis Downer ground to a halt after a driver was threatened with serious assault [https://substack.com/redirect/79020a68-4b13-4d75-8bcb-931c549dc7c1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the latest in a number of incidents of increased aggression on the network. After an inadequate response from Keolis Downer, an HSR issued a cease work notice, which severely disrupted the afternoon's school bus schedule. Following SafeWork NSW inspectors attending the workplace and a safety evaluation being undertaken, bus services resumed [https://substack.com/redirect/d7e94b55-c2c3-4d09-a24c-b14b02e53a54?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The RTBU and workers are calling for more roving security on the bus network and safety screens. In November last year, bus drivers in Canberra walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/aba049d2-b41a-45e1-8d1f-7ff0208b05cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] following the assault of a bus driver, and as a result were promised the introduction of safety screens, de-escalation training and more transit officers on the network.

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to get the full report straight to your inbox.

TWU QLD - Cleanaway

For the second time in 3 weeks workers at Cleanaway in Noosa took strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/7d994a88-dda4-4aa2-b2fb-56558b0a6a1e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The action on Friday (14/3) by workers affected an estimated 8000 bin collections. In addition to the strike, workers implemented overtime bans on Saturday, Sunday and Monday (15-17/3). The TWU has asked the Noosa Council to intervene, as they contract Cleanaway to deal with household rubbish collection, but the CEO of Noosa Council has said they are not involved in the negotiations. Workers are seeking a 7% pay increase. The Services Union - Noosa City Council

Also in Noosa, workers directly employed by the Noosa City Council are taking strike action today (19/3) including a stop work meeting at 9am outside the Noosa Council chambers in Tewantin [https://substack.com/redirect/35850299-7908-4ea3-b528-9b92c562ff1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The Council has refused to budge from its offer of 13.5% over 3 years. Workers want a better deal that keeps up with the cost of living and the wages of other council workers [https://substack.com/redirect/af23dd12-2260-4102-b886-c43f7a9a2320?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

WMWA - Rio Tinto

Workers at Paraburdoo mine in the Pilbara have secured a Majority Support Petition - the first at a major Pilbara iron mine in 30 years [https://substack.com/redirect/c7b8b5ca-1715-49d6-b034-7728eeaa148a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This means over 50% of workers at the mine are in favour of enterprise bargaining. Once the petition is confirmed by the Fair Work Commission, Rio Tinto will be obliged to negotiate an enterprise agreement. The petition has been organised by the Western Mine Workers Alliance (WMWA), a joint project between the MEU and AWU [https://substack.com/redirect/b6039175-e2a1-4be2-84a6-b95d378790b6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This is a significant turn of events given the almost complete de-unionisation of the Pilbara throughout the 1980s & 1990s.

RAFFWU - Aesop

In other Majority Support Petition news, workers at Aesop with the assistance of RAFFWU lodged an application with the Fair Work Commission [https://substack.com/redirect/13e3707d-1a82-4212-accf-824dff904ef8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] accompanied by a

petition signed by 118 of 200 workers. A formal ballot commenced yesterday (18/3) and will run through to 28 March. If successful, Aesop will be obliged to commence EBA negotiations with workers at Victorian Aesop stores. A special shout out to the beautiful Instagram reel [https://substack.com/redirect/01b3dd5c-74d8-4681-a2f6-a5f9a89af918?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on the theme of bread and roses!

AMWU/AWU/CEPU SA - BAE Systems

For the third time in recent weeks, workers at BAE at Osborne Naval Shipyard in Adelaide have walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/4b50ed38-2d41-4014-ba77-5dd602b64db2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. 500 workers took strike action on Monday (17/3) in pursuit of a 30% wage increase over 3 years. Workers at BAE are paid up to 20% less than other workers in the shipbuilding industry. BAE Systems is refusing to budge from their offer of 12% over 3 years. Workers have been in negotiations with BAE since July 2024 [https://substack.com/redirect/40aa25ff-d277-45cb-b540-a16e214fba14?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

AWU NSW - Tomago

The Herald Sun has reported that industrial action at Tomago was suspended after an improved offer from management [https://substack.com/redirect/f59651f0-8bcc-4931-b1c0-a4eccd47c197?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers had been demanding 4% annual increases, but Tomago was not prepared to budge from 4% in the first year and 3.5% in the second and third years. According to the report, the improved offer is 4% in the first year, and 3.75% in the second and third years along with a \$1500 cost of living payment. Neither Tomago nor the union has made any public statement as yet... so stay tuned for confirmation.

AWU - Silicosis

In terrible OHS news this week, 13 workers on tunnelling projects in NSW have been diagnosed with silicosis [https://substack.com/redirect/819680ba-8387-4f31-bf66-308e54ba928a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. CPB failed to inform the regulator of 12 of these cases. While this is awful in and of itself, what makes it worse is that companies - like CPB - and SafeWork NSW knew about dangerous dust levels on projects as early as 2017 but failed to take action [https://substack.com/redirect/e064eb14-b00e-40f7-8691-102c9129d2a4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. In November last year, the AWU released documents obtained through FOI requests and warned of a "silicosis tsunami coming for metro tunnellers [https://substack.com/redirect/508152f3-e6c2-464b-a0cb-f7297acbda6a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]". Air monitoring reports on NorthConnex, WestConnex, M6 stage 1, and Western Harbour Tunnel projects were withheld from being released. According to a letter from SafeWork NSW this was because "release of the reports will... adversely impact upon the reputation of CPB." This all feels incredibly reminiscent of the James Hardie asbestos saga [https://substack.com/redirect/6f8e2376-edc6-49f6-a48e-48d5e1118dc7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. It also reminds us that the ban of engineered stone [https://substack.com/redirect/2140a0be-cc84-48d4-9e69-fb5eaf4a697d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] won by unions last year does not spell the end of silicosis. The CFMEU NSW Branch shared some helpful advice on their Facebook page for workers in the tunnelling industry: "If you feel that you are being exposed to unsafe levels of silica in your workplace, please contact your delegate, HSR, or union organiser. We also encourage all our members who have worked on tunnelling projects in NSW to contact iCare on 1800 550 027 to organise a free lung screening. [https://substack.com/redirect/29855bc7-fab1-423a-acf6-3e28ef68b025?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]"

CFMEU - 60 Minutes

On Sunday (16/3), Nick McKenzie fronted another 60 minutes segment [https://substack.com/redirect/264c54ea-04ab-43e7-9673-3608ad0aee6b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] focused on the CFMEU, which kicked off another round of articles in the "Building Bad [https://substack.com/redirect/806bb71b-e0c9-43e8-bbe9-cf774baa0acf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]" series. The allegations against the Victorian branch of the union focused on associations with bikies; Mike Gatto acting as a mediator/fixer; and allegations of violence and harassment against women perpetrated either on construction sites or by CFMEU delegates. National Secretary Zach Smith responded with a strong statement [https://substack.com/redirect/66b82667-630e-4d77-bfcf-1aec317bab92?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] condemning corruption and violence against women. The statement was followed up with a Victorian delegates meeting held yesterday (18/3) which according to reports in The Age [https://substack.com/redirect/ca79994a-5fbc-483d-bbcb-6f3f69835c65?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] passed several resolutions committing to oppose corruption, intimidation, violence and specifically violence and harassment against women. The meeting (according to The Age) also endorsed a new policy that would require shop stewards to have 5 years of uninterrupted membership, industry experience, a demonstrated commitment to union values and be required to be elected by the members on each project - at the start of the project and once during the life of the project. The meeting also passed a

resolution in support of CFMEU organiser Lisa Zanatta and the Victorian Branch's Women's Committee. Zanatta was portrayed harshly by the 60 minutes piece as having not adequately supported women members of the CFMEU who faced harassment and violence. A statement from Smith [

[https://substack.com/redirect/5f72ef90-c4a7-495d-984d-fbe041137f2d?](https://substack.com/redirect/5f72ef90-c4a7-495d-984d-fbe041137f2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5f72ef90-c4a7-495d-984d-fbe041137f2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] countered that the union had limited resources to deal with the issue and said that "I fully support Lisa Zanatta and the work that she has done. I believe the union has also let her down." In a statement [

[https://substack.com/redirect/5f72ef90-c4a7-495d-984d-fbe041137f2d?](https://substack.com/redirect/5f72ef90-c4a7-495d-984d-fbe041137f2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5f72ef90-c4a7-495d-984d-fbe041137f2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)], Zanatta shared that "I may not have always got it right, but I have always tried my best for the women that I represent." It does, to my mind, seem a bit bloody rich to put the blame for how the union handled complaints from women members about violence and harassment squarely on the shoulders of the one woman who by all accounts has spent her working life supporting women in the construction industry. I don't have the time, skills or information to critically examine each allegation made in the 60 minutes report. What does remain clear to me is that any issues within the union can only be adequately resolved by the members of that union. The need for a union run by members, for members has never been greater.

And in closing, last week the ABS released the most recent stats on industrial disputes [

[https://substack.com/redirect/27d79094-304e-4549-878d-ed40d72aaaaaf?](https://substack.com/redirect/27d79094-304e-4549-878d-ed40d72aaaaaf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/27d79094-304e-4549-878d-ed40d72aaaaaf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. In the December Quarter, 69 disputes occurred involving 25,200 workers. 53,800 working days were "lost" (lost is what the bosses say, you or I might say "put to good use"). I haven't had time to dig into the data. Any nerds or wonks out there who have any analysis to share - please get in touch. What I do know, is I definitely did not cover 69 disputes in the December quarter!! To help me cover more disputes - please get in touch if there's something going on in your workplace, your industry or your union.

In solidarity, Sarah.

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades and subscribe.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UVTVNekkzTkRrd0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05ESXpNekF3T0RRc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM016ZzJOakE0TkN3aWFTYnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAualRiX1dUeXV0Z0pGZDdDOE5Wd1FjWEhFVTM4RXl6LW51RHY3MFhrUXpIayIsInAiOjE1OTMyNzQ5MCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImldCI6MTc0MjMzMMDA4NCwiZXhwIjoxNzQ0OTIyMDg0LCJpc3MiOiIjWdWIjMCI6InN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.8SrXpl63sXiyY4RIZE-PVDD-1XK1Q4La1CfHRI47BaE?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-19-november>

ANMF Vic - Healthscope

This Thursday (20/11), ANMF members at Healthscope facilities will stop work for 4 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/10ca0431-c532-4150-ae98-3054135decec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The workers are asking the community to support them at two rallies [https://substack.com/redirect/75dc6b71-f44b-4ccd-b773-e161188337bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]: one at the Melbourne Private Hospital (Royal Parade, Parkville) and one at the Geelong Clinic (98 Townsend Rd, St Albans Park). Both rallies will commence at 2pm. On Friday (14/11) the ANMF advised members that Healthscope was putting their proposed agreement out to a ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/fa42278a-2471-4ed9-aa52-d678c9c47208?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] without the ANMF's agreement. The ANMF is advising members to vote no for a number of reasons, primarily that the proposed agreement does not achieve parity with public sector wages until July 2027, and then only for five months; and that the proposal includes the unfair salary packaging clause. If you're in Melbourne or Geelong on Thursday afternoon, try to get along and support Healthscope nurses at their rallies.

AMWU/ETU NSW - Downer

Last Wednesday (12/11), AMWU & ETU members who work for Downer Engineering around Newcastle and the Hunter Valley commenced industrial action. Workers at sites including the Bayswater Power station, Port Waratah Coal Services, Kooragang Bulk Facilities and the Downer Haxham workshop have been taking 8 x 1-hour stoppages each day. 80% of workers rejected Downer's last offer, and 95% endorsed taking industrial action.

CFMEU Vic - CSR Yarraville

Last week, CSR refused to pay workers [https://substack.com/redirect/7f997f24-54fd-4536-91c7-53eba90f8b28?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at its Yarraville factory their wages after workers commenced industrial action. This follows 21 weeks of EBA negotiations which had stalled. After their wages were withheld, workers resolved to walk off the job indefinitely late on Friday night. Workers have been picketing the factory this week, and intend to keep fighting for 4% annual wage increases [https://substack.com/redirect/721b1229-249a-4477-8ec8-50bfa97d989a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CPSU/MEAA - ABC

Thanks again to Crikey for in-depth reporting on EBA negotiations at the ABC [https://substack.com/redirect/daa7a0f5-f885-4842-a2f6-b0afc68f5390?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The ABC is putting its proposed agreement out to vote with the ballot opening last Friday (14/11). The proposed agreement includes a 3.5% wage increase in the first year and 3.25% increases in years 2 & 3. This is 1% more than the last offer rejected by staff. The MEAA has characterised the offer as "insulting" and that it fails to address job security and career progression as well as pay increases that don't keep up with inflation. It is believed the CPSU is feeling more favourable towards this deal than the MEAA. This is unsurprising given that 62% of CPSU members at the ABC voted in favour of the July proposed agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/002eba00-2709-4568-8e21-b7831e0aa924?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which guaranteed a 3% pay rise from 1 October, with future pay increases to be negotiated; an agreement that there be no industrial action for 6 months and a safeguard that the ABC couldn't put any agreement to a vote without union agreement. Stay tuned for updates. The MEAA have not ruled out industrial action.

Ambulance Managers & Professionals Association - Ambulance Victoria

Yesterday (18/11) corporate staff at Ambulance Victoria commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/3ab44d4b-c183-4617-bbb2-e1006fe40eb4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Members of AMPA (a division of Professionals Australia) kicked off with "Stage 1 bans" [https://substack.com/redirect/884d0cfe-46da-468e-ad15-0a1e7a093a51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including recruitment activities; training and development; tendering and procurement functions; rostering and scheduling operations and statutory and mandated reporting requirements. AMPA members have had 4 years of just 2% pay increases, which according to the union represents a pay cut of at least 5% in real terms. Workers have been in negotiations with the state government for over 6 months.

AMWU/ETU Vic - Bendigo Railway workshops

Workers at the Bendigo Railway workshops have implemented bans on overtime, callouts and night shifts in response to management "taking a knife to the railway workshop agreement" [https://substack.com/redirect/5ccd129a-f116-4609-a3eb-06827d199d60?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The bosses are trying to remove overtime penalties; back pay and more. Workers are committed to fighting for a fair pay increase

without any trade-offs.

QTU - Public sector teachers

Having been unable to win over the Premier with a box of cannoli and a sternly worded letter [[https://substack.com/redirect/dffccdd1-7f7b-4b3b-bc3e-58c00352354d?](https://substack.com/redirect/dffccdd1-7f7b-4b3b-bc3e-58c00352354d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/dffccdd1-7f7b-4b3b-bc3e-58c00352354d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)], the QTU has committed to a 24 hour strike next Tuesday [[https://substack.com/redirect/04ff76d7-93e7-4c2d-87cb-979e38936818?](https://substack.com/redirect/04ff76d7-93e7-4c2d-87cb-979e38936818?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)
[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/04ff76d7-93e7-4c2d-87cb-979e38936818?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] (25/11). This will be the second 24 hour strike for teachers in Queensland this year. Rallies are set to be held across the state. The QTU is putting responsibility firmly at the feet of the Premier as the government “refused to enter dialogue [[https://substack.com/redirect/418ccf5d-8cf1-4416-b958-817649d6fcbd?](https://substack.com/redirect/418ccf5d-8cf1-4416-b958-817649d6fcbd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)
[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/418ccf5d-8cf1-4416-b958-817649d6fcbd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]” with the QTU. QTU members are fighting for “nation leading” wages and improved conditions including action on workload, occupational violence and staff shortages.

AWU Victoria - Infrabuild

Yesterday (18/11) Workers at Infrabuild’s Laverton steel mill held a mass meeting and stoppage [[https://substack.com/redirect/61c56e56-325e-4fb6-b811-c9876c21f3fc?](https://substack.com/redirect/61c56e56-325e-4fb6-b811-c9876c21f3fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/61c56e56-325e-4fb6-b811-c9876c21f3fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]. Workers are fighting for fair conditions and a decent wage increase.

HSU WA - GenesisCare

As reported last week, more than 50 radiation therapists at GenesisCare in WA stopped work for four hours [[https://substack.com/redirect/bc29415a-710e-4783-ab66-e3a66ea6c4ea?](https://substack.com/redirect/bc29415a-710e-4783-ab66-e3a66ea6c4ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/bc29415a-710e-4783-ab66-e3a66ea6c4ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] last Wednesday (12/11).

Negotiations between GenesisCare and the HSU WA broke down in October when workers rejected a pay increase [[https://substack.com/redirect/c7b860ef-84fb-4e5c-bb12-1d8d2f035f8d?](https://substack.com/redirect/c7b860ef-84fb-4e5c-bb12-1d8d2f035f8d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c7b860ef-84fb-4e5c-bb12-1d8d2f035f8d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] (3.3% for radiation therapists and 3.8% for unit leaders) below CPI (4.5% in Perth). Workers are fighting for a 7% increase or an increase in line with CPI - which ever is higher - for all positions. GenesisCare and the HSUWA are due to meet in the FWC today.

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Public sector nurses and midwives have entered “the next phase of the Public Sector EA 2025 campaign [[https://substack.com/redirect/9627b0f7-6a4c-48bc-bf28-ee7615659c80?](https://substack.com/redirect/9627b0f7-6a4c-48bc-bf28-ee7615659c80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9627b0f7-6a4c-48bc-bf28-ee7615659c80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]”. For workers at metro sites this means working to rule [[https://substack.com/redirect/cfa0aafe-3f37-428a-9dbb-9dbb94780837?](https://substack.com/redirect/cfa0aafe-3f37-428a-9dbb-9dbb94780837?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/cfa0aafe-3f37-428a-9dbb-9dbb94780837?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] - claiming all overtime; taking all breaks; no last minute shift swaps etc. Working to rule is a great way for hospital management to comprehend how much unpaid work nurses and midwives do! For nurses and midwives in regional, rural and remote areas - rolling stopwork visits are planned from 10 November through to 26 November. The first of these stopwork visits [[https://substack.com/redirect/30750118-76b0-4fdb-a043-250045b5af7a?](https://substack.com/redirect/30750118-76b0-4fdb-a043-250045b5af7a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/30750118-76b0-4fdb-a043-250045b5af7a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] took place on Thursday (13/11) in Mount Gambier.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Bus drivers in Newcastle continue their industrial action. Actions this week [[https://substack.com/redirect/8c276183-046d-4e87-a4d0-405c64fcef8e?](https://substack.com/redirect/8c276183-046d-4e87-a4d0-405c64fcef8e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8c276183-046d-4e87-a4d0-405c64fcef8e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] include “piss off early day”; “reduced speed limit day” and “moving forward is the only way [

[https://substack.com/redirect/8d1f95a0-7d0d-4d7e-b25f-e172fda691f1?](https://substack.com/redirect/8d1f95a0-7d0d-4d7e-b25f-e172fda691f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8d1f95a0-7d0d-4d7e-b25f-e172fda691f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]” which is a ban on reversing buses unless in an emergency situation. Workers are also continuing to wear their red berets. While workers are negotiating a new agreement and fighting for fair wages, secure jobs and safe workplaces; the dispute has also opened up the conversation about contracting out of public services to private enterprise. As NSW MLC Bob Nanva (former RTBU National Secretary) said last week - “Privatisation turns the provision of public goods into the accumulation of private wealth. [

[https://substack.com/redirect/cb2c7f3b-b9a5-4bcc-a4ac-bf6c1514236e?](https://substack.com/redirect/cb2c7f3b-b9a5-4bcc-a4ac-bf6c1514236e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/cb2c7f3b-b9a5-4bcc-a4ac-bf6c1514236e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]”

AWU QLD - Holcim

It appears that AWU members at Holcim cement in Swanbank are in dispute and fighting back against an unfair pay offer. At the time of writing I was unable to track down any other details - if you know what’s going on, please get in touch!

NTEU NSW - University of Newcastle

Following their strike action on campus in late October, workers from the University of Newcastle are taking their fight to Sydney today (19/11). While university execs will be at Parliament House in Sydney celebrating the university’s 60 year anniversary; workers will be outside rallying and demanding a fair deal [[https://substack.com/redirect/3ed2c9d1-ffde-47f8-8f80-708992693cf2?](https://substack.com/redirect/3ed2c9d1-ffde-47f8-8f80-708992693cf2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3ed2c9d1-ffde-47f8-8f80-708992693cf2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]. Workers want fair pay, job security, workload relief and respect. If you’re in Sydney today, join NTEU members at 12 noon on

Macquarie Street outside Parliament House to support their call for a decent offer.

NTEU WA - Curtin University

With exams finished on 7 November, and final results due to be published next week, workers at Curtin University are looking ahead to 2026 [https://substack.com/redirect/5fa8e114-8dba-42f4-8205-ba9701fd340f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The NTEU is seeking members to sign a pledge [https://substack.com/redirect/e7ae2fa3-0caf-4bbd-a4db-35815067d31d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] that if by 1 February 2026 “significant progress” has not been made towards agreement on key claims relating to workload, job security, work flexibility and pay; academic staff will institute a ban on attending physical campuses. This could lead to a very lacklustre 0-Week commencing on 9 February. One to watch in the new year!

CFMEU WA - Freo Cranes

In last week’s report [https://substack.com/redirect/a3b2a5db-c1f2-4f99-b2ed-293496154275?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] I shared very brief details of a 1 hour work stoppage held by CFMEU members at Freo Cranes in the Pilbara. I now have more information to share about this dispute. Negotiations have been underway for over 6 months. The initial offer from Freo Cranes was voted down decisively with a 92% no vote. Since then, the company has not put a substantive offer on the table. Workers have been pushing for fairer industry wages and conditions, and are fed up with the company crying poor. Workers are fighting for superannuation to be paid on all hours; double time on nightshift; substantial increases to rates and conditions; improved delegate clauses; paid stand down after nightshift and R&R payments. Throughout the dispute, membership has grown exponentially. Workers are committed to achieving a good outcome not only for themselves but in order to raise the bar for wages, skills, and safety in their industry. It’s great to be able to share a bit more detail on one part of the much hyped re-unionisation of the Pilbara! I hope to be able to share more updates in future reports.

MEU NSW - Bloomfield

After 7 weeks on strike, workers at Rix’s Creek mine have voted up a new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/54353d81-0663-48e6-a279-2e382c087c6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The strike is the longest in the area in decades [https://substack.com/redirect/0eb47adb-b7fe-4513-ace3-35dc5d9d773f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. According to a MEU media release the “miners have secured everything they set out to achieve”. Workers have achieved a 17% wage increase with an initial 5% increase followed by annual increases of 5%; 4.5% and 2.5%. Key in the dispute was improvements to accident pay, the Newcastle Weekly reports that improvement includes “an additional 13 weeks of site bonus payments will be added to the accident pay clause for employees off work more than 39 weeks due to a work-related injury [https://substack.com/redirect/d20504e2-4124-48ce-b80f-b225ba924766?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]”.

AWU QLD - Townsville City Council

More than 96% of workers have voted up the Townsville City Council Stream B agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/4a081ee0-b186-43a5-aa2c-ab9057b50705?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The AWU reports that the deal locks in payrises of \$125 per week with back pay to July this year alongside improved job security. I am unsure if other unions with members at the city council (The Services Union, CFMEU, TWU etc) have also finalised in-principle agreements. All unions have participated in various work bans, and The Services Union took strike action earlier in the year. Know more about the state of play at Townsville City Council? Get in touch!

AMWU/ETU NSW - Solvay

International solidarity has helped workers at Solvay seal a decent deal. Solvay, a Belgian multinational, refused to negotiate with workers. Workers took strike action, but also called on unions in Belgium to take their fight to HQ. Once the company was aware of the situation in Australia, two management representatives were in Australia within three days [https://substack.com/redirect/58cce40a-a4f0-48a4-aa89-06580ce2fa00?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. An agreement was reached after one meeting that delivered all claims workers had put forward: backpay; 10 days personal leave; incorporation of the Manufacturing Award and wage increases of 4%; 3.5% and 4% or CPI up to 5% in the final year of the agreement.

That’s all I’ve got time for this week! Thanks to the readers who have got in touch over the last week. If I haven’t managed to get back to yet, I will do soon. If I’ve missed something or got something wrong this week - please send me a message. And if you get along to any of the pickets, strikes or rallies covered in this report - I’d love to hear reports from readers about how things are on the ground.

In solidarity, Sarah

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<https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc>

2FibGVfZW1haww_dG9rZW49ZXlKMwMyVn1YMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjlwWkNjNk1UYzVNak0zT0RRM0xDSnBZWf
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3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.Snwf8z40mDHpX30f8umTAXnD_JCVDvtVoPivGuwnGOI?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-2-april>

ANMF/HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

HACSU members will hold a statewide stop work action today [https://substack.com/redirect/eb277c45-6c8d-4f2b-99cb-162060bae86d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (2 April) with a rally and march kicking off at Victorian Trades Hall in Melbourne from 12 noon. This follows stopwork actions in Bendigo, Albury-Wodonga and Warrnambool last week. On Thursday (27/3), the Victorian Government put forward an offer for the public sector mental health EBA which HACSU has termed “disappointing and disrespectful [https://substack.com/redirect/38c8c3a9-ce0f-4a29-a540-f00b5f6d8288?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]”. HACSU is concerned on several fronts including that the pay offer for mental health nurses falls short of matching general nurses; that the offer does not address ratios or staffing profiles; that social workers and occupational therapists are being offered less than nurses; and that the offer fails to address the specific concerns of Lived and Living Experience Workers or Admin Staff. However, the ANMF which also has members covered by this agreement endorsed the offer at a statewide members meeting on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/d8838f7b-5e82-4104-9b8d-1f44293e8829?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (28/3), as well as ceasing industrial action. Apparently this was not an overwhelming endorsement with only 61% of the meeting voting yes. A poll of HACSU members has recorded in excess of 90% saying NO to the agreement. This now leaves HACSU, who has the vast majority (perhaps as much as 85%) of members covered by the agreement to continue industrial action and keep the pressure on the government. If you can get along and support the workers at their stop work today, please do!

ETU & RTBU NSW - Sydney Trains

While all industrial action on the Sydney Trains network has been suspended by the FWC until at least July, unions are working the legal angles [https://substack.com/redirect/20051f03-780c-4461-8b6c-a0c013ee9b02?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The first of these was a Federal Court application by the ETU which contended that the Combined Rail Unions did not adequately represent the ETU’s interests and that the suspension of industrial action gave the government an unfair advantage in negotiations. This was dismissed last Tuesday (25/3) with the full decision and reasoning [https://substack.com/redirect/7e655549-07c0-46c7-b2b1-774e276ec2b1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] delivered on Thursday (27/3). The FWC had deferred hearing the RTBU’s application until the decision in the ETU case was delivered, so I assume that this will happen soon. The RTBU’s application hinges on the argument that suspending industrial action has not assisted in the stated intention of the FWC’s order - resolving the dispute - and in fact the two sides are “further apart than they were before”. Allen Hicks, the state secretary of the ETU summed it up when he said “This decision tears away the right of workers to withdraw their labour in pursuit of a better deal.” [https://substack.com/redirect/20051f03-780c-4461-8b6c-a0c013ee9b02?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to get the full report straight to your inbox.

UWU/ETU QLD - XXXX

Workers at the XXXX Brewery in Milton went on strike for 24 hours yesterday (1 April). Workers are fighting for a 15% pay rise over 3 years as well as maintaining existing conditions. XXXX are seeking to impose new conditions for “when workers access personal leave for significant health issues [https://substack.com/redirect/f9830aaa-60fa-423e-8bda-9e2a6650b917?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” which sounds dodgy as fuck. Workers also want to ensure apprentices are covered by their agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/bdb336c2-c3e7-4163-9c7f-3055ebeaab59?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In the Courier Mail, XXXX responded to these claims by asserting that personal leave is “above the Fair Work Act” and that while there aren’t any apprentices at the brewery currently, former apprentices were paid “well above the award rate”. Someone should probably tell the XXXX spokesperson that paying above the legally mandated minimum isn’t the flex they think it is! Workers have been in negotiations since December.

IEU Victoria - Strathcona Girls’ Grammar

Teachers at Strathcona Girls’ Grammar commenced industrial action this week [https://substack.com/redirect/df9f72ee-21eb-4b98-8847-0267b17ac632?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The action takes the form of refusal to attend assemblies, wearing union t-shirts to work and including campaign messages in emails. The union has the option to take strike action, and members have voted to escalate industrial action in Term 2 (starts 22/4) if needed. Negotiations have been underway at the school for 6 months, but the major sticking points are enforceable limits to scheduling teaching time, ensuring time for preparation and marking [https://substack.com/redirect/cae525c2-7d8d-4b4b-8d92-0633a57c1cec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the right to access arbitration in the case of a workplace dispute and wages.

RAFFWU - Aesop

Stand by for fully automated luxury handcream communism! A majority of workers at Aesop's Victorian stores have voted yes in the majority support petition. This means that Aesop must now sit down with workers to negotiate an agreement. 155 of 199 eligible voters cast a ballot; with 82.58% voting YES. This is another example of RAFFWU organising workers in workplaces that have been written off by many as un-organisable. This work builds on previous success such as Readings and Better Read Than Dead bookshops [https://substack.com/redirect/aff35908-c647-4085-8466-f4badc218580?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] that both successfully negotiated EBAs under intense pushback from employers.

AWU Victoria - Forest Fire Management Victoria

AWU members at FFMV commenced industrial action in November [https://substack.com/redirect/db2e842c-438a-4ecf-a4f9-185acaef47e4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] last year in pursuit of a fair deal including a decent pay rise greater than the Victorian Government's wages policy. They have maintained industrial action over the summer fire season, whilst also keeping our communities safe. With the government still not budging, workers have voted up a bunch more work bans effective as of last Thursday (27/3). The bans include not entering or operating vehicles from 12:30-5:30pm on Wednesdays, as well as bans on painting; handling firewood; baiting and trapping; welding; recording odometer information; using pruners; using trailers; filling potholes by hand and more. This is on top of a raft of existing bans. Time will tell if this is enough to force the government into a better deal.

The Services Union/AWU - Noosa City Council

Members of The Services Union at Noosa City Council are set to strike again tomorrow (3/4). I am unsure if AWU members are joining the action - I would assume so, but have not been able to confirm this. Workers will hold a rally [https://substack.com/redirect/974b3319-0e99-493b-9cf1-6b8b99fda997?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] along Hastings Street in Noosa Heads from 10:30am - 1:30pm. In addition to this, workers commenced a range of work bans yesterday (1/4) that restrict emails, phone calls and meetings. Union members are fighting for an 18.5% wage increase over 3 years, with a 9.5% increase in the first year in order to keep up with the wages of workers in neighbouring council areas. Noosa City Council is refusing to budge from their offer of 13.5% increase over 3 years.

ASMOF NSW - Public Hospital Doctors

ASMOF members in public hospitals in NSW had been planning a 3 day strike [https://substack.com/redirect/f01dceab-aa8e-4c58-b77f-81d6c17900ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], but the NSW IRC has ordered the union and its members not to take any industrial action for 3 months [https://substack.com/redirect/bd30aa1b-a4d8-4638-b9a5-b009028e41f0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. ASMOF members have rejected two offers from the NSW Government described by the union as "insulting" and conciliation at the IRC on Tuesday failed to find an acceptable deal for the two parties. Doctors are fighting for a pay increase to achieve pay parity with other states as well as safe working hours, penalty rates for unsociable hours and improved leave entitlements.

ETU WA - Western Power

After taking industrial action late last year, workers at Western Power have voted up a new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/f4f87c3e-4004-4a1d-bb13-c983221e792c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The ETU has proudly shared that they have beaten the government's wages policy with wage increases of up to 16.46% (compounded) over the life of the agreement. Workers have also won significant improvements to superannuation, income protection coverage, allowances and leave. Workers had been fighting for a 36 hour week in line with other states' power workers, and although they were unsuccessful on this item Western Power has committed to work with the ETU to explore alternative rostering patterns, as well as improvements to workplace consultation.

ASU - Maurice Blackburn

Last week ASU members at Maurice Blackburn voted in support of an in-principle agreement. The agreement includes a 12.5% wage increase over 3 years for workers earning less than \$100,000 (5.5%, 3.5% & 3.5%) and 11% over 3 years for workers earning more than \$100,000 (4%, 3.5%, 3.5%). Workers have also been successful in gaining 6 days of paid reproductive health leave per annum, as well as improvements to redundancy, leave and allowances clauses. Workers have been in negotiations for 12 months, and have been taking industrial action including stoppages and work bans since October 2024.

MUA - Teekay

After 9 days of industrial action on the Absolute I bunker barge, an in-principle agreement has been reached between Teekay and the MUA [https://substack.com/redirect/29c27c2a-71cd-460d-9158-b79290c3eacf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The in-principle agreement includes an up-front increase in salary by 26% for permanent workers and 38% for casuals; annual salary increases of CPI + 1%; backpay to November 2024; and other improvements to allowances and conditions. The MUA is encouraging members to vote up the agreement. Industrial action has ceased

[https://substack.com/redirect/618d7c35-1dfb-4ee4-b277-092aa6fff344?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and the port of Fremantle bunkering operations have returned to normal.

ANMF Vic - St Vincent's Private

The ballot on the St Vincent's Private Hospital EBA closed on Monday 24 March, and media reports confirm that the agreement has been voted up [https://substack.com/redirect/d8d1f57d-1493-4e1e-9e35-5a35f6276c32?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The ANMF did not recommend either a yes or no vote but advised in a campaign update [https://substack.com/redirect/155a51cc-2177-450f-9c43-ab5b171a5ee2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in early March that "apart from the staffing provisions and the allowances, we regard the offer as reasonable." The update went on to note that allowances in the offer were "behind the public sector and considerably behind Epworth" and though the union described staffing provisions as "a positive step forward" noted that "these provisions do not go far enough and do not represent a prescriptive mechanism for safe staffing and workload relief that we were seeking." It seems these staffing provisions were the main barrier to the union recommending a Yes vote. Nurses and midwives at the hospital took industrial action including stoppages and work bans for over 100 days in pursuit of a fair deal. It was the first time nurses at the hospital had ever taken industrial action - an achievement worth acknowledging.

Trade Unions for Democracy Summit #2

The second Trade Unions for Democracy Summit was held in Melbourne last Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/05463d3b-3854-484c-9bf6-350abd9be5b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (28/3). 9 unions were in attendance, I am assuming that means ETU, CFMEU, UFU, PPTEU, RTBU, AFULE, AMIEU, MUA and AMWU (but happy to be corrected!). It is understood a constitution was adopted, along with a mission statement. Whether this means that the original idea of an alternative to the ACTU is still being considered, I am unsure. A number of resolutions were also endorsed by the summit calling on the Federal Government to enable rank and file elections in the Construction Division of the CFMEU as soon as possible; for the Federal Government to comply with international labour law and for the right to strike to be included in the Fair Work Act; and for the Federal Government to mandate union agreements in all federally funded work. The summit also discussed the upcoming Federal Election, with an unsurprising approach of putting Dutton last.

Speaking of Dutton, I assume everyone is aware that a Federal Election has been called for May 3. But (in the words of Bob Katter [https://substack.com/redirect/591bf814-d747-4dbc-b082-d314d1f621a8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]) I ain't spending any time on it because in the meantime hundreds of workers will be fighting and struggling in their workplaces, and that's what this report is about!

That's all I've got this week. Thanks as always to the workers who have helped me put this week's report together.

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UWXdNek14TkRReExDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05ETTF0REF5TURZc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM05UQTNOak13Tm13aWFTYnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhSWDJWdFlxbHNjbAUS01jWm5qRzhxazJYb1A0RmxcPC2hoOTVSa0xmOS1CcUFkdGMWwIRTZNOCIsInAiOjE2MDMzMtQ0MSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc0MzU0MDIwNiwiZXhwIjoxNzQ2MTMyMjA2LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.g-HeDJBGJ-oiVistGn_G22KxXuvyrwPHs29Ec3saqA?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-2-july>

UFU Vic - FRV

In the latest move in the long running dispute between the UFU and Fire Rescue Victoria union members passed a vote of no confidence in FRV leadership [<https://substack.com/redirect/5887e747-d626-4f10-aa64-4ca737e26389?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>]. Around 80% of eligible members participated in the vote, with 90% voting that they did not have confidence in the leadership of the agency. Similar votes of no-confidence by ambos and cops last year preceded resignations of Victoria Police's Chief Commissioner and Ambulance Victoria's CEO. The dispute has been dragging on for years at this point I believe, and the legal status of the intractable bargaining process is not clear to me. Any fires or friendly industrial officers able to shed any light on this one - please get in touch!

AWU QLD - Townsville City Council

Workers at Townsville City Council commenced strike action yesterday (1/7). The AWU has told residents to expect disruptions to council services. Council's current offer amounts to an 11% increase in base rate (5%, 3% and 3% over the three years) with reclassifications for some workers [<https://substack.com/redirect/63efa992-6ddb-4b30-8750-e7e98038d89a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>]. AWU members are pushing for a 20% pay increase and a 'ratepayer value committee' [<https://substack.com/redirect/1c6ebe38-15de-44c7-b09e-694076322f6a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>] "to divert money away from senior executives and into services". Meanwhile, Townsville senior executive pay grew 79% last year and the Mayor draws a \$225,000 salary whilst suspended because of a Crime and Corruption Commission investigation.

QNMU - Public sector nurses and midwives

The QNMU has accused the state government of "gaslighting" and has said if the government doesn't agree to their demands by today, industrial action will escalate to Stage 2 [<https://substack.com/redirect/b439bab7-85ea-4853-be49-50c72ece15a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>]. After two weeks of intensive negotiations, Queensland Health declared that everything the union thought was already agreed was off the table, which has understandably angered the QNMU and led to them imposing their deadline for a reasonable and serious offer. If no agreement is made, Stage 2 protected industrial action will start on Monday (7/7) which will include "rolling statewide work bans" [<https://substack.com/redirect/029ca1c0-1737-4946-8f7b-54b17ca1e0f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>] - potentially including bans on making beds, data entry, going to meetings, cleaning duties, answering phones and restocking supplies. The QNMU are demanding a 13% wage increase over 3 years but the government is not budging on 8% over 3 years [<https://substack.com/redirect/70861ddf-0467-44fb-a231-79f6ca7294ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>].

CFMEU QLD - Qube

Qube crane crews at both the Port of Brisbane and Vestas' Wambo Wind Farm have voted down the bosses' proposed EBA, and resumed industrial action.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU NSW - Bluescope

Workers at Bluescope in Port Kembla commenced industrial action on 14/6. [<https://substack.com/redirect/45079dcf-08e5-4be5-9766-94413e7b4fff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>] Three unions are involved in the dispute, and it is understood the industrial action has thus far included 1 hour stoppages as well as various work and overtime bans [<https://substack.com/redirect/23f55027-fb47-4637-8810-9bbe821dc411?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>]. Workers are fighting for a fair deal, as well as for Bluescope to revert to direct hiring of apprentices, rather than hiring them through Zeal Futures [<https://substack.com/redirect/47dae4c3-87d0-48f4-a85c-b781724b8716?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>].

ANMF Vic - Epworth

Medical imaging nurses at the Epworth escalated their industrial action last week with 4 hour stoppages last Wednesday (25/6) at Geelong and Richmond. Nurses are fighting for a 4.5% pay increase as well as industry standards wages and conditions - including a \$9 lead apron allowance.

AFAP/AIPA/TWU - Qantas

Industrial action on Qantas subsidiary Express Freighters Australia appears imminent with successful protected action ballots from members of AFAP, AIPA and the TWU. "Low level actions" [<https://substack.com/redirect/2c9aeaeb-d621-44da-a6aa-18b8b43cdf86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>] will commence on Friday (4/7) with workers not completing work on days off or before shifts start. Negotiations have been underway for more than 6 months with Qantas refusing to improve their offer [<https://substack.com/redirect/6d6fd92e-8a18-466e-a56e-ad33d49f695c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9-eM>].

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Pilots are fighting for improved wages and conditions.

AMWU Vic - Crown Equipment

Workers from Crown Equipment and their supporters rallied at Bunnings in Box Hill on Monday (30/6) to kick off a 48 hour strike. Bunnings is one of Crown Equipment's largest customers. Workers are fighting for a fair deal, while the bosses are trying to freeze their allowances. Workers at Crown Equipment sites in Wodonga, Mulgrave and Truganina commenced industrial action in June with bans on overtime and call outs.

ANMF Tasmania - RHH

Nurses in the Department of Medical Imaging at the Royal Hobart Hospital commenced industrial action last Tuesday [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/3c25b242-1fb3-478a-a0c7-662f6c289b12?](https://substack.com/redirect/3c25b242-1fb3-478a-a0c7-662f6c289b12?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](24/6). Nurses and their union have been demanding action on unsustainable and unsafe hours as well as understaffing since January, with no action from the government. Nurses have implemented bans on overtime and non-nursing duties as well as taking extra fatigue management breaks when on call [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/b8812249-70dc-4b2e-87c9-2f2cdd9596ad?](https://substack.com/redirect/b8812249-70dc-4b2e-87c9-2f2cdd9596ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

TWU Vic - CDC

Over 600 bus drivers employed by CDC Victoria held their third 24 hour strike on Tuesday [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/77016227-c084-4657-9919-c060dcdeb896?](https://substack.com/redirect/77016227-c084-4657-9919-c060dcdeb896?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (1/7). Buses in Melbourne, Geelong, Ballarat and Mildura were affected, with only school buses running in Werribee, Altona and Geelong, and no buses running at all in Ballarat. Buses ran less frequently in Oakleigh, Elsternwick, Brighton, Sydenham, Sunshine, Essendon, Glenroy and Mildura. Drivers are striking for improved pay and conditions, and demands around driver safety.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Bus drivers in Newcastle launched a fresh round of industrial action on Monday [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/d084bb66-5f3a-41dd-a624-f081a3201463?](https://substack.com/redirect/d084bb66-5f3a-41dd-a624-f081a3201463?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (30/6). Drivers will refuse to drive any vehicle with a "persistent warning light" which may cause delays and cancellations. Workers are fighting for a new EBA with a decent pay increase to keep up with the cost of living as well as 72 hours' notice for shift changes. Drivers previously held a 24 hour strike in April, and several weeks of not turning on Opal card readers. The bus network in Newcastle was also shut down by an HSR in March after a driver received serious threats from a passenger.

UWU - Grill'd

Workers at Grill'd in Victoria, Queensland and South Australia struck for 24 hours on Saturday (28/6). This followed earlier strike action [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/3aaca0be-cfa3-4652-9c1c-9f2336965e11?](https://substack.com/redirect/3aaca0be-cfa3-4652-9c1c-9f2336965e11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

NSWNMA - Westmead Hospital

Nurses at Westmead Hospital held a rally in their own time on 23 June over staff shortages and patient safety [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/f810a0fd-e0e8-4ea3-af55-b98914afa2d3?](https://substack.com/redirect/f810a0fd-e0e8-4ea3-af55-b98914afa2d3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Alarmingly, nurses are managing babies double or triple "parked" due to a lack of staff. The situation sounds quite dire, and nurses were calling on the Health Minister to ensure sufficient funding to properly staff the NICU. Nurses and midwives in NSW are waiting for a decision from the NSW IRC in relation to their "Special Case" for an award variation. This dispute with the state government has been going on for close to a year.

CFMEU/ETU QLD - Cape Flattery Silica Mine

Social posts from both the CFMEU [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/42302897-d147-4b39-a9ad-639adbeb3b7c?](https://substack.com/redirect/42302897-d147-4b39-a9ad-639adbeb3b7c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and ETU [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/d9f738c9-2f97-4b55-b0c3-c1ba689a560b?](https://substack.com/redirect/d9f738c9-2f97-4b55-b0c3-c1ba689a560b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

MEU NSW - Glencore

Workers at Glencore's Ulan Coal Mine commenced industrial action on 16/6 [[\(https://substack.com/redirect/e5837e1d-879b-4cfb-a247-4770c9bc9157?](https://substack.com/redirect/e5837e1d-879b-4cfb-a247-4770c9bc9157?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. According to the MEU, underground workers would be starting their shifts with 5 hour stoppages, with other bans and actions taking place both above and underground. Workers are fighting to be listened to in negotiations, for pay

increases and for flexibility clauses.

SASMOA - SA Doctors

Members of SASMOA attended a 1 hour stop work meeting last Wednesday (25/6). At the meeting doctors unanimously voted down the SA government's pay offer of 10% over 3 years and an extra \$4050 pay boost for junior doctors [https://substack.com/redirect/d6654808-64d2-417a-acc9-7506a46996f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. SASMOA is fighting for a 30% pay increase over 3 years. Doctors are threatening a full day strike on 30 July if the government doesn't put forward a better offer [https://substack.com/redirect/bab47b70-5ac9-44b8-9903-4018d6547e57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. More stop work meetings will be scheduled across the public health system over the week of 21 July.

CFMEU Vic - BMS

An update on the Concrete Gang [https://substack.com/redirect/ea99a86f-7962-4271-980b-e289b71dfd32?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] radio show [https://substack.com/redirect/ea99a86f-7962-4271-980b-e289b71dfd32?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on Sunday (29/6) confirmed that the dispute with BMS at the Golden Plains Wind Farm is ongoing. They also reported that there has been a serious injury on site. A rigger's leg became trapped between the wheel and frame of a trailer, resulting in him being hospitalised. This is the same site where installation technician Jess Patience was crushed to death by a turbine blade [https://substack.com/redirect/ecb8cf6b-69c4-4f53-adcd-2d3dcb1b10f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] last year. Time for BMS to sort out a fair deal and safety on site.

MEU - Peabody

Miners at the Metropolitan Mine [https://substack.com/redirect/15fe166e-e5f5-4a8c-8661-aaa6884cfac3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] near Helensburgh have been locked out since 18 June [https://substack.com/redirect/12f5a9d0-e352-4883-b019-e827e41dfbed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in retaliation for a one hour stop work action. Workers initially expected to return to work on Thursday 26/6 but Peabody has extended the lockout to 6 July [https://substack.com/redirect/ddb37453-306d-4d03-8a66-a8dbccb7879c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. This dramatic overreach from the mining giant is an obvious attempt to intimidate workers and punish them for exercising their industrial rights. Workers are fighting for 5% annual wage increases as well as \$1.50 added to their hourly rate [https://substack.com/redirect/a8981c98-5215-46bf-bf0f-9d02f64d0192?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

HSU/PSA SA - Public sector allied health workers

Despite my best efforts, I have been unable to get to the bottom of what is going on with the proposed SA public sector allied health agreement which is currently being voted on. On one hand the HSU is calling for a yes vote [https://substack.com/redirect/4eb53707-d4e4-4cc2-891a-84fda1284ace?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] spruiking a 13.5% total wage increase over the life of the agreement; improvements to progression; easier access to 5 weeks annual leave and fixed term contract protections. The PSA is calling for a no vote [https://substack.com/redirect/827ca896-13ae-4cf7-a749-57853dfdf7cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] deeming the wage offer inadequate and that the agreement "removes and waters down a lot of really important workplace rights." I don't know enough about the sector or the state; nor have I seen the agreement to be able to shed much light on this. I would love to hear from any affected HSU or PSA members who have a more informed view to share. The ballot opened on Monday (30/6) and will close on Sunday (6/7).

VAHPA - I-MED

Workers at I-MED continue to take industrial action in pursuit of a decent pay increase and the industry standard 5 weeks of annual leave. It is understood that all metro Melbourne I-MED sites stopped work 2-4 hours on 25 June to attend a members' meeting. On Monday (30/6) workers at Camberwell, Caulfield, Collins Street, East Melbourne, Kew and South Yarra stopped work for 24 hours severely impacting some services. There hasn't been a lot of media coverage on this dispute, but a new rank and file newsletter, VAHPA Pulse [https://substack.com/redirect/00ddfc5c-24a1-4516-ba65-f393a0381cc1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], launched this week aiming to "to re-activate, re-invigorate, find our Union pulse and WIN." So hopefully VAHPA Pulse will be able to keep us updated on this and other VAHPA disputes.

CFMEU - Administration

On 18 June, the High Court unanimously rejected [https://substack.com/redirect/a24e71b7-ea3c-4f95-9285-23a61c65c83c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] the case brought by former CFMEU officials challenging the legality of changes to the Fair Work Act that put the union into administration. The next day (19 June), CFMEU members in Queensland marched through the streets and rallied outside the CFMEU Queensland Branch office in Brisbane [https://substack.com/redirect/55043d28-9c57-493d-9d00-1e39d70585d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], demanding the return of their union to democratic control. Despite calls from Administrator Mark Irving for workers to return to

work [https://substack.com/redirect/bf6e77c0-be0d-456c-a61d-90845d0f534a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the protests in Brisbane continued for a second day [https://substack.com/redirect/b75a6da1-ad81-490c-97a4-71d74ab2dd64?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (20 June). The wildcat action did not continue into the next week, nor did it spread to other states. Last week, former Minister for Employment and Workplace Relations Tony Burke, congratulated himself for putting the union into administration rather than deregistration [https://substack.com/redirect/def7a76e-e1fd-4a39-819c-d2456f06625c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Mark Irving and his team busied themselves leaking an audit report from Kordamentha [https://substack.com/redirect/2af3ba97-a4cc-4c6d-baf6-763fe8d983d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to The Australian. The “confidential” report discovered that the CFMEU has assets! If that’s a crime, maybe Irving can move onto administering some BRW Rich Listers?

UWU - Allied Pinnacle

Workers at Allied Pinnacle have reached an agreement for a new EBA. The new deal includes an 8% wage increase over 2 years as well as an increase to shift loadings for 19% to 25% for working unsociable hours and casual loadings increasing from 21% to 25%. Workers’ original demand had been for 15% over 3 years, and the initial offer from Allied Pinnacle had been 11.25% over 3 years.

TWU QLD - Cleanaway Noosa

Workers at Cleanaway Noosa have voted up a new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/83922d51-204f-4305-afe7-8ee782d22944?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which includes a pay increase of 9.68%; legal indemnity for drivers; a \$2500 end of contract bonus and an additional paid work break. This follows ongoing industrial action and negotiations since February, including 7 days of strike action. Media reports earlier in the year claimed workers were fighting for a 7% pay increase in the first year [https://substack.com/redirect/2927e0cf-31ad-4417-9350-ef279f9b1c90?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - I am unsure if that has been realised in this agreement.

That’s all I’ve got this week - and that should be enough! A big round up after a week off. To finish up, I want to share a new piece of mine that was published in Overland [

https://substack.com/redirect/8531af79-23b6-4b0a-8841-da5e7491bf4d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A democratic way forward for the

CFMEU [https://substack.com/redirect/1587e307-5a88-43bb-9fe6-ec319ef694a2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is the product of many hours of

thinking about corruption, the administration of the CFMEU and what it means (and the great responsibility of) representing workers in a union. My comrade Sam Wallman [

https://substack.com/redirect/3f418a13-0432-48bd-8e2e-fa2311a53ded?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] drew some beautiful illustrations

to go along with the piece. I am very grateful to him and to Overland. I’d love to hear your thoughts- on the Overland piece; Disputes Report or any current or emerging disputes. Get in touch!

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UWTNNa1l3T1RRM0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05URTBNRFUyTmNc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE1qazBNVFkyTXl3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlxbHNjbjAuQ1hIdl90Y0oyeHdBWlwbHh5M3NfaEtQMEVjanNzZlVtMkp1OWFLOEZTVSIsInAiOjE2NzI2MDk0NywicYI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc1MTQwNTY2MywiZXhwIjoyMDY2OTgxNjYzLCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.2Q3qsm1UhiZGD40FOXyZlW5l2a0gY7iddw3f0GlgOMY?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-2-september>

ASMOF Vic - Public hospital doctors

Doctors at Victorian public hospitals have commenced industrial action for the first time in 20 years. Doctors had initially intended to take stop work action for 3.5 hours on 13 August [https://substack.com/redirect/8b3fa463-c792-4932-acd6-ba29176eabc8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. However the state government accused the union of not submitting their paperwork correctly [https://substack.com/redirect/0304d10e-0ad9-4f1c-afeb-3af918c4a846?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and the action was cancelled. A week later on 20 August doctors from the Royal Melbourne Hospital, the Royal Women's Hospital, the Royal Children's Hospital, the Royal Victorian Eye and Ear Hospital, Western Health Hospitals, The Alfred, the Peter MacCallum Cancer Centre, St Vincent's Health and Parkville Youth Mental Health and Wellbeing Service walked off the job for 4 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/3e944884-95c1-4e41-b785-d355973b7e47?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The doctors rallied outside the Peter MacCallum Cancer Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/4e67e2ba-f90b-488d-8ac8-2a5229519055?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. On 25 August, doctors at Monash Health and Eastern Health took their turn to strike for 4 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/8b6f4611-a894-4fd0-9b1e-a6f234ce8030?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. On 27 August, doctors from Northern Health, Mercy Health and Austin Health walked off the job for 4 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/df9c8856-02b9-4000-be79-2f88665be039?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In addition to these stopwork actions, doctors across the state are participating in a range of work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/d59f6600-d0be-492c-86f7-7cd1f1fd9360?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. After over 12 months of negotiations, doctors are fighting for a 30% pay increase over 4 years [https://substack.com/redirect/73495693-595d-45f5-bfd4-78a97e47275d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as well as improvements to conditions, safety, training and career development.

AMOU/MUA QLD - RiverCity Ferries

Industrial action has continued throughout August on Brisbane's CityCat ferries run by RiverCity Ferries. Union members have conducted stoppages on 15 August (4 hours); 17 August (2 hours morning and 2 hours evening); 21 August (2 hours morning and 2 hours evening); 22 August (2 hours); Monday 24 August (4 hours); Wednesday 26 August (2 hours morning and 2 hours evening) and a complete stoppage with no ferries running on 28 August [https://substack.com/redirect/0b031513-7c8b-4c59-a949-c94ef6bec714?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Yesterday the ABC reported that workers will undertake another 24 hour stoppage this coming Saturday [https://substack.com/redirect/0341c1ce-2219-4b6d-b60c-bedef02394d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (5/9) which will disrupt the Riverfire festival. Unions have been in negotiations with RiverCity Ferries for 9 months [https://substack.com/redirect/3f215b67-0f37-40f2-bf63-fef1289e6cd1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a 6% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/55d11bf6-752b-42c0-883b-550e9816930f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the first year of a new agreement followed by 4.75% or the FWC increase, whichever is greater; as well as backpay from the expiry of the current agreement. Workers are also demanding improvements to paid parental leave; heat and inclement weather policies; a 12 hour break between shifts and increased meal breaks.

CPSU/ETU/MEAA Victoria - Arts Centre Melbourne

In early August, workers at the Arts Centre Melbourne voted in favour of taking industrial action. Wages at the Arts Centre Melbourne have fallen 10% behind inflation since 2022 [https://substack.com/redirect/ff8d2585-c6b5-4b5e-939d-5b9f10d036f4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Nearly 40% of the workforce is on the lowest pay band, with many workers now being paid the minimum award wage. Due to the state government wage cap, workers are only being offered a 3% wage increase this year - a wage cut in real terms. Workers have been taking industrial action over the last few weeks. On 13 August [https://substack.com/redirect/596661b3-01e2-44d6-96b4-9d4ff794b85f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] workers explained their industrial campaign to audiences [https://substack.com/redirect/75c85cd0-c6f0-494d-999d-65c402dc36c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and handed out leaflets. Workers took action again on 21 August [https://substack.com/redirect/5d64a49b-fdd9-4ae0-aad4-74d3a8c0b0d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at Hamer Hall.

AMWU/ETU/RTBU/The Services Union - Queensland Rail

Queensland Rail has reached an in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/ebd7e9ca-a604-4fc8-8fe8-2e8c7d312bd5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] with the RTBU and The Services Union for the EBA covering train controllers. This follows 3 in-principle agreements being made in July [https://substack.com/redirect/954b3444-ddd4-4222-9950-6cd1eace7bd6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] - the administrative, professional and technical enterprise agreement; the travel and tourism and other employees enterprise agreement; and the station operations enterprise agreement. Two agreements are still being negotiated [https://substack.com/redirect/3f125252-f773-4927-af1f-a6bbdd1f89e9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], the network and rolling stock agreement mainly covering AMWU members, and a separate electrical only agreement being pursued by the ETU. The train controllers' in-principle agreement includes an 8.5% wage increase over 3 years, a potential additional cost of living relief payment depending on inflation and a "strategic delivery allowance" related to the delivery of major projects. Workers will receive backpay from 1 August. Disruptions and delays on the train network are likely to continue as the AMWU and ETU continue to participate in industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/68ff4213-7b82-4224-815b-8a794a6b0154?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] including rolling stoppages and overtime bans which are having impacts on maintenance and repairs.

AMWU/ETU Vic - Downer

Industrial action at Downer's Pakenham East depot that maintains Melbourne's new High Capacity Metro Trains (HCMT) has been ongoing since 24 July [https://substack.com/redirect/97e962dc-9381-4997-85bf-9436626a3884?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are participating in half day strikes and full-day strikes on Mondays. The action is slowing down maintenance, and is now causing cancellations. 89 services were cancelled on Wednesday, Thursday and Friday last week. From yesterday (1/9), some services are being replaced entirely by buses [https://substack.com/redirect/9535f8a1-0d09-4fef-8b9a-cf16fe3ed269?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

The AMWU and ETU have shared that Downer is sending workers from WA [https://substack.com/redirect/08ef6fdf-5baf-4cfa-9fcc-30196a383aa4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to work at the depot, unaware that there is a dispute going on. Workers are seeking pay parity with workers who perform the same work at Metro Trains and V/Line.

AWU Qld - Youth detention centres

AWU members working in Queensland's Youth Detention Centres and in Youth Justice have commenced industrial action. AWU members at the 4 youth detention centres in Queensland struck for 8 hours on 6 August [https://substack.com/redirect/dde35a3e-512c-49c5-80b4-ea06e04e853c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

This was followed by a 24 hour strike on 24 August [https://substack.com/redirect/6224f820-2d0c-4276-ba36-dba9f97be622?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] by both operational and non-operational staff. This means as well as the officers in detention centres, other workers such as case managers and speech pathologists also went on strike. In addition to the strike action, work bans have been in place [https://substack.com/redirect/1eccc072-a7f6-4863-84fc-e7ca1cfc2051?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] including not moving young people around the centre; not taking them to afternoon programs; and not escorting them to education and therapeutics. AWU members are fighting for a decent pay increase, but also calling out severe overcrowding in youth detention centres that is increasing violence within the facilities. Workers are yet to receive an offer [https://substack.com/redirect/00ce9a53-b5c7-43ed-9f6b-7b1c05fd50a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] from the state government. The Crisafulli government just last week admitted its tough "breach bail, go to jail laws" would further overcrowd prisons and detention centres and would require overriding the Queensland Human Rights Act [https://substack.com/redirect/b12ed622-6e3a-4e99-98e6-2269329d12a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. A horrendous situation. Kids don't belong in prisons.

NTEU Victoria - University of Melbourne

NTEU members at the University of Melbourne have commenced industrial action. Workers held a 2 hour stopwork meeting on 13 August, and a 5 hour strike and rally on 27 August [https://substack.com/redirect/4e41968b-8dfb-4c1b-bdde-76db3052da4e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

The NTEU has been negotiating with the University since November 2025 [https://substack.com/redirect/83255592-a71b-4830-9749-1351a2deec17?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The log of claims [https://substack.com/redirect/4af4d453-aa76-4276-9c8a-5ea03dfe2dcd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] includes a 20% wage increase for all workers; action on workload and job security; sick leave for casuals; casual workers to receive the same rate of superannuation at permanent staff (17%); and improvements to leave. A mass meeting held after the strike on 27 August voted in favour of a new claim [https://substack.com/redirect/e18323f9-c487-46af-aef3-bd0d452dc96d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] which would require all major

changes that would permanently relocate staff be put to a ballot of affected staff and receive majority approval to be implemented. In the last EBA campaign in 2023 at the University, workers participated in 2 week-long strikes [https://substack.com/redirect/777571a4-3bb6-46ae-997b-5fc7b500d6e0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

MUA NSW - Transdev Sydney Ferries

MUA members working for Transdev on Sydney's iconic ferries will strike for 5 hours today [https://substack.com/redirect/ad502380-248e-4d7c-ba23-9646b2dc51ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (2/9) from 9am - 2pm. Opal readers will be turned off on the ferries when services resume on Wednesday as a gesture of goodwill to ferry passengers. Workers are fighting for a fair EBA with a 5% increase to base rates, as well as yearly increases to keep with the cost of living [https://substack.com/redirect/8a307ccd-c60f-4aa6-8070-1d5935d12b3f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The MUA has asked members, unionists and supporters to join striking workers at Circular Quay this morning from 9am [https://substack.com/redirect/3762b466-7972-47ef-b1a4-9db363be5dba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

ASMOF/CFMEU/CPSU/HSU/PPTEU/Professionals Australia ACT - ACT Public Sector

The ACT Government's ballot for Administrative and Related Classifications Enterprise Agreement opened last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/dc6896d6-4328-40db-90b9-c6cf130ebf34?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (26/8). Unions in the ACT are running a "vote no" campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/4b9d6f8c-c231-49cf-8ab7-8abff434b3de?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on this agreement which sets the floor on pay and conditions for other frontline EBAs. Unions believe that a 3% wage increase is not enough to keep up with the cost of living and that current superannuation payments are insufficient. CFMEU members employed as GSOs implemented a ban on collecting general litter in Civic [https://substack.com/redirect/84161b52-4808-4505-9615-cc0053cca3d3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on 9 and 10 August, and then in Braddon on 16 & 17 August [https://substack.com/redirect/b1b033f7-099a-4110-b909-c00ae2353bf2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Sonographers in ACT public hospitals - a mixture of CPSU and HSU members - commenced rolling stoppages on 24 August [https://substack.com/redirect/76be66af-cd2e-4484-b65c-adb46c4f6de7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] where one day a week non-urgent patients will not be seen.

NTEU NSW - University of Sydney

NTEU members at the University of Sydney are striking for 24 hours today (2/9). Formal bargaining for a new EBA commenced in April [https://substack.com/redirect/3138c33b-021a-4cba-a7de-c2e38a38bf7e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], having been delayed by USyd management for 6 weeks. A number of "deadlocks" in negotiating [https://substack.com/redirect/481d2473-f89f-4341-97d5-c341baa5cfff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] have led workers to strike action. The log of claims [https://substack.com/redirect/089515d1-1768-4d40-a2cf-0474402681b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] developed by NTEU members includes a single agreement covering all workers at the university; a 20% wage increase over the life of the agreement; casual workers to receive the same rate of superannuation at permanent staff (17%); improvements on workload and job security, and protections from AI [https://substack.com/redirect/30e21787-7882-427f-9fe9-a8c1ee9c7fd2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. NTEU members had intended to hold a 2-hour stop work meeting [https://substack.com/redirect/512c6a50-e3d0-433d-bce4-2b89819b2607?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on 10 August, but this was cancelled due to a paperwork error. The 24 hour strike today is expected to include picket lines on the major entrances of the university.

ASU Victoria - Service Stream

ASU members employed by Service Stream to conduct maintenance work on Bendigo's water supply infrastructure struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/935e1158-4fd0-42be-8140-d3718f715fa7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on August 10. Workers in Bendigo are paid \$20,000 less than their counterparts employed by Central Highlands Water in Ballarat. Service Stream is contracted by Coliban Water in Bendigo, who were themselves subjected to industrial action by disgruntled workers earlier this year. According to media reports, ASU members are seeking a 3.5% pay increase on top of what has already been offered by Service Stream.

ETU/MUA NSW - Newcastle Coal Infrastructure Group

On 24 August, ETU and MUA members employed by the Newcastle Coal Infrastructure Group at the Kooragang Island terminal commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/019fed7b-4471-433b-bd8a-7522e7602c44?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are currently on a 16 year old agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/f6476f0c-ba2d-48e8-821f-8df8e7b4aa57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] - a legacy of the Howard Work Choices era. After 6 months of negotiations, and 98% of the workforce voting down an

offer from NCIG, workers have commenced stoppages and bans on overtime. Workers are seeking a 20% pay increase over 4 years [https://substack.com/redirect/86090cad-091e-434a-b2a9-6e7a5a0041cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], family friendly rostering, and improved management of public holidays.

Together QLD - Child Safety and Youth Justice workers

Together members working in Child Safety and Youth Justice commenced industrial action in early August. Union members are wearing stickers, putting up posters, and adding to their email signature as part of the industrial campaign for better wages and conditions, and adequate resourcing for their work. The state government applied to the QIRC [https://substack.com/redirect/f5a472fb-9cf3-48e4-8428-290e11c905f8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to have work bans affecting electronic case notes overturned. Together also coordinated a vigil [https://substack.com/redirect/2258fbf7-7ec4-4e70-9d73-833e99ec4b7f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for the children the system is failing outside Parliament House during estimates.

AWU/CPSU Vic - Parks Victoria

While negotiations continue with Parks Victoria, so does industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/51ecf2e2-b698-4d77-b0d2-8ede7927f690?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

AWU members took strike action over the weekend of 22-23 August [https://substack.com/redirect/dc6721ef-8d4d-4512-ad32-9975e8ed9fa5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. From 28 August CPSU members have implemented a range of indefinite bans including a ban on opening parks to public access; a ban on rubbish collection and cleaning facilities and fireplaces; a ban on enforcement and compliance activities; a ban on Ranger talks; and a range of administrative bans. Workers are seeking pay parity with their counterparts in the Victorian public service (Parks Victoria is a statutory authority).

AMWU/ETU/WMA - BHP

Union members at BHP Port Hedland escalated their industrial action in early August with a 24 hour ship loading ban on 8 August and a 24 hour work stoppage from 5:30am on 9 August [https://substack.com/redirect/e76c088c-e9db-41dd-87fd-6ff2eea77f1d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. As with the previous 8 hour stoppage in July, according to BHP the industrial action had no effect on anything, and according to the unions it was a successful stoppage. BHP and the unions were set to meet in the FWC again on 18 August, and I don't have any further updates on how negotiations are travelling or future industrial action. I do have two other BHP items worth nothing though. On 8 August, during the strike weekend, a contractor's elbow was broken [https://substack.com/redirect/ef45097d-344d-4071-86ce-0be5c12fa584?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] during maintenance of a rail car dumper. And sometime after the strike weekend, 3 union organisers were removed from a site meeting by security guards [https://substack.com/redirect/a447e606-f759-4183-8dd8-9f8b1505e5c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Apparently a BHP staff member told the organisers to sit down while addressing a meeting in a crib room. The only problem was, the meeting was standing room only - there were no seats left.

In short

ETU NSW - Confluence Water

On 14 August, ETU members at Confluence Water, a key contractor for Sydney's water supply, walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/377d09a8-a18b-4ba6-93a9-a548d2d1b6e9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers commenced industrial action after 18 months of negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/d176a0a8-75fb-4fe6-9236-8ff61903b25d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and bosses cancelling negotiating meetings [https://substack.com/redirect/8bc33cda-4a50-428e-b741-9ada2a72007e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. On 17 August, ETU members rallied outside Sydney Water's headquarters demanding a fair deal.

VAHPA - Public sector allied health workers

VAHPA members from the public sector struck for 24 hours on 11 August [https://substack.com/redirect/0a1453f2-9495-4302-8a25-5bb9219cabf5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. VAHPA has been in negotiations with the state government for 11 months, and are demanding a 38.16% pay increase. On 11 August, workers rallied outside the Peter MacCallum Cancer Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/d4e42b13-5d7d-41e8-931d-362e6561c49a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in Parkville.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU WA - BP

Union members at BP's Kwinana site have commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/1bfe6b72-3186-4671-9d59-03dca23819c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers wages have eroded over the past decade, and workers are seeking a fair deal from multinational BP [https://substack.com/redirect/4a6589f0-a2a6-48e7-aa27-77d17eaf6263?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to keep up with the cost of living.

HACSU Vic - Scope

Last Wednesday (26/8), HACSU members from Scope walked off the job and rallied in Kew [[https://substack.com/redirect/b313b4b0-b4c8-4b02-985c-2038afe9f594?](https://substack.com/redirect/b313b4b0-b4c8-4b02-985c-2038afe9f594?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for better pay and conditions [[https://substack.com/redirect/52fdc3f1-862b-4036-93f4-e8cebfd28a1f?](https://substack.com/redirect/52fdc3f1-862b-4036-93f4-e8cebfd28a1f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], as well as trying to stop Scope from selling its disability transport buses [[https://substack.com/redirect/95c466b8-7c1c-4a82-999a-1c951109bbb0?](https://substack.com/redirect/95c466b8-7c1c-4a82-999a-1c951109bbb0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and to reverse its decision to withdraw accessible transport from supported accommodation residents. HACSU is calling on both state and federal governments to properly fund disability care.

CEPU SA - TAFE SA

On 19 August, 60 TAFE lecturers walked off the job at TAFE SA [[https://substack.com/redirect/8d5ecab1-f2f3-49d9-8614-b8e6cb65b7e1?](https://substack.com/redirect/8d5ecab1-f2f3-49d9-8614-b8e6cb65b7e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Trades lecturers are seeking a 20% wage increase over 3 years to restore wages to “near their 2015 level” and ensure qualified staff can be retained. Some TAFE teachers earn less than the fourth year apprentices [[https://substack.com/redirect/04db91d3-0241-49d7-8e0f-c640a30a24f5?](https://substack.com/redirect/04db91d3-0241-49d7-8e0f-c640a30a24f5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] they teach. In addition to stoppages, the teachers are not marking attendance or providing results to students. The CEPU has been in negotiations with TAFE SA for 22 months.

CPSU/HACSU Tasmania - Child Safety and Youth Justice workers

Last Wednesday (26/8), union members working in Child Safety and Youth Justice walked off the job to attend a stop work meeting [[https://substack.com/redirect/c237d321-1cd6-4ce0-be6b-75d444ca9098?](https://substack.com/redirect/c237d321-1cd6-4ce0-be6b-75d444ca9098?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. At the meeting, workers discussed concerns about the negotiation of their agreement - specifically the Tasmanian government’s proposal to cut the Child Safety Allowance by 40% [[https://substack.com/redirect/c21b384c-30d7-4d17-a8de-c020c87b7fb8?](https://substack.com/redirect/c21b384c-30d7-4d17-a8de-c020c87b7fb8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The allowance is a measure to retain and attract staff. Cutting this allowance is an attack on workers’ conditions, and threatens the sustainability of Tasmania’s Child protection services.

UWU - Bridgestone

On 24 August, UWU members working at Bridgestone went on strike [[https://substack.com/redirect/ac76da22-f827-4b9f-8c9f-259a01579378?](https://substack.com/redirect/ac76da22-f827-4b9f-8c9f-259a01579378?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for the first time ever. Workers are seeking fair wage increases that will keep pace with the cost of living. Despite productivity improvements over the last two years, Bridgestone is refusing to pay workers a decent wage. Workers are asking supporters to sign this petition [[https://substack.com/redirect/9a809c78-3032-4c76-a62f-09ddf550b277?](https://substack.com/redirect/9a809c78-3032-4c76-a62f-09ddf550b277?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

AWU Vic - RLA Polymers

Since my last report, there has been more industrial action at RLA Polymers [[https://substack.com/redirect/9a9c00c3-e4f8-4b14-89e1-30d535117007?](https://substack.com/redirect/9a9c00c3-e4f8-4b14-89e1-30d535117007?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers struck for 24 hours on 7 August [[https://substack.com/redirect/d16ad14d-5c7a-4d77-b6d8-a4e37f8264d7?](https://substack.com/redirect/d16ad14d-5c7a-4d77-b6d8-a4e37f8264d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and commenced a 4 day stoppage [[https://substack.com/redirect/1788e8fd-6da2-4931-8d3e-4bdca789ba4c?](https://substack.com/redirect/1788e8fd-6da2-4931-8d3e-4bdca789ba4c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] yesterday (1/9). Workers are fighting for better pay and conditions [[https://substack.com/redirect/e05f968f-1a8e-4313-90cf-9f719565f93d?](https://substack.com/redirect/e05f968f-1a8e-4313-90cf-9f719565f93d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and to defend their entitlements including voluntary redundancy.

TWU - FedEx

On Friday (28/8), TWU members at FedEx walked off the job for two hours [[https://substack.com/redirect/a522851a-4cab-432f-8c2d-87914c6e34c6?](https://substack.com/redirect/a522851a-4cab-432f-8c2d-87914c6e34c6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. FedEx is refusing to protect workers against AI and automation, and is shifting work to contracted drivers on piece rates [[https://substack.com/redirect/b3446f43-c094-448b-a8c7-16ac70ce64cf?](https://substack.com/redirect/b3446f43-c094-448b-a8c7-16ac70ce64cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. FedEx responded to the 2 hour stoppage by locking workers out [[https://substack.com/redirect/474f560f-d686-4024-86dc-c2fb28ff511e?](https://substack.com/redirect/474f560f-d686-4024-86dc-c2fb28ff511e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for the whole day, meaning they will receive no wages. This is the first industrial action in the TWU’s coordinated, industry-wide campaign [[https://substack.com/redirect/2fedab3c-d89f-48b5-ae7c-3d20d8688e24?](https://substack.com/redirect/2fedab3c-d89f-48b5-ae7c-3d20d8688e24?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the logistics and freight sector.

TWU WA - Cleanaway

TWU members from Cleanaway in Kwinana went on strike on 17 August [

[https://substack.com/redirect/77691cf0-6f90-49a2-8414-46fdb9064b34?](https://substack.com/redirect/77691cf0-6f90-49a2-8414-46fdb9064b34?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/77691cf0-6f90-49a2-8414-46fdb9064b34?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Workers are fighting for 4% annual wage increases to keep up with the cost of living. Cleanaway is not coming to the table, so workers were left with no choice but to commence industrial action.

UWU WA - ISS

Airport screening officers at Perth airport held more stoppages [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d8ba53ad-b541-4c86-a0ed-b43bde86da9c?](https://substack.com/redirect/d8ba53ad-b541-4c86-a0ed-b43bde86da9c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d8ba53ad-b541-4c86-a0ed-b43bde86da9c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] on 14 August. This followed stoppages on 5 August [[https://substack.com/redirect/4bea6700-b937-420f-a972-04de2c054135?](https://substack.com/redirect/4bea6700-b937-420f-a972-04de2c054135?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4bea6700-b937-420f-a972-04de2c054135?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and in July [

[https://substack.com/redirect/ea25f7af-2f20-41c4-89c1-da3cf7285da4?](https://substack.com/redirect/ea25f7af-2f20-41c4-89c1-da3cf7285da4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ea25f7af-2f20-41c4-89c1-da3cf7285da4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Workers are fighting for pay parity with airport screening officers on the east coast as well as secure jobs and respectful rostering practices.

MUA Victoria - Quantem

The MUA has called for all workers to join a rally at 8am this morning [

[https://substack.com/redirect/ed8d3796-d1f0-4543-b308-9b7bebbf0095?](https://substack.com/redirect/ed8d3796-d1f0-4543-b308-9b7bebbf0095?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ed8d3796-d1f0-4543-b308-9b7bebbf0095?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] (2/9) at Mackenzie Road, West Melbourne. Workers at Quantem, one of Melbourne's biggest bulk liquid ports, were set to take strike action this morning. But on Monday evening (31/8) the MUA notified supporters that every single worker at Quantem had been stood down in response to the industrial action. If by chance you read this at 7:30am and live near the port - get down there!

RTBU - Pacific National

On 19 August, RTBU intermodal train crew members at Pacific National implemented more bans as part of their campaign of industrial action. Train drivers implemented a 7-day overtime ban and a sticker campaign [[https://substack.com/redirect/18260d62-2086-4c79-9fe3-d46843af9a55?](https://substack.com/redirect/18260d62-2086-4c79-9fe3-d46843af9a55?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/18260d62-2086-4c79-9fe3-d46843af9a55?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The sticker campaign [

[https://substack.com/redirect/575c44fc-d507-4009-8230-2f6a3030d46f?](https://substack.com/redirect/575c44fc-d507-4009-8230-2f6a3030d46f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/575c44fc-d507-4009-8230-2f6a3030d46f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] means that if there is not a RTBU sticker on the locomotive, union members will not drive the locomotive. RTBU members commenced industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/474a3232-b207-4558-8e5e-50bf97be9fa7?](https://substack.com/redirect/474a3232-b207-4558-8e5e-50bf97be9fa7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/474a3232-b207-4558-8e5e-50bf97be9fa7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] on 1 August with a 48 hour overtime ban and a 24 hour ban on lift up and lay back. Workers are fighting for better work/life balance; fair conditions and basic respect.

PABO Watch

TWU Vic - CEVA

TWU members at CEVA logistics are voting in a protected action ballot [

[https://substack.com/redirect/0b6f918c-df7e-4c0d-a5a6-54bf937b3e5e?](https://substack.com/redirect/0b6f918c-df7e-4c0d-a5a6-54bf937b3e5e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0b6f918c-df7e-4c0d-a5a6-54bf937b3e5e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Workers are fed up with waiting for a fair wages offer from the boss. They are also fighting back against workers being replaced by robots [[https://substack.com/redirect/0b6f918c-df7e-4c0d-a5a6-54bf937b3e5e?](https://substack.com/redirect/0b6f918c-df7e-4c0d-a5a6-54bf937b3e5e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0b6f918c-df7e-4c0d-a5a6-54bf937b3e5e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and demanding job security.

AIPA/ASU/Professionals Australia/TWU - Qantas

Qantas has reported massive pre-tax profits of \$2 billion [[https://substack.com/redirect/16b69eea-c11d-41bb-b175-a0b8c3917b48?](https://substack.com/redirect/16b69eea-c11d-41bb-b175-a0b8c3917b48?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/16b69eea-c11d-41bb-b175-a0b8c3917b48?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and has paid out \$700 million to shareholders. But the airline seems incapable of sharing its success with its workforce and is involved in a number of industrial disputes across its business. This is a bit hard to track as workers at Qantas are now spread across 38 different subsidiaries and labour hire companies [[https://substack.com/redirect/6adddd92-7d0d-4785-80ae-1c041272e9ac?](https://substack.com/redirect/6adddd92-7d0d-4785-80ae-1c041272e9ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6adddd92-7d0d-4785-80ae-1c041272e9ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. TWU members who are Qantas Ground Services workers have voted in favour of protected industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b5b3583e-bed0-4abd-9bf9-c2f6feeea4c1?](https://substack.com/redirect/b5b3583e-bed0-4abd-9bf9-c2f6feeea4c1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b5b3583e-bed0-4abd-9bf9-c2f6feeea4c1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. 97% of workers who voted in the ballot were in favour of taking industrial action. ASU members working in operations at Jetstar, Qantas' budget subsidiary, are also voting in a protected action ballot [

[https://substack.com/redirect/94fcfc9f-d7bb-41d7-bf18-253f76a6496e?](https://substack.com/redirect/94fcfc9f-d7bb-41d7-bf18-253f76a6496e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/94fcfc9f-d7bb-41d7-bf18-253f76a6496e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Jetstar has offered workers 3% annual wage increases, but workers want more. ASU members will vote on a range of actions including stoppages, uniform bans and waiving excess baggage charges. Engineers at Qantas represented by Professionals Australia have also applied to the FWC for a protected action ballot [

[https://substack.com/redirect/582ea5f7-b38f-4d62-b37a-b01194dc771a?](https://substack.com/redirect/582ea5f7-b38f-4d62-b37a-b01194dc771a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/582ea5f7-b38f-4d62-b37a-b01194dc771a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Professionals Australia members unanimously rejected Qantas' pay offer [[https://substack.com/redirect/c076b061-874a-4a3d-b85c-f56b353a6614?](https://substack.com/redirect/c076b061-874a-4a3d-b85c-f56b353a6614?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c076b061-874a-4a3d-b85c-f56b353a6614?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and instructed their union to apply for a PABO. Negotiations have been underway for over 12 months [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2394eddd-01c4-46bc-b479-5003fe8ed624?](https://substack.com/redirect/2394eddd-01c4-46bc-b479-5003fe8ed624?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2394eddd-01c4-46bc-b479-5003fe8ed624?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)], and workers want Qantas to speed up and make a decent offer. Finally, while AIPA (Australian and International Pilots Association) members had voted in favour of taking protected industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/7b3f6e67-4127-495a-8b24-c7126925106e?](https://substack.com/redirect/7b3f6e67-4127-495a-8b24-c7126925106e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM) [j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7b3f6e67-4127-495a-8b24-c7126925106e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)], the basis for an acceptable new Long-Haul EBA [[https://substack.com/redirect/81e3aed6-446d-4b16-8741-42845d1c5db1?](https://substack.com/redirect/81e3aed6-446d-4b16-8741-42845d1c5db1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM) [j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/81e3aed6-446d-4b16-8741-42845d1c5db1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] was thrashed out in the FWC between Qantas, AIPA and AFAP. This has averted strike action amongst pilots, but as you can see - certainly not a great environment for workers at Qantas.

Professionals Australia NSW - Sydney Water

Professionals Australia members at Sydney Water are voting in a protected action ballot. Workers have been bargaining for a new agreement for 6 months. Workers at Sydney Water have been subjected to a disastrous rollout of a new payroll system [[https://substack.com/redirect/8e385e67-bd4c-4705-9291-1d7702b24967?](https://substack.com/redirect/8e385e67-bd4c-4705-9291-1d7702b24967?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM) [j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8e385e67-bd4c-4705-9291-1d7702b24967?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] leaving workers unpaid or incorrectly paid for weeks. Professionals Australia are fighting for decent pay increases to keep up with the cost of living, fair working hours, and assumedly to be paid on time and correctly!

Unions news

VAHPA Pulse election win

VAHPA Pulse [[https://substack.com/redirect/fbf02804-a1bb-4233-a009-6b22b1e4f82f?](https://substack.com/redirect/fbf02804-a1bb-4233-a009-6b22b1e4f82f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fbf02804-a1bb-4233-a009-6b22b1e4f82f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)], a rank and file group in VAHPA, has won their election campaign and will take control of the union. VAHPA Pulse first started organising in October 2024 last year from a growing sense of dissatisfaction with the management of their union. They launched their newsletter and formally became VAHPA Pulse in June last year, first taking aim at their union's approach to negotiating the Allied Health public sector EBA. By October, VAHPA Pulse pivoted to campaign against a planned merger between VAHPA and HACSU endorsed by the HSU National office. By December, they had managed to organise a shock defeat of the merger plan [[https://substack.com/redirect/a6617ad4-d4e7-4f41-a2ec-3503dcdc3afa?](https://substack.com/redirect/a6617ad4-d4e7-4f41-a2ec-3503dcdc3afa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a6617ad4-d4e7-4f41-a2ec-3503dcdc3afa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] with 96.7% of members present at a Special General Meeting voting against the planned merger. No small feat for a rank and file group! This year's election for branch leadership positions was the first contested election at VAHPA in 14 years. The last contested election was when Craig McGregor's "Clean Sweep" ticket [[https://substack.com/redirect/2357fa38-c245-46b3-b7bc-b9309a7e8c5d?](https://substack.com/redirect/2357fa38-c245-46b3-b7bc-b9309a7e8c5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2357fa38-c245-46b3-b7bc-b9309a7e8c5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] won against a ticket backed by Kathy Jackson and David Feeney. McGregor, who has faced allegations of sexual harassment and workplace bullying [[https://substack.com/redirect/278d3767-9c47-4979-af11-55ffe777b29d?](https://substack.com/redirect/278d3767-9c47-4979-af11-55ffe777b29d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/278d3767-9c47-4979-af11-55ffe777b29d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)], did not stand for re-election. VAHPA Executive Officer Andrew Hewatt led the "VAHPA Unity" ticket alongside Assistant Secretary Bernada Cavka, and branch management committee members Anthony D'Amore and Nicole Erlich. VAHPA Pulse's ticket across the board got about 60% of votes. Only 26% of eligible VAHPA members voted in the election. Incoming leadership team Aneta Menkinoska (Secretary); Lil Muir (Assistant Secretary); Marni Jackson (President) and Chris Parsons (Vice President) are all rank and file VAHPA members, who will have a big job ahead of them to negotiate a decent public sector agreement as the state hurtles towards an uncertain election. Before the results of the election, VAHPA Pulse wrote about what success would look like [[https://substack.com/redirect/e5065ebe-3d8e-416e-b020-0d1acab6a8b7?](https://substack.com/redirect/e5065ebe-3d8e-416e-b020-0d1acab6a8b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e5065ebe-3d8e-416e-b020-0d1acab6a8b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] and landed on the idea that: We've started conversations about what good leadership looks like. We've encouraged members to think about what they need from their union and what kind of future they want for it. Most importantly, we've seen more people asking questions, sharing ideas and engaging with the governance of their union. Whatever the outcome of the election, that's something worth celebrating.

I think this is the energy we should all be approaching union elections with. Whether a ticket wins or not, by encouraging more discussion, debate and ensuring every election is contested we can improve the democracy in our unions, and hopefully make our organisations more active, more accountable to rank and file members and more effective.

RAFFWU - ALP

On 12 August, Ben Carroll announced the introduction of the Associations Incorporation Reform Amendment Bill 2026 [[https://substack.com/redirect/1e5fa9c6-5811-4d05-b7ea-90985a5b50cf?](https://substack.com/redirect/1e5fa9c6-5811-4d05-b7ea-90985a5b50cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1e5fa9c6-5811-4d05-b7ea-90985a5b50cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] into the Victorian Parliament. The legislation seeks to give Consumer Affairs Victoria the power to wind up any association formed for "industrial purposes" in Victoria unless the organisation is registered under the Fair Work Act. While the ALP has said this in relation to "Red Unions", it seems pretty obvious this is an attack on RAFFWU who are unable to become a registered union under the Fair Work Act. So when is a union a real union and when is it a "fake"? According to the MUA's statement in support of RAFFWU [[https://substack.com/redirect/47a88ca9-9989-47b7-bd9f-d6b308731d87?](https://substack.com/redirect/47a88ca9-9989-47b7-bd9f-d6b308731d87?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] “A union should not be judged only by whether it holds a particular form of registration. It should be judged by whether it is democratic, member-led, independent of employers, committed to collective action, and capable of advancing the wages, conditions and dignity of workers in its industry.” And I couldn’t agree more. Organisations should be judged on their activities, not their registration papers with Fair Work. This is another disappointing move by the ALP using legislation to attack workers’ rights. If registered unions are concerned about “Red Unions” or RAFFWU for that matter, the challenge is to out-organise them - not go whining to the ALP and demanding more legislation. There is a rally in support of RAFFWU [[https://substack.com/redirect/dc1a6ad4-9737-45b4-a7ed-51d33e332d79?](https://substack.com/redirect/dc1a6ad4-9737-45b4-a7ed-51d33e332d79?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] being organised in Melbourne this Saturday (5 September) at 1pm outside ALP HQ at 438 Docklands Drive, Docklands. Please get along if you can! I also wrote a longer piece about this legislation, the SDA and RAFFWU which you can read over at Red Black Notes [[https://substack.com/redirect/02a8c264-4fa1-4f43-b191-f404415e2c4e?](https://substack.com/redirect/02a8c264-4fa1-4f43-b191-f404415e2c4e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Wins/resolutions

Offshore Alliance - UGL

Union members employed by UGL at Varanus Island have voted up a new EBA [[https://substack.com/redirect/67b67465-3815-4e54-84e8-bc82b9cbbdf?](https://substack.com/redirect/67b67465-3815-4e54-84e8-bc82b9cbbdf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In the face of terrible behaviour from UGL, including hiring scab labour, workers have stood strong and won an improved EBA. The agreement includes an additional 4.5% pay increase on what was originally on offer as well as improved allowances and income protection. Workers have also maintained important clauses for training and cyclone stand-by provisions. Offshore Alliance acknowledges that this deal could not have been secured without workers taking industrial action.

AWU Vic - GMCT

AWU members at the Greater Metropolitan Cemeteries Trust have finally reached an in-principle agreement after a year-long dispute. Workers commenced industrial action in December 2025 [[https://substack.com/redirect/6cbbc01b-44a6-499e-a8c0-923d3d4e710f?](https://substack.com/redirect/6cbbc01b-44a6-499e-a8c0-923d3d4e710f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The new agreement includes a fair disciplinary clause; a fair warnings process; a \$3000 sign-on bonus; “solid” pay increases; paid wellbeing leave and a super on parental leave.

MSAV - Public health professionals

On 14 August, the Victorian state government presented an improved offer [[https://substack.com/redirect/b7a3d425-3f7c-48d5-9329-d9eb13cccf1b?](https://substack.com/redirect/b7a3d425-3f7c-48d5-9329-d9eb13cccf1b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to MSAV members working in the public sector. 89% of members who responded to a survey endorsed the offer [[https://substack.com/redirect/16f19145-3eaa-457f-8c1f-3e810874494a?](https://substack.com/redirect/16f19145-3eaa-457f-8c1f-3e810874494a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. While the agreement will still need to be formally voted on by the workforce, the proposed agreement includes a 28% pay increase over 3.5 years; a one-off payment of \$1500, and \$3500 a year per worker for professional development. MSAV also shared that the agreement includes [[https://substack.com/redirect/b004e5e6-7e33-41a9-8cbd-c8258c6dd886?](https://substack.com/redirect/b004e5e6-7e33-41a9-8cbd-c8258c6dd886?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] 5 days paid reproductive health leave; expanded portability for personal and long service leave; and improvements to classifications structures. MSAV members commenced industrial action in March this year, and took their first strike action since 2012.

MUA WA - Kimberley Port Authority

On 21 August, the MUA reached an in-principle agreement with the KPA for workers at Broome Port. MUA members at the port commenced strike action on 7 August [[https://substack.com/redirect/bb9b091b-e972-4274-98bc-f96363c65735?](https://substack.com/redirect/bb9b091b-e972-4274-98bc-f96363c65735?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] after 10 days of “soft” industrial action. Industrial action was scaled back on 17 August, before a full return to work on 24 August. At the height of the industrial action, passengers from cruise ships had to be ferried ashore in small boats [[https://substack.com/redirect/4eeec3d0-67e5-4ef8-88b8-f048ef349f39?](https://substack.com/redirect/4eeec3d0-67e5-4ef8-88b8-f048ef349f39?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Key issues in the dispute were time-in-lieu provisions, pay parity for maintenance trade workers with other ports in the state and cultural leave for Aboriginal workers. All demands have been met to the MUA’s satisfaction. The cultural leave provision is a first for any port authority.

MEU NSW - Peabody

After multiple lockouts, workers at the Wambo washery have reached an agreement with Peabody. According to an MEU press release [[https://substack.com/redirect/b3fa5d61-8350-456d-b3f6-78b879b515b4?](https://substack.com/redirect/b3fa5d61-8350-456d-b3f6-78b879b515b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the agreement includes “4% increases to total remuneration, with the second increase brought forward to six months after the first, and a \$5,500 sign-on bonus.” The original offer from Peabody included 2.5% annual wage increases [[https://substack.com/redirect/b747cc16-fd63-45bc-8fc1-5032aeb9d03f?](https://substack.com/redirect/b747cc16-fd63-45bc-8fc1-5032aeb9d03f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

AEU Victoria - Public sector teachers

Unsubscribe

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-20-august>

AMWU/AWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU/The Services Union/TWU QLD - Townsville City Council

Industrial action continues at Townsville City Council with reports of unemptied bins [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2d1323f2-2c18-4cc7-adb6-d7cbf91756d0?](https://substack.com/redirect/2d1323f2-2c18-4cc7-adb6-d7cbf91756d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2d1323f2-2c18-4cc7-adb6-d7cbf91756d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and frustrated community members.

Rubbish woes only escalated when the Council closed multiple waste facilities/tips [

[https://substack.com/redirect/773b48f7-6c53-448e-9591-846851978ea1?](https://substack.com/redirect/773b48f7-6c53-448e-9591-846851978ea1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/773b48f7-6c53-448e-9591-846851978ea1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] over the weekend following union members implementing a ban on taking payments from tip users. The next scheduled bargaining meeting isn't until 28 August, so industrial action is likely to continue for at least another week. Workers are fighting for an uplift to base wages as well as annual wage increases. They are also concerned about Council getting rid of direct hire blue collar workers [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2e447fc0-09bd-4ae2-93eb-b353c19f9b26?](https://substack.com/redirect/2e447fc0-09bd-4ae2-93eb-b353c19f9b26?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2e447fc0-09bd-4ae2-93eb-b353c19f9b26?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] in favour of contracting out services. The Services Union members at the Council have now "overwhelmingly" voted in favour of industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/a3b3530a-309c-4914-a451-0423ed1c4ca4?](https://substack.com/redirect/a3b3530a-309c-4914-a451-0423ed1c4ca4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a3b3530a-309c-4914-a451-0423ed1c4ca4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] too.

AWU/AMWU/ETU - Qantas

Qantas engineers continue their industrial action with twice weekly stoppages and work bans. The AMWU reported [[https://substack.com/redirect/86d5d68a-8663-4700-8d31-ca27b881bb78?](https://substack.com/redirect/86d5d68a-8663-4700-8d31-ca27b881bb78?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/86d5d68a-8663-4700-8d31-ca27b881bb78?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] that at a meeting with Qantas held yesterday (19/8), they announced their original offer was "back on the table". This is the offer voted down by workers in May. Qantas intends to put this offer out to vote again, has demanded unions accept it, and threatened workers' backpay if they don't endorse the agreement. All this in the same week the company was fined for illegally sacking workers. Qantas still has a lot to learn about respecting its workforce!

Professionals Australia SA - ElectraNet

Members of Professionals Australia at ElectraNet walked off the job for a one-hour stoppage last Thursday (14/8). Engineers and other professional workers stopped work after negotiations stalled. Workers have voted down proposed agreements from management twice as ElectraNet attempts to get rid of guaranteed wage increases and shift most staff into a performance-based pay regime. Workers are fighting for a decent offer that protects conditions and guarantees fair wage increases.

ETU NSW - Schindler

Last Friday (15/8), the FWC ruled that Schindler's (NSW) lockout of workers was unprotected [

[https://substack.com/redirect/7d34ba6b-49fd-4ef0-87bc-d2c8a5ac1655?](https://substack.com/redirect/7d34ba6b-49fd-4ef0-87bc-d2c8a5ac1655?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7d34ba6b-49fd-4ef0-87bc-d2c8a5ac1655?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and that they must allow workers back on site within 14 days. ETU members commenced industrial action at Schindler on 1 August with short stoppages and bans. A week later on 8 August, Schindler cracked the shits and locked workers out without pay. While it is great the lockout is over, ETU members must now get back to their original fight for a decent deal, 6% annual wage increases and improved conditions.

The Services Union - Cairns Regional Council

Last Thursday (14/8), The Services Union members at Cairns Regional Council rallied during a 1 hour stop work action [[https://substack.com/redirect/61418369-d2c1-43aa-b73a-2fc50fdb3c4f?](https://substack.com/redirect/61418369-d2c1-43aa-b73a-2fc50fdb3c4f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/61418369-d2c1-43aa-b73a-2fc50fdb3c4f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The primary concern of workers is that the Council has offered different pay increases to different "streams" of workers [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2810a3bb-c553-48be-919f-2d3e472b17cd?](https://substack.com/redirect/2810a3bb-c553-48be-919f-2d3e472b17cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2810a3bb-c553-48be-919f-2d3e472b17cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Outdoors workers are set to receive a 9% wage increase in the first year of the agreement, while indoors workers represented by The Services Union will only receive between 6-6.5%.

ETU QLD - Otis Elevators

Workers at Otis Elevators in Brisbane commenced strike action on Monday (18/8). Workers are fighting for industry standard wages and conditions. Yesterday, as part of their strike action workers rallied outside Otis HQ [[https://substack.com/redirect/869b0715-3fb8-4fec-9f67-6336966af809?](https://substack.com/redirect/869b0715-3fb8-4fec-9f67-6336966af809?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/869b0715-3fb8-4fec-9f67-6336966af809?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

UWU - Crown Sydney

On Friday (15/8) workers at Crown in Sydney took industrial action for the second week in a row [[https://substack.com/redirect/6671af52-3116-45d0-8794-1ea341e1bb76?](https://substack.com/redirect/6671af52-3116-45d0-8794-1ea341e1bb76?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6671af52-3116-45d0-8794-1ea341e1bb76?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. This time General Service Attendants who make-up rooms and deliver room services walked off the job at 11am [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e9fb0f94-d59f-4c89-a6ec-00e96f98602a?](https://substack.com/redirect/e9fb0f94-d59f-4c89-a6ec-00e96f98602a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e9fb0f94-d59f-4c89-a6ec-00e96f98602a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] (check-out time). Later in the day, casino workers including dealers walked off the job at 6pm [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e9fb0f94-d59f-4c89-a6ec-00e96f98602a?](https://substack.com/redirect/e9fb0f94-d59f-4c89-a6ec-00e96f98602a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e9fb0f94-d59f-4c89-a6ec-00e96f98602a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Workers at the luxury casino earn wages only marginally above the award, and less than their counterparts at Crown in Melbourne. Crown's current offer (a 3.25% increase in the first year, followed by 3% in years 2 and 3) is not acceptable to workers. As well as insufficient wage increases, Crown is also trying to cut "length-of-service increments" from the classification structure. UWW is calling on Crown to bring forward a decent offer warning that "to retain skilled hospitality professionals, Crown must pay them properly and respect their length of service." [https://substack.com/redirect/e9fb0f94-d59f-4c89-a6ec-00e96f98602a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

AWU NSW - WesTrac

On Thursday (14/8), AWU members at WesTrac repair centres in Tomago and Mt Thorley struck for 2 hours [[https://substack.com/redirect/b29d4b9b-0c3f-418d-8a9a-01ca15491e25?](https://substack.com/redirect/b29d4b9b-0c3f-418d-8a9a-01ca15491e25?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b29d4b9b-0c3f-418d-8a9a-01ca15491e25?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. 95% of workers voted down the most recent offer from the company which contained an underwhelming 9.3% wage increase over three years as well as stripping back conditions including overtime protection and notice for shift changes. Workers at WesTrac earn below industry standard wages and work a 50 hour week (5 x 10 hour shifts). Morale is at rock bottom and the annual turnover rate is 20%. Workers are fighting for industry standard pay, proper conditions and respect. They are calling on WesTrac to return to the bargaining table [[https://substack.com/redirect/982c3e50-fac9-4e06-af44-5c7793fc385c?](https://substack.com/redirect/982c3e50-fac9-4e06-af44-5c7793fc385c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/982c3e50-fac9-4e06-af44-5c7793fc385c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

QUTU - Public sector teachers

The QUTU has written to members advising that if a "reasonable offer" was not made by the Cristafulli Government by Friday 29 August, the union would vote on when to hold another 24-hour strike [

[https://substack.com/redirect/6729c4c8-8697-47a3-99e9-b8d5f5a8facd?](https://substack.com/redirect/6729c4c8-8697-47a3-99e9-b8d5f5a8facd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6729c4c8-8697-47a3-99e9-b8d5f5a8facd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The QUTU State Council is expected to meet on 30 August.

MEAA - ABC

A great scoop from Crikey last week [https://substack.com/redirect/697b9e89-49f8-4573-a666-a5ba07373454?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with a report that ABC management refused to meet with bargaining reps due to a poster promoting a member meeting being a "psychosocial hazard" and risk to OHS. The poster in question? A meme labelling a drowning child as "staff on low pay and insecure contracts" and a distracted mother as "ABC management". The meeting with bargaining reps was postponed, and then resumed an hour later after the posters in questions were removed. In July, MEAA members at the ABC rejected an offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/fa3e22e0-56bf-41a6-8537-6cdfdd7c9520?](https://substack.com/redirect/fa3e22e0-56bf-41a6-8537-6cdfdd7c9520?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fa3e22e0-56bf-41a6-8537-6cdfdd7c9520?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] which would give them a 3% pay increase from the first pay period after the expiry of their current agreement, as long as both the CPSU and MEAA agreed not to take industrial action for 12 months from the expiry of the current EBA. The ABC EBA expires on 1 October.

AEU Tasmania - Public school principals

Principals in Tasmanian public schools commenced industrial action last Monday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/4060ed29-7759-4d31-936d-a7f38d2cb6bc?](https://substack.com/redirect/4060ed29-7759-4d31-936d-a7f38d2cb6bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4060ed29-7759-4d31-936d-a7f38d2cb6bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] (11/8) in the form of work bans. Principals are responding to the Department for Children and Young People (DECYP) linking Progressive Achievement Tests (PAT) to performance-based pay progression. PATs are a form of standardised testing which are described by the AEU as a "inaccurate and blunt instrument". Principals' work bans include a ban on attending any departmental principal meetings, briefings or forums; a ban on any work associated with principal Performance Development Plans (PDP); a ban on any work associated with PDPs for staff apart from those staff eligible for a pay rise and a ban on facilitating any State Government MP or MLC visits to workplaces. The union has warned that unless members' concerns are addressed, industrial action will escalate up to and including stoppages.

UPFU WA - WA Firefighters

Despite my best efforts, sometimes my east coast bias means I miss disputes that are taking place in the west. So thanks to a WA reader for letting me know the WA firefighters are currently in dispute with the WA Government. Most recently the firies participated in an 8 day cycle of industrial action kicking off on 8 August. This included limitations to off-duty contact; a 24-hour cap on overtime and chalking messages on vehicles. Firefighters also rallied outside Parliament House on 12 August. Firies are fighting for an increase in their base rate [https://substack.com/redirect/aac9e97c-4caf-4f60-bbbb-4f01fe570a66?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as well as

a comprehensive health and wellness program; enhanced consultation with DFES; a revised rank structure; strategies to address emerging risk; and wage, allowance and conditions parity with the rest of the WA public sector. I'd love to learn more about this dispute so any firefighters or Western Australians with more information - please get in touch!

ETU WA - Schindler

On Friday (15/8), ETU members at Schindler (WA) endorsed the latest offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/85107eb0-169f-4e39-abb5-9ea62b0109d9?](https://substack.com/redirect/85107eb0-169f-4e39-abb5-9ea62b0109d9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/85107eb0-169f-4e39-abb5-9ea62b0109d9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] from the company. Workers had been on strike for 27 days and 22 hours. The new agreement includes 4.5% annual wage increases; increased superannuation; implementation of the RDO calendar; paid parental leave for the secondary carer; an “industry leading” security clause; strengthened consultative clause and more.

MEU - Peabody

Workers at the Metropolitan colliery have come to an in-principle agreement with Peabody [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e10b1365-ac73-468d-8582-3f8028a2427b?](https://substack.com/redirect/e10b1365-ac73-468d-8582-3f8028a2427b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e10b1365-ac73-468d-8582-3f8028a2427b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. The agreement gets workers 5% annual wage increases over the life of the agreement as well as maintaining job security protections [[https://substack.com/redirect/c61b2f3b-5627-4647-8431-8509f1678e63?](https://substack.com/redirect/c61b2f3b-5627-4647-8431-8509f1678e63?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c61b2f3b-5627-4647-8431-8509f1678e63?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. In June, Peabody locked MEU members out for three weeks in retaliation for union members participating in 1-hour stoppages. Rolling strike action and a picket line followed. The MEU’s South West District President Mark Jenkins described the result as “a testament to the unity and determination of the miners.”

TWU - Qantas

In the Federal Court on Monday (19/8), Qantas was ordered to pay \$90 million [

[https://substack.com/redirect/98993475-930e-460b-ae6b-b80c2878d705?](https://substack.com/redirect/98993475-930e-460b-ae6b-b80c2878d705?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/98993475-930e-460b-ae6b-b80c2878d705?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] for illegally outsourcing ground handling jobs during the COVID pandemic. Of the \$90 million, \$50 million will go to the TWU who mounted the legal challenge on behalf of the sacked workers (perhaps a welcome cash injection into their 2026 our roads, our skies, our future campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/f98c1bc9-f110-4797-8a57-c9420705c886?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]?). How the remaining \$40 million should be paid will be decided at a later date. This fine is on top of \$120 million [[https://substack.com/redirect/5f749191-c14e-420c-88b2-36ec837877ed?](https://substack.com/redirect/5f749191-c14e-420c-88b2-36ec837877ed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5f749191-c14e-420c-88b2-36ec837877ed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] Qantas agreed to pay into a compensation fund for affected workers. This is a historic settlement, the biggest ever penalty ordered by a court for violating industrial relation laws. The question is, will it act as discouragement for large corporations? While Qantas CEO Vanessa Hudson sent sincere apologies to the workers who were sacked, what about the rest of the Qantas workforce? This very report shows Qantas threatening engineers to agree to a subpar agreement or risk losing out on backpay. Qantas is also in negotiations with the ASU, and a report back from The Services Union last week noted that a revised offer from Qantas “misses key improvements and uses a divide-and-conquer approach that pits groups against each other. [[https://substack.com/redirect/eb85c9a6-92db-4f72-bbac-257e5061c0b6?](https://substack.com/redirect/eb85c9a6-92db-4f72-bbac-257e5061c0b6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/eb85c9a6-92db-4f72-bbac-257e5061c0b6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]” It seems unlikely that this leopard will change its spots entirely.

That’s all I’ve got for you this week. I did write a few notes on the Economic Reform Roundtable earlier in the week which you can read here [<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen/note/c-146574685>] if you are interested. Speaking of productivity, I need a break! I’m going to take next week off from the report to allow for a bit of rest and relaxation. I’ll be back here on Wednesday 3 September with the first Disputes Report of Spring!

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UY3hNe1kxTURjM0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05UVUVTJNemt5TWpRc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE56RTNOVE15TkN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnBkV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhsWDJWdFlXbHNjbjAudm5jZjRrMHBXVlhJd2ZVbE54dzZOUktHMElBYjNXeVp2QUhROEw3S3FaQSIsInAiOjE3MTM2NTA3Nywic3I6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMzMzMsImldCI6MTc1NTYzOTIyNCwiZXhwIjoyMDcxMjE1MjI0LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnBmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.3Xsf8oYQdngNoFnuK3rxP0rH8n6asd-sGlpdE8v97I?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-20-may>

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Last week, the ANMF announced that members would recommence industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/ebb941dc-1a8e-4dad-a191-28ef20887891?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the public sector on Monday (18/5). Industrial action was suspended in February when the government made an offer of a 6% “interim administrative increase [https://substack.com/redirect/947c334f-1e95-4c9b-85a9-22fe3659ca2c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” in the lead up to the state election. Following the election, negotiations resumed over the ANMF’s full wage claim and demands for improved conditions. These negotiations have now stalled. On Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/5819e1da-8a58-4fb3-b709-97c0657bb6a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], ANMF members started wearing campaign t-shirts to work as well as only fulfilling roles strictly within their job requirements. Next week industrial action will escalate to bans on non-clinical duties. If a decent offer has not been made by June, nurses will move to strike action - most likely starting with a strike at the Lyle McEwin Hospital. Strike action at LMH had been scheduled but was cancelled [https://substack.com/redirect/8ac49aae-fa41-4a7d-8ed9-1c8c86ea39d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] after the interim administrative increase was offered. Beware those who negotiate with a government in the lead up to an election!

AMWU/ETU/RTBU QLD - Queensland Rail

Industrial action continues at Queensland Rail including maintenance bans and staffing bans. Due to concerns over disruption to the NRL Magic Round, the state government threatened unions and went to the FWC to attempt to get industrial action suspended over the weekend. The FWC rejected the Queensland Government’s application [https://substack.com/redirect/d3f74272-6005-426e-a9a8-ffbd85965b40?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and industrial action went ahead [https://substack.com/redirect/9352c3cb-a284-4407-ba29-ee52aabe0307?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. It seems on this occasion the government sorted out replacement services, which makes you wonder if the recent chaos on the network could have been avoided if the government had wanted it to! Not being an NRL person, it was hard to gauge what if any impact there was on the footy. According to Wikipedia stats [https://substack.com/redirect/85367678-2204-458c-a898-65bbd147b389?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the average daily attendance was down by only 221 people from last year. Negotiations through the FWC will continue over the coming weeks [https://substack.com/redirect/06120df8-f5bc-441d-aeba-655d9ba3673e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

On Friday (15/5), the AEU Branch Council endorsed an in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/2c62d647-7bfa-465c-aba1-48145a064c4b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with the state government. The endorsement was not unanimous [https://substack.com/redirect/84db8186-732a-44d6-b20c-1e2c0a4ade4f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The agreement would see teachers receive wage increases between 28.3% and 32.4% over 4 years [https://substack.com/redirect/3ae218c1-e378-47f3-ba5a-f10bbd36b0a7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Teachers and education support staff had been fighting for 35% over 3 years. While there are some improvements such as additional professional practice days, many teachers are concerned about the lack of concrete action on workload and class sizes. There is also concern that this is not an equitable deal for education support staff. From talking to teachers, reviewing materials put out by rank and file groups and reading a lot of Facebook comments, there seems to be a significant cohort of AEU members who are dissatisfied, and disappointed that the union does not want to fight a bit harder, for a bit longer, for a bit more. The agreement still needs to be endorsed by sub-branches, and of course be voted up by members.

MUA - Certis

Gatehouse guards at DP World at Port Botany commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/f27b10e1-23a1-4abd-8c41-7b9a7e10f98c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last week. The workers are employed by multinational Certis and have the legal minimum of pay and conditions. Workers have been in negotiations for a decent offer for 6 months, but Certis isn’t budging. Management have been threatening workers participating in industrial action with termination. Industrial action is taking the form of guards delaying the entry or exit of trucks to the terminal by 5 minutes [https://substack.com/redirect/f8ee2ae1-35dc-463d-92e9-b62d68416420?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] upon arrival at the gatehouse. This may seem small on the face of it, but has the effect of backing up trucks and slowing down the

whole port.

TWU WA - Brownes

On Monday (18/5), TWU members at Brownes dairy commenced an 82 hour strike [

[https://substack.com/redirect/39dfa2bc-b22c-44c6-8f9f-b58640cb1ee3?](https://substack.com/redirect/39dfa2bc-b22c-44c6-8f9f-b58640cb1ee3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/39dfa2bc-b22c-44c6-8f9f-b58640cb1ee3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The mammoth strike is due to finish at 4pm today. Workers have been in negotiations for a new agreement since December with simple demands: a fair wage increase; job security and less labour hire; and improvements to parental leave. This is the second strike [[https://substack.com/redirect/5bdc2e7f-816c-4ff5-81b2-45e6ead6c154?](https://substack.com/redirect/5bdc2e7f-816c-4ff5-81b2-45e6ead6c154?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5bdc2e7f-816c-4ff5-81b2-45e6ead6c154?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] at Brownes. Brownes is currently under acquisition, and have admitted that they want an “attractive” EBA [

[https://substack.com/redirect/fc2f9a0a-f81b-466a-904c-97329ff739b8?](https://substack.com/redirect/fc2f9a0a-f81b-466a-904c-97329ff739b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fc2f9a0a-f81b-466a-904c-97329ff739b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] (aka cheap for the bosses) to help the sale. Brownes have reportedly said they will only consider wage increases if workers accept cuts to conditions. Unsurprisingly, negotiations are going nowhere. Management is trying to intimidate union members by standing down delegates and calling the cops during the last strike. Workers are standing firm and demanding a fair deal.

NTEU Tas - UTAS

NTEU members at the University of Tasmania will strike for four hours today [

[https://substack.com/redirect/6c2bd79c-01f0-41df-a542-98f8c489b1d5?](https://substack.com/redirect/6c2bd79c-01f0-41df-a542-98f8c489b1d5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6c2bd79c-01f0-41df-a542-98f8c489b1d5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] (20/5). Workers will down tools at 1pm [[https://substack.com/redirect/569da42c-a9d4-4e7c-bba4-b60267f62ba4?](https://substack.com/redirect/569da42c-a9d4-4e7c-bba4-b60267f62ba4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/569da42c-a9d4-4e7c-bba4-b60267f62ba4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The union participated in more bargaining meetings late last week, but no real progress appears to have been made. UTAS’s chief of people Kristen Derbyshire told the NTEU that a 3% wage increase is “appropriate in a Tasmanian context [[https://substack.com/redirect/7b88e52b-7d65-49e1-9411-8a50b081cd22?](https://substack.com/redirect/7b88e52b-7d65-49e1-9411-8a50b081cd22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7b88e52b-7d65-49e1-9411-8a50b081cd22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]” which seems somewhat hypocritical when the UTas VC is in the top 12 VC salaries in the country [

[https://substack.com/redirect/08abab14-0bb2-4074-940f-144355cfdcf?](https://substack.com/redirect/08abab14-0bb2-4074-940f-144355cfdcf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/08abab14-0bb2-4074-940f-144355cfdcf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

QUTU - Public school teachers

In a real dog act, the Queensland State government has opposed teachers getting an interim pay increase [[https://substack.com/redirect/79fc20cf-a01f-41af-95c1-36e9738fad50?](https://substack.com/redirect/79fc20cf-a01f-41af-95c1-36e9738fad50?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/79fc20cf-a01f-41af-95c1-36e9738fad50?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. After negotiations for a new agreement failed earlier this year, the QUTU now has to go through a lengthy arbitration process which may not start until October. The union requested teachers get the 3% pay increase that was offered at the end of 2025 while arbitration takes place. Education Minister John-Paul Langbroek said the union had been warned this would happen and they should “explain to all teachers why the deal that they negotiated with the Department of Education through conciliation was not accepted.” Like I said, a real dog act.

AWU/ETU/MEU WA - Fortescue

The AWU and Fortescue will have a show down in the Federal Court tomorrow (21/5). The AWU wants to use new laws introduced by the ALP in 2022 to restart bargaining on two expired EBAs [

[https://substack.com/redirect/7b401331-6eec-4471-8213-1d3c45e2a47e?](https://substack.com/redirect/7b401331-6eec-4471-8213-1d3c45e2a47e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7b401331-6eec-4471-8213-1d3c45e2a47e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] that cover workers at Solomon, Eliwana, Cloudbreak and Christmas Creek Mines. Fortescue is claiming that the AWU is excluding some employee groups to ensure the union has majority support. The excluded workers are reportedly train drivers who accepted \$20,000 pay rises last year if they agreed not to get involved in trying to get an agreement. The ETU have put forward a counter claim for urgent orders to compel Fortescue to issue bargaining notices [[https://substack.com/redirect/01152daf-41cb-4027-99f2-233932d57d8a?](https://substack.com/redirect/01152daf-41cb-4027-99f2-233932d57d8a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/01152daf-41cb-4027-99f2-233932d57d8a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. No one said re-unionisation of the Pilbara would be easy!

In short

ETU NSW - Stowe

ETU members at Stowe Sydney went on strike [[https://substack.com/redirect/16274021-93b3-4e2a-8834-16fcb2353200?](https://substack.com/redirect/16274021-93b3-4e2a-8834-16fcb2353200?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/16274021-93b3-4e2a-8834-16fcb2353200?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] on Thursday (14/5). Workers rallied and fired up the barbeque [[https://substack.com/redirect/bad31768-5603-440c-8cb7-cbd7cd66ed4c?](https://substack.com/redirect/bad31768-5603-440c-8cb7-cbd7cd66ed4c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/bad31768-5603-440c-8cb7-cbd7cd66ed4c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] outside Stowe’s head office. Workers are fighting for 5 weeks annual leave to offset long hours and six day weeks. All Stowe has offered is a one-off pay increase and a 12 month EBA extension [

[https://substack.com/redirect/0cbb51a3-7ce6-41d5-b3a6-709411c6ef99?](https://substack.com/redirect/0cbb51a3-7ce6-41d5-b3a6-709411c6ef99?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0cbb51a3-7ce6-41d5-b3a6-709411c6ef99?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. As mentioned in an earlier Disputes Report, there are a lot of strategic machinations [[https://substack.com/redirect/cae189a6-10d0-43ff-9c00-3c4d238c12fd?](https://substack.com/redirect/cae189a6-10d0-43ff-9c00-3c4d238c12fd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/cae189a6-10d0-43ff-9c00-3c4d238c12fd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] involved in this dispute.

Offshore Alliance (AWU/MUA) & ETU WA - UGL

Union members employed by UGL at Woodside's KGP/Pluto facilities are set to commence industrial action today (20/5) [https://substack.com/redirect/e93a6de2-ac29-4274-bae9-3030eebd2f2c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Unions are calling for maintenance workers not to take up any work from labour hire groups or UGL subsidiaries at KGP-Pluto. The bosses will inevitably attempt to use scab labour to diminish the effectiveness of the industrial action. Media reports indicate around 70 workers will participate [https://substack.com/redirect/c798385b-8d52-4945-a6d3-3848403e6c4e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the industrial action.

HACSU Tasmania - Dental Assistants

Stoppages continue in support of public dental assistants' fight to be appropriately classified and receive backpay as promised by the state government. On Friday (15/5) HACSU members at Clarence Dental Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/e18ce828-301a-4ddc-bb3a-8e6c3e62a422?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] stopped work for 2 hours.

ASU/Professionals Australia - DXC

Industrial action at DXC Technology continues. Workers are currently participating in rolling 24-hour strikes [https://substack.com/redirect/d34f2833-dff9-4c76-9cb7-afb8537b5ba6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The best offer from DXC thus far has been a 2.5% wage increase in the first year of a new agreement (with no backpay) followed by 3% increases in the second and third years [https://substack.com/redirect/bc79e403-44d1-48da-bea8-6e4ec62decf9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are standing firm in their demand for 4% annual wage increases.

CEPU Tasmania - Blue Star Electrical

CEPU members employed by Blue Star Electrical on the Hobart Airport Project commenced industrial action yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/c70e94c7-fd3d-4891-8da1-d861775f4c98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (19/5). Workers have been in negotiations for over 6 months with no fair deal. Workers are fighting for an 18% wage increase over 3 years (with backpay) as well as better severance and redundancy; improved travel and tool kit allowances and fair overtime conditions.

Offshore Alliance (AWU/MUA) & ETU WA - Inpex

A meeting of members [https://substack.com/redirect/c53bc89c-426c-483f-b50d-ee3ace1717b6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] working for Inpex at the Ichthys LNG facility last week voted to serve a notice of protected industrial action if FWC facilitated bargaining meetings failed to result in a suitable deal [https://substack.com/redirect/66e95be9-c62f-48f1-936e-9a2f113816e0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. While the Offshore Alliance noted that "FWC facilitated bargaining... achieved more in 1 day than in 6 months with Inpex HR.", it wasn't sufficient. The Offshore Alliance have notified Inpex that industrial action in the form of work bans and stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/d2e0c189-e9bf-41e9-8785-906490709bb5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] will start next week on 27 May. According to the AFR [https://substack.com/redirect/12b778f8-233f-4f7e-b460-09cba2dc51fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], 243 work bans and stoppages have been notified, and the action will run through to 10 June. There is still a chance for an agreement to be reached with both parties scheduled to meet in the FWC for facilitated bargaining on 25 May. In April, 100% of respondents voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/b1e13ec9-5b66-4eaa-add6-9d16989fd624?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and 98% of the workforce rejected Inpex's proposed EBA.

CPSU ACT - ACT public sector

On Thursday (14/5), CPSU members at Housing ACT stopped work for 1 hour [https://substack.com/redirect/2ae300b8-76f5-4718-a3fd-a08203c0c7c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of their campaign for a decent EBA. The Barr Government has said it cannot afford any more than 3% annual wage increases [https://substack.com/redirect/2782c035-270e-48c1-94fa-8d15db1a7bd0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. CPSU members are fighting for 12% over 3 years (5%/4%/3%) [https://substack.com/redirect/b80e8ac2-2637-480a-acfc-b5a15e3eaab8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The CPSU has pointed out that CPI is at 4.6% and ACT parking fees have been increased by the government by 3.5%.

NTEU Vic - RMIT UP

NTEU members at RMIT UP (University Pathways) were on strike again [https://substack.com/redirect/58770144-aa5e-4b82-ad3a-c90f7ad7d5c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last Wednesday (13/5). Workers have not received a pay rise in 4 years and are paid lower superannuation [https://substack.com/redirect/58770144-aa5e-4b82-ad3a-c90f7ad7d5c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] than other RMIT workers. This is the second strike action taken by workers following the 23 April strike [https://substack.com/redirect/bca488a7-c3c6-458e-a059-ab9efde06c41?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

MEU - Peabody

The MEU shared on social media that workers at the Wambo Coal Handling and Processing Plant have received notices from Peabody [https://substack.com/redirect/cf307473-45d1-44b6-9f2d-9a401db57949?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that work from workers participating in partial work bans and stoppages will not be accepted. This means that workers who participate in industrial action will not be paid. Workers are not intimidated, and are going ahead with industrial action.

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

AEU members at ACT's public schools are taking 2 hours stopwork action [https://substack.com/redirect/5e31e2cb-3c1e-4ef1-baf4-d4753fb3794a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] this Friday (22/5). It will be the first strike action by teachers in the territory in 15 years. The ACT Education Directorate has announced that schools will be closed during the stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/49bad063-3923-475a-a7c7-d06307cd8fd8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as participation by teachers is expected to be so high that students will not be able to be adequately supervised. Teachers are fighting for a fair pay deal as well as action on workload and staff wellbeing.

PABO Watch

MUA WA - Port of Broome

MUA members at the Port of Broome have decided to apply for a PABO [https://substack.com/redirect/46b3308c-d49f-403a-8959-f0d5c1fe1de2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers at the port are the lowest paid Port Authority workers in the state. Negotiations have been underway for more than 6 months [https://substack.com/redirect/95ab1f41-ab91-4ff2-8805-90b42e3c5551?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CPSU VIC - Parks Victoria and Ravenhall & Fulham Correction Centres

Results of three successful protection action ballots for the CPSU were announced last week. 94.66% of respondents at Parks Victoria [https://substack.com/redirect/c1d26bbe-29d1-4908-b5e5-c925f508d977?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] voted yes to industrial action. Industrial action was also strongly endorsed at Ravenhall and Fulham Correction Centres [https://substack.com/redirect/c56c8a79-b9d0-4c10-a4de-4428d3ef652e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. 98.32% of respondents at Ravenhall and 95.86% at Fulham voted in favour of industrial action.

VAHPA - Public sector allied health workers

VAHPA members absolutely SMASHED their protected action ballot. Voter turnout has been reported as 92.87% of eligible members, and of those 98.73% voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/2237b136-db4c-47f8-bf3f-b4e7f486d731?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. We often say that support for industrial action is overwhelming, but this is overly overwhelming! Stay tuned for next steps!

Unions news

AWU - CFMEU Demarcation

A snip of a document (below) is circulating online which appears to be a proposed demarcation outlining coverage between the AWU and CFMEU. Mark Irving, the former Administrator of the CFMEU, in his third and final report [https://substack.com/redirect/e4570364-700d-42b7-8e56-f102503dfab9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to the Minister wrote that "the resolution of long running demarcation problems will be a priority for the Administration over the course of 2026". In point 24 of his report Irving notes:

"This new approach has already borne fruit. In relation to one long running demarcation sore the CFMEU Construction Division has engaged a former member of the Fair Work Commission to arbitrate a dispute. All sides agreed to accept the outcome. This has resulted in a process where hundreds of members are being transferred from the Construction Division in accordance with the determination made. Once finalised, the outcome will be publicised so all stakeholders know where the lines of demarcation are drawn."

Are these the lines that Irving mentions, and will it see traffic controllers sent packing from the CFMEU and forced to join the AWU?

It is worth considering a few questions: Do demarcation agreements between unions trump a worker's right to freedom of association? Who is demarcation serving - union bureaucracies or workers? Should workers be divvied up like the spoils of war, or should workers be able to organise themselves and request the assistance of a union of their choosing? And how will workers respond to these changes? That's all I've got this week. I once again have some commitments that will keep me away from my writing this weekend, so I will most likely take next week off. I'll definitely be back on deck on 3 June. Please get in touch with your hot takes on demarcation disputes, NRL attendance and info or any disputes kicking off at the moment.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlYMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UazRNemszT0RJM0xDSnBZWFpT2pFM056a3lNaikyTkrNc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE1EYzJNa1kwTXl3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuV0RreVl2U0pnWlMxVFNUVjNMT0hqTWJlVWw8wNVP5U1M5bUpXRHkyV3ltSSIsInAiOjE5ODM5NzgyNywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3OTIyNjY0MywiZXhwIjoyMDk0ODAyNjQzLCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.Lh1UNfbdq_v8mCrzcE4DM-Z3UgKoGQwv_6H_oRAbG5A?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-21-january>

HWU - Public sector healthcare workers

Yesterday (20/1), HWU members walked off the job and rallied at Trades Hall in Melbourne before marching to the Premier's office [https://substack.com/redirect/bd508fbd-77c1-4149-88e9-a203f0acb90a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The plan had originally been to rally at Frankston hospital to coincide with the opening of the hospital, and attendance at the site by Premier Jacinta Allen [https://substack.com/redirect/57273ac1-c2fe-47fc-b67a-687789d8aea2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but this shifted [https://substack.com/redirect/793eb7ee-570d-463c-b840-2d755f4decea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as the Premier moved her ribbon cutting to Sunday. The strike action follows workers rejecting a below inflation pay offer in December, as well as work bans. In December, workers commenced rolling administrative bans [https://substack.com/redirect/a6581d1c-ae0e-4c5c-981b-aa9b5e2f7d2a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including refusing to train or onboard new staff and refusing "revenue raising activities" such as collecting patients' private health insurance. Last week (14/1), workers commenced more bans including a ban on instrument sterilisation and cleaning of non-clinical areas [https://substack.com/redirect/e54c88a3-e420-4b94-91c1-cc26fd4d9529?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and suspending training and onboarding of new staff. These bans will close one in every four hospital beds, and are set to continue until 1 February [https://substack.com/redirect/5cb41d88-c85f-4883-9474-96077bc96e71?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers want a fair pay deal that keeps up with the cost of living. HWU Lead Organiser Jake McGuinness was quoted in the Herald Sun as saying "When I brought up the nurses 7 per cent a year, the government's senior representative yelled at me across the table, words to the effect of: 'your members aren't emergency services, you don't have the political power of the nurses, the public don't care'." [https://substack.com/redirect/4c6f5164-bd40-46bd-af51-1655cde0e053?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] If this is the attitude of the people negotiating on behalf of the government, I fear this dispute may drag on for a long time.

UWU - Sealife

UWU members at Sealife aquariums in Melbourne and Sydney took industrial action on 20 December [https://substack.com/redirect/88058f3f-12de-4139-bfc1-19365031df89?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers at the aquariums stopped work and rallied outside the aquariums as well as commencing work bans. One work ban was the cancellation of educational talks about the animals, instead UWU members intended to speak to customers about the dispute. Despite being highly qualified, workers at the aquariums are only making between 67 cents to \$2.80 above the award. Workers at Sealife earn up to \$5 less per hour than similar workers at Zoos Victoria and Taronga Zoo. UWU has been in negotiations with multinational Merlin Entertainments which runs the aquariums for over 13 months [https://substack.com/redirect/ba78f359-faab-4f28-b443-69fde9648a63?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a decent wage and action on unsafe staffing practices.

AMWU/AWU/ALAEA - Qantas TSS

Engineers, safety trainers and technicians at Qantas commenced industrial action on Friday (16/1) [https://substack.com/redirect/ae56f083-da42-45bb-8743-3e81df7024f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The workers who are covered by the Qantas Technical Salaried Staff EBA work as engineers, safety trainers and technicians. After 18 months of negotiations and 9 meetings with management, no offer has been made by Qantas [https://substack.com/redirect/d6f51a77-dcb6-4951-9f81-dc37ba0ce4c9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers feel Qantas is "dragging the chain". Workers are taking industrial action for the first time in decades for a fair EBA and decent wages to keep up with the cost of living.

PSA NSW - Mid North Coast Correctional Centre

In 2015, David Dungay Jr, a Dunghutti man from Kempsey, died in Long Bay jail in Sydney [https://substack.com/redirect/3e258faa-e26d-40f8-8a9b-087dad5e973e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Before he died, Dungay Jr was restrained face down by guards, and injected with a sedative by a nurse. He said 12 times that he could not breathe. No correctional officers faced disciplinary action over Dungay Jr's death with the coroner saying the guards' actions were "limited by systemic inefficiencies in training." [https://substack.com/redirect/3e258faa-e26d-40f8-8a9b-087dad5e973e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] On Thursday 18 December, Correctional Officers at the Mid North Coast Correctional Centre in Kempsey commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/afb52027-446d-459e-bcf3-b7d77ff47ee9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in response to Corrective Services NSW's plan to hold a ceremony unveiling a plaque commemorating David Dungay Jr. NSW Minister for Corrections Anoulack Chanthivong intervened and the industrial action was stopped [[https://substack.com/redirect/e4596011-0ec3-45f6-bb50-7efd01917961?](https://substack.com/redirect/e4596011-0ec3-45f6-bb50-7efd01917961?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] after confirmation that the plaque would not be placed in the prison and the ceremony would be held elsewhere. Media reporting and comments from the PSA frame the key issue being the date of the plaque ceremony coinciding with the anniversary of an incident at the Mid North Coast Correctional Centre where guards were taken hostage and injured by 2 prisoners [[https://substack.com/redirect/aa18eaca-5e2b-4a96-a161-66af8ca2c3e6?](https://substack.com/redirect/aa18eaca-5e2b-4a96-a161-66af8ca2c3e6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. It is important to note that the original motions calling for the strike action do not mention this at all and focus entirely on the plaque. One motion ends with "The proposed memorial plaque does not belong on the MNCCC complex. In the event of the plaque being placed on the MNCCC complex the MNCCC POVB sub-branch will refuse to service, provide security or enter the areas of the plaque's placement." [[https://substack.com/redirect/dfce8643-be4c-4ab3-84b9-2fe5814ad76c?](https://substack.com/redirect/dfce8643-be4c-4ab3-84b9-2fe5814ad76c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] I have struggled to write this bit of the report. Here we see Correctional Officers using their industrial muscle to continue to push the very real issue of Aboriginal deaths in custody out of view and out of mind. If the people working in the system cannot acknowledge issues in the system, what hope is there for change in that system? Here we must sit with a number of uncomfortable truths: the majority of people in prisons are working class people; Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders people are the most incarcerated people on the planet; and our legal system is not fair. With all this, how do we, as workers, relate to Correctional Officers? I don't have any great answers, but I will say this: the action at the Mid North Coast Correctional Centre feels deeply troubling to me, and very different to, for example, the PSA SA industrial action the week before [[https://substack.com/redirect/4dd3595b-e439-40ca-ae49-fa0d47d08339?](https://substack.com/redirect/4dd3595b-e439-40ca-ae49-fa0d47d08339?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. It is one thing to use industrial power to demand a wage; and another to silence an acknowledgement of systemic violence and racism.

MUA - Carnival

The MUA has launched a campaign fighting for a fair deal for workers on Carnival cruise ships home-ported in Sydney and Brisbane. While these ships primarily operate in Australian waters, a loophole in the Coastal Trading Act 2012 exempts the ships from domestic labour laws. This means crew can be paid in line with international maritime standards rather than the Australian minimum wage. MUA organiser Shane Reside says this leaves some hospitality and housekeeping staff who work long hours on the ship earning as little as \$2.50 per hour. Carnival has rejected this claim saying wages meet international maritime standards and are "supported by additional benefits including accommodation, meals and medical care." [[https://substack.com/redirect/805ef9df-76c6-46a5-b5a7-cfc0f3d0861d?](https://substack.com/redirect/805ef9df-76c6-46a5-b5a7-cfc0f3d0861d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] The MUA kicked off its campaign by vox-popping Carnival passengers about how much they thought workers on the ships earned [[https://substack.com/redirect/a9a7db1e-ffcd-4327-b254-1d99538b302b?](https://substack.com/redirect/a9a7db1e-ffcd-4327-b254-1d99538b302b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - and the general public were rightly horrified when the low wages were revealed. This morning (21/1), unionists will rally at Station Pier in Port Melbourne as a Carnival ship arrives for the Australian Open [[https://substack.com/redirect/1d7ccb16-b075-4216-8357-ac8499e25c1a?](https://substack.com/redirect/1d7ccb16-b075-4216-8357-ac8499e25c1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The demo kicks off at 8am, so by the time you read this it will probably be too late to get down to the port, but I suspect this won't be the last mobilisation in support of Carnival's workforce. Stay tuned!

TWU - Qube

In my 2026 Watch List [[https://substack.com/redirect/fdac5f1f-0187-4874-9536-58e95d4f4cc1?](https://substack.com/redirect/fdac5f1f-0187-4874-9536-58e95d4f4cc1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], I flagged I would be watching out for the TWU's Our Roads, Our Skies, Our Future campaign [[https://substack.com/redirect/103a90ce-a361-4c20-8b61-a9d97e98b6ae?](https://substack.com/redirect/103a90ce-a361-4c20-8b61-a9d97e98b6ae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and it looks like it is kicking off today (21/1). From 5am local time in WA and Victoria today, drivers for Qube logistics will strike for 24 hours [[https://substack.com/redirect/258be106-2c55-4d61-ac8c-ccba09f39225?](https://substack.com/redirect/258be106-2c55-4d61-ac8c-ccba09f39225?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. These drivers ensure the supply of Coca-Cola, Asahi and Mondelez products. Workers are fighting for a fair, national agreement. Qube has enjoyed year-on-year profit increases thanks to workers, some of whom have not seen a fair wage increase since 2022. The TWU has noted that transport is the deadliest industry in Australia [[https://substack.com/redirect/ae5e07cd-e360-44e8-a7f2-a1c5c1b97d82?](https://substack.com/redirect/ae5e07cd-e360-44e8-a7f2-a1c5c1b97d82?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Ensuring decent, national agreements will stop the race to the bottom in a dangerous industry, and ensure safe and sustainable jobs.

UWU - Crown Casino

UWU members at Crown Casino in Melbourne kicked off 2026 with decisive industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/3a8fedc0-243c-4d0c-a30b-8d0e8aa2d37e?](https://substack.com/redirect/3a8fedc0-243c-4d0c-a30b-8d0e8aa2d37e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers at the casino walked off the job from 10pm to 2am on New Years' Eve and again on New Years' Day from 10am to 2pm. The central issue of the dispute is Crown's proposal to introduce a two-tier wage system that would see new employees earn between 16-32% less than existing workers in identical jobs [[https://substack.com/redirect/796d863f-c9aa-4d5b-9c96-5675c561ced9?](https://substack.com/redirect/796d863f-c9aa-4d5b-9c96-5675c561ced9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In early December, workers voted down the proposed agreement, but Crown will not listen to workers' concerns. Uwu met with Crown on 22, 29 and 30 December but the casino bosses refused to remove the two-tier wage system leaving workers no choice but to bring in the new year striking for a fair deal. Negotiations have been underway since May 2025. More industrial action will likely be coming Crown's way if they don't put forward a fair deal for workers.

AMWU NSW - Downer EDI

100 AMWU members at Downer EDI's Cardiff rail workshop spent the lead up to Christmas on strike [[https://substack.com/redirect/d63346b8-7227-430b-a036-0501e3413dcb?](https://substack.com/redirect/d63346b8-7227-430b-a036-0501e3413dcb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Prior to taking strike action workers had implemented some work bans, but escalated to strike action when management refused to pay workers whilst they participated in the bans. The company was expected to put an offer of a 14% pay increase over 4 years to workers on 18/12, but I have not been able to find out if the offer was accepted or rejected. Workers had been seeking a 21.5% wage increase over 4 years, or 18% over 3 years. AMWU Organiser Nathan Clements said that if a deal was not struck before Christmas that "we will come back in the new year and have a conversation with the members about whether they want to return to work in the new year." [[https://substack.com/redirect/d63346b8-7227-430b-a036-0501e3413dcb?](https://substack.com/redirect/d63346b8-7227-430b-a036-0501e3413dcb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] Anyone have an update on this? Please get in touch!

CEPU Tasmania - Zinfra

CEPU members at Zinfra in Tasmania have been locked out by the bosses [

[https://substack.com/redirect/bc9a4896-da30-48f4-adeF-9ba4c7e93ad4?](https://substack.com/redirect/bc9a4896-da30-48f4-adeF-9ba4c7e93ad4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Last week, workers commenced protected industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/cb1d6e60-67bd-4682-aac6-dbea20ae5339?](https://substack.com/redirect/cb1d6e60-67bd-4682-aac6-dbea20ae5339?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the form of partial work bans, including a ban on reading non-essential emails and text messages. Zinfra's decision to use extreme tactics like a lockout will delay planned works. In a story familiar to many Tasmanians, these workers are earning up to 30% less than their mainland counterparts. CEPU members will continue to fight for a fair deal.

VAHPA - HACSU Merger

Well, call me cynical but I did not have this on my January 2026 bingo card! On 13 January, HACSU and VAHPA put out a statement [[https://substack.com/redirect/cce1940b-25e3-43ba-b15c-fd2f9347bc8c?](https://substack.com/redirect/cce1940b-25e3-43ba-b15c-fd2f9347bc8c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] acknowledging VAHPA's rank and file members' opposition to the proposed merger between VAHPA and the HACSU Victoria branch. The statement went on to announce that they would not be moving forward with the merger and would withdraw consent for the HSU rule changes associated with the proposed merger, and work with the FWC to halt the change. Hopefully this serves as a reminder to union bureaucracies of the importance of consultation with members! I will note that the final sentence of the statement says "However, at this time we will remain separate branches." (Emphasis mine). VAHPA rank and file [[https://substack.com/redirect/08383a21-ac0f-4791-8735-1c5bf9568fbc?](https://substack.com/redirect/08383a21-ac0f-4791-8735-1c5bf9568fbc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] will need to keep a close eye on their elected officials, as well as the negotiations for their public sector EBA this year.

In short

CEPU/RTBU Tasmania- TasRail

On 18 December, CEPU and RTBU members walked off the job at TasRail [

[https://substack.com/redirect/bba2449e-9e6b-457c-b7ba-8a743265f8fc?](https://substack.com/redirect/bba2449e-9e6b-457c-b7ba-8a743265f8fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This was the second stoppage in as many weeks, and was an escalation following other bans [[https://substack.com/redirect/2dbc446b-dcb7-4b11-8a7d-39b291c109ba?](https://substack.com/redirect/2dbc446b-dcb7-4b11-8a7d-39b291c109ba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a 31% wage increase over 3 years, having rejected an offer from TasRail in October. The current agreement expired in November.

RAFFWU - Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books

RAFFWU members at Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books went on strike from 20 - 24 December [

[https://substack.com/redirect/3286e002-4d37-4f0f-966c-9f5e4c6731cb?](https://substack.com/redirect/3286e002-4d37-4f0f-966c-9f5e4c6731cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This followed a two day strike on 13-14 December. I have been unable to get an update on where things have landed for the booksellers after Christmas. Workers have been fighting for a new EBA to replace the expired "zombie" agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/cfdceff8-fb2c-425d-8a7c-8ad78fbd6ced?](https://substack.com/redirect/cfdceff8-fb2c-425d-8a7c-8ad78fbd6ced?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] they are stuck on which cuts conditions and leaves wages below the award minimum. Any RAFFWU members able to update me - please

get in touch!

VAHPA - Lake Imaging

Workers at Lake Imaging at the St John of God Geelong Hospital site walked off the job for two hours last Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/d9af7d48-ed3c-495f-a366-5eeab5c321e0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (15/1). Workers at Lake Imaging are fighting for a new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/5e0f3a06-d1ee-4ef5-8231-2b26792b55d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with improved wages and conditions.

AMWU/ETU Victoria - Thales

Workers at Thales have been taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/0ebd50a2-3b38-4a45-bb71-73e7e642e253?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] over the past week to win a better deal.

HACSU Tasmania - Public sector healthcare workers

HACSU has continued industrial action demanding a better offer from the Tasmanian state government for public sector workers. Stoppages have taken place at Clarence Dental Clinic [https://substack.com/redirect/02e3e931-2fc0-4e30-a5d3-d0e98fefb2ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (18/12); Sorell Dental Clinic [https://substack.com/redirect/480629bd-e503-42a1-abfb-d10dcdcdadd05?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (22/12); Royal Hobart Hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/cb84175a-01e1-457d-bb30-53e8f7b3d913?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (31/12), Cambridge Food Production Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/6f3df252-3ab9-4faf-9732-4799c6bc0f66?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (14/1) and Millbrook Rise Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/f7acca49-cafc-46aa-8921-970aaea75df0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (20/1).

Wins and resolutions

UWU - MSS

Airport security screeners at Canberra Airport were set to take industrial action in the lead up to Christmas 2025 [https://substack.com/redirect/662a6e2c-824b-463c-a5a3-f642a9c745c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], however an agreement was reached with MSS. Workers had been fighting for pay parity with workers at Sydney Airport. I'm not certain that parity was reached, but UWU have shared that workers will be paid 10.5% above the award and all conditions have been retained [https://substack.com/redirect/b47d8d69-5048-4728-bffa-44fb5bbb833e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

Professional Australia/UWU- Ambulance Victoria

In December, Professionals Australia [https://substack.com/redirect/0c5000d2-3c2e-430d-b59d-612e3b131f57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and UWU [https://substack.com/redirect/551425ba-ffff-4ce4-95f3-8b241e4dfec6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] both reached agreement with Ambulance Victoria. Both unions report a new agreement being endorsed by members with a wage increase of 20% over 4 years as well as substantial improvements to conditions. In addition to wage increases the agreement ends the two-tier pay system; improves access to leave including gender affirmation leave and reproductive health leave; and the introduces trained Contact Officers to deal with workplace bullying and harassment. Workers at Professionals Australia and UWU both undertook industrial action including stoppages and work bans in pursuit of a fair EBA.

CFMEU Vic - CSR

After 8 weeks on strike, CFMEU members at CSR in Yarraville have won a new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/f7d398e5-796b-43ed-a2aa-d69e83ef9a6a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers commenced strike action on 15 November, and continued with their strike throughout Christmas and into the new year. The new agreement includes a 4% annual wage increase over the next four years; backpay; compounded increase in skills allowance; additional skills benefit to warehouse workers; a 4.5% increase in night shift allowance; and the inclusion of an overtime process and consultative committee process in the new EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/a38caae0-0fbe-4a63-98b8-c632fb24c6c3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. This would seem to be a pretty comprehensive win for the workers at CSR.

UFU Tasmania and Police Association of Tasmania (PAT) - Tasmanian State Government

In December, UFU members gave in-principle support for one-year rollover agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/1dfaa38c-393b-4728-9887-ba313066607c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with a 3% wage increase. Firies will also receive a 1% "structural adjustment" to their composite wage. The union has warned that members will commence "high level" industrial action if the government attempts to stall negotiations for a longer agreement. Meanwhile, a "small majority" of PAT members backed a third offer from the state government [https://substack.com/redirect/dcedec97-55be-4b56-bc21-6a996ff97881?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The agreement runs for 3 years

with 3% wage increases in the first 2 years and a 2.75% increase in the third. In addition to a 3 year agreement and wage increases, the cops have also won increases to allowances and improvements to conditions and a guarantee that police “will receive an uplift if any other state service employee receives more.” [https://substack.com/redirect/dcedec97-55be-4b56-bc21-6a996ff97881?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

UFU SA - SA firefighters

UFU members in SA have voted up a new agreement. 85.7% of eligible workers participated in the ballot, with 88.5% voting in favour of the proposed agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/51355b00-6259-4a6f-b726-f7bf9985307a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. UFU members commenced industrial action in August 2025 following 13 months of negotiations. Their campaign has secured firefighters a 10.5% wage increase over the next 3 years as well as a \$3000 increase to base wages of all workers in recognition of qualifications and skills. The agreement also includes additional resources for training and medical support and screening for all employees covered by the agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/76f44463-23d0-4bc9-9867-645909a127cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The agreement is waiting for final approval from the SA Employment Tribunal. Worth noting while we are talking about firefighters, that UFU members in both Western Australia [https://substack.com/redirect/527fe312-2eb0-4b76-9ed4-03bd52758757?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and Victoria [https://substack.com/redirect/4abd98e3-ca16-4115-9c16-c9509a2eb5dc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and AWU members [https://substack.com/redirect/42987946-21e3-45ae-9278-61dcd72f048f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] employed by the Victorian Department of Energy, Environment and Climate Action as forest firefighters are all still fighting for new agreements.

That’s it for this bumper first edition of Disputes Report for 2026! In a little bit of international news, the community in Minneapolis has responded to the murder of Renee Good by an ICE agent by calling for a “statewide pause in economic activity [https://substack.com/redirect/e27c0020-131b-40c5-afc9-3b825b6c0225?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” - no work, no school, no shopping. The action is set to take place this Friday (23 January) and has been endorsed by a number of unions and the Minneapolis Regional Labor Federation [https://substack.com/redirect/06fdce5f-d226-4904-85c9-8c7f8d5b4228?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In their article on the mobilisation, LaborNotes notes [https://substack.com/redirect/4cdc7497-6df6-4ab2-817a-9f948a1802d3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that no unions have voted to strike yet, but quotes CWA Local 7250 President Kieran Knutson: “People can say, ‘This is not a real general strike.’ This is a mass mobilization. To me, at a certain point, a mass mobilization becomes something qualitatively new.” We’ll watch with interest what happens on Friday. If you want a bit more on union organising in Minneapolis and St Paul, Minnesota, you can check out the Twin Cities Labor Report [https://substack.com/redirect/496a134e-d168-4f3e-857c-20c3cb50c431?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

I also want to thank all the readers who took the time to complete my reader survey [https://substack.com/redirect/41fd86cd-00d0-4c58-8336-82a76e16fb24?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at the end of last year. The survey has provided me with plenty to think about how I can best shape Disputes Report this year and keep this ever growing project manageable! It also provided me with a big ego boost - thank you so much for all your lovely compliments. I am so glad that comrades enjoy reading the report, and more importantly, have found ways to use it to help organising efforts. I honestly could not do this report without the support of readers - both for encouragement, as well as the tips, information, clarifications and corrections so generously shared with me. I am looking forward to another year of collating and reporting!

In solidarity, Sarah

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View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-21-may>

QNMU - Public sector nurses and midwives

The Queensland Government has written to the QNMU [https://substack.com/redirect/2930dffd-4c1a-44c9-844e-ed72a6f11b67?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] advising that they will not be making a new offer, despite their first offer being roundly rejected by nurses and midwives. The letter [https://substack.com/redirect/c819a525-cce9-4ce3-95b4-0aff2bebb352?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] states that the offer “reflects Queensland Health’s commitment to ensuring it is an employer of choice to respect, recruit and retain our workforce, while also maintaining a clear focus of respecting taxpayers’ money” before going on to remind nurses that if an agreement isn’t made by 30 May, workers will lose out on 2 months of backpay. The QNMU has told members to “stand by” for a protected industrial action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/5cb77736-6c2a-4df1-89eb-1e5cd768d43d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

ASU Vic - West Wimmera Shire Council

The ASU has been in negotiations with the West Wimmera Shire Council since October last year [https://substack.com/redirect/fd7e64da-4888-499b-8535-bba5abc83909?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. According to a Council update on 6 May [https://substack.com/redirect/48548ef0-2a83-46a2-9fe5-5a4dff2e1fd1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] bargaining “concluded”, and workers then voted down a proposed agreement. From this update, it would appear the 3% pay increase and the Council’s refusal to include income protection cover in the agreement may be the major sticking points. Workers at the West Wimmera Shire Council commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/23eb86aa-44a8-4a84-a80d-cc5243dd8ff0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on Friday 9 May. Industrial action includes ban on some meetings; a ban on collecting fees, charges, payments or money; a ban on overtime; a ban on gardening or picking up rubbish around Council buildings; a ban on picking up or relocating dead animals and more.

AMWU Vic - Kempe Engineering

As part of their EBA campaign, AMWU members Kempe Engineering in Portland struck for 24 hours last Wednesday (14/5). Workers have also implemented overtime and call-in bans. Workers are demanding a decent payrise.

USU - Riverina Water

Workers at Riverina Water took strike action for a second time [https://substack.com/redirect/fa942713-57c8-4274-9ca7-3e1d2ca4fe03?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on 13/5. USU members returned to work the next day (14/5) after an agreement was made between the union and Riverina Water [https://substack.com/redirect/776fa69a-6b1a-4208-9738-5f12c6435198?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to seek the NSW Industrial Relations Commission to oversee further discussions on the dispute. The dispute centres on the pay disparity between indoor and outdoor workers at Riverina Water. Outdoor workers work 38 hours per week three hours more than their indoor colleagues who are only required to work 35 hours for the same pay.

TWU NSW - Mondiale

Workers at Mondiale in Erskine Park have been participating in industrial action since early May as part of their EBA campaign for decent pay and conditions. Mondiale have refused to budge from their unreasonable offer which would leave workers on average more than 10% below industry hourly rates.

AWU NSW - Snowy 2.0

Around 1000 workers on the Snowy 2.0 project will take 24 hours strike action today [https://substack.com/redirect/d4c0e9b1-ca56-4494-a280-a1d6abb2c3be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (21/5). Workers are fighting for improved conditions including better food, triple time on public holidays, 2 mental health days each year, increased allowances and pay rises “totalling more than 30% over four years”. The pay claim is to bring FIFO workers in line with tunnelling wage rates in Melbourne. While four unions have members on the site, it is understood this action only involves AWU members. Old tunnelling excavation is due to cease and most other work on the project will consequently also be shut down for the day. As well as the stoppage today the AWU has advised there will be “follow up action” early next week.

UWU - Allied Pinnacle

Industrial action commenced at Allied Pinnacle last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/f3b16df4-9931-49a6-af4a-efb8bc22021a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (14/5) and the dispute remains ongoing. Allied Pinnacle is a manufacturer of flour; bakery ingredients and bakery products including supermarket mud cakes [https://substack.com/redirect/c17fbbf8-09e3-49e8-a8a1-f28fd7f4e447?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers have been in negotiations since last September, and are fighting for a 15% pay increase over 3 years. Allied Pinnacle won't budge from 11.25% over 3 years. I understand visits to the picket line at 23-29 Pinnacle Road, Altona North are welcomed, particularly today and Thursday.

CFMEU Vic - BMS Heavy Cranes

The crane crew at the Golden Plains Wind Farm have voted up industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/1492b7a8-fc01-4177-9f2e-b50807aab93c?](https://substack.com/redirect/1492b7a8-fc01-4177-9f2e-b50807aab93c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for decent wages for their skilled work, and parity with crane crews operating in metropolitan Melbourne. A subcontractor was killed at the wind farm in November last year when he was crushed by a turbine blade [[https://substack.com/redirect/3e49e23c-5c8e-4961-9578-acb17e848dff?](https://substack.com/redirect/3e49e23c-5c8e-4961-9578-acb17e848dff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

UWU - PepsiCo

Industrial action at PepsiCo in South Australia continues as workers fight for pay parity with their Queensland colleagues. UWU is asking supporters to send a message to the PepsiCo CEO [[https://substack.com/redirect/253cb932-09cc-44ac-a1a9-252f9d9254a6?](https://substack.com/redirect/253cb932-09cc-44ac-a1a9-252f9d9254a6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] Ramon Laguarta demanding a fair deal for workers. Laguarta himself earns around \$28 million per year [[https://substack.com/redirect/13a442fc-724b-4c42-a831-70b85d5aa706?](https://substack.com/redirect/13a442fc-724b-4c42-a831-70b85d5aa706?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU - The Transport Industry (in 2026)

The National Secretary of the TWU, Michael Kaine, has revealed to The Australian that the TWU has spent 8 years orchestrating the simultaneous expiry of 200 enterprise agreements in 2026 [[https://substack.com/redirect/8b1bd938-73d7-4683-89d2-6d135d201f3a?](https://substack.com/redirect/8b1bd938-73d7-4683-89d2-6d135d201f3a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Companies on the hit list include Qantas, Aldi, amazon, Qube, Linfox, Toll, Virgin Australia, Boral, K&S Freighters, and Cleanaway. Any transport industry insiders reading? Get in touch cos I am going to need your help next year!

CFMEU ACT - Mark Irving

As I wrote in a last minute breaking news section last week, Mark Irving demoted CFMEU ACT Branch Secretary Michael Hiscox and appointed former ACTU Chief of Staff Ben Davison as CFMEU ACT Executive Officer, effectively putting the CFMEU ACT Branch under control of the administration [[https://substack.com/redirect/50d41333-3a38-47b8-b18e-1e44be53cd59?](https://substack.com/redirect/50d41333-3a38-47b8-b18e-1e44be53cd59?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The CFMEU ACT Branch Committee of Management rejected Irving's reasoning in a statement [[https://substack.com/redirect/ec329bf3-4139-45d7-b662-5d2590c537d7?](https://substack.com/redirect/ec329bf3-4139-45d7-b662-5d2590c537d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. If you're interested in my longer form thoughts on this you can read my note about it [<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen/note/c-118522190>].

AEU Vic - TAFE

Victorian TAFE teachers have endorsed a new agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/9d43a0ba-4fb7-405b-98a9-8c2043db16fc?](https://substack.com/redirect/9d43a0ba-4fb7-405b-98a9-8c2043db16fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which includes a minimum wage increase of 21% over 4 years, with a 14% increase occurring in the first 14 months. The agreement also includes greater leave entitlements, an increase in planning time and in-class assessments will now be counted as teaching time. During the campaign TAFE teachers held rolling stoppages around the state as well as a 24 hour state-wide strike.

That's all I've got this week! To finish, just a couple of quick announcements. Unions are rightly furious about the NSW Labor Government's proposed changes to workers compensation [[https://substack.com/redirect/ffa8c348-2705-4182-893c-4f9d17c0b835?](https://substack.com/redirect/ffa8c348-2705-4182-893c-4f9d17c0b835?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], there will be rallies across NSW [[https://substack.com/redirect/85500539-f5e8-47b4-bd5e-7de712d879b9?](https://substack.com/redirect/85500539-f5e8-47b4-bd5e-7de712d879b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] protesting the changes today (21/5), Thursday (22/5) and Monday (26/5). And for Victorians, "A Voice for Members" (a rank and file group of CPSU members) have called a rally for next Tuesday [[https://substack.com/redirect/e5f1627b-6985-4487-99df-30f0405c6ca2?](https://substack.com/redirect/e5f1627b-6985-4487-99df-30f0405c6ca2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (27/5) protesting the Victorian Labor Government's proposed cuts to the public service. Get along if you can!

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwknJNk1UWTBnREF3TVRNNuXDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05EYzNOelk0TXpZc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM09UTXhNamd6Tm13aWFFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdxPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhSWDJWdFlXbHNjbAUAZmVPSXJleEV1YkxPNE56anpWUFk4OUZ3Zm1HUjFCRXBDeDkxNE5DVnpHRSIsInAiOjE2NDAwMDEzOSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzZmXmNzMSIm1hdCI6MTc0Nzc3NjgzNiwiZlZlXhwiIjoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-22-april>

ASU Vic - Melbourne metro councils

ASU members at the 8 Melbourne metropolitan councils currently negotiating a multi-employer agreement are set to strike for 24 hours on 5 May [https://substack.com/redirect/3a7c5014-2396-47f7-934b-d5e9ace3aad0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers will rally at Trades Hall in Melbourne from 10:30am before marching to Parliament House [https://substack.com/redirect/10a35e82-a634-47c6-af62-bec767e4a671?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The decision to strike [https://substack.com/redirect/75fdb8dc-012f-4584-afd2-d31d4f62f216?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] was made by a mass meeting of ASU members on Friday (17/4). Work bans and some stoppages have been taking place across the 8 councils, with some councils getting a bit tetchy. For example, Merri-bek Council has been docking the wages [https://substack.com/redirect/12673c37-2c46-4742-9463-0294cabad587?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of Home Support Workers and Home Maintenance Workers for participating in work bans; Hume City Council has contracted scab labour [https://substack.com/redirect/d5f1907b-0658-406c-b3d3-387212f67110?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to collect bins and docked workers wages [https://substack.com/redirect/a2e07387-a2c1-4419-88a2-bc5bf39653cc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. If you live in one of the affected councils - write to your council reps and tell them you support workers and their struggle. Tell neighbours their bins not getting picked up is the fault of the Council, not the garbos. Back the workers that keep your community running. And get along to the strike rally if you can!

ETU WA - BHP

Industrial action at BHP did start on Thursday (16/4) but not without some issues [https://substack.com/redirect/9dba6ced-62f4-41d8-8908-11902106fae9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. It had been planned that bans on overtime, call-outs and acting in supervisory roles and mentoring or training new workers would be in place. BHP sent legal letters to two ETU members who were rostered to act as supervisors threatening to dock 100% of their pay [https://substack.com/redirect/a785c172-2401-40ec-b7bd-09c38204c888?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This led to the ETU withdrawing the ban on acting in a supervisory capacity or training new workers. As workers were commencing industrial action, Labor Premier Roger Cook said [https://substack.com/redirect/0dca3cc4-4e05-4f5a-8192-e1782ae03bda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] "We respect, and, indeed, admire, the opportunity for workers to be collectively represented by their union. But the Pilbara is an important opportunity, an economic opportunity, a jobs opportunity. The fact of the matter is that if industrial action is escalated, if industrial action is protracted, that just leads to job losses. That doesn't necessarily lead to better outcomes for those workers." I don't know what is worse about that statement - the assertion that industrial action should not come at the expense of the economy or the inference that if you take industrial action you should expect to lose your job. Cook belongs to the same ALP faction as the ETU. With friends like those, you certainly don't need enemies.

AMWU Victoria - Thales

Last week, the AMWU posted on social media [https://substack.com/redirect/ad93cfac-7be6-4946-9714-0801658e70ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that members at Thales were taking industrial action. There was a report in January [https://substack.com/redirect/0a9866b9-9423-41bd-902e-d809ff352a89?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that workers from both the AMWU and ETU took industrial action. Do you have more details about this dispute? Please get in touch!

AEU Vic - Public school teachers

As Term 2 kicked off on Monday (20/4), AEU members in Victorian public schools escalated industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/6719c4d4-a42e-4a9e-9add-7ce9c9d76a96?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Teachers will stop attending some meetings and refuse to respond to emails from the Department of Education [https://substack.com/redirect/78755cdb-869d-448a-94a9-db15925975c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Principals will refuse to attend principal area forums and the Government Schools Principals Conference. There will also be bans on providing written comments on student reports; and union members will stop work if an ALP member of the Victorian Parliament attends the school. A series of rolling, region by region half-day stoppages will start from May 6 - the day after the state budget. The first stoppage will see teachers from the West and North-West regions of Melbourne rally at Education Minister Ben Carroll's Niddrie electorate office. I've gleaned this list of stoppages from The Age [https://substack.com/redirect/d89de846-078e-4a79-a900-c232856866ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]:

6 May - Maribyrnong/Broadmeadows/Sunbury; 7 May - Wodonga/Wangaratta; Cranbourne/Berwick/Pakenham; 12 May - Warrnambool/Hamilton/Portland; Frankston/Moorabbin; 13 May - Bendigo/Castlemaine/Kyneton/Maryborough; Werribee; 14 May - Shepparton; Springvale/Dandenong; 19 May - Echuca/Kyabram; Horsham/Stawell; LaTrobe/Plenty; 20 May - West Gippsland/Latrobe Valley; Inner city suburbs Melbourne (Northcote); 21 May - Ballarat; Prahran/Longbeach/ Moorabbin/Bentleigh; 26 May - Geelong/Colac; 27 May - Melton; 28 May - South Gippsland; Doncaster/Warrigal/Diamond Valley; 2 June - Outer Easter suburbs/Knox/Dandenong Ranges/Yarra Valley; 3 June - Sale; 4 June - Inner West suburbs Melbourne (Footscray); 9 June - Seymour; Inner East suburbs (Ashburton); 10 June - Glen Waverley/Forest Hill; 11 June - Mildura; 17 June - Swan Hill; East Gippsland; 18 June - Mornington Peninsula

HACSU Tasmania - Clare House

Last Wednesday (15/4), HACSU members working in the Child and Youth Mental Health Service stopped work for two hours [https://substack.com/redirect/db12414f-25a4-4a85-8e0d-717260fdb5d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of their campaign to protect Clare House. The state government wants to sell off the building and relocate the service to a CBD office block. HACSU members argue that moving away from this carefully designed therapeutic space risks stripping away an environment that supports recovery. Last week's stoppage follows an initial stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/3312bb9b-b1fd-4d98-b10f-f13c0a43feb9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 1 April. Workers are asking supporters to sign a petition [https://substack.com/redirect/21ccf971-482e-4ec4-9bd4-0e915e30d941?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to the Health Minister demanding Clare House be saved.

RTBU QLD - Queensland Rail

The RTBU has notified Queensland Rail that industrial action will recommence from 27 April [https://substack.com/redirect/951a6663-f03f-4f52-97c1-83c008ada2e3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] unless an improved offer is made. The union has deliberately provided as much notice as possible after the last kerfuffle caused by the state government during industrial action. Bans on overtime and shifts longer than 6 hours contact time will resume as well as some new actions [https://substack.com/redirect/eba91510-85ae-4f65-9654-eb9044c8e488?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. For Rail Centre 1, Townsville and Rail Management Centre there will be a periodic ban on the performance of acting/working in higher grades from 29/4-26/5. For Rail Centre 1 and Rail Management Centre there will also be a ban on the train movements of coal and mineral trains on 30/4 and 1 May respectively.

QNMU - Mater

Mater has made an improved offer [https://substack.com/redirect/7d181a50-ec89-4d3b-a83d-a34907db5d6a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to the QNMU. The wage offer has increased from 11% over 4 years to 13.5%. While the union notes this is an improvement, they clearly state it is not parity with Queensland Health, or equal to the 2026 wage offer made to nurses and midwives at Ramsay. While the wage offer is increased, the offer does not include nurse to patient ratios and will not include a Sunday penalty rate increase until 2028. The union held a meeting with members [https://substack.com/redirect/38446fb0-401f-4f5f-9d0d-3d7bfac0c98a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 15/4 and subsequently sent out a poll to members at Mater asking if the offer is acceptable [https://substack.com/redirect/4b6d5df9-066a-4fab-aa54-da18ebec01fa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Stay tuned.

IEU Vic - Lauriston Girls' School

Teachers at Lauriston Girls' School commenced industrial action on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/3160bfa4-6fb2-4006-aad1-4baefb439eb2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (21/4). Teachers are adding campaign statements to their work emails; displaying materials in the school about the campaign and not adhering to the dress code. Teachers rejected the latest offer from the school of a 9% wage increase over 3 years. 170 staff voted against the proposal, with just 30 staff supporting it. IEU members are pushing for an 18% wage increase over 3 years.

HACSU Tasmania - Ambulance Tasmania

HACSU members finished work on time on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/ea7d1c53-1acc-46f6-80ad-bf44a24f84eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (20/4), refusing to work even 1 minute of overtime. Which for some paramedics meant walking off hospital ramps. This was an escalation in the campaign for fair pay, and improved conditions. HACSU and its members rightly argue that the regular and excessive overtime forced on paramedics is unfair and unsustainable. In addition to wages and excessive overtime, paramedics also have safety concerns including shift rostering and single officer staffing models.

In short

HACSU Tasmania - RHH

On 14/4, HACSU members from the Environmental Services Department walked off the job for the 5th time [https://substack.com/redirect/5fe6f81e-5924-4e29-a865-9760982aa180?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are disputing the creation of a new middle management role that duplicates duties carried out by supervisors. Workers want resources to go to more frontline cleaning staff, not more middle management. A deeply relatable dispute for many workers!

NTEU ACT - University of Canberra

NTEU members at the University of Canberra intend to strike on 5 May [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e5500adc-ebb6-427f-84ec-46f47ecd5f81?](https://substack.com/redirect/e5500adc-ebb6-427f-84ec-46f47ecd5f81?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] if there is no progress in negotiations. The NTEU has been in negotiations with the University for 5 months, but there has been no resolution on key issues including salaries and workload. Vice Chancellor Bill Shorten said the decision to move to strike action was “premature”. NTEU members will meet again on 30 April to see if any progress has been made.

PABO Watch

AWU/MUA WA - Inpex

Last week, union members at Inpex’s Ichthys LNG operation voted down [

[https://substack.com/redirect/11bfb4b1-e7e4-4734-8e95-0fcd48f2628f?](https://substack.com/redirect/11bfb4b1-e7e4-4734-8e95-0fcd48f2628f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] management’s proposed agreement. 98% of Offshore Alliance (MUA & AWU) union members voted no. Workers are now voting in a protected action ballot [[https://substack.com/redirect/163df9fd-88b8-4d9f-bd48-abe1bbbd901e?](https://substack.com/redirect/163df9fd-88b8-4d9f-bd48-abe1bbbd901e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. If the ballot is successful, industrial action could start as soon as 7 May.

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

Public school teachers in the ACT are now voting in a protected industrial action ballot [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a14803ed-8998-4aff-81da-65079fd84f1c?](https://substack.com/redirect/a14803ed-8998-4aff-81da-65079fd84f1c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. AEU members will vote on a range of industrial tactics [[https://substack.com/redirect/df2e2ee8-3528-43b4-9100-d32c1276b370?](https://substack.com/redirect/df2e2ee8-3528-43b4-9100-d32c1276b370?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including work stoppages; bans on professional learning; bans on student reporting; stoppages during visits from ALP MLAs; bans on implementing new system initiatives; bans on split/collapsed classes; bans on exceeding class sizes; and more. The ballot is open until May 1 [[https://substack.com/redirect/185e9232-c7e5-4649-8b82-82ddda7a16ec?](https://substack.com/redirect/185e9232-c7e5-4649-8b82-82ddda7a16ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Wins/resolutions

NSWNMA - Public sector nurses and midwives

On Thursday (16/4), the NSW IRC handed down its decision in the Special Case brought by the NSWNMA.

The Full Bench of the IRC awarded a 3 year deal [[https://substack.com/redirect/a3b92d16-e0e3-4655-98c9-773333d4763a?](https://substack.com/redirect/a3b92d16-e0e3-4655-98c9-773333d4763a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from 1 July 2025. This will see a 16% wage increase for Registered Nurses and Midwives (this is the majority of nurses/midwives) (10%/3%/3%); a 18% increase for enrolled nurses (12%/3%/3%) and a 28% increase for Assistants in Nursing and Midwifery (22%/3%/3%). While this is more than the NSW Government’s original offer of a 9% wage increase over 3 years [[https://substack.com/redirect/85d7c999-6aa0-44b4-bd5d-95edc92c9b03?](https://substack.com/redirect/85d7c999-6aa0-44b4-bd5d-95edc92c9b03?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], it falls well short of the 35% wage increase (15%/10%/10%) that the union had been fighting for. Michael Whaites the Secretary of the NSWNMA noted that “Throughout our campaign, we had politician after politician saying that they know nurses and midwives are worth more, we just can’t afford it...This is an outcome that says that women’s work has to remain undervalued because of the economy - that’s an appalling position for us to be in in 2026.” In 2024 while NSW nurses were striking for a fair deal [[https://substack.com/redirect/bb4ed91b-bbc9-4235-80fc-892c70409ff9?](https://substack.com/redirect/bb4ed91b-bbc9-4235-80fc-892c70409ff9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], NSW Police officers were awarded pay increases of between 22.3% - 39.4% over 4 years [[https://substack.com/redirect/56acccb86-dea8-48f3-be6d-72c0e658d266?](https://substack.com/redirect/56acccb86-dea8-48f3-be6d-72c0e658d266?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Union news

New union - TFTU

On 17/4 the Timber Furnishing and Textiles Union announced that the FWC had officially registered the union [[https://substack.com/redirect/9969379d-a423-4919-8e14-d6b5278ef603?](https://substack.com/redirect/9969379d-a423-4919-8e14-d6b5278ef603?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The TFTU is a new union formed by the CFMEU Manufacturing Division de-amalgamating from the CFMEU. If you want a whole chart of historic amalgamations [[https://substack.com/redirect/0520d7fc-84e7-48c8-a58a-20750fc01a57?](https://substack.com/redirect/0520d7fc-84e7-48c8-a58a-20750fc01a57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the Australian Trade Union Archives can help you out with that, but more recently the CFMEU Manufacturing Division came about through a merger between the CFMEU’s FFPD Division (Forestry, Furnishing, Building Products and Manufacturing Division) and the TCFUA (Textile, Clothing and Footwear Union of Australia) in 2018. The Manufacturing Division has been seeking to leave the CFMEU for several years seeking a “clean break” [[https://substack.com/redirect/8f8529ae-e21b-42b3-85e0-814318160b9c?](https://substack.com/redirect/8f8529ae-e21b-42b3-85e0-814318160b9c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the construction division. I propose the official pronunciation of the union should be “tff-too”.

International Workers Memorial Day - 28 April

Australian workers have marked International Workers Memorial Day [https://substack.com/redirect/31ee2531-a879-4b56-bc75-1a18b2d5ac3c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] since 1997. First initiated in Canada in the 1980s, it is a day to remember those injured or killed at work, and to fight for safer jobs. Safe Work Australia data isn't perfect but as at 9 April [https://substack.com/redirect/9f03b393-6567-4b36-8d42-2c5698a468df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] they recorded 180 deaths at work in 2025, and 30 deaths thus far this year. Please consider going to an IWMD memorial event this year. Or if you can't get off work, it's a great time to talk to workmates about safety or electing an HSR.

ACT - 9am, National Workers Memorial, Parkes, Canberra [https://substack.com/redirect/5d8ba842-922c-4a21-a99a-a1cddf383b6f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

NSW - 12pm, Reflection Park, Darling Harbour, Sydney [https://substack.com/redirect/df4d6c37-8ca8-453c-9892-74fc45d482bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

NSW - 9am, Blacktown Showground, Blacktown [https://substack.com/redirect/df4d6c37-8ca8-453c-9892-74fc45d482bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

NSW - 12pm, Newcastle Harbour Foreshore, Newcastle [https://substack.com/redirect/df4d6c37-8ca8-453c-9892-74fc45d482bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

NT - 7am (speeches at 8:20am), The Mall, Darwin City [https://substack.com/redirect/5d8ba842-922c-4a21-a99a-a1cddf383b6f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

QLD - 12pm, Speakers' Corner, Queensland Parliament, Brisbane [https://substack.com/redirect/5d8ba842-922c-4a21-a99a-a1cddf383b6f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

SA - 10am, Pilgrim Uniting Church, 12 Flinders Street, Adelaide [https://substack.com/redirect/7252303a-bc28-4090-bf8b-f66f1dc2dfa2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

TAS- 12:30pm, Workers Commemorative Park, Elizabeth Gardens, Invermay [https://substack.com/redirect/24e95212-6a10-4506-b1dd-ab1ead84b346?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

VIC - 10:30am, Argyle Square, Carlton, Melbourne [https://substack.com/redirect/e3d359fc-5cb9-43ac-a535-46c1c2afcf5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

VIC- 8am, Trades Hall Memorial Gardens, Bendigo [https://substack.com/redirect/aa91e46e-328d-4ea8-a340-b705503c6414?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

WA - 10am, Solidarity Park, West Perth [https://substack.com/redirect/0ed4aec1-d9ce-4e06-ad16-e03fbe41b736?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

That's all I've got this week. If you have details of any May Day events, please send them through as I will share them in next week's report. And as always, if I've missed a dispute, big or small, please get in touch!

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNJNk1UazBPVEF4T1RrMEXDSnBZWFpT2pFM056WTRNRGN3TVRJc0ltvJrjQ0k2TVRnd09ETTBnekF4TWl3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhSWDJWdF1xbHNjbAub3N3S1BDQVRncWZc0hVY0Q1SnNoME1TbFJYNDVoeEpVSG9tY0wySkFVTSIsInAiOjE5NDkwMTk5NCwicWcyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxZmZmIm1hdCI6MTc3NjgwNzAxMiwiaXhwaW9yMDkyMzgzMDEyLCJpc3MiOiIjWdWITMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.SrC1SMbtVL9Qa9wc8wLjq1nHdnAmTK34q4JcKjZtZQ?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-22-january>

ASMOF - NSW Psychiatrists

Resignations by NSW public sector psychiatrists commenced yesterday (21/1) and some mental health wards have already closed [https://substack.com/redirect/f4044bc3-dc77-40f6-8496-a5dbb3e5a59d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. According to the Minister for Mental Health of the 200 resignations, 25 had been rescinded and 81 deferred. That still leaves 94 resignations. And bearing in mind that there are only 443 public psychiatrist positions in NSW, and 40% of those roles were vacant before the resignations. If that's not a system in crisis, I'm not sure what is. A directions hearing was held in the NSW IRC yesterday (21/1) with ASMOF and the state government agreeing to expedited arbitration with a full bench from 17-21 March. ASMOF have shared their frustration [https://substack.com/redirect/427250b8-6078-4025-987c-3fed88d0d694?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with negotiations so far with NSW Health representatives leaving negotiations last week after only 1 hour and a refusal to consider any wage increase over the 3% already offered. Many psychiatrists have also gone public with their concerns [https://substack.com/redirect/5b2f1991-3605-405a-9975-02f2b0244ffa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and dispelled some of the misleading statements made by the government about psychiatrists' wages.

ANMF Vic - St Vincent's Private

The ANMF has had a win in the Federal Court [https://substack.com/redirect/91d19125-3a0e-4448-9afd-b2793a17b54f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with their application for an injunction which stops St Vincent's Private from asserting that bed closures are unprotected industrial action. The hospital has to provide every nurse and midwife a copy of the Federal Court Order. The union met with management on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/cbd00870-2c31-43f3-b6de-2718d259b2bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and the talks were described as "positive" - more negotiating meetings are scheduled for this Friday (24/1;) Wednesday 29th January and Friday 5th February.

AWU Victoria - Geelong Infrabuild Wire Mill

Following on from industrial action late last year, workers at the Infrabuild Wire Mill in Geelong will participate in a 24 hour stoppage today (22 January). The union will be holding 2 rallies - one at 6am and one at 1pm to cover all shifts and support workers. Workers are fighting for a fair deal. Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to receive the full report straight to your inbox.

CFMEU Manufacturing - Opal

The Opal paper production facility in Maryvale locked out 300 workers last Thursday 16/1. The lockout came in response to 7 workers taking a 6 hour stoppage as part of their EBA negotiations - the first industrial action taken by production workers in twenty years. The workers have been bargaining for a new agreement since October, and their current EBA expired in December. Opal has claimed the changes to wood supply and the end of white paper manufacturing at the plant means that "terms and conditions that were appropriate many years ago in previous Enterprise Agreements were not relevant to the Mill's operations today. [https://substack.com/redirect/2dd47b10-722b-4716-8179-190b694530b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]" The CFMEU says that Opal wants to "increase employees' ordinary working hours; reclassify their roles again; treat them like casual employees and remove checks and balances around rostering; crewing numbers and career progression. [https://substack.com/redirect/31f3eb2d-7da9-4bfe-8968-944e0c5cd24a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]" In 2016, production workers took a 5% pay cut to secure the Mill's future, but now appear to be having that thrown in their faces. At a mass meeting on Monday (20/1) [https://substack.com/redirect/9314038b-15b5-4e56-bbca-554c9d9c2352?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], workers agreed to stand firm, and passed a vote of No Confidence in senior management. The union has set up a fundraiser for affected workers [https://substack.com/redirect/28fb6c93-f353-4a38-9577-6d0c57632f0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

CRU - Sydney Trains

Industrial action by the Combined Rail Unions (CRU) continued last week until all industrial action was suspended in an interim order made by the Fair Work Commission late last Thursday (16/1) [https://substack.com/redirect/aefb0b8f-74dc-4e10-a1dd-0583df32e79e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Following this the CRU filed for a Good Faith Bargaining order [https://substack.com/redirect/1e7e562f-c0d9-4bb2-8e13-6d82bf3c492c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] due to the exasperation of how the negotiations to date have been handled. The CRU has presented a counteroffer to the government [https://substack.com/redirect/72e625bd-7fd8-4d41-a040-04aed84f00c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], which according to media reports includes a payrise of 11% over 3 years. This is less than the unions' original demand of 32%, but

also less than the 14% increase that was recently rejected. The counteroffer does include several removed clauses being reinstated, including the clauses that ensures participation by workers in risk assessments. This clause appears to be one of the major sticking points. All parties are due back in the FWC today and tomorrow for the full hearing on the suspension of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/7f73b298-6bce-4192-b633-c77eeeab8eca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

HSU WA - Public Sector Healthcare workers

It has been disclosed that the 4th offer to public sector health workers was rejected by 77% of HSU WA members [https://substack.com/redirect/6d214519-9e9f-44ac-a892-5deeebe1020d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

The union appears steadfast in their demand for improved wages and conditions. The HSU WA has re-launched the Your Voice In Health survey [https://substack.com/redirect/4cdcacf7-d1d3-4a46-875f-1890fb76e3a8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], a state Labor government initiative established in 2019, but subsequently skipped in 2022 and 2024. With the survey now in the union's hands it will gauge "the morale of healthcare workers, their confidence in WA Health, how well staff are supported by their employer and the culture in the workplace." I suspect the results won't be easy reading for the Cook Government!

TWU WA - K&S Fuels
Fuel delivery drivers in WA employed by K&S Fuels took 24 hour strike action yesterday (21/1) and are preparing to strike again tomorrow (23/1) [https://substack.com/redirect/abf67776-afc2-4dcb-80ee-19ad21656da1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The workers are fighting for improved pay and conditions, crucially wage increases to keep up with the cost of living. K&S drivers are paid less than other fuel delivery drivers, and want to see their wages rise to keep up with other companies.

AWU NSW - Tomago Aluminum

580 AWU members at Tomago Aluminum in Newcastle commenced industrial action this week. Interestingly, the industrial action coincided with a visit from Prime Minister Anthony Albanese announcing \$2 billion of investment into the Australian-made aluminium industry [https://substack.com/redirect/f675f23c-02d6-408a-9452-acd968656c87?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. I'm unsure what percentage of that \$2 billion is going to Tomago, but the bosses there are refusing workers a 15% pay increase over 5 years, refusing to budge from their 10% offer. AWU NSW Branch Secretary Tony Callinan commented that "We have got a new CEO and management structure up there that hasn't got the benefit of the history of the site and don't understand that the blokes are prepared to fight for a better outcome. They are about to learn the hard way. [https://substack.com/redirect/b59cfef0-7d2d-43c9-a57b-b4318295b114?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]"

AWU Vic - FFMV

While more than 800 AWU members at Forest Fire Management Victoria (FFMV) have participated in important work over the summer in relation to bush fires, their industrial action has continued [https://substack.com/redirect/2deee877-8349-4b44-92f7-6e0a3dc74865?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

Workers have not been attending to campground maintenance duties such as removing rubbish or cleaning fire pits. The workers are fighting for pay parity with Parks Victoria workers who perform similar roles. The union is in negotiations with DEECA.

AMOU/AIMPE - Smit Lamnalco

Industrial action on the tugs at the Port of Gladstone continues [https://substack.com/redirect/5c7984ec-4584-42f6-baf3-5d081176504f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

In addition to earlier bans, a new suite of bans including a ban on performing work outside rostered hours; a ban on performing extended maintenance and paperwork and data entry bans will commence today and run through to February 5. An initial conference in the FWC has been scheduled for 31 January.

UWU - Woolworths

The Guardian has reported that following the UWU strike at Woolies distribution centres late last year, 2 workers have been sacked and many other staff across sites in NSW and Victoria are being investigated for their conduct during the strike [https://substack.com/redirect/5375d25a-edbf-40e2-9df9-d2860c29266d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Both the union and the two sacked workers declined to comment, but the bosses have alleged the investigations are in relation to "unlawful picketing" and the two workers were sacked due to "alleged behaviour outside a site that was not on strike." This is all deeply concerning, and shows the lengths bosses will go to in order to punish militant workers.

A Voice for Members

A rank and file group of CPSU SPSF members in Victoria are mounting an election campaign in their union. "A Voice for Members [https://substack.com/redirect/52775457-f55f-47e6-9d26-8c7d487e95fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]" will be holding a campaign launch and fundraiser meeting next Thursday 30 January, 6pm at Bargoonga Nganjin, North Fitzroy Library.

CPSU SPSF members are strongly encouraged to attend. The rank and file group are “committed to revitalising our union by strengthening grassroots democracy and empowering members to lead the fight for better wages and workplace conditions.”

Leadership Change ANMF Victorian Branch

In December, it was announced that the ANMF Victorian Branch Assistant Secretary Paul Gilbert will retire in February. Gilbert started work for the branch as an organiser in 1991 and was elected Assistant Secretary in 2009. Current Professional Officer, Sam Casey, has been appointed by the Branch Council to step into the Assistant Secretary. Branch Secretary, Lisa Fitzpatrick, has also announced that she will not contest the next election, with her current term ending on 30 November 2025. According to ANMF rules, elections should be held between 1 September and 30 October. Fitzpatrick has been Branch Secretary since 2001, a whopping 24 years. I did wonder if any other current union leaders had held office for as long, but a quick google found at least 3 with longer tenure in the top job! Paddy Crumlin has been National Secretary of the MUA since 2000 (25 years); Tony Maher has been General President of the Mining and Energy Union (previously CFMEU Mining and Energy Division) since 1998 (27 years) and Karen Batt has been secretary of the CPSU SPSF Victorian Branch since 1993 (32 years).

That’s all I’ve got this week. Has your union’s leadership been in power since the Howard era? Is your EBA campaign kicking off in 2025? Does your union have elections this year? Let me know! I’d love to hear all about it.

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWw0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVn1YMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UVTFNekk1T0RrekxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM016YzBPVEUzTKRjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjMk9UQXl0emMwTn13aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlxbHNjbjAudWdoNTBIR0JUQjBfRlplJQkc4bG5DTlZ2ZmtYaEtYdE9JTWdIcGtCWVZSWSIsInAi0jE1NTMyOTg5MywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTczNzQ5MTc0NywiZXhwIjoxNzQwMDgzNzQ3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.fzWhFzK5nus1w7Cdo-9etHCpMcTRAAQKd0Rc3JEnzj4?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-22-july>

AEU Vic - Public school teachers

On Friday (17/07) the Victorian government put a new pay offer to teachers [https://substack.com/redirect/112610fd-5200-416c-b776-36a667089ffc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Victorian AEU members have since rejected the offer [https://substack.com/redirect/f75f20a3-16e0-4d1f-bac9-e6b3bb7ced62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (51.81% to 48.82%), and the AEU has confirmed plans for a 24 hour strike on Thursday (23/07). The vote on the new offer reveals just how much the AEU Victoria's membership has grown this year. 35,915 AEU members were eligible to vote in the protected action ballot in March. The AEU reports 50,677 members voted in their straw poll on the government's latest offer. The latest offer [https://substack.com/redirect/b7936796-6260-49be-b69d-75f154c2381f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] was a small improvement to the one members rejected in June. It included an additional 1% bonus for teachers and principals at the top of the range, reduced after school meetings, and the conversion of allowances into base rate for Education Support staff. According to Class Struggle [https://substack.com/redirect/f89fe1ab-5ae9-4fe4-b707-798177decfae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], teachers and school staff are holding out for action on workload and class sizes. As part of the 24 hour strike action on Thursday, teachers and supporters will be meeting in the Bourke Street Mall at 10:30am before marching to Parliament House - join them if you can (wear red!).

MUA - Certis

The MUA is calling for support on a picket line [https://substack.com/redirect/8e02b253-8f15-4872-9e52-30a4389c1ca0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] this Friday (24/7) at DP World Port Botany from 1pm. Gatehouse guards at Port Botany, who are employed by Certis, have been in negotiations for a new deal since late last year. They commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/4ab20746-3c4d-48ce-bb12-a0b0ff72ea18?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in May. But Certis are still refusing to come to the table with a fair offer. Workers are striking again on Friday, and the MUA is calling on "every decent person who believes in working class solidarity" to head down to the port to support the picket line. The MUA has reason to believe that scabs are going to be used to try and break the picket. Head on down to 42 Friendship Road, Port Botany, 1pm, Friday 24 July.

AMWU/AWU/ETU WA - BHP

The "historic" strike [https://substack.com/redirect/c50cc257-8f9a-456d-8a6c-ce542f7ff5a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at BHP Port Hedland took place as expected on Thursday (23/7). Union members walked off the job at 2pm [https://substack.com/redirect/073f5a52-ba2f-4e5d-aa80-b29e7150cdd6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] joining families and supporters. Solidarity rallies were held outside BHP Offices in Melbourne [https://substack.com/redirect/260575ab-5dd8-4828-839d-87023f1cd3bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and Brisbane [https://substack.com/redirect/49c14a96-ebb9-485f-acee-e0b24a152107?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. There has been a lot of commentary about the numbers of workers striking [https://substack.com/redirect/9df61557-7531-4c2d-b47a-c44427a765e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and the extent of the cost and disruption [https://substack.com/redirect/d375801c-1483-4ce2-9b3f-b09f2ff60ebf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to port operations. But, as ETU Secretary Adam Woodage said [https://substack.com/redirect/ef0dba88-7ad4-49c7-ac01-b5332624f607?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] "The aim of the game was to send to BHP a very strong message that our members want BHP to get serious, and get serious about negotiations, and put real tangible figures in an EBA document." Negotiations resumed yesterday (21/7) in the FWC. The Western Mine Workers Alliance shared [https://substack.com/redirect/f26234c6-466f-42cb-b449-d13899936193?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that remuneration models; allowances; classification structures; and transitioning legacy agreements were all on the agenda. The talks were described as "constructive" [https://substack.com/redirect/c07deaa1-f08c-4d30-874d-9d902c49c00b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] by BHP. Unions have committed to more industrial action should negotiations stall again. Negotiations are scheduled to continue next Tuesday (28/7).

UWU - ISS

Aviation screening officers at Perth Airport walked off the job on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/9a5c7f05-9032-4b2f-8bc8-f96ea2068ea4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (17/9) and again on Monday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/6a20d9d8-728b-40c4-b549-cb67bbbec8ea?](https://substack.com/redirect/6a20d9d8-728b-40c4-b549-cb67bbbec8ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6a20d9d8-728b-40c4-b549-cb67bbbec8ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] (20/7). ISS's employees at Perth Airport are paid 13-19% less than their interstate counterparts despite doing the same job. Most workers are stuck on insecure rosters [https://substack.com/redirect/7dbca2f5-8e8f-4235-8f52-d0325396127b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which only guarantee 16 hours of work a week, and include four hour shifts. Workers often only find out about shifts a few days in advance. Only 20% of workers are employed full time. One proposed agreement from ISS has already been voted down [https://substack.com/redirect/41c68d3d-f22a-4e1a-a94e-a7cf38857d36?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Uwu members just want a fair deal - pay parity with east coast colleagues, secure jobs and respectful rostering practices.

CPSU Vic - Parks Victoria

CPSU members at Parks Victoria escalated work bans over the weekend. Starting from Saturday morning (18/7) the CPSU warned that at parks across the state entrance gates may not be unlocked, bins may not be emptied, toilets may not be cleaned and other access may be affected. The bans will be in place until 27/7. Workers are fighting for a decent offer from the state government to ensure fair wages and conditions. Since the minimum wage increased from 1 July, multiple levels of Parks Victoria pay grades now fall below the minimum wage. Workers are asking supporters to sign their "Fair Pay for Parks" petition [[https://substack.com/redirect/36bc200f-5531-4a26-8134-6a5c4174952f?](https://substack.com/redirect/36bc200f-5531-4a26-8134-6a5c4174952f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/36bc200f-5531-4a26-8134-6a5c4174952f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

CEPU SA - Service Stream

Services Stream, a services company that designs, operates and maintains critical infrastructure, put out a substandard agreement to vote without union backing. The agreement was voted down [

[https://substack.com/redirect/76bca8e2-b8dd-4db4-9aaf-ae821390abb9?](https://substack.com/redirect/76bca8e2-b8dd-4db4-9aaf-ae821390abb9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/76bca8e2-b8dd-4db4-9aaf-ae821390abb9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] yesterday (21/7). CEPU members

held stoppages last week [[https://substack.com/redirect/ceaf1d46-ab11-427c-a7c7-529c1606bd4a?](https://substack.com/redirect/ceaf1d46-ab11-427c-a7c7-529c1606bd4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ceaf1d46-ab11-427c-a7c7-529c1606bd4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] on 16 and 17 July, and again on

Monday [[https://substack.com/redirect/077cf4c7-0646-49f9-9acd-cfe7fc713a41?](https://substack.com/redirect/077cf4c7-0646-49f9-9acd-cfe7fc713a41?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/077cf4c7-0646-49f9-9acd-cfe7fc713a41?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and Tuesday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/76bca8e2-b8dd-4db4-9aaf-ae821390abb9?](https://substack.com/redirect/76bca8e2-b8dd-4db4-9aaf-ae821390abb9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/76bca8e2-b8dd-4db4-9aaf-ae821390abb9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] this week. Workers are seeking a fair EBA with industry standard wages and conditions. They know the company can afford it as last year they signed a \$1.6 billion dollar contract [https://substack.com/redirect/9b6c33b6-8504-45dc-a2cb-1616b3bec810?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with the government to manage defense assets. Workers including electricians, plumbers and HVAC technicians from the RAAF Base Edinburgh north of Adelaide and the Defence Base at Woomera walked off the job to participate in the stoppages.

ANMF Vic - Public school nurses

ANMF members who work as public school nurses have been taking industrial action for over 80 days [

[https://substack.com/redirect/644507bd-9ce7-4caf-b657-d6be24732eec?](https://substack.com/redirect/644507bd-9ce7-4caf-b657-d6be24732eec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/644507bd-9ce7-4caf-b657-d6be24732eec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. School nurses are fighting for pay parity with their public sector colleagues. They want the state government to negotiate genuinely and respect their qualifications. Industrial action includes [

[https://substack.com/redirect/4fe508ff-1015-4f1a-a5c3-799af8265df3?](https://substack.com/redirect/4fe508ff-1015-4f1a-a5c3-799af8265df3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4fe508ff-1015-4f1a-a5c3-799af8265df3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] talking to parents and community members about the campaign; providing comment on social and traditional media; wearing union campaign t-shirts and displaying campaign messages in the workplace and on vehicles used for work [

[https://substack.com/redirect/8b515e7d-98b5-48b1-8703-4dc9da8c53b7?](https://substack.com/redirect/8b515e7d-98b5-48b1-8703-4dc9da8c53b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8b515e7d-98b5-48b1-8703-4dc9da8c53b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

CPSU ACT - ACT public sector

A new pay deal has been offered [[https://substack.com/redirect/871770f4-1f7d-4ce6-89d2-754b328329e4?](https://substack.com/redirect/871770f4-1f7d-4ce6-89d2-754b328329e4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/871770f4-1f7d-4ce6-89d2-754b328329e4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] to ACT public sector workers. The new deal includes a \$600 cost of living payment if CPI reaches 3.5% or higher which would increase to \$1000 if CPI hits 4%. Wage increases remain the same at 9% over 3 years. The government has moved on its superannuation offer, with contributions increasing to 13% 6 months earlier than in the last offer. Various other improvements have been spruiked by the government including action on workload; a clause on the use of AI and increasing the cap of personal leave without evidence from 7 to 10 days. The CPSU is currently polling members on the agreement, with the poll closing on Monday (27/7). The ACT Government has said the agreement will go to a ballot in August.

CPSU Tasmania - Launceston Reception Prison

For the second time in 3 months, correctional officers at Launceston Reception Prison have taken industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/af0891e6-33d8-45f5-bea4-134868dad237?](https://substack.com/redirect/af0891e6-33d8-45f5-bea4-134868dad237?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/af0891e6-33d8-45f5-bea4-134868dad237?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. On Tuesday and Wednesday last

week [[https://substack.com/redirect/784c7961-d86e-466f-a2ac-f1a64831074c?](https://substack.com/redirect/784c7961-d86e-466f-a2ac-f1a64831074c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/784c7961-d86e-466f-a2ac-f1a64831074c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] (14-15/7), CPSU members refused to accept additional prisoners from Hobart; only provided essential welfare services to prisoners and

non essential movements including court appearances were cancelled. The union is concerned about chronic overcrowding at the prison, where there is often not enough space to house everyone. Safety warnings from workers have been ignored and overcrowding poses safety risks to prisoners and workers. In addition to overcrowding, CPSU delegates at the prison have also flagged terrible pest issues at the prison [https://substack.com/redirect/7b8ba25b-ad93-4c75-b5a2-f8cff2c61c64?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with rats climbing through sewerage into cells.

In short

MSAV - Public health professionals

Late last week MSAV sent a survey to all members [https://substack.com/redirect/f1778f9b-3f2a-4c9c-ae50-b2a085f1a8df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to gauge their appetite for industrial action. MSAV had been advised by the state government to expect a revised offer last week, but no offer was forthcoming. Workers are sick of being strung along, and the union is signalling an escalation in industrial action in response.

AMWU Victoria - Kinetic

AMWU members at Kinetic buses in Melbourne commenced industrial action on Monday (20/7) after a break down in negotiations.

ETU WA - UGL

Industrial action by ETU members at Varanus Island continues [https://substack.com/redirect/337df994-2a75-41bd-86b4-b3190811e9a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and the ETU has put another call out to workers to avoid taking up any work there as UGL and Santos are seeking scab labour through various labour hire companies including Mobalize, TechForce, Talent HQ, and Core Talent [https://substack.com/redirect/a534493c-c25e-4199-b62b-46423de0a0dc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Please share in your networks if you work in the sector.

ETU QLD - Cleanco

Last Wednesday (15/7) ETU members at Cleanco Kareeya Power Station took industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/79ce9228-02f4-411c-972c-398f1940b923?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. This follows action by Cleanco workers [https://substack.com/redirect/4d9d4fea-21c1-4af7-a8f2-402c6b3f4b5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] at the Barron Gorge Power Station in June. Workers are fighting back against the hostile bargaining framework imposed by the Crisfaulli Government. Cleanco is a state government owned corporation.

QNMU - Bethany Christian Care

Last Thursday (16/7), QNMU members at Bethany Christian Care commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/f1e53e51-e798-4303-b634-23b41cfd64ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Very scant information available other than that the current offer from management isn't good enough, and workers are fighting for a fair agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/18e8774b-e528-4295-9534-b633e14bd68d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Know more? Get in touch.

PABO Watch

MUA WA - Port of Broome

100% of MUA members [https://substack.com/redirect/3c22eb9f-c8fb-4274-99bd-f8e0b581d1ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] at the Port of Broome have 100% endorsed [https://substack.com/redirect/f36a9775-563b-4197-997c-5ebc0d52ae5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] taking industrial action. Industrial action will kick off this Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/4a50a4c7-ecfa-4c83-b96a-e2d72f8a7329?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (24/7).

AIPA - Qantas

Members of the Australian and International Pilots Association will vote in a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/10bab7e3-e730-4841-a28a-40d1d1e2ba53?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] next week. Negotiations on a new pay deal between Qantas and two unions - AIPA and AFAP - have been underway for two years. Pilots rejected an offer [https://substack.com/redirect/aa5aea36-b715-4429-880a-25c8e804b2c8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] from Qantas in April. AIPA members are seeking improvements to work-life balance and a higher annual pay rise than Qantas' offer of 3%. Long-haul pilots have not taken industrial action for 15 years.

Union news

UWU National Convention

UWU's National Convention will take place on Monday (27/7). This is the final stage of the fiercely contested UWU election. It's a different system to many unions. The national election is for convention delegates, and then those delegates elect the National Executive (Secretary, President etc) and Member Council. So whoever has the numbers at Convention, gets a clean sweep of Exec positions. The United for You ticket will have the numbers on the floor after winning a majority of

electorates in the election. I did valiantly attempt to “do the numbers” and get a full picture for you, but I ran out of time! Last week, United for You unveiled their ticket for National Executive [https://substack.com/redirect/06d867a4-ab8e-4cda-934a-ee8d47a3d804?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] headed by current Vice-President and ACT Secretary Lyndal Ryan and ALP powerbroker Gary Bullock.

Wins/resolutions

AWU/ETU/MUA - Inpex

The in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/9b4537b6-cbf5-41a2-8a1f-00ed4c6da9f5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] made between Inpex and unions, has now been endorsed by workers. 97.3% of eligible workers participated in the ballot, and 97.5% voted in favour of the agreement. According to a social media post by Offshore Alliance [https://substack.com/redirect/25090ba9-1976-45da-8247-51a405cda4bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the agreement includes “highest remuneration standards amongst the 4 Tier-1 oil & gas operators” as well as a new career progression framework; 20 job share positions; additional leave entitlements; improved fatigue management provisions and more. Unions estimate the industrial action undertaken to get this agreement cost Inpex \$200 million in lost production.

That’s all I’ve got this week. It has been a late night effort to get the report finished this week so no special closing remarks! Let me know what I’ve missed and I’ll be back next week.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWw0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1qQTNPVEV3TXpFd0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09EUTJOamsyTlRjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE5qSXdOVFkxTn13aWYFNpJam9pY0hWaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkvV0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhswdJWdFlXbHNjbAUVeO3UFRUQ09hNjBwY2N4akVjMjF5MmU4QW51MXJwZmFh3SxNkSlV3MXgzSSIsInAiOjIwNzkxMDMxMCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc4NDY2OTY1NywiZXhwIjoyMTAwMjQ1NjU3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0cCI6InN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.e8gij_q3A9igs0b4Akp_04ERTKCzuLLZe9pLpPcthTc?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-22-october>

NTEU - ACU

On Thursday (16/10) NTEU members walked off the job for 2 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/e467af84-9f2e-45b0-8d1e-836a5e7ebd41?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at ACU campuses in Ballarat, Brisbane, Sydney, Canberra and Melbourne. Workers have rejected management's offer of 2.5% annual wage increases, as it falls below the wage price index of 3.4%. In addition to a decent wage increase, workers are fighting for strengthened job security; action on workloads and improved rights to flexible working conditions. According to the NTEU, ACU's Vice-Chancellor received a \$60,000 pay rise last year - equivalent to a 5.8% wage increase. Is taking a wage increase that is double what you offer staff acting in truth and love [https://substack.com/redirect/5e687db8-5c71-4154-99f8-b2c5ef10fdf5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as the ACU mission statement commands?

AMWU Vic - Bucher Municipal

Workers at Bucher Municipal continue their industrial campaign for a fair wage increase and clear reclassification structures. Workers will not agree to any dodgy trade-offs.

TWU VIC - Armaguard and Prosegur

99.15% of TWU members at Armaguard and Prosegur (cash in transit security workers) in Victoria and Tasmania voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/f5df4169-197f-4e35-b4a0-5d6e2748873c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Starting today (22/10), indefinite bans on overtime and weekend work will commence. Workers are also poised to strike on Friday (24/10) and Monday (27/10) [https://substack.com/redirect/8943c7d1-36ea-48cd-a9f9-39798b831761?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Negotiations broke down between workers and cash handling companies after delays on finalising a new sustainable funding model for the industry. TWU members are fighting for a decent EBA and stronger safety nets for pay and conditions. TWU members in NSW have also voted up industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/63a2e404-d242-4ad9-9f1e-4403ea46fba9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at Armaguard and Prosegur, but are yet to announce commencement. Stay tuned.

Public Sector Unions Tasmania - Tasmanian Government

Members of the AEU, CPSU, HACSU and UWU in the Tasmanian public sector are planning coordinated industrial action in the last week of October [https://substack.com/redirect/ac4466dd-a832-4af6-a9de-f69bc9a7d734?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This follows the unions' rejection of the Rockliff government's offer of a 3%, wage increase, one year agreement on a "take it or leave it" basis. Each union will decide on the nature of the industrial action they participate in - likely one hour stopwork actions or working to rule.

MEU - Bloomfield

Tomorrow (23/10) will mark 3 weeks on strike [https://substack.com/redirect/2cff94fa-e9e2-4162-8960-f5ffd0394e12?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for miners at Rix's Creek coal mine. MEU members commenced industrial action after 10 months of negotiations. The major sticking point is ensuring accident pay reflects real wages. Currently, accident pay is supplemented by union members chipping in to support a fellow worker to ensure injured workers don't lose out. The MEU has described this as an "outdated system" that is both unfair and unsustainable. Instead of listening to workers, Bloomfield now intends on putting a worse agreement out to vote which reduced the pay position from the previous offer and still doesn't fix the accident pay issue. Bloomfield is also advertising for scab labour [https://substack.com/redirect/38dbd24d-a535-42e3-ba72-8f271cf869f3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are standing strong for a decent deal [https://substack.com/redirect/63ccc98d-5486-4e5f-b980-88cedbfcb2b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU NSW - ZircoDATA

On Thursday (16/10) workers at ZircoDATA took protected industrial action in response to a substandard offer from management. TWU members are fighting for a fair deal with decent pay and conditions.

AWU Vic - Infrabuild

On Friday (24/10), Infrabuild workers at the Laverton steel mill will commence rolling 12-24 hour stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/01dac025-caf6-46c8-b7c9-22e22ffa401a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

AWU members want management to come back to the table and negotiate an agreement that has fair wages and decent conditions. Workers have rejected the latest offer from the boss [https://substack.com/redirect/2cf5aa8e-8992-41c7-b5af-bf908b7a99f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and are committed to fighting for a better deal. Join workers for an early BBQ on the picket line this Friday, 6:30am at 105 Doherty's Road, Laverton North [<https://substack.com/redirect/ea716d87-7d1b-43f5-bc9f->

8e986d89311d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU NT - CDC

Bus drivers in Darwin and Palmerston employed by CDC took 24 hours strike action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/1e365db3-432f-4cce-97ae-c11a29529819?](https://substack.com/redirect/1e365db3-432f-4cce-97ae-c11a29529819?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1e365db3-432f-4cce-97ae-c11a29529819?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on Monday (20/10). Workers have been participating in low level industrial action for several weeks [

[https://substack.com/redirect/ca1e4cf6-1dc9-4f79-86d0-12a922262ad0?](https://substack.com/redirect/ca1e4cf6-1dc9-4f79-86d0-12a922262ad0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ca1e4cf6-1dc9-4f79-86d0-12a922262ad0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], but have escalated to this stoppage. They are demanding a decent pay increase and for improvements to safety at work. The TWU claims bus drivers need access to “industry standard” conditions to improve safety. A union survey found 41% of drivers had been attacked at work, 31% reported being attacked in the last 18 months. 85% of drivers reported they would consider leaving without change [

[https://substack.com/redirect/75c018f4-9df0-4d21-9357-5b150eee7ed7?](https://substack.com/redirect/75c018f4-9df0-4d21-9357-5b150eee7ed7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/75c018f4-9df0-4d21-9357-5b150eee7ed7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] to their working conditions. The TWU has not ruled out further industrial action.

RTBU NSW - Sydney Metro

On Friday (17/1) industrial action commenced on the Sydney Metro [

[https://substack.com/redirect/047a38a5-1478-4724-9746-fa5633485df9?](https://substack.com/redirect/047a38a5-1478-4724-9746-fa5633485df9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/047a38a5-1478-4724-9746-fa5633485df9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. RTBU members will be wearing campaign t-shirts; displaying and distributing campaign materials and talking to the media and general public about their EBA negotiations [[https://substack.com/redirect/9618f86e-78dc-4fbc-a21e-71c2639e966a?](https://substack.com/redirect/9618f86e-78dc-4fbc-a21e-71c2639e966a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9618f86e-78dc-4fbc-a21e-71c2639e966a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The industrial action is of an indefinite nature. A bargaining update from 1 October shared that “MTS has spat the dummy and declared bargaining is over.” I don’t have any specific details on what the sticking points in negotiations are. Would love to hear from any RTBU members involved in the dispute.

AWU Vic - Forest firefighters

As foreshadowed in last week’s report, Victorian forest firefighters will rally next Wednesday (29/10) at 11:30am at Trades Hall in Lygon Street. AWU members and supporters will march to Victorian Parliament to demand fair pay and a decent deal from the government. Workers have been in dispute since December last year. Get along and support them if you can.

UWU - Graincorp

Workers at Graincorp in Geelong and Portland walked off the job for 24 hours yesterday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/1a02ede2-21f0-40ee-8617-6984b9601370?](https://substack.com/redirect/1a02ede2-21f0-40ee-8617-6984b9601370?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1a02ede2-21f0-40ee-8617-6984b9601370?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] (21/10). EBA negotiations have broken down a few months after systemic underpayments were discovered. Workers are fighting for a workable rostering system, the provision of safety equipment in the agreement, and a fair pay rise. [[https://substack.com/redirect/45c7889b-9192-4b64-b6e8-31efd3ad05?](https://substack.com/redirect/45c7889b-9192-4b64-b6e8-31efd3ad05?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/45c7889b-9192-4b64-b6e8-31efd3ad05?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]

PSA SA - Public sector workers

Public sector workers in SA stopped work and rallied on the steps of Parliament last Wednesday (15/10). Workers demanded the Premier lift their wages [[https://substack.com/redirect/3e66953c-5d7c-45e2-b7bd-e8dfbd67b2ad?](https://substack.com/redirect/3e66953c-5d7c-45e2-b7bd-e8dfbd67b2ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3e66953c-5d7c-45e2-b7bd-e8dfbd67b2ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The demand of the PSA is a 20% wage increase over 18 months [[https://substack.com/redirect/0e6294af-fdea-4c9b-9c47-0e4ad9a8891f?](https://substack.com/redirect/0e6294af-fdea-4c9b-9c47-0e4ad9a8891f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0e6294af-fdea-4c9b-9c47-0e4ad9a8891f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The SA Government’s offer remains at 10% over 3 years [[https://substack.com/redirect/0e6294af-fdea-4c9b-9c47-0e4ad9a8891f?](https://substack.com/redirect/0e6294af-fdea-4c9b-9c47-0e4ad9a8891f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0e6294af-fdea-4c9b-9c47-0e4ad9a8891f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The PSA has claimed that after years of being underpaid and underestimated, “the PSA dragon has awoken” [[https://substack.com/redirect/7554db51-1663-4433-bb46-e9824d5492ad?](https://substack.com/redirect/7554db51-1663-4433-bb46-e9824d5492ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7554db51-1663-4433-bb46-e9824d5492ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

ETU QLD - Coca-cola

ETU members in the maintenance team at Coca-cola held a 24 hour stoppage [

[https://substack.com/redirect/980df062-2379-45e4-8e2c-7ed4fb8e92d1?](https://substack.com/redirect/980df062-2379-45e4-8e2c-7ed4fb8e92d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/980df062-2379-45e4-8e2c-7ed4fb8e92d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on Monday (20/10). Workers and their union have been in negotiations for a new EBA for 4 months, but negotiations have stalled. ETU organiser Scott Reichman described the stoppage as the “opening shot” in the campaign and warned that further stoppages are planned.

UWU Vic - Padre

The coffee production team at Padre, a coffee roaster and cafe in Brunswick, were on strike last Friday (17/10) [[https://substack.com/redirect/d4bf0a05-7b6a-45cd-a2c3-f17caab61ee5?](https://substack.com/redirect/d4bf0a05-7b6a-45cd-a2c3-f17caab61ee5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d4bf0a05-7b6a-45cd-a2c3-f17caab61ee5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Since the family business was bought by coffee giant Seven Miles in 2022, conditions and treatment of staff have deteriorated rapidly [[https://substack.com/redirect/541b63ec-9d28-46d4-b4cc-6ed7f7439600?](https://substack.com/redirect/541b63ec-9d28-46d4-b4cc-6ed7f7439600?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/541b63ec-9d28-46d4-b4cc-6ed7f7439600?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. After months of negotiations, Padre is refusing to budge and pay workers decent wages, in fact they have not even provided a counter offer to the log of claims. In addition to fair wages, workers are fighting for paid gender

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzZGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMmMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNOHXpkRjllwWkNJNk1UYzJOek15TlRBmkxDSnBZFpT2pFM05qRXdOemc0TWpZc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRJNU1qWXhORGd5Tm13aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDnkpV0lpT2lkajUFYTmhZbXhsZDJDWdFlXBHNjbjaAua3Z4SE90Y2RrVjBDSlZZXWRheVvdXVQKZLNh3YjVVSUTfSDR0VDFnTSIsInAiOiE3NjczMjUyNiwiYmJAJA5NTe3NiwiZi6DHj1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzNmXzMsImldhClMTc2MTA3ODgyNiwiZShwIjoymDC2NjU0ODI2LCJpc3MiOiJldWltMCIsInNjYiOiE1ImxpbnpmcmVkaXZlY3QifQ.v12wlhvH-3-- SmmgadHQwxahCxt1aY3poLkmzVFVs?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-23-april>

UWU/ETU QLD - XXXX

Members of the ETU and UWU continue their industrial action at XXXX factory in Milton. Workers went out on strike last Thursday (17/4) and yesterday (22/4). There may be more strikes this week. Workers are fighting for improved wages and conditions.

TWU QLD - Cleanaway Noosa

Workers at Cleanaway in Noosa remain in dispute. Further strike action took place last Thursday (17/4) and yesterday (22/4) [https://substack.com/redirect/89acc807-816d-49c9-8a44-f5666895f81b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. TWU members are fighting for a decent pay deal, including a 7% increase in the first year of a new EBA. Members also have significant concerns about safety. The TWU have asked Noosa city Council to intervene as they have contracted Cleanaway to manage waste services on their behalf. The council declined to get involved saying it was a matter for Cleanaway and the TWU. It is worth noting that Noosa City Council is currently in dispute with both The Services Union and the AWU [

https://substack.com/redirect/a7d3b989-be60-4928-974e-4ba60fc44802?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

Members of The Services Union took strike action for the third time [https://substack.com/redirect/d6ae55f1-0cda-4afd-aacb-b9497612f347?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] last Wednesday (16/4).

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TWU QLD - Boral

TWU members at Boral took 24 hours strike action last Thursday (17/4). This was the second strike by the tipper drivers in two weeks. Strike action by these workers threatens significant delay to critical infrastructure projects. Workers are fighting for improved pay and job security.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

In an escalation of their industrial campaign bus drivers in Newcastle will strike for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/f8e7f100-4824-4bac-92c4-4a8cfdc84f6a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]

starting at 2 am on Thursday 24th April. This follows weeks of bus drivers refusing to turn on Opal card readers. Workers are fighting for a new EBA with a decent pay increase to keep up with the cost of living as well as 72 hours notice for shift changes.

UWU - Capital Airport Group

UWU are holding a rally at Canberra Airport on 1 May to protest against worker intimidation by both the Capital Airport Group and the AFP. Apparently an UWU organiser was arrested by the AFP for attending a meeting with security workers at the airport. This follows terrible treatment of workers at the airport when the security screening contract was transferred to the “notoriously anti-worker” MSS group [https://substack.com/redirect/62a14ec2-5a2c-4466-bae2-429300f5d284?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

The transition has been far from smooth with workers having to reapply for jobs and those who were offered jobs by the new contractor all forced to undergo a six month probationary period. Details for the rally in the poster below.

CFMEU Administration

Last Monday (14/4) CFMEU Administrator Mark Irving announced via social media that he had approved a 2025-2028 Strategic Plan [https://substack.com/redirect/52566cd0-b0ad-4df7-8d6c-7c8caf027fb9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

In the update Irving states “It is essential that the union be returned to Democratic control... We need to build a democratic union – a union where members and delegates have a greater say and control over what the union does and how it does it.” [https://substack.com/redirect/394a287d-f31c-4dd9-a0b4-12b37ac7dcf6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]

I am yet to find a CFMEU member who has seen this Strategic Plan, and from the comments on Irving’s Facebook post I do not believe that any rank and file members or delegates were consulted on the plan. Democracy cannot be imposed from above. Irving should hand back the union to its members.

HACSU VIC - public sector mental health workers

HACSU’s EBA campaign continues with work bans and stoppages. The most recent stoppage was held last Wednesday (16/4) at Eastern Health.

AEU Vic - Public school teachers

The EBA for public school teachers in Victoria expires later this year, with negotiations expected to commence with the state government in the coming months. The AEU has reported that the union is “spoiling for a confrontation” and that Victorian teachers are eager to fight for improved wages and conditions [https://substack.com/redirect/2d43ebe1-1f7f-49b8-8b2d-c14f76582f55?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

Victorian public school teachers are the worst paid in the country and would require a 13 to 14% pay increase just to reach parity with NSW. Schools are also facing chronic staff shortages and teacher workloads continue to be an

enormous problem. The 2022 EBA included below inflation pay increases of approximately 2% per annum [[https://substack.com/redirect/7a3b3158-da03-484f-8274-b136967fe37f?](https://substack.com/redirect/7a3b3158-da03-484f-8274-b136967fe37f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7a3b3158-da03-484f-8274-b136967fe37f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. In the campaign for the 2022 agreement, teachers participated in work bans but did not go on strike. With new leadership at the helm of the AEU and the rank and file increasingly agitated these negotiations will be worth watching.

May Day

May Day's radical roots lie in the movement for the 8 hour day in the USA and have spread around the world as a day of both protest and celebration for workers.

There are a bunch of May Day activities happening around the country, get along to one if you can. If your union isn't doing anything to mark May Day, ask your officials/organisers why not!

Thursday 1 May

Sydney - 10:30am - Belmore Park [[https://substack.com/redirect/619a8c88-5e1c-48a2-ac3b-92b1931d1026?](https://substack.com/redirect/619a8c88-5e1c-48a2-ac3b-92b1931d1026?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/619a8c88-5e1c-48a2-ac3b-92b1931d1026?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Adelaide - 12 noon - Light Square [[https://substack.com/redirect/5a20e281-5e24-4903-86b2-](https://substack.com/redirect/5a20e281-5e24-4903-86b2-a8c836c56f22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[a8c836c56f22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5a20e281-5e24-4903-86b2-a8c836c56f22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Canberra - 12:30-1:30pm - Canberra Airport (rally as reported above)

Melbourne - 5pm - 8 Hour Memorial Wreath Laying

Melbourne - 5:30pm - State Library of Victoria [[https://substack.com/redirect/5593b058-d140-41b0-8dd9-d551fd9ded0f?](https://substack.com/redirect/5593b058-d140-41b0-8dd9-d551fd9ded0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5593b058-d140-41b0-8dd9-d551fd9ded0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Geelong - 5:30pm - Geelong Trades Hall, 127 Myers Street [[https://substack.com/redirect/f5f93ae2-](https://substack.com/redirect/f5f93ae2-16a0-4f7b-be2c-65672357c621?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[16a0-4f7b-be2c-65672357c621?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f5f93ae2-16a0-4f7b-be2c-65672357c621?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Saturday 3 May

Bundaberg - 10:00 am - Bundaberg Bowls Club [[https://substack.com/redirect/40ab713f-c46d-40c0-a2d5-](https://substack.com/redirect/40ab713f-c46d-40c0-a2d5-dc7fd32d623e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[dc7fd32d623e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/40ab713f-c46d-40c0-a2d5-dc7fd32d623e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Ipswich - 12:30 pm - Timothy Moloney Park, Ellenborough Street, Woodend [[https://substack.com/redirect/c5c664f4-ea81-45a4-8303-b6833de411b8?](https://substack.com/redirect/c5c664f4-ea81-45a4-8303-b6833de411b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c5c664f4-ea81-45a4-8303-b6833de411b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Toowoomba - 10:30 am - Annand Street Carpark [[https://substack.com/redirect/2c044507-a65c-4634-a9da-](https://substack.com/redirect/2c044507-a65c-4634-a9da-7e0b6f232df8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[7e0b6f232df8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2c044507-a65c-4634-a9da-7e0b6f232df8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Weipa - 7 am - across from Woolworths and Weipa Hospital [[https://substack.com/redirect/3c2a7a1c-](https://substack.com/redirect/3c2a7a1c-e9a4-415a-a7b4-76f45cbd5615?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[e9a4-415a-a7b4-76f45cbd5615?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3c2a7a1c-e9a4-415a-a7b4-76f45cbd5615?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Sunday 4 May

Gold Coast - 9 am - North end of Kurrawa Park, Old Burleigh Road, Broadbeach [[https://substack.com/redirect/be401b9a-910c-4993-b3ce-b1e75c809e15?](https://substack.com/redirect/be401b9a-910c-4993-b3ce-b1e75c809e15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/be401b9a-910c-4993-b3ce-b1e75c809e15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Rockhampton - 9 am - Woods Park, Mile St, Berserker [[https://substack.com/redirect/bd994819-1405-](https://substack.com/redirect/bd994819-1405-4b58-b551-6746870aa99a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[4b58-b551-6746870aa99a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/bd994819-1405-4b58-b551-6746870aa99a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Sunshine Coast - 10 am - Caloundra Sharks Football Club, 1 Gregory Street, Golden Beach [[https://substack.com/redirect/6f9d14ea-840a-42cf-a040-f9be1e775368?](https://substack.com/redirect/6f9d14ea-840a-42cf-a040-f9be1e775368?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6f9d14ea-840a-42cf-a040-f9be1e775368?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]

Melbourne - 11am - Victoria Trades Hall, Lygon St Carlton

Fairfield - 11 am - Salvador Allende Monument, Honour Avenue, Fairfield Park (Australia-Chile Solidarity Committee)

Perth - 12 noon - Esplanade Park, Fremantle [[https://substack.com/redirect/ee302541-9633-4b82-805b-](https://substack.com/redirect/ee302541-9633-4b82-805b-843c42307483?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[843c42307483?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ee302541-9633-4b82-805b-843c42307483?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Karratha- 5pm - Karratha Rec Club [[https://substack.com/redirect/b93cd57e-00b0-4180-83bd-](https://substack.com/redirect/b93cd57e-00b0-4180-83bd-df84f42c6bea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[df84f42c6bea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b93cd57e-00b0-4180-83bd-df84f42c6bea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Monday 5 May

Cairns - 9 am - Figtree Park, 34-38 Esplanade [[https://substack.com/redirect/e5236c90-80a6-40dc-](https://substack.com/redirect/e5236c90-80a6-40dc-a601-e1e227fceacc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[a601-e1e227fceacc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e5236c90-80a6-40dc-a601-e1e227fceacc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Alice Springs - 9 am - Carpark across from the Old Memorial Club [[https://substack.com/redirect/703f464d-4f7e-4cbb-8d03-1549131a6c9d?](https://substack.com/redirect/703f464d-4f7e-4cbb-8d03-1549131a6c9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/703f464d-4f7e-4cbb-8d03-1549131a6c9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Mackay - 9 am - Corner River and Gregory Streets [[https://substack.com/redirect/6b8cf40d-d917-4c82-](https://substack.com/redirect/6b8cf40d-d917-4c82-bfff-e65700a6ad59?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[bfff-e65700a6ad59?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6b8cf40d-d917-4c82-bfff-e65700a6ad59?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Townsville - 9 am - strand Park, The Strand [[https://substack.com/redirect/2b25f457-f392-4db2-8d9d-](https://substack.com/redirect/2b25f457-f392-4db2-8d9d-31da59e21ee3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[31da59e21ee3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2b25f457-f392-4db2-8d9d-31da59e21ee3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Gladstone - 9:30 am - Gladstone Council Carpark, 58 Central Lane [[https://substack.com/redirect/4b98c0a4-12a2-410a-889c-541a3355cc0f?](https://substack.com/redirect/4b98c0a4-12a2-410a-889c-541a3355cc0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4b98c0a4-12a2-410a-889c-541a3355cc0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Brisbane Labour Day March - 10 am corner of Turbot and Wharf Street Spring Hill [[https://substack.com/redirect/7ead62fb-7294-4cdb-a81b-48dcaee48081?](https://substack.com/redirect/7ead62fb-7294-4cdb-a81b-48dcaee48081?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7ead62fb-7294-4cdb-a81b-48dcaee48081?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7ead62fb-7294-4cdb-a81b-48dcaee48081?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]
Darwin - 10 am - 38 Woods Street [

a191ec697386?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]

That's all I've got this week. It has been a bit of a struggle to get the report out this week as I am having some health issues. In order to carve out some time to rest and look after myself I am going to take two weeks off. That means the next report will be on 14 May. In the interim you can find me on Instagram [[https://substack.com/redirect/4baedd30-bdfa-48e5-8876-d0521992ac47?](https://substack.com/redirect/4baedd30-bdfa-48e5-8876-d0521992ac47?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM], Twitter [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e8f2caf2-fa0a-4af2-baaf-bcd41e853202?](https://substack.com/redirect/e8f2caf2-fa0a-4af2-baaf-bcd41e853202?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM], BlueSky [

[https://substack.com/redirect/5447c8c4-4626-4418-bd55-833fbab2b50e?](https://substack.com/redirect/5447c8c4-4626-4418-bd55-833fbab2b50e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] and Substack [

<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen>].

In solidarity, Sarah

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View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-23-july>

QTU - Public school teachers

Teachers rallied in Rockhampton last Wednesday (16/7) warning the Crisafulli government “that they’re more than up for a fight.” [https://substack.com/redirect/ee9a26c5-2e4a-4587-895c-db8a24748071?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] The QTU has rejected the government’s second pay offer of 8% over 3 years. As it stands, Queensland’s teachers are the third-lowest paid in the country. Teachers are currently voting on whether to take protected industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/636b835d-765f-4356-b121-b183478bd3ef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with the ballot closing on Monday (28/7). Teachers are fighting for better pay, safer schools, and action on workload and the teacher shortage.

ETU QLD - T K Elevators

ETU members at T K Elevators commenced industrial action on Thursday (17/7). Workers rallied outside the Brisbane Convention and Exhibition Centre [https://substack.com/redirect/f132eb6d-c9ed-4edb-bc82-f0a0eabeb5a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] where they maintain the lifts and escalators. Workers are fighting for industry standard wages and conditions, and to protect their superannuation.

AMWU NSW - NH Foods

Maintenance workers at Wingham Beef Exports struck for 24 hours last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/a9352047-0f29-44da-80f7-d883120e6b79?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (16/7). Workers have been in negotiations with NH Foods for 8 months to try and get a fair deal. Workers are currently paid below industry standards [https://substack.com/redirect/c1bab685-0544-4dcb-95ce-018a5c946271?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at \$28-33 per hour, while other maintenance workers in the area earn \$35-50 per hour. Workers need a decent wage increase to keep up with the cost of living. The AMWU has said that there will be more stoppages if no deal is reached.

ASU NSW - Towong Shire Council

Council workers at Towong Shire Council commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/8d24f810-aada-4973-a783-64a705071c1d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Thursday (17/7). Workers will be participating in a range of work bans including bans on attending staff, team or departmental meetings; responding to non-urgent requests from Councillors; using private phones for work; writing reports or statistical reporting as well as putting campaign messages on vehicles and wearing campaign material. Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal. The ASU has identified a number of issues [https://substack.com/redirect/4a2d1050-e0b0-4b3f-a663-7901801daa1e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with the current pay offer from the Council including the bundling of allowances into the base rate and the Council refusing to apply for government funding to increase Early Childhood Educators wages through the Worker Retention Program.

ETU QLD - Getinge

Thanks to the comrades at Hardhat [https://substack.com/redirect/b3161114-1173-4d5c-8ced-b78f53189eda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for sending through this update. The electricians who perform maintenance work for Getinge have been on strike for over 5 weeks. Getinge’s only offer has been a 3% wage increase, but workers are already at least 10% behind their Victorian counterparts. Workers are also not being paid the correct site allowance, and Getinge is also refusing to pay a “sewer allowance” despite regular exposure to live sewage. ETU members have been holding pickets at major hospitals as they are Getinge’s major customers. There has been strong support from hospital maintenance workers to their ETU comrades on strike. The workers are committed to winning this dispute and getting a fair deal. For more updates on this dispute and other Queensland union news - make sure you are subscribed to [https://substack.com/redirect/b3161114-1173-4d5c-8ced-b78f53189eda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] Hardhat [https://substack.com/redirect/b3161114-1173-4d5c-8ced-b78f53189eda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]!

AMWU Vic - KONE

Workers at KONE Elevators commenced industrial action last Thursday (17/7) with the implementation of an overtime ban. Workers also took a half day stoppage on Friday (18/7).

VAHPA - I-MED

VAHPA members at I-MED sites in the North West region stopped work for 24 hours on Monday (21/7). This is the latest in a string of rolling stoppages that started in May. Workers are fighting for a decent pay increase and the industry standard 5 weeks of annual leave. Despite projecting a \$230 million profit and seeking to be purchased for \$3 billion, I-MED is claiming workers’ claims are “unsustainable”. It is understood there will be more stoppages at I-MED in the coming weeks.

UWU SA - Public sector healthcare workers

According to social media posts, UWU members are ramping up their industrial action in public hospitals in SA. Workers across the state have been participating in industrial action and work bans since February. I don't have any further information about what this escalation looks like, but I would love to hear from any UWU members involved! Workers are fighting for fair pay, safe staffing and secure jobs.

HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

HACSU state secretary Paul Healey reported that 82% of HACSU members have voted in favour of continuing industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/1b8dfd06-efdd-4d71-be80-226883e72202?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] rather than accepting a new deal from the state government. HACSU noted that the second offer "comes nowhere close to our pay claims for allied health workers [https://substack.com/redirect/92e48559-bc14-4323-9cf9-0895b2e2b7b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" and accuses the government of driving a wedge between different workers, warning "A bad deal for one workforce, is a bad deal for every workforce." The state government and Victorian Hospitals Industrial Association (VHIA) have now applied to the FWC under s240 of the Fair Work Act for the Commission to manage the dispute as they claim it can't be resolved. HACSU contends it can be resolved - with a fair deal for mental health workers.

VAHPA

An article in Workplace Express [https://substack.com/redirect/45a5687e-88fe-47e1-9256-0c14abd3bf93?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last week reported that a VAHPA industrial officer had initiated FWC proceedings against VAHPA branch secretary Craig McGregor. The industrial officer also accused the union of unlawful adverse action due to "unreasonable work demands" when she took annual leave. Yesterday, Workplace Express reported [https://substack.com/redirect/362c0ff4-5e90-4026-a4b3-933030bf77b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that the industrial officer had

"discontinued her case...and resigned from her position." McGregor has "strongly denied" the allegations against him. Rank and file newsletter VAHPA Pulse posted on instagram the question: "Does this finally explain why VAHPA has been AWOL? [https://substack.com/redirect/308b8791-19bc-4112-ba05-97580e22be97?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]". Could internal issues at VAHPA be the reason behind a lack of responsiveness to member phone calls and emails; delays and confusion in the lead up to bargaining and a "revolving door of union staff"? As of late yesterday, VAHPA members had not received any communications from their union about the allegations, their secretary briefly stepping aside, or Executive Officer Andrew Hewat briefly being "Acting Secretary".

PSA SA

"PSA Change" has been successful in its election campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/4776621e-bcfb-4da7-b538-f25eab5d074d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Charlotte Watson and Celia Brougham comfortably won Branch Secretary and Assistant Secretary and 12 of 19 Branch Council positions were won by PSA Change candidates. Are the winds of change specific to the public service? To 2025? Or is this a shift in the movement? I'd love to hear from other groups of workers who are thinking about or planning on contesting a union election- send me a message if that's you!

That's all I've got this week! I feel like I must have missed some stuff this week as it is a pretty short report. Please feel free to get in touch if you can fill the gaps. Also, a very quick plug for the comrades at APHEDA: this Friday night (25/7) there is a fundraiser gig [

https://substack.com/redirect/7bcc4b48-52b1-4fb2-b284-2c36b77903e9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] hosted by MUA and CFMEU WA Youth

at the Fremantle Buffalo Club.

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

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View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-23-september>

ASU Vic - Hume City Council

The mayor of Hume City Council, Carly Moore, put out a statement [https://substack.com/redirect/331eda04-4d35-430b-9f7b-ce89a88ee7f9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on Thursday calling on the ASU to end industrial action and “focus on reaching an agreement through the bargaining process”. Moore also said that Hume was negotiating in good faith and “and demonstrated its commitment to employees by providing a 2.5% pay increase in November 2025”. What Moore’s statement did not mention, but the ASU shared on their social media accounts, is that Moore herself received a 10.6% payrise last year [https://substack.com/redirect/292a38d8-555b-48ae-bac7-644a4406202f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. She’s no Mamdani [https://substack.com/redirect/2c97efff-7f2e-4a82-963d-0bc54fc0e441?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]!

ANMF/HACSU Tasmania - Public sector nurses

HACSU member nurses in Tasmania’s public sector commenced industrial action on Monday (21/9). HACSU had set a deadline of 14 September for the government to present an offer for nurses to consider, but an offer is yet to be tabled. HACSU’s bargaining team have participated in 50 hours of negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/576137d1-d4d4-46f4-afd9-08ba2975df5b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] thus far. Industrial action has kicked off with a round of workplace bans. HACSU members will be wearing campaign materials at work; placing campaign materials on patient care boards; speaking to the media and the general public about the campaign; working to rule by taking all breaks on time; not participating in audit-related activities; not attending non-patient related meetings and not filing RFAs or taking late files to admissions. Meanwhile, ANMF members at the Royal Hobart Hospital endorsed industrial action at a mass meeting yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/5d5abbfd-59b1-40bc-8476-f28939b5e266?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (22/9), with further mass meetings of ANMF members to take place in the north and north-west later this week. Public sector nurses are fighting for a fair deal with decent wages and conditions and safer staffing levels.

TWU - Qantas

Negotiations between the TWU and Qantas in the FWC on Friday (18/9) did not progress significantly, so industrial action is set to commence at the airline this week. TWU members employed at one Qantas subsidiary, Qantas Ground Services, are expected to strike for 24 hours tomorrow (24/9) [https://substack.com/redirect/3907c612-2f28-4862-9501-b34b4152db5e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] while TWU members at another Qantas subsidiary Australia air Express are expected to strike today (23/9) [https://substack.com/redirect/51d89b31-b188-4f32-abf1-015df493d799?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The TWU has been in negotiations with Qantas for 11 months [https://substack.com/redirect/06438d3e-2417-463e-ad75-f249d71d0c81?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] seeking decent pay and conditions for workers. Workers also have concerns about safety [https://substack.com/redirect/544a9b86-b25b-4c14-a107-10df3dca0d08?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]; the splintering of workers into multiple subsidiaries [https://substack.com/redirect/0e120956-9293-45c6-8adc-6f045c230f06?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and outsourcing of permanent jobs. The TWU did post a video late yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/31499517-1651-4bb4-8979-8a662a339354?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] saying Qantas was trying some legal manoeuvres to stop industrial action, so this is a bit of a fluid situation - stay tuned.

CPSU/ETU/MEAA - Arts Centre Melbourne

Union members at Arts Centre Melbourne held a second 24-hour strike on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/1cc090d5-8923-4e1d-bbe1-9c7a1b67100d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (18/9). The first 24 hour strike on 11 September resulted in two shows being cancelled, and one being postponed. It was anticipated that Friday’s strike would disrupt programming and venue operations. Workers are fighting for a decent wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/61baf422-a24e-4b60-816d-4b46dd7399a9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to keep up with the cost of living, while Arts Centre Melbourne management is refusing anything more than the 3% that is referenced in the state government’s wages policy. It is worth noting that other state government employees - perhaps most notably nurses and teachers - fought for and won wage increases well above the wages policy. Unions have warned that further industrial action will occur if negotiations stall and a fair agreement is not reached [https://substack.com/redirect/7e4eb6ef-bbdb-4ace-b9a6-e48f0a7383bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and that this could include disruption to the opening of the Ian Potter State Theatre in October.

AMWU/AWU/ETU - BHP

As I reported last week [https://substack.com/redirect/b7052f63-771e-4db8-be3a-9045c83de80c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the unions in dispute with BHP at Port Hedland are applying to the FWC for an intractable bargaining declaration. On Thursday (17/9), the unions all posted identical statements [https://substack.com/redirect/4464c97c-391a-40fb-bbee-33f92ea554ca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on social media. The statement notes that workers rejected a proposal from BHP that would leave half the workforce worse off, and that unions want to resolve inequality in conditions by lifting everyone to the same standards. It goes on to say that negotiations have reached an impasse, and there is no reasonable chance that an agreement will be reached without the intervention of the FWC, and that's why they are applying for an intractable bargaining declaration.

MUA Vic - Quantem

On 15/9, MUA members at Quantem unanimously voted to lift work bans and return to work [https://substack.com/redirect/eddb87a9-d4ae-43fb-8847-c5fe39d02814?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], having been stood down for 13 days without pay. The workers have decided to try and negotiate a satisfactory outcome with Quantem. However, organiser Shane Reside warned that if a decent deal isn't made in the next couple of weeks, industrial action will recommence and escalate. The MUA commenced industrial action earlier in the month, and while the action was ongoing not a single ship has been able to load or unload any product out of the Quantem terminal - despite scabs being brought in from interstate and overseas. Hopefully that will serve as a warning to the bosses as they return to the negotiating table.

ANMF WA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Nurses and midwives in WA are furious that the Cook government has delayed the next major stage of the rollout of nurse/patient ratios in WA. The next stage in the rollout was due to happen this month [https://substack.com/redirect/90e60159-f196-4875-b875-3264e8e69ad5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and was meant to extend ratios to remaining metropolitan emergency departments and many specialist wards. No revised timeline has been provided. ANMF WA Secretary Romina Raschilla said "Our nurses and midwives are really quite angry, and they are calling for industrial action. They want to strike." [https://substack.com/redirect/c867eeb7-5c99-4782-8eb0-d2db1cbce747?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] WA's public sector nurses and midwives last went on strike in 2022 [https://substack.com/redirect/e4d764a3-b323-4646-b381-41508b1d693c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in their EBA campaign that included a demand for ratios.

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

After rejecting the territory government's latest offer, public school teachers in the ACT have called another stoppage. Teachers will stop work from 8:30am - 10:30am tomorrow morning [https://substack.com/redirect/ac0aad79-c778-44a3-87b6-04e8247071a9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (24/9). In response to the stoppage ACT Education Directorate has announced all public schools, preschools and specialist schools will close from 8:30 - 10:30am [https://substack.com/redirect/b10c25d9-0aef-46d2-aed1-7588b93441bd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with the school day starting from 10:30am. In addition to their demands around pay, the AEU is also putting a spotlight on resourcing and workload issues in schools [https://substack.com/redirect/0e62a4c6-3057-4f26-9d61-747731a9855a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] where a shortage of teachers is causing schools to regularly split and collapse classes.

In short

ASU - Jetstar

On Friday (18/9) ASU members at Jetstar escalated their industrial action. Workers commenced a ban on following the uniform policy on shoes. Workers will now be wearing sneakers and other comfy shoes at work, as well as campaign badges/stickers. Today (23/9), Jetstar workers will not process fees for overweight baggage, seat changes or late fees [https://substack.com/redirect/fc1ebd23-367e-4fb3-b4ca-66d3e7dbaf3d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU NSW - Certis

Certis Security workers at Sydney Airport will commence industrial action tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/955c87c4-4837-40b7-9da4-6cd27ac15a73?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (24/9) and TWU members employed as Work Safety Officers will strike from 10pm on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/29ec16e6-1c56-4f08-ad19-806ed78c6a08?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (28/9) through to 1am (29/9). Workers are fighting for stronger protections [https://substack.com/redirect/0c4e5dc8-ba22-4519-9326-9e9d97b7f4a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], improved conditions and pathways to full-time employment.

VAHPA - Public sector allied health

For Week 3 of the "Four Weeks To Fix It Campaign", VAHPA members will be participating in rolling

lunchtime rallies [https://substack.com/redirect/18d65a28-e124-48d9-a201-da1a0e173fb4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Rallies kicked off on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/18d65a28-e124-48d9-a201-da1a0e173fb4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (21/9) at the Royal Women's Hospital; and Tuesday (22/9) at Northern Health and Monash Health. Today (23/9) rallies will take place at the Alfred; Western Health; Austin Health and Bendigo Health. Tomorrow, workers will rally at Grampians Health.

NTEU NSW - University of Sydney

NTEU members at the University of Sydney will meet tomorrow and vote on taking further stop work action on 13 October [https://substack.com/redirect/0b388644-1120-4edf-9027-bf3ee1abb482?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Delegates will also share an update on bargaining.

PABO Watch

Professionals Australia - Sydney Water

Professionals Australia members at Sydney Water have endorsed a protected action ballot. 95% of those who participated voted yes [https://substack.com/redirect/1f6bd749-583f-47b6-8a07-fdea00d37b96?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. 87% of eligible members participated in the ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/8d28d9d3-9965-47e0-8feb-da56822bb9fb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers at Sydney Water are fighting for decent wage increases and fair working hours.

Professionals Australia - AEMO

Professionals Australia members at AEMO have voted in favour of taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/3a73983b-b57a-488f-b389-347b97f83843?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. AEMO has put a subpar offer to workers for a third time, with 68% voting it down. Professionals Australia members are set to commence industrial action next week [https://substack.com/redirect/322fcd9b-09c1-462a-b766-ef57ac97b05b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Wins/resolutions

MUA NSW - Certis

MUA gatehouse workers employed by Certis at DP World Port Botany have endorsed a new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/aed95592-d62e-4f95-96b3-4f33111d3670?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The agreement includes a 10% wage increase on commencement, backdated to July, along with other improvements. Workers have been fighting for a fair deal for 6 months and participated in industrial action including two stoppages that effectively shut down the terminal.

AEU Vic - Public school teachers

The whole workforce ballot for the new agreement for public school teachers in Victoria has concluded with 93.1% of those who participated endorsing the deal [https://substack.com/redirect/0789be7a-b909-499b-a236-0f80f8e9c4bd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. 79% of AEU members [https://substack.com/redirect/a91c8464-7862-48fb-8970-8203bade1f16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] had previously endorsed the agreement.

AMWU/ETU/Professionals Australia/RTBU/The Services Union - Queensland Rail

Unions and Queensland Rail have reached in-principle agreements for all 6 agreements [https://substack.com/redirect/76634a70-6f60-44e7-b8db-fb2a0a60b0dc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as well as a new standalone agreement with the ETU. This follows months of negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/eac165a8-23f7-46b8-9fb3-48d1bc1536ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and industrial action taking place since April. The agreements include a guaranteed 8.5% wage increase over 3 years [https://substack.com/redirect/e7352378-ca9a-4d16-ba9b-62aba06a67f7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], with "potential further uplift" in the second and third years depending on inflation. The agreements also include a "Strategic Delivery Allowance"; an increase in shift allowances when working unsociable hours for the Network and Rollingstock agreements; an increase in the overtime rate from the first hour for the Electrical agreement and job and rail-specific fortnightly payments and allowances for the Network, Rollingstock and Electrical Agreements. With industrial action finished, Queensland Rail has said the network should return to full service by the end of November [https://substack.com/redirect/deb5e744-f5f1-4bf5-a09f-a0b6cb7750fb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. That is quite a maintenance backlog! Queensland's trains have been operating on a Saturday timetable since May [https://substack.com/redirect/eac165a8-23f7-46b8-9fb3-48d1bc1536ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers now have to vote on the agreements, with FWC Deputy President Lake encouraging Queensland Rail to put them to a vote as quickly as possible.

That's all I've got this week. One little extra to share this week is something I saw via the Australian Communist History [https://substack.com/redirect/b2ef14fd-a59f-406e-95eb-9c3f9f0bd688?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

Unsubscribe

[illegible]

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-24-june>

ASU Victoria - Metropolitan Melbourne council workers

Last Wednesday (17/6) ASU members from 8 metropolitan Melbourne councils went on strike for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/e43d25e6-bf6e-437c-9221-7f644d1f7723?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This is the second 24 hours strike by council workers in pursuit of a multi-employer agreement. Workers have been in negotiations for 6 months [https://substack.com/redirect/44945c16-0bca-40c8-8865-d744a87cc89f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but are yet to receive an offer. The ASU is demanding a 10% wage increase in the first year [https://substack.com/redirect/f272afab-d1c4-41f6-a666-dfc3fadeaca9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of the agreement, and 4% annual increases after that. Workers and their supporters rallied at Trades Hall before marching to Parliament House. The action disrupted council services across the city including closing libraries and leaving bins uncollected. The ASU revealed this week that they have launched Federal Court action against Hume City Council [https://substack.com/redirect/2f607e81-e238-4671-8b0c-fa7efc727b3c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] who docked the pay of workers, despite the partial work bans for which they were docking pay having been withdrawn. Union members have subsequently voted to reinstate partial work bans.

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

On Friday (19/06) Victorian AEU members rejected an offer recommended by their union. The AEU Vic Branch reached an in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/4a747221-1c27-4c6f-8c21-f1207d4d998b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with the Victorian government earlier in May [https://substack.com/redirect/d2104516-5aa1-4d5c-8464-52283eb5d567?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. On Friday the union admitted [https://substack.com/redirect/b9ce91dd-a423-4f08-8799-fc425fc60bc7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that 57.7% of members had voted against the proposed agreement in the union's internal ratification process. The AEU Joint Primary and Secondary Council met the same day to consider the outcome. Council rejected motions moved by Fight the Crisis [https://substack.com/redirect/91362823-6830-4c71-9792-f05dc795e03a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] delegates to recommence industrial action and instead voted to survey members. Fight the Crisis have called on AEU sub-branches [https://substack.com/redirect/4e745696-caf3-4f3a-af7f-8cafaa6b2a92?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to endorse their call for a strike on 4 August. Socialists in Schools [https://substack.com/redirect/6e171a45-ceab-432c-9155-22d9d4a45ea0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] are promoting a Term 3 strike pledge (with no specific call for a date), and Class Struggle [https://substack.com/redirect/4276c851-646d-4c33-a9ef-96256307f296?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] has proposed a buck each way, encouraging participation in the survey as well as sub-branch meetings to discuss and endorse further strike action. AEU Vic Branch President Justin Mullaly has now moved to get out ahead of the strike push. In a video on Tuesday [https://substack.com/redirect/0957d637-ac64-4a2f-8df8-ed712502c75b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (23/4), Mullaly stated "we need to move swiftly towards industrial action", panned calls for a strike in August as "too late" and defended the survey as necessary "for members to have their say". The AEU Joint Primary and Secondary Council meets again on 17 July.

AWU/The Services Union QLD - Western Downs Council

On Thursday (18/6) union members at the Western Downs Council walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/27fd73fd-de7c-41b7-863f-efb095356fc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and rallied at Dalby. And once again, workers were locked out by management [https://substack.com/redirect/462934fe-91a8-406d-8108-2062f2241c5c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers last struck in May, and were locked out in response [https://substack.com/redirect/1b3b30d5-33e8-4303-835c-85e7802a4a91?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Western Downs Council have also threatened locking out workers for participating in extremely low level bans [https://substack.com/redirect/a75bb042-e22a-4042-a49d-2f3d3efd56cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] such as working to rule or wearing campaign badges, t-shirts or fancy dress. Despite multiple hearings in the QIRC, the bosses continue to stall on finding a resolution to the dispute. Workers are fighting for a decent pay increase to keep up with the cost of living. A conciliation meeting [https://substack.com/redirect/d8730254-c9fe-4bdd-b392-f8b5647ca614?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is scheduled to take place in the QIRC on 6 July.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer Northern Beaches

RTBU members driving buses in the Northern Beaches area of Sydney will turn off the Opal card readers

for 2 weeks [https://substack.com/redirect/6f6be7d9-2047-431a-9003-f18271f3c6da?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The action started last Thursday (18/6) and will continue until 2 July and represents an escalation in industrial action against Keolis Downer. Negotiations have been underway for several months, but Keolis Downer refuse to budge on several items related to pay, condition and retention of drivers. The next bargaining meeting is scheduled for 26 June.

HSU ACT - Canberra Hospital

Last week, HSU members at the Canberra Hospital who work in medical imaging, sonography, and pathology participated in industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/a336171a-9621-4de3-ab7e-848de48c1ab5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The HSU has been in negotiations for fair wages and conditions for 6 months [https://substack.com/redirect/7036a013-2b15-494f-ad2c-07f65c7577f9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], but have not received anything meaningful from the Territory Government. On 17 June HSU members wore campaign t-shirts and implemented bans on answering telephone calls; responding to voicemail messages and responding to electronic messages. Other administrative bans took place on 18 June, before the week of action [https://substack.com/redirect/bbc6cda4-3b98-4bbf-8703-0c9a6b831945?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] culminated in a 1-hour stoppage on 19 June.

In short

AMWU Victoria - UGL

AMWU members at the Viva Refinery in Geelong have stopped work for a second time [https://substack.com/redirect/e0aefea9-4fd2-4dfa-830a-8191f75a3313?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The strike on Monday (22/6) follows previous industrial action on 12 June. UGL is trying to strip conditions including redundancy and income protection & force workers back onto the award.

MEU NSW - Peabody

Last Wednesday (17/6), workers at the Wambo Washery were locked out by Peabody [https://substack.com/redirect/a23de8b3-c863-4a01-8a23-c8bc1c2bc1d3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The lockout will last for 2 weeks (at least). The lockout is in response to industrial action which has been undertaken by MEU members at the washery since May. Peabody have offered a measly annual wage increase of 2.5% as well as unfair changes to bonus arrangements [https://substack.com/redirect/493bf53e-de22-48bc-9e91-96301671628a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a better deal.

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses & midwives

On Thursday (18/6) ANMF members at the Flinders Medical Centre participated in the second 24 hour strike [https://substack.com/redirect/4de2f37b-4265-4eaf-b9a3-1bb49b078986?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] by ANMF members since the resumption of industrial action. If a decent offer is not forthcoming, the next strike will take place at the Royal Adelaide Hospital in early July [https://substack.com/redirect/832f0430-c8c7-4368-ae38-011b15315d04?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

Offshore Alliance - DOF

Offshore Alliance members working with Remotely Operated Vehicles (ROV) at DOF commenced rolling 1-hour stoppages on 14 June [https://substack.com/redirect/0ceb9e05-e3d2-4523-9411-2d1822804cec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. According to the Offshore Alliance, DOF workers have been stuck on a shitty agreement since 2016 which was negotiated during a downturn in the industry. When work and profits came back, wages didn't. The Offshore Alliance has also warned that DOF is attempting to hire scabs.

AMWU QLD - RACQ

Patrol Officers at RACQ held another stoppage yesterday (23/6). Workers are fighting for a fair deal and want the bosses to come back to the negotiating table.

UWU - Secure Journeys

I haven't heard anything this week, but industrial action at immigration detention centres around the country was continuing late last week [https://substack.com/redirect/47c19ffc-3751-46de-90b3-f862628c459b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. UWU members employed by "Secure Journeys" continue their campaign for decent wages, improvements to safety and to have unsafe rostering addressed.

ASU/AWU/CPSU Victoria - Parks Victoria

The dispute at Parks Victoria continues with CPSU members set to walk off the job and rally outside Parks Victoria's Board meeting today [https://substack.com/redirect/7620166e-caea-481b-bd95-7acd57267f7d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (24/6). Work bans also remain in place.

PABO Watch

MEU NSW - Glencore

MEU members at three Glencore mines have voted in favour of industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/82ce78dc-552d-4434-9881-270138015145?](https://substack.com/redirect/82ce78dc-552d-4434-9881-270138015145?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/82ce78dc-552d-4434-9881-270138015145?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]. Wambo - 95% yes; Mangoola - 97% yes and Ravensworth - 95% yes. Workers are ready to fight back against Glencore's proposed tiered pay structures - referred to as Glencore's Shifty Cuts [https://substack.com/redirect/1b67ebd3-3263-472d-bea3-b5cc02488d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (say that fast!).

AMWU/ETU/WMWA - BHP

Last week, the Western Mine Workers Association applied for a protected action ballot [[https://substack.com/redirect/1844341e-847f-41d4-8239-0c620872cbfc?](https://substack.com/redirect/1844341e-847f-41d4-8239-0c620872cbfc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1844341e-847f-41d4-8239-0c620872cbfc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] for members at BHP's Port Hedland operations. The WMWA is an alliance between the AWU and the MEU. This follows successful ballots of AMWU and ETU members at the port. Secretaries of the AMWU, ETU and AWU met on Friday [[https://substack.com/redirect/2330fa01-2023-4737-80a2-27712c3af1b8?](https://substack.com/redirect/2330fa01-2023-4737-80a2-27712c3af1b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2330fa01-2023-4737-80a2-27712c3af1b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] (19/6) to "set up a plan to maximise the ability to lever the company." It seems that BHP may have listened to the union's urging to "meaningfully negotiate", as a draft enterprise agreement was put forward [[https://substack.com/redirect/c15d03be-c921-436d-b0dd-640dc7749589?](https://substack.com/redirect/c15d03be-c921-436d-b0dd-640dc7749589?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c15d03be-c921-436d-b0dd-640dc7749589?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] by BHP yesterday (23/6). A bargaining meeting is scheduled for 7 July, and it is not anticipated that strike action will kick off before then.

Wins/resolutions

ETU NSW - Sydney Construction multi-employer agreement

ETU members at 12 construction companies in Sydney have won a 5.25% pay increase [[https://substack.com/redirect/3d208071-ac2b-46de-992a-a3397d505522?](https://substack.com/redirect/3d208071-ac2b-46de-992a-a3397d505522?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3d208071-ac2b-46de-992a-a3397d505522?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] for the first year of their new agreement. While negotiations for the rest of the agreement continue, workers will benefit from this pay increase in their next pay packet, and with backpay to 1 May.

AWU/ETU/MUA - Inpex

An in-principle agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/0905b31a-c486-425f-b8ab-d5124fd26013?](https://substack.com/redirect/0905b31a-c486-425f-b8ab-d5124fd26013?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0905b31a-c486-425f-b8ab-d5124fd26013?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] between unions and Inpex was reached last week (17/6) ending industrial action at the Ichthys gas facilities. Media reports say the agreement includes [[https://substack.com/redirect/d3dfce63-b1a3-46fc-917b-3f24a2cc2ed1?](https://substack.com/redirect/d3dfce63-b1a3-46fc-917b-3f24a2cc2ed1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d3dfce63-b1a3-46fc-917b-3f24a2cc2ed1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] annual wage increases of 3.75%, improved job security and career progression systems. Offshore Alliance said more specific details about the agreement would be shared after the formal ballot of workers, but did allege the strike action at Ichthys cost Inpex \$200 million in lost production [[https://substack.com/redirect/58104e11-dde4-4667-b148-35c531380bab?](https://substack.com/redirect/58104e11-dde4-4667-b148-35c531380bab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/58104e11-dde4-4667-b148-35c531380bab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)].

CFMEU SA - Fleurieu Cranes

On Thursday (18/6), the CFMEU shared on social media that members at Fleurieu Cranes had voted up a new EBA [[https://substack.com/redirect/aa249177-7364-43f4-aa40-d1fbf8797680?](https://substack.com/redirect/aa249177-7364-43f4-aa40-d1fbf8797680?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/aa249177-7364-43f4-aa40-d1fbf8797680?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]. In March, I reported [[https://substack.com/redirect/003fd714-5b70-4729-9dc6-0593ed23b6ca?](https://substack.com/redirect/003fd714-5b70-4729-9dc6-0593ed23b6ca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/003fd714-5b70-4729-9dc6-0593ed23b6ca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)] that protected action ballots were being voted on at both Fleurieu Cranes and Crane services - two of the biggest crane companies in South Australia. I am unsure if industrial action ever commenced, or if the threat was enough to get the bosses to the negotiating table. The union has shared this news as "a huge win".

UWU - Early Childhood Educators

UWU members in early childhood education will no longer walk off the job in July as the Federal Government has agreed to fund a 15% pay increase [https://substack.com/redirect/82b73d7d-d33f-436e-8826-03750bb21758?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] for another 18 months. The workers were facing a funding cliff, and pay cut, in November. This additional government funding will fill the gap in wages for early childhood educators until the gender undervaluation wage increases come into effect in 2029.

AWU Vic - Forest firefighters

After 18 months of protected industrial action, AWU forest firefighters have been successful in their campaign for a new agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/37d3e4e2-3fc9-4699-8ee9-cec82360ed21?](https://substack.com/redirect/37d3e4e2-3fc9-4699-8ee9-cec82360ed21?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/37d3e4e2-3fc9-4699-8ee9-cec82360ed21?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]. No details on what's in the agreement as yet, but one fact worth reflecting on - over the course of the campaign, membership grew from 300 members to 1000 members. A massive achievement in itself!

ETU NSW - Stowe

After two weeks of industrial action, ETU members at Stowe have voted up an in-principle agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/79e048cc-f539-49bc-94c4-a36e85dc51c5?](https://substack.com/redirect/79e048cc-f539-49bc-94c4-a36e85dc51c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/79e048cc-f539-49bc-94c4-a36e85dc51c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM)]. The agreement includes wage increases of 23.25% over 4 years (6%/6%/6%/5.25%); 5 weeks annual leave; improved parental leave;

improvements to allowances and May Day guaranteed as a paid day off.
That's all I've got this week. Any other unions including a May Day clause in any of their agreements? Always keen to hear about fun EBA clauses!
In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

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On Wed, 24 Sept 2025, 05:48 Disputes Report, <disputesreport@substack.com> wrote:

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OXVJbAUTC1VUVJGV
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> deterioration in the quality of the service they are able to deliver since
> privatisation
> <https://substack.com/redirect/204824bb-a252-4617-b947-7dff94c0d1c1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.
> Passengers are frustrated, and workers bear the brunt of it. Workers want
> fair wages, secure jobs and safe workplaces.
> Subscribed
>
<<https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlCG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWNjb3VudCI9InAiOjE3NDIzOTgxNSwic3I6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImIhdCI6MTc1ODY2NDEwOSwiZXhwIjoyMDc0MjQwMTE5LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.mhz5qmEkpJIuI-Q51tKs85Nw2xQNLdLx1iX4c6U7rDA?>>
> UWU SA - RSPCA
>
> UWU members at the RSPCA in SA walked off the job for 2 hours on Friday
> <https://substack.com/redirect/d4e9fdd9-53d3-40be-a19e-2671f01e063d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> (19/9). This is the first ever industrial action at the RSPCA in South
> Australia. Workers are seeking a fair and reasonable wage increase; mental
> health support and safe and decent working conditions. 85% of workers voted
> down management's proposed agreement
> <https://substack.com/redirect/dfd20730-eb6b-45d8-8749-5430d535cbef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> that attempted to slash pay by nearly 20%, remove on-call allowances worth
> more than \$10,000 per annum and reject basic mental health support. Time
> for the RSCPA to treat its workers with dignity and respect.
>
> <https://substack.com/redirect/d6a1bf5a-9473-4c29-9b78-8c88b5a5c72d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> The Services Union - Townsville City Council
>
> Last week the Townsville Bulletin was reporting on household bins getting
> pretty gross
> <https://substack.com/redirect/02bf8a7a-0839-4048-a0dc-737400d88fa1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> as they awaited collection. But there didn't seem to be any reporting on
> the Townsville City Council cancelling two scheduled negotiation meetings
> with the TSU
> <https://substack.com/redirect/d88992f6-5299-4f3e-b220-7e2f7d594756?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.
> The TSU claims that "despite having met with outdoor Unions and offering
> them improved wage increases during negotiations, Council has shown no
> movement on Stream A wages." It appears this dispute will head to the
> Queensland IRC, but the TSU is adamant that an 11% wage increase over 3
> years (5%, 3% and 3%) is not good enough. Meanwhile, it has been reported
> that the AWU has reached an in-principle agreement with the Townsville
> City Council
> <https://substack.com/redirect/3605876c-352b-4f87-9479-80252e693104?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> which will now be voted on by AWU members.
> ETU NSW - Dormakaba
>
> Workers at Dormakaba in NSW have been taking strike action over the last
> month. Workers are striking for a fair EBA. Workers in other states are
> earning up to 33% more than NSW Dormakaba workers, yet management has only
> offered a 9% wage increase. ETU members are sticking together and demanding
> pay parity and respect.
>
> <https://substack.com/redirect/573ecd0b-8d5f-4141-a1b0-6526a76ec5a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> ANMF Tasmania - RHH
>
> In July, nurses at the Royal Hobart Hospital Medical and Cancer Services commenced
> industrial action
> <https://substack.com/redirect/db24d06d-b24f-40ae-81d8-119f17fdc19c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> in response to a proposal to reduce staffing in the Cancer Clinical Trials
> Unit by 58%. The campaign has included ANMF members wearing badges to work,
> as well as engaging with the community (including patients) and the media
> about the proposal, which the union has declared will have “dire
> consequences” for Tasmanians. The ANMF has now lodged a formal dispute
> with the Tasmanian IRC
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/6c264d81-46dd-4b6f-a2eb-e592af10f231?](https://substack.com/redirect/6c264d81-46dd-4b6f-a2eb-e592af10f231?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> .
> AMWU QLD - Infrabuild
>
> Workers at Infrabuild in Queensland took further industrial action last
> week. Workers have voted down the most recent offer from management, as it
> failed to include a decent base pay rate. Industrial action commenced at
> Infrabuild in late July - the first industrial action at the company in 20
> years.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/1ab63f80-5635-4b63-aa39-36185216d0ee?](https://substack.com/redirect/1ab63f80-5635-4b63-aa39-36185216d0ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
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> UWU Vic - Fonterra
>
> Last Wednesday, workers at Fonterra Bayswater began indefinite strike
> action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/640b9de0-7ad4-4efd-8e8e-f6c43dc76c3b?](https://substack.com/redirect/640b9de0-7ad4-4efd-8e8e-f6c43dc76c3b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal and fair redundancy provisions.
> This is particularly important as farmers and the union raise concerns
> about factory closures
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/4d052fc0-6c44-4c2b-b715-d69e271ba807?](https://substack.com/redirect/4d052fc0-6c44-4c2b-b715-d69e271ba807?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> following the sale of Fonterra to dairy giant Lactalis. Supporters are
> encouraged to chip into the strike fund
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/2c5d796c-fd33-4205-a600-4abe5a35883e?](https://substack.com/redirect/2c5d796c-fd33-4205-a600-4abe5a35883e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> .
> TWU Vic - CDC
>
> Following on from the Independent Transport Union strikes at CDC I
> reported on last week, TWU members at CDC went on strike on Friday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/95db409f-0715-4736-a26a-b62f2b7ec6b5?](https://substack.com/redirect/95db409f-0715-4736-a26a-b62f2b7ec6b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> (19/9) - the fifth strike for those workers since May. The strike action
> disrupted services
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/c09a455a-5005-40e8-a2c9-6677b10da30c?](https://substack.com/redirect/c09a455a-5005-40e8-a2c9-6677b10da30c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> in Ballarat
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/b3383373-2198-42a0-86e6-cb814a03b12e?](https://substack.com/redirect/b3383373-2198-42a0-86e6-cb814a03b12e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>,
> Mildura, Oakleigh, Wyndham Vale, Sunshine, Tullamarine and Geelong. The
> last offer put to workers by CDC was rejected by 84% of the workforce.
> Workers are striking for improved pay and conditions, and demands around
> driver safety.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/1ce2128a-f813-4a6c-8630-b08b1023329a?](https://substack.com/redirect/1ce2128a-f813-4a6c-8630-b08b1023329a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> UWU - MSS
>
> A couple of weeks ago I reported on security guards at Casey Hospital who
> are employed by MSS walking off the job
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/3a6550d8-b014-47da-8c70-22a8b632987a?](https://substack.com/redirect/3a6550d8-b014-47da-8c70-22a8b632987a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> The dispute with MSS is more widespread than one hospital with security
> guards at Homes Victoria also taking industrial action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/e89e0217-b5fc-4816-be4e-83b5e8cb3141?](https://substack.com/redirect/e89e0217-b5fc-4816-be4e-83b5e8cb3141?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.

> These security guards, who work at public housing complexes in Melbourne,
> are fed up with being pushed to do more and more by their employer while
> they are paid far less than other guards doing the same work. Workers have
> major concerns about safety and are at breaking point. UUU members are
> asking supporters to sign a petition
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/55bf658d-a4fe-4bfc-b87c-116091ad439e?](https://substack.com/redirect/55bf658d-a4fe-4bfc-b87c-116091ad439e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> addressed to Victorian Minister for Housing Harriet Shing asking her to
> step in and ensure workers get a fair deal. Security Guards working at
> Defence bases are also taking action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/371db6bc-ef04-4455-8eed-a82d5a17f207?](https://substack.com/redirect/371db6bc-ef04-4455-8eed-a82d5a17f207?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> following pay cuts and being told to eat while they work. Governments need
> to ensure the contractors they appoint are treating workers with respect,
> and MSS - whether it's at a hospital, a public housing tower or a defence
> force base - needs to make sure workers get fair pay, fair conditions and
> respect.
> ETU/MUA WA - CBH
>
> As the two week "cooling off" period ended on Saturday (20/9), the MUA headed
> to social media
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/7fa18ceb-2eaa-47dc-b3d4-e8c9cb2fecc4?](https://substack.com/redirect/7fa18ceb-2eaa-47dc-b3d4-e8c9cb2fecc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> to explain that the cooling off period included posting on social media.
> The MUA also shared that CBH has agreed to continue the suspension of the
> lockout for another fortnight (until 4 October). This is on the basis of
> supervised negotiations being held in the FWC over 4 full days over the
> coming fortnight, with the last meeting occurring on Friday 3 October the
> day before the lockout could recommence. Stay tuned to see what comes of
> the negotiations.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/a7aed884-5b98-426a-9caa-a784ee1d25b9?](https://substack.com/redirect/a7aed884-5b98-426a-9caa-a784ee1d25b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives
>
> ANMF members in SA public hospitals are expected to start industrial
> action soon
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/d2dd8bbe-e1b5-47e1-8c2a-4b2a20e1783d?](https://substack.com/redirect/d2dd8bbe-e1b5-47e1-8c2a-4b2a20e1783d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> as the state government failed to meet their demand of providing an
> improved offer by 17 September. In fact, no further formal offer - good,
> bad or otherwise - was received. Nurses are fed up and want a fair deal
> with action on workload. The ANMF has flagged that industrial action will
> likely include "stop work meetings, community engagement and rallies."
> ASU SA - Salisbury City Council
>
> Workers at Salisbury Council held a 1 hour stoppage last Wednesday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/478e6f54-fc77-4369-b2f3-bbe6ecdb926a?](https://substack.com/redirect/478e6f54-fc77-4369-b2f3-bbe6ecdb926a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> (17/9) as part of their EBA campaign. Workers have subsequently escalated
> their industrial action to include not processing fines and invoices or
> charging for photocopying and other financial bans. Workers are fighting
> for a fair pay deal, improved conditions and adequate staffing levels.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/6846f5a5-6d1c-4033-b428-c685155c22c4?](https://substack.com/redirect/6846f5a5-6d1c-4033-b428-c685155c22c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> ETU/MUA NSW - GrainCorp
>
> Workers at the Port of Newcastle employed by GrainCorp walked off the job
> yesterday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/ae54b0c4-a051-4a6d-bb65-95890e792cea?](https://substack.com/redirect/ae54b0c4-a051-4a6d-bb65-95890e792cea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> (23/09) commencing a 72 hour stoppage. Workers have rejected a 3% wage
> increase

> <https://substack.com/redirect/c5c4a51e-d9df-4226-986d-f6212454e0f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> - reported elsewhere as a 6% increase in the first year and 3% increases
> in years 2 and 3
> <https://substack.com/redirect/d07e0eb6-d291-4671-8bc3-3e27f235ec86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> - and are angry that despite endless overtime to manage high grain
> volumes, they are not being rewarded
> <https://substack.com/redirect/c5c4a51e-d9df-4226-986d-f6212454e0f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> with a decent wage increase. Workers are also seeking clauses related to
> fatigue management. The stoppage is affecting the loading
> <https://substack.com/redirect/d07e0eb6-d291-4671-8bc3-3e27f235ec86?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> of a 55,000-tonne wheat cargo bound for Indonesia which berthed yesterday
> and is due to sail on Friday. It has been reported that GrainCorp is bringing
> in scab labour
> <https://substack.com/redirect/5b59bf7b-c1dc-43fa-b329-c1eed6b2176a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> while workers are on strike.
> AMWU QLD - Superior Pak
>
> Workers at Superior Pak in Bundaberg commenced industrial action on Monday
> (22/9) and are expected to stay out on the grass all this week. The AMWU
> members who manufacture garbage trucks are fighting for decent wages and
> conditions stating that CPI is not enough.
>
> <https://substack.com/redirect/d172c443-b801-49d3-bd78-35e2cd166ff5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> TWU QLD - DHL Express
>
> More than 50 workers at DHL Express at Brisbane Airport walked off the
> job again on Monday
> <https://substack.com/redirect/24861044-e248-4fef-914e-81b8c24e8e04?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> (22/9). This is the second strike for the workers, and follows workers
> being sent home for wearing union badges to work. DHL is refusing to make a
> fair offer to workers who are fighting for \$33 an hour to bring them into
> line with other companies at Brisbane airport, and closer to pay parity
> <https://substack.com/redirect/a3a07dd0-2f60-4710-92d2-945cb45fcfd6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> with their colleagues in Melbourne and Sydney. The TWU noted that we are
> “coming into the peak season for moving freight around the world.” DHL
> countered that they had “reached an impasse” but “remain(ed) committed to
> fair and competitive compensation for our employees.”
> HSU NT - Allied health workers
>
> Allied Health workers rallied outside the Royal Darwin Hospital and Alice
> Springs Hospital yesterday
> <https://substack.com/redirect/33e1a7a2-d81a-43d6-a6fe-c042d587fe01?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> (23/9). Workers have been in negotiations for a new EBA for more than 6
> months. The NT Government has put an sub-par agreement out for vote, which
> closes today. The HSU is encouraging members to vote no on the proposed
> agreement, and are continuing to fight for fair wages, safer workloads and
> more support for allied health workers.
>
> <https://substack.com/redirect/06bde8d8-49cd-4e5c-bf77-3fee52798209?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>
> AWU/CFMEU/The Services Union/TWU QLD - Southern Downs Regional Council
>
> Both the TWU and The Services Union have reported that agreements have
> been voted up at Southern Downs Regional Council. The TWU highlighted
> <https://substack.com/redirect/7679a3a3-4c15-4348-8082-3b7f2714bb49?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM>

> a 15% pay rise over 3 years, backpay, saving their Sundays and improved job
> security. The Services Union shared
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/7550d931-e44a-4767-add6-cf26fab9e2da?](https://substack.com/redirect/7550d931-e44a-4767-add6-cf26fab9e2da?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> wins including a 6% pay rise and back pay coming sooner; improved overtime
> for supervisors and protection on rosters that include Saturdays. No
> reports from the CFMEU or AWU as yet. Council workers walked off the job
> earlier in September, the first strike action at the Council in 40 years.
>
> That's all I've got this week! One final piece of news is that another 4
> Melbourne metropolitan councils have voted in support of bargaining for a
> multi-employer agreement
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/c3878dfe-f11d-4aaa-8b67-87beb0374483?](https://substack.com/redirect/c3878dfe-f11d-4aaa-8b67-87beb0374483?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> Merri-bek (65% in favour); Hume (68% in favour); Yarra (63% in favour) and
> Hobson's Bay (77% in favour) will join City of Melbourne, Maribyrnong City
> Council and City of Greater Dandenong who have already consented to
> multi-employer bargaining. Definitely an interesting one to watch! I would
> love to hear from any council workers involved for an "on the ground"
> perspective. If that's you - get in touch!
>
> In solidarity, Sarah
>
> Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.
>
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> <[https://substack.com/app-link/post?](https://substack.com/app-link/post?publication_id=2095176&post_id=174239815&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email&utm_content=share&utm_campaign=email-share&action=share&triggerShare=true&isFreemail=true&r=owmol&token=eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MTgzMzE3MywicG9zdF9pZCI6MTc0MjM5ODE1LCJpYXQiOjE3NTg2NjQxMTksImV4cCI6MTc2MTI1NjExOSwiaXNzIjoicHVlTiIwOTUxNzYiLCJzdWIiOiJwb3N0LXJlYWNoaw9uIn0.L-UQRFT5kQsR26pkYMXdLeyk9MwFc6XmEqhlRnwobiw)
publication_id=2095176&post_id=174239815&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email&utm_content=share&utm_campaign=email-
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publication_id=2095176&post_id=174239815&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email&isFreemail=true&comment_s=true&token=eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MTgzMzE3MywicG9zdF9pZCI6MTc0MjM5ODE1LCJpYXQiOjE3NTg2NjQxMTksImV4cCI6MTc2MTI1NjExOSwiaXNzIjoicHVlTiIwOTUxNzYiLCJzdWIiOiJwb3N0LXJlYWNoaw9uIn0.L-UQRFT5kQsR26pkYMXdLeyk9MwFc6XmEqhlRnwobiw&r=owmol&utm_campaign=email-half-magic-comments&action=post-comment&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email>
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View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-25-february>

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

ANMF members at the Lyell McEwin hospital had planned on taking a 24 hour strike last Thursday (19/2), but the action never eventuated. Initially, the government lodged a dispute in the SA Employment Tribunal [https://substack.com/redirect/69f36f85-0b3c-46de-bdc4-2c85dda3b609?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], seeking more time to prepare for the strike in order to ensure patient safety. The strike was then postponed to 26 February. However, the strike was ultimately cancelled [https://substack.com/redirect/dbba1f2a-b634-4893-b66c-07ef163be43f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] after the government made an offer of an “interim administrative increase [https://substack.com/redirect/b536329a-de34-40f1-9888-9c4e360f8b0e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]” of 6%. Nurses and midwives will receive a 4% increase backdated to January 1, and another additional 2% from 26 October. While negotiations for the EBA continue, including for the full wage claim and improved conditions, all industrial action has now been suspended.

HWU - Public sector healthcare workers

At last week’s (18/2) strike and rally [https://substack.com/redirect/f3e7dedf-470d-4fc9-ad10-b901e66e9d3d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] at the new Footscray Hospital, HWU Organiser Jake McGuinness announced a new offer from the government of a 12% wage increase over 2 and a half years. A statement from the HWU [https://substack.com/redirect/d3f586ad-ae2b-41f8-a5a7-b9195b6e708c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] said the union was “proud to recommend” the deal to members. The union had initially been aiming for 6% annual wage increases [https://substack.com/redirect/f5a37d12-bc6b-4b61-9324-c1290f367dce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. While the HWU will be putting the offer to a vote of members, not all members are that keen. One HWU member was quoted in an article [https://substack.com/redirect/f3412ec2-0d75-4bd7-b04c-24a0b25dfa4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] as saying “People are angry with the government. It’s only been two months of industrial action. We want the union to amp it up. I think we should reject this offer—we’re being taken for fools.” The “Socialists In Healthcare” group (part of Victorian Socialists) is running a vote no [https://substack.com/redirect/4d188d33-af6c-4820-a618-f70a8ef43819?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] campaign, outlining issues [https://substack.com/redirect/8a75bb58-03a7-4bfb-bcc0-5dbf42939f47?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] with classifications, and wanting workplace meetings to discuss the offer and the campaign.

AWU - Skydive Australia

Skydive instructors have now taken 8 days of industrial action in pursuit of a fair deal. Workers struck for two days in December, two days earlier in February and now struck for 4 days from 20 - 23 February [https://substack.com/redirect/bf75fa79-052b-4f39-9000-7054c34621bd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers have been in negotiations for over 12 months, but the current offer from Skydive Australia amounts to a pay cut of around 2.3% [https://substack.com/redirect/0e329ecb-3eb9-48ae-b16d-08a71fff9f53?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Skydive Australia has also applied to the government to be able to hire 37 overseas workers, which they propose paying less than full time local workers [https://substack.com/redirect/14acbe70-b31f-4699-97d4-2f54b9180fe7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The company has also axed its local training program. Regardless of visa status, workers deserve decent wages and conditions, and a fair EBA.

RAFFWU - Harry Hartog & Berkelouw Books

RAFFWU has launched legal action [https://substack.com/redirect/9bdd16e3-f2bd-4fb5-be50-d7c90ec53d80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] against Berkelouw Leichardt Pty Ltd and Cordeaux Creek Pty Ltd (companies that operate Berkelouw Books and Harry Hartog). The legal action is in response to adverse action taken against striking booksellers by their employers. While workers participated in work bans, the bosses slashed their pay by 37%. Not content with that, and refusing to negotiate for a new agreement, the bosses went on to strip part-time and casual workers who participated in the strike action of their regular shifts. Shifts were instead given to strike breakers (who had been paid bonuses to work during the strike). RAFFWU alleges taking shifts away from workers was unlawful adverse action [https://substack.com/redirect/7e9e7261-43fd-459f-9768-1e091847545c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers at Harry Hartog & Berkelouw Books are still participating in workplace bans including a partial ban on participating in meetings with managers, supervisors or team leaders; a ban on training and interrupting work periodically to wear, display and distribute campaign material.

HACSU Victoria - Aruma Disability Services

On Friday (20/2), HACSU members working for Aruma Disability Services commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/98343a90-8c34-4bf6-9c9a-d5dceabb1d17?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. This one is a bit tricky as I do not understand NDIS funding or the disability sector at all, but it appears that the Victorian government have stopped paying subsidies for group homes for people with disabilities, and the NDIS hasn't filled the gap leaving a funding shortfall. So group homes are closing, or participants are scrambling around for funding to keep their homes operating. Aruma has subsequently applied to the FWC to have its EBA terminated [https://substack.com/redirect/705b2664-aa54-4f93-b8cc-f037bc0ccc82?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] because the rates in the EBA are higher than what the NDIS covers. This is a terrible situation for workers, and participants and their families [https://substack.com/redirect/484307f5-bb17-4092-98cf-1554dbfc9496?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Workers have implemented a range of work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/04a9d7a5-6f99-478c-bb11-06ca402c13a2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] including a ban on completing vehicle logbooks; a ban on participating in employer-initiated workplace change or restructures; a ban on participating in employer-initiated roster reviews; a ban on data entry and collection of statistics; a ban on dropping mail off and picking mail up from administration offices; and members will be wearing campaign t-shirts.

TWU NSW - NSW bus drivers

The TWU has filed an application [https://substack.com/redirect/0d46e1d6-e9ff-4f2d-a712-f45d5c241ddc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in the Fair Work Commission to seek approval to begin bargaining on behalf of NSW bus drivers across 6 bus companies. If approved the application would pave the way for 8000 bus drivers to negotiate an agreement collectively, and to take industrial action simultaneously when their current EBAs expire in 2026. The TWU aims to put pressure on the Minns government to provide additional funding to companies to lift the wages of bus drivers. Strike action could shut down buses across Greater Sydney, the Central Coast, the Hunter and Wollongong. The union is aiming to raise wages by ~25% over 3 years which would achieve parity with bus drivers in Victoria. Drivers are also concerned about job security, staff shortages and safety [https://substack.com/redirect/172fc489-45a7-4aca-9588-abbfa8048ec0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. This is part of the TWU's 2026 Our Roads, Our Skies, Our Future campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/234067c7-75fc-4b9c-a4ed-a0926f29d0b0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

UFU WA - WA Fireies

The UFU has initiated an "Enterprise Order process" in the WAIRC as the deadlock between the union and the state government refuses to budge. An Enterprise Order process [https://substack.com/redirect/4e9f5516-eecc-41cc-84c5-f85f3219c287?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] is apparently very rarely used and leaves it to the Commission to draw up a new pay deal based on evidence provided by both sides. Any WA lawyers, feel free to correct me on this one! The UFU provided its log of claims to the government in February 2025 and rejected the first offer [https://substack.com/redirect/a7cf7328-14a0-4b3c-8707-72f031d7d41e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] from the government in July, and a second offer in November. The Government rejected a counter offer from the union in December. There have been over 20 bargaining meetings [https://substack.com/redirect/011ba4da-7831-4664-93be-9ebb0fddbfc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Fireies are fighting for a \$2 increase to their base rate, as well as percentage wage increases, and improvements to health and safety.

RTBU NSW - Aurizon

A win for the RTBU at the FWC! Aurizon went massively heavy handed intimidating workers about protected industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/4b44a49a-27f9-4e3d-970b-c6aa20981911?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] - affixing union stickers on vehicles. Aurizon went so far as to send workers home if they were going to put a sticker on a car - essentially a lock out [https://substack.com/redirect/e5532f08-0612-41ba-82b7-6249f28f78b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The Fair Work Commission ordered Aurizon to stop. While it's a win for the union in this battle, they still need to win their EBA campaign. Last week, 97% of respondents voted against the company's proposed agreement.

In short

MUA - Carnival

The next installment in the Carnival campaign took place on Friday (20/2). Two MUA organisers attempted to board a Carnival Ship docked at Circular Quay, with a legal right of entry permit, but were denied entry by security guards and staff. As the MUA noted "they think they can keep exploiting their crew up and down the Australian coast without consequence. They're wrong. This isn't over. Not even close. [https://substack.com/redirect/409bde0e-a54c-400b-8154-966557b56403?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]"

AEU Victoria - Early childhood education

AEU members who work in early childhood education will be holding a stopwork meeting and rally [https://substack.com/redirect/0b4518eb-a8ac-4b29-84f6-97d69471bb74?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/0b4518eb-a8ac-4b29-84f6-97d69471bb74?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (26/2). The AEU has been in negotiations with the Allen Government for 18 months [https://substack.com/redirect/d832fc47-be5d-4c3f-9582-b92cd6f1bbc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], but is yet to receive a pay offer. This will be the second 24 hour strike taken by early childhood educators who are fighting for decent wages, and action on workload. Get along and support these workers tomorrow if you can - 10:30am at the Melbourne Town Hall.

The Services Union - Urban Utilities

Rolling stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/02abef14-c115-4f16-8a2b-9b089ea3657c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] at Urban Utilities are continuing this week.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU - Queensland Health

On Thursday (19/2), maintenance workers employed by Queensland Health struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/3f341f2d-cd7a-44ee-8599-1521e51b7724?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Unions have been in negotiations for 9 months [https://substack.com/redirect/8caabbe2-3fe4-482d-a4c5-4f6f5dfc05a4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], and their EBA expired 6months ago. Workers are fighting for a fair deal with wages that keep up with the cost of living, backpay, no new clauses that will casualise their jobs and their usual working arrangements to be honoured. It's not much to ask. Striking workers rallied outside state Health Minister Tim Nicholl's office [https://substack.com/redirect/71f45d8c-d348-46b6-8c7d-391552b001be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

AEU Tasmania - Public sector support staff

Yesterday (24/2), a video of AEU Branch President David Genford shared the news that after a week of "intense" negotiations with the state government there has been no change to the sort of proposal put forward to the union. Despite assurances, what has been put forward is less than what the police union in Tasmania received. In the video, Genford says that members and reps will be contacted shortly to discuss further industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/d120c322-e850-4f57-8512-236c630f688c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Stay Tuned.

MUA - DP World

Yesterday (24/2), MUA members rallied outside DP World's office in Sydney [https://substack.com/redirect/3240967b-0071-4784-9bff-d58151b69652?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The rally [https://substack.com/redirect/ea600089-bfee-4d6e-8e97-a7343f6f1b12?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] was in opposition of DP World's plans to further automate ports. The MUA has also shared on social media [https://substack.com/redirect/1a7b6cd0-1a08-4298-9793-5c5e427035b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] that DP World's CEO, Sultan Ahmed bin Sulayem, is in the Epstein files - as he apparently was emailing with Epstein about torture videos. So perhaps DP World would be better getting their own management in order, and get their hands off wharfies' jobs.

Wins/resolution

ANMF/HACSU Victoria - Public sector mental health workers

Both the ANMF [https://substack.com/redirect/645c2892-5e52-48ff-87d7-3c5833a9dc38?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and HACSU [https://substack.com/redirect/8fbc0888-77d5-4b41-adf3-5af2b93cd17d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] shared social media posts announcing that the public mental health EBA has been approved and will come into effect on March 2.

While mental health nurses achieved pay parity with general nurses, some on the HACSU side of the aisle in allied health positions were disappointed to not receive the same wages boost. When HACSU recommended members endorse the offer, they acknowledged it fell short of their claims [https://substack.com/redirect/b30ec01f-4d82-43a0-b9d8-52f21d78924c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], but pointed to a facilitative clause related to the HPSS Gender Undervaluation case which "leaves open the door to significant wage uplifts" during the life of the agreement. HACSU provided a full breakdown [https://substack.com/redirect/ae0e9047-80a5-491e-a433-36257c0aeecc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] of the new EBA.

UFU SA - SA Firefighters

Last week the UFU announced that the SA Metropolitan Fire Service's Enterprise Agreement has been formally approved [https://substack.com/redirect/e50d6ed0-30ca-48c8-b86e-e02d3e630113?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The union shared that the agreement includes pay rises of between 15.41 and 31.6% over the life of the agreement including a

\$3000 lift to the base rate. The agreement also includes increased opportunities for career progression; introduction of a gold standard health monitoring program and an additional resource to be committed for the delivery of SAMFS training. Firies in SA participated in industrial action late last year to ensure this win.

That's all I've got on the disputes front this week. But there is one other thing to include in this week's report. Geoffrey Watson has alleged that across the Victorian "Big Build" infrastructure projects the CFMEU cost taxpayers \$15 billion. And every union basher, right winger, conservative, and to be honest some folks that I thought better of have taken the bait hook line and sinker.

Watson's methodology is completely farcical. As The Guardian explains [

[https://substack.com/redirect/7cc7d4ca-b42d-4ade-96d1-2dd22102d54d?](https://substack.com/redirect/7cc7d4ca-b42d-4ade-96d1-2dd22102d54d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7cc7d4ca-b42d-4ade-96d1-2dd22102d54d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], "Given the Big Build was worth roughly \$100bn and industry sources told Watson that cost blowouts linked to CFMEU conduct ranged between 10% and 30%, he settled on an estimate of 15%, describing it as "not unreasonable" and "probably conservative." This is sort of like asking two blokes how tall a third bloke is and one of them says 180cm and the other says 150cm so you conclude the person must be 160cm. Watson went on to claim that "much of that \$15bn has been poured directly into the hands of criminals and organised crime gangs." But as with so much of Watson's report - there are no receipts. Watson presents many rumours and assumptions as facts, and that he would be able to prove it IF ONLY he could compel witnesses. In his report, Watson talks about "unskilled" workers on the Big Build making \$1900 a week. And to that I say workers and unions should never be ashamed of having fought for and won decent wages. Never forget that so much of the talk in the media about the "CFMEU tax [

[https://substack.com/redirect/1b8e187c-0a05-4b81-8e26-cfa5ddb29f23?](https://substack.com/redirect/1b8e187c-0a05-4b81-8e26-cfa5ddb29f23?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1b8e187c-0a05-4b81-8e26-cfa5ddb29f23?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]" on projects is nothing more than a barefaced attack on workers' wages. There are some serious and credible allegations about corruption in the Watson report that must be confronted. We must confront corruption in our unions - the failure to do so eats away at solidarity. But the answer to any of these issues is not a Royal Commission or Administration. The answer is more democracy [

https://substack.com/redirect/fa6f08fe-84ec-479f-aa1a-63d2781e92bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in our

unions, and for rank and file workers to exercise genuine control over their unions. If you want to read Watson's report it's here [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b892f2dd-32c5-4d08-969b-621654bc94c6?](https://substack.com/redirect/b892f2dd-32c5-4d08-969b-621654bc94c6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b892f2dd-32c5-4d08-969b-621654bc94c6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], and if you're a real glutton for

punishment the transcript to his latest appearance at the Queensland CFMEU Inquiry is here [

[https://substack.com/redirect/42902721-2a89-4161-a5c4-1647dd20a93a?](https://substack.com/redirect/42902721-2a89-4161-a5c4-1647dd20a93a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/42902721-2a89-4161-a5c4-1647dd20a93a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UZzVNREYyT0RZM0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056RTVOalV3TmF01tVjRjQ0k2TVRnd016VXdNVEEYTVN3aWFTYnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnBkV01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdF1XbHNJbAUZ2FhZmxDWVZleHFnTU14Um1rNzJHqjVHTDBkUGxmTXpsc1pNc3VfeUhxOCIsInAiOjE4OTAwNjg2NywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3MTk2NTA2MSwiZXhwIjoyMDg3NTQxMDYxL2Jpc3MiOiJwdWItMcIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnR0cmVkaXJlY3QifQ.0N8PdSTDLHutJVIqOK6wevM5eJRFzYcnptELUJYcPaY?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-25-march>

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

Tens of thousands of Victorian public school teachers rallied in Melbourne yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/45497552-df4b-4161-8f77-5228a1aa06ef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (24/3) in the first strike action of this EBA campaign. I have had reports confirming that AEU membership has increased by 30% since the start of the year with teachers eager to be able to participate in this significant strike action. Workers are so enthusiastic to fight for a better deal that last week saw 1,700 sign ups in one day. Public school teachers in Victoria are at breaking point - the lowest paid teachers in the country, in the lowest funded system [https://substack.com/redirect/81d14cbd-8911-4e14-8984-27789b97c049?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] are overworked and facing staff shortages. Education Minister Ben Carroll claims the government did everything they could do avert the strike [https://substack.com/redirect/663363c9-1b0a-4584-ad7b-364d4c7fa194?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] so I suspect it is going to take a bit more pushing to get the state government to make a reasonable offer. The AEU Branch has endorsed further escalation of the campaign should a decent offer not be forthcoming. This escalation would include bans on meetings; bans on responding to Departmental emails; bans on implementing any new Department initiatives; bans on providing written comments on student reports and rolling half day regional stopwork actions during Term 2.

NTEU NSW - University of Technology Sydney

On Thursday (19/3), NTEU members at UTS struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/be499e19-c797-40ea-bd78-ad9f50d90b8c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The NTEU has been in negotiations for 6 months, and management has refused union claims for job security, safe workloads, reproductive health leave and a decent wage increase. During a rally on campus on Thursday, an email from UTS' Chief Operating Officer Glen Babington was read out where a pitiful 1.5% administrative pay increase [https://substack.com/redirect/570f5871-01da-44f7-bec1-18a49022af06?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] was offered to workers. UTS is also in the process of a major restructure, with 100 voluntary redundancies to take place before June [https://substack.com/redirect/04526d20-2351-4e53-8328-6cb4daf59dfb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

AEU/CPSU/HACSU/UWU Tasmania - Tasmanian public sector workers

Tasmanian public sector workers continue their industrial campaign this week. The Rockliff government failed to provide a decent offer by 20 March leaving workers no choice but to escalate industrial action. Yesterday (24/3), hundreds of healthcare workers, teachers and public sector workers walked off the job and rallied in both Devonport and Burnie. Today (25/3) workers in the north of the state will rally in Launceston. And on Thursday workers in the south of the state will strike and rally in Hobart. This massive week of industrial action includes rolling 24 hour strikes in public schools [https://substack.com/redirect/ad08991e-c609-4d0c-881c-00c4c4ea0a84?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and shorter stoppages from other public sector workers. In addition to this week's activities, last week CPSU members in child safety struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/800387f3-48c7-42ab-8866-36f3ecd5cb99?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on Thursday (19/3); and HACSU members at the Royal Hobart Hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/5a75686c-2106-4b1a-86dd-2e22f676f14b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], the Holman Clinic [https://substack.com/redirect/e7b6627b-5520-4b04-af90-5f8c17cd62a9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] also held stoppages. Yesterday

afternoon (24/3), Jeremy Rockliff announced a new wage offer [https://substack.com/redirect/dd5282de-d6a5-4755-8513-20639f287ffb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which would impact more than 15,000 workers. The offer includes an 8.75% wage increase over 3 years and "a range of incentives and conditions". It is understood negotiations will continue today.

QNMU - Mater Hospital

The QNMU met with Mater management last Tuesday [https://substack.com/redirect/5aa8065f-e497-475d-a552-678fae6a370a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (17/3) following strike action the week prior. The latest offer is unsatisfactory. Mater has offered an 11% wage increase over 4 years. This lags behind Queensland Health's minimum of 11% over 3 years, and will not see pay parity for Mater nurses & midwives. In addition to failing on wages, the offer fails [https://substack.com/redirect/8a91fbfc-4222-4fa9-826d-92618f56338c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to include nurse to patient ratios; has no commitment to increasing Sunday penalty rates and does not have a new RN level 1 top pay point to match Queensland Health. I suspect more to come on this dispute.

CPSU/MEAA - ABC

Workers at the ABC have voted down management's latest offer [https://substack.com/redirect/68ca1fd3-832b-46b8-b51e-2b060a91c35f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], and overwhelmingly voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/23dfa2fb-ff04-4b5a-a3f6-62706fe546e4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. CPSU and MEAA members will strike for 24 hours commencing today (25/3) at 11am AEDT. This will be the first strike at the broadcaster in 20 years [https://substack.com/redirect/3a96dfe1-c35b-4c8a-b5ea-b6572c169513?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a decent EBA that includes fair pay increases and job security. The offer voted down by workers included below inflation pay outcomes and failed to address key concerns including the staff appraisal process, career progression, penalty rates and reproductive health leave. The strike is set to cause significant disruption to ABC TV and radio, with replacement content from the BBC likely to be used. The MEAA have asked supporters to attend their local bureau [https://substack.com/redirect/1cd7d438-a465-4368-9e31-295169e2582a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] to cheer workers on as they walk off the job at 11am this morning.

In short

AMWU NSW - Downer

A reel on the AMWU Facebook page [https://substack.com/redirect/e2f848bf-c99d-4f01-966d-aa93d331b1f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] suggests that workers employed by Downer at Progress Rail and possibly also EDI held a stoppage last week. I don't have much info, but workers at both Downer sites are fighting for respect, dignity and decent pay; and held stoppages late last year.

NTEU WA - Curtin University

NTEU members at Curtin University held a full day strike on Monday [

https://substack.com/redirect/478c4106-a2d1-4618-8d6b-275e0b70fa8f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (23/3). This follows a stopwork

rally in November, and bans that included working from home since the start of semester. Key issues in the dispute are unsustainable workloads; wages; and limitation on work-from-home. Workers have demanded a 20% wage increase over 4 years as well as action on workloads and improved job security.

UWU NT - Alice Springs Correctional Officers

The Northern Territory Corrections Commissioner and Commissioner for Public Employment applied to the FWC [https://substack.com/redirect/afddb233-5261-4668-8f61-bf02bc3a9b18?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] to have industrial action by

correctional officers at Alice Springs prisons stopped. This attempt was unsuccessful and industrial action went ahead with more than 80 correctional officers participating in the 12 hour strike on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/3622dce9-852d-445c-aa06-39ac80a6d1b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (20/3).

UWU Victoria - Vinidex

UWU members at Vinidex in Sunshine took industrial action on Monday (23/3). Vinidex is one of Australia's leading pipe system manufacturers. Its workers have not had a payrise since 2024.

AWU/ETU QLD - Glencore

Workers at Townsville's copper refinery were set to commence partial work bans on Saturday (21/3). Glencore notified workers that if they participated in partial work bans, they would not be paid for the whole shift [https://substack.com/redirect/33cbde5-fe95-463d-848a-b4b7b58e0b4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. A media release [

https://substack.com/redirect/c550b1e7-1ae1-47d2-87a7-949064a4148b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] announced that ETU members would

not "work for free" and that sparkies would not attend their shifts on Saturday (21/3). A media release from the AWU [https://substack.com/redirect/f938d58f-916b-422a-ab5a-e459a455343e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] did not reveal whether AWU members

would follow suit.

AWU members would follow suit.

TWU - Swissport

Yesterday (24/3), TWU members at Swissport rallied at airports around the country [

https://substack.com/redirect/e28952e3-c292-4925-b5f0-326027a7bd28?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] as bargaining for a new EBA

commences. A recent safety blitz has revealed multiple issues including damaged ground equipment, unsafe staffing levels, heat based injuries and psychosocial hazards from intrusive worker surveillance.

PABO Watch

ASU/Professional Australia - DXC

In early March, ASU and Professional Australia members at DXC both voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/f56c9571-6ab2-4a11-855b-3e58c7b10cc6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. DXC is a large IT services

company that has significant contracts [https://substack.com/redirect/ba868896-5cb6-43a8-9398-8d504c8de7be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] with federal and

state governments in Australia. Workers at DXC are on an old zombie agreement, and are fighting for a new agreement. The Mandarin reported on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/b7d7423f-fa07-4138-b882-21278ef95080?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (20/3) that while industrial action had been expected to kick off on the weekend, DXC came to the negotiating table late on Thursday (19/3) with an offer and industrial action was “paused”. Know more about this dispute? Get it touch!

NTEU WA - University of WA

A protected action ballot has opened [https://substack.com/redirect/9bd159aa-4412-4dc7-b48e-f811205bf0b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] for NTEU members at the University of WA. The ballot opened on 18 March and closes tomorrow (26/3). In late 2025 a mass meeting of workers [https://substack.com/redirect/6a0ca2fb-e173-4468-8822-52a6e3e2562b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] at UWA voted to move to industrial action due to the university’s unreasonable positions on pay, workload, and work flexibility.

ASU Victoria - Metro city councils MEA

Negotiations with 8 city councils [https://substack.com/redirect/e3fa8fe6-43d0-4f01-80b7-1641509f1cfb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] in Greater Melbourne for a multi-employer agreement have begun. A ballot for protected industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/2b5a4f31-1fb8-4f60-90d7-84404e55a29a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] opened on Monday and will run

until Friday (27/3). The ASU is fighting for a pay increase of 22% over 4 years - 10% in the first year, followed by 4% annual increases.

ASU/Professionals Australia Vic - Coliban Water

ASU [https://substack.com/redirect/5d91cf3e-2c54-4c7c-bc51-134902f99d6e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and Professionals Australia [https://substack.com/redirect/9995464a-e397-44f2-9301-71e6047d9daa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] members at Coliban Water have both

voted in favour of taking industrial action. Coliban Water is a regional water corporation in North-Central Victoria. Workers are fighting for a fair deal after years of real pay cuts. A Professionals Australia social media posts suggests industrial action kicks off today (25/3) - let me know if you have more details!

That’s all I’ve got this week. I have been a bit unwell the last few days, so apologies for there being a few more loose ends than I would like, and probably more typos and errors than usual! To close, Professionals Australia are collecting signatures for a petition [https://substack.com/redirect/5deaad9c-2639-4319-ad57-62288f4ca171?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] demanding the reinstatement of a

delegate on the Snowy Hydro 2.0 project. Rock Idugboe, a Professionals Australia delegate on the plagued site, raised concerns about unpaid overtime and was subsequently sacked. Please consider signing to support the union, and Rock, in this campaign.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-26-march>

NSWNMA - Healthscope

A series of 26 hour strikes by nurses and midwives at private hospitals run by Healthscope [https://substack.com/redirect/20096705-4dea-460d-af3a-8171cd374592?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] are underway. Newcastle Private Hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/1bfd6fbe-0e6a-4512-b396-0cef24394d5f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and Hunter Private Hospital kicked off the strike wave on Thursday last week (20/3); with Northern Beaches Private hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/f8ae777a-f4a1-482f-a9da-5f6161bd18ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] following on Monday (24/3). Norwest Private Hospital will strike on Friday (28/3). This follows an attempt at taking strike action in February that was quashed by the FWC [https://substack.com/redirect/e5ccada0-9f86-4d20-97d2-e37d15570951?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. NSWNMA members are fighting for a 15% pay increase in 1 year. This is to reach pay parity with Healthscope nurses in Queensland who are paid 16% more than their NSW counterparts. Healthscopes best offer to date is only 13% over 3 years. Nurses and midwives are also fighting for ratios; improved leave and an increase to night shift penalty rates [https://substack.com/redirect/c9c19f02-23a8-4756-92f0-e0b6a6f6dd4b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

UWU - Avalon Security Guards

Security guards at Avalon airport are taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/7c75c2a4-c464-4b50-9055-58896db21255?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in pursuit of a better deal. Workers are fighting for a better pay deal, as well as job security. At present, if a flight is cancelled - workers are told to go home and are not paid for the full shift. Workers also have concerns about safety - whether these concerns are related to the recent attempted hijacking of a Jetstar flight by a teenager, or more everyday safety issues, I am not sure. Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to receive the full report straight to your inbox.

RTBU Tasmania - Metro buses

RTBU members at Metro buses in Hobart implemented an indefinite work ban on collecting fares [https://substack.com/redirect/4dcaca64-887b-41c5-b42b-00ba177618e6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The action comes in response to an spate of robberies and assaults. On Friday (21/3) a union HSR issued a cease work directive to not collect fares which “removes a well-established escalation point [https://substack.com/redirect/6241b9d8-ea65-496b-81e6-ddbc3ad81b94?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]”. The RTBU wants the Government to speed up the roll out of a statewide deployment of Transit Officers, with powers to issue fines and detain offenders, which was committed to over 2 years ago. RTBU members secured a new EBA with Metro late last year which included “critical incident leave” [https://substack.com/redirect/0ef42a49-f14a-4686-b6ba-b48d6c72deb4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which gives drivers 3 days leave after a serious incident. As reported last week, this is the latest in a string of union action following assaults of bus drivers - with bus drivers in Canberra, Newcastle and now Hobart all facing increased safety concerns at work. Make sure to give your bus driver a big cheery thank you today! Every worker should be safe at work.

ANMF/HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

Industrial action by ANMF and HACSU members in public sector mental health continues. According to an ANMF update [https://substack.com/redirect/e30d1cfa-47e1-4b5e-a0de-3055709957fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], bargaining meetings have been ongoing, and the ANMF expect an offer to be made this week. Consequently, the ANMF has called a statewide members meeting this Friday (28/3) to either discuss the revised offer, or next steps. Would love to hear from any mental health workers for more updates on the bargaining process.

AWU QLD/The Services Union - Noosa City Council

Missing from my reporting on the dispute at the Noosa City Council was that members of the AWU also participated in the industrial action last Wednesday (19/3). AWU organiser Michael Anderson shared that negotiations had stalled after the Council put forward an unsatisfactory pay offer [https://substack.com/redirect/4dd704ee-b9e9-45f0-a6e4-0ed67dde6e81?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The offer leaves workers struggling to keep up with the cost of living, but also struggling to keep up with workers at the neighbouring councils of Gympie, the Sunshine Coast and Moreton Bay. Workers are likely to take industrial action again tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/48973af7-2199-4d0f-a23e-646c5eaad69b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (27/3).

UWU SA - Disability support workers

Disability support workers in SA have been undertaking industrial action in the form of work bans for

over a month [https://substack.com/redirect/cbfc13fc-961d-4c4f-be67-4b949816ba41?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Over the last week, UWW members have escalated their bans, targeting management. The bans restrict administrative tasks, limit communications during unpaid times and increased chalking of campaign slogans on vans. Workers are calling on Premier Malinauskas to ensure public sector disability support workers are paid the same as those in the private sector, and that the SA Government passes on the funding it receives from the federal government for workers' wages.

AWU Victoria - Frankston Concrete Products

Workers at Frankston Concrete Products held a two hour work stoppage last week after months of stalled negotiations. When AWU members then tried to return to work, management sent everyone home for the day. Workers are fighting for a fair deal - 4% annual wage increases; better redundancy protections and improved classification rates and conditions. Not to be discouraged, workers will be doubling down and holding a 4 hour stoppage this Thursday (27/3).

ASU - Maurice Blackburn

It is understood that workers from Maurice Blackburn met yesterday to discuss a revised offer from management. Hopefully I will have a full report on this next week. Stay tuned!

AMWU/ETU Vic - Nestle

Workers at Nestle in Broadford and Campbellfield have accepted an in-principle agreement. The agreement includes wage increases of 5%, 4.5% and 4% - an improvement from Nestle's original offer of 3.5% each year. The most contentious item in the negotiations was Nestle's attempt to implement a 24/7 roster. The unions and employer have apparently landed at a compromise position that a 24/7 roster can only be implemented if workers fail to provide coverage for 12 shifts in any 12 week period.

Queensland Public Sector Workers - Queensland Government

It looks like the Queensland Government may face some challenges over its wages policy. The current public sector wide offer to workers is a 3% wage increase this year followed by 2.5% increases in 2026 and 2027 [https://substack.com/redirect/6fa4ce67-468f-4424-aae4-a3236932d30f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The nurses and midwives agreement is the first to expire at the end of March, and QNMU members have been meeting across the state and voting down the government's wages policy [https://substack.com/redirect/4ceeb0a0-3995-424c-97fb-0b6f90ec631c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The Courier Mail has reported that the Police Minister has opted to commence negotiations with the police union outside of the central wages policy; which triggered the Firefighters' Union to knock on the door of the Minister for Fire, Disaster Recovery and Volunteers and demand the same option to negotiate separately. [https://substack.com/redirect/8edf213c-a48f-4d69-a7c4-9ef260f594c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] The Fire State Secretary said he was "bewildered" by the low ball offer. The QTU's Secretary said "The QTU is prepared for a transparent and robust process in securing a deal." Meanwhile QCU General Secretary Jacqueline King said unions were committed to central wage policy, and warned against side negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/2d117050-f4b7-4272-9b9d-88efa48adea0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Any Queensland public servants reading this? Would love to hear your thoughts!

That's all I've got this week. Please make sure you're extra nice to your bus driver this week! I feel like I am preaching to the choir on this one, but let's all get on board with making bus drivers feel safe and respected.

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades and subscribe.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UVTVPREU1T0RreUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05ESTVNe1EzT1Rjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM05EUTNnRG1Tn13aWYFNpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdpVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT21Ka2FYTMhZbXhswDJWdFlXBHNjbjAuODNhMXdxMndoSmZRd3JwU1JUbK5VNdVRWZ6dl1xUk5mYkFxRGFfXSl84USIsInAiOjE1OTgxOTg5MiwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc0MjkzNDc5NywiZXhwIjozNzQ1NTI2Nzk3LCJpc3MiOiIjWdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.3egeG1VVDamMJwm9IBCWWG9sZJDMNPau_YNirex2FkQ?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-26-november>

PSA SA - Public sector workers

A last minute call out for workers in Adelaide! The PSA will be holding its "Public Sector Mega Rally" [https://substack.com/redirect/2c5da101-6aec-4c7a-8ded-6b1e4b947a9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] today. Workers will be assembling at Hindmarsh Square at 12:30pm today (26/11) and then marching to Parliament House. If you live or work in Adelaide, get along and support the PSA in their fight for a 20% wage increase [

https://substack.com/redirect/0dfe2376-607e-4769-b240-f2f895a75edd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

https://substack.com/redirect/0dfe2376-607e-4769-b240-f2f895a75edd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

https://substack.com/redirect/0dfe2376-607e-4769-b240-f2f895a75edd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

QTU - Public sector teachers

QTU members held their second 24 hour strike yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/adcf0974-5f3d-48c6-b7b1-9520df55d437?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (25/11).

Teachers rallied in Cairns, Townsville, Mackay, Rockhampton, Gladstone, Bundaberg, Hervey Bay, Sunshine Coast, Toowoomba, the Gold Coast and Brisbane. The union put the blame for any inconvenience to parents and students at the feet of the Premier and Education Minister for failing to pick up the phone and negotiate. A statement from the union [https://substack.com/redirect/c40511e9-e8fe-498c-9117-0da7fe356b42?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] went on to explain that "arbitration will be triggered by 31 December, with the QTU asking for an interim 3 per cent salary increase and a narrowing of the matters to be resolved by the full bench of the QIRC." This has been refused by the state government. With only 13 more school days this year, the QTU is fast running out of industrial options.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Keolis Downer has made an offer [https://substack.com/redirect/71400ac8-242e-4d0f-a206-58a716522d15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to Newcastle's bus drivers, and the RTBU has turned it down. The offer amounted to a 15.5% increase over 4 years with an extra 8% for Year 1 Trainees. The RTBU is angered by Keolis Downer rejecting basic safety proposals [

https://substack.com/redirect/c9c9a773-537f-407b-91c6-5e43a295c206?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This dispute isn't just about wages. Workers want fair wages, secure jobs and safe workplaces. According to the calendar of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/7c7c9415-c63f-4810-ad6a-4e9909cd910f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], only school bus runs will occur today (26/11) followed by a 12 hour strike on Thursday (27/11) and a 24 hour strike scheduled for Friday (28/11). The RTBU has advised that the planned actions could change [

https://substack.com/redirect/58e0086a-c27f-46af-91e8-ca35998ff590?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] should Keolis Downer put its substandard out to vote.

https://substack.com/redirect/58e0086a-c27f-46af-91e8-ca35998ff590?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] should Keolis Downer put its substandard out to vote.

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CPSU Tasmania - Child protection workers

Last Wednesday (19/11), child protection workers in Tasmania walked off the job in a one-hour stop work action. This was an escalation in industrial action for the workers in response to the "disrespectful" pay offer from the Rockliff Government and their approach to bargaining. The CPSU views the offer as "band aid solutions" to an ongoing recruitment and retention crisis [

https://substack.com/redirect/4a019bed-3f62-4a67-8773-52c1f1dc1a80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

https://substack.com/redirect/4a019bed-3f62-4a67-8773-52c1f1dc1a80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

https://substack.com/redirect/4a019bed-3f62-4a67-8773-52c1f1dc1a80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

https://substack.com/redirect/4a019bed-3f62-4a67-8773-52c1f1dc1a80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

HACSU Tasmania - Public sector health workers

Public sector health workers are also participating in industrial action against the Rockliff Government's miserable take it or leave it offer [https://substack.com/redirect/52fdf6e2-ed08-4f4f-b022-4ff925c16cc1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. On Monday (24/11) cardiac physiologists and neurophysiology scientists at the Royal Hobart Hospital walked off the job for 1 hour [https://substack.com/redirect/ff0bfc95-092b-42c5-9efd-8e4440d2e164?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; on Tuesday (25/11) pathology and allied health staff at the Launceston General Hospital walked off the job for 1 hour [

https://substack.com/redirect/7e86e039-7816-4b48-aaf5-e3d8045e57f5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; and today (26/11) medical imaging workers at the Royal Hobart Hospital will walk off the job for 1 hour. HACSU members are committed to fighting for a better deal, for themselves and Tasmania's health system.

https://substack.com/redirect/7e86e039-7816-4b48-aaf5-e3d8045e57f5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; and today (26/11) medical imaging workers at the Royal Hobart Hospital will walk off the job for 1 hour. HACSU members are committed to fighting for a better deal, for themselves and Tasmania's health system.

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ETU QLD - Coca-cola

On Friday (21/11) ETU members at the Richlands Coca-Cola facility were effectively locked out [

https://substack.com/redirect/2467a339-23d6-4064-8fe7-bcfed6431979?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of their workplace after the company refused to accept partial work bans. It is worth noting the partial work ban was a ban on using computers - so maintenance would still be carried out, it just wouldn't be recorded.

https://substack.com/redirect/2467a339-23d6-4064-8fe7-bcfed6431979?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of their workplace after the company refused to accept partial work bans. It is worth noting the partial work ban was a ban on using computers - so maintenance would still be carried out, it just wouldn't be recorded.

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https://substack.com/redirect/2467a339-23d6-4064-8fe7-bcfed6431979?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of their workplace after the company refused to accept partial work bans. It is worth noting the partial work ban was a ban on using computers - so maintenance would still be carried out, it just wouldn't be recorded.

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been in play for several weeks. Workers are fighting for 5% annual wage increases as well as higher penalty rates and overtime [https://substack.com/redirect/a4832d6f-254e-46c8-8b62-13141a06f43a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

The Services Union - Urban Utilities

Members of The Services Union at Urban Utilities will commence industrial action today [https://substack.com/redirect/bc775b98-cdd5-45af-8ad1-922376afe756?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (26/11). Urban Utilities—owned by the Brisbane, Ipswich, Scenic Rim, Somerset and Lockyer Valley councils—provides water and sewerage services to more than 1.6 million Queenslanders. Industrial action will include [https://substack.com/redirect/88504ffe-72e0-4071-9596-916ae7b3d1a8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] an indefinite ban on authorisations, approvals and certifications; adding EBA negotiation messages to official emails; wearing union t-shirts; refusing to work outside PDs and rolling 1-hour stoppages until Friday (28/11). Urban Utilities offered workers a 12% wage increase over 3 years - 70% of workers rejected the offer citing cost of living pressures, and the much more generous wage increases achieved by workers at many of the councils that own Urban Utilities.

TWU - GKR Transport

Long distance truck drivers are in the midst of a week-long strike. Drivers commenced strike action at midnight on Monday (24/11) with the action expected to continue until Sunday (30/11). As well as drivers refusing to work, drivers will also man picket lines [https://substack.com/redirect/26f39936-f702-44e1-ae7-c4c36b73ece3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] at depots in Truganina, Welshpool, Regency Park, Redbank and Villawood. Workers' demands are an additional 3% wage rise across the 3 year agreement; annual leave paid on the average of the previous six weeks' earnings, plus leave loading; a retention bonus and improved delegate rights embedded in the agreement. Negotiations were scheduled to resume yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/21e27df4-47f2-4a5a-b5e5-ae34dcfb30e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (25/11).

CFMEU Vic - CSR

The dispute at CSR continues [https://substack.com/redirect/31e4338e-fe51-44b1-9b87-821af72143f9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. A report on the [https://substack.com/redirect/00929b16-c80c-4cc8-be9c-ef0b9e7fa4cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] Concrete Gang [https://substack.com/redirect/00929b16-c80c-4cc8-be9c-ef0b9e7fa4cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] shared that solidarity visits are most appreciated from 6am - 6pm, Monday to Friday, at Whitehall Street, Yarraville. The report also shared that with workers out on strike the factory is struggling to produce products and management attempts to load trucks took 4 times as long as usual.

HSU WA - GenesisCare

On Friday (21/11), radiation therapists at GenesisCare held another stop work [https://substack.com/redirect/ae448256-bffd-4ebb-adb3-2f8b8920b394?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] - this time for 2 hours. Workers are fighting for a 7% increase or an increase in line with CPI - which ever is higher.

UWU QLD - Queensland Health

On Friday (21/11); UWU members employed by Queensland Health escalated their industrial campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/3f074af9-e5e2-4362-aae6-7123755e7832?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and rallied outside QH HQ. The action takes place after 6 months of failing negotiations. The Government wants to cut pay for some workers by up to 25% and make conditions worse for frontline health workers. Workers involved in the action include radiation therapists; imaging teams; pharmacists and clinical assistants.

AWU NSW & QLD - Holcim

Last week I reported on AWU members at Holcim cement [https://substack.com/redirect/42e8e18f-cdbb-4830-a64f-9e0f72421368?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in Swanbank (QLD) taking industrial action. Those workers were on strike for another 4 hours yesterday (25/11) in pursuit of a fair pay deal (6% in the first year, 3% in the second and third years). But in addition to the QLD dispute, on Thursday (20/11), the NSW Branch of the AWU reported that workers at Holcim's Albion Park Quarry were in the second full day of protected action [https://substack.com/redirect/f1069ec4-8cfc-487a-9755-709cf41f87d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Not many details were furnished - just that workers were fighting for a fair deal. Holcim is a multinational based in Switzerland that specialises in building materials (primarily cement). A press release in February described 2024 as a year of "record performance" from Holcim, and spoke of a "positive outlook" for Australia. So obviously the money is there to give workers a fair deal! Time for Holcim to come to the table and pay up.

UWU Vic - Graincorp

Following on from October's 24 hour strike, workers at Graincorp at Geelong and Portland ports struck

for 48 hours last week [https://substack.com/redirect/5d32fb23-a4a9-4c63-bb4d-a1b5ab22e609?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], commencing on 20 November. Graincorp has offered workers a below-inflation pay deal and are refusing to negotiate fairly. With harvest underway in Victoria, it's not a great time for Graincorp to delay shipments and have ships sitting idle. Negotiations and a fair deal would be a much better approach!

TWU QLD - ReGroup

Workers at the Re.Group recycling facility in Bli Bli have voted up a new agreement. This follows industrial action which commenced in August, including a 24 hour strike in October. This is the first EBA with the company, and secures the first above award wages any Re.Group workers have ever received. The new agreement incorporates the Waste Management Award, provides clearer classifications, and many improvements to conditions including improved consultation rights; paid quarterly union meetings; and additional training leave for delegates. The TWU's social media posts said that some members would gain an immediate 4.2% lift through reclassification. The media reported in August that workers were fighting for "a 7% annual pay and allowance increase [https://substack.com/redirect/543bcb70-5993-4008-a037-cb32316c53c4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" - not sure whether that has been realised. Regardless, a first EBA getting workers above award minimums is a great result.

RTBU NSW - Sydney Metro (MTS)

The RTBU has shared on social media that 96.92% of respondents have voted up the proposed EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/d6be5af2-d0ac-4a4a-89d8-354ff8332219?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at MTS. No other details on the deal have been released publicly - if you have details, let me know! RTBU members commenced industrial action in October [https://substack.com/redirect/8a4ac236-f21c-42ad-b4cd-5fe60bc5a103?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. That's all I've got time for this week! In closing, the RTBU put out a report this week about the lack of toilet and sanitary facilities available to women in the transport industry. It's a bloody mess [https://substack.com/redirect/4ab0246b-4ebf-4e17-8fcf-2691d056495b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is based on a survey of women working in the industry. It follows a 2021 report from the ETU about inadequate amenities for women in male dominated industries entitled Nowhere to go [https://substack.com/redirect/09c09195-38ed-465c-88ac-52e0ef5ac98d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The CFMEU spent 6 years fighting a legal battle [https://substack.com/redirect/baaf014b-38a0-45d3-8e43-4d6d3a1647bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] against the ABCC over an incident on a building site in Melbourne where workers refused to work until a toilet was provided for the sole woman on site [https://substack.com/redirect/f4cc9eb2-50f3-42be-8fca-7e625f825fb5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The union was initially fined \$50,500 over the action, but this was overturned on appeal [https://substack.com/redirect/c13212fd-ca8e-4d91-99f4-0b9e2a495b2b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A toilet was put on the site though! It does seem remarkable that bosses still resist providing adequate toilet facilities for workers. Perhaps more militant responses like those of the CFMEU are required?

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UYzVPEUXt1RFNUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05qUXhNREk0Tmrc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNU5UWXpPRGcyT1N3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hWaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAubUpWnRqa2hTX2RZnkpPRDNaaDdkQ2V5ZnlfZ2s0SzhVnU0RTB5WTNLZyIsInAiOjE3OTkxNTkxOSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImIldCI6MTc2NDEwMjg2OSwiZlhwIjoyMdc5Njc4ODY5L2Jpc3MiOiJwdWI6MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.f5AVkVW_WTqS5Y6GYfTcErwxDasZP004r30vJT_C-Sk?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-27-may>

ASMOF ACT - Canberra public hospital doctors

Doctors in Canberra's public hospital commenced industrial action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/95dbdb4c-6ec6-42c8-b127-e552deee9105?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (22/5). Industrial action commenced with low level activities such as wearing stickers and badges to work. Yesterday, ASMOF members stopped work for 15 minutes [https://substack.com/redirect/506e7ec4-8bbd-4bf7-82e6-361852d32728?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to talk to the media about their dispute, and started posting on social media as part of their campaign. Doctors are also refusing to use Microsoft Teams from yesterday (26/5) through to Thursday (28/5). 21 separate types of action were endorsed by members in their protected action ballot including administrative and meeting bans as well as campaign actions. ASMOF, along with other public sector unions in the ACT, have rejected the most recent offer from the territory government of 3% annual wage increases over 3 years and an additional 0.5% superannuation in the third year. ASMOF is demanding 6% annual wage increases, as well as more notice to junior doctors for rosters; better fatigue management and action to begin implementing doctor-to-patient ratios.

ASU/CPSU Vic - Parks Victoria

Union members at Parks Victoria participated in a 1 hour stop work [https://substack.com/redirect/6c8a0660-4dc0-4f42-97aa-39850c6ff99d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Monday (25/5), with many workers rallying outside Parks Victoria's HQ in Melbourne. This is the first time in 15 years [https://substack.com/redirect/779d68c8-6b31-4c70-85c6-f4fe4af31732?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that workers at the agency have taken industrial action. Unions have been in negotiations with Parks Victoria for more than a year. Executives at PV are paid at Victorian Public Service wage rates, but PV workers are not [https://substack.com/redirect/46148b57-5ac7-4dd2-a082-c56d9acc8ddc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a fair deal and the same pay and conditions as their colleagues in the Victorian public sector.

PSA NSW - Goulburn Correctional Centre

PSA members first at Goulburn Correctional Centre, and then at prisons across NSW walked off the job on Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/08d651a8-c9a7-4245-bbc4-019d33381f2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (21/5). The action disrupted court proceedings and prisons across the state. The PSA opposes the proposed closure of 2 maximum security wings of the Goulburn Correctional Centre fearing job losses. The state government argues that the "Victorian era" facilities are "outdated, unsafe and no longer fit for a modern correctional system" [https://substack.com/redirect/ddb0cbd1-297b-4995-8503-5e77405ffe97?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The prison wings in question (not the whole prison) opened in 1884 [https://substack.com/redirect/cd3311f9-bf28-454a-a668-bf2b673912f4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers at the Goulburn Correctional Centre encouraged PSA members at prisons across the state to also walk off the job due to the whole system being under pressure from a record number of prisoners [https://substack.com/redirect/2c9eca27-f40a-46d3-a66e-c9732168d2af?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Following discussions in the IRC on Thursday, industrial action has been suspended [https://substack.com/redirect/0fc0b3f5-323f-4eed-bcfe-7dcc05f24f23?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The Commissioner has undertaken to facilitate conciliation between the PSA and the state government. Interestingly (at least to me!) journalist and trade union leader James Vance Marshall is one of Goulburn prisons' former inmates. Vance was incarcerated in Goulburn in 1917 [https://substack.com/redirect/bd6a16e3-3793-47f8-b96c-43431fc434a9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for saying "soldiers in the war are the blind tools of the capitalist class" [https://substack.com/redirect/f9d4ef8b-dfa6-4cac-aca9-3bfe56d2bf87?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Vance wrote two books about the dreadful conditions in prison - Jail From Within and The World of the Living Dead both of which are informed by his time in Goulburn jail.

VAHPA - Public sector allied health workers

VAHPA members at public hospitals have commenced industrial action this week [https://substack.com/redirect/949ecc35-06f6-4d1f-a876-e3a5fe0bbccf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are refusing to work overtime, taking all entitled breaks, wearing campaign t-shirts, adding campaign materials to email signatures and displaying campaign materials in the workplace. Bans on billing or charging patients are also in place. The union has indicated that industrial action will "ramp up" with stop work action likely in June if the government doesn't make a decent offer. Negotiations have been underway

for 8 months, and the state government is yet to make an offer (let alone a decent one!). VAHPA members are calling for a 38.16% pay increase over 3 years as well as improvements to career progression frameworks and action on workload.

UWU - Early childhood educators

UWU early childhood educator members have voted in favour of strike action on 15 July [https://substack.com/redirect/99f77e32-d3f7-41f4-ad9d-0b61a262c4a2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are angry that the Federal Budget did not include an allocation to continue funding a 15% pay rise [https://substack.com/redirect/46665bde-bc17-4555-9a28-8b0c5faa8201?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] for early childhood educators. Without continuation of this funding, most early childhood educators face a “pay cliff” of 4-15% [https://substack.com/redirect/f037f41b-8f10-43d5-a6be-da3f1a86e14f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. UWU had previously threatened a mass walkout in 2024 [https://substack.com/redirect/9764a07f-ce9e-43d1-af0b-dcdd01d18cd2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], but this was suspended after the government committed to funding the pay increases. An important reminder that government commitments or promises are not legally enforceable. This is taking place with the backdrop of the contested UWU elections where some childcare members have spoken out against UWU’s strategy and reliance on government grants. The election [https://substack.com/redirect/7962921a-95b1-4867-a2b0-a9ab7cfff48d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] closes tomorrow (28 May).

In short

AEU ACT - ACT public school teachers & school assistants

ACT teachers and school assistants will strike for a full day on 11 June [https://substack.com/redirect/7f02a0f7-ab5b-4e1e-87c2-25e20c50bb3f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The announcement of further strike action was made at last week’s 2 hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/61548177-70c9-492b-97c7-f9d6101e8550?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The union has been in negotiations for 8 months already [https://substack.com/redirect/0785cf84-b710-43fe-9501-4ddbc0c35168?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Teachers are fighting for a decent pay increase, action on class sizes and workload and other improvements to conditions.

HSU NSW - SDPRIA

HSU members at the Single Digital Patient Record Implementation Authority (SDPRIA) held a stopwork meeting on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/21faeb71-2d4a-4ab7-b2f8-b8678e63e65c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (25/5) and discussed further industrial action. Workers are due to roll out single digital patient records at the Hunter New England Health District this week. The roll out is not going smoothly, and workers are facing burnout, overwork, non-stop pressure and unrealistic demands. I haven’t been able to find any other information about this one. Are you at SDPRIA or a HSU member? Get in touch.

MSAV - Public sector health professionals

MSAV have shared that 93% of members have said they are prepared to walk off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/8b54fad5-93f8-4ea8-bdf5-79ca15c8f54e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (again) to get a decent deal. And yesterday, a video on social media said a “big stoppage” is being prepared for in mid-June [https://substack.com/redirect/45ce7843-57d9-4f81-b775-d2b17c97b66e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Perhaps they can rally together with fellow HSU branch VAHPA? Stay tuned!

TWU WA - Brownes

I missed this last week, but TWU members at Brownes Dairy were locked out on 18 May [https://substack.com/redirect/31f6ccb7-d618-46c8-ba88-6ce2d677c8e2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The lockout continued until Sunday (24/5). This followed the TWU’s 82 hour strike [https://substack.com/redirect/06647654-7614-4081-8b81-f21c0aa62936?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] the week before. Negotiations have continued in the FWC this week. The union presented a revised position last Friday (22/5) and are expecting to hear a response this Friday (29/5).

Union news

TWU National Council

The TWU is holding its National Council meeting [https://substack.com/redirect/25035820-54d4-4494-96d0-76570ffb1166?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] in Canberra this week, and reaffirming its commitment to its Our Roads, Our Skies, Our Future campaign. The union has orchestrated the expiry of 200 EBAs [https://substack.com/redirect/657ef861-b765-454b-8b0f-e170f69dd1b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] from June 30 through to September. The union is seeking wage increases of up to 15-18% in the first year of some agreements. Secretary Michael Kaine has again warned that members are willing to take industrial action if their demands are not met. In addition to the National Council, yesterday (26/5) TWU

members in Canberra protested against Amazon Flex [https://substack.com/redirect/10d3781c-b4b2-4453-9be8-b5f45a1ef20e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] commencing delivery work with grocery store Harris Farm. Today (27/5) TWU members and officials will be protesting against Swissport at the Canberra airport [https://substack.com/redirect/25035820-54d4-4494-96d0-76570fffb1166?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

UFU Victoria - Allan Labor Government

At the Victorian Labor conference on the weekend, UFU members rallied outside with placards [https://substack.com/redirect/ac872378-4c10-4f24-beb2-bff55ab0d763?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] announcing: “Make Your Vote Count Put Labor Last”. The union’s website says [https://substack.com/redirect/9f26f5a0-4538-4aa2-a299-2b5b47476790?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]: “This November, when you cast your vote, remember who stood up for community safety and who stayed silent while the fire service was left behind.” The UFU filed an application for an intractable bargaining declaration back in 2023 and the dispute has dragged on and on since then. If the ALP can’t or won’t facilitate an acceptable deal for the firies, will any other party? Can an electoral strategy win an industrial dispute?

That’s all I’ve got this week. And yes, I did say I was going to have the week off, but then there wasn’t too much to report on this week and I managed to have enough time to get some writing done! I love putting this report together each week. I always learn something, and it’s a joy to share that with you.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWw0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UazVNekV5TkRVMEsDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056azRNekV4TVRjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE1UTTJOekV4Tn13aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkvV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbJAuZ21wam11RTRWUFFaUjQyOU9sU25KUKxtSUU0N2VfZ1FZT2h4R2hUT1QzOCIsInAiOjE5OTMxMjQ1NCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3OTgzMTEwNywiZXhwIjoyMDk1NDA3MTE3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.3_1Lbvz9CSTsAI2J95WEW2akvZ4aENli5sWM7vHpxME?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-28-january>

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Nurses will forge ahead with their planned demonstration [https://substack.com/redirect/8c9e69ab-290b-40be-82e3-43c9bb7a6d79?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on February 5th, first rallying at Parliament House before marching to SA Health at Hindmarsh Square. On 10 December the ANMF wrote to the state government outlining what would be an acceptable offer to their members, and requested a response by 22 December [https://substack.com/redirect/3aae10e6-c84c-4584-b04f-6f0f39a99948?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The government requested an extension until 23 January (I never remember getting a month's extension at school!) which the ANMF agreed to. The due date for a response has now passed, and the ANMF has not received a response [https://substack.com/redirect/c53a6539-d38c-466e-95a4-7ae06fabb33d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Unfortunately, it would seem if nurses and midwives in SA want a fair deal and respect, they are going to have to fight for it.

HWU - Public sector healthcare workers

I want to share two elements of the HWU's dispute with the Victorian state government that I missed last week when reporting their strike action. First, the HWU has called on the Premier to intervene in the dispute "before we are forced to escalate it. [https://substack.com/redirect/40c8fb4c-ddb4-446f-8e17-933479aac65e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" The union was set to apply to the Fair Work Commission to extend and likely escalate work bans before the current bans expire on 1 February. Second, lead organiser Jake McGuinness told the rally of striking workers that should the government not come to the table before the opening of the new Footscray Hospital (scheduled for 18 February), HWU members would "ruin" the Premier's ribbon-cutting as they did for the opening of the Frankston Hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/760e0929-5e67-418f-bdfa-537ed721c6f3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

AEU/CPSU/HACSU Tasmania - Tasmanian public sector workers

In another chaos inducing move from the Tasmanian state government, it was announced on 20 January, that the lead negotiator for multiple public sector agreements Norm McIlpatrick had resigned effective immediately [https://substack.com/redirect/d647fa52-2bc2-41e0-a401-2d42e500944a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. While it is understood McIlpatrick is ill, as the CPSU noted this is a continuation of "a bargaining process characterised by delays, cancelled meetings, an absence of decision-makers, and employer representatives repeatedly stating they had no instructions and no mandate to meaningfully engage with claims." [https://substack.com/redirect/8eb00ad6-388a-4dd5-959d-78db513b10d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] The CPSU has continued with "Wear Red Wednesdays" [https://substack.com/redirect/b4533d9d-3a01-451d-9bb8-4e26654a4e24?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], while HACSU has held one-hour stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/24ab1d57-1beb-416d-8e15-0106d5d25c15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last Wednesday (21/1) at West Coast District Hospital and Rosebery Community Health Centre. Yesterday (27/1), HACSU members at the Royal Hobart Hospital rejected the government's 3% pay offer and agreed to escalate to "stage 3 bans" [https://substack.com/redirect/b0624542-2eb6-4f45-a3ab-d115331e43dc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Sounds like we have hit an impasse.

CEPU/RTBU Tasmania - TasRail

On Friday (23 January), RTBU and CEPU members at TasRail struck for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/e0ec66c8-9853-4d42-83b9-ddba88f52ea3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] after failed bargaining meetings earlier in the week. TasRail has also threatened to stand down CEPU members for observing partial work bans like using hand tools or fault finding. The RTBU states [https://substack.com/redirect/e70e057b-2325-4682-b00f-52a7a317d331?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] "TasRail workers have reached a tipping point" as the state-owned company's "confrontational approach has only deepened frustration across the workforce".

CFMEU - Administration

Last Wednesday (21/1), Zach Smith, the National Secretary and appointed Victorian Executive Officer of the CFMEU, resigned [https://substack.com/redirect/d952e894-4e2d-4822-a793-50d6bd03cf94?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] citing personal reasons. Victorian Branch organiser, Lisa Zanatta, and former National Assistant Secretary Nigel Davies are now interim joint Branch Executive Officers [https://substack.com/redirect/96841720-a743-4e7f-b957-97da1c4eb8df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Rank and file activist group Democracy on Trial noted [https://substack.com/redirect/cac59ac6-2513-4532-8d85-4e22670f5e79?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that they welcomed the

resignation, arguing that under Smith's leadership "At the moment members needed leadership, resistance and resolve, they got acquiescence. His tenure was defined by collaboration with the Administration, the Labor Party and the ACTU, not by standing up for rank-and-file members. Time and again, workers were put last, while vested interests came first – especially Smith's own career interests." The statement went on to say "This resignation must be more than a changing of the guard. Members deserve a union that will fight for them, not manage their decline. To that end, we wish Lisa and Nigel every success." As for Smith's next steps - The Age notes "Smith has a range of long-term backers in the ACTU and the Labor Party and is likely to reappear within the labour movement." [[https://substack.com/redirect/d952e894-4e2d-4822-a793-50d6bd03cf94?](https://substack.com/redirect/d952e894-4e2d-4822-a793-50d6bd03cf94?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d952e894-4e2d-4822-a793-50d6bd03cf94?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] With Smith having now left the CFMEU, I believe WA Branch Secretary Mick Buchan [https://substack.com/redirect/ad18f5f6-d41a-432b-9ef3-b91c962e1925?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] is the only pre-administration senior leadership figure still working for the union.

In short

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer Hunter

Keolis Downer Hunter have lodged an Intractable Bargaining Application [[https://substack.com/redirect/92237eb5-6921-40ac-893b-ba6925f709c7?](https://substack.com/redirect/92237eb5-6921-40ac-893b-ba6925f709c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/92237eb5-6921-40ac-893b-ba6925f709c7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] with the FWC after over a year of negotiations with the RTBU representing bus drivers in and around Newcastle. A ballot on a proposed agreement opened on 8 January [[https://substack.com/redirect/386425aa-5804-41ef-8e87-8cca3ae46e9d?](https://substack.com/redirect/386425aa-5804-41ef-8e87-8cca3ae46e9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/386425aa-5804-41ef-8e87-8cca3ae46e9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] - the RTBU were recommending a no vote. Given the intractable bargaining application, the agreement must have been voted down. For more background on this dispute, you can search the Disputes Report archives!

MUA NSW - Certis Security

Security workers at Port Botany employed by Certis Security at DP World are fighting for a new EBA with decent wages and conditions. Certis rejected the union's claims, and workers moved to commence protected industrial action with a one-hour stoppage on Friday (23/1). Certis responded by attempting to bring in scabs to ensure operations continued. More than 100 workers from across the trade union movement turned up to support the right of workers [https://substack.com/redirect/32405500-e201-4944-86c4-0d361505692c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to take protected industrial action - and stopped operations at the security gates. The union has warned there will be more industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/1aa769d8-7a69-4a9d-ad16-f61aefd1df16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] if MUA members at Certis don't get a fair deal.

ETU NSW - Dynelec

On Friday (23/1), ETU members walked off the job and rallied outside Dynelec [[https://substack.com/redirect/5133dd60-7ea8-42f7-a866-9f1b9aadae46?](https://substack.com/redirect/5133dd60-7ea8-42f7-a866-9f1b9aadae46?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5133dd60-7ea8-42f7-a866-9f1b9aadae46?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. The action follows months of stalled negotiations. Workers are fighting for fair pay increases, basic safety allowances, proper support for apprentices and improved carers leave.

PABO Watch

AEU Vic - Public school teachers

As promised, yesterday (27/1) the AEU in Victoria lodged an application with the FWC for a protected action ballot order [[https://substack.com/redirect/9d177563-2419-43d4-85db-73a1a2926017?](https://substack.com/redirect/9d177563-2419-43d4-85db-73a1a2926017?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9d177563-2419-43d4-85db-73a1a2926017?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)].

ANMF Vic - Cabrini Hospital

The ANMF is urging members at Cabrini Hospital to vote yes in the protected action ballot [[https://substack.com/redirect/ccaae9d4-578f-4171-b3e4-8da5266a3baf?](https://substack.com/redirect/ccaae9d4-578f-4171-b3e4-8da5266a3baf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ccaae9d4-578f-4171-b3e4-8da5266a3baf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] that opened yesterday (27/1).

Wins/resolutions

HACSU Vic - Forensicare

HACSU has reported [[https://substack.com/redirect/75d2db6b-1332-4e1a-a828-f6a509d5923e?](https://substack.com/redirect/75d2db6b-1332-4e1a-a828-f6a509d5923e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/75d2db6b-1332-4e1a-a828-f6a509d5923e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)] that industrial action at Forensicare will be suspended from Thursday (29/1) as members have voted to endorse an offer from the state government. Workers have been successful in their aim for an alignment payment to match the Public Mental Health Pay Increases effective from 20 May 2025.

ANMF Vic - Healthscope

On Thursday (22/1) a members' meeting of Healthscope ANMF members voted in favour of an updated proposal from Healthscope [[https://substack.com/redirect/f693f0f0-f080-4aa6-a15c-308973878379?](https://substack.com/redirect/f693f0f0-f080-4aa6-a15c-308973878379?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f693f0f0-f080-4aa6-a15c-308973878379?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)]. A ballot of all Healthscope workers will now be prepared to vote on the agreement. The proposal includes wage increases of 4.25% (1 July 2025); 2.25% (1 January 2026); 4.25% (1 July 2026); 1% (1 January 2027) and 4.25% (1 July 2027). Workers will receive backpay, and also market adjustments to some classifications as of July 2025 and 2026. One of the key issues in the dispute was a proposed salary packaging scheme that would see up to 90% of employee salary packaging benefits go to "paying for Healthscope's operational

costs, including servicing corporate debt.” [https://substack.com/redirect/74630581-2d12-4028-a2e3-1fa213131185?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] The fix on that appears to be making the scheme an opt-in one, but I do not have a lot of detail on this, so there could be more to it than meets the eye! If you know more, let me know. ANMF members sustained approximately 85 days of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/555c75b5-64cb-4b2c-bb89-bd81286cc23d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in pursuit of this agreement.

That’s all I’ve got this week. I’ve run a bit short on time this week, so have had to carry a few updates over to next week. I still feel a bit like I’m in holiday mode! Please get in touch if anything is brewing at your workplace this year. Next week it will be February, school will be back and the year will really kick off in earnest.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UZzFPVFE1TnpBekxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05qazFORFl6T0Rrc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd01UQTRNak00T1N3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hWaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAuNWNhYzVyODBreDRPMdJ4cVVEb1VmemxqV1RMUzNFbDJwcHBaazI3dTlxOCIsInAiOjE4NTk0OTcwMywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc2OTU0NjM4OSwiZXhwIjoyMDg1MTIyMzg5LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.t8jzrUAwz_ZpzArMbTPt-yuvGRAZPEoKTn3ygNqqkqw?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-28-may>

TWU VIC - CDC & Dyson

Over 800 bus drivers are striking today [https://substack.com/redirect/1fc4bcf1-e6c3-4729-8226-223c55b1ab77?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (28/5). TWU members at CDC and Dyson bus companies will participate in a joint 24 hour stoppage as part of their campaign to demand action on safety, decent wages and respect at work. According to the TWU the action will cause disruptions to a third of all bus routes in Victoria.

AWU NSW - Snowy 2.0

It is understood workers at Snowy 2.0 will strike for 24 hours again today [https://substack.com/redirect/28eb0f9a-a240-4512-a10a-89571ed87390?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (28/5), following a similar strike last week (21/5). The AWU is also reportedly considering legal action [https://substack.com/redirect/da7968be-8eee-42fb-9521-0e6f8915415e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] after striking workers were essentially locked down during the strike, unable to leave the project or even use crib rooms. Workers are fighting for pay parity with tunnelling crews in metro Melbourne, as well as improved allowances and conditions.

CFMEU VIC - BMS

The BMS crane crew at Golden Plains Wind Farm commenced industrial action on Thursday (22/5). The CFMEU has been attempting to negotiate a national EBA for workers on wind farms, but BMS has refused to negotiate in good faith. Workers are fighting for decent wages; a living away from home allowance; roster flexibility; and improved allowances, leave and conditions. Importantly, workers are also seeking appropriate inclement weather provisions to ensure safety on site.

UWU SA- Public sector health workers

Public sector health care workers at Flinders Medical Centre walked off the job for 30 minutes last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/adcb7f4b-ec2c-4d8e-bafb-91c28c5a21cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (21/5). The stoppage is part of a statewide campaign for fair wages, secure jobs, action on workload, and safety. Workers across the state have been participating in industrial action and work bans since February. Workers are asking supporters to sign a petition [https://substack.com/redirect/e48aa0de-b7ca-426f-880e-9077198e2482?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

AMWU/AWU/CEPU SA - BAE Systems

Last Thursday (22/5), workers from BAE Systems at the Osborne Naval Shipyard walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/228a7f39-24b1-4086-b354-6abcf397720e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and rallied at BAE headquarters in Adelaide. Workers at BAE are paid 20% less than others in the shipbuilding industry. They have been participating in industrial action since September last year in pursuit of a 30% pay increase over 3 years. BAE has refused to budget from their offer of 12% over 3 years.

APANSW - NSW Ambulance

Australian Paramedics Association NSW members commenced industrial action on May 6 [https://substack.com/redirect/c22c607e-b5df-492c-b6fb-0a5558099bb4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] in relation to NSW Ambulance and NSW Health's pilot program, the Mental Health Clinician Responder Team (MHCRT). Under the industrial action, APANSW members refused to take part in any training, logistics, or vehicle movements connected to the rollout of the MHCRT. APANSW says the MHCRT pilot "redirects a small and highly specialised group of paramedics away from critical rescue and high-risk response roles to staff an untested model." [https://substack.com/redirect/c366307a-8d19-41da-9a4e-e86412bfd3bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] On 12 May, the NSW IRC ordered that the industrial action must cease [https://substack.com/redirect/35fa9a75-504e-4aaf-b71e-fa3cfcf35a93?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] following an application made by NSW Ambulance.

CFMEU QLD - Qube

To punish workers for taking industrial action, Qube has announced a restructure [https://substack.com/redirect/4a4a0bab-7d97-4fd0-8fde-dbe43d94c71c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] of its mobile crane division. The company has also advised workers there will be redundancies, and stood down a CFMEU delegate. This is shameful behaviour (even for Qube): pushing a sham restructure process to discipline workers and get rid of the union. Qube workers are fighting for market rates and a fair deal.

ASU Vic - Brimbank City Council

The ASU is encouraging workers at Brimbank City Council to vote no to management's proposed EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/1931c151-db6e-4456-9678-a86b6c42481c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. A majority of workers at the

council have signed the ASU's petition to join with 9 other councils (Darebin, Greater Dandenong, Hobsons Bay, Hume, Maribyrnong, Melbourne, Merri-bek, Port Phillip and Yarra) and pursue multi-employer bargaining (MEB). To try to avoid MEB, Brimbank City Council has put forward an agreement with no negotiations. If it is voted up, Brimbank City Council will not be able to join in on MEB. The ASU is putting considerable resources into the MEB campaign. 8 councils (Brimbank, Darebin, Hume, Maribyrnong, Melbourne, Merri-bek, Port Phillip and Yarra) are fighting the union's application for MEB [https://substack.com/redirect/fffab2af-b30b-4fd5-bebd-9b42d351f412?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

VAHPA - I-MED

Last Thursday (22/5) workers at I-MED radiology clinics in Werribee, Hoppers Crossing and Wyndham [https://substack.com/redirect/00804e59-4f1f-4880-a907-d824588630f3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] held a 2 hour stoppage. Workers at

68 I-MED clinics across Victoria are in negotiations for an agreement with a decent wage increased and improved conditions. I-MED is crying poor, despite being on track to record \$1.35 billion in revenue for FY ending 30 June 2025. VAHPA has said there will be more stoppages at radiology clinics across Victoria, and will escalate if I-MED doesn't make a decent offer.

UWU - Allied Pinnacle

No confirmation from official sources, but I have heard that Allied Pinnacle workers will be back on strike indefinitely from 6am this morning (28/5). If this is correct, I am sure visits to 23-29 Pinnacle Road, Altona North would be welcomed.

QNMU - Public sector nurses & midwives

96.5% of QNMU of participants voted YES in a protected industrial action ballot [

https://substack.com/redirect/baea7893-6f0f-40b7-a8bb-ac071dd2c47c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which closed on Monday. However,

the QNMU advised that despite the letter from the Queensland Health [https://substack.com/redirect/a9f4af80-121f-4bf5-ab2b-f3215355ad99?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which firmly stated there would be

no revised offer, the government sent through a revised offer on Friday (23/5). The new offer contains some improvements, but no change to the proposed wage increase. The QNMU has told members that they are meeting with Queensland Health this week to seek clarification on some items in the revised offer, as well as to push for "further improvements".

UWU Vic - Avalon Airport

Security guards at Avalon Airport have had significant wins in the negotiation of their first EBA. Workers will get pay rises equivalent to 16% in the first year of the agreement, and in July casual workers will start converting to full time, permanent jobs. Workers at Avalon took industrial action in March as part of their campaign for this EBA.

ETU QLD/UWU - XXXX & ETU QLD - Downer

There are two other dispute resolutions to report on this week - XXXX and Downer. For the full scoop from local sources- check out the May Edition of [https://substack.com/redirect/ac12b6f4-20ec-4721-9dc1-1c74ce125cfc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]Hard Hat [https://substack.com/redirect/ac12b6f4-20ec-4721-9dc1-1c74ce125cfc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Self-described as for construction workers, by construction workers the Brisbane based newsletter/substack is a rank and file initiative and worth a read whether you know your way around a construction site or not. That's all I've got this week. Thanks to the comrades who assisted with this week's report. And please, if you've got any information (or hot takes!) please get in touch! You can email me [<mailto:mssarahmissen@gmail.com>], or send a message on socials. The best part of this project is hearing from workers on the shopfloor.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UWTBOVFUxTmBNuXDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05EZ3pPREU0TURFc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM09Ua3h0emd3TVN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlxbHNjbjAuV2YxNEJCLTNvbEtVcjM0WjRScTRFUC10cDVhew1pTE5PUUlaTV9KX2ZuayIsInAiOjE2NDU1NTYwOSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImldCI6MTc0ODM4MTgwMSwiZXhwIjoxNzUwOTczODAxLCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.BJLZiQEYOw6BwKz2tdJAPJqwypHikBQF_a9q9JewR2k?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-29-april>

NTEU Vic - RMIT

On Thursday (23/4), RMIT UP teachers and team leaders took strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/fec91e6a-fe4f-4997-b0ec-57009683b1dd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. RMIT UP (University Pathways) is an international education provider which provides “pathway programs” and English language classes for international students to prepare for university. Workers at RMIT UP have not received a pay increase since 2022 [https://substack.com/redirect/b062d312-e68e-4cd5-bacf-ed44be2b29b1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and do not receive the same level of superannuation as other RMIT employees. Management refused to negotiate, so strike action was taken. I would love to hear more about this dispute if any RMIT workers (or students!) are reading.

TWU WA - Brownes Dairy

On Thursday (23/4), TWU members at Brownes in WA commenced a second round of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/2810b114-be6e-4d39-9a26-ab3f69868e9a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with rolling stoppages over 2 days. This follows initial strike action on 1 April. Brownes Dairy is for sale after its holding company was put into receivership. Securing a low wages deal will assist in getting a higher price for the business. The CEO of Brownes shared that annual revenue increased by 10% [https://substack.com/redirect/bc3545da-f7fc-4f8c-86e8-3fad265c7a15?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] last year as exports increased. Plenty of money to be made for everyone but workers it would seem. Since commencing industrial action, the TWU reports that negotiations have grown more hostile. There have been 9 bargaining meetings since December, but the current offer from Brownes will see workers wages erode over the life of the agreement.

TWU Tasmania - Kinetic

On Thursday (23/4), TWU members at Kinetic walked off the job for two hours [https://substack.com/redirect/902ba489-e65a-4f9a-8288-4dec0762219b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The bus drivers have been in dispute with Kinetic since November last year. Currently, Kinetic bus drivers are the worst paid in the country [https://substack.com/redirect/e56335c5-4c18-4f74-98fe-a71c9d5c2312?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] earning up to \$6.40 less an hour than their counterparts at Metro [https://substack.com/redirect/1eaba841-a2a4-40ca-a421-83d740f7a89a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Metro and Kinetic are both contracted by the state government to run public bus services, including school bus routes. While the government refuses to get involved, the TWU believes ultimately the buck stops with them. While this stoppage was during the school holidays, minimising disruptions, the union has warned [https://substack.com/redirect/39b62e2d-151e-43c5-82b8-2ae44a3a244f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] bigger and more disruptive strike action could take place if a fair pay deal is not reached.

RAFFWU - Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books

Berkelouw Books has announced the closure [https://substack.com/redirect/36321fe4-7335-47c7-9744-0a56f7e23443?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] of its store in Norton Street Leichardt - where according to RAFFWU “almost all” workers were involved in recent industrial action including the 4 day strike before [https://substack.com/redirect/fc736821-770e-495b-8164-5a154c65b440?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] Christmas. The fallout from that industrial action is still continuing. While bargaining broke down, management put a proposed agreement out for vote. The bosses claim the agreement was voted up with 92 votes in favour, and 91 votes against - the thinnest of thin margins. Smart Company interviewed Josh Cullinan (RAFFWU’s director of strategic litigation) who said “the employers allege their dodgy deal was voted up by one vote, but that vote was impugned for many reasons.” [https://substack.com/redirect/f0fb2637-77f0-411e-ac82-a04ce8339554?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] In addition to that, RAFFWU has also started proceedings alleging unlawful adverse action was taken against RAFFWU members - roster changes and loss of shifts - for participating in industrial action. To add the list of RAFFWU’s issues with Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books is the closure of the Leichardt store. The store closure was not mentioned at all during bargaining and workers were only advised a few weeks before the closure date. Very suss.

ASU SA - City of Adelaide

Last Tuesday (21/4) ASU members from the City of Adelaide rallied in Victoria Square. ASU members are not satisfied with the current offer made by the city council. Workers are committed to fighting for a fair wage increase that keeps up with the cost of living.

CPSU (& others) - ACT public sector

ACT public sector workers are set to rally this Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/7973aa25-84c9-4e11-b1f0-f169b538d8c9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (1 May) as part of their EBA campaign. In March, CPSU members voted down an offer [https://substack.com/redirect/ef357e28-106f-48ff-9917-d1b3608732af?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the state government which included a 9% wage increase over 3 years (3%, 3%, 3%). The CPSU is demanding 12% over 3 years (5%, 4%, 3%). The CPSU is also seeking to insert clauses about AI into the agreement - both in terms of how AI is used for work and for surveillance - but the government is refusing any mention of AI at this stage. Workers are also unhappy with proposed changes to the timing of scheduled pay and superannuation increases. Several unions are involved in these negotiations and have members covered by the agreement including AEU, ANMF, ASMOF, CFMEU, ETU, PPTEU and TWU. The current agreement expired on 31 March [https://substack.com/redirect/4ccac8fb-9f63-43fc-ba35-57c15d7a854a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and negotiations have been underway since mid-way through 2025.

ASU SA - Women's Legal Service SA

A reader has let me know that ASU members at Women's Legal Service SA commenced industrial action yesterday (28/4). Workers at the service are fighting for their first agreement, and have got their EBA campaign off the ground through a majority support determination. Workers are fighting to secure the basics like above award wages and paid parental leave. Bosses are not cooperating, so "low level" protected industrial action has started, with a plan for escalation over the next month. I don't have specific details on the actions in progress, but you can see the PABO [https://substack.com/redirect/2ee21656-7b03-4916-a16a-216ea5443de9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] results here which gives you an idea of what might be happening.

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

Yesterday evening (28/4), the AFR announced that the Victorian government is "preparing" to make an offer to teachers of a 28% wage increase over 4 years [https://substack.com/redirect/574c12e8-f0df-46a2-a9b3-101d0281c6ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This is less than what teachers have been aiming for (35% over 3 years) but an improvement on the last offer of 17% over 4 years. No other details of the offer have been publicly released. School teachers in Victoria were set to kick off rolling stoppages from next week, but whether this offer will change those plans remains to be seen. But, if one day of strike action increased the pay increase by 11%... could a few more half day stoppages get the job done? Unless you hear otherwise, first cab off the rank for the half day stoppages are teachers in the Maribyrnong, Broadmeadows and Sunbury regions. Get along to support the teachers in their morning half day strike if you can: Wednesday 6 May, 10am, Ben Carroll's Office, 473 Keilor Road, Niddrie.

ANMF Victoria - School nurses

This morning (29/4) ANMF members who work as school nurses will commence industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/22c7ff40-3a86-4569-a030-1e65ba68c160?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The bans are low level at this stage including stopping work to share campaign materials with parents or members of the general public; wearing ANMF campaign gear; a ban on providing information to management about who is participating in industrial action; and refusal to be redeployed from one area to another. School nurses are seeking improvements in pay and conditions to reach parity with public sector nurses. Negotiations with the state government have reached a stalemate, and as such nurses have commenced this action.

Phlebotomists Council of Australia - Dorevitch

Phlebotomists at Dorevitch pathology are set to walk off the job tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/cab55155-6886-45d2-ba6a-3026acf503e6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (30/4). Members of the Phlebotomists Council of Australia (PCA) have been participating in work bans for a month including limiting processing to one patient blood test per hour. In an escalation of their campaign, members will walk off the job for three hours (9am - 12noon). The PCA have been negotiating with Dorevitch over the past year, and management have put unacceptable offers to workers 3 times. Each time, it has been rejected. Time for Dorevitch to come to the table with a decent offer for workers.

In short

PPTEU Victoria - Downer EDI

Very scant details, but PPTEU members in the water main industry employed by Downer EDI stopped work on Friday (24/4) as part of their campaign for better conditions. Know more? Let me know.

QNMU - Mater

Yesterday (28/4), Mater commenced balloting nurses and midwives on their revised offer [https://substack.com/redirect/8656a73e-e3af-40bd-b0b4-94a54fefdb96?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The QNMU doesn't appear to be publicly endorsing a yes vote, or explicitly calling for a no vote, but their social media posts [https://substack.com/redirect/64510e47-7562-4602-acc9-b9c11115f9c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] do say “It’s important to remember under this offer 40% of Mater nurses and midwives would be up to \$4500 a year worse off than colleagues at Queensland Health and Ramsay...” which sounds like a no to me!

AWU Vic - Wilmar BioEthanol Yarraville

AWU members at Wilmar BioEthanol in Yarraville had notified management of a 5 day forklift ban [[https://substack.com/redirect/71dbfbce-97cd-486b-999f-981df899d951?](https://substack.com/redirect/71dbfbce-97cd-486b-999f-981df899d951?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Bosses responded by saying they would dock workers’ entire wages for this partial ban. Workers have stood together and instead did not attend work for the duration of the ban at all. Nobody is going to work for free! No other details except that bosses’ behaviour at the negotiation table has been “unproductive and unsatisfactory”.

RTBU QLD - Queensland Rail

The RTBU received an offer from Queensland Rail which they described as disappointing. The offer would see workers receive wage increases that would not keep up with inflation, as well as increasing hours for some, whilst reducing their penalty rates. A video message [[https://substack.com/redirect/e20efc0f-cf0b-4f3a-b043-66755a82c4ac?](https://substack.com/redirect/e20efc0f-cf0b-4f3a-b043-66755a82c4ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the RTBU stated that the industrial campaign would continue, and maybe escalate. Media reports [[https://substack.com/redirect/53f0dafb-9985-4a44-a1f7-d0317e10de4d?](https://substack.com/redirect/53f0dafb-9985-4a44-a1f7-d0317e10de4d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] say that industrial action will take place over the next two weeks, including by maintenance workers and signallers.

ASU Vic - Melbourne metro councils

A quick reminder about the Melbourne council workers strike rally. It is taking place on Tuesday (5 May) [[https://substack.com/redirect/a7c6441a-52ca-4664-928e-7b814a9878a1?](https://substack.com/redirect/a7c6441a-52ca-4664-928e-7b814a9878a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with workers gathering outside Trades Hall at 10am. Please get along if you can! The bin bans [[https://substack.com/redirect/6aa951db-1ad8-412e-b5c7-47e7f757725c?](https://substack.com/redirect/6aa951db-1ad8-412e-b5c7-47e7f757725c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] across the 8 councils have been paused for the fortnight leading up to the strike, but other bans and actions are ongoing.

HACSU Victoria - Possability

HACSU Disability workers in Aarat and Stawell will strike and rally today (29/4). This is part of continued protected industrial action by members at NDIS provider Possability. This action is in response to the mass closure of disability homes caused by the cutting of state government subsidies. 26 homes in the Stawell and Aarat regions are facing closure. If you’re in Aarat or Stawell today, get along to these rallies at the town halls; Aarat at 11am and Stawell at 1:30pm.

PABO Watch

ETU NSW - Stowe

ETU members at Stowe have overwhelmingly voted in favour of [[https://substack.com/redirect/3ff1c40c-f30d-4958-bded-20357ba3cc99?](https://substack.com/redirect/3ff1c40c-f30d-4958-bded-20357ba3cc99?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] taking industrial action. Stowe is NSW biggest electrical contractor. There is a lot of strategy going on in the electrical sector in NSW with both the union and employers strategically using multi-employer agreement applications [[https://substack.com/redirect/452d7827-2fa8-4cea-82fb-bbf1e82e3385?](https://substack.com/redirect/452d7827-2fa8-4cea-82fb-bbf1e82e3385?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to try and better their bargaining positions. I’m going to limit my commentary on that because this is a disputes report, not a 3D chess/FWC report. Suffice to say, I watch on with interest. Current offer from Stowe is a 5% wage increase on a 12 month extension of the current agreement and a \$15 per day travel allowance from May. The ETU’s list of claims includes a 6% wage increase [[https://substack.com/redirect/52683d73-6683-467e-9d3e-93dd38477592?](https://substack.com/redirect/52683d73-6683-467e-9d3e-93dd38477592?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

NTEU Tas - University of Tasmania

Workers at the University of Tasmania (UTAS) have been in bargaining for 6 months [[https://substack.com/redirect/c7d5e97b-d748-4299-b13a-91ae8cc6b35b?](https://substack.com/redirect/c7d5e97b-d748-4299-b13a-91ae8cc6b35b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and the bosses are yet to provide a wage increase offer. Frustrated with the lack of progress, NTEU members have voted in favour of industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/7955f198-4979-4311-b4e7-a347f357b9af?](https://substack.com/redirect/7955f198-4979-4311-b4e7-a347f357b9af?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. In addition to wages, key issues for workers [[https://substack.com/redirect/dec4d970-6a94-4b3c-95d4-71a72173600d?](https://substack.com/redirect/dec4d970-6a94-4b3c-95d4-71a72173600d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] include UTAS’s rejection of the NTEU’s proposed AI guardrails, and management’s consistent gymnastics to try and avoid flexible working arrangements being included in the agreement. NTEU Tasmanian Division Secretary Dr Ruth Barton has said it is now up to university management to decide when to resume negotiations. Workers are seeking a 20% wage increase over 4 years. UTAS staff are the lowest paid university workers in the country.

AWU/MUA WA - Inpex

“Offshore Alliance” members (AWU & MUA) have voted in favour of industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/b6f8f8e2-854d-4cf7-8741-6582ba46926b?](https://substack.com/redirect/b6f8f8e2-854d-4cf7-8741-6582ba46926b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] at Inpex. Between 99%-100% of voting members endorsed each of the 26 actions proposed by the union. While industrial action could start as soon as 7 May, all parties have agreed to six, full-day facilitated meetings at the FWC between 5 and 15 May, and the unions have agreed not to commence industrial action during this time. Perhaps the threat alone of industrial action is enough to get Inpex to the table and make a decent offer. Stay tuned.

CPSU Vic - Ravenhall and Fulham Correctional Centres

CPSU members at Ravenhall and Fulham are set to vote in a ballot for protected industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/b2d7bf79-da79-4c8a-a3eb-33a58a9ddf05?](https://substack.com/redirect/b2d7bf79-da79-4c8a-a3eb-33a58a9ddf05?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]. The Victorian state government has outsourced the running of Ravenhall and Fulham to GEO Group, a for-profit operator of prisons in the US, UK, South Africa and Australia. One key issue shared by the CPSU on social media is that correctional officers employed by GEO Group are currently only entitled to 2 weeks paid parental leave as a primary caregiver. CPSU members want 8 weeks; GEO Group refuses to budge past 4 weeks. Wins/Resolutions

AEU Tasmania - Public sector agreement

On Monday (27/4), the AEU shared that 72% of members who participated in the poll voted in favour of the latest offer [[https://substack.com/redirect/7783f01f-6064-456e-bd3c-52035f9adba0?](https://substack.com/redirect/7783f01f-6064-456e-bd3c-52035f9adba0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] from the state government. This means a new agreement for teachers, psychologists, education support specialists, school leaders, family learning centres and DECYP staff. The agreement includes pay rises of 8.75%-9.01% over the life of the agreement; improved reproductive leave and family and domestic violence leave; 5 “personal impact days” to manage the impact of critical incidents and vicarious trauma and other improvements and commitments [[https://substack.com/redirect/24ac8b26-5ce1-4945-90c3-70bcc876a13d?](https://substack.com/redirect/24ac8b26-5ce1-4945-90c3-70bcc876a13d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]. You can look at the full details here [[https://substack.com/redirect/a681d099-dea2-43fe-82c4-588f651499db?](https://substack.com/redirect/a681d099-dea2-43fe-82c4-588f651499db?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]. The wages component is in step with other public sector groups who also participated in industrial action (HACSU and CPSU members).

Union news

CFMEU Administration

On Monday evening (27/4), The Age reported that CFMEU Administrator Mark Irving resigned [[https://substack.com/redirect/e779c5d8-7c39-45a6-8b1b-dffe494a83a5?](https://substack.com/redirect/e779c5d8-7c39-45a6-8b1b-dffe494a83a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]. In a statement provided to The Age Irving said “it was more appropriate for a unionist rather than a barrister to lead the next stage of union reform”. Close, but no cigar Mark. Obviously the only person who has any business leading a construction union is a construction worker. It seems to be an increasingly old-fashioned point of view that a union should be run by workers from the relevant industry. Michael Crosby, who will be filling Irving’s chair while the FWC finds a replacement, doesn’t think experience in the construction industry is a necessary qualification. According to the AFR [[https://substack.com/redirect/0c8a5d31-d3ab-421f-994c-a4fae720e426?](https://substack.com/redirect/0c8a5d31-d3ab-421f-994c-a4fae720e426?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] when asked if he had enough industry experience he responded “Construction is not that hard to understand... I’m not worried about that at all.” Crosby has been Executive Officer of the NSW Branch for about 12 months. While he is acting as Administrator, Karma Lord, the brains behind HospoVoice’s ill-fated tiered membership model [[https://substack.com/redirect/1cbf77b1-5a18-4477-92aa-44ecd22b4c11?](https://substack.com/redirect/1cbf77b1-5a18-4477-92aa-44ecd22b4c11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM], will be overseeing the NSW Branch. Nigel Davies and Lisa Zanatta (the first construction workers mentioned in this paragraph) who have been overseeing the Victorian Branch have been sidelined in favour of former NTEU Secretary Matt McGowan. So is this shuffling deck chairs on the Titanic, or the ACTU lining up their preferred leadership for the future?

May Day

May 1 is May Day. In some Australian states May Day is a big deal, in others less so. We do not do a good job overall of marking May Day on May 1. I wonder if the answer to this is taking inspiration from UAW comrades in America and the multi-year plan of lining up contracts to enable a mass strike on May 1, 2028 [[https://substack.com/redirect/64f723eb-a4da-4cbe-be15-139f6bf5ce5d?](https://substack.com/redirect/64f723eb-a4da-4cbe-be15-139f6bf5ce5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]? There is definitely untapped potential for us here in Australia for May Day! There is a really special reason to celebrate this year as this May Day marks the 80th anniversary of the start of the 1946 Pilbara Strike [[https://substack.com/redirect/351187c5-7cd4-4de5-8889-16c2689aeb88?](https://substack.com/redirect/351187c5-7cd4-4de5-8889-16c2689aeb88?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] - the longest strike in Australian history and one hell of an amazing yarn. If you can’t get along to a May Day event this year (I’ve attempted to collate a list below), maybe spend the weekend reading Anne Scrimgeour’s book about the dispute: “On Red Earth Walking [[https://substack.com/redirect/4fealcb5-f796-42b2-99e4-8d55d8e4d6fb?](https://substack.com/redirect/4fealcb5-f796-42b2-99e4-8d55d8e4d6fb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]”.

Adelaide [[https://substack.com/redirect/73717399-e2dc-407e-a8ca-3cdc5a9ac804?](https://substack.com/redirect/73717399-e2dc-407e-a8ca-3cdc5a9ac804?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 2nd May, 10am, Victoria Square / Tarntanyangga, Adelaide, SA
Alice Springs [[https://substack.com/redirect/8b6e7651-38c0-4cab-8c7a-c700e85634cd?](https://substack.com/redirect/8b6e7651-38c0-4cab-8c7a-c700e85634cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 10am, Alice Springs Library, Alice Springs, NT
Bowen [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 8:30am, Australia Post, 46 Herbert Street, Bowen, QLD
Brisbane [[https://substack.com/redirect/d18253be-0a3d-4bd4-bc2f-95cc76547844?](https://substack.com/redirect/d18253be-0a3d-4bd4-bc2f-95cc76547844?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 9:30am, Cnr Turbot and Wharf Street, Spring Hill
Bundaberg [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 2nd May, 10am, Riverside Parklands, 1 Quay St, Bundaberg, QLD
Cairns [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 2nd May, 9am, Fogarty Park, 42-50 Esplanade, Cairns, QLD
Canberra [[https://substack.com/redirect/7973aa25-84c9-4e11-b1f0-f169b538d8c9?](https://substack.com/redirect/7973aa25-84c9-4e11-b1f0-f169b538d8c9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 1st May, 1pm, Civic Square
Darwin [[https://substack.com/redirect/d6851cd1-e35d-4dfb-920a-16963a2b1c32?](https://substack.com/redirect/d6851cd1-e35d-4dfb-920a-16963a2b1c32?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 10am, Unions NT, 38 Wood Street, Darwin, NT
Fremantle [[https://substack.com/redirect/d331b822-2280-45bd-b74c-271a96edfbdc?](https://substack.com/redirect/d331b822-2280-45bd-b74c-271a96edfbdc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 3rd May, 10am, Fremantle Esplanade, WA
Gladstone [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 10am, 58 Central Lane, Gladstone Central, QLD
Gold Coast [[https://substack.com/redirect/8d19e06f-66e4-4206-8b70-3777f191ace2?](https://substack.com/redirect/8d19e06f-66e4-4206-8b70-3777f191ace2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 3rd May, 10am, Pratten Park, Broadbeach
Ipswich [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 2nd May, 12pm Timothy Molony Oval, 2A Elizabeth St, Woodend, QLD
Mackay [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 9:45am, Corner of River and Gregory Street, Mackay, QLD
Maryborough [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 3rd May, 10am, 98 Wharf Street, Maryborough, QLD
Melbourne [[https://substack.com/redirect/d554339b-627a-492f-b873-91100042b6ed?](https://substack.com/redirect/d554339b-627a-492f-b873-91100042b6ed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 3rd May, 1pm, Trades Hall, Melbourne VIC
Newcastle [[https://substack.com/redirect/d2c0c6bf-a4b9-4b61-ab86-64985331419b?](https://substack.com/redirect/d2c0c6bf-a4b9-4b61-ab86-64985331419b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 3rd May, 9:30am, Newcastle Museum; Newcastle, NSW
Parramatta [[https://substack.com/redirect/a2e9aea3-15d3-47b3-922b-b561195da52a?](https://substack.com/redirect/a2e9aea3-15d3-47b3-922b-b561195da52a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 3rd May, 11am, Prince Alfred Square, Parramatta, NSW
Rockhampton [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 9am, Woods Park, 1 Miles Street, Berserker, QLD
Sunshine Coast [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 3rd May, 10am, Caloundra Sharks Rugby League Football Club, Gregory Street, Golden Beach, QLD
Sydney [[https://substack.com/redirect/dc60bbf0-7972-45ad-b7bc-4108fcbef801?](https://substack.com/redirect/dc60bbf0-7972-45ad-b7bc-4108fcbef801?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 1st May, 11am, Belmore Park, Sydney NSW
Toowoomba [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 2nd May, 10am, Cnr of Hall Lane & Neil Street, Toowoomba, QLD
Townsville [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ba60804-1cdc-4413-a784-2d7738233753?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 4th May, 8:40am, Strand Park, 37-43 The Strand, North Ward, QLD
Wollongong [[https://substack.com/redirect/e340069b-32cb-43f1-b25e-2b8a982ae959?](https://substack.com/redirect/e340069b-32cb-43f1-b25e-2b8a982ae959?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - 1st May, 5pm, Lowden Square, Wollongong, NSW

That's all I've got this week comrades. Happy May Day.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UazFOe1F4TnpVMUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056YzBNVEl3T1RJc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd09EazBPREE1TWl3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAuZnZ5OHY3MTVMQV92eEhlaXM2c2ZfbmtTbEtVd2FLUTdJeHF0UXIybktCcyIsInAi0jE5NTc0MTc1NSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3NzQxMjA5MiwiaXhwIjoyMDkyOTg4MDkyLCJpc3MiOiJwdWI6MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.t2z4HqjaP1eq1xaq3_Og2SGkDKj_DBDdvtugDG6ewEQ?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-29-january>

ANMF Vic - St Vincent's Private

At a mass meeting on Friday (24/1) nurses and midwives at St Vincent's Private voted to pause most of their industrial action for two weeks "as a sign of good will in support of a new schedule of EBA negotiations. [https://substack.com/redirect/d68bbd97-a27a-475c-afe3-15496fa28a9f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]" While bed closures and stoppages have been paused, ANMF members will continue to refuse to perform food delivery services, will not respond to hospital communications outside of shifts, and maintain a ban on redeployment and some admin bans. Over the next fortnight, the ANMF will participate in at least twice weekly meetings with management [https://substack.com/redirect/e2cd651f-05d4-4d0e-9b02-f73462571204?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to try and resolve priority outstanding items including staff workload issues; annual leave and wages and allowances. If sufficient progress isn't made in the next two weeks, industrial action will resume in the week of 10 February.

MEU NSW - Peabody

Members of the Mining and Energy Union (MEU) commenced industrial action on Friday (24/1) at Peabody's Wilpinjong mine. Workers are fighting for improvements to their base rate, long service leave, parental leave and a laundry service. MEU members participated in stoppages on Friday and have implemented ongoing bans on overtime, training and workers performing higher duties. More stoppages are expected to take place this week.

NSWNMA - Ramsay Health

The NSWNMA is asking community members to email the CEO and Chairman of Ramsay Health Care [https://substack.com/redirect/bd74b4e9-b9ec-43be-9242-67eddacca129?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] to urge them to come back to the negotiating table. NSWNMA members at Ramsay Health struck for 24 hours in November after 20 months of negotiations. Nurses and midwives have voted down 3 proposed agreements. It is beyond time for Ramsay to start negotiating in good faith. Workers are fighting for a 20% pay increase over 3 years and safe staffing levels.

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to receive the full report straight to your inbox.

TWU WA - K&S Fuels

As threatened, TWU members at K&S Fuels in WA took a second day of strike action last Thursday (23/1). The bosses continue to ignore the demands of workers. The key issues for workers include the abolishment of the yard rate (this financially penalises workers for taking time off work); their demand for a pathway to 15% superannuation contributions and a wage increase that keeps up with the cost of living.

CRU - Sydney Trains

As I reported last week, the Combined Rail Unions were in the FWC on Wednesday (22/1) last week [https://substack.com/redirect/157f18bc-15e8-4691-b049-33dbac17f657?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] for the full hearing about the suspension of industrial action. In the end, unions made undertakings to withdraw work bans and industrial action in exchange for the NSW Government withdrawing its s424 application (to suspend the industrial action). The ETU has retained its right to undertake some limited stoppages between now and February 28 [https://substack.com/redirect/5181d8e6-565d-4b2a-95fb-1e6d97e29ebc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and after February 28 can take unlimited stoppages provided they give 7 days notice. The RTBU has clarified that the counteroffer made by the unions [https://substack.com/redirect/82ddb4f2-34a1-4f05-a32b-21a6a62743ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] includes 20% pay increases over 3 years; back pay to May 2024; a range of already agreed conditions and for the Government to withdraw its proposed changes to Clause 35A (worker participation in risk assessments) and the consultation clause.

ASMOF NSW - Public sector psychiatrists

The mass resignation of public sector psychiatrists in NSW is already having a major effect on the NSW health system with 70 beds closing at Westmead and Cumberland hospitals [https://substack.com/redirect/fb100b2f-bc58-4b9c-996e-79d333f65526?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Some of this is planned to be offset by opening beds in private hospitals - assumedly paid for by the state government. The NSWNMA and its members [https://substack.com/redirect/a7a9b2f0-96e3-46c8-b7de-276aec23c911?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] have been at the forefront supporting ASMOF members. NSWNMA Branch Secretary O'Bray Smith told the media nurses were already feeling pressured to "step up" to fill the void, with the union concerned about nurses being pressured to perform work that they are not trained to do. Gerard Hayes, the secretary of the HSU took a different position, posting on Facebook that his members "will have a greater opportunity to

flex their skills and apply their training” and rejoicing at “the rigid hierarchy” getting a shake up. Hayes also linked to an article in the Daily Telegraph which claims that “The Daily Telegraph can reveal thousands of healthcare professionals will replace psychiatrists in prescribing medications, diagnosing conditions and developing treatment plans, as psychiatrists threaten to resign from the state’s hospitals in pursuit of higher wages.” [https://substack.com/redirect/990862a4-8791-4c52-817a-fc4ed2ce66d2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] Commenting on who does what in a hospital is outside my scope of practice, but as a unionist, I think this is a terrible lack of solidarity. And my opinion is shared by the majority of people commenting on his Facebook post [https://substack.com/redirect/251d3e45-68da-496a-a3bb-ac471b2ad105?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]!

CFMEU Manufacturing Vic - Opal

The lockout at Opal’s Maryvale mill continues, and will hit the two week mark tomorrow. An article in The Australian [https://substack.com/redirect/7a8c8e36-e1fa-496a-948b-3db57a784349?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] provided some additional context for the negotiations. Opal wants to increase weekly hours from 35 to 38 hours. The average weekly hours are currently around 37.1 hours, meaning about 2 hours on double time (overtime rates). All up the union believes the proposals from the company would equate to a \$10,000 per annum cut for workers. CFMEU members are seeking a 13.5% increase over 3 years. The company has offered 9%. The CFMEU was at the FWC yesterday, so more to come on this dispute. The fundraiser to support the workers is still running - please contribute if you can [https://substack.com/redirect/c5ab0ba8-6a22-433c-b06c-4b744cfe68c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

TWU - Dnata

Around 1000 ground handlers employed by Dnata at airports around the country participated in rolling 4 hour stoppages on Friday (24/1) [https://substack.com/redirect/23b38e20-269a-4554-a82e-417223e21a6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The rolling stoppages took place at Sydney, Brisbane, Melbourne, Adelaide and Darwin airports commencing at 3am and ending at 11am. The TWU had reached an agreement with Dnata in December just days before scheduled strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/419ccbed-5ec9-4ae6-83c4-3f444a865a29?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] however over the festive period workers let their union know that the deal fell short of what they wanted. Workers key concerns are improved pay, fair overtime payments and shift allowances; maintaining an agreement expiry date of 30 June 2026 and backpay. Workers are also concerned about their conditions - they are only guaranteed 24 hours per week, and the ground handling work at airports is now entirely outsourced and split amongst a number of companies. The tentative agreement reached in December included an 11% pay increase over 2 years. TWU members are now fighting for an 11% immediate increase, and an addition 6% in six months [https://substack.com/redirect/b7e73864-9b5d-4435-a110-af63acddceee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

TWU WA - Ventia

Court security and custodial officers employed by Ventia in WA took 8 hours strike action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/626357e4-2e24-4ada-97b7-c5dbdf1ccef8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (24/1). Striking workers rallied in front of the Supreme Court, but it is unclear if the strike had any significant impact on court proceedings. Workers are seeking a pay increase to reach pay parity with other contractors performing the same jobs - Ventia employees earn up to 24% less. This is the workers’ third strike having previously taken industrial action in late 2024.

TPAV - Victoria Police

Media reports on Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/f14a4dc5-c971-4a26-8c3b-105f22c8b492?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (23/1) and Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/38175436-2d99-4ed1-918b-a9c0f8729bce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (24/1) stated that 67% of Police Association member respondents to an informal poll endorsed the proposed EBA recommended by the Fair Work Commission. The proposed EBA includes annual 4.5% wage increases over 4 years. Frontline cops would receive an extra .5% and no longer have to kit up/down on their own time. This falls short of the cops’ demand had for 6% wage increases. An article in the Herald Sun on Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/0c230f0e-f5c0-4f8d-93c1-6301fbfffb3a2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] 22/1 had cops referring to the deal as “a stinker” as the Allan Government threatened that if the offer was rejected, back pay would be taken off the table. The proposed deal also removes a clause that allows retiring cops to cash out up to 12 months of accrued sick leave which I can’t imagine would be popular! The deal still has to go through a formal ballot... so stay tuned.

That’s all I’ve got this week - a bit of a short report this week. Can’t believe January is already coming to a close. As always, please let me know what I’ve missed and if anything is kicking off at your workplace or in your union.

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades and subscribe.

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlYMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UVTFPVEUwTVRBM0xDSnBZWFpT2pFM016Z3dPVFkzTVRjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjMk9UWXpNamN4Tn13aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAucTZSZEtIWHM5N0EydEpFSkVlc09oVDBKMmx6Y3M2U1JlIbFh0aThlTk94MCI5InAiOjE1NTkxNDEwNywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTczODA5NjcNYywiZXhwIjoxNzQwNjg4NzE3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.F200Hg5R5fpo7s89hauBIWD0Geuq2UuuVhVksW50JLI?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-29-july>

AEU/ANMF/CFMEU/CPSU ACT - ACT Public Sector

On 20 July, the ACT Government revealed a new public sector offer that would be put out to ballot in August. The offer included some improvements, but no change in the wage offer of a 9% increase over 3 years. Unions have considered the offer over the last week and the consensus is that it's not good enough. 66% of CPSU members who voted in a union survey rejected the offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/c4ee7cd1-d40c-4fb3-803a-7488e83492e1?](https://substack.com/redirect/c4ee7cd1-d40c-4fb3-803a-7488e83492e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/875763b4-b7e0-432f-a966-75a7971ca342?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The AEU has described it as "an absolute shocker [[https://substack.com/redirect/2bf95ab6-aae9-43f7-a9cc-017ee46feddf?](https://substack.com/redirect/2bf95ab6-aae9-43f7-a9cc-017ee46feddf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2bf95ab6-aae9-43f7-a9cc-017ee46feddf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]". The ANMF said the offer "does not value the work of our members [[https://substack.com/redirect/2bf95ab6-aae9-43f7-a9cc-017ee46feddf?](https://substack.com/redirect/2bf95ab6-aae9-43f7-a9cc-017ee46feddf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[https://substack.com/redirect/b4af3f57-d071-4b72-b4ca-4e73af8737ef?](https://substack.com/redirect/b4af3f57-d071-4b72-b4ca-4e73af8737ef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b4af3f57-d071-4b72-b4ca-4e73af8737ef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]" and a mass meeting of 300 GSOs unanimously voted to reject the offer. The CPSU has said it will run a vote no campaign against the offer, and I can only imagine other unions will do similarly.

AWU/ETU QLD - Glencore

Workers at the Townsville Copper Refinery have rejected an offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/91341a6c-e24d-4953-8a5f-384c13a619eb?](https://substack.com/redirect/91341a6c-e24d-4953-8a5f-384c13a619eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/91341a6c-e24d-4953-8a5f-384c13a619eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] from Glencore. After 18 months of bargaining the company offered just 12% over 4 years. The AWU claims that meanwhile management have received a 15% bonus on top of high salaries. Glencore has also gone ahead and put forward another draft agreement which is even worse than the one just voted down. Union members at the refinery struck for 4 hours and instituted partial work bans when negotiations first stalled back in March.

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

Last Thursday (23/7) public school teachers stopped work for 24 hours [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d681ae0c-ad78-4f83-a1ab-52d38ecc7bc4?](https://substack.com/redirect/d681ae0c-ad78-4f83-a1ab-52d38ecc7bc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d681ae0c-ad78-4f83-a1ab-52d38ecc7bc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. This was the second 24 hour strike by teachers this year. Teachers and their supporters rallied in Bourke Street Mall before marching to Parliament House. Some Disputes Report readers shared that while the rally was big, it was smaller and somewhat more subdued than the first 24 hour strike rally in March. In addition to last week's strike action, a range of work bans also remain in place. It is safe to say negotiations have stalled - The Age confirmed on Friday that no negotiation meetings had been scheduled [

[https://substack.com/redirect/55fea8f1-4cdd-4218-9863-8454e4371335?](https://substack.com/redirect/55fea8f1-4cdd-4218-9863-8454e4371335?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/55fea8f1-4cdd-4218-9863-8454e4371335?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] or even requested by either side. This week Education Minister Ben Carroll has been more focused on becoming Premier than negotiations, and at the time of writing it's unclear if Victoria actually has an Education Minister. The AEU Branch Council is scheduled to meet on Friday 31 July [[https://substack.com/redirect/4dce5a3a-5605-48a9-b5b7-08d6c5e40670?](https://substack.com/redirect/4dce5a3a-5605-48a9-b5b7-08d6c5e40670?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4dce5a3a-5605-48a9-b5b7-08d6c5e40670?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] to decide the next steps in the campaign. Rank and file group Fight the Crisis is calling for strike action on 4 August [[https://substack.com/redirect/7f1566f2-348b-4449-ac7d-88b82d42e106?](https://substack.com/redirect/7f1566f2-348b-4449-ac7d-88b82d42e106?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7f1566f2-348b-4449-ac7d-88b82d42e106?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. It is understood the AEU has sent an email to all delegates advising this is "not authorised action" and advising members to only participate in industrial action that is authorised and protected. Definitely one to watch over the next few days.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

It has been reported that the RTBU has agreed to stop industrial action on buses operated by Keolis Downer Northern Beaches. Northside Living News [[https://substack.com/redirect/33341af0-5810-4106-948f-0e1ca62387f3?](https://substack.com/redirect/33341af0-5810-4106-948f-0e1ca62387f3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

MEU - Peabody

Workers at the Wambo Washery have been locked out for another 14 days [

[https://substack.com/redirect/61be712d-a53a-49f2-a81d-e5e246de092f?](https://substack.com/redirect/61be712d-a53a-49f2-a81d-e5e246de092f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/61be712d-a53a-49f2-a81d-e5e246de092f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. After 3 months in dispute and 18 bargaining meetings, negotiations have stalled. While Peabody accuses the MEU of not moving on remuneration [[https://substack.com/redirect/61be712d-a53a-49f2-a81d-e5e246de092f?](https://substack.com/redirect/61be712d-a53a-49f2-a81d-e5e246de092f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the MEU is quick (and correct!) to counter that if the CEO gets a 29% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/3f938ad9-c89b-42cc-b98a-4c46bc61134b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], surely workers should get a decent deal too. It is worth noting the ALP National Conference endorsed a change to its platform [https://substack.com/redirect/e4b55f7c-6599-403f-860d-2959d9bdb41c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] over the weekend which commits Labor to amending the Fair Work Act to allow workers to apply to the FWC to suspend “disproportionate employer response action”. In plain words - stop prolonged lockouts in response to protected industrial action.

VAHPA - Allied health workers

VAHPA members at public hospitals across Australia stopped work for 3 hours [

https://substack.com/redirect/3e6867a3-0323-4d1e-b342-ba46780a8dbc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Thursday (23/7). It is

estimated that around 1000 workers across the state participated in the action. The union has been in negotiations with the state government for 10 months. Workers rejected the state government’s most recent offer [https://substack.com/redirect/3e6867a3-0323-4d1e-b342-ba46780a8dbc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which included a pay increase of

between 19 - 21%. VAHPA members are fighting for a 36% wage increase over 3 years.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU QLD - Mater Hospital

On 21 July, maintenance workers at Mater Hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/068c06bf-2243-4fa2-986e-4cf4c68a5a44?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in Brisbane took industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/2071fea6-14af-4d2e-8227-60ade850cbec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in their campaign for a fair EBA.

Workers have been in negotiations for over 9 months [https://substack.com/redirect/f40920f5-2870-48d9-9383-6931db0a1c32?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. I think that these workers are at the public hospital, so assumedly part of the Queensland Health EBA negotiations. I understood the Queensland Health Building, Engineering and Maintenance agreement was currently in the arbitration process but again, not sure. Got more solid details on this? Let me know! Very happy to post a correction and more information next week.

In short

UWU - Secure Journeys

UWU members at immigration detention centre across the country continue to take industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/f5481838-0def-4674-8587-750e1301cae0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to improve safety in centres for

workers and detainees. On the weekend, UWU members at the Melbourne Immigration Detention Centre and the Brisbane Immigration Detention Centre held stoppages from 4am - 8pm and 4pm - 8pm on both Saturday and Sunday (25 & 26 July).

CEPU SA - Service Stream

The CEPU shared a video [https://substack.com/redirect/f891820e-d7bc-4715-b48a-af431846dd85?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last Wednesday (22/7) of “Day 5”

of stoppages at Service Stream. The CEPU will be back at the bargaining table with Service Stream today after workers voted down management’s proposed agreement.

MSAV - Public health professionals

MSAV members are going to strike for 24 hours tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/db0b35c7-2256-45d2-8e50-577f5031c3e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (30/7).

Workers were planning to blitz Premier Jacinta Allan’s home electorate of Bendigo, but given she is no longer the Premier [https://substack.com/redirect/f9b78462-c92b-49a4-9b6c-7bf11946de62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the plan is changing. Stay tuned

to MSAV’s social media pages for updates on specific actions. Perhaps a trip to new Premier Ben Carroll’s electorate of Niddrie?

ASU Victoria - Metropolitan Melbourne council workers

ASU members from the 8 metropolitan Melbourne councils currently fighting for a multi-employer agreement will walk off the job from 10am - 2pm on Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/99a8dce5-141a-42d7-b476-49b5174e979f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (30/7). Workers will rally at the Victorian Parliament at 12 noon [

https://substack.com/redirect/0a7a94b1-36d3-45bf-8451-81cdc78b4eb2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The ASU is focusing attention on the state government, [https://substack.com/redirect/6cba3e7f-7364-4e6d-a06d-24354b0e2a0e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as they are currently considering

changes to rate capping to ensure council worker wages are properly factored in. If the State Government fixes this problem, it may go some way to assisting workers win a fair deal from councils. A strike fund [https://substack.com/redirect/ebb8ddf2-6194-424e-aabf-c738fb10fe4a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] has been established to assist workers facing financial hardship. In addition to lost wages for strikes, many workers are having their pay docked [https://substack.com/redirect/0b16dc86-df48-4014-a5f2-7b876e969880?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

workers facing financial hardship. In addition to lost wages for strikes, many workers are having their pay docked [https://substack.com/redirect/0b16dc86-df48-4014-a5f2-7b876e969880?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for participating in partial work bans.

PABO Watch

AMWU WA - UGL

Results are back from the protected action ballot at Alcoa. 92% of those who voted endorsed industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/126b4ff3-65e2-4229-b6c7-b97a8c89cbad?](https://substack.com/redirect/126b4ff3-65e2-4229-b6c7-b97a8c89cbad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Negotiations have been underway for months, and workers are now being told that the company “can’t afford” improved wages and is looking at KPI-based bonuses instead. I don’t think that was the response workers were looking for!

The AMWU posted on social media that industrial action is “imminent [

[https://substack.com/redirect/3e4d3867-4877-4523-a100-4c6f3340c7a9?](https://substack.com/redirect/3e4d3867-4877-4523-a100-4c6f3340c7a9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]”.

HACSU Vic - Scope

After 18 months of bargaining with no progress, HACSU members at Scope are voting on taking industrial action this week [[https://substack.com/redirect/85276a87-8584-4872-99c1-1f3748c0cd6c?](https://substack.com/redirect/85276a87-8584-4872-99c1-1f3748c0cd6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a fair EBA and seeking action on non-contact hours; minimum shift lengths and fair rostering.

TWU - FedEx

Last Wednesday (22/7), the TWU’s application for a protected action ballot [

[https://substack.com/redirect/330173dc-96f3-498c-802e-fe7d79c38375?](https://substack.com/redirect/330173dc-96f3-498c-802e-fe7d79c38375?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at FedEx was granted by the FWC.

Not sure at this stage when the ballot opens, but it will close on 20 August. Workers recently voted down an offer [[https://substack.com/redirect/321779fb-bcb7-4a8c-89a2-929263ff8896?](https://substack.com/redirect/321779fb-bcb7-4a8c-89a2-929263ff8896?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from FedEx which had no job security provisions. The TWU sees FedEx’s behaviour as part of the “Amazon Effect” [

[https://substack.com/redirect/5dba658c-12e4-45df-ab88-583566778a58?](https://substack.com/redirect/5dba658c-12e4-45df-ab88-583566778a58?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - attempting to shift work to contractors on piece rates, who are forced to deliver a parcel up to every 4 minutes.

RTBU - Pacific National

The intermodal train crew at Pacific National have voted in favour of industrial action. According to the RTBU “a majority of actions received 90%+ support from members [

[https://substack.com/redirect/3ce86965-37de-4092-8218-49c4f412635c?](https://substack.com/redirect/3ce86965-37de-4092-8218-49c4f412635c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]”.

AMOU/MUA Tasmania - TasPorts

Union members at 11 ports around Tasmania have voted in favour of taking industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/ac9ec010-fab4-469d-a7af-e390ebd5b709?](https://substack.com/redirect/ac9ec010-fab4-469d-a7af-e390ebd5b709?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], including 24 hour strikes. AMOU and MUA members are fighting for industry standard wages and conditions that recognises workers’ skills, responsibilities and operational importance. The most recent offer from TasPorts included a wage offer below CPI. The next bargaining meeting is on 3 August where unions will be demanding “meaningful progress.”

CPSU/ETU/MEAA Vic - Arts Centre Melbourne

A reader let me know that union members at Arts Centre Melbourne are currently voting in a protected action ballot. Arts Centre Melbourne is a statutory authority, and workers are ready to fight for a wage increase above the Victorian government wages policy cap of 3%.

Union news

UWU Convention

Hot on the heels of the ALP National Conference in Adelaide was the UWU Convention which kicked off on Monday. Unsurprisingly, a new leadership team was elected [

[https://substack.com/redirect/193ae9fc-0ea6-4dd4-a72c-850429f18dde?](https://substack.com/redirect/193ae9fc-0ea6-4dd4-a72c-850429f18dde?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] headed by Lyndel Ryan as President and Gary Bullock as National Secretary. The media release announcing the new leadership team starts by saying “For the first time since the formation of United Workers Union, the organisation will be led by two people who started on the shop floor.” While that may be technically true, both Ryan and Bullock have been union officials since at least the late 1990s. The leadership team also includes Vice Presidents Carolyn Smith, Demi Pnevmatikos, Helen Gibbons and Pat O’Donnell and Executive Officers Erryn Cresshull, Dom Rose, Jackie Lowe, Catalina Gonzalez, Fiona Scanlon and Chris Field. UWU’s election system where the Convention votes up the Executive means this National Union will have no leadership representatives from Victoria, Tasmania or the NT. I have heard that some Convention delegates from the losing Members First ticket did not attend the convention, while others were prevented from wearing Members First t-shirts at the event. A number of organisers and officials have already ceased employment at the union following the election. The fallout from a bitterly contested election will undoubtedly affect members in the days, weeks and months to come.

ACTU leadership

In somewhat surprising news, on Monday night (27/7) ACTU Secretary Sally McManus and ACTU President

Michele O'Neil announced their imminent departures [https://substack.com/redirect/e972f7c6-6716-44a5-8102-7c2dfc33722e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] from the ACTU via a video on social media [https://substack.com/redirect/924adbf7-8882-4560-846a-14aa2c1262aa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Both have been in their jobs for close to a decade. McManus plans to leave within the next month, while O'Neil will stay and help the new Secretary settle in before departing later this year. ACTU Congress will be held next year. Putting my bush lawyer hat on for a moment, I believe both positions will be deemed casual vacancies, and as such according to the standing orders [https://substack.com/redirect/98fef738-3939-480d-a324-bbc44893a19e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] any member of the ACTU Executive may nominate any member of an affiliated union as a candidate for election to the vacant office. ACTU Executive members [https://substack.com/redirect/4490d301-50a0-401e-93db-21c4b149732a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] will vote in a secret ballot, but with weighted votes - depending on how many union members an Executive member represents. Possible contenders for the positions include [https://substack.com/redirect/3f95fecf-67e9-4251-a6ac-2b3f8d250336?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] Victorian Trades Hall Council Secretary Luke Hilakari, AEU Federal Secretary Correna Haythorpe, CPSU National Secretary Melissa Donnelly and AMWU National Secretary Steve Murphy.

That's all I've got this week. I would love to hear not just your calculated speculations, but also your wishes for who will get the top jobs at the ACTU. Let me know in the comments!

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWw0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVn1YMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1qQTRPREkzT1RnNUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09EVXl0e1EyT0Rrc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE5qZ3hNRfK0T1N3aWYFNpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbAURVhwak1RMTN6RWZDOW8xMTVDanRlZ3Fkc2tKRdDqcFFRQW5VNldPOEtYRSIsInAiOjIwODgyNzk4OSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc4NTI3NDY4OSwiZXhwIjoyMTAwODUwNjg5LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.OxtnQDxhM8Eog3ux-28E9_3BkxAxzXnxAsECfDnNm7I?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-3-december>

NTEU NSW - UTS

Apologies to the comrades at UTS because last week's report missed reporting on their strike action! Workers at UTS stopped work for 4 hours last week [https://substack.com/redirect/9335b5a6-4ef5-4784-afc0-7a884e1fb41d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (26/11) in the first industrial action of their EBA campaign. Workers are fighting for no forced redundancies; workload protections; staff voice and transparency on UTS council and committees; a cultural safety plan co-designed and implemented with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander staff; protections against AI surveillance; 10 days paid union leave for members and improved change processes [https://substack.com/redirect/5847b5e8-46c8-4a19-b00c-927ac9e7417c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A report in the Sydney Morning Herald [https://substack.com/redirect/f01da5c3-e6c1-4143-8e23-2a5357f47459?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] revealed that VC Andrew Parfitt emailed staff on the morning of the strike and announced that a bunch of contentious proposed changes to the university would not be going ahead - most academic redundancies would now be voluntary; a proposed merger of the Faculty of Law, the Business School and the Transdisciplinary School would not take place; and teaching degrees would be preserved. I would love to hear from any workers at UTS for their thoughts on these backflips, and any whispers about next steps in the EBA campaign.

AWU Vic - Forest firefighters

Friday (28/11) marked 365 days since AWU forest firefighters started industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/fb2e5a0a-d225-499f-9f73-393561301534?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. After 12 months of various bans, stoppages and the October stop work rally [https://substack.com/redirect/9705df91-59f7-46c2-9ffd-1b42a92cf5bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], workers are upping the ante with new bans. New bans include a ban on using chainsaws and rake-hoes; all work at rec sites will stop and more stoppages. To annoy the bejesus out of the decision makers, every email sent by AWU members will CC the Environment Minister (Steve Dimopoulos) and the Department's Deputy Secretary. With the Australasian Fire Authorities Council Seasonal Bushfire Outlook [https://substack.com/redirect/b254d1c4-ea15-4576-8e1f-bf54e7ffe38a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] warning of increased bushfire risk in Victoria, it would seem to be a prudent time for the state government to ensure these crucial frontline workers get a fair deal.

AWU Vic - Forest firefighters

HSU NT - Public sector health workers

1000 hospital workers across the NT will walk off the job from 10am today [https://substack.com/redirect/3bc3e8fd-3ee3-487c-8b01-f8448da6bf6d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (3/12). The NT Government is now putting the Enterprise Agreement back out to vote [https://substack.com/redirect/26eb7ca4-7c53-4a46-b86e-679a5dac089d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with only an additional 1% in wages than the offer rejected by workers, and remains less than what police have received. The HSU is encouraging workers to vote no.

HSU NT - Public sector health workers

ANMF Vic - Healthscope

After taking stop work action [https://substack.com/redirect/fc19f4f5-fba7-4086-9efd-7b127ce0d914?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 20 November, nurses and midwives at Healthscope facilities in Victoria went on to vote down management's proposed EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/ff14fb6b-fa34-4d90-8c4d-2ffdd63bf52f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (and unfair salary packaging clause) a week later on 27 November. The ANMF requested that Healthscope provide results of the ballot (how many voted, and breakdown of yes/no votes) but Healthscope has refused. The ANMF has "sought to resume negotiations" and in the meantime, industrial action will continue [https://substack.com/redirect/1b6c9656-fab1-4e40-b24c-98f00d418213?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

ANMF Vic - Healthscope

AEU Tasmania - Public sector teachers

Teachers in Tasmania's public education sector will take strike action for the second time in two months next week. I couldn't pin down details at the time of writing, the AEU has shared on social media that teachers will strike on Friday 12 December. Stay tuned for more details.

ETU WA - TK Elevators

Sparkies at TK Elevators in Perth have been undertaking industrial action for over 3 weeks [https://substack.com/redirect/f57e0f36-96a3-4a5f-8437-8aec279f3c9b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The ETU reports that negotiations have stalled. Last week, workers rallied outside the PTA in East Perth after reports of unlicensed scab labour being used to maintain lifts and escalators. If there's anything worse than a scab, it's an unlicensed scab - not only morally bankrupt, but dangerous as hell!

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Over the past fortnight, nurses and midwives in regional South Australia have rallied outside their hospitals demanding a better deal from the state government. Now stop work rallies at metropolitan Adelaide hospitals have commenced [https://substack.com/redirect/b6b3d012-ebe0-4cf0-8522-3c875f73bbc6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Nurses and midwives kicked off the stopworks yesterday (2/12) at Modbury Hospital. Today (3/12) stopwork action will take place at the Women's and Children's Hospital from 1:30pm. Lyell McEwin Hospital; The Queen Elizabeth Hospital; Flinders Medical Centre; Royal Adelaide Hospital; Noarlunga Health Services; Repatriation Hospital and Glenside are to follow over the next two weeks. Get along and support nurses and midwives if you can.

HACSU Tasmania - Public sector health workers

HACSU members in Tasmania continue to make their displeasure with the state government's wages offer known. On Thursday (27/11) workers at both the Mersey Community Hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/0bf049df-432e-4110-8cd8-846cda2c1cbe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and the North West Regional Hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/4b607c8b-ac8e-41a2-b31a-860b403d4a98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] held stop work meetings demanding a fair and respectful wage offer from the Rockliff Government.

HWU Vic- Public sector health workers

Tomorrow (4/12), for the first time in 25 years public sector HWU members will be taking protected industrial action. 75% of HWU members voted in the protected action ballot with 97% endorsing industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/8bacd834-8ddb-4e99-9be4-8c72538f67b0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. According to the HWU, the Victorian Government has offered members the worst pay offer in the entire public sector - 3%. Workers are demanding liveable wages. Join HWU members at Trades Hall from 10am before marching to Parliament House at 11am. The HWU has been under administration [https://substack.com/redirect/192ef45a-8e4a-42d1-a7d8-91a01123e222?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] since June this year following allegations of financial misconduct and corruption against former Secretary Diana Asmar and her factional allies.

AWU Vic - GMCT

AWU members at the Greater Metropolitan Cemeteries Trust (GMCT) at Fawkner and Lilydale will commence industrial action on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/9422e0f7-ebb9-45de-ab74-af7e4cc84f82?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (5/12). According to the union, workers want to send "a clear message that AWU members won't be walked over." AWU members will down tools from 12 noon to 4pm on Friday as well as imposing indefinite work bans on working overtime and disclosing union membership. Solidarity visits are welcome and they'll be firing up the BBQ from midday at both Fawkner (1187 Sydney Road) and Lilydale (126-128 Victoria Road, Lilydale).

AFULE/RTBU QLD & WA - Pacific National

Workers at Pacific National in Queensland held a 36 hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/bf0f9b63-8a45-46c6-8880-ee2d6901f19c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] from 6am on Thursday (27/11). Unions felt they had reached an impasse with Pacific National and a stoppage was necessary to put pressure on Pacific National. Workers are committed to fighting for a fair agreement that ensures parity with other traincrew. Unions are set to meet with Pacific National in the FWC today (3/12). Trouble is also brewing with Pacific National in WA [https://substack.com/redirect/86d2c6c3-762e-409c-8de4-c90516839b10?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], the RTBU applied for a protected action ballot in late November, PN have challenged this, and a hearing about that will also take place in the FWC today (3/12). Pacific National has threatened intermodal terminator operators with removing backpay if they took industrial action. Stay tuned for updates on both of these disputes.

Professionals Australia/UWU Vic - Ambulance Victoria

Workers at Ambulance Victoria have been undertaking industrial action over the last few weeks. Workers walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/ff06a3d6-822f-4e97-9ec1-65c4139f9ffd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] in late November, and are chalking messages on ambulances [https://substack.com/redirect/265847b8-ac5b-4f7f-b3f2-61cef01ff971?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Members of AMPA (Ambulance Managers & Professionals Association, a division of Professionals Australia) escalated action yesterday by hijacking Ambulance Victoria's social media [https://substack.com/redirect/10cc1b3f-4c11-4264-b068-bca53e3dafc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to share information about their industrial action. While the posts were deleted, union members have promised to reveal details of more public action, due to start today (3/12). Workers who work in payroll, rostering, fleet, health and safety, HR, property, procurement, and training and keep ambulances running have been in negotiations with Ambulance Victoria for 7 months, and so far no offer has been made.

The TWU has come to an in-principle agreement with GKR. The deal includes a 13% increase to km/hourly rates over 3 years; a 19.5% increase to annual leave over 3 years (11.5% in year one); and delegates' rights embedded into the agreement. Workers will also get backpay to 1 July 2025. Drivers at GKR were on strike all last week to put pressure on GKR for a better deal.

Look, I do my best to not embroil myself with the machinations of the Labor party but a comrade shared with me a photo of a resolution from the Queensland Labor conference [

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVult0QrwnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which was held over the weekend and I felt compelled to respond to it. The motion was entitled “Scab Unions have no place in Queensland” and moved: “That this Conference: 1. Condemns NPAQ, TPAQ, AMPS, RAFFWU and other Red Unions who continue to sow division within our union movement. 2. Calls on the Miles Government to continue to affirm their position and do everything it can to ensure that scab unions have no place in Queensland.” Well. One of these things is not like the other! NPAQ (Nurses Professional Association of Queensland); TPAQ (Teachers Professional Association of Queensland); and AMPS (Australian Medical Professionals Society) are self-described “Red Unions” with deep ties to the LNP.

https://substack.com/redirect/f2d5cf5b-2640-484d-8fb1-3c957284cb09?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVU1t0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] the former chair of the LNP's
industrial relations and employment policy committee, but really came into their own challenging
"vaccine mandates". Haycroft's credentials also include being a member of the HR Nicholls Society, a
supporter of the Joh for PM campaign and a franchisee of labour hire fire Troubleshooters Available [

by eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] with which he intervened and severely damaged the AWU's unionisation of shearers in Queensland in the 1990s. The problem with these so-called "Red Unions" isn't that they are not registered trade unions or that they are not affiliated to the ACTU or QCU. The problem with these "unions" is that they exist to undermine the genuine organisation of workers and have no interest in the improvement of conditions for the working class as a whole. While it may be justified to call NPAQ; TPAQ and AMPS "scab unions", this label is in no way suitable to apply to RAFFWU. RAFFWU was set up in 2016 by activists and workers following the Fair Work Commission overturning several EBAs that had been negotiated by the SDA and large, national employers including Coles [https://substack.com/redirect/e57482c7-69d7-4aac-a4f8-df04dd9e291d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The FWC found that these EBAs left workers worse off than if they had been on the award, failing the Better Off Overall Test (BOOT). With the registered union (SDA) for their industry area caught doing sweetheart deals with the bosses, workers felt compelled to start a new union. RAFFWU describes itself as a "member-led, democratic union" and is doing what the SDA failed to do for decades - actually organising workers in retail and fast food rather than cutting deals with the bosses. RAFFWU is not undermining the organisation of workers, it is in fact improving the organisation of workers in its sector. So why has RAFFWU been lumped in with the "Red Unions"? While you or I might not give two shits as to whether a union is registered or has the blessing of Sally McManus, much of the union establishment is at best uneasy and at worst hostile towards RAFFWU. In addition to that, the mover and secondor of the motion both have links to the AWU a factional ally of the SDA. So why not lump in the SDA's number 1 enemy (RAFFWU) with the "unions" set up by AWU enemy Graeme Haycroft?

<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen/note/c-182598453>] about the upcoming VAHPA Special General Meeting
[<https://substack.com/redirect/5498d456-d36b-444e-9bd5-059f222da91a?>

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] which is being held on Thursday 11 December at Trades Hall in Melbourne. The meeting is set to discuss the proposed merger of VAHPA and HACSU (two HSU branches). If you know any VAHPA members make sure they are aware of the meeting, and encourage them to get along to it! One question I have is how often have rank and file members in Australia managed to get a Special General Meeting (or similar) called? If you can remember other examples of this happening, please drop me a line and let me know. Keen to learn more. We all need to be thinking about how we can inject more democracy and transparency into our unions, and what tools are available to us.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzZGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMmMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNJNk1UZ3dORGt3TXpVNUxDSnBZWFpT2pFM05qUTNNRGcyT1Rnc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRJNU5qSTBORFk1T0N3aWFTYnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4Tnp2aUxDsnPkV0lpT21Ka2FYTMhZbXBhWDJldFlxbHNBbjAuaFBjQ0hyVjBlSnFRS1vb192N1pUNThYRS1uRnJycDV3VFJUOHhpCU4yMCIsInAiOjE4MDQ5MDM1OTSwicyImWDAJSNTe3NiwiZiI6dHMjZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNmZSMlhdCI6MTc2NDcwODY5OCwiZSwiaXhwIjoyMDgwMgJg0Njk4LCJpc3MiOiJldWltMCIsInNjaXI6ImxpbnbstcmVkaXJlZ3ViOif0_7BeFkfF993UUvGZmpuBhAljMPXPXMRSoXiHPUtUwizpfOI?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-3-june>

AWU/ETU/MUA WA - Inpex

Union members at Inpex's Ichthys LNG facilities commenced industrial action yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/1c1a911f-75d4-429b-a967-ec2161731fe9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (2 June). According to the Offshore Alliance, while significant progress was made in negotiations last week "they have fallen short on a number of fundamental claims. [https://substack.com/redirect/b24c3b7d-af5a-4312-a055-5923f9af73d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" Workers are fighting for 3% annual wage increases and improvements to conditions. AREEA has claimed this would increase labour costs by 50-60% [https://substack.com/redirect/0df88f12-88eb-4f9e-970c-a9ce22361a47?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Industrial action at 3 facilities included stoppages yesterday, as well as work bans. Workers were set to commence industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/de93c1b0-0986-4132-b1c5-48fc28935282?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last week, but action was suspended at the eleventh hour.

MSAV - Public sector health professionals

MSAV members are set to take strike action again [https://substack.com/redirect/59fcc5c9-fad8-4699-a9c0-9e1e4e5a6489?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 16 June. Workers will rally outside the Department of Health at 50 Lonsdale Street, Melbourne from 11:30am. Get along and support them if you can. MSAV members have also held snap rallies on 29 May at University Hospital Geelong [https://substack.com/redirect/e8c6ea38-5d6d-4fbf-812e-53424a11a89f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and yesterday (2 June) in the Parkville medical precinct. MSAV have been in negotiations for 14 months, attending 50 bargaining meetings and are yet to receive a decent offer.

ASU SA - City of Port Adelaide Enfield

ASU members at the City of Port Adelaide Enfield (PAE) commenced industrial action yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/69614840-9362-4ec7-993b-dbb22183e255?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This was the first time since the 1990s [https://substack.com/redirect/9dd70d7b-45b2-48b3-8a09-5594ab6981a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that City of PAE workers have taken action. Yesterday's stoppage comes after ASU members twice rejected an agreement from management. The dispute is not just about wages and conditions, management has also made a proposal that could allow the Council to move employees into entirely different roles across the organisation. ASU members are likely to escalate action over the next fortnight with work bans to be implemented across libraries, depots and the civic centre. Workers are fighting for a fair deal, and a say in their future.

ASU/AWU/CPSU Vic - Parks Victoria

Industrial action at Parks Victoria continues [https://substack.com/redirect/6eb840a9-f385-4fb2-87cb-7aa5847faf27?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] by members of the ASU, AWU and CPSU. ASU members [https://substack.com/redirect/08d594f9-1c48-4809-8e2b-ddff82919084?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] are writing slogans on PV vehicles; displaying campaign signs in the workplace and have implemented bans on rubbish collection, cleaning facilities and fireplaces, travelling between work centres and having meal breaks in the field. AWU members are calling for a reclassification and pay uplift [https://substack.com/redirect/3591a1c2-7be2-40fb-a0f8-4fe1bd00d67b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that recognises the work of rangers. AWU members' industrial action includes displaying campaign material in the workplace; making media statements; placing campaign signage at parks and on PV vehicles and adding campaign email signatures and campaign auto-reply messages to their emails. CPSU members' industrial action includes stoppages; indefinite bans on completing online tasks or forms; responding to Ministerial enquiries; rubbish collection; cleaning facilities and fireplaces; taking meal breaks in the field; as well as displaying campaign material in workplaces, parks and on PV vehicles; making media statements; and campaign auto-reply emails and email signatures. It is understood more action is likely to take place over the long weekend. All union members are calling for a fair deal from the state government - including pay parity with their public sector colleagues.

IEU Vic - Catholic school teachers

The IEU in Victoria is still pursuing a Single Interest Application to be able to bargain across the whole Catholic sector in Victoria. The union is awaiting a Fair Work Commission ruling [https://substack.com/redirect/db5fee4e-a726-4cd6-89ea-60f0e6521b9b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but in the interim launching a "term of action [https://substack.com/redirect/76b886f2-e3bd-4b9b-bbc7-7f89ee856338?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]". Catholic teachers across the

state held before or after school rallies on Friday (29/5) and will be wearing IEU t-shirts on Fridays going forward. The IEU has put forward 113 claims [https://substack.com/redirect/feaae39f-619c-4fec-9a86-41855578343b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] so far in bargaining, of which 100 have been rejected outright. IEU members are fighting for decent pay, improved conditions and union rights.

AMWU/ASU/ETU/RTBU QLD - Queensland Rail

Queensland Rail took it upon itself to issue a press release [https://substack.com/redirect/a345b352-8fe6-4cd0-a375-ee3a457f8c6e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] announcing that regional trains will move to a reduced timetable starting from 1 June due to “impacts from union protected industrial action”. This was of course picked up by the Courier Mail [https://substack.com/redirect/35884dde-77a6-46f0-babf-24d1fc67195d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] close to verbatim. Of course, no mention of the fact that maintenance disruption could have been minimised by Queensland Rail accepting work from union members undertaking partial work bans, or better yet by making a decent offer to workers. The disruptions to rail services in this now protracted dispute lay with the bosses and the state government, not the workers.

In short

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Strike action is returning to SA public hospitals after negotiations for a new EBA stalled. ANMF members at the Lyell McEwin Hospital will stop work for 24 hours tomorrow (4/6). Please get along and support the nurses and midwives walking off the job if you can - they will be gathering outside the Lyell McEwin Hospital at 7:15am on Thursday and 7am on Friday.

ASU/Professionals Australia - DXC

Industrial action and “strike-breaking tactics” continue at IT services provider DXC [https://substack.com/redirect/9dfebca6-be71-4029-a077-72351c1bb861?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. While workers at DXC participated in stoppages, DXC attempted to bring in contractors to cover the gaps. But according to unions - many of these contractors did not have the required security clearances needed to work on sensitive government accounts. DXC’s clients include the Department of Defence, Australian Signals Directorate, the ATO and the Department of Home Affairs.

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

Due to AEU members’ scheduled strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/448b7978-79d2-4ba7-b7e6-661ae790f215?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] on 11 June, the ACT Education Directorate has announced that all ACT public schools will be closed [https://substack.com/redirect/ae7782d3-9c17-4798-9363-2dd713ad366b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

ASU Victoria - Metropolitan Melbourne city councils

Negotiations have stalled [https://substack.com/redirect/a07e40c0-754d-4b86-bc47-42b857592c78?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] with the eight metropolitan Melbourne city councils that the ASU is attempting to negotiate a multi-employer agreement with. To keep the pressure up, ASU council worker members will strike again on Wednesday 17 June [https://substack.com/redirect/78272011-4ec6-4a50-8731-d927bfd2d194?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Join workers at the Victorian Trades Hall at 10:30am before they march to Parliament at 11:30am.

PABO Watch

MEU - Glencore

Over 95% of MEU members at the Wambo United Joint Venture coal mine near Singleton voted in favour of taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/12040285-5a62-45e9-a210-958bb3f384a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. 95% of eligible workers participated in the ballot. The MEU is negotiating a replacement EBA but there are a number of key issues with what is coming back from management. Management has proposed lower tier classifications that would undermine Same Job Same Pay laws; changes to some on-site conditions; and no backpay. There has also been a lack of engagement on workers’ claims. Time to up the ante!

Offshore Alliance - DOF

Offshore Alliance members working with Remotely Operated Vehicles (ROV) at DOF have overwhelmingly voted in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/a6ad6c5d-325d-426d-9c24-c785bc8a1382?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. DOF is a Norwegian based multinational that provides offshore services including construction, repair, inspection and maintenance. 95% of eligible members participated in the ballot, and 100% of participants voted in favour.

AMWU QLD - Isis Sugar Mill

Workers at the Isis Sugar Mill in Cordalba have voted in favour of taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/c9a28531-1263-4387-a9ee-d97edb1690b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. At least 85% of voters supported each measure on the ballot. AMWU members are ready to fight for a fair EBA with better pay, stronger

conditions and respect.

AMWU/ETU WA - BHP

Both the AMWU [[https://substack.com/redirect/58bd1ec4-3e65-4d60-aa57-1a75cab78e9d?](https://substack.com/redirect/58bd1ec4-3e65-4d60-aa57-1a75cab78e9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/58bd1ec4-3e65-4d60-aa57-1a75cab78e9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] and the ETU have applied for protected action ballot orders [[https://substack.com/redirect/34a4ea35-4474-4d2f-ba9e-9a7ad14150e8?](https://substack.com/redirect/34a4ea35-4474-4d2f-ba9e-9a7ad14150e8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/34a4ea35-4474-4d2f-ba9e-9a7ad14150e8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] at BHP's port operations at Port Hedland. Negotiations have been underway for 6 months but have been fruitless. Media reports claim that AMWU and ETU members make up just under half of BHP's workforce at the port, and could cause serious disruption. In addition to the dispute at the port, high-voltage electricians at BHP are already taking industrial action in their separate pay dispute. A proposed offer from BHP for workers at South Flank and Mining Area C has been described by the ETU as "a pile of snot [[https://substack.com/redirect/96d2c1bb-2deb-4911-89b5-7ed765754007?](https://substack.com/redirect/96d2c1bb-2deb-4911-89b5-7ed765754007?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/96d2c1bb-2deb-4911-89b5-7ed765754007?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]"; as being full of "vague classifications, management discretion and salary absorption clauses [[https://substack.com/redirect/4c43d28d-0184-4591-b79e-323fb0219032?](https://substack.com/redirect/4c43d28d-0184-4591-b79e-323fb0219032?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4c43d28d-0184-4591-b79e-323fb0219032?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]" by the AMWU, and conversely as a "significant step forward [[https://substack.com/redirect/9c784bdd-3e5e-4512-8089-b0443a980d3c?](https://substack.com/redirect/9c784bdd-3e5e-4512-8089-b0443a980d3c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9c784bdd-3e5e-4512-8089-b0443a980d3c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]" by the AWU.

Union news

UWU election results

The results haven't been formally declared yet, but an article in the AFR [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b3bb970b-d97b-443d-ae48-281e78742fb8?](https://substack.com/redirect/b3bb970b-d97b-443d-ae48-281e78742fb8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b3bb970b-d97b-443d-ae48-281e78742fb8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] yesterday, as well as social media posts from Members First [[https://substack.com/redirect/f631b56d-6c08-47b0-bee1-80933250e2d9?](https://substack.com/redirect/f631b56d-6c08-47b0-bee1-80933250e2d9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f631b56d-6c08-47b0-bee1-80933250e2d9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] and United for You [

[https://substack.com/redirect/037b6019-dfe0-4e37-8a1a-7346fbe3e3f2?](https://substack.com/redirect/037b6019-dfe0-4e37-8a1a-7346fbe3e3f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/037b6019-dfe0-4e37-8a1a-7346fbe3e3f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] indicate that the United For You ticket led by current UWU President Jo Schofield will ultimately win control of the union. Although, according to Members First, Jo Schofield herself has not been re-elected. The election was for delegates for a "national convention" who go on to elect the union executive officers. So whoever has the most seats in the convention - wins. It looks as though United For You has won a majority of electorates in Queensland, WA and South Australia, while the Members First ticket led by current UWU Secretary Tim Kennedy has dominated Victoria, NSW and Tasmania. According to Members First, only 31% of UWU members voted in the election. As I write this late on Tuesday evening, United For You spent \$187,006 on Facebook ads; and Members First spent \$42,968. It is likely even greater sums were spent on mail outs, campaign materials and expenses. I am sure there will be more analysis of this election when the full results are available.

National Wage Case

Yesterday (2 June) the Fair Work Commission announced its decision in the Annual Wage Review [

[https://substack.com/redirect/820220c3-648a-4979-8a89-70b0fe08b015?](https://substack.com/redirect/820220c3-648a-4979-8a89-70b0fe08b015?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/820220c3-648a-4979-8a89-70b0fe08b015?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The annual review undertaken by the FWC sets the National Minimum Wage as well as reviewing the minimum wage rates in awards. The national minimum wage will increase by 5.97% and modern award rates will increase by 4.75%. The ACTU's original submission in March [[https://substack.com/redirect/c6822634-d904-4a65-95e6-690d6cba1482?](https://substack.com/redirect/c6822634-d904-4a65-95e6-690d6cba1482?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c6822634-d904-4a65-95e6-690d6cba1482?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] to the FWC called for a 5% increase to minimum and award wages. However this was revised in a supplementary submission in May [[https://substack.com/redirect/3ceab2da-54e9-430d-ada8-c2111e2a06be?](https://substack.com/redirect/3ceab2da-54e9-430d-ada8-c2111e2a06be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3ceab2da-54e9-430d-ada8-c2111e2a06be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] calling for a 6% increase due to increased volatility and inflation. The FWC announcement acknowledged [

[https://substack.com/redirect/820220c3-648a-4979-8a89-70b0fe08b015?](https://substack.com/redirect/820220c3-648a-4979-8a89-70b0fe08b015?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/820220c3-648a-4979-8a89-70b0fe08b015?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] that they had "concluded, regrettably, that it would not be practicable or responsible in the current uncertain circumstances to award a real wage increase for employees reliant on modern award wage rates that would be sufficient to close the real wage gap entirely." The ACTU acknowledged [

[https://substack.com/redirect/35f06234-bbbd-4cbc-9f00-0855fd2fb47d?](https://substack.com/redirect/35f06234-bbbd-4cbc-9f00-0855fd2fb47d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/35f06234-bbbd-4cbc-9f00-0855fd2fb47d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] the decision fell short of what is needed, but that it would help workers to some extent.

Wins/resolutions

HWU - Public sector health and allied services workers

Public sector health and allied services, manager and administrative workers have voted up a new agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/25f24776-f743-40b8-ab07-52f804ee6649?](https://substack.com/redirect/25f24776-f743-40b8-ab07-52f804ee6649?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/25f24776-f743-40b8-ab07-52f804ee6649?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. 91.3% of HWU members endorsed the deal, with 94% of workers who voted in the final ballot saying yes. According to the HWU the deal includes [[https://substack.com/redirect/2aa83309-a3f8-437c-b99f-a6e5b22799e9?](https://substack.com/redirect/2aa83309-a3f8-437c-b99f-a6e5b22799e9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2aa83309-a3f8-437c-b99f-a6e5b22799e9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] a 12.5% wage increase over 2.5

years; backpay from December 2025; \$1500 pro-rata cash payment and improvements to conditions including enforceable workload protections, reproductive health leave, an increase in personal days without evidence and more.

That's all I've got this week. And I know I cried wolf last week, but I am DEFINITELY taking next week off. We've got a long weekend in Victoria and I intend to try and enjoy some outdoors time before it gets any colder. I'll be back with another report on 17 June.

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1qQXdNamc1TVRRNUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09EQTBNe1l3TXpNc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE1UazNNakF6TXl3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuSEhTSUV5VkFYTHkwWnFiaVdWQm9hcEptSkZBVF8zSEgwb0Mwak9KX2ZfTSIsInAiOjIwMDI4OTE0OSwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc4MDQzNjAzMywiZXhwIjoyMDk2MDEyMDMzLCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.upBBVx08n_jpSjzI-jXRjIfzZmxL03rYuQUJoSrBhrQ?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-3-september>

TWU QLD - Re.Group

On 22 August, workers at the ReGroup Material Recovery Facility in Bli Bli took industrial action for the first time [https://substack.com/redirect/c8f62640-aea3-4233-97ce-fd08051d42ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. After dragging the bosses to the negotiating table by organising a majority support petition [https://substack.com/redirect/fe282034-de48-4545-830f-30753c20b6e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] there have been nine bargaining meetings and one conciliation session at the Commission. These meetings have only made minimal progress for workers. Workers hope industrial action will get the bosses to the table with a decent offer. The workers at Re.Group who are currently on minimum wages [https://substack.com/redirect/b7d9964e-44dd-4bbe-b009-8acc4439609c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] are fighting for better pay and conditions including 7% annual wage increases.

AMWU/CEPU/CFMEU Tasmania - Cascade

26 CFMEU members at the Cascade brewery in Hobart commenced industrial action on 11 August with “rolling intervals of hour-long stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/d44a951b-35c3-42ec-82ea-fa77b5944f62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]”. Negotiations for a new EBA commenced in March, but no agreement has been reached. According to organiser Mark Green, the major sticking point [https://substack.com/redirect/0a9f7e38-a2f4-49d6-98fb-96587fd79b11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] is the brewery’s desire to move to continuous production, but refusing to compensate workers, or to add associated safety protections into the EBA. AMWU and CEPU members at the brewery are currently voting in protected action ballots [https://substack.com/redirect/d44a951b-35c3-42ec-82ea-fa77b5944f62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which will close in mid September. AMWU and CEPU workers have concerns about wages, overtime and conditions. A management proposed EBA with an 8.5% wage increase over 3 years was voted down by workers in August [https://substack.com/redirect/d44a951b-35c3-42ec-82ea-fa77b5944f62?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM].

QTU - Public sector teachers

The QTU has confirmed there will be no further strike action this term [https://substack.com/redirect/166dd1d8-be23-44e4-8034-38096b8a51bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Term 3 in Queensland ends on Friday 19 September, and Term 4 commences on Tuesday 7 October. The “delay in considering” any strike action for four weeks was recommended by the QIRC and agreed to by the QTU’s State Council. QTU members in state schools went on strike for 24 hours on 6 August.

Professionals Australia NT - Public sector pharmacists

Professional Pharmacists Australia (a division of Professionals Australia) members in NT public hospitals commenced industrial action on 26/8 [https://substack.com/redirect/235c5602-fa33-4a5b-a217-52daa19453ed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. Pharmacists had originally planned to commence on 22/8, but were stopped by a last-minute application to the FWC. The industrial action being undertaken is that pharmacists will not claim Federal Government subsidies for medicines they dispense [https://substack.com/redirect/ca313bd4-387d-4b87-a748-7eaaaaa49f11b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which the union claims could cost the Territory up to \$1million a week. In response, pharmacists who participate will have 25% of their pay docked. This is the first time pharmacists in the NT have taken industrial action. Their primary concern is the grave understaffing of pharmacies in hospitals - 50% understaffed in Alice Springs; 30% understaffed in Darwin and Palmerston and no permanent staff in Katherine, which could result in cancer treatment being shut down. The PPA believes without wage increases, it will be impossible for the Territory to attract staff. Pharmacists can earn up to \$20,000 per annum more in Queensland. The PPA are committed to fighting for a better deal for pharmacists in order to ensure safety for patients.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU QLD - Queensland Government

“Tradies” working for the Queensland Government including QHealth, QBuild and the Department of Transport and Major Roads walked off the job on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/d5488f73-c574-42ef-bfff1-534c9a902b74?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] (1/9). Workers are fighting for a fair deal, with the major claim being for a 36 hour week to bring them into line with white-collar public servants. Workers are also demanding an 8% pay increase over 3 years to keep up with the private sector. In addition to Monday’s strike action, the ETU reported that the Department of Transport and Major Roads locked out union members after they voted to participate in paperwork and phone bans.

UWU SA - Public sector health workers

Around 150 public sector hospital and disability workers rallied outside the SA treasurer’s office [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a6dc3d62-c457-47c2-98f3-77373b53f968?](https://substack.com/redirect/a6dc3d62-c457-47c2-98f3-77373b53f968?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a6dc3d62-c457-47c2-98f3-77373b53f968?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on 22 August. This is the latest action in the UWW campaign for a pay rise for low paid public sector health workers. Workers are asking for a 20% pay adjustment to reach parity with other states, and fix staffing issues in hospitals. Workers are asking supporters to sign this petition [

[https://substack.com/redirect/964cce95-4c76-44a2-bca9-c56b02d1ead6?](https://substack.com/redirect/964cce95-4c76-44a2-bca9-c56b02d1ead6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/964cce95-4c76-44a2-bca9-c56b02d1ead6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] to the Premier of SA.

TWU WA - Dnata

Ground workers at Perth airport employed by Dnata have struck twice over the past fortnight. On 21/8 workers struck from 5:30pm until 10am the next day [https://substack.com/redirect/c41f4e3e-a1c5-4264-9b4d-b6767ad221ff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]; followed by a 24 hour strike commencing at 5:30pm on 28/8 [https://substack.com/redirect/d8b38765-ffa3-4803-af71-2131625a73b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are seeking a fair deal - currently they earn less than Dnata employees at airports on the east coast. An agreement put out to vote by Dnata was rejected by workers [https://substack.com/redirect/2cc53c83-8fdc-4bc5-b5cc-cbde8528f406?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - it included wage increases of only 13% over 4 years. Despite 79% of workers rejecting the agreement, Dnata are putting it out to a vote again tomorrow (4/9). The TWU has also alleged that in response to the first strike action, Dnata flew in strike breakers from interstate, working them “dangerously long hours” [[https://substack.com/redirect/d8b38765-ffa3-4803-af71-2131625a73b4?](https://substack.com/redirect/d8b38765-ffa3-4803-af71-2131625a73b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d8b38765-ffa3-4803-af71-2131625a73b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Time for Dnata to start treating their workers with respect! In addition to decent pay, workers are fighting for better roster flexibility, retention of night soil allowance, secure jobs and increased parental leave [

[https://substack.com/redirect/fd8e584b-f761-41c9-b725-95165ff1048e?](https://substack.com/redirect/fd8e584b-f761-41c9-b725-95165ff1048e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fd8e584b-f761-41c9-b725-95165ff1048e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

AMWU/AWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU/The Services Union/TWU QLD - Townsville City Council

Townsville City Council has threatened workers with being locked out [

[https://substack.com/redirect/0fd6bc87-caaf-40b4-a681-02ea090d4484?](https://substack.com/redirect/0fd6bc87-caaf-40b4-a681-02ea090d4484?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0fd6bc87-caaf-40b4-a681-02ea090d4484?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] for 48 hours if they participate in any further industrial action. A media report quotes an AWU official as saying work bans had been lifted [[https://substack.com/redirect/ff0d9ca4-25ef-4e92-bcbf-9fe7c5c7b62a?](https://substack.com/redirect/ff0d9ca4-25ef-4e92-bcbf-9fe7c5c7b62a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ff0d9ca4-25ef-4e92-bcbf-9fe7c5c7b62a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] in any case, but I am unsure if that goes for all unions involved in the dispute. At the time of writing I do not have a clear picture of what industrial action (if any) is still happening. Any Townsville locals reading? Get in touch!

TWU QLD - DHL Brisbane Airport

Last Friday (29/8), TWU members from DHL at Brisbane Airport struck for 24 hours. Workers are fighting for a pay increase to keep up with the cost of living and to ensure parity with interstate DHL workers. According to the TWU, DHL Express made \$1billion in revenue last year, and workers in Brisbane are asking for \$33/hour.

UWW Vic - Fonterra

On 22/8, workers at Fonterra Bayswater commenced industrial action by holding one hour stoppages [[https://substack.com/redirect/f6203709-0aa1-479c-9d2f-c3f3ff2cbdcf?](https://substack.com/redirect/f6203709-0aa1-479c-9d2f-c3f3ff2cbdcf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f6203709-0aa1-479c-9d2f-c3f3ff2cbdcf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] over both shifts. Workers have held stoppages [[https://substack.com/redirect/0ebba186-532a-4417-98ed-07050f04c8b2?](https://substack.com/redirect/0ebba186-532a-4417-98ed-07050f04c8b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0ebba186-532a-4417-98ed-07050f04c8b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] another 3 times over the past fortnight. UWW members are also participating in an indefinite ban on overtime. UWW members are

fighting for a 4 year agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/19dca62e-b802-4b1e-9775-193ba4127cbf?](https://substack.com/redirect/19dca62e-b802-4b1e-9775-193ba4127cbf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/19dca62e-b802-4b1e-9775-193ba4127cbf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] to provide certainty in an uncertain time as Fonterra is about to be purchased by dairy giant Lactalis. Workers are also fighting for an increase to redundancy payments and improvements to safety and conditions.

TWU WA - Metroll

On 21/8, TWU members at Metroll struck for 24 hours. Metroll continues to refuse to negotiate a fair agreement with workers. Workers are fighting for a fair wage offer, a commitment to safety and rights for union delegates.

CPSU NT - Chief Correctional Officers

Chief Correctional Officers in the NT who manage a wide range of prison operations have put the territory's government on notice. The CPSU members have advised 2 weeks of stoppages will commence from 8 September [[https://substack.com/redirect/375ba416-bc88-48ce-8839-8afab00868f2?](https://substack.com/redirect/375ba416-bc88-48ce-8839-8afab00868f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/375ba416-bc88-48ce-8839-8afab00868f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], unless a better offer is made.

EBA negotiations have stalled, and the officers are frustrated and concerned over a number of issues [[https://substack.com/redirect/0afca41a-afcf-402f-825e-ae41553f29ca?](https://substack.com/redirect/0afca41a-afcf-402f-825e-ae41553f29ca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0afca41a-afcf-402f-825e-ae41553f29ca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] including health and safety due to over capacity within prisons; unfair workers compensation arrangements; the removal of the public service redeployment register, and the introduction of 24-hour shifts.

AMWU/AWU/ETU NSW - Solvay Interlox

Workers at Solvay Interlox, who produce hydrogen peroxide for industrial applications, struck for 24 hours last week [https://substack.com/redirect/ef5537e0-4561-46b2-a850-efe53e08ea82?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for fair wages and to maintain and improve conditions. The escalation in industrial action is due to the bosses refusing to come to the table with a decent offer.

ETU/MUA WA - CBH

Union members at CBH's Kwinana Grain Terminal were due to start 5 days strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/d38d9cac-4fec-40f8-b922-45d1471c32d0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on Monday 1 September at 5:30am. However on Sunday evening (31/8), workers were advised that CBH would be locking out all workers [https://substack.com/redirect/d8535f7a-c82b-4db5-a59d-cadeb1e3a73f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from 5:30am on Monday morning. The lockout is in place indefinitely. In a media release [https://substack.com/redirect/833114f8-836b-45fe-98ee-fc85514b1fd8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the MUA revealed that the whole workforce at the terminal (130 workers) were locked out due to the 24 maintenance workers implementing rolling stoppages in response to being told by CBH that they would only be paid 9% of their daily salary if they participated in work bans refusing to do isolations which represent less than 10% of their work on a normal day! WA Branch Secretary Will Tracey called it "corporate bastardry" - a fair assessment.

AEU Victoria - Early Childhood Educators

AEU members at Victorian kindergartens commenced industrial action on 25 August [https://substack.com/redirect/6887e19f-671a-4ac2-8f0a-4de5a7fca459?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This first phase of action includes bans on responding to any enquiries from employers, other than those related to OHS, child safety and welfare or teacher/educator working conditions and a ban on attending staff meetings called by employers. Workers will also stop work should their kindergarten be visited by any Victorian MP from the ALP. This industrial action comes after 15 months of negotiations with no offer of a pay increase. Kinder teachers are fighting for a 35% wage increase to make salaries competitive with school staff, and improved conditions to address workload and burdensome administrative requirements.

UWU NSW - Crown

On 28/8, UWU members at Crown in Sydney went on strike for the third time in a month. Workers walked off the job from 7pm for a four hour stoppage. Crown has put a subpar agreement out to vote - UWU is running a vote no campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/73408882-d263-49ba-a246-841e4cfbbd48?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The current offer [

https://substack.com/redirect/1f6f542c-2011-44f3-9aec-5f91a3c9f888?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] has pay rises below inflation; scraps career progression; does not improve overtime or higher duties rates and pays up to \$24,000 less than what workers at Crown in Melbourne get. Workers deserve a better deal.

The Services Union & others - Rockhampton City Council

On Monday (1 September), The Services Union and other unions at the Council participated in a 1 hour stoppage and rally [https://substack.com/redirect/1384cf4f-bf60-4ddb-a486-d3b5eaf2967d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a decent wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/1b86a3d5-5718-4a1d-91e2-410958f76caa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] but the Council's offer (2.7% in the first year, and 2.5% or CPI capped at 4.5% in the second and third years) could turn out to be less than the state government's own wage policy.

ASU Tas - Derwent Valley Council

On 28/8 ASU members at the Derwent Valley Council commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/14b61a2d-6320-4c39-85fa-3c093139b363?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers held a stoppage on Thursday morning until 10:30am, and have implemented indefinite bans on issuing and collecting fines, fees and rates; street cleaning, toilet cleaning, mowing and litter collection as well as an overtime ban. The dispute has been underway for more than a year [https://substack.com/redirect/33b56856-59af-460f-969b-2fbddc50874c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] since negotiations stalled in May 2024. Wages are the final unresolved item. The ASU is demanding a 4.5% increase or CPI (whichever is higher), backdated to July 2024; the Council won't budge from 2.5%.

AMWU/ETU NSW - Schindler

On 28/8 union members at Schindler Lifts in NSW commenced an indefinite stoppage. Workers have been participating in industrial action since the start of August, and were locked out by the company. Workers are fighting for 6% annual wage increases and improved conditions and job security.

PSA NSW - Art Gallery of NSW

PSA members at the Art Gallery of NSW walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/61419143-4521-43cd-8236-f50b938a1b13?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 27

August to hold a lunch time action in response to the announcement of 51 jobs being cut along with \$7.5 million in funding. The cuts, part of a restructure, prompted the first industrial action at the gallery in a decade [https://substack.com/redirect/aca63f03-bbe7-4726-bbbc-6cc975181d1c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. PSA officials and delegates were due to meet with management yesterday. The consultation period for the restructure has been extended until 16 September. Workers are asking members of the public to contact John Graham, the Minister for the Arts on 02 7225 6030 or at john.graham@parliament.nsw.gov.au [<mailto:john.graham@parliament.nsw.gov.au>] and let him know that cutting jobs is not the answer!

QNMU - Public sector nurses & midwives

The QNMU has reached agreement with the state government [https://substack.com/redirect/1d147695-33da-4112-b4fe-67e7dc8b54d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. The agreement includes wage increases of 11% over 3 years (3% this year with back pay to April; a 2.5% increase over the next two years, and a 3% “government election commitment pay rise” from December 2027 [https://substack.com/redirect/78ae0e4a-0da0-4ba3-8a1b-2329014a2b43?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]). The union had been pushing for 13%. In addition to wages the agreement includes improved allowances including overtime paid at double time, and “most” of the Log of Claims delivered. The offer will now be discussed at member meetings. If endorsed, the workforce will then be balloted.

AMWU Vic - KONE

AMWU members have reached an in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/ed87fd1b-2841-4a06-9dc9-5aac19d87db8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVU1t0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] with Kone. According to the AMWU the agreement secures “significant benefits and quality of life improvements” including wage increases, a sign on bonus, more RDOs and public holidays to be paid at triple time.

HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers

Last Thursday (28/8), HACSU announced that 62% of HACSU's public sector mental health members had endorsed the most recent offer [https://substack.com/redirect/4b4da7a9-a788-4fa5-9bf9-48732479ba04?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] from the state government, ending months of industrial action by workers. For full details of the wage components, and everything else in the offer there is a full breakdown online [https://substack.com/redirect/a56d8021-1835-455a-8d9a-f8aa5c6b9100?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. HACSU shared that changes in the accepted offer [https://substack.com/redirect/e99039d9-8414-4275-862d-4119709e0111?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] included a revised classification and wage structure for Lived and Living Experience Workers; a one-off retention payment of \$4200 per full time employee and a facilitative clause regarding how VHIA and HACSU will work together in relation to the HPSS Gender Undervaluation case.

That's all I've got this week - and I think it's more than enough after a week off! One thing I do want to add before I sign off is a quick comment about the horrendous racist rallies led by nazis over the weekend. This is a massive challenge for the union movement. Racism divides the working class, doing the bosses dirty work for them. Nazi and fascist movements are a threat to organised labour - because they don't like workers being organised and thinking for themselves. Opposing racism and fascism must be part of our work as trade unionists. It was great to see social posts about telling nazis to fuck off [https://substack.com/redirect/405d9f1b-dcf7-4d94-8bf6-b80c50943782?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] from the Victorian Trades Hall Council, as well as tips for dealing with friends or colleagues being sucked into the far-right vortex [https://substack.com/redirect/1fcbe9b7-f3cd-44ac-ae28-0a1f0464f412?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVult0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. But it is going to take more than social media. We have an enormous task ahead of us to build a working class, anti-fascist, fight back. We must do this work, because we cannot allow them to win.

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzZdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMmMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNJNk1UY3lOVFkxT0RRMKxDsnBZWFpT2pFM05UWTRORgcZTURfc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRJNE9ETTRORG3TVN3aWFTYnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4Tnp2aUxDSnpjV0lpT2lKa2FYTMhZbXBhZDJDWdFlXBHNjbjArRknQdkZqc0lFPT2ZuQ1JtZkhNQlBfwk1tVERUUUVjVOGg1VnNHT3FGMUe4MCIsInAiOjE3MjU2Ng0NiwiCMjA5NTc2NiwiZSI6dHJlZSwidGEDE4MzMxNmIsImldhQMlMTc21Njg0ODcwMSwiZSwiOiJyMDcyNDI0NzAxLCJpc3MiOiJldWItMCIsInNjIjY1I6ImxpbnpmcmVkaXJlY3Qif0.fEXYr99Ap3bcPfiJNnXQ5Ju6hAYj_nSEGAJo97mfJoY?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-4-february>

AEU Victoria - Public sector school teachers

The Allen Labor government opposed the AEU's application [https://substack.com/redirect/94182495-f4c3-43b1-b59a-96bc9714a185?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for a protected action ballot. The state government argued that the union wasn't genuinely trying to reach an agreement. The AEU and the government have been in negotiations since August last year [https://substack.com/redirect/10e163c2-23d6-4c46-8311-02d54bd95d6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and the government is yet to make an offer to teachers. The FWC ultimately found that the union was trying to reach an agreement, and ordered for the ballot to go ahead. Voting will open in the coming weeks and close on 12 March. It certainly feels like many Victorian teachers are geared up to fight [https://substack.com/redirect/eb4b2e75-8992-4dda-ad0e-a8f3b99110d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for a decent EBA. While sharing the news that the protected action ballot would go ahead, Branch Secretary Justin Mullaly noted that 600 teachers had joined the AEU [https://substack.com/redirect/8c38b985-a3bd-4357-a520-103c20064caa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the last few days.

AEU Victoria - Early childhood educators

Kindergarten teachers who are members of the AEU are planning on taking a second day of strike action on February 26 [https://substack.com/redirect/d61aae76-20ed-49a4-b13c-2a64bb7eccca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Educators also struck for 24 hours in September 2025 [https://substack.com/redirect/61667b56-6f26-4859-8731-d4a3ebb13fee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The AEU has been in "talks" with the state government for more than 18 months, but an offer "that increases salaries and addresses excessive workload" has not been forthcoming. So much for the education state! One can't help but wonder whether school and kindy teachers can join forces for one big joint strike day to really push the issue with the Allan Government.

AEU/CPSU/HACSU - Tasmanian Public Sector

Last week, leaders of the AEU, CPSU and HACSU in Tasmania urged Premier Jeremy Rockliff to intervene in the public sector negotiations. CPSU Secretary Thirza White said while unions continued to show up to negotiating meetings, "we are meeting with people who clearly do not have the authority to even discuss issues. [https://substack.com/redirect/14c7c78e-9c0f-49b4-871d-eff8d84df8a6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" HACSU Secretary Robbie Moore said the bargaining process was the worst he'd seen, and warned that HACSU members were meeting and voting on whether to escalate their industrial action. On Thursday, HACSU members held a 3-hour rolling stopwork action [https://substack.com/redirect/c04c1a74-749f-4c88-a2cc-8d5cfe9988a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] at the Launceston General Hospital.

CPSU/HACSU Tasmania - Ashley Youth Detention Centre

CPSU and HACSU members at the Ashley Youth Detention Centre struck for 2 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/a86cdcfc8-72c6-49b0-b029-84d73140d867?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] yesterday (3/2). Workers are striking due to safety, security and staffing concerns [https://substack.com/redirect/6c7fe5df-9ef5-4261-b717-ecaac7ad9f57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - it would appear the facility is not safe for workers, or those incarcerated there. The UN has condemned the treatment of young people at the centre [https://substack.com/redirect/245cba0c-8e64-44a0-9aa0-3d7d74a20454?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and both the Tasmanian Aboriginal Legal Service and the Tasmanian Aboriginal Centre have raised concerns about the treatment of Aboriginal detainees at the facility. Workers want the department "to fix the staffing, fix the safety and (to) treat workers with respect [https://substack.com/redirect/6c7fe5df-9ef5-4261-b717-ecaac7ad9f57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]".

HWU Victoria - Public sector healthcare workers

98% of HWU members have rejected an offer [https://substack.com/redirect/347165e8-c140-40ae-a9b1-3afb1346faa5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the Victorian Government. According to the HWU, the offer included 5% pay increases in the first 2 years of the agreement but no wage increase in the third year. In an interview with the ABC [https://substack.com/redirect/6c8f6e16-44a2-4480-a1f3-88844cfae0b3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], lead organiser Jake McGuinness shared that an informal, verbal agreement had been reached for a 2 year deal with 5% annual increases. But then, the offer that was put to members had stretched the deal to 3 years. Work bans are set to continue throughout February resulting in cancellations and delays to Category 1 and 2 "elective" surgeries.

RAFFWU - Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books

If you were a boss, and you were trying to get workers to scab on their mates and work during a strike, what level of financial inducement would you think is necessary? Well, the bosses at Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books offered a measly \$2.50/hour extra to anyone prepared to work during the 5 day strike [https://substack.com/redirect/c68880d5-ce76-4802-824e-603fe40bd926?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] before Christmas. \$2.50?? Are they nuts? Obviously no one reading this is lining up to scab during a strike, but \$2.50 is absolutely laughable. It perhaps points to how disconnected from reality the bosses must be. Since the strike, there have been two bargaining meetings, with another one due to be held tomorrow (5/2). RAFFWU members across all Harry Hartog and Berkelouw Books stores held a 1 hour stoppage on Saturday (31/1) and continue to participate in work bans including bans on meeting with management and training new staff. Workers are also handing out leaflets about the dispute to customers.

UWU - Members First election ticket

As noted in my 2026 Watch List [https://substack.com/redirect/7a22569a-c56e-4f7f-a0c1-9fcfb0f27388?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], UWU will hold its quadrennial elections this year. Two tickets for the election have now been announced. Last week, the "Members First" [https://substack.com/redirect/e88622f4-621d-4024-9e73-50c9169035f8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] ticket was announced on social media. Members First describes itself as a "national collective of members, delegates, organisers and leaders" from more than 45 different industries [https://substack.com/redirect/d2ddf6b5-46e5-48b2-ae8f-09ddced32f68?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] across the country. Their election platform [https://substack.com/redirect/57551d24-7b6b-4df2-a61f-545fc962dca5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is built around 8 key ideas - face to face organising; invest in delegates; regional organising; a strike fund; member-led politics; financial transparency; an open and democratic union; and diversity and solidarity. Leading the ticket are disability support worker and former union organiser Katie McGinn [https://substack.com/redirect/8859074b-8234-48d0-bb48-d4ab2a73ba22?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] who will stand as National President and current National Secretary Tim Kennedy [https://substack.com/redirect/9529aa89-f201-46c9-ac20-c5bd7af83337?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] who will re-contest his position.

A second ticket, the "Workers First Collective" [https://substack.com/redirect/c97d0617-cfc6-4746-a236-f677511647cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is led by current UWU National President Jo-Anne Schofield. On the Workers First Collective Facebook page [https://substack.com/redirect/c97d0617-cfc6-4746-a236-f677511647cf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the ticket positions itself as "a leadership team that brings experience, strong governance, and responsible financial management." The page also has multiple posts attacking Tim Kennedy. This is shaping up to be a robust election campaign. UWU members need to think about what they want their union to look like.

Members First are holding campaign launches where members can hear more about the ticket and its platform and make up their own minds:

Victoria [https://substack.com/redirect/9f997375-e890-4ac1-880a-722078ee98ef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - Sunday 8 February, 1pm, Coburg Town Hall, 90 Bell Street, Coburg

QLD [https://substack.com/redirect/3076cd4e-f92a-46ae-a49a-c14f7d13851b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - Thursday 12 February, 5:30pm, Moorooka Sports & Community Club, 76 Koala Road, Moorooka

SA [https://substack.com/redirect/c1c69c61-ba97-4064-a4a5-22363936cf80?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - Sunday 15 February, 3:30pm, Western Youth Centre, 79 Marion Road, Cowandilla

NSW [https://substack.com/redirect/5fae6658-5c19-4b1d-9c9f-9705f99c6499?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - Sunday 22 February, 2:30pm, Merrylands RSL (Sydney), 8/12 Miller Street, Merrylands

In short

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Nurses and midwives across South Australia will walk off the job tomorrow (5/2) and march through Adelaide demanding a fair new agreement. In addition to the strike action, nurses and midwives are also participating in work bans including refusing to clean beds [https://substack.com/redirect/ff5740fd-3808-40f5-88b3-183352a5bb93?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and mental health nurses refusing to complete NOCC forms.

ETU NSW - Dynelec

An update from the ETU on Thursday (29/1) confirmed that workers at Dynelec were still on strike. Workers are fighting for improved wages and conditions in a new EBA.

AWU/AMWU/ALAEA - Qantas TSS

On Thursday (29/1), engineers, safety trainers and technicians at Qantas coordinated a national 4-hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/d1c0e7ee-5033-458f-835c-00fa10e3dbc3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for a new agreement with fair wages and conditions. Qantas attempted to shut the stoppage down, but were unsuccessful. In Brisbane, workers rallied outside Hangar 3.

AMWU/CPSU/UWU - CSL

Members of three unions at CSL will strike for 24 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/335a7ab4-4580-40e6-a90c-5fc67f5fe03a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] today (3/2). Workers are fighting back as the company threatens “to extend their working hours, cut conditions and move office-based employees off an enterprise agreement on to individual contracts”. Workers have moderated their demands around wages, now seeking “at least” 14% over 3 years which would provide parity with workers at CSL Seqirus. CSL has offered 10.5%.

Wins/Resolutions

UWU NSW - Crown Sydney

UWU has announced on social media that a new EBA at Crown Casino in Sydney has been negotiated [https://substack.com/redirect/1e2bd475-05d3-44cb-b0a3-9373bb4bd318?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Workers at the casino took industrial action last year, including their first ever stoppage and work bans. The new agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/e9ad5602-c2e1-4a4f-ad49-46974e61e9f6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] includes wage increases of 3.25% from 1 July 2025; 3.25% in July this year and 3% in July 2027. Workers had rejected an offer of 3.25%/3%/3% in August last year, so hopefully the new agreement includes some wins on other key concerns including career progression and classifications. I don't have the time to do a full EBA analysis - so if you've got further info on this, let me know!

AMWU/AWU/CFMEU/ETU - Woodside

A delayed update on the dispute at Pluto 2, because writing this meant I had to do maths. As I reported last year [https://substack.com/redirect/588dc6de-4eeb-4cea-80a7-73f54f16512b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], before Christmas, Bechtel (lead contractor) put another offer out to ballot. This offer was voted up by workers and the proposed agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/31c42c5f-f374-48ff-823e-e53ab265dc73?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is currently sitting with the FWC for approval. By my calculations, the proposed agreement would see workers get approximately a 7% wage increase on commencement followed by 5% wage increases in December 2026 and 2027. Unions had reportedly been aiming for a 30% wage increase [https://substack.com/redirect/672c3f08-32b5-4d56-b14a-0fe7db57befd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] over the life of the agreement. The real sweetener on the deal though is a sign-on bonus of \$10,000 for all full time employees covered by the agreement at the time of the ballot closing on 21 December 2025. Hard for anyone to say no to \$10,000 in this economy! While looking through the proposed agreement, I noticed that there is a “Project Incentive Payment” clause which entitles workers on the project to an additional payment of \$175 per completed week of service. What's the catch? “In any week in which an employee has an unauthorised absence or engages in industrial activity not approved by the Company that ceases or disrupts operations the payment will be forfeited in full for that week.”

PSA SA - SA public sector workers

On Thursday (29/1), a joint press conference [https://substack.com/redirect/d362c0a1-d156-46e6-b732-7eacc86d338d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] between the PSA and the SA state government announced that an in-principle agreement had been reached and a proposed new EBA would go to ballot commencing on Friday 30 January. The new EBA which covers salaried workers in the SA public sector includes a 10.8% cumulative wage increase [

https://substack.com/redirect/b390bfa8-224c-4873-9d33-948dc66d6f0c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

A 3.75% wage increase will be backdated to 1 August 2025, with a 3.5% increase on 1 July 2026 and a 3.25% increase on 1 July 2027. In addition to those wage increases, the government's press release [

https://substack.com/redirect/301802cd-9df3-44a0-a253-b12b564fc18a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

notes an additional \$4000 increase to base wages for “historically low paid employees” as well as “further payments to reflect any gap with Award rates”. The agreement also includes improved benefits; improvements to progression between classifications, and a commitment to review of classification structures during the life of the agreement. A “tailored package to support correctional officers” is also included. Correctional Officers struck for 4 days [https://substack.com/redirect/db61660d-4e53-4c4b-9342-cac64ec928e5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in December last year. While the proposed agreement falls short of the 20% the PSA had been aiming for [

https://substack.com/redirect/a35fdf07-7f93-46f1-8142-34df458d621f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM],

the union is advocating for a yes vote noting the short 18-month agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/694ed69f-3d07-4eff-bf81-972e4dbb2bd0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] “will put us in a

stronger position when we return to the bargaining table in just 6 months time". Looking at Facebook comments is a bit like reading tea leaves, but it would seem not everyone is happy with the proposal, and a PSA Facebook post requests [https://substack.com/redirect/4b1ec748-bd12-4179-ae77-680e2d47125b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] "If you've already shared your views here, we ask that you consider whether it's necessary to do so again." The ballot closes [https://substack.com/redirect/4053a3a1-1dbe-4f32-921c-b580b520a367?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on 13 February. That's all I've got this week... and I know I only just got back from holidays, but there won't be a Disputes Report next week. I'll be back with a full report on 18 February. In the meantime, I wanted to share three pieces I've read this week musing on what is (and what isn't!) a general strike. The first is by Tabitha Arnold [https://substack.com/redirect/4a562405-cca8-477a-913d-3aa698c5d1df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], which led me to the second by Joe Burns [https://substack.com/redirect/784306cc-3d07-47e9-94f8-8d52d43acd47?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] and the third by Kim Kelly [https://substack.com/redirect/7b1c6240-6a6c-4bc7-944b-de1457459fd9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM]. All of these are by American writers in the context of the USA, but still plenty of food for thought for us here in Australia. In Arnold's piece she quotes an instagram post [https://substack.com/redirect/1ec577d1-a13d-49ce-825b-c10b67d239ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] from artist Roger Peet who reminds us that "Everyone wants a magic spell to do something about the way things are. But there is no spell. You have to organise."

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UZzJ0ek13TWpBNExDSnBZWFFpT2pFM056QXh0VEE0T0Rjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd01UWTR0amc0Tn13aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhSWDJWdFlXbHNJbjAudjNzdzhPM1BEbXVGZDI5LTJNYkplQ0I2cDVuQnp4X3ExUDN1SE9lZXpfMCIsInAiOjE4NjczMDIwOCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3MDE1MDg4NywiZXhwIjoyMDg1NzI2ODg3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.nv05n3rz9jncU20TZdl_I531IVARTLBdA3CIC3i6J6w?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-4-june>

QNMU - Public sector nurses and midwives

Public sector nurses and midwives in Queensland will commence industrial action on Thursday (5 June). More details will be disclosed at a statewide member meeting this afternoon at 4pm. Stay tuned! The QNMU shared [https://substack.com/redirect/e5ce6515-ec80-498d-92d7-b2e84f8abd11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] that while the Crisafulli

Government had “shifted its position on some points, the revised offer still presented too many unanswered questions, missing commitments, and continued to put conditions at risk.”

CRU & ETU NSW - Sydney Trains

On Friday (30/5) in the Fair Work Commission, the Combined Rail Unions and the NSW Government reached an in-principle agreement. The proposed agreement includes a 12% pay increase over 3 years as well as back pay [https://substack.com/redirect/1cfd2be-5a23-47c1-82c7-b835282aa263?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. However, it's not a done deal

yet. The ETU, who split from the CRU claiming inadequate representation for its members through the multi-union alliance, are not happy with the proposed agreement. The ETU contends that Claim 145 (creating a trades-based section to maintain relativities in the classification structure) has been actively blocked by the CRU, and that the ETU didn't receive a copy of the proposed agreement until 10 minutes before the FWC hearing on Friday. The laws that cover multi-enterprise agreements say that every union covered by the agreement must agree to the proposed agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/3e38657f-cae4-48c1-8d13-9cb8558fc095?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] before it can be put to a ballot

of workers, so this is not yet a done deal. The ETU remains in discussions with the NSW Government.

VAHPA - I-MED

Industrial action at I-MED continues with stoppages at Frankston, Peninsula Private and The Bays last Wednesday (28/5). More stoppages were to have taken place on Friday (30/5) and Monday (2/6) but I don't have any details. If you've got any further information on this dispute - please get in touch!

AWU NSW - Zinfra

Workers at the largest gas distributor in NSW struck for 48 hours from 4am last Tuesday [https://substack.com/redirect/8f075d52-af30-4e9c-ac8f-673dfc390821?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (27/5). 235 workers at depots in

Newcastle, Bathurst, Forbes, Unanderra and Sydney walked off the job as part of their EBA campaign for 5% annual wage increases. Zinfra has only offered 3.5% increases. Management allegedly gave themselves a 7.5% wage increase last year. The action meant that no repairs, maintenance or connection hook ups occurred over the 2 days, and the AWU has warned that reliability across the network could be at risk if industrial action continues.

CFMEU QLD - QUBE

Crane operators at QUBE in Queensland have been on strike for a week after unanimously voting to strike indefinitely. The workers are fighting for market rates and a fair agreement. In one heartwarming moment [https://substack.com/redirect/70688288-8a1e-4d73-a73b-72bf444e7d07?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM], a worker found a job on Seek,

only to discover it was QUBE hiring a scab labour force and he was taking the job of a striking worker. Once he worked out the situation, he left the job and headed immediately to the union picket.

AWU QLD/The Services Union - Noosa City Council

Workers at Noosa City Council have been locked out again. After talks in the QIRC on 22 May failed, unions were told by the council that any workers who continued to participate in industrial action would be subject to an unpaid lockout from 23 May - 2 June [https://substack.com/redirect/6a5abf69-338a-445c-b35a-031789df5abe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

Workers are taking the dramatic step of doorknocking and leafleting local residents [https://substack.com/redirect/dfa0bbca-cc65-4ae0-8be4-696dd6217ebf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] to bring the community's attention

to this long running dispute. Unions are demanding the negotiations be taken out of the CEO's hands and resolved by the mayor [https://substack.com/redirect/28a3be2c-c167-4766-a38a-1fc37af5d56a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. While the dispute centres on pay

increases, there is also mounting evidence of a toxic work environment [https://substack.com/redirect/aba0f606-9370-4dc0-b4a6-595477b8be9e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] at the Council. Another meeting

will be held in the QIRC on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/e3fdb753-3b1d-46e3-b05c-9fe938d85b87?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (6/6).

CFMEU Vic - BMS

Today (3/6) will be day 13 of industrial action by BMS workers at the Golden Plains Windfarm in Rokewood. According to the [https://substack.com/redirect/776a39e0-20c6-4b2c-a696-3c59eb574628?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] Concrete Gang [

[https://substack.com/redirect/776a39e0-20c6-4b2c-a696-3c59eb574628?](https://substack.com/redirect/776a39e0-20c6-4b2c-a696-3c59eb574628?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/776a39e0-20c6-4b2c-a696-3c59eb574628?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on the 8th day of stoppages, the bosses came and locked the workers out, demanding that if they didn't sign the proposed agreement that they should go and find another job. Action was expected to "ramp up" this week.

ASU Vic - CFA

Paid CFA staff commenced industrial action yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/d858897f-5275-41b7-b3d0-37a9828b2871?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (3/6). ASU members at the CFA are stopping training, not recording fuel management data and diverting calls and emails to the bosses. All internal communications will be in RED ALL CAPS. Workers haven't received a pay increase since 2023, and claim negotiations with management have stalled after 6 months. Management is pushing the state government's wage policy of 3% annual increases on the workers, although apparently signed off on more than 4% for themselves last year. The industrial action is directed squarely at the bosses and should not effect volunteers or communities.

AMWU VIC - Mission Foods

Workers rallied at Mission Foods in Epping on Monday [https://substack.com/redirect/05512ace-f19b-4d09-8be3-d5b8de28615a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (2/6) in support of Victorian HSR of the Year Navneet Bedi. Navneet was stood down by management last week. Of course the bosses have made allegations against him, but the truth of the matter is that he has been stood down for doing his job, and representing his members. The bosses have apparently been discriminating against Navneet for some time, including hiring a supervisor to "supervise" only Navneet. I guess he was HSR of the year for a reason! Stay tuned to AMWU socials for next steps in the campaign to support Navneet.

HSU SA - Public sector psychologists

Public sector members of the South Australian Psychologists Association, a HSU sub-branch, are commencing industrial action today [https://substack.com/redirect/58c6e0db-e65b-400a-8af2-cf77abc8d17e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. SAPA has revealed that four major services – the Statewide Neuro-behavioural Units; the Brain Injury Rehabilitation Unit; the South Australian Intellectual Disability Health Service and the Eastern Child and Adolescent Mental Health Service – have no psychologists left. Yes, you read that right. ZERO psychologists left. SAPA is fighting for fair pay and conditions for public sector psychologists in SA – they are the lowest paid in the country. By improving their conditions, these services will be able to attract and retain psychologists. SAPA President Deborah McLean has said that the industrial action will "disrupt bureaucratic processes while remaining on the front line for the consumers who depend on us"

CPSU A Voice For Members - Gold Review

Rank and file election ticket "A Voice For Members" [https://substack.com/redirect/531f182c-a7f0-4138-a39d-2d19f45285e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] who are contesting the upcoming CPSU SPSF (Victoria) elections have hit back at the Allan Government's review of the public service and plan to slash public sector jobs. The Silver Review, led by Helen Silver, was asked by the state government to find efficiencies and provide recommendations to reduce the size of the public service. A Voice For Members have put forward their own counterproposal [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b4c3ebd7-8bac-4273-a262-79ed54fff8d7?](https://substack.com/redirect/b4c3ebd7-8bac-4273-a262-79ed54fff8d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b4c3ebd7-8bac-4273-a262-79ed54fff8d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] – The Gold Review [

[https://substack.com/redirect/9ca85090-3afe-499a-8ab2-7d15e7062fb6?](https://substack.com/redirect/9ca85090-3afe-499a-8ab2-7d15e7062fb6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9ca85090-3afe-499a-8ab2-7d15e7062fb6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] – which they describe as a job-focused alternative. The ballot for the CPSU election opens on 10 June and closes on 8 July.

Annual Wage Review

The ACTU may have described it as a "Union Win!" [https://substack.com/redirect/3c0423f3-b883-4a10-95dc-046d86b9104f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] but the 3.5% increase to minimum and award wages [https://substack.com/redirect/a49dc817-4607-4085-9112-4cc842c3e589?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is less than the peak body advocated for (4.5%) and only 1% more than the ceiling ACCI put in its submission (no greater than 2.5%). So perhaps, less of a union win and more a safe, straight down the middle decision? The Australia Institute described the decision as an "appropriate reward [

[https://substack.com/redirect/1acc582d-a0e3-4d88-969b-e0a87725af54?](https://substack.com/redirect/1acc582d-a0e3-4d88-969b-e0a87725af54?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1acc582d-a0e3-4d88-969b-e0a87725af54?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]" but still noted that their research shows "the real value of award wages had fallen nearly 4% below September 2020 levels. This increase will still see award wages 1% lower than they were five years ago." [

[https://substack.com/redirect/1acc582d-a0e3-4d88-969b-e0a87725af54?](https://substack.com/redirect/1acc582d-a0e3-4d88-969b-e0a87725af54?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1acc582d-a0e3-4d88-969b-e0a87725af54?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] I think the analysis from RAFFWU [[https://substack.com/redirect/0701b28a-fb5c-4b21-b574-3a4bfff6ce60c?](https://substack.com/redirect/0701b28a-fb5c-4b21-b574-3a4bfff6ce60c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0701b28a-fb5c-4b21-b574-3a4bfff6ce60c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] might resonate the most with minimum wage workers: "Every cent counts for retail and fast food workers. But this increase maintains woefully low poverty rates and falls far short of what would be required to undo the damage of cost-of-living rises over the past three years."

That's all I've got this week. A bit of a rushed job this week, but I hope I can follow up on a few things for next week's report. If there's anything you think should be in the report - please get in touch!

In solidarity, Sarah

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AEU/CPSU/HACSU Tasmania - Tasmanian public sector workers

On the mainland, we have the luxury of forgetting about the existence of Eric Abetz. Not so for our Tasmanian comrades who have to suffer with Abetz as the state's treasurer. Last week, Abetz rubbed salt in the wounds by commenting in relation to the difference in wage offers between cops and other public sector workers - "with respect, police have a more difficult role than public servants." [<https://substack.com/redirect/8ac940c9-8798-4781-a37f-d0753e08a810?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] You know whenever anyone starts something with "with respect" it's going to be INCREDIBLY disrespectful. Absolutely disgusting comment. What a grub. Abetz's comments didn't occur in a vacuum. The AEU, CPSU and HACSU had all suspended industrial action to return to intensive negotiations with the state government after indications that a package similar to what the Tasmanian police received would be on offer. But for each union, the negotiations ended in disappointment with the government renegeing on a fair deal. HACSU has reinstated 120 bans [<https://substack.com/redirect/a6d0185a-b635-4a69-861e-7fcdccacc110f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] across the public health system including actions to cost the Tasmanian state government huge amounts of money by not billing Medicare and diverting pharmacy costs [<https://substack.com/redirect/efc48449-75e6-4920-9f49-dfc133b4e4d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] to the state government. HACSU members also recommenced stopwork actions including 1 hour stop work meetings at Mersey Community Hospital and North West Regional Hospital on Monday [<https://substack.com/redirect/ca22b778-6709-48f0-9257-f703edec7043?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] (2 March); a 1 hour stop work meeting at Launceston General Hospital yesterday [<https://substack.com/redirect/568ee2b5-a056-452e-ba3f-4442ed778168?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] (3 March) and stop work meetings will take place at Royal Hobart Hospital and St John's Park today. The stoppage at St John's Park will also include CPSU members [<https://substack.com/redirect/3ad86882-76c8-492b-bbbb-a2023ef59207?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] from the Forensic Science Service, the Child Safety Service, Strong Families Safe Kids Advice and Referral Line and the Department of Natural Resources & the Environment. The AEU is considering further industrial action, but nothing announced as yet.

UWU NT - Northern Territory firefighters

Firies in the Northern Territory will commence industrial action this Friday (6/3). Firies will be wearing campaign shirts, writing slogans on fire trucks and holding public rallies. UWU members employed by NT Fire Service "overwhelmingly" voted in favour of industrial action [<https://substack.com/redirect/32bcb077-1a39-4148-bc54-35ef31932977?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>]. UWU has been in negotiations with the NT Government for 8 months. Firies are seeking health and safety provisions for workplace cancer protections as well as improvements to workplace flexibility; attraction and retention; fatigue controls; and safe staffing levels. The last offer from the government in December proposed 3% annual wages increases over the life of the agreement. While this is in line with the Territory's wages cap policy - it is less than the NT police and public servants received.

AEU Victoria - Early childhood educators

On Thursday, AEU members who work as early childhood educators walked off the job for 24 hours [<https://substack.com/redirect/ea1d72ff-f4c8-4db3-bfa0-31b190466ee3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] and rallied in Melbourne. The AEU has been in negotiations with the state government for 20 months, and this is the second 24 hour strike the educators have participated in. Early childhood educators have not had a pay increase for 2 years. While the state government has committed to 15 hours of free kinder for 3-year olds and 30 hours for 4-year olds, they seem intent on ignoring the people who are going to provide that education.

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU - QBuild

Union workers at QBuild walked off the job for 24 - 48 hours (depending on union) last week after receiving a "woefully inadequate [<https://substack.com/redirect/185ce743-ae31-4f5c-bff4-df561ba1e846?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>]" offer from the Queensland Government. The offer included an 8% wage increase over 3 years; no backpay (agreement expired in August 2025) and other unsatisfactory changes to classifications and the excess kilometres allowance. With the agreement being voted down, I believe arbitration was due to start this week.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

On Friday (27/2); a bus driver in Charlestown (Lake Macquarie) was stabbed. HSRs issued a cease unsafe work direction [<https://substack.com/redirect/d467d533-c5cb-4494-95cd-976301af7fb4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbG9eM>] and bus services were suspended until further notice. SafeWork NSW conducted an inspection, and the unsafe work direction was lifted

on Saturday afternoon (28/2). This is not the first time buses in the Newcastle area have stopped due to driver safety concerns - HSRs also stopped the buses in March 2025 after a driver was threatened with serious assault. RTBU members have been fighting for a new EBA for almost 12 months with demands for improved wages; fair notice for shift changes; and improvements to driver safety.

In short

AFULE/RTBU QLD - Pacific National Queensland Coal

Yesterday (3/3), Pacific National commenced a 24 hour lock out [

[https://substack.com/redirect/c9aff4a5-5b27-4c54-bc71-2652d86e9bc4?](https://substack.com/redirect/c9aff4a5-5b27-4c54-bc71-2652d86e9bc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c9aff4a5-5b27-4c54-bc71-2652d86e9bc4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] of its Queensland Coal workforce.

The lockout was in direct retaliation of an overtime ban implemented by AFULE and RTBU members which kicked off on 23 February and is due to finish on Sunday. Drivers voted down [

[https://substack.com/redirect/fd79c332-a946-418e-928d-b0729f3be782?](https://substack.com/redirect/fd79c332-a946-418e-928d-b0729f3be782?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fd79c332-a946-418e-928d-b0729f3be782?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] a proposed agreement in January.

Workers first voted to take industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/5d2b53af-6ddf-450c-](https://substack.com/redirect/5d2b53af-6ddf-450c-a3b5-d0e4730ea329?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[a3b5-d0e4730ea329?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5d2b53af-6ddf-450c-a3b5-d0e4730ea329?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] in October and commenced industrial action in November 2025 [https://substack.com/redirect/7e9ee60f-1784-4757-8243-47516cc4aafe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

ETU QLD - Department of Transport and Major Road

On Monday (2 March), sparkies at the Department of Transport and Major Roads went on strike. ETU members at TMR are in dispute with the government, along with many public sector workers in Queensland. Workers are fighting for a better pay deal.

Wins/resolutions

HWU - Public sector healthcare workers

On Wednesday (25/2), the HWU announced that members had endorsed the offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b134e1b1-a55c-41ae-926e-f0ef9b5c94d7?](https://substack.com/redirect/b134e1b1-a55c-41ae-926e-f0ef9b5c94d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b134e1b1-a55c-41ae-926e-f0ef9b5c94d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] from the state government. As

reported last week, the offer includes a wages component of a 12% wage increase over 2 and a half years. This was the third offer put to members. 5964 votes were cast in the ballot, with 91.3% voting up the agreement. I did reach out to the HWU to ask how many members were eligible to vote, but haven't heard back. A media release from the union about the strike action in January suggested more than 10,000 [[https://substack.com/redirect/b1f9bd53-bd6e-4b43-8699-c138f27c9f11?](https://substack.com/redirect/b1f9bd53-bd6e-4b43-8699-c138f27c9f11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b1f9bd53-bd6e-4b43-8699-c138f27c9f11?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] would participate in the strike which gives us a bit of an idea. With the offer endorsed, all industrial action and work bans have now stopped [[https://substack.com/redirect/e5bf2c09-0a4c-41f0-8c7b-1a905276b1eb?](https://substack.com/redirect/e5bf2c09-0a4c-41f0-8c7b-1a905276b1eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e5bf2c09-0a4c-41f0-8c7b-1a905276b1eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

That's all I've got this week. Since my last report, war has commenced in Iran and across the Middle East. I don't have any unique insights into this terrible situation, but as a worker my heart aches to see more violence, more killing, more death and more destruction. They said a bayonet was a weapon with a worker on each end, and I know the same can be said of the fighter jets, missiles and drones. We know who war benefits - and it sure as hell isn't workers. Education International released a statement [[https://substack.com/redirect/d5fe203a-85a8-443b-8edc-b034602794f7?](https://substack.com/redirect/d5fe203a-85a8-443b-8edc-b034602794f7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d5fe203a-85a8-443b-8edc-b034602794f7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] condemning the bombing of schools in Iran. A statement from the ITUC [[https://substack.com/redirect/d24d13f7-5728-4d38-9ade-](https://substack.com/redirect/d24d13f7-5728-4d38-9ade-5dc40a973ba1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[5dc40a973ba1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d24d13f7-5728-4d38-9ade-5dc40a973ba1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] has called for an immediate ceasefire, an end to all military operations and a return to peaceful negotiations. More

locally, the MUA has put out a statement [[https://substack.com/redirect/fcc065d0-1c65-45fb-96c2-](https://substack.com/redirect/fcc065d0-1c65-45fb-96c2-dd491301a613?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[dd491301a613?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/fcc065d0-1c65-45fb-96c2-dd491301a613?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] condemning the

attacks by Israel and the USA on Iran. It also reminds us that peace is union business.

In solidarity, Sarah

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ASMOF Victoria - Public hospital doctors

Doctors at major hospitals in Melbourne will walk off the job next Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/8b5cee1a-d50a-432a-a3df-f9e2f57e99ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (13/8). It has been reported that doctors will strike from 12:30pm - 4pm. Doctors in emergency departments and other critical areas will not participate. It will be the first strike action [https://substack.com/redirect/00f2abcb-ee5c-4350-914e-6703bb49d972?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] taken by public hospital doctors in Victoria in 20 years. "Nearly 76%" of eligible members voted in the protected action ballot endorsing industrial action. 97% of those who voted were in favour of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/3415ad99-9e13-49ee-bb52-bd052c6c3fc2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Negotiations for a new EBA started in August 2025, and the current EBA expired in February 2026. Key claims [https://substack.com/redirect/7705bda0-af6b-4244-8dfd-a1bc053a9293?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from ASMOF include banning shifts longer than 12.5 hours, capping consecutive night shifts at four in a row and introducing doctor-to-patient ratios as well as a 30% wage increase over 4 years. "Phase One" of industrial action commenced this week including "visible campaigning" and work bans targeted to disrupt billing, administration and revenue raising activities.

AWU Vic - Department of Transport & Planning

AWU members at the Victorian Department of Transport and Planning commenced industrial action on 23 July [https://substack.com/redirect/3214bd49-95ae-4de0-adb4-ef3073c45073?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are in EBA negotiations but have been told by the Department to move to a 24/7 roster, that they will lose 13 RDOs and that public holiday rates will be reduced. That sounds less like negotiations and more like slashing conditions. Incident Response workers are taking industrial action between 7am and 10am and 4pm and 7pm on weekdays [https://substack.com/redirect/4f21afa8-8726-42d4-93f3-1963abb606f2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. When there are crashes, spills, debris or breakdowns on major arterial roads, workers will close all but one lane of traffic while they are resolving the issue. The union has successfully pissed off Jacqui Felgate [https://substack.com/redirect/bf6af17d-dc92-44b0-b95b-e417c857fefb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], so hopefully the bosses in the Department will get the message and return to the negotiating table with a fair deal.

AMWU/AWU/ETU WA - BHP

Union members from port operations at BHP met last Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/92deea73-76a3-43c4-ace3-9af05f9460b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (30/7) and endorsed further industrial action at Port Headland. This followed a negotiation meeting on 28 July between unions and BHP ending without any agreement being reached [https://substack.com/redirect/b9fbbec4-59a3-4ae5-86b0-449a1ad2e3cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Union members will implement a 24 hour ban on loading ships on Saturday 8 August, followed by a 24 hour complete stoppage from 5:30am on Sunday 9 August [https://substack.com/redirect/5dd45a93-898b-4584-9193-148254eefa9f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. ETU members who are high voltage specialist electricians negotiating a separate agreement from port operations will also strike for 12 hours on 9 August. A 5 hour bargaining meeting [https://substack.com/redirect/e9a00bf6-0134-478d-8e03-758eb8e5c0c2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] was scheduled yesterday (4/8), but finished prematurely [https://substack.com/redirect/8fda0e53-794f-4272-9b65-36ae238385cb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A spokesperson from BHP said "significant progress" [https://substack.com/redirect/c6a4d323-ff8b-490f-819f-cda26be06bda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] had been made and called on unions to call off strike action. At the time of writing there is nothing to indicate the strike action has been called off. According to media reports the current offer from BHP [https://substack.com/redirect/b9fbbec4-59a3-4ae5-86b0-449a1ad2e3cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] includes a 16% wage increase over 4 years "for most", improved allowances and "a simplified pay structure". Couple of red flags there! ETU WA Branch Secretary Adam Woodage said [https://substack.com/redirect/92deea73-76a3-43c4-ace3-9af05f9460b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] "we are not going to entertain what the company is pushing". WMAA spokesperson Craig Beveridge added [https://substack.com/redirect/5dd45a93-898b-4584-9193-148254eefa9f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that "instead of engaging in the bargaining process, BHP continues to delay, distract and waste time." Union members at BHP are fighting for decent base rate wage increases, classifications, career progression and fair

conditions.

Professionals Australia - ACT Government Forensic Scientists

Last Wednesday (29/7) forensic scientists who work at the ACT Government's Analytical Laboratory walked off the job in their first ever strike [https://substack.com/redirect/ac6a0228-4fec-470d-8e80-d2321f017cb3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Professionals Australia members held a two hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/db7c41e0-15a7-4aaf-ace3-052489749181?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and marched to the ACT Legislative Assembly demanding a fair deal, and for their claim for a hazard allowance to be recognised. This is an escalation in the workers' campaign - they have been participating in a range of work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/f3fbdd33-67cd-4afa-b532-e3b818fe3752?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] since 29 June. This is another cohort of ACT public sector workers who are dissatisfied with the government's recent offer [https://substack.com/redirect/8ce83901-2f6f-4f88-a776-d147d17bfd50?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

ASU Victoria - Metropolitan Melbourne council workers

ASU members from 8 metropolitan Melbourne councils stopped work for 4 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/ae4bc432-1413-4f20-bfd1-4825edb2723f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] last Thursday (30/7). Workers at the councils are fighting for a new multi-employer agreement. During the stoppage, union members rallied outside Parliament House. Workers' demands [https://substack.com/redirect/57baafb6-54ad-469a-acd0-5f108b13c8fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] are simple: they want a 10% wage increase in the first year of a new agreement, followed by 4% annual wage increases; they want councils to stop blaming workers and start negotiating a fair deal and they want the state government to proceed with rate capping reform. In addition to the strike on Thursday, workers from Hobsons Bay council rallied outside their local council meeting [https://substack.com/redirect/b959d9e8-a304-4a57-98ca-77c5845ce9a9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 28 July. Negotiations continue with management, and while some progress has been made, key differences remain on wages.

AMOU/MUA QLD - River City Ferries

Union members at River City Ferries who run Brisbane City Cat services are set to strike this Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/d88c0fc2-6c56-4fa3-ae4b-4d9d400a3824?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (7 August) between 8am and 10am. This will be the second strike for the workers, who stopped work last Friday (31/7) from 8am to 10am [https://substack.com/redirect/43da3a6b-659b-4b53-b06e-5dc309d922fd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] disrupting peak hour travel. According to the MUA, despite numerous bargaining meetings, River City Ferries refuse to budge from their position [https://substack.com/redirect/893fe70b-b9dd-4285-8e26-da5f210109dd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. They have signed off on significant wage increases for their executive leadership team, but will only offer workers a below-inflation increase. The bosses have also failed to act on improving work-life balance or fatigue management.

UWU SA - Arnotts

More than 160 UWU members at Arnott's in SA walked off the job for 24 hours yesterday (4 August). This is the first industrial action taken at Arnott's since the 1990s. For the past four years, workers have received wage increases of 2.5% which has just not kept up with the cost of living. In Adelaide, inflation over 4 years has been 17.4%. Workers wages have gone backwards in real terms. UWU members want the boss to come back to the table with a serious offer that reflects the cost of living. Arnott's is now owned by private equity giant KKR which manages around \$US758 billion in assets. Time to pay workers a decent wage.

NTEU NSW - University of Sydney

NTEU members at the University of Sydney will commence industrial action next week. Workers plan to hold a 2 hour stop work meeting [https://substack.com/redirect/aca5e1a0-07cc-4c89-950e-9c5bae6d73df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 10 August to discuss "the industrial campaign needed to shift management at the bargaining table." The stoppage was voted on at a members meeting on 21 July. 235 voted in favour of the 2 hour stop work meeting, 66 against and 19 abstentions. Honi Soit noted [https://substack.com/redirect/d817bdbb-8361-4e42-bffd-597d77933cb0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that many of the 66 voting against the motion were voting for a stronger motion calling for a 24 hour strike on 20 August. Bargaining commenced in April [https://substack.com/redirect/15c23f91-30ab-46ca-a5e3-415eeee5e231?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] this year after being delayed by USyd management for 6 weeks. Key issues in the dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/d817bdbb-8361-4e42-bffd-597d77933cb0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] include academic and intellectual freedom; change management; AI and teaching associate positions.

VAHPA - Public sector allied health workers

Next Tuesday (11/8) VAHPA members from across the public sector will strike for 24 hours. A union

rally [[https://substack.com/redirect/8031fd6a-98e9-4b53-adbb-9c0c0ec60cc2?](https://substack.com/redirect/8031fd6a-98e9-4b53-adbb-9c0c0ec60cc2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8031fd6a-98e9-4b53-adbb-9c0c0ec60cc2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] will be held at 12 noon outside the Peter MacCallum Cancer Centre on Royal Parade in Parkville (Melbourne). This follows a previous 24 hour strike on 16 June alongside MSAV members. In the subsequent weeks, VAHPA members have held lunchtime rallies out the front of their workplaces across the state. Workers have been bargaining with the Victorian government for almost a year. An acceptable offer is yet to be made.

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

ANMF members have rejected the state government's most recent offer [

[https://substack.com/redirect/38270cf7-1422-4de7-9039-999f674eee2a?](https://substack.com/redirect/38270cf7-1422-4de7-9039-999f674eee2a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/38270cf7-1422-4de7-9039-999f674eee2a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], despite it being recommended by the leadership of the branch. The offer included a 16% wage increase over 3 years [

[https://substack.com/redirect/da237a7b-4545-4be3-aff5-578f1d1c9bc7?](https://substack.com/redirect/da237a7b-4545-4be3-aff5-578f1d1c9bc7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/da237a7b-4545-4be3-aff5-578f1d1c9bc7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], which did not meet the demands of the union. The offer also didn't meet key claims including counting babies as patients in maternity wards. The state government will now refer the matter to the South Australian Employment Tribunal for arbitration. The argument put forward by the branch was that while the offer did not get nurses and midwives everything they wanted, an assessment of "the current environment" led them to believe the offer should be accepted. Looks like the members felt there was still a bit more gas in the tank, and they were willing to fight a bit longer for a bit more. According to a "vote no" campaign group [

[https://substack.com/redirect/7c55df18-ea90-4042-9f4e-e0cee0000dfe?](https://substack.com/redirect/7c55df18-ea90-4042-9f4e-e0cee0000dfe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7c55df18-ea90-4042-9f4e-e0cee0000dfe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], 67% of those who voted, voted no.

Members involved in the no campaign are now pivoting to "reinvigorate" the branch. Nominations for [

[https://substack.com/redirect/778d8120-ce73-464a-bf4d-4efe171af404?](https://substack.com/redirect/778d8120-ce73-464a-bf4d-4efe171af404?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/778d8120-ce73-464a-bf4d-4efe171af404?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] Branch President, Branch Vice

President, 4 Branch Executive Members and 15 Branch Councillors closed yesterday.

RTBU - Pacific National

RTBU members at Pacific National commenced industrial action over the weekend [

[https://substack.com/redirect/87408b12-522b-4eb2-b2d7-e3742eab7731?](https://substack.com/redirect/87408b12-522b-4eb2-b2d7-e3742eab7731?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/87408b12-522b-4eb2-b2d7-e3742eab7731?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] as part of negotiations for the Intermodal Train Crew EBA. Starting on Saturday (1 August) RTBU members put a 48 hour ban on overtime in place. This was followed by a 24 hour ban on "Lift Up and Lay Back" changes on Monday (3 August). Lift Up and Lay Back changes are provisions that allow the boss to adjust a worker's scheduled start time to manage network emergencies, delays or disruptions. A "Lift Up" brings forward the start time by 1-2 hours; and a "Lay Back" delays the start of a shift by 2-4 hours. The industrial action has worked in so far as Pacific National have agreed to return to the bargaining table [

[https://substack.com/redirect/add9bba5-5519-43bd-9049-5b69dce7f9d4?](https://substack.com/redirect/add9bba5-5519-43bd-9049-5b69dce7f9d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/add9bba5-5519-43bd-9049-5b69dce7f9d4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] next week. Key claims in the dispute include restrictions on the use of Lift Up and Lay Back; increasing the number of weekends off duty; improvements to the disciplinary clause; cracking down on unsafe car driving and 5% annual wage increases.

ASU SA - City of Port Adelaide Enfield

Last week, ASU members at the City of Port Adelaide Enfield took their third round of industrial

action [[https://substack.com/redirect/5a93e217-db86-4b06-a313-008bbe3163d6?](https://substack.com/redirect/5a93e217-db86-4b06-a313-008bbe3163d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5a93e217-db86-4b06-a313-008bbe3163d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. This time the action was a 3 hour stoppage. Workers are fighting for a fair EBA. In particular, they are fighting back against a proposed clause which would give the bosses the right to redeploy any worker unilaterally. Workers are also concerned that the City of Port Adelaide Enfield, along with other South Australian councils are investigating the future use of AI at councils - with no consultation with workers.

AEU Victoria - Public school teachers

The AEU Joint Primary and Secondary Council met on Friday (31/7) and voted for another 24 hour strike on Wednesday 19 August [[https://substack.com/redirect/ecfd368c-3a3b-4f23-b210-891f430cadcl?](https://substack.com/redirect/ecfd368c-3a3b-4f23-b210-891f430cadcl?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ecfd368c-3a3b-4f23-b210-891f430cadcl?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. I understand other motions

including for a strike on 4 August and to align strike action with VAHPA on 11 August were unsuccessful. At the time of writing, I don't believe negotiations have resumed as yet and new Education Minister Gabrielle Williams will need to get her skates on to get a revised offer together if she wants to avoid a third strike from the teachers. While the Fight the Crisis rank and file group pushed hard for mass strike action on 4 August [[https://substack.com/redirect/58fd0cc0-6bad-49f6-86d9-bcc767553a27?](https://substack.com/redirect/58fd0cc0-6bad-49f6-86d9-bcc767553a27?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/58fd0cc0-6bad-49f6-86d9-bcc767553a27?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], ultimately they shifted to calling for local stop works and actions [[https://substack.com/redirect/3050b119-401a-41be-a62a-a879d30c07a1?](https://substack.com/redirect/3050b119-401a-41be-a62a-a879d30c07a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3050b119-401a-41be-a62a-a879d30c07a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

Interestingly, since former Education Minister Ben Carroll became Premier, messaging on AEU Victoria social media has been focusing on not just the VGSA negotiations, but also a renewed push for full funding of public schools in Victoria [[https://substack.com/redirect/c9083d91-416e-4d5d-bf11-2302358cb259?](https://substack.com/redirect/c9083d91-416e-4d5d-bf11-2302358cb259?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/c9083d91-416e-4d5d-bf11-2302358cb259?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

HACSU Vic - Scope

Last Wednesday (29/9), HACSU notified Scope that industrial action would commence on Tuesday 4 August and continue until Friday 4 September. The action included a range of bans including bans on completing vehicle logbooks; bans on completing transport transition plans; bans on using personal mobile phones or vehicles for work; copying management into all emails; and wearing and distributing campaign materials. But on Monday (3 August), the FWC made an order [https://substack.com/redirect/537b620a-e60d-4d4b-94e7-661706fac3c8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] under s.418 of the Fair Work Act that the industrial action must stop, not occur and not be organised. Section 418 relates to unprotected industrial action happening or being organised. So I dunno if there was an issue with paperwork or what, but the action is not happening. Discovered this one too late to check in with the folks at HACSU to try and get an explanation. But industrial action is not to go ahead [https://substack.com/redirect/ce80da25-7ef0-40c3-9620-9a176d56f18e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Stay tuned.

In short

AWU Victoria - RLA Polymers

AMWU members at RLA Polymers unanimously voted in favour of taking industrial action. Last week they kicked off their industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/7a2d495f-72d7-4a46-aba8-984e3ae7e270?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] with an overtime ban. RLA Polymers makes construction adhesives (for tiling, plumbing, waterproofing etc).

UWU WA - ISS

Airport screening officers at Perth airport will continue their industrial campaign with more stoppages today [https://substack.com/redirect/fb534880-cb72-4c93-ba1f-06b68040e4a1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (5 August). The UWU members employed by ISS at the airport commenced industrial action in July. Workers are fighting for a fair deal - pay parity with east coast colleagues, secure jobs and respectful rostering practices.

AMWU Vic - Acciona M&E

In July I reported [https://substack.com/redirect/68eb841b-1867-4acb-b965-a8aae2151421?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] that AMWU members in Acciona's Mechanical and Electrical division commenced industrial action. On Thursday (30/7), the Victorian Branch of the AMWU announced that workers are now on strike indefinitely as Acciona refused to meet and finalise bargaining. Workers rallied outside Acciona's office [https://substack.com/redirect/ad172484-26d0-4a06-8d85-e4ac7a6e9514?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] in South Melbourne on Monday (3 August). Acciona is a Spanish multinational that works on infrastructure and renewable energy projects.

MEU - Peabody

The MEU launched FWC proceedings against Peabody's third lockout of workers at the Wambo Washery, and Peabody promptly abandoned the lockout [https://substack.com/redirect/58a26fe0-7388-4cdb-9474-00bf0634c4e2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Peabody has also agreed to pay workers for the latest lockout [https://substack.com/redirect/51492b9e-c38b-4bcf-8442-4a472fc9cb37?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Sounds like a guilty conscience to me! Peabody's share price has also taken a tumble [https://substack.com/redirect/2a371a61-5073-4915-9582-1f88211d8516?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

The MEU is calling on Peabody to start negotiating in good faith.

AMWU/ETU Vic - Downer

Last Wednesday (29/7), AMWU and ETU members at the Pakenham and Calder Park Rail Depots commenced rolling stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/b0bcbb9d-7d16-4142-91eb-af978bc6056e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers are fighting for industry standard wages and conditions, roster protections and rights for delegates. Downer is contracted to maintain the High Capacity Metro Trains until 2053. Workers are seeking pay parity with workers who perform the same work at Metro Trains and V/Line.

PABO Watch

CPSU/MEAA Victoria - Arts Centre Melbourne

Some more information [https://substack.com/redirect/a75db077-5b60-4ce8-85db-88f227d8a0b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on the protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/f6e9624f-4851-4e3e-a34a-458856841baf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] at The Arts Centre is now available. The ballot opened last Wednesday (29/7) and closes today (5 August). Key claims in bargaining include wages, allowances and leave entitlements. The MEAA is also calling for increased government funding [https://substack.com/redirect/0edd33f9-68e6-4bc5-ab73-227158d85b68?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] for Arts Centre Melbourne.

TWU - Cleanaway

TWU members at Cleanaway in Dandenong have unanimously voted [https://substack.com/redirect/be650dac-a44e-4b1a-ac1b-6947ebb9c154?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]

https://substack.com/redirect/be650dac-a44e-4b1a-ac1b-6947ebb9c154?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] in favour of taking industrial action. Bosses refuse to make a decent offer, and are increasing intrusive surveillance of workers. Cleanaway has a terrible record as an employer [https://substack.com/redirect/473c015b-46ee-420b-86f7-29cf4866f63b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]. Across Australia, 8 workers have been killed at Cleanaway since 2022. 5 of these workers were killed on the job in just the last two years. The TWU has also shared harrowing stories including one Cleanaway worker who permanently lost their vision from toxic chemicals, and other safety risks including used syringes left on top of bins, blocked fire exits, out of date PPE and wing mirrors held together with tape. Solidarity to the workers at Cleanaway in Dandenong leading the fight against this terrible employer.

ASU Vic - Service Stream Coliban

ASU members at Service Stream Coliban have unanimously voted in favour of taking industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/1bc0716f-8948-4a22-994b-a451ced62b13?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM].

Service Stream have lost their contract at Coliban, with the contract due to finish in mid 2027. This leaves workers in an uncertain position. Workers have not had a pay rise since 2024, and want to ensure they get a fair deal.

Members are meeting this week to discuss implementing bans including stop works, bans on travel between work locations, displaying campaign materials on vehicles and redirecting phones and emails to management.

Wins/resolutions

AMWU/AWU Vic - UGL

Workers at the Viva Oil Refinery in Geelong have endorsed a new EBA [

https://substack.com/redirect/5e4595b4-d8b8-4cec-9d63-d3fbd2a4257a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] after weeks of industrial action.

The new agreement includes [https://substack.com/redirect/e2f3a8ac-bc57-4afb-bb7e-cf3c1e09b2d8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM] no loss of entitlements; an 11.5% pay increase over 3 years (4%/4%/3.5%); improved allowances, two paid rest days when workers change from night to day shift after a long period; a \$3000 sign-on bonus and back pay to July 1.

That's all I've got this week, and in fact - it's all I've got for this whole month. Since I started this project in November 2023, I haven't really had much of a break aside from over the summer holidays. So I am taking the rest of the month off from the report. I will be back with a BUMPER edition on 2 September. There is so much going on at the moment with lots of disputes and elections in play, but I need to step away from my laptop and have a rest. I look forward to returning in the Spring rejuvenated and ready to catch up on everything.

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3J1cG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjlwWkNjNk1qQTV0emN5T0RBNEExDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09EVTR0emt5TURJc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE56UXhOVEl3TWl3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAuczBiMHMxcG54S1I4TWtIWfJQbVRNd0ktbXFvb1JjTGgwbGttang3cXlaQSI5InAi0jIw0Tc3MjgwOCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImldhdCI6MTc4NTg3OTIwMiwiZlXhwiIjoyMTAxNDU1MjAyLCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.8PJ0MM0avzsgPNHoyf8IhSW1Cb3lr_OpYVvfbJ9obY?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-5-february>

The Services Union/MEU - Gladstone Power Station

Workers at Gladstone Power Station commenced a 24 hour stoppage yesterday (4/2) after management failed to address key claims in negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/8cd40281-fdd3-4529-af93-51a5982e054f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including a cost of living adjustment. In addition to the stoppage, a number of bans were put in place including a ban on operating units above 110MW, indefinite bans on overtime, call-out/recall work, bans on use of technology and bans on performing higher duties or seconded roles. In much less than 24 hours, the MEU shared that a “successful outcome” had been reached.

AEU VIC - Victoria University

The AEU has shared that teachers in the vocational education part of Victoria University have commenced industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/63bcd819-41bd-415c-912f-993010c0a6db?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. I don't have details on what actions are being undertaken, but workers are fighting for action on workload and for pay parity with RMIT and Swinburne. Any VU teachers reading - I'd love to hear more about the action!

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to read the full report straight to your inbox.

AWU NSW - Snowy 2.0

Workers on Snowy 2.0 walked off the job last week over safety concerns [https://substack.com/redirect/bc66c402-c6ed-4676-8b3c-b51558d0cc8b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers have raised concerns that safety chambers for underground emergencies have not been maintained, and there hasn't been sufficient training in their use. It has also been reported that there have been no safety drills in recent times. The job has been riddled with safety, environmental and engineering concerns since it started. The project is also over budget and behind schedule. There has been one fatality associated with the project [https://substack.com/redirect/9808605e-2665-465a-b897-4feee753fba1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] when a subcontractor driving pre-cast panels to the project crashed and was killed.

CFMEU Manufacturing Vic - Opal

Today will be the 20th day of the lockout of workers at the Opal Paper mill in Maryvale. Workers are concerned the lockout may be protracted as there is still a lot of product in warehouses and it is understood production has been stepped up by the multinational internationally. Sally McManus attended a mass meeting in Morwell last week [https://substack.com/redirect/9c0f9da2-ccc2-4d19-9156-a5b673e2c343?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and called for the ALP to change laws to stop bosses from being able to lock out workers [https://substack.com/redirect/320ccd51-5d3c-4909-8ee3-24b922d66ca6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] or at least make lockouts a proportional response. Predictably, employer groups condemned the call [https://substack.com/redirect/95aa3e0c-2973-4041-8919-15ac2f751951?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and Workplace Relations Minister Murray Watt merely encouraged Opal to negotiate with workers. A strike fund for workers has raised \$55,000 thus far [https://substack.com/redirect/f3b48fb2-e4f9-48a7-a041-7cb5d9ed4542?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

CRU - Sydney Trains

NSW Transport Minister Jo Haylen who described industrial action on Sydney's train network as “intolerable” has been forced to resign over her use of taxpayer funded drivers for private trips - including a 13 hour, 446km round trip [https://substack.com/redirect/d40e070a-2108-4d48-a9bb-458878ad7881?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to a winery for lunch. But as the RTBU has speculated, a new Transport Minister could be a fresh start [https://substack.com/redirect/9b65049a-0812-49a1-9597-c025bfd8e18e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The Combined Rail Unions were due to be back in the FWC this week for further conciliation meetings [https://substack.com/redirect/3b4399a4-3e14-411d-9822-fd276f7ebb7d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and the RTBU have notified Sydney Trains/NSW Transport of new industrial actions [https://substack.com/redirect/9b65049a-0812-49a1-9597-c025bfd8e18e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to re-start the industrial campaign.

UWU - Star Casino

Star Casino is on the verge of collapse, and UWU has called for the NSW and Queensland Premiers to step in and take “immediate and decisive action” to protect the jobs of 9000 workers at the 3 Star Casinos [https://substack.com/redirect/d08cd0c9-a0b7-4a6a-bcb9-f5cf7c1458e6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Given the huge societal damage gambling causes, I don't know how I feel about a government bail out of a casino. Perhaps we need to

think creatively and call for a just transition for casino workers into less harmful industries?

RTBU QLD - Brisbane City Council

The RTBU commenced 30 days of industrial action at Brisbane City Council last Thursday (30/1).

Industrial action includes work to rule and a uniform ban.

ASMOF NSW - Junior Doctors

Doctors will rally at the Royal Newcastle Centre tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/cbc6c4a2-a2b1-425a-96ea-d5594077b781?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (6/2) at 11am in response [https://substack.com/redirect/20bb6e47-2a7e-44aa-949a-312914ff3ab6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to a leaked email where a hospital administrator called junior doctors “clinical marshmallows” [https://substack.com/redirect/37aa9efb-f0d4-4469-bb03-b5832745f192?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

Junior Doctors in NSW last year won a class action [https://substack.com/redirect/3e20216d-996a-4d98-a1dc-de902cacc093?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] against the NSW Government in relation to unpaid overtime with NSW Health paying out \$230 million to doctors [https://substack.com/redirect/6baf0f91-e94d-4065-aa21-146ac52eadc5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Meanwhile, award negotiations have stalled [https://substack.com/redirect/0229f5f2-7c39-4eae-847c-015129ceaf9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Doctors, psychiatrists, nurses -

Chris Minns doesn't seem to want to pay anyone, and yet 88 hour waits at hospitals are being reported [https://substack.com/redirect/d46bb3bf-ffff-408f-9b3f-fb45222b926f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

ASU - Maurice Blackburn

The fight for fair at Maurice Blackburn continues with another protected action ballot order being granted yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/e9879573-aacb-4928-abb0-51e256086e26?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (4/2). The ballot will close on Tuesday 18 February, so stay tuned for more industrial action at MB's.

CFMEU/AMWU Vic - Loy Yang

A number of workers at AGL's Loy Yang power station, employed by Programmed Energy & Resources were sacked in January. One HSR was sacked 2 weeks before his probationary period was up for raising safety concerns. According to the Concrete Gang, workers took 48 hours strike action commencing last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/515fe38a-6e78-4b75-a91c-03b22a918cf0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (29/1).

UWU - Serco

Serco has lost its contract with the Federal Government to provide security at immigration detention centres creating uncertainty for the workforce [https://substack.com/redirect/1d55f1d3-1feb-4ab3-ac3a-ca405ef39679?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. According to UWU not one Serco employee had been offered a job with the new contractor Secure Journeys. UWU has also criticised Serco for sending misleading letters advising workers that they would need to resign in order to get a job with Secure Journeys, which would rob them of redundancy payments. The union said last week strike action had been endorsed by 96% of members [https://substack.com/redirect/02391d30-dc89-48d0-a96e-18a5ce7f4991?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and would start this week if a suitable resolution was not reached.

TWU - Dnata

Following recent strike action, the TWU has reached an in-principle agreement with Dnata [https://substack.com/redirect/93384085-9dd8-4d0d-ae5f-b2df9e708e48?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. It has been reported the deal includes a 12% pay increase over 2 years, improvements to rosters and rest periods and increased shift penalty rates. The in-principle agreement that was reached in December and then abandoned [https://substack.com/redirect/76d2ffc8-2d84-4240-a8a7-b90fc000f8a7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] was for 11% over 2 years, but appears to have had most of the same condition improvements as the new agreement.

ANMF/HACSU Tasmania - Launceston General Hospital

On Monday, nurses and healthcare workers rallied outside Launceston General Hospital in response to the lack of air conditioning in the hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/9c0c192d-37b6-4581-a14b-5b59e0e960f7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Portable air-conditioners, cold face washers and icy poles were being rolled out by management - which was rightly viewed as insufficient by unions. Unions are calling for urgent action from the government to ensure a safe environment for workers and patients. Heat policies are often seen as the domain of blue collar and outdoors workers, but the LGH situation shows it doesn't matter where you work. A seemingly lighthearted video of a bloke chucking a tinnie to a worker on a construction site [https://substack.com/redirect/4d2ed4b6-3aae-400e-871c-e7ced00547df?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in Perth last week actually revealed serial safety violator Hanssen Constructions keeping a construction site open after the temperature had reached the threshold where workers should have downed tools. No job is worth risking

your health and safety. As the climate crisis deepens, bosses must make suitable arrangements for working through the summer.

CFMEU - Civil Construction

A NSW CFMEU organiser's car was firebombed at their home on Monday (3/2). In his report [

[https://substack.com/redirect/8fa09053-56cd-4b37-baaf-78f328b0531f?](https://substack.com/redirect/8fa09053-56cd-4b37-baaf-78f328b0531f?j=eyJlIjoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJlIjoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8fa09053-56cd-4b37-baaf-78f328b0531f?j=eyJlIjoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], The Age's Nick McKenzie implied that former CFMEU officials are somehow involved, writing that "the targeted organiser ... had cut ties with [former CFMEU officials] and now aligned himself with those leading the union clean-up". Only later did he mention that authorities are actually investigating whether "the official's car was targeted in connection to an industrial dispute [at the Western Sydney Airport] project ... [where] the organiser was involved in a dispute with a major form work company on the site over safety issues and had instructed union members to down tools." The government and media talk a lot about criminality in the construction industry, but bosses who may or may not firebomb union officials' vehicles aren't the ones being put into administration. Meanwhile, the Civil Contractors Federation is lobbying [[https://substack.com/redirect/62ac4407-0484-4ded-9535-b20bf9522a84?](https://substack.com/redirect/62ac4407-0484-4ded-9535-b20bf9522a84?j=eyJlIjoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJlIjoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/62ac4407-0484-4ded-9535-b20bf9522a84?j=eyJlIjoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] for even more new laws to prevent the CFMEU negotiating EBAs in the Civil Construction sector.

That's all I've got this week. Thanks to the readers who helped fill in some gaps in the report this week. Please feel free to get in touch and share your thoughts, or let me know what I've missed!

In solidarity, Sarah

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVn1YMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UVTJORFE0TkRnM0xDSnBZWFFpT2pFM016ZzNNREU0TKRbc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM01ESXp0emcwTUN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT2lKa2FYTMhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbAUMew2Q3JNTlp1azlMcHQyVEZ6Y1o1VKE4QnR4RFYyRVpta1N6ellZMkpSSSIIsInAi0jE1NjQ0ODQ4NywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImldhdCI6MTczODcwMTg0MCIwZXhwIjoxNzQxMjgzODQwLCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.VfyS-0mUUEgt-14uL-kwKkbgYLRMvVsONy2bMwVRO34?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-5-march>

HACSU/ANMF - Public mental health workers

HACSU members stopped work for 2 hours last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/c06143fa-e375-4a0d-80bd-0f8c29802225?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (26/2) at Northern Health and at St Vincent's on Friday (28/2) as an escalation of their EBA campaign. The union says there has been "no meaningful movement [https://substack.com/redirect/da40d0b7-1384-40ac-bd11-0e4c783ca611?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" from the Victorian Hospitals Industry Association or the government. In addition to these stop work action, both HACSU [https://substack.com/redirect/e3466a6e-8a50-43ee-afc4-a83818776b8f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and the ANMF [https://substack.com/redirect/ad7ff9c7-baf8-4095-aa7e-34238722924b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] have implemented a range of work bans as part of the campaign for a new public sector mental health EBA. Negotiations have been underway for 7 months.

UWU - Serco

Industrial action at immigration detention centres around the country continued over the weekend [https://substack.com/redirect/dab1e888-88e5-4bca-885f-209cabfd26ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as Serco is still refusing to address redundancy claims as the detention centres' operation is transferred to a new contractor. On Sunday (2 March) the FWC issued a recommendation that stoppages be reduced from 4 hours to 2 hours. Workers at 9 detention centres had already taken 4 hours of industrial action that morning before the FWC issued its recommendation [https://substack.com/redirect/dab1e888-88e5-4bca-885f-209cabfd26ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. UWU believes Serco is deliberately inflaming tensions, while workers just want their entitlements.

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AMWU QLD - UGL

Workers at UGL in Townsville struck again last Wednesday (26/2) in pursuit of a better deal from the boss.

ANMF Vic - St Vincent's Private

At a mass meeting last Tuesday (25/2) ANMF members at St Vincent's Private Hospital voted to put the revised offer from management to a formal vote [https://substack.com/redirect/111c9c86-ffae-4015-ae93-64f1a1c92e13?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This followed 100 days of protected industrial action. Protected industrial action came to an end on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/5562d3fe-2f86-4bed-9dea-bdddfbf6e1d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (28/2) after drafting was completed. The union conceded that the campaign had not achieved all demands, but also expressed a concern that it was unclear what support there was for escalated protected industrial action and "what that would achieve [https://substack.com/redirect/111c9c86-ffae-4015-ae93-64f1a1c92e13?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]". The ANMF lists the wins of the campaign as an extra week of annual leave for part-time shift workers; 5 days compassionate leave; 5 uncertified personal leave days; recognition of unpaid parental leave for the accrual of long service leave, a Consultative Committee and "recognition of the pressing need for additional staff in the agreement". A ballot for endorsement of the agreement will now take place.

AMWU/CEPU SA - BAE

Last Tuesday (25/2) over 400 workers at BAE Osborne walked off the job [https://substack.com/redirect/3140cdfb-1f04-46b2-b075-7fcf2c6f80d5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Both the morning and afternoon shifts held 1 hour stop work meetings [https://substack.com/redirect/e1a28243-f1a7-4be5-a642-4e1a1427af98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] to discuss their EBA campaign. Workers struck again yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/d08d0946-6d66-4eff-b556-a46893e2a4ae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (4/3). Workers are seeking pay parity with ASC. In September last year workers from both BAE and ASC rallied outside the Premier's office [https://substack.com/redirect/2e241d4e-02f8-48bb-a45a-043e821f847e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of their campaign for improved wages and conditions. But while the dispute at ASC concluded in November [https://substack.com/redirect/b20d313f-b7dd-4cd4-b2fb-54a7356bfe0b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], BAE's continues. Last year, workers at BAE rejected management's offer of a 9.75% wage increase over 3 years, holding out for annual increases of 6.5% (19.5% over three years) [https://substack.com/redirect/7eb02b4c-ef4f-4796-9fcf-136b89f6b5bc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

HSU - Young Hospital/Cootamundra Pathology Lab

Pathology workers at Young Hospital are striking for 24 hours today [

[https://substack.com/redirect/68e3d129-40dd-442b-885c-7f87efb42363?](https://substack.com/redirect/68e3d129-40dd-442b-885c-7f87efb42363?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/68e3d129-40dd-442b-885c-7f87efb42363?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] (26/2). The dispute is over pathology services in the wider Murrumbidgee region. It has been decided that the Cootamundra Pathology Lab will be closed, meaning all the work currently undertaken there, will end up at the Young Hospital pathology lab (about 40 minutes from Cootamundra). Workers are concerned the closure of the Cootamundra lab will increase wait times for results and put more pressure on pathology services. Workers will be rallying outside the hospital for a press conference at 11:30am this morning.

AMWU/ETU/PPTEU Vic - Nestle

Workers at Nestle Campbellfield and Broadford have strongly voted in favour of taking industrial action after 9 months of negotiations for a new EBA. From tomorrow (6/3), workers will implement bans on overtime and callbacks, and stop work for 1 hour at the start of every shift. The workers have demanded 8% annual pay rises, but Nestle are refusing to budge from 3.5%. The main sticking point in the agreement though is rostering. Nestle have proposed moving from 3 eight hour shifts of a standard working week based on 36 hours to a 24/7 roster. Under the proposed arrangement maintenance workers will be required to work 12 hour shifts - up to 5 in a row. There will also be a requirement to work every second weekend and through public holidays. There would be no monetary compensation for this changed work pattern. Workers will also hold a protest on Thursday 6 March from 2:30pm at Nestle Campbellfield (1585 Hume Hwy (Sydney Road), Campbellfield). Get along and support them if you can.

USU - Wingecarribee Shire Council

Any locals from the Wingecarribee Shire Council area reading this? There are a few media reports about a culture of bullying and harassment at the Council, with the USU apparently filing a dispute in the NSW IRC [[https://substack.com/redirect/76613597-e2b5-4d20-860d-1146199ec82b?](https://substack.com/redirect/76613597-e2b5-4d20-860d-1146199ec82b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/76613597-e2b5-4d20-860d-1146199ec82b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. On Thursday (27/2), the Council posted a statement claiming the USU would participate in "unlawful industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/305d2bf6-5423-47e4-bd4f-15aac3c0151e?](https://substack.com/redirect/305d2bf6-5423-47e4-bd4f-15aac3c0151e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/305d2bf6-5423-47e4-bd4f-15aac3c0151e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]" from 1pm Thursday 27 February until 8:30am on Monday 3 March. I haven't been able to track down any further details. Any locals or USU members that can shed light on the situation - please feel free to get in touch.

AMWU/ETU WA - Alstom Metronet

Workers at Alstom Metronet in Bellevue will walk off the job this Friday (7/3) at 11:30am [

[https://substack.com/redirect/cb7df240-286e-47a7-a3f4-481d71940842?](https://substack.com/redirect/cb7df240-286e-47a7-a3f4-481d71940842?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/cb7df240-286e-47a7-a3f4-481d71940842?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Unions have been in negotiations for an EBA for awhile at this stage. The last bargaining meeting was held on 24 February where Alstom wouldn't agree to the union's claims, and subsequently lodged a dispute in the FWC. As such, workers felt there was little option but to take industrial action. Unions are seeking a 23% wage increase over 3 years, but Alstom's best offer thus far is only 12% over 3 years. Workers are also fighting for a 36 hour week.

MUA WA - Teekay

Bunkering operations (supplying fuel to ships) will be impacted by industrial action at Fremantle Port from this Friday (7/3) until 4 April [[https://substack.com/redirect/ea325d3f-e2c8-4cbe-af10-da6171476aba?](https://substack.com/redirect/ea325d3f-e2c8-4cbe-af10-da6171476aba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ea325d3f-e2c8-4cbe-af10-da6171476aba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. MUA members have voted to take industrial action against marine services company Teekay due to their use of cheap, exploited labour. Workers will participate in a range of bans including a ban on operating cranes between 6am and 5pm; a ban on operating winches; a ban on bunkering cruise ships or ocean liners unless they have been tied up to a wharf in Fremantle for at least 72 hours; a ban on training employees and contractors; and a ban on sending emails. The union wants a fair deal for workers, and an 100% YES vote on industrial action shows they are ready to fight for it.

ETU NSW - Sydney Trains

Important update on the Sydney Trains dispute. With the ETU breaking away from the Combined Rail Unions, the union has now applied to the Federal Court to have the FWC's decision to suspend all industrial action thrown out [[https://substack.com/redirect/7f196a67-c50b-41e3-8010-175f68bfb55e?](https://substack.com/redirect/7f196a67-c50b-41e3-8010-175f68bfb55e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/7f196a67-c50b-41e3-8010-175f68bfb55e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The ETU contends that the CRU did not adequately represent the ETU's interests and that the decision to suspend all industrial action until July gives the government an unfair advantage in negotiations as in August, the dispute will have been going long enough for Sydney Trains to apply for an intractable bargaining declaration. The case will be before the Federal Court on March 7 - so stay tuned for the next update.

The Services Union/RTBU - Brisbane City Council

After The Services Union members at Brisbane City Council took industrial action on Thursday (27/2), RTBU members at the Council shelved their planned peak hour strike [

[https://substack.com/redirect/31f05232-bc25-4736-ae84-d0ed61b2e8e1?](https://substack.com/redirect/31f05232-bc25-4736-ae84-d0ed61b2e8e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/31f05232-bc25-4736-ae84-d0ed61b2e8e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] as a deal between unions and the Brisbane City Council was made. The media reported the deal as being a 7.35% wage increase over 2 years [[https://substack.com/redirect/b3f6b82a-7741-43bd-820a-c6e6171ae517?](https://substack.com/redirect/b3f6b82a-7741-43bd-820a-c6e6171ae517?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b3f6b82a-7741-43bd-820a-c6e6171ae517?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], only a fraction above the 7.25%

<https://substack.com/redirect/c9d85405-9580-4f2e-b457-2cc11e6db020?>

MUA Domestic Violence Solidarity Leave

Not a dispute, but a great initiative worth sharing. The MUA have launched a campaign to introduce a new leave type that they are calling “Family and Domestic Violence Solidarity Leave” [

<https://substack.com/redirect/5cc1847a-ecff-4ab2-be10-048178d50329?>

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Sydney Branch organiser Shane Reside described the initiative: “This leave is for maritime workers to render assistance to their loved ones in times of crisis. For example, if my sister in Brisbane was to call me today in tears because her partner has torn the house to pieces, I could get in the car, drive up to Brisbane, pick her and the kids up and bring them back to safety. That would all be covered by this category of leave. [<https://substack.com/redirect/0fcdddc6-c46a-4cf9-a74b-070d68e5a708?>

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbf_KD9-eM]” The MUA has successfully secured 10 days of paid Family and Domestic Violence Solidarity leave in 6 workplaces across Sydney. The union now wants to roll it out across the industry. Last week, 40 MUA delegates in Sydney participated in a day of training about the leave, including how to recognise when loved ones are experiencing violence, how to help, and how to support the roll out of this leave across the industry. This fantastic initiative follows in the footsteps of annual leave, sick leave, parental leave and domestic violence leave. No boss has ever happily given a worker a paid day off work - every single category of leave has been fought for by workers and their unions. Hats off to the MUA for leading the charge on this one.

International Working Women's Day

This Saturday, 8 March, is International Working Women's Day. They can pry the extra "W" in IWWD out of my cold dead hands. Get along to a demo to mark this important day if you can.

Sydney - Saturday 8 March, 1pm - Town Hall Square

Darwin - Saturday 8 March, 8:30am - Civic Centre Courtyard

Adelaide - Saturday 8 March, 11am - Victoria Square

Hobart - Thursday 6 March, 12:30pm - Franklin Square

Melbourne - Thursday 6 March, 5:30pm - State Library of Victoria

Perth - Oops we missed it. The WA comrades rallied last Friday, 28 February.

That's all I've got this week. There are a bunch of things outside of the realm of disputes that I would love to write about, but I'm a bit time poor currently. If I manage to get some time and space, I'll post them as substack notes [<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen/notes>] and in my instagram stories [<https://substack.com/redirect/6b0b51b9-53e2-41d8-82a3-363ac7ef9a47?>

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVult0QrntwdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - so if the prospect of that interests you, make sure you've subscribed and followed. Thanks also (as always) to the readers who helped fill some gaps in the report this week.

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades and subscribe.

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlCzG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXLKMMMyVnlyMmxrSWpvcME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkrJlwwkNjNk1UVTRNe1U0T0RFMExD5nBZWFpT2pFM05ERXhNakEwTVRrc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjM01qWTF0a1F4T1N3aWFTYnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXpVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT21Ka2FYTMhZbXhsdWJdF1XbHNjbjAud1N2Q2l6YXE1UfC2LTZZYVlqXBFU1lBMUdmY0tZY1l1faUppqeEZJjNzMCIsInAiOjE1ODM1ODgxNCwicjE1MCJA5NTE6SiNiwiZlI2SwidS16NDE4MzMyNmSiImldhCjE1MTc0MTEyMDQxOSwiZXRhZjoxNzQzInEYnDE5LCJpc3MiOiJldWltcmJpInNjY1I6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlZ3oiOi0uSTF9nzIIMdVeItH24KL1I0IteItH05RChw-ek12lWjKb4?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-5-november>

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU QLD - Queensland Government

Trades workers across 3 departments of the Queensland Government struck for 24 hours yesterday (4/11). Workers are calling for the introduction of a 36-hour working week to bring them in line with their white-collar public sector colleagues.

AWU Vic - Infrabuild

AWU members at Infrabuild in Laverton commenced rolling stoppages [

[https://substack.com/redirect/59540f28-1ebd-49c0-8adb-1ab910b5cbf6?](https://substack.com/redirect/59540f28-1ebd-49c0-8adb-1ab910b5cbf6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/59540f28-1ebd-49c0-8adb-1ab910b5cbf6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on 24/10. Social media posts indicated [[https://substack.com/redirect/5812018e-beb4-4ddd-953e-745fc1479a2b?](https://substack.com/redirect/5812018e-beb4-4ddd-953e-745fc1479a2b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/5812018e-beb4-4ddd-953e-745fc1479a2b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] they started another week of action last Monday (27/10). Workers voted down the boss' offer, and are committed to fighting for a better deal with fair wages and conditions. Workers commenced another 24 hour stoppage this morning. [[https://substack.com/redirect/ee9fd894-356e-4f69-b78c-0d126adca1d1?](https://substack.com/redirect/ee9fd894-356e-4f69-b78c-0d126adca1d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ee9fd894-356e-4f69-b78c-0d126adca1d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]

HSUWA - GenesisCare

Radiation Therapists - health workers who administer radiation treatment to cancer patients - at GenesisCare commenced industrial action on Monday (3/11). Workers are fighting for a fair agreement and wages that keep up with the cost of living.

ASU - SCHADS Award

On 23/10, ASU members across the country rallied against proposals put by AIG [

[https://substack.com/redirect/112f88b9-a7a2-4bd6-8aa6-b6080dc9408c?](https://substack.com/redirect/112f88b9-a7a2-4bd6-8aa6-b6080dc9408c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/112f88b9-a7a2-4bd6-8aa6-b6080dc9408c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] to the Social, Community, Home Care and Disability Services (SCHADS) Award review. The ASU claims the proposals could result in wage cuts of up to \$930 per week for some workers covered by the award. AIG responded by saying that the ASU's campaign "intended, in part, to intimidate or coerce the Australian Industry Group into adopting a position that accords with the position of the ASU." [

[https://substack.com/redirect/6dcd8b95-5e05-4b4a-b887-f841d5ed8734?](https://substack.com/redirect/6dcd8b95-5e05-4b4a-b887-f841d5ed8734?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6dcd8b95-5e05-4b4a-b887-f841d5ed8734?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] I believe hearings were held at the FWC last week, but don't have a current update on the status of the review - please get in touch if you can provide some info on this.

AEU/CPSU/HACSU/UWU- Tasmanian Public Service

Industrial action continues in the Tasmanian public service following a rejection of the state government's "take it or leave it" offer of a 3% pay rise on a one year agreement. Tasmania's public schools closed for half days last week as AEU members participated in stop work meetings [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2b7b0037-1fcb-4489-af1e-49ad60757b03?](https://substack.com/redirect/2b7b0037-1fcb-4489-af1e-49ad60757b03?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2b7b0037-1fcb-4489-af1e-49ad60757b03?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] in the north-west on 28 October;

the north on 29 October and the South on 30 October. CPSU [[https://substack.com/redirect/6a7f4d-78d5-4557-afc4-985227c9c662?](https://substack.com/redirect/6a7f4d-78d5-4557-afc4-985227c9c662?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6a7f4d-78d5-4557-afc4-985227c9c662?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], UWU [

[https://substack.com/redirect/8339bf12-3921-45a2-8e09-6b892de5319e?](https://substack.com/redirect/8339bf12-3921-45a2-8e09-6b892de5319e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8339bf12-3921-45a2-8e09-6b892de5319e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] and HACSU [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d8dac650-2c1a-44fa-bbfa-1f1b2ad6faa0?](https://substack.com/redirect/d8dac650-2c1a-44fa-bbfa-1f1b2ad6faa0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d8dac650-2c1a-44fa-bbfa-1f1b2ad6faa0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] members also participated in these mass stop work meetings. It is understood that HACSU members have also implemented work bans in over 70 workplaces. Many of these are revenue bans like pharmacists not charging patients for medicines or podiatrists not charging for wound dressings - this will strip the government of revenue whilst ensuring people still get the services they need. It is likely more joint stopwork meetings will occur. The Tasmanian Government cancelled bargaining meetings with unions last week, although a little birdie told me they did have time to meet with the Police Association to work on a deal. ANMF members are not currently participating in industrial action, but support those workers who are and have pledged not to "take on extra duties that lessen the impact of others' industrial action."

NTEU NSW - University of Newcastle

NTEU members at the University of Newcastle walked off the job on the afternoon of 23 October [

[https://substack.com/redirect/8709fba7-4c18-4814-92c7-231288fff366?](https://substack.com/redirect/8709fba7-4c18-4814-92c7-231288fff366?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8709fba7-4c18-4814-92c7-231288fff366?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Workers rallied and marched on campus [[https://substack.com/redirect/cab04c4b-6d91-42a2-ad6e-f7e2b92599ec?](https://substack.com/redirect/cab04c4b-6d91-42a2-ad6e-f7e2b92599ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/cab04c4b-6d91-42a2-ad6e-f7e2b92599ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] attempting to deliver a suggestion box to the Vice Chancellor but were prevented by security guards. Workers have been in negotiations with university management for 6 months, and the negotiations come with the backdrop of budget cuts at the university with both jobs and courses on the chopping block. Prior to the strike on 23 October, University of Newcastle requested the FWC to intervene in the dispute. The NTEU has labelled this as "inflammatory" [[https://substack.com/redirect/bd1453ad-527d-421b-8ff6-eb82261f0e46?](https://substack.com/redirect/bd1453ad-527d-421b-8ff6-eb82261f0e46?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] claiming the university will blow up negotiations rather than constructively engage with workers.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer Hunter

On Monday (3/11), the RTBU launched a “calendar of chaos” at Keolis Downer in Newcastle [

[https://substack.com/redirect/c19fda22-5fa4-46f5-8705-8cd27868eebd?](https://substack.com/redirect/c19fda22-5fa4-46f5-8705-8cd27868eebd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Bus drivers will sound the bus horn when leaving and entering depots and will implement bans on driving buses with less than a full tank of fuel and a ban on driving buses without a first aid kit on board. In addition to this, bus drivers will be wearing red berets that say “French Government gets paid, our bus is delayed” - calling attention to the French Government’s partial ownership of Keolis Downer. Industrial action will escalate to a 12 and 24 hour strikes at the end of the month if a decent offer is not forthcoming. The bus drivers last struck for 24 hours in April [

[https://substack.com/redirect/841ab84d-a5de-450f-9cd4-f552f47acd23?](https://substack.com/redirect/841ab84d-a5de-450f-9cd4-f552f47acd23?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU NT - CDC

After more than 6 months of negotiations, bus drivers in Darwin went on strike for 24 hours [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a68fc3b8-6125-4d60-bc80-8dc0a3eef4e3?](https://substack.com/redirect/a68fc3b8-6125-4d60-bc80-8dc0a3eef4e3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on 20 October. TWU members are fighting for industry standard pay, penalty rates and overtime, as well as improvements to safety. The union is calling on CDC to come back to the negotiating table with a decent offer. The TWU has not ruled out further industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/52b5ea04-e023-4fe0-80b1-8e3653a34b75?](https://substack.com/redirect/52b5ea04-e023-4fe0-80b1-8e3653a34b75?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

NTEU WA - Curtin University

NTEU members at Curtin University will stop work and rally on campus today (5/11). The current EBA expired in June, and negotiations have been in progress since then but management have failed to properly respond to workers’ claims [[https://substack.com/redirect/5f3058db-4bba-4c18-8d99-0d0480b38c8d?](https://substack.com/redirect/5f3058db-4bba-4c18-8d99-0d0480b38c8d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Workers are seeking [[https://substack.com/redirect/400b728f-95a2-4568-a5b6-18f7c629db23?](https://substack.com/redirect/400b728f-95a2-4568-a5b6-18f7c629db23?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] a 20% wage increase over 4 years; action on workload; improved workplace flexibility; job security and casual conversion and strengthened fixed term contract regulations.

QUTU - Public sector teachers

The Queensland Government’s offer [[https://substack.com/redirect/a79f87e5-583f-4f7f-a11a-1071670a5811?](https://substack.com/redirect/a79f87e5-583f-4f7f-a11a-1071670a5811?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of an 8% wage increase over 3 years has been rejected by teachers [[https://substack.com/redirect/9a7471e7-70dc-4f1b-bd69-d934073fa104?](https://substack.com/redirect/9a7471e7-70dc-4f1b-bd69-d934073fa104?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The QUTU shared that 67.60% of QUTU members who participated in the ballot voted no. Secretary Kate Ruttiman noted in a social media post that there had been a strong turnout for the ballot [[https://substack.com/redirect/65b66be6-1dc0-4bca-bfb9-38a81a8e0a2f?](https://substack.com/redirect/65b66be6-1dc0-4bca-bfb9-38a81a8e0a2f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The QUTU’s state council were due to meet on 1 November to consider the next steps in the campaign. Teachers struck for 24 hours in August, as well as some regional after school rallies. But since a decision by QUTU state council in late August to accept the recommendation of the QIRC to pause industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/64f8307d-1bd6-41d1-a5d9-285433ea42a8?](https://substack.com/redirect/64f8307d-1bd6-41d1-a5d9-285433ea42a8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] while conciliation was being undertaken, the only action has been “Maroon Mondays” (wearing campaign tshirts on Mondays).

ASU/AWU SA - City of Salisbury

While I believe ASU members have voted on a new agreement with the City of Salisbury, now their colleagues in the AWU are in dispute with the council. AWU members have held two stop work meetings in support of three workers who have been stood down for 10 weeks with no formal allegations made against them. Sounds very fishy!

TWU QLD - DHL Express

Two weeks ago, TWU members at DHL Express at Brisbane Airport rejected an offer from the company [[https://substack.com/redirect/2e8eaa15-ca5f-4503-822d-29de316ccaaa?](https://substack.com/redirect/2e8eaa15-ca5f-4503-822d-29de316ccaaa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The offer would have left 1 in 5 staff worse off by cutting legacy clauses. The workers have held two 24 hour strikes - one in August, and one in September. Stay tuned for next steps in this campaign.

MEU - Bloomfield

Last week, workers at Rix’s Creek coal mine entered their fifth week on strike. Workers also rejected a proposed agreement from the Bloomfield Group [[https://substack.com/redirect/db261975-275c-41c8-b421-3ce7e6cd0fd6?](https://substack.com/redirect/db261975-275c-41c8-b421-3ce7e6cd0fd6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with 92.6% of workers voting no. The proposed deal was actually worse than the offer previously rejected by workers. The MEU believes this was an “antagonistic move that has only deepened members’ resolve”.

PSA NSW - Prison officers

Thousands of prison officers across NSW walked off the job last Thursday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/4b8804b9-1244-4877-a8a0-894144a8f9ad?](https://substack.com/redirect/4b8804b9-1244-4877-a8a0-894144a8f9ad?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8fff39c5-5487-4260-b85d-e315fcf13104?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] (30/11). The walk off was sparked by the sentencing of a man who assaulted 4 prison officers at Cessnock Prison earlier in the year. Prison officers claimed the sentence was too lenient. Late on Thursday the IRC ordered [[https://substack.com/redirect/8fff39c5-5487-4260-b85d-e315fcf13104?](https://substack.com/redirect/8fff39c5-5487-4260-b85d-e315fcf13104?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM) [j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8fff39c5-5487-4260-b85d-e315fcf13104?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] work resume by 6am on Friday, and that the PSA stop organising further industrial action. The PSA appears to have chalked this up to a win as the offender in question was no longer to be released on Friday (31/10) and was due to attend another parole hearing on Monday (3/11).

ANMF SA - Public sector nurses and midwives

Last Thursday (30/10), ANMF members held a stop work rally outside Parliament House [

[https://substack.com/redirect/3f674c33-2e77-443d-8612-51571342ead0?](https://substack.com/redirect/3f674c33-2e77-443d-8612-51571342ead0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3f674c33-2e77-443d-8612-51571342ead0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] in Adelaide. The government made an 11th hour new pay offer [[https://substack.com/redirect/768f5672-2f66-498f-8e8e-cdd5d21b89b5?](https://substack.com/redirect/768f5672-2f66-498f-8e8e-cdd5d21b89b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/768f5672-2f66-498f-8e8e-cdd5d21b89b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] the day before which included a 13% wage increase over 4 years and \$4500 in bonus payments. This offer was rejected at the rally [[https://substack.com/redirect/9378cf3d-3151-4368-962a-8c790f487ae6?](https://substack.com/redirect/9378cf3d-3151-4368-962a-8c790f487ae6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9378cf3d-3151-4368-962a-8c790f487ae6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], with one nurse citing Victoria's 28% wage increase for nurses asking "why can't we have the same respectful fair offer" [[https://substack.com/redirect/9378cf3d-3151-4368-962a-8c790f487ae6?](https://substack.com/redirect/9378cf3d-3151-4368-962a-8c790f487ae6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9378cf3d-3151-4368-962a-8c790f487ae6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. I am unsure what the next steps in the campaign are - any nurses or midwives in SA reading this, please feel free to get in touch!

AWU Vic - Victorian Racing Club

AWU members who are groundskeepers and track staff at the Victorian Racing Club have voted to accept an agreement [[https://substack.com/redirect/e2283f88-d39b-4bdf-97ad-743d9325feda?](https://substack.com/redirect/e2283f88-d39b-4bdf-97ad-743d9325feda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e2283f88-d39b-4bdf-97ad-743d9325feda?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] put forward by the FWC. Last Wednesday (29/10), workers struck for 24 hours [[https://substack.com/redirect/4f286a5d-01b9-489e-8f98-164e8d17e420?](https://substack.com/redirect/4f286a5d-01b9-489e-8f98-164e8d17e420?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM) [j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4f286a5d-01b9-489e-8f98-164e8d17e420?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] in pursuit of a 4% annual wage increases. The VRC had only been offering 3% [[https://substack.com/redirect/13013d41-405a-4917-9997-b329cdaf0d1a?](https://substack.com/redirect/13013d41-405a-4917-9997-b329cdaf0d1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM) [j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/13013d41-405a-4917-9997-b329cdaf0d1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. I don't have any details on what the final figure was in the agreement, but hopefully a favourable deal given industrial action was taking place less than a week out from the Melbourne Cup!

ETU QLD - Coca-cola

On 29 October, the ETU maintenance team at Coca-cola hit 10 days on strike. Workers have been in negotiations for a new EBA for 4 months.

ANMF Vic - Healthscope

Last Tuesday (28/10), nurses and midwives at Healthscope commenced "Stage 1" industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/9a0ec09b-338a-474b-b44f-ab2bd3ca549f?](https://substack.com/redirect/9a0ec09b-338a-474b-b44f-ab2bd3ca549f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9a0ec09b-338a-474b-b44f-ab2bd3ca549f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The action includes wearing campaign t-shirts; displaying and sharing campaign material; talking to patients, visitors and the media about the action; bans on redeployment; overtime; working outside ordinary hours; and attending management meetings; taking all breaks; and refusing to respond to emails and other communications from Healthscope (unless related to patient or staff safety.) On Friday (31/10) a number of administrative bans commenced. Over 2,500 nurses and midwives at 12 Healthscope facilities are expected to participate in the actions. The ANMF is seeking "market-comparable wages and conditions" [[https://substack.com/redirect/8cc6e0ec-70de-4d43-bc1e-946781331b7e?](https://substack.com/redirect/8cc6e0ec-70de-4d43-bc1e-946781331b7e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8cc6e0ec-70de-4d43-bc1e-946781331b7e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] and is opposing Healthscope's proposal [[https://substack.com/redirect/1c56ac35-88cf-498b-b1a5-809512d36a1c?](https://substack.com/redirect/1c56ac35-88cf-498b-b1a5-809512d36a1c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/1c56ac35-88cf-498b-b1a5-809512d36a1c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] that would see up to 90% of employee salary packaging benefit go to "paying for operational costs, including servicing corporate debt." [[https://substack.com/redirect/8cc6e0ec-70de-4d43-bc1e-946781331b7e?](https://substack.com/redirect/8cc6e0ec-70de-4d43-bc1e-946781331b7e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8cc6e0ec-70de-4d43-bc1e-946781331b7e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The current EBA expired in June 2025, and nurses received their last pay increase in June 2024. As one Job Rep noted, by focusing on their salary packaging scam, instead of the EBA - they are holding workers pay to ransom [[https://substack.com/redirect/3e3a1501-ec03-4e77-94d0-7fdb4fea6558?](https://substack.com/redirect/3e3a1501-ec03-4e77-94d0-7fdb4fea6558?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3e3a1501-ec03-4e77-94d0-7fdb4fea6558?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)].

CEPU SA - Sprinkler Fitters

On 31/10, sprinkler fitters from 7 companies in SA held a joint stop work meeting [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b92324fa-9abe-4a17-b584-14b781e1cc1a?](https://substack.com/redirect/b92324fa-9abe-4a17-b584-14b781e1cc1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b92324fa-9abe-4a17-b584-14b781e1cc1a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] to discuss further industrial action in support of their campaign for a multi-employer agreement. In a social media post, the CEPU note that "the company bosses are on notice that things are ramping up and the action will be escalating until the collective agreement is achieved."

AMWU/CFMEU/ETU/PPTEU QLD - Genex

On 22/10, workers at the Kidston pumped hydro project voted to down tools [

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVGVZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXLKMMMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkrJlwwkNjNk1UYzNPVGNG6TXpJM0xDSnBZWFpT2pFM05qSX1PRGc0TKRRc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNU16Z31ORGcwTkN3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXpVFV4Tnp2aUxDSnpkV0lpT21Ka2FYTMhZbXbHdJWdFlXBHNjbJAUm21fckZwHcVgyN0JLZXRMaTNZNfHVRGhpYWFPOWU4eTbtZmhVNTlkRn5NCISInAiOjE3Nzk3MzMyNywyIEMWdJA5NTE3NiwiZiEdHJlZSwidS16NDE4MzMyNmZlImhldCMTc2MjJl40DG0cWjZXhwIjoyMDc3ODY0ODQ0LClJpc3MiOiJydwJtMCISInNjYiIEMxpbmxtbStKvKaXJLY3oiI0f0_R6G0Z0US10LM-aZkbqXMRNsCuBb2CjHkTgv5109V-ujk?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-6-august>

QUTU - Public sector teachers

Tens of thousands of Queensland teachers will strike for 24 hours today (6 August). This is the first strike action by teachers in the Sunshine State for 16 years. Workers have rejected the state government's offer - an 8% increase over 3 years. QUTU members are fighting for "nation leading" wages and improved conditions including action on workload, occupational violence and staff shortages. The Crisafulli Government has referred the stalled negotiations to the QIRC for conciliation [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a7bd9905-6660-4d2d-bfae-051be9386bdc?](https://substack.com/redirect/a7bd9905-6660-4d2d-bfae-051be9386bdc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a7bd9905-6660-4d2d-bfae-051be9386bdc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)].

Professional Australia QLD - Department of Transport and Roads

After threats from the government to dock wages for participating in work bans [

[https://substack.com/redirect/cd4eede5-ea88-48d0-af5b-5675011945e8?](https://substack.com/redirect/cd4eede5-ea88-48d0-af5b-5675011945e8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/cd4eede5-ea88-48d0-af5b-5675011945e8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], engineers and technical

professionals in the Department of Transport and Roads have upped the ante. Professionals Australia members held a snap rally [[https://substack.com/redirect/97a1d271-d76a-484c-aa20-ef0a39bc9f16?](https://substack.com/redirect/97a1d271-d76a-484c-aa20-ef0a39bc9f16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/97a1d271-d76a-484c-aa20-ef0a39bc9f16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] on Thursday (31/7) evening and

then walked off the job for 12 hours on Monday [[https://substack.com/redirect/edc28aa6-0adf-4a51-aa46-23347c7e34b9?](https://substack.com/redirect/edc28aa6-0adf-4a51-aa46-23347c7e34b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/edc28aa6-0adf-4a51-aa46-23347c7e34b9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] (4/8). Workers are fighting for a decent pay deal that will ensure parity with their private sector colleagues.

AMWU/ETU NSW - KONE

On Friday (1 August), KONE workers in the Newcastle area stopped work for 3 hours [

[https://substack.com/redirect/88a3d90a-606f-42d2-b615-1d311c7ac7d7?](https://substack.com/redirect/88a3d90a-606f-42d2-b615-1d311c7ac7d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/88a3d90a-606f-42d2-b615-1d311c7ac7d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] after KONE walked away from what

the union thought was an in-principle agreement. This is the fifth work stoppage at KONE, lift technicians took earlier strike action in July, as well as overtime and work bans. Workers at KONE in the Hunter region are some of the lowest paid in the country with the average wage being over \$8 per hour lower than other agreements.

AEU Vic - Public sector teachers

On Friday (1 August), AEU members marched to Premier Jacinta Allen's office with a novelty sized letter demanding the state government reverse cuts to schools' funding [

[https://substack.com/redirect/96652f6a-528c-4bdf-99f4-aac620f375e9?](https://substack.com/redirect/96652f6a-528c-4bdf-99f4-aac620f375e9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/96652f6a-528c-4bdf-99f4-aac620f375e9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. State secretary Justin Mulally was quoted as saying there was "no doubt" that teachers would consider industrial action if the cuts weren't reversed [[https://substack.com/redirect/6365568d-9ce9-4af8-8088-1ce879b287e7?](https://substack.com/redirect/6365568d-9ce9-4af8-8088-1ce879b287e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/6365568d-9ce9-4af8-8088-1ce879b287e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. Technically, what will likely drive teachers to strike action in Victoria will be the negotiations for their next EBA. The current agreement expires on 31 December 2025, and AEU members finalised their log of claims in June. It is understood the log of claims includes demands for a 35% pay increase over 3 years; a \$5000 sign on bonus; retention payments; reduced class sizes; reduction in workload; additional classroom supports and flexible work arrangements. Definitely one to watch!

AMWU/AWU/ETU - Qantas

On Friday (1 August), Qantas engineers commenced rolling work bans. Engineers took industrial action on numerous occasions last year, including a 24 hour strike in December [

[https://substack.com/redirect/90b9784a-1c24-4145-bc5a-1d341e0c05e1?](https://substack.com/redirect/90b9784a-1c24-4145-bc5a-1d341e0c05e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/90b9784a-1c24-4145-bc5a-1d341e0c05e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)], but Qantas still refuses to put forward a decent offer. Engineers' wages have only increased by 12% over the last decade.

AWU Vic - Alcoa

At the time of writing, workers at the Portland Aluminium smelter are on the verge of strike action.

After 16 weeks of negotiations, workers comprehensively voted to take industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e4f55c33-8328-42c6-8950-3e39a9bd856c?](https://substack.com/redirect/e4f55c33-8328-42c6-8950-3e39a9bd856c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e4f55c33-8328-42c6-8950-3e39a9bd856c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] if a final counter offer from

workers is not accepted. The bosses' last offer amounted to a 12% pay increase over 3 years and

"stripping away conditions" according to the AWU. If an agreement was not reached, workers were

expected to commence a 48 hour strike starting at 8pm last night [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d9bdc10a-93b7-45cc-ad43-fda34eb3b133?](https://substack.com/redirect/d9bdc10a-93b7-45cc-ad43-fda34eb3b133?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d9bdc10a-93b7-45cc-ad43-fda34eb3b133?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] (5 August). This would be followed with rolling 6 hour stoppages "if management doesn't get the message".

MUA WA - CBH

MUA members at CBH's Kwinana Grain Terminal commenced industrial action yesterday [

[https://substack.com/redirect/9aa93a4c-b7fe-481e-94f3-867d7fca1f51?](https://substack.com/redirect/9aa93a4c-b7fe-481e-94f3-867d7fca1f51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9aa93a4c-b7fe-481e-94f3-867d7fca1f51?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] (5 August). The action takes the form of work bans which will affect the unloading and loading of trains, trucks and ships and other

operational and maintenance tasks. More work bans will commence over the course of the week. Negotiations have been underway since March [https://substack.com/redirect/b4c42d54-a4fe-45bb-bb2b-894494305da1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], but the most recent offer from CBH only included 2% annual increases as well as roster changes and a reduction in the number of meal breaks. According to the MUA, the offer leaves maintenance workers behind pay rates at all other CBH maintenance departments; and leaves operators with a worse roster and worst shift loading than the current agreement.

ETU NSW & WA - Schindler

On Friday (1 August), lift technicians in NSW employed by Schindler stopped work for 24 hours. Workers are striking in pursuit of a decent wage increase. Schindler workers in Queensland signed off an agreement last year that gave them 6% annual pay increases - NSW workers want the same but are being denied by the company [https://substack.com/redirect/556db4a0-84f8-4a04-b155-ef5ca5c8c012?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. This was the first time Schindler workers in NSW have taken industrial action in 25 years [https://substack.com/redirect/8b285108-a5b7-4e64-af35-bcc70def8789?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Meanwhile, Schindler workers in WA will reach 24 days on strike today [https://substack.com/redirect/d2be1a7a-bffa-4126-bb53-5a1a6915b58b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

These workers also want a fair deal and parity with their Queensland colleagues - 6% annual increases. Workers are also demanding the right to be covered by Protect income protection rather than the company's current self-insurance system of "extended sick leave" at the company's discretion. Time for Schindler to start treating workers fairly from east to west coast.

TWU WA - Ventia

Court security and custodial officers employed by Ventia took their sixth round of industrial action yesterday (5 August) rallying outside Ventia's Canningvale Base. The state government, who has a contract with Ventia to provide court and custodial services, has been giving Ventia sufficient funds to cover wage increases since 2022, but Ventia hasn't passed this money on to workers. Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal - and pay parity with their counterparts employed by G4S. In addition to decent wages, workers are fighting for safe staffing levels and rosters.

QNMU - Public sector nurses and midwives

The QNMU released a statement last week [https://substack.com/redirect/d346d050-ff2c-4fe2-8abf-dfc7780d3ddc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] that while they support "a swift EB agreement for Queensland police" they are incredibly frustrated by both the speed of the EBA process and financial incentives offered to police when compared to what has been offered to nurses and midwives. A very reasonable question was asked by the QNMU: "Is it because we are predominantly women?" Nurses and midwives are continuing a wide range of work bans. The QNMU has also asked nurses if they are ready to strike [https://substack.com/redirect/82044f51-7bc6-484f-94fe-5efb467ae105?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], signalling that "Stage 3" industrial action might be sooner than we think.

MEU - BHP

The Pilbara Women's Committee in the MEU has launched a campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/ff91ca32-ed47-4bf8-9e74-aba19219b7f3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] "calling on BHP to immediately provide adequate, accessible toilet facilities for all train crew in the Pilbara." Apparently the facilities provided are often either inadequate or completely non-existent. While BHP has been promoting their work around gender balance across the workforce, this toilet issue (as it so often does [https://substack.com/redirect/54f281eb-3844-4ad6-a665-80474a3d41dd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]) is disproportionately affecting women. The union shared a few photos of the very schmick loos [https://substack.com/redirect/b25f35dc-b11b-4ab7-875c-cec29430eae6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] in the BHP Brisbane office. If it's good enough for corporate, it's good enough for the Pilbara!

ASMOFQ - Queensland public sector doctors

Doctors in Queensland's public hospital system reached an in-principle agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/9d959ad2-f5cf-4bae-9dc0-a2bb79e12a98?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] with the Crisafulli government last week. The agreement includes the Queensland state wages policy annual increases (3%, 2.5% and 2.5%) as well as guaranteed cost of living provisions if CPI increases above the wages policy. The agreement also includes a new career medical officer classification, increased attraction and retention payments for rural doctors and an increase in overnight allowances. The offer has been sent to doctors for review and feedback, and is open for acceptance until 22 August [https://substack.com/redirect/c4175572-9fe0-4d73-9af8-5dc8feb49424?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

QPU - QLD cops

Last week, the Queensland Police Union made an in-principle agreement [

[https://substack.com/redirect/0b3f12b0-e1d7-4722-81cb-143727cf44a3?](https://substack.com/redirect/0b3f12b0-e1d7-4722-81cb-143727cf44a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/0b3f12b0-e1d7-4722-81cb-143727cf44a3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] with the state government. The agreement includes the Queensland state wages policy annual increases (3%, 2.5% and 2.5%) but also includes an \$8000 bonus paid to general duty officers, “regional bonuses, 5% lifts in night shift loading and double time for overtime [https://substack.com/redirect/e52234b4-29bf-433f-92f0-c98f5354c1d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]”. QPU President Shane Prior claims he squeezed an additional \$163 million more than the state government’s first offer. The QPU had originally been aiming for 8% annual wage increases. Not everyone is happy with the agreement though. The Australian [https://substack.com/redirect/e52234b4-29bf-433f-92f0-c98f5354c1d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] reports there is discontent in the ranks [https://substack.com/redirect/e52234b4-29bf-433f-92f0-c98f5354c1d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e52234b4-29bf-433f-92f0-c98f5354c1d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] with some cops calling the agreement “not good enough” and “insulting”, as well as pushing for Prior to be removed from his position. Meanwhile, nurses and teachers - both taking industrial action - are furious [https://substack.com/redirect/4300a470-95fc-4a19-bf6c-e84cdacc9710?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

[https://substack.com/redirect/4300a470-95fc-4a19-bf6c-e84cdacc9710?](https://substack.com/redirect/4300a470-95fc-4a19-bf6c-e84cdacc9710?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/4300a470-95fc-4a19-bf6c-e84cdacc9710?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] with both the speed at which the police’s agreement has been dealt with, as well as the additional financial sweeteners. Rank and file cops will vote on the agreement in September.

USU/ETU NSW - Riverina Water

A new agreement for Riverina Water staff has been finalised [https://substack.com/redirect/06614ad2-3a74-4dc5-a9e7-744f8f7f8c64?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the NSW IRC. This follows two walk offs by outdoors workers at the union over one of the key issues in the dispute - a discrepancy in the number of hours worked between indoor and outdoors workers.

Outdoor workers (sparkies, maintenance etc) work 3 more hours per week than indoor staff in the same classification. While this discrepancy wasn’t solved through the dispute, a new memorandum of understanding has been signed committing Riverina Water to complete an organisational change review during the life of the agreement. The agreement also wins workers a 15% pay increase over 3 years.

UWU - PepsiCo

On Saturday (2/8), UWU shared that an agreement has been reached with PepsiCo. Following industrial action workers have secured a 13% wage increase over 3 years, with back pay to 1 March. Workers have also won 20 weeks paid parental leave for all caregivers and protected their Friday shift loading. Workers were fighting for pay parity [https://substack.com/redirect/db2e9bea-9f2a-4d1c-bb76-72b0b9210572?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with their Queensland colleagues who it was reported earned 12% more than the South Australians. It will depend on what wage increases the Queenslanders get over the next 3 years whether this wage increase will achieve the aim of parity over the course of the agreement.

That’s all I’ve got this week! Quite a few disputes likely to kick off industrial action in the next little bit - I have a long list of things to check in on next week. Thanks to the readers who have sent me tips and info this week!

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwKNJNk1UY3dNVFkwTmpReUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM05UUTBNamswT0Rjc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE5UazJOVFE0Tn13aWFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv01pT21Ka2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAuU0I0NTJAMkdSSGpQWTg5d0xXRGI1UnNpXzhwMDdtMmdFZVZwN0xudzE1cyIsInAiOjE3MDE2NDY0MiwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc1NDQyOTQ4NywiZXhwIjoyMDcwMDA1NDg3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.EM1PR6BiUvGNkuxHViJvBAB-IOVTCNH_kerBGe6b5WA?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-6-may>

ASU Vic - Metro Melbourne councils

Over 1000 workers from 8 metropolitan Melbourne city councils rallied outside Trades Hall yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/1c8de7a1-f961-4c1a-8282-d7d6129fb952?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (5/5) before marching to

Parliament House. ASU members at the 8 councils struck for 24 hours, missing bin collections, closing libraries and disrupting council services. Workers are fighting for their first multi-employer agreement. They are demanding [https://substack.com/redirect/e9471e00-9c40-4d2e-8211-14deb4e63bca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] a fair pay rise (10%/4%/4%/4%); locking in and protecting all existing conditions to make sure no worker goes backwards; as well as improving a range of common conditions such as dispute resolution, discipline, replacement of vacancies and parental leave.

MSAV - Public sector health professionals

Last Wednesday (29/4), having still not received an offer from the state government, MSAV members commenced "Stage 3" industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/8ebccec4-7eb9-422d-b788-b3e09f88e622?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Stage 3 means

working to rule [https://substack.com/redirect/8b8b833d-6fb6-4953-aa49-f0b642d0fa7b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and several new bans being

instituted. Indefinite bans include starting work earlier or later than rostered; working outside of duties/responsibilities listed on position descriptions including "acting up" or "filling in"; covering unfilled absences; commissioning or testing new software, instruments or equipment; performing work associated with projects; taking inventory or performing other stock or supplies management; and the performance of certain non-urgent and/or non-critical clinical work.

AFULE/AMWU/ETU/Professionals Australia/RTBU/The Services Union QLD - Queensland Rail

Queensland Rail has cancelled hundreds of train services and most lines are running at reduced capacity [https://substack.com/redirect/b77c4624-1418-41dc-a02e-c175f67a7e37?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The government and Queensland

Rail are, of course, busy blaming unions [https://substack.com/redirect/93f6e73c-fb29-4bb4-babd-8caee28ff39a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for this. The most

recent offer from Queensland Rail (8% over 3 years) was rejected by all unions [https://substack.com/redirect/8271d47e-ca1a-4c0d-93da-8102069b3329?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and described by the RTBU as

pitiful. Since then, the RTBU has instituted overtime and paperwork bans. RTBU members are now taking their unpaid lunch breaks instead of working through lunch. But it would appear the industrial action

really having an impact is maintenance bans, which is affecting maintenance and train availability [https://substack.com/redirect/0eb920aa-9bf0-43b6-a8ed-eeef9b9cb7cc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This has been exacerbated by

Queensland Rail issuing notices to workers [https://substack.com/redirect/a7135ca3-3c2e-4657-b57d-ad886ad2e6b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] that they would not

accept any work from workers participating in partial work bans, and refused to pay wages. As an ETU spokesperson said "Instead of allowing our members to come to work and perform some work, they have

elected to push our membership out of the workplace and have all maintenance scream to a halt. [https://substack.com/redirect/43f9a449-6f66-4b08-b612-72e988c491c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" An AMWU spokesperson said train

users were paying the price for poor planning [https://substack.com/redirect/1e1b52e2-0765-45c8-8ebe-5e56dce4297d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from Queensland

Rail and the state government and urged them to "stop playing politics, take responsibility and come to the table. [https://substack.com/redirect/1e1b52e2-0765-45c8-8ebe-5e56dce4297d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" Senior leaders from all involved

unions have been called to a meeting at the FWC on Thursday (7/5) to attempt to progress negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/5b0dcb44-f237-426e-8e3e-58b504638629?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

MEU - Peabody

MEU members at the Wambo coal mine washery commenced industrial action on 1 May [https://substack.com/redirect/7c25452f-dec3-42ae-9ae1-f97c0ee318ce?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Peabody have offered workers a

2.5% wage increase per year, as well as changes to bonus arrangements that would leave workers worse off. A key issue in the dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/1850cc58-0b3d-4322-ad11-e2d663b5c05d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] is a proposed unfair tier

structure. This new structure would lock in cheaper labour hire rates, getting around the new Same Job, Same Pay laws. Bosses are also refusing to fix rostering or include back pay in the agreement.

They are also proposing moving to fortnightly pay which workers are against. Unsurprisingly, the move to protected industrial action was unanimously supported by members. The MEU is calling on Peabody to

return to the table with a decent offer [https://substack.com/redirect/1850cc58-0b3d-4322-ad11-e2d663b5c05d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

AEU Vic - Public school teachers

On Monday (4 May), the AEU announced that planned rolling stoppages would not go ahead. The first of these stoppages was due to be held today (6/4) following the Victorian state budget. According to Branch Secretary Justin Mullaly, the Branch Executive met on Sunday night and decided to suspend the stoppages [https://substack.com/redirect/a317fd75-ed5e-4462-b6d3-887bfd80df37?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

following 3 days of “intensive” negotiations that have shown “significant and important movement in relation to pay.” Other work bans are continuing [https://substack.com/redirect/c9ee819d-01db-4c05-83d8-1a2e07135f9d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

These include not responding to Department emails; a ban on providing comments in student reports and stopping work if Victorian ALP MPs visit schools. It is important to note that no formal offer has been made, and the only figure about wages that members have seen is the one the government leaked to the Fin Review [https://substack.com/redirect/ce795c1a-7b63-4d4b-ad04-7511f0945695?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

Three rank and file groups (and dozens of social media commenters) are not happy with this turn of events. Fight the Crisis [https://substack.com/redirect/3b0b8b65-a5d1-43fc-801f-e7f118339188?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

is calling for a mass meeting of members; Socialists in Schools [https://substack.com/redirect/d97e0cad-c9e0-40cc-b828-bc0aeaf29de?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

is calling for sub-branches to pass a motion condemning the “sell out” and Class Struggle bulletin [https://substack.com/redirect/1621ac01-4c6b-475c-be5d-07ab9526939d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

is calling on sub-branches to identify what their non-negotiables are; escalate the industrial campaign and prepare to reject any substandard agreement put forward. The AEU’s social media posts [https://substack.com/redirect/d3ab504b-c600-455c-8fcb-365d35160d61?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

announcing the suspension of stoppages are captioned with “Your industrial action is working” - so why stop just when the pressure on the government is starting to hurt? As the doctor says - always finish your full course of antibiotics, even if you start feeling better!

NTEU Tasmania - University of Tasmania

NTEU members at the University of Tasmania are taking strike action this week. Workers in Hobart stopped work for two hours yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/1c378860-da17-42ff-ac73-35fda598276d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (5/5), and workers in Launceston will stop work for two hours today [https://substack.com/redirect/e8dff63b-0eeb-486e-ad16-02dc0a512b20?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (6/5). UTAS has tabled an offer [https://substack.com/redirect/37344c90-bc82-4f84-ac2b-1b3c4fb28290?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]

which includes 3% annual wage increases over 3 years, and a \$1000 sign on bonus. The sign on bonus is not available for casual workers. This offer does not make up for the loss of pay workers endured during COVID [https://substack.com/redirect/54bd6467-9015-4bb4-87e7-3aa51e52326e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM],

and it does not keep pace with the cost of living. The NTEU is seeking 5% annual wage increases [https://substack.com/redirect/09083605-b676-46f4-9284-c06fc14152b1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

The union claims that under the 2021-2025 agreement, workers absorbed a real wage loss of 5-6% against CPI.

ETU WA - BHP

High-voltage electrical workers at BHP in the Pilbara have escalated their industrial campaign. The ETU members have now made overtime, on-call and mentoring bans indefinite [https://substack.com/redirect/be8af1f5-f851-4835-9b71-f91bb4474822?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

When asked about the dispute, the Prime Minister reflected that “You only have workers and union members if you have successful businesses. [https://substack.com/redirect/4258ec12-9ff4-448d-b335-0512d56324d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]”

Not to get all chicken and egg about it, but the truth of the matter is you only have successful businesses if you have workers. The iron ore doesn’t magically explode from the ground. BHP and other mining giants are on a wall to wall whinging tour about increased organising activity in the Pilbara. Right of entry requests have increased by 400% in the last 12 months [https://substack.com/redirect/4258ec12-9ff4-448d-b335-0512d56324d7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

HACSU Tas - Ambulance Tasmania

HACSU members at Ambulance Tasmania have again escalated their industrial campaign [https://substack.com/redirect/a85f13bc-5f79-4724-af0e-867e7ae51f34?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

All 000 patients will now be taken to hospital and contract work at public events has been banned. This week paramedics will

participate in overtime bans and hold stop work meetings. Premier Jeremy Rockliff described the action as “completely unnecessary and putting patient safety at risk”. HACSU countered that these comments were “insulting”. HACSU Secretary Robbie Moore singled out Rockliff’s comments around safety explaining that current working conditions - including 14-hour shifts and single officer responses by paramedics are unsafe both for workers and their patients.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

On 28/4, the FWC issued an intractable bargaining declaration [

[https://substack.com/redirect/501a7e0e-70f4-487c-8bb0-ce3798d873b7?](https://substack.com/redirect/501a7e0e-70f4-487c-8bb0-ce3798d873b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/501a7e0e-70f4-487c-8bb0-ce3798d873b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] in relation to the long running dispute between Keolis Downer Hunter and the RTBU in relation to buses in the Newcastle area. The drivers’ EBA expired in November 2024 [https://substack.com/redirect/9e84427e-8bb4-490a-989a-e4172d83261e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM], and bargaining for a new agreement commenced in December 2024. There have been over 20 bargaining meetings in the intervening period, and workers have participated in industrial action including strike action. In December, workers rejected an offer of an increase of 15.5% (or wage price index, whichever is higher) over 4 years. An “enhanced offer” which KDH alleged was the best they could make was rejected in January. It included an increase of 12% (or wage price index, whichever is higher) over 3 years; and an additional increase of 0.25% in the third year. The intractable bargaining declaration means a post declaration negotiating period will run from 28 April through to 12 May [

[https://substack.com/redirect/2079e343-4792-4ec2-be95-a0e947d24fc2?](https://substack.com/redirect/2079e343-4792-4ec2-be95-a0e947d24fc2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/2079e343-4792-4ec2-be95-a0e947d24fc2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] in a process assisted by the FWC.

AMWU NSW - NRMA

NRMA patrol officers are taking industrial action for the first time in 23 years [

[https://substack.com/redirect/8330f38f-5f76-48db-9446-a040481f962b?](https://substack.com/redirect/8330f38f-5f76-48db-9446-a040481f962b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/8330f38f-5f76-48db-9446-a040481f962b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. AMWU members took strike action last week as part of their campaign for a fair EBA. Negotiations for a new agreement have been underway since 10 December, but over the last month have ground to a halt. Workers are seeking a 17% wage increase over 4 years (5% in the first year, and 4% in the next 3 years), but the NRMA won’t budge from 12.5%. NRMA are crying poor, the workers just want a fair deal and some respect.

AWU/The Services Union QLD - Douglas Shire Council

The AWU has commenced industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/03e3a3e3-75cd-4e1d-b198-](https://substack.com/redirect/03e3a3e3-75cd-4e1d-b198-d015bfe9b961?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[d015bfe9b961?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/03e3a3e3-75cd-4e1d-b198-d015bfe9b961?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] in the form of overtime bans at the Douglas Shire Council. Council has apparently responded by threatening to lock out workers who participate in industrial action. Local media reports that The Services Union has also notified that its members intend to undertake industrial action, but I have not been able to gather any specific details on this, and did not hear back from The Services Union. According to the AWU, workers are seeking a decent wage increase, as their wages have decreased in real terms by more than 5% since 2021.

NTEU NSW - University of Technology Sydney

NTEU members at UTS struck for 24 hours over 30 April [[https://substack.com/redirect/417ef310-6ad5-](https://substack.com/redirect/417ef310-6ad5-4a70-91c6-6f8cafc3c6c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[4a70-91c6-6f8cafc3c6c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/417ef310-6ad5-4a70-91c6-6f8cafc3c6c5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] & 1 May [

[https://substack.com/redirect/a6c3ad17-0048-4f6c-ac04-be340717d0b2?](https://substack.com/redirect/a6c3ad17-0048-4f6c-ac04-be340717d0b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/a6c3ad17-0048-4f6c-ac04-be340717d0b2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Workers are fighting for a fair pay rise that keeps up with the cost of living; job security; action on workloads; improved parental and reproductive leave and protections against AI. According to the NTEU, management at UTS are trying to wrap up bargaining without having agreed to a majority of claims, or even engaging with them. The union has delivered a Settlement Proposal [https://substack.com/redirect/14f0c075-c37d-4449-b4ed-0c0dfcf0cbab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] which includes a path to concluding negotiations and what a fair agreement looks like, so the ball is in UTS’ court. Hopefully the 24 hour strike has nudged bosses in the correct direction.

In short

ETU NSW - Goldwind

ETU members at 5 Goldwind wind farms have commenced industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/03f3eea1-c7bb-41c8-ad12-00f68cc41c0f?](https://substack.com/redirect/03f3eea1-c7bb-41c8-ad12-00f68cc41c0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/03f3eea1-c7bb-41c8-ad12-00f68cc41c0f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. Work stoppages are rolling out across sites including the Gullen Range wind farm (NSW); Morrabool wind farm (VIC); White Rock wind farm (NSW); Cattle Hill wind farm (TAS). Bosses have been hiding behind HR reps and piles of excuses and refuse to come to the table with a fair deal, whilst conditions on site get worse.

CPSU Tasmania - Launceston Reception Prison

On 27 April, CPSU members at the Launceston Reception Prison (LRP) walked off the job for 1 hour [

[https://substack.com/redirect/3d40c931-f4a7-4d77-8a19-e41ef80b804d?](https://substack.com/redirect/3d40c931-f4a7-4d77-8a19-e41ef80b804d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/3d40c931-f4a7-4d77-8a19-e41ef80b804d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. The action is in response to safety concerns for both prisoners and staff due to overcrowding. Overcrowding has become such an issue in the prison that prisoners have had to sleep on mattresses on day yard floors [

[https://substack.com/redirect/44be1ca9-93f3-4a73-a3e2-9a03fd00aed8?](https://substack.com/redirect/44be1ca9-93f3-4a73-a3e2-9a03fd00aed8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and watchhouse cells are being used to hold excess prisoners.

UFU Tasmania - Tasmanian Fire Service

UFU members at the Tasmanian Fire Service commenced industrial action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/52700492-8a53-4519-b1c5-dd34d9b8f1ee?](https://substack.com/redirect/52700492-8a53-4519-b1c5-dd34d9b8f1ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] yesterday (5 May). From 8am, firies implemented bans [[https://substack.com/redirect/2ef06a4c-ccad-4914-b377-46b0a1a1f6d1?](https://substack.com/redirect/2ef06a4c-ccad-4914-b377-46b0a1a1f6d1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] on conducting practice building evacuations and silencing fire alarms when there is no fire. The bans will be in place for 10 days. Firies are not seeking parity with firefighters in other states, but simply “what an advanced trade person in the Tasmania state service gets paid. [[https://substack.com/redirect/52700492-8a53-4519-b1c5-dd34d9b8f1ee?](https://substack.com/redirect/52700492-8a53-4519-b1c5-dd34d9b8f1ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” Seems reasonable!

HACSU Tasmania - Dental assistants

On Friday (1 May), oral health workers at Clarence Dental Centre and New Norfolk Dental Clinic [[https://substack.com/redirect/78250893-5c3c-4121-90af-f714fc492896?](https://substack.com/redirect/78250893-5c3c-4121-90af-f714fc492896?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] held a two hour stop work action. Oral health workers at Sorell Dental Clinic [[https://substack.com/redirect/9c114f06-3f35-4609-99f3-31453f347fe4?](https://substack.com/redirect/9c114f06-3f35-4609-99f3-31453f347fe4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] held a two hour stop work action on Monday (4 May). HACSU members took the action in solidarity with Dental Assistants who have been in dispute with the state government for over 18 months. The key issues in the dispute are backpay and high classifications for dental assistants.

NTEU ACT - University of Canberra

NTEU members at the University of Canberra walked off the job for a half day strike yesterday [[https://substack.com/redirect/01e54054-65b3-4f20-ad5c-dad3e8787d84?](https://substack.com/redirect/01e54054-65b3-4f20-ad5c-dad3e8787d84?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (5/5). Negotiations began in November, but several key issues [[https://substack.com/redirect/ae08667b-72c9-4a7d-a543-15cac550a15a?](https://substack.com/redirect/ae08667b-72c9-4a7d-a543-15cac550a15a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] including wages, workload and job security remain unresolved. NTEU members are seeking a 20% wage increase over the life of the agreement.

AEU/ANMF/CPSU/CFMEU/PPTEU ACT- ACT public sector

On Friday (1 May), union members from across the ACT public service rallied in Canberra [[https://substack.com/redirect/14c0b55d-bc38-4cd9-b315-3b7df52fa5b8?](https://substack.com/redirect/14c0b55d-bc38-4cd9-b315-3b7df52fa5b8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] as part of their EBA campaign. Workers are fighting for fair pay and better conditions. Around 1000 people attended [[https://substack.com/redirect/bb9c40cc-5046-449d-be7b-69efda6cb3ac?](https://substack.com/redirect/bb9c40cc-5046-449d-be7b-69efda6cb3ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the rally, with speakers from the CFMEU, CPSU and the PPTEU. Bargaining has been underway since August, and workers have rejected a 3% wage increase offer from the government.

PABO Watch

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

AEU members in the ACT have voted in favour of taking industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/6649ab24-1550-4747-b294-32ac61c14b63?](https://substack.com/redirect/6649ab24-1550-4747-b294-32ac61c14b63?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], with most actions receiving endorsement by 90% or more of respondents. School psychologists and school assistants will also participate in industrial action [[https://substack.com/redirect/c6521bbd-9182-44b0-bf4d-8f30eb02e379?](https://substack.com/redirect/c6521bbd-9182-44b0-bf4d-8f30eb02e379?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The union will announce the first actions to take place tomorrow (7/5) so stay tuned!

VAHPA - Public sector allied health workers

VAHPA recently surveyed public sector members about industrial action. According to rank and file newsletter VAHPA Pulse [[https://substack.com/redirect/8440feac-477f-4015-b6e7-bd4a5ef8415e?](https://substack.com/redirect/8440feac-477f-4015-b6e7-bd4a5ef8415e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], 75% of members responded to the survey with 99.53% in favour of taking industrial action. VAHPA has now obtained a PABO, and a formal ballot will be undertaken [[https://substack.com/redirect/84812763-38cd-4c6b-bde1-3821319067ee?](https://substack.com/redirect/84812763-38cd-4c6b-bde1-3821319067ee?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. VAHPA Pulse have shared the important technicality of this ballot, that the votes for protected industrial action are not counted in one pool. So in order for each workplace included in the agreement to be able to take protected industrial action at least half of eligible members in each workplace must vote, and more than half of those votes must be yes. So this is going to be another big job for rank and file organisers to get this ballot voted up from the shop floor in each and every workplace. If you know a VAHPA member, reach out to them and make sure they know to vote.

CPSU Vic - Parks Victoria

CPSU members at Parks Victoria are voting in a protected action ballot [[https://substack.com/redirect/c27b5e9e-9996-480c-b71c-826fff2969ac?](https://substack.com/redirect/c27b5e9e-9996-480c-b71c-826fff2969ac?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] this week. Workers have been in

negotiations for a whole year, but management have not put forward an acceptable offer. Workers are seeking pay parity with their counterparts in the Victorian public service (Parks Victoria is a statutory authority). The ballot closes on Saturday (9/5).

Union news

UWU Quadrennial Elections

The UWU elections are underway, with ballots mailed out to members across the country. The vote opened last Thursday (30/4) and will close on Tuesday 28 May [

[https://substack.com/redirect/fa3cc6e2-0628-409a-925c-079786b415fc?](https://substack.com/redirect/fa3cc6e2-0628-409a-925c-079786b415fc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/10ccb473-eb4e-40db-9d25-63cb99ff6f19?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. There are two tickets in the election, Members First [[https://substack.com/redirect/10ccb473-eb4e-40db-9d25-63cb99ff6f19?](https://substack.com/redirect/10ccb473-eb4e-40db-9d25-63cb99ff6f19?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ae3498f7-4a3f-4bd1-890d-59adb442be83?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] and United for You [

[https://substack.com/redirect/ae3498f7-4a3f-4bd1-890d-59adb442be83?](https://substack.com/redirect/ae3498f7-4a3f-4bd1-890d-59adb442be83?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ae3498f7-4a3f-4bd1-890d-59adb442be83?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. I was remarking to a comrade last week that as a casual observer to this hotly contested election, it is very hard to get a read on how it is going. I'm limited to the things people tell me, and what I see online. It is much harder to get a grasp on the breadth and success of the mailouts, door knocking, phone banking and workplace organising that is going on. One statistic we can look at is how much each ticket has spent on social media advertising on Meta (Facebook and Instagram). At the time of writing, United for You which has 3,600 followers on Facebook has spent \$163,400 on ads. Members First on the other hand has 2,400 followers on Facebook and has spent only \$21,500 on ads. Can you buy a union election? Or does it take a bit more than ads? We're about to find out. I would encourage UWU members to get as much information as they can and weigh things up for themselves. Who do you want in your corner on the worst day at work?

FWC - Diana Asmar - HWU

The FWC has launched fresh legal action [https://substack.com/redirect/a02a5c98-c8eb-4e8c-8502-403e17807082?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the Federal Court against former Secretary of the HWU Diana Asmar. The case uses anti-reprisal laws in the Fair Work Act that prohibit unions from taking action against whistleblowers. Asmar and former Senior Vice President Lee Atkinson are accused of generating false complaints about whistleblowers as well as excluding them from meetings and interfering in their jobs at the union. It is also alleged Asmar threatened, smeared and sacked [[https://substack.com/redirect/d1c3c9ca-c417-49cf-828e-71e9f61491e7?](https://substack.com/redirect/d1c3c9ca-c417-49cf-828e-71e9f61491e7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

Wins/resolutions

ASU/Professionals Australia - Coliban Water

Workers at Coliban Water have successfully negotiated a new agreement [

[https://substack.com/redirect/90162d0c-609a-45e5-a555-89abde09a745?](https://substack.com/redirect/90162d0c-609a-45e5-a555-89abde09a745?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/90162d0c-609a-45e5-a555-89abde09a745?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The EBA campaign undertaken by ASU and Professionals Australia members included strike action [

[https://substack.com/redirect/b020fe1d-ab3a-4799-8474-7b8e7f47e997?](https://substack.com/redirect/b020fe1d-ab3a-4799-8474-7b8e7f47e997?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/b020fe1d-ab3a-4799-8474-7b8e7f47e997?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] and work bans. The new agreement includes wage increases of 20 - 26.8%. The original offer from management was 3% annual increases over 4 years. In addition to the wages outcome, they have successfully negotiated a \$7,100 lump sum payment; 17.5% annual leave loading; protected RDOs; improvements to allowances and leave; paid union meetings and strong union rights.

CPSU/MEAA - ABC

Yesterday, the MEAA announced that ABC staff have voted up a new EBA [

[https://substack.com/redirect/e0e48997-1fbc-4d34-9678-5a1e0d8e0f9b?](https://substack.com/redirect/e0e48997-1fbc-4d34-9678-5a1e0d8e0f9b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e0e48997-1fbc-4d34-9678-5a1e0d8e0f9b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)]. The agreement includes a wages component of 10.5% over 3 years [[https://substack.com/redirect/9561c372-9fb2-4cc0-9138-81e88e662b27?](https://substack.com/redirect/9561c372-9fb2-4cc0-9138-81e88e662b27?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/9561c372-9fb2-4cc0-9138-81e88e662b27?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)] with backpay to October 2025. In March, workers voted down an offer of 10% over 3 years with a \$1000 sign on bonus, before going on strike for 24 hours. According to the MEAA media release [https://substack.com/redirect/a0c414f1-0f96-48c6-92f9-90a8d1c214e6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the approved agreement “delivers improved pay and job security, genuine classification progression to support sustainable careers” as well as including “strengthen diversity measures and clear guardrails to ensure the ethical use of artificial intelligence.”

That's all I've got this week! I hope everyone had a great May Day weekend (especially those who got Monday off work!). Thanks to all the readers who helped me with this week's report. Please get in touch if there's a dispute kicking off at your workplace!

In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJlIjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UazJOVE0wT0RRNExDsnBZWFfpT2pFM056Z3dNVFk0TURJc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRnd09UVTFNamd3TWl3aWFYTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuUTIitVHp1RndUVVowaG5USHdnamxQLVA5YUhxbm9TUWVwRGNPOFBvOGV5TSIsInAiOjE5NjUzNDg0OCwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc3ODAxNjgwMiwiZXhwIjoyMDkzNTkyODAyLCJpc3MiOiJwdWItdmCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.1my1wfeVjXFGPUVT5wCsVMiHM9qxhAWIqg5dGLUpFQ4?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-8-january>

Combined Rail Unions - Sydney Trains

The dispute between Sydney Trains and the Combined Rail Unions group (ASU, AMWU, ETU, RTBU and Professionals Australia) was big news in the lead up to Christmas. In short, unions voted up new PABOs following the Federal Court injunction, but then the Federal Court injunction was lifted on 19/12 [https://substack.com/redirect/2eab9615-a7ff-48a7-8d4f-d9ed2d86e013?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] allowing the previous suites of industrial action to resume. This is when the hysteria over unions ruining New Years Eve started, probably reaching fever pitch with the NSW Police Commissioner fronting the press with her “grave concerns” and threatening to have the fireworks cancelled [https://substack.com/redirect/68c58a3b-26a5-48d7-a999-7ac7c42b969c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. While industrial action re-commenced [https://substack.com/redirect/2b73f6e7-38b0-48dc-ad68-8257d705d03c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] causing delays, the business community heaped on to the unfounded concerns about potential train cancellations on New Years Eve. Laundry Hotels, Merrivale Hotels, Veolia Waste Services, Luna Park and the North Sydney Leagues Club then all lodged submissions in the Fair Work Commission [https://substack.com/redirect/f95e25f9-46b6-496b-a2ef-28104b23bbeb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] under Section 426 [https://substack.com/redirect/76f74455-bc14-4c90-91b1-f54e6cc3f7fb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of the Fair Work Act which pretty much allows for the FWC or order industrial action to cease if it has a negative economic outcome for anyone. The RTBU attempted to make a peace deal [https://substack.com/redirect/bad26251-9010-4f45-8182-a1f9ac97cfb5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] of no industrial action until January 7 in return for free travel on the network - this was rejected by the Premier. Ultimately, on Christmas Eve the decision was made that the CRU would withdraw a number of work bans in order to head off the coordinated attack by government and businesses. The unions agreed to adjust bans to “ensure the safety of passengers and workers” and the NSW government and businesses withdrew their applications [https://substack.com/redirect/dcca8e54-32be-4c94-9b2f-e9a87e9cb27e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Low level industrial action has continued over the festive period, including a five minute stoppage by rail workers on New Years Eve [https://substack.com/redirect/47100396-3cd1-497c-9db7-8369eb92df9b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Industrial action will step up again from 15 January [https://substack.com/redirect/a62532df-effb-4e1f-8199-480f2a7f2d5c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with additional bans including reduced speeds on some sections of track; a ban on RTBU members working with contractors and a ban on work to reinstate cancelled services. It is worth noting that on 20 December, the RTBU publicly announced they would “suspend any support to the NSW Labor Party insofar as it relates to the NSW Parliamentary Labor Party” [https://substack.com/redirect/24e2d4d2-9133-4867-aa21-cdc4ab9b22e3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and that any legal fees they spend “fighting this bogus government industrial strategy” would be taken off any future affiliation fees. If and when there is a return to negotiations [https://substack.com/redirect/280e47d5-ff9c-4955-bbd1-0fb4b169118c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] this year - it is likely to be quite frosty around the table. Stay tuned - I am certain there will be more to come on this dispute.

ANMF Vic - St Vincent's Private

Nurses and midwives at St Vincent's Private paused their rolling stoppages from 25 December through to 6 January [https://substack.com/redirect/b8de419b-30c2-4915-a213-e03de2c2b50d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This pause followed a successful stoppage by nurses in theatre and recovery on 18 December [https://substack.com/redirect/be804567-dd9e-4060-895a-d74cd63fbdcd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. A members meeting was due to be held via Teams yesterday. The ANMF is awaiting further information from St Vincent's ahead of another negotiating meeting.

ASU - Maurice Blackburn

The dispute at Maurice Blackburn continues [https://substack.com/redirect/c6f18fa6-7892-4a28-8b97-23e87e0f67b7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] following lawyers and support staff taking stop work action twice in December. The ASU rejected a proposed deal from Maurice Blackburn which would give workers 10-12% pay increases over the life of the agreement. Workers' wage proposal to Maurice Blackburn was a 17.5% increase over 3 years. Workers also want improvements to conditions including work life balance, 10 days reproductive leave and measures to improve the gender pay gap at the firm. The irony of MB's slogan “We fight for fair [https://substack.com/redirect/45684141-0772-4015-ba8b-94e34e134265?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]” is not lost on anyone at this point, as negotiations have been underway for some time. It is expected industrial action will

continue during January with workers wearing badges, including campaign messages in emails and distributing campaign materials. There is potential for the escalation of industrial action including not recording time - billable hours aren't billable if they are not recorded! Union membership at Maurice Blackburn is understood to be at record levels with workers eager to get a fair deal.

ASU Vic Tas - Glenelg Shire Council

Workers at Glenelg Shire Council commenced industrial action before Christmas. Workers are fighting for a fair pay deal and improvements to conditions.

NSWNMA - NSW public sector nurses & midwives

The NSW government has forced the pay dispute with the NSWNMA into the NSW Industrial Relations Commission. According to an update from the NSWNMA [https://substack.com/redirect/22251eaf-d808-4c89-b6f2-ec61dd6f1a71?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on 20 December, the Log of Claims Committee are reconvening to review and redraft an updated pay claim. Significantly, this will be moving to a 3 year award. The draft revised claim will be circulated to branches on 13 January to be voted on in the week of 20 January. The IRC has requested the pay case is filed in early February. The NSWNMA also shared that the IRC "expects our case to be heard by (next) September" (September 2025). This is a long time in an already long dispute.

ANMF/HACSU Tasmania - Baptistcare Karingal

Workers at Baptistcare Karingal in Devonport took stop work action on 18 December [

[https://substack.com/redirect/f29da393-7959-4fd6-954d-0a95d7c33c56?](https://substack.com/redirect/f29da393-7959-4fd6-954d-0a95d7c33c56?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f29da393-7959-4fd6-954d-0a95d7c33c56?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]. ANMF and HACSU members stopped work for 1 hour as part of their campaign for improved staffing levels and a decent pay increase. Workers haven't received a pay increase since 2021 and Baptistcare has continued to stall and delay. A media release from the ANMF [https://substack.com/redirect/6ad9b93a-1308-4906-847c-6c5dfcfa619e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] disclosed that the last offer from Baptistcare to workers included an insulting 95 cent pay increase - CENT, not PERCENT. Time for Baptistcare to come to the table with a realistic offer.

MUA QLD - Smit Lamnalco

On 18 December, industrial action was commenced [https://substack.com/redirect/2687637b-3a56-4c07-a011-bd1ed4433a9c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] by workers on Reef Keeper, a ship that provides support and crisis recovery services to boats around the Great Barrier Reef as well as maintenance to navigational aids in the area. The MUA and its members is fighting to retain conditions for workers on the vessel. A MUA media release [

[https://substack.com/redirect/d76744fd-b3ff-464e-9b8b-0fbd9201edf4?](https://substack.com/redirect/d76744fd-b3ff-464e-9b8b-0fbd9201edf4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/d76744fd-b3ff-464e-9b8b-0fbd9201edf4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] says Smit Lamnalco (which has been contracted by the Australian Maritime Safety Authority) is attempting to convert 8 hour shifts to 12 hour shifts with no additional wages as well as cutting income protection insurance policy payments and removing important on-ship conditions and allowances.

HSUWA - Public Sector Health workers

A fourth offer from the Cook government was sent to members to vote on in December [

[https://substack.com/redirect/ed7f9ab1-4adf-4e2e-90f5-e8eb0d91dc5f?](https://substack.com/redirect/ed7f9ab1-4adf-4e2e-90f5-e8eb0d91dc5f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/ed7f9ab1-4adf-4e2e-90f5-e8eb0d91dc5f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], with the ballot due to close on 20 December. Members voted the offer down. Next steps in the campaign are likely to be announced soon.

AMWU/AWU/ETU/MEU/PPTEU QLD - Gladstone Ports Corporation

Workers in 5 unions at Gladstone Ports have been in negotiations with the employer since May 2024 [

[https://substack.com/redirect/40d7f5bb-13f8-449c-87cd-bee9ecbe9a1e?](https://substack.com/redirect/40d7f5bb-13f8-449c-87cd-bee9ecbe9a1e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/40d7f5bb-13f8-449c-87cd-bee9ecbe9a1e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)], but have still not reached agreement on wages and shifts. Stoppages were undertaken before Christmas with some workers participating in a 24 hour stoppage [https://substack.com/redirect/c66af6ff-2592-43b4-97c0-963fd618e043?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] on 16/17 December. A significant sticking point for workers is an attempt by the employer to change the length of shifts from 8 hours to 12 hours.

UWU - Chep

Workers at Chep in Brisbane struck for 24 hours on 20 December. Chep deals in "pallet and container pooling services [[https://substack.com/redirect/e00b3c35-56b9-46ea-96ff-cd05ecafdb6c?](https://substack.com/redirect/e00b3c35-56b9-46ea-96ff-cd05ecafdb6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/e00b3c35-56b9-46ea-96ff-cd05ecafdb6c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)]". Workers are fighting for a better pay deal than the 9.5% over 3 years offered by the boss.

MUA - Qube

Industrial action at Qube ports around the country has continued over the summer holidays. A range of stoppages, bans and restrictions [https://substack.com/redirect/03f779f7-f300-4c5d-a160-03c51d4ebe8e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM] are in place at Port Kembla, Brisbane, Melbourne, Adelaide and Darwin. The MUA has been vocal in their suspicion that Qube is stalling [[https://substack.com/redirect/f3989f96-e337-4349-aba2-e09db209aff1?](https://substack.com/redirect/f3989f96-e337-4349-aba2-e09db209aff1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)

[j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM](https://substack.com/redirect/f3989f96-e337-4349-aba2-e09db209aff1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfb_KD9-eM)] to try and trigger intractable bargaining provisions.

AMWU/ETU NSW - Coca-cola

Workers at the Coca-cola factory in Northmead struck for a second time on 19 December. Workers rallied outside the Coke headquarters in North Sydney. Workers are seeking a fair pay deal and decent conditions that keep up with industry standards.

TPAV - Victoria Police

On Friday (3/1), the Fair Work Commission rejected Victoria Police's application for an intractable bargaining declaration [https://substack.com/redirect/8ef10b45-61f1-470a-84b3-40cdd7234461?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The cops are seeking a 24% pay increase over 4 years and action on unpaid overtime. An in-principle agreement had been reached in May 2024 for a 16% increase and a 9 day fortnight - but it was rejected by members.

AMWU/ETU/AWU - Qantas Engineers

Qantas engineers struck for 24 hours on 20th December, their second strike in the busy lead up to Christmas [https://substack.com/redirect/f7906d37-efd9-4cb0-983a-ebb0d10a8c2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

For reasons only known to the brains trust in the Qantas C-Suite, some workers were sent a pair of Qantas business class pyjamas [https://substack.com/redirect/fe3e154a-f794-4c6f-bca8-0b0cfa96dddb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in the week leading up to the strike - thanking them for their hard work. Thank yous and pyjamas don't pay the bills. Workers are seeking a 15% wage increase in the first year and 5% annual increases in subsequent years to make up for years of wage stagnation and to keep up with the cost of living.

Following three days of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/f44f4acc-e35a-45bf-b185-64628b3b0daf?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and an estimated 90,000 missed bin collections the dispute between the TWU, AWU and CFMEU and the Ipswich City Council was resolved. Workers negotiated a 13.75% pay increase over 3 years [https://substack.com/redirect/70e542b1-8f2f-4944-a656-8b6d7084cd16?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (5%, 5% and 3.75%). This is just under the original demand of 15% over 3 years [https://substack.com/redirect/dba0a4e7-77e9-4dff-9f11-5aa14dedc760?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU/AWU - Ipswich City Council

Public sector nurses and midwives were balloted on the Cook Government's second wages offer. According to an ANF Facebook post [https://substack.com/redirect/19b25eae-9de5-4b1a-b7fa-1e206636c3ed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] "over 65%" of members that voted endorsed the deal which includes a 12.5% wage increase over 3 years as well as "rebasings" - an increase to base salaries. According to the ANF this equates to an average increase of 15% across all levels. I would be curious to know what percentage of members voted in the ballot which was held in the busy lead up to Christmas. Any nurses in WA reading this - I would love to hear your thoughts on the new agreement.

ANF WA - WA public sector nurses & midwives

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ASU - Slater and Gordon

Before Christmas, 88% of workers at Slater and Gordon voted up their new EBA [https://substack.com/redirect/c9eb4e7b-f5c2-4903-a723-5ff7a86f6711?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The new agreement includes 26 weeks of paid parental leave for both parents; a large increase in base salaries for legal assistants (between 10-25%); as well as an 11% pay increase for all workers covered by the agreement over 3 years.

HWU

As a result of the Federal Court making orders for Diana Asmar to stand aside [https://substack.com/redirect/78519ab5-2e57-4f61-aaa2-e39200e365e0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], on 18 December, the HWU Facebook page posted that Lee Atkinson (Vice President) had been appointed Acting Branch Secretary by the Branch's Committee of Management. The post has now been deleted (and I didn't take a screenshot). On 23 December, the Federal Court placed the HWU under interim administration [https://substack.com/redirect/5d7f15aa-f94a-4d9f-a9c4-5f148cf5deb6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

The former General Secretary of the NUW, Charlie Donnelly, has been appointed administrator. Donnelly was at the NUW for 27 years starting as an Industrial Officer, and finishing as National Secretary for 10 years. He left the union to become CEO of industry super fund LUCRF in 2014, staying with the fund until it merged with Australian Super in 2022. LUCRF famously failed APRA's [https://substack.com/redirect/2f98d1b7-2524-4709-8183-cefd21ea1e20?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] Your Future Your Super Performance Test [https://substack.com/redirect/2f98d1b7-2524-4709-8183-cefd21ea1e20?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in 2021. [https://substack.com/redirect/2f98d1b7-2524-4709-8183-cefd21ea1e20?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]

That's all I've got this week! Thanks to the comrades who helped me with updates over the busy festive season to get this report together. I'm excited to keep this project going for another year -

In solidarity, Sarah

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlCg9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSwpvME1UZ3pNekUzTX13aWNHOXpkRj1wWkNjNk1UVTBnekU0T1RnNUxDSnBZWFpT2pFM016WX1PREkwTWprc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjMk56Z3hPRFF5T1N3aWFYUtpJm9pY0hwaUxUSXdpVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV01pT21Ka2FYTmhZbXhsWDJldF1xbHNjbjAuM2F5SFQzUE9Ya3J2RmEta1CTjVQUldjwUVBmnZ4aUFjd1YxUFZnaS0wWSIsInAiOjE1NDMxODk4OSwicyMjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzZmXzMsIm1hdCI6MTczNjI4MjQyOiwiaXhwIjoxNzY0ODc0NDI5LjCjpc3MiOiJwdWItMCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.vb8MnzebbzKd1knAauebXgeK59PMIB-g6p0lUmaEOHQ?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-8-july>

ASU/Professionals Australia - DXC

After rejecting DXC's proposed offer, workers commenced 3 days of stop work actions [https://substack.com/redirect/1a624519-6caf-4726-aac6-89201eb02a5a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from 1 July. This included workers on the ATO's mainframe at a peak time for the tax agency. Clients affected by industrial action included the ATO, Victorian WorkCover Authority, WorkSafe, Victoria Police and the City of Gold Coast [https://substack.com/redirect/55e09c51-bb3c-455f-855f-9a0aac5fde3f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], although many - including the ATO - deny there was any major effect. And while the industrial action may not have caused outages, it will likely have extended the wait time [https://substack.com/redirect/8e48f5ea-6878-470b-bd0e-f3811a677041?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] for things getting fixed. Work stoppages will continue until at least 14 July [https://substack.com/redirect/6aa54faa-1912-4adf-9a62-d7c520d06e50?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Union members are fighting for a 4% wage increase backdated to 1 July 2025.

AMWU/ASU/ETU/Professionals Australia/RTBU QLD - Queensland Rail

In-principle agreements have been reached for 3 EBAs at Queensland Rail [https://substack.com/redirect/8de6a174-5bf5-4521-b871-8012cb919715?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The in-principle agreements are the administrative, professional and technical enterprise agreement; the travel and tourism and other employees enterprise agreement; and the station operations enterprise agreement. Negotiations continue on the train control enterprise agreement; network enterprise agreement; rollingstock and operations enterprise agreement and a proposed electrical-only agreement. The in-principle agreements include [https://substack.com/redirect/aa289757-5a82-42d8-959d-be840cb4b941?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] an 8% wage increase over 3 years as well as an additional cost-of-living relief payment with backpay from 1 June 2026. These agreements cover almost 3500 employees. My understanding is that much of the disruptions caused by industrial action lie in maintenance performed by AMWU and ETU members not covered by these agreements so it is likely disruptions will continue. However unions have ruled out any disruptive industrial action during tonight's State of Origin decider [https://substack.com/redirect/5046edca-2db5-48d9-8e29-2c32d2c8e872?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

MEU NSW - Peabody

Peabody's lockout of workers at the Wambo washery was due to come on an end last Wednesday (1 July). But the multinational has now refused to accept work from union members participating in partial work bans [https://substack.com/redirect/6d9afb74-11f4-4777-a4b7-2a84ca8d8ff6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] - in practice, an indefinite lockout. In addition to the lockout, the MEU alleges Peabody is sharing cherry picked figures to justify its offer to workers, bundling in superannuation and bonuses when wage increases are only applied to the base rate [https://substack.com/redirect/bae9a408-8fc6-4179-8e32-61a2dd6cc3b4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. This is the sort of creative accounting one can expect from a business where the CEO earns 70 times as much as the average Peabody employee [https://substack.com/redirect/042d2ddd-0b90-459d-8be4-2e6b0bfd92ba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. President & CEO James Grech was paid over \$9 million in 2025.

AEU ACT - Public school teachers

AEU members at ACT public schools have been participating in a number of work bans since their last strike day. The Education Directorate sent an email to workers after hours on 26 June directing teachers to detail any industrial action they were taking in their timesheets [https://substack.com/redirect/5689c6c3-c291-4a62-8689-87057fd94b33?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. It was only after the AEU lodged a dispute that the direction was withdrawn [https://substack.com/redirect/63205dd4-020b-4698-ae5d-699b4571322e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The AEU views this directive as an attempt to intimidate teachers and try to discourage them from taking industrial action. While it is now school holidays in the ACT, over the past few weeks work bans have included [https://substack.com/redirect/7cf08574-881a-4203-a5f5-260df6f20fff?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] no written comments on student reports; no staff meetings after 3:30pm; talking to parents about industrial action; not participating in Education Directorate surveys and wearing AEU t-shirts on Fridays.

VAHPA - Public allied health workers

On Friday (3/7) VAHPA members at GV Health in Shepparton rallied out the front of the hospital [https://substack.com/redirect/934bfe4e-825d-4750-b4c2-c53880e00aef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. And yesterday (7/7) VAHPA members

rallied at Barwon Health in Geelong [https://substack.com/redirect/82327c6e-c682-4cf7-ae77-e8112cb3ba70?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] and other hospitals including Peninsula University Hospital in Frankston and the Olivia Newton John Cancer Wellness Centre in Heidelberg. Workers are also participating in a range of work bans and stoppages. VAHPA has been bargaining with the state government for 10 months for a new agreement for public sector allied health workers. They have received one unsatisfactory offer from the state government thus far, one workers say fails to reflect the recent FWC decision that Allied Health has been historically undervalued. Industrial action is ongoing, and more regional protests are expected in the coming weeks.

ETU QLD - Glencore

On Thursday (2/7), the ETU made a “one-time concession” offer to Glencore [https://substack.com/redirect/1b39588f-bdd2-4940-be42-3202acbb3935?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on behalf of its members at the Townsville copper refinery. Countering a sub-standard offer, the ETU proposed 4% annual wage increases over 3 years with existing bonuses rolled into base rates. This was on the basis that industrial action would be withdrawn, allowing a vote to proceed uninterrupted. Glencore rejected the offer, and threatened workers that if they did not accept what was on the table “large financial elements” would be withdrawn. Consequently, industrial action continues at the refinery [https://substack.com/redirect/f49b8f91-05c8-4d16-8a48-2c08b035dd9a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM].

HSU NSW - Downer

HSU members at the Orange Base Hospital walked off the job for 2 hours [https://substack.com/redirect/385018d7-7217-4abb-903b-454d863ec620?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on Monday (6/7). Workers were protesting about dangerous rosters that leave workers with only a seven hour gap between shifts. The Downer Group (a Disputes Report regular!) is contracted to operate non-clinical services at the hospital which is a public-private partnership.

In short

ASU/CPSU Vic - Parks Victoria

Union members at Parks Victoria are striking for 24 hours today [https://substack.com/redirect/06d5fbb2-ae47-449e-96ca-65eeb443b7d6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (8/7). This is the second 24 hour strike at Parks Victoria. Workers will rally outside the office of the Environment Minister (8 Nicholson Street, Melbourne) from 12 noon. Workers are fighting for a fair deal from the state government - including pay parity with their public sector colleagues.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Industrial action on Northern Beaches buses is escalating this week [https://substack.com/redirect/a86664bc-ecc5-4c34-8c9d-bd12e8b0ec68?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. RTBU members have been turning off opal card readers since 18 June, but this week have instituted a ban on driving any bus displaying a dashboard warning light. Workers are fighting for decent wages and safer working conditions.

AMWU/AWU Vic - UGL (Viva Refinery)

In Disputes Report on 17 June [https://substack.com/redirect/c5062556-c7ba-4907-bcd5-a2a820a6f2ef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] I reported on AMWU members taking industrial action at the Viva refinery in Geelong on 12/6. The AWU has shared that their members held a 4-hour stoppage on 19/6 [https://substack.com/redirect/9ee5ccfd-6baa-4b89-8a6a-dd5965787d94?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. By the looks of the photo, this was AWU and AMWU members. Workers will participate in stoppages every Friday until they get a better deal. Workers are fighting for 4% annual pay increases; better severance pay and consistent overtime pay.

PABO Watch

AMWU WA - UGL (BP Refinery)

The AMWU have applied for a protected action ballot [https://substack.com/redirect/e0d5c4cf-aa2b-40a4-b615-cb481f8f3171?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] on behalf of members at the BP Refinery employed by UGL. Workers are fighting for pretty basic things like a fair wage increase; industry standard site and travel allowances and recognition for working on a major hazard facility. Not much to ask for, but UGL isn't budging, so workers are ready to step up their campaign.

AWU/AMWU/ETU - BHP (Port Hedland)

AWU members employed by BHP at Port Hedland have endorsed protected industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/0f9cac9c-420f-4cab-a561-395dffd2e9ca?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. 97% of members voted yes, following strong protected action ballot results from AMWU and ETU members. The 3 unions were due to meet with BHP at a bargaining meeting [<https://substack.com/redirect/acc4c65a-5a01-4bca-8dd3->

b2c5504269dd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] yesterday (7/7) with a strong indication that if it didn't go well, industrial action would follow. At the time of writing I had not heard any further updates.

Union news

ASU SA NT leadership change

There has been a change of leadership at the SA/NT Branch of the ASU. No ASU elections were scheduled this year, and no reason given in the social media posts. A Facebook post said that Branch Secretary Abbie Spencer was "stepping down" [https://substack.com/redirect/d5e438f4-4b68-43b1-8308-faf20cf40f63?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] after 8 years as Secretary. The post went on to say that under her leadership membership had increased by 50% in the last 5 years. A post the next day announced the "appointment" of Ella Waters as Secretary and Robert Habel as Assistant Secretary [https://substack.com/redirect/23260c6e-fddc-4c1b-9384-c7434900c9ef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Know more? Get in touch.

UWU Elections

The post election report for the UWU quadriennial elections is now available on the FWC website [https://substack.com/redirect/09319993-34b1-4027-9452-cc59fce53792?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. As previously reported [https://substack.com/redirect/6ffcb6e3-aa6c-45e0-9007-e2f9329d340e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], the Members First ticket was unsuccessful in taking control of the national convention, but while the United for You ticket had the numbers, UWU National President Jo Schofield did not win a seat. I understand the National Convention will meet later this month and elect the union's executive officers. What interested me in the results was voter turnout. I did a bit of rough analysis and my calculations are that only 33% of members on the electoral roll returned a ballot. The electorate with the highest percentage participation was the Southern New South Wales electorate with 49% of ballots returned. The lowest participation was in the electorates of Western Australia North and Western New South Wales with just 25% of ballots returned. Honestly, these numbers aren't surprising to me - but they are definitely worth acknowledging. The other thing worth noting is that the AEC's report notes that "this election was highly unusual with the number of issues and complaints raised with the AEC." Allegations included the improper handling of ballot papers, voter coercion and replacement ballot pack requests. The AEC also noted a "significantly higher than usual" number of replacement ballot requests. What does this tell us? This was a hard fought election with two cashed up tickets fighting for every vote. And even with all that effort, only a third of UWU members participated in this election. This illustrates a key problem not just for UWU, but across the union movement of a very disengaged membership.

Wins/resolutions

AMWU/AWU/ETU/MEU - BHP (Mining Area C/South Flank)

BHP's proposed agreement to cover workers at Mining Area C and South Flank has been endorsed by workers. A narrow majority of 58% [https://substack.com/redirect/b040ba11-ef0c-4aca-8a3f-1fbe22daad1e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] voted in favour of the deal. The agreement includes [https://substack.com/redirect/96deb450-26f6-402c-b25a-f28e2e8f5352?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] annual pay increases of 4% over the 4 year agreement; 14% superannuation contributions; and a delayed flight compensation scheme commencing next year. Both the AMWU and ETU recommended a no vote to members. The Western Mine Workers Alliance (AWU and MEU) did not make a public recommendation on how to vote, but did acknowledge that the agreement failed to meet a number of the Alliance's claims [https://substack.com/redirect/c9bef9a8-dbce-4a57-b830-8f73578853ae?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The headline in the AFR called it a "win" for BHP [https://substack.com/redirect/ba859bed-c6e1-453e-a6b9-f200a2852f5d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM].

TWU Tasmania - Kinetic

The TWU has reached an in-principle agreement with Kinetic [https://substack.com/redirect/28337e07-7da7-4dd3-ad59-476a4c250e49?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], covering all Kinetic bus drivers across Tasmania in a single agreement for the first time ever. While the TWU acknowledges they didn't get everything they wanted, workers have achieved an immediate 6.65% wage increase, with 4% increases in the next 2 years. The new agreement also includes greater certainty with rosters, increased shift loadings and other improvements.

AMWU QLD - RACQ

Following industrial action in June workers have endorsed a new offer from the RACQ. The new deal includes a 17% pay rise; allowances indexed every year; leave loading; paid time for on-job tasks and other improvements.

That's all I've got this week. There are lots of things I have simply not had time to cover like Queensland kicking union representatives off [https://substack.com/redirect/bb9237cb-00ef-4361-87aa-3e7882070983?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the state's Work Health and Safety and Work Cover boards, the ongoing MUA campaign to unionise Carnival Cruises [

https://substack.com/redirect/6f0c0676-aba4-403d-95a1-3c25f9a054da?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] and more union elections news.
Plenty happening - if only I had more time to write!
In solidarity, Sarah

Unsubscribe

https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aw9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1qQTF0e1l3TlRReUxDSnBZWFFpT2pFM09ETTB0akF6T0RVc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRneE5EazVOak00TlN3aWFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnkv0lpT2lKa2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNjbjAuNnBZamhSV24yckpKLXNmUWdTWWHERDlJeV9ycGdowUgzeDVWcnVYVUFJMCIsInAiOjIwNTc2MDU0MiwicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJlZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsIm1hdCI6MTc4MzQ2MDM4NSwiZXhwIjoyMDk5MDM2Mzg1LlCJpc3MiOiJwdWI0MCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.ZYPpwAxJZMxwzyljBJiniH1LLAZsP1BFpxsVgoi6NH8?

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-9-april>

ASMOF NSW - Public sector doctors

Despite ASMOF being ordered to not take any industrial action for three months [https://substack.com/redirect/ed7dbf61-e2c7-43fc-8f0c-c65104ddf699?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] by the NSW IRC, doctors in NSW public hospitals commenced a 3 day strike yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/d05c0a4c-c725-423c-b438-31f50ef5c3de?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (8/4) at 8am. The strike takes staffing levels down to public holiday levels [https://substack.com/redirect/7ba6cad7-6fe2-4c4e-802c-093d7d2553ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], and ASMOF members are laying the blame for any inconvenience squarely on Premier Chris Minns. Doctors are seeking a pay rise in order to address chronic doctor shortages and poor retention in the NSW public health system. They are also fighting for safe working hours with a minimum 10 hour break between shifts. With both public sector doctors and nurses in dispute [https://substack.com/redirect/12babf3d-82bd-4659-a54c-2e264c6a1a57?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] with the state government, I'm not sure what it's going to take for Chris Minns to get the message! Let's see how 3 days of strike action shakes things up.

RTBU NSW - Keolis Downer

Last week, bus drivers around Newcastle and Lake Macquarie turned off Opal card readers, essentially providing free transport as a form of industrial action [https://substack.com/redirect/05acd08a-e838-4c63-b688-db0968d379e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The action started on Thursday (3 April) and has continued this week in an attempt to force Keolis Downer back to the negotiating table. The action will also impact the live tracking of buses, and drivers will not be wearing uniforms. Workers are fighting for a new EBA with a decent pay increase to keep up with the cost of living as well as 72 hours' notice for shift changes. Newcastle's bus drivers shut down the network last month [https://substack.com/redirect/e26bfb72-cb53-4db7-8b4b-520d7b6e3600?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] after an HSR issued a cease work notice following an incident where a bus driver was seriously threatened by a passenger. Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Subscribe to get the full report straight to your inbox.

TWU QLD - Boral

Truck drivers for Boral in South-East Queensland took strike action yesterday [https://substack.com/redirect/b3bdc7e8-e874-4f67-b652-b6374307fdfa?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (8/4). TWU members are seeking a fair deal, as their wages have gone backwards by 9% in real terms over the last 3 years; and they are earning less than their colleagues in NSW. Workers are also fighting for improved job security.

NSWNMA - Healthscope

Nurses and midwives at Nepean Private Hospital are the latest group of workers to take part in rolling stoppages at Healthscope hospitals in NSW. NSWNMA members at Nepean Private started a 26 hour strike last Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/4c8ceace-a184-4ba3-b9a4-39d46ebc633e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (3 April). Workers are fighting for a 15% pay increase as well as ratios; improvements to leave and allowances; and for babies to be counted as patients. Healthscope has responded to shorter stoppages and work bans by docking pay by up to 30%, but according to the union have done so in an arbitrary and illogical [https://substack.com/redirect/9c335610-7080-4cf1-b82f-4788eac32760?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] way with some workers' pay cut when they didn't participate in bans; and some who only participated in partial bans having their wages cut as much as those who fully implemented bans.

ETU QLD - Downer

Workers in supply transmission line construction employed by Downer took industrial action in Cairns and Swanbank last Thursday [https://substack.com/redirect/a9c459e8-7ce2-48f0-a7cd-99b6a6dc94bd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (3 April). I have no other details about this dispute, but would love to hear from more details from any QLD sparkies!

AMWU/CEPU SA - BAE Systems

Workers at BAE Systems at the Osborne Naval Shipyard took industrial action again last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/4b2f7960-6e07-4ed4-9503-8b54b574b64e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] (2/4). Workers held a stop work meeting to discuss the stalled negotiations, and voted to return to work for 30 minutes before walking off the job for the remainder of the day. Workers are fighting for pay parity with ASC (Australian Submarine Corporation) and other comparable businesses - this would look like ~10% annual wage increases. BAE is refusing to budge from their offer of 12% over 3 years.

QNMU - Public Sector nurses and midwives

The QNMU held a mass meeting on Friday (4/4) after public sector nurses and midwives received a

disappointing email from the Director General of Queensland Health, Dr David Rosengren [https://substack.com/redirect/22f87eb6-7d09-40d1-92be-5151f52e2196?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The email stated that “nation-leading conditions will be maintained” but QNMU members have rejected the government’s offer of 8% over 3 years (3%, 2.5% and 2.5%) as the offer will leave Queensland’s nurses and midwives being paid less than in other states for the first time in 15 years. The snap meeting provided an update on the QNMU’s last meeting with the state government, and also passed a resolution to “commit to undertake local union activities in workplaces this month alongside colleagues to get used to taking action together, and commit to getting thousands of their colleagues to pledge their support for future protected industrial action.” [https://substack.com/redirect/086ceb0c-0193-43cb-aa2b-c1a72d41e33f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] In short, the QNMU is going to do a big structure test to see if the membership is prepared for industrial action. By the looks of the comments on social media - I think there are a lot of angry nurses and midwives who are more than ready to show the leadership they are ready to take on the government. Any Queensland nurses reading - I would love to hear what the vibe at work is.

AMWU/ETU NSW - Tomago

AMWU and ETU members at Tomago Aluminium have overwhelmingly endorsed taking protected industrial action in pursuit of a 15% pay rise over 3 years [https://substack.com/redirect/857104eb-80f2-4ed7-8d6e-9048b35a1738?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. Workers are seeking parity with operators at the plant (AWU members) who recently came to an in-principle agreement with Tomago for an 11.5% pay increase over 3 years as well as a \$1500 cost of living payment [https://substack.com/redirect/7b4516ad-ffe0-4802-b405-eca730da05b5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. In addition to pay parity with operators, AMWU and ETU members are seeking improvements to annual leave provisions; mental health days and the ability to take long service leave at half pay.

HWU - ACL

On 4 February, the HWU posted on social media [https://substack.com/redirect/e04000ae-6fe2-4c49-a50c-951da0632309?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] that industrial action at Australian Clinical Labs would commence on 17 February pending approval from the Fair Work Commission. I noted this, kept an eye on socials, news and protected action ballot results... nothing. So I assumed that perhaps the threat alone of industrial action had pushed the ACL bosses into a better position and the job was done. But no concrete evidence of anything. I did message HWU on Instagram, but no response. Then on 31/3, the World Socialist Website, run by the Socialist Equality Party published an article [https://substack.com/redirect/9da43ec5-56b2-468d-a2bd-16f952dd0473?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] which alleges the HWU is suggesting workers endorse an in-principle agreement that would “slash the real wages of most workers and do nothing to address their concerns over working conditions, safety and job security.” The article also says the HWU called off strike action in February, less than 48 hours after it was scheduled, and that in an online meeting HWU officials told workers that the FWC would “uphold ACL’s application to ban strikes...on the phoney grounds that this would pose a risk to public health.” I have been unable to verify these claims, or to even get a different account of events - so I am sharing this as information found. It is worth noting that the HWU is currently under administration [https://substack.com/redirect/1b967b8e-e68b-4a3d-a725-e1e42c4fb1fe?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

HACSU Vic - Public sector mental health workers & Forensicare

HACSU members’ stopwork rally last Wednesday [https://substack.com/redirect/a69ec582-38d1-4d62-bef9-7db1646d53e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] (2 April) was an impressive turn out including delegations from other unions. It is understood there will be more stop work actions in the future, but for now the long list of workplace bans continues. HACSU members at Forensicare (Victorian Institute of Forensic Mental Health) have joined their public mental health comrades and are also implementing workplace bans [https://substack.com/redirect/7cffa69f-fc1b-4fb6-b7a1-c1806c28d014?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] to fight for a better offer from the Victorian state Government. I have to say, I love that wearing a cowboy hat is listed in the list of bans. Yeehaw!

RTBU Tasmania - Metro buses

Security screens costing a total of \$2.1 million that had been promised 2 years ago will be installed on Tasmania’s Metro buses “soon” [https://substack.com/redirect/12b14994-5c9d-459b-b07b-8856dc754de5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM]. The Government was given a kick up the pants on getting this done when bus drivers stopped collecting fares [https://substack.com/redirect/db85ff7e-72d8-41bd-be98-42c0110288cd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3d0b2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] after a spate of assaults and robberies on buses. The RTBU is still agitating for transit officers with the power to issue fines and detain people.

CPSU/CSA - Child protection workers

More than 95% of child protection workers in WA have endorsed an offer [

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from the WA State Government. The offer includes a 12.5% increase over 3 years (5%, 4% and 3.5%) as well as new salary schedules; expansion of recognised qualifications; improvements to allowances and leave and an enforced overtime clause when caring for children out of hours [https://substack.com/redirect/d1411fc7-950f-4f04-a57c-fe98e596b11a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Child protection workers in WA took industrial action last year as part of their campaign for this agreement. That's all I've got this week! But I would like to share a recommendation: the new ABC 6 part podcast series Conspiracy? War on the Waterfront [https://substack.com/redirect/c0515209-c4e6-4a3a-8eb2-09529cce1947?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. The podcast includes some new revelations [https://substack.com/redirect/173d48a2-2780-4156-91ab-e511100866d5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] about how involved the Howard Government was in the dispute and what they knew when - particularly in relation to the training of a scab workforce in Dubai. Whether you were there on the picket lines, remember it being on the news or weren't even born yet - I think most workers will get something out of the podcast. Since listening, I've been thinking about other examples of government overreach and meddling in industrial relations. It's a long list!

PS I know I said I wouldn't talk about the election but I couldn't help myself and wrote a small note [<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen/note/c-106389671>] about it. If you're interested in my hot takes on miscellaneous union stuff, I post bits and pieces to substack [<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen>], instagram [https://substack.com/redirect/2243c5b1-29dd-4b98-b0c6-8a4204408b2d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM], bluesky [https://substack.com/redirect/9157dd0a-0587-460c-a84f-6998929cce83?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM] and twitter [https://substack.com/redirect/5ced3c5b-02db-4259-8972-a21bc2b1eebb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM].

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[illegible]

View this post on the web at <https://disputesreport.substack.com/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-9-july>

AMWU/UWU QLD - Star Casino

UWU members at The Star Casino in Brisbane walked off the job on Friday afternoon [https://substack.com/redirect/5b03a2bf-6590-4241-8d0b-a2adeb0b840a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] in a two-hour stop work action(4/7). Workers have been in negotiations for 7 months, but the best that Star has offered them is a 4% pay increase over 3 years coupled with cuts to Sunday penalty rates. Workers from every part of the casino participated in the stopwork including dealers, security, cleaners, bar staff, room attendants and supervisors. AMWU workers at Star [https://substack.com/redirect/523dbd35-29d0-44ce-827b-1ff19e0f81ec?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] are also in the process of negotiating a new deal and also joined in on the action. Workers will be striking again for 4 hours tonight (9/7) to coincide with the last game of the State of Origin series, and potentially more action to come on Friday (11/7). UWU members are also running an indefinite ban on wearing uniforms and can wear union apparel to work instead - this will continue until the dispute is over. Time for Star to put their cards on the table, and offer workers a reasonable deal.

QNMU - Public Sector Nurses and Midwives

As threatened, QNMU members in the public sector moved to start "Stage 2" protected industrial action on Tuesday morning (8/7). "Stage 1" actions like wearing pink continue, but can now also be added to with actions including [https://substack.com/redirect/cc8dc875-7a29-4f3b-be69-2816f847decc?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] taking all breaks; no overtime without four hours' notice; no attending management meetings; not entering Medicare details at patient admissions; no meeting agendas or taking minutes; no answering administrative phones; no filing; no transferring of stable patients who could be transferred by operational staff; no cleaning and making of beds; no movement of beds and furniture; no cleaning of equipment and/or treatment spaces and/or other non-clinical areas; and no emptying bins. QNMU Secretary Sarah Beaman was quoted as saying "We will not be gaslit, or taken for fools. [https://substack.com/redirect/5b34f2b6-ea14-40b8-9546-e95b0a42500b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]" in response to the Health Minister describing the state government's offer to nurses as a "nation-leading" package.

MEU NSW - Peabody

Workers rallied outside [https://substack.com/redirect/e9df767f-c85d-4316-b1dc-c84a66ba221f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the Helensburgh Metropolitan Mine yesterday (8/7) as Peabody extended the lockout's end date [https://substack.com/redirect/d700a4ab-dedd-4d7b-b3eb-55b9f6243b1b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] from Sunday 6 July until today (9/7). Workers have been locked out without pay since 18 June. The lockout was in response to a 1 hour stoppage by workers as part of their EBA campaign - an absolutely bonkers reaction by anyone's standards. Workers are fighting to retain their longstanding job security clause as well as for a pay rise to bring workers in line with other mines in the area [https://substack.com/redirect/5b888b99-a5b0-4f8f-81fb-87ba7ce4c0f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. Peabody and the MEU were due to meet in the FWC yesterday for mediation. The lockout is expected to end this evening [https://substack.com/redirect/cd5d4c89-f8aa-49f0-9d9f-4cd7e32bdac9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM], but stay tuned for further updates.

ETU QLD - Getinge

Getinge workers continue their industrial action. Last Thursday (3/7), workers picketed [https://substack.com/redirect/a640e414-42cb-4a62-b129-63348c55bfb3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM] the Royal Brisbane and Women's Hospital. Getinge supplies and maintains medical equipment for several hospitals. The dispute has been going on for several months now with workers fighting for a fair pay deal to keep up with the cost of living.

ANMF SA - Public Sector Nurses & Midwives

Last Wednesday (2/7) at a members meeting, ANMF members from the public sector in South Australia unanimously voted to reject the state government's offer of 3% annual pay rises. The ANMF's log of claim hasn't been publicly released that I can see. Would love to hear from any nurses or midwives about what the key demands for the EBA campaign are.

UWU - Grill'd

Industrial action at Grill'd took place in 4 states over the weekend [https://substack.com/redirect/e3f1aec9-7542-40b3-b9b3-9c01ea835f01?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM]. On Friday evening (4/7) workers at Grill'd stores in Flinders Lane, Melbourne and Rundle Street, Adelaide went on strike from 5pm. On Saturday (5/7) workers at Grill'd Galleries, Sydney went on strike from 12 noon, followed by workers

at Grill'd Southbank in Brisbane from 4pm. Workers at Grill'd are fighting back against the chain's use of traineeships to cut wages. Workers want to see the end junior wages, and get decent pay with a fair EBA. Reports on the Melbourne action [https://substack.com/redirect/790f21ee-1ad4-4f69-9055-f91d2ee3cef2?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] indicate that the strike disrupted the dinner rush hour forcing the restaurant to close an hour earlier. I haven't seen any reports from other states - would love to hear from any readers that participated in or attended these strikes.

TWU Vic - Kinetic & CDC

A fourth bus strike will take place tomorrow [https://substack.com/redirect/81bec746-6a6c-4260-bf63-ea79d1b7141d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (10/7) with bus drivers from Kinetic & CDC across Melbourne, Ballarat and Geelong stopping work. In Melbourne, drivers will be rallying at Victorian Trades Hall from 11am and then marching to Parliament. Get along to support them if you can. Drivers are striking for improved pay and conditions, and demands around driver safety.

ETU NSW - Kone

Lift technicians from the Hunter, Central Coast and Mid-North Coast employed by Kone walked off the job on Friday [https://substack.com/redirect/094ad37c-adb5-426d-913a-db18c78d709e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] (4/7). The strike action follows earlier overtime and work bans. In late June, workers rejected a subpar agreement [https://substack.com/redirect/f364e9ca-4d6a-4d21-8379-99b326c1f4eb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] from Kone. Workers at Kone in this region are some of the lowest paid in the country with the average wage being over \$8 per hour lower than other agreements. Workers are also finalising a second underpayment claim - the last one was for \$12.6m in underpayments to over 800 workers. Time for Kone to start paying workers properly!

AMWU Vic - Strammit/Taurean Doors

AMWU members at Strammit/Taurean Doors will kick off a 48 hour stoppage this Friday (11/7). Not much else to report on this one aside from the fact that negotiations have been going on for awhile, and have thus far proven unsuccessful. Know more? Get in touch!

CFMEU Vic - BMS

A report from the Concrete Gang confirms industrial action by the BMS crane crew [https://substack.com/redirect/9a2be458-4470-4137-99f7-5030124c11be?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] at the Golden Plains Wind Farm continues. The radio show also appealed for unionists to visit the striking workers, but cautioned to call the Geelong office first to check on plans for the day as the worksite at Rokewood is very large. The CFMEU Geelong office phone number is (03) 5223 1845. Workers are fighting for industry standard wages and conditions, including an inclement weather policy.

HSU SA - Public sector allied health workers

The HSU has been successful in its yes campaign for a separate EA for Allied Health workers in the public sector [https://substack.com/redirect/81f20e8e-6f8f-49dc-8b52-c165a8a4dcf5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The union has been campaigning for a standalone EA separate to the broader SA Public Sector Agreement since at least 2022 (probably longer). The agreement includes [https://substack.com/redirect/dc3ea3cb-bfb0-4074-ab2a-bdefba144d61?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] a 4% pay rise and backpay from 1 May, and a 13.5% total increase over the life of the agreement; a new professional development allowance & model; career progression changes; fixed term contract protections; easier access to 5 weeks of leave and gender neutral parental leave. 80.1% of voters voted in favour of the agreement, with 71.3% of eligible voters participating in the ballot. HSU members in allied health participated in a series of stopwork actions in June.

Combined Rail Unions & ETU - Sydney Trains & NSW Trainlink

The drawn-out dispute between unions and the NSW Government is now over after 92% of voters voted yes for the new EBA for Sydney Trains and NSW Trainlink [https://substack.com/redirect/4aca4e4e-1547-49d4-82d2-00211da485f4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. Workers will get a 12% wage increase over 3 years. The RTBU's original claim had been for a 32% pay increase over 4 years [https://substack.com/redirect/2f401034-fe94-4901-9027-02e026193748?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]. The unions have also negotiated 2 days free travel on the whole Sydney and NSW train network for the general public - free travel days will be 31 July and 1 August. It is unclear whether the relationship between the RTBU and ETU has been, or will be repaired following strong disagreement between the two unions on the manner in which the negotiations were managed.

CPSU Victoria

Early reports indicate that an opposition rank and file ticket "A Voice For Members [https://substack.com/redirect/85447865-a4c0-4bbc-a6c1-1985c4db9382?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM]" have won the leadership of the CPSU Victorian Branch. The Herald Sun reported [https://substack.com/redirect/e9b2112f-17dc-497a-bdfd-9a11b68ca8e5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbfbf_KD9-eM] that incumbent

secretary Karen Batt announced to CPSU staff yesterday afternoon that “A Voice For Members” had won in a “landslide”. Karen Batt has been Secretary of the union since 1993. Official results will be out in two weeks according to CPSU rules. This is a significant result that will most likely send a shiver down the spine of entrenched union bureaucrats, and possibly spark copycat rank and file tickets in unions across the country. Once again we are reminded: dare to struggle, dare to win! That’s all I’ve got this week. A special thank you to the QLD comrade who helped me understand the State of Origin fixture and associated Star Casino strike! Also, I’d love to hear readers’ thoughts on the CPSU Vic election result - comment below or send me a DM. And please - if there’s a dispute brewing in your union or your corner of the world - let me know!

In solidarity, Sarah

Thanks for reading Disputes Report! Please share with your comrades.

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https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWN0aW9uL2Rpc2FibGVfZW1haWw_dG9rZW49ZXlKMWMyVnlyMmxrSWpvME1UZ3pNekUzTXl3aWNHOXpkRjllwWkNjNk1UWTNPREE0TURNekxDSnBZWF FpT2pFM05USXdNVEExTnpVc0ltVjRjQ0k2TVRjNE16VTB0a1UzTlN3aWYFTnpJam9pY0hwaUxUSXdPVFV4TnpZaUxDSnpkV0lpT2l Ka2FYTmhZbXhswDJWdFlXbHNJbjAueDBxMlBFTDjnYm50LThyMTZ5bVU3T2pLbjctbXhGYTZ0ZjNzWDVUUXdrRSIsInAiOjE2Nzgw ODAzMywicyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNzMsImIhdCI6MTc1MjAxMDU3NSwiZXhwIjoyMDY3NTg2NTc1LlCJpc 3MiOiJwdWItdmCIsInN1YiI6ImxpbmstcmVkaXJlY3QifQ.kUFrok00YQ_EhCe0LOMBdnSWKz00yHZa_83_q9bjpPE?

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> Hi comrades - *Disputes Report *is a weekly round-up of industrial
> disputes and news here in Australia. I started this project as a way of
> learning about what was happening in the labour movement and how workers
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> were organising.
>
> This will never be a complete record of disputes. I'm always eager to hear
> what I've missed, and what is going on in workplaces and unions around the
> country (and the world).
> -----
> Industrial disputes & news - 9 September 2026
> <https://substack.com/app-link/post?publication_id=2095176&post_id=214719610&utm_source=post-email-title&utm_campaign=email-post-title&isFreemail=true&r=owmol&token=eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MTgzMzE3MywicG9zdF9pZCI6MjE0NzE5NjEwLCJpYXQiOjE3ODg5MDMyNjcsImV4cCI6MTc5MTQ5NTI2NywiaXNzIjoicHVlTIwOTUxNzYiLCJzdWIiOiJwb3N0LXJlYWNoaw9uIn0.1rAUccEW-gLof-XAmDQk9r19tjLD-8aDhGlabWOpzho>Arts
> Centre Melbourne; Sydney Ferries; Victorian doctors; RiverCity Ferries;
> Downer; Scope; Quantem; DOF; Secure Journeys; Melbourne metro councils;
> Fire Rescue Victoria; Lumus Imaging; NPT & more
>
> Sarah Missen <<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen>>
> Sep 9
> <<https://substack.com/@sarahmissen>>
>
>
> <https://substack.com/app-link/post?publication_id=2095176&post_id=214719610&utm_source=substack&isFreemail=true&submitLike=true&token=eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MTgzMzE3MywicG9zdF9pZCI6MjE0NzE5NjEwLCJpYXQiOjE3ODg5MDMyNjcsImV4cCI6MTc5MTQ5NTI2NywiaXNzIjoicHVlTIwOTUxNzYiLCJzdWIiOiJwb3N0LXJlYWNoaw9uIn0.zyu70WpFU2NCSj7NK27x3ZStEcDKUu8Db95KRv4hv-0&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=email-reaction&r=owmol>
>
> <https://substack.com/app-link/post?publication_id=2095176&post_id=214719610&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email&isFreemail=true&comment_s=true&token=eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MTgzMzE3MywicG9zdF9pZCI6MjE0NzE5NjEwLCJpYXQiOjE3ODg5MDMyNjcsImV4cCI6MTc5MTQ5NTI2NywiaXNzIjoicHVlTIwOTUxNzYiLCJzdWIiOiJwb3N0LXJlYWNoaw9uIn0.1rAUccEW-gLof-XAmDQk9r19tjLD-8aDhGlabWOpzho&r=owmol&utm_campaign=email-half-magic-comments&action=post-comment&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email>
>
> <https://substack.com/app-link/post?publication_id=2095176&post_id=214719610&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email&utm_content=share&utm_campaign=email-share&action=share&triggerShare=true&isFreemail=true&r=owmol&token=eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MTgzMzE3MywicG9zdF9pZCI6MjE0NzE5NjEwLCJpYXQiOjE3ODg5MDMyNjcsImV4cCI6MTc5MTQ5NTI2NywiaXNzIjoicHVlTIwOTUxNzYiLCJzdWIiOiJwb3N0LXJlYWNoaw9uIn0.1rAUccEW-gLof-XAmDQk9r19tjLD-8aDhGlabWOpzho>
>
> <https://open.substack.com/pub/disputesreport/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-9-september?utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=email-restack-comment&action=restack-comment&r=owmol&token=eyJ1c2VyX2lkIjo0MTgzMzE3MywicG9zdF9pZCI6MjE0NzE5NjEwLCJpYXQiOjE3ODg5MDMyNjcsImV4cCI6MTc5MTQ5NTI2NywiaXNzIjoicHVlTIwOTUxNzYiLCJzdWIiOiJwb3N0LXJlYWNoaw9uIn0.1rAUccEW-gLof-XAmDQk9r19tjLD-8aDhGlabWOpzho&utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email>
>
> READ IN APP
> <https://open.substack.com/pub/disputesreport/p/industrial-disputes-and-news-9-september?utm_source=email&redirect=app-store-no-desktop&inbox=true&utm_campaign=email-read-in-app>
>
> CPSU/ETU/MEAA - Arts Centre Melbourne
>
> Arts Centre Melbourne workers (in the MEAA, CPSU and ETU) are stepping up
> their campaign for a fair deal. Union members have announced a 24 hour stop
> work this Friday (11/9). Union members took stop work action on Thursday
> (3/9); Friday (4/9) and Saturday (5/9)
> <https://substack.com/redirect/00f3bfbc-aa25-4faf-9e95-5dfef2b32d45?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVult0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> at the Arts Centre; Melbourne Town Hall and Hamer Hall. This Friday's
> strike action (11/9) threatens to entirely disrupt a concert by American
> R&B artist Macy Gray. Workers wages have fallen 10% behind inflation since
> 2022, and management is only offering a 3% pay deal (a further pay cut in
> real terms). The MEAA
> <<https://substack.com/redirect/2f02bd3e-4b8d-465c-ae78-07b252eafaa2?>

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j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> and CPSU
> <https://substack.com/redirect/db875451-e042-4b88-85c1-81777fbaef11?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> have announced that workers will form a picket line from 3:30pm Friday, and
> hold a rally outside Hamer Hall at 6pm. Get along and support the workers
> if you can.
>
> <https://substack.com/redirect/a5f1fa59-8d8d-4906-9952-64dbcf050c25?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> MUA NSW - Sydney Ferries
>
> Last Wednesday (2/9), MUA members at Sydney Ferries went on strike from
> 9am - 2pm and held a stopwork meeting
> <https://substack.com/redirect/1b399049-88a3-47ad-872f-1df152a486b6?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> at Circular Quay. From Friday (11/9) through to 6 October, Opal card
> readers will be switched off on the ferries
> <https://substack.com/redirect/9f31e142-b9b4-41b5-bf35-a10f4800bb25?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>,
> meaning free travel for ferry passengers. Workers have also been
> participating in overtime bans. MUA members are fighting for a 5% wage
> increase with guaranteed annual increases in subsequent years that protect
> workers' wages from inflation and the cost of living crisis. Transdev, the
> multinational that operates Sydney's iconic ferries, refuses to come to the
> table with a fair deal for workers.
> Subscribed
>
<https://substack.com/redirect/2/eyJ1IjoiaHR0cHM6Ly9kaXNwdXRlc3JlcG9ydC5zdWJzdGFjay5jb20vYWVnb3VudCIzInAiOjIxNDcxOTYxMCwicycyI6MjA5NTE3NiwiZiI6dHJ1ZSwidSI6NDE4MzMxNmMsIm1hdCI6MTc4ODkwMzI2NywiZXhwIjoyMTA0NDc5MjY3LCJpc3MiOiJwdWI6ImxpbnstcmVkaXJlY3QiPQ.u2fBpv9NjLmQZW4Z82\_L3f0VLi0VTHxAy2vk3dhNluo?
>
> ASMOF Vic - Public hospital doctors
>
> On Thursday (3/9), doctors from Grampians Health and Bendigo Health walked
> off the job for 4 hours
> <https://substack.com/redirect/7e76cbef-33ba-4667-869f-8b8fd4d65109?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> This included doctors at the Ballarat Base Hospital and Bendigo Hospital -
> two of the biggest hospitals in regional Victoria. Negotiations with the
> state government have been underway for a year
> <https://substack.com/redirect/44b7f166-8034-4497-8ba4-166403f902b0?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>,
> but no offer has been made to public sector doctors as yet. A range of new work
> bans commenced on Monday (7/9)
> <https://substack.com/redirect/6699804b-8810-4e70-a875-ef758b122343?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> including refusing to attend meetings and refusing to participate in
> workplace activities associated with maintaining the hospital's
> accreditations. In a significant escalation of the campaign, a statewide,
> 24 hour strike will take place on Tuesday 15 September
> <https://substack.com/redirect/1cd23bd5-1048-42a1-af6e-9dc425cc5099?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> Doctors and their supporters will rally at Parliament House at 12 noon -
> get along if you can. Doctors are fighting for a 30% pay increase over 4
> years
> <https://substack.com/redirect/7b180b29-b772-4fab-9690-71a5cf2b70be?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> as well as improvements to conditions, safety, training and career
> development.
>
> <https://substack.com/redirect/e6bb7e84-991a-4c2f-b9b3-6dbffe478f14?
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> AMOU/MUA QLD - RiverCity Ferries
>
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> Strike action by workers on CityCat ferries in Brisbane went ahead on
> Saturday (5/9) during the RiverFire festival. Unions attended a last
> ditch negotiation meeting
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/b582165f-6824-4291-a56f-0232e83bcff3?](https://substack.com/redirect/b582165f-6824-4291-a56f-0232e83bcff3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> on Friday (4/9) but no agreement was reached. Workers felt they had little
> choice but to strike when RiverCity Ferries put out another agreement for
> vote
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/e762ab0d-ce67-43d5-8832-8737efa8130c?](https://substack.com/redirect/e762ab0d-ce67-43d5-8832-8737efa8130c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> that was barely changed from the last one rejected by workers. As
> predicted, 90% of workers voted against the agreement. Union members will strike
> for 24 hours again tomorrow
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/112f2def-759a-4329-83ed-541e56f560c6?](https://substack.com/redirect/112f2def-759a-4329-83ed-541e56f560c6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> (10/9).
> TWU - FedEX, Border Express, K&S, SCT, PFD, Sadliers, Goldstar & Qube
>
> It's finally happening! The TWU's much-hyped "Our Roads Our Skies Our
> Future" campaign is kicking off its first round of coordinated industrial
> action. On Thursday (10/9), TWU members at transport/logistics companies
> FedEx, BorderExpress, K&S, SCT, PFD, Sadliers, Goldstar and Qube will
> strike for 24 hours from 4am
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/a4081484-256b-4a6a-82dc-9b473e91e793?](https://substack.com/redirect/a4081484-256b-4a6a-82dc-9b473e91e793?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.
> Members at K&S ChemTrans will strike for 48 hours. The TWU has already
> reached agreements with Toll, Linfox, Team Global Express
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/b0e22076-64dd-475e-90ff-ff4a9f0126dd?](https://substack.com/redirect/b0e22076-64dd-475e-90ff-ff4a9f0126dd?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> and BevChain. Workers at FedEx tested the waters of strike action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/34caa605-30a3-4741-9eb2-ebeef63b577c?](https://substack.com/redirect/34caa605-30a3-4741-9eb2-ebeef63b577c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> with a two-hour stoppage in late August. The TWU has also had a win in the
> Federal Court with an injunction stopping BorderExpress from terminating
> 25 employees
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/0159ae10-3cea-44fa-8f95-0672ab11f600?](https://substack.com/redirect/0159ae10-3cea-44fa-8f95-0672ab11f600?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>,
> including 3 union delegates, days after workers voted in favour of
> industrial action. Workers cannot be made redundant until the union's legal
> challenge against the sackings is determined.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/1dc7b541-bdcc-4e1e-9ab7-044763563ea8?](https://substack.com/redirect/1dc7b541-bdcc-4e1e-9ab7-044763563ea8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> AMWU/ETU Vic - Downer
>
> A media release
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/c49676e0-bdd7-47b0-bfa6-b0459073bef3?](https://substack.com/redirect/c49676e0-bdd7-47b0-bfa6-b0459073bef3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> from the AMWU and ETU shared that on 31 August the unions had applied for
> assisted bargaining with Downer in the FWC. The matter was due to be heard
> yesterday (8/9), but at the time of writing I haven't been able to find any
> outcome. In advance of the hearing, as an act of good faith, both unions
> withdrew all industrial action. A number of newspaper articles noted that
> affected train lines were to resume regular service on Friday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/34275bd0-0725-4de7-aebf-b7ce5735fef8?](https://substack.com/redirect/34275bd0-0725-4de7-aebf-b7ce5735fef8?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>,
> however some delays and cancellations may occur while trains get back into
> position. Stay tuned to see what happens through the FWC process.
> IEU Vic - Overnewton Anglican Community College
>
> IEU members at Overnewton Anglican Community College commenced a range of
> work bans yesterday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/3f98b382-6e19-4a80-8170-781d9b67163d?](https://substack.com/redirect/3f98b382-6e19-4a80-8170-781d9b67163d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> (8/9) and intend to strike for 4 hours on 17 September. Workers have been

> in negotiations with the school for 6 months, and have rejected an offer of
> a 14% pay increase. IEU members are demanding a 37% increase over 3 years
> and a \$5000 healthcare allowance. Work bans include not following the dress
> code; boycotting co-curricular activities and not attending parent-teacher
> interviews.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/781c9508-4774-4a87-9eb9-2d580aa8956b?](https://substack.com/redirect/781c9508-4774-4a87-9eb9-2d580aa8956b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> IEU SA - Adelaide Catholic Schools
>
> IEU members at a number of Catholic schools in Adelaide have voted in
> favour of taking industrial action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/b5c57ce9-1cdd-42a8-9168-8dac5753c69d?](https://substack.com/redirect/b5c57ce9-1cdd-42a8-9168-8dac5753c69d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>,
> and in some schools commenced industrial action last week. 17 schools are
> able to take action, and have been leafleting parents; not attending
> meetings, refusing yard duty and wearing black IEU campaign t-shirts. On
> Friday (4/9), IEU members at Cardijn College took a full day of strike
> action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/f1b2e3b9-5a59-4a95-8737-91489d40f31f?](https://substack.com/redirect/f1b2e3b9-5a59-4a95-8737-91489d40f31f?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.
> Catholic Education SA has offered 3% increases and a one-off payment of
> \$2200. Workers are fighting for 6% annual pay rises
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/e5f0340b-91d2-4395-9334-51a7105f4aef?](https://substack.com/redirect/e5f0340b-91d2-4395-9334-51a7105f4aef?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> over a 3 year agreement and action on workload. Negotiations have been
> underway for more than 18 months. Coordinated strike action across all
> schools is being considered.
> HACSU Victoria - Scope
>
> HACSU members at Scope will walk off the job again this Friday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/5dd44adf-7838-4a37-94da-586a14985dc3?](https://substack.com/redirect/5dd44adf-7838-4a37-94da-586a14985dc3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> (11/9) and rally for better pay and conditions. Workers at Scope are also
> trying to stop the disability service provider to reverse its decision to
> withdraw accessible transport from supported accommodation residents. HACSU
> would welcome other unionists joining them at this rally on Friday from 12
> noon at Scope Head Office, 109 Burwood Road, Hawthorn
> <<https://www.google.com/maps/search/109+Burwood+Road,+Hawthorn?entry=gmail&source=g>>.
>
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/9d117ec6-7db2-4d62-91a5-e92a8eab8aba?](https://substack.com/redirect/9d117ec6-7db2-4d62-91a5-e92a8eab8aba?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> MUA Vic - Quantem
>
> Quantem, one of Australia's biggest bulk fuel port operators, continues to
> refuse to come to the table with a decent offer. Since last Wednesday
> (2/9), Quantem has completely stood down its entire workforce and has flown
> in scabs from SA, QLD and even overseas to run the terminal. Workers and
> unions have been mobilising to support stood down workers by rallying at
> Quantem and making it clear how they feel about scabs being brought in to
> break strikes in Port Melbourne. There have been several rallies held at
> Quantem including Wednesday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/f6dc9662-0a5f-41ae-ac0a-95a78697a9ea?](https://substack.com/redirect/f6dc9662-0a5f-41ae-ac0a-95a78697a9ea?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> (2/9); Saturday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/5df59097-938c-427b-a836-1335a010aed0?](https://substack.com/redirect/5df59097-938c-427b-a836-1335a010aed0?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> (5/9) and yesterday (8/9).
> Offshore Alliance - DOF
>
> Offshore Alliance members working with Remotely Operated Vehicles at DOF
> recommenced industrial action last Wednesday (2/9). Workers first
> commenced industrial action in mid-June
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/05f9945a-54f5-40eb-b79b-dc04b6da5c61?](https://substack.com/redirect/05f9945a-54f5-40eb-b79b-dc04b6da5c61?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.

> Since then, DOF have spent most of their time trying to block industrial
> action, including attempting to recruit scab labour from overseas
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/c48c4726-1997-473c-a5ac-f12f16d4e293?](https://substack.com/redirect/c48c4726-1997-473c-a5ac-f12f16d4e293?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.

> DOF have now filed for an intractable bargaining declaration
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/0662623b-e027-4b61-b419-3b3f8bcf1789?](https://substack.com/redirect/0662623b-e027-4b61-b419-3b3f8bcf1789?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.

> Time for DOF to stop messing around, and start negotiating with workers.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/f42a9d1c-8f61-4ea4-bc28-4c7da50851ab?](https://substack.com/redirect/f42a9d1c-8f61-4ea4-bc28-4c7da50851ab?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>

> AWU Qld - Youth detention centres
>
> Industrial action continues to escalate in Queensland's youth detention
> centres. Last Wednesday (2/9) workers struck for 24 hours
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/92705907-0b71-4598-8c96-6fe12a10a2a5?](https://substack.com/redirect/92705907-0b71-4598-8c96-6fe12a10a2a5?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.

> This week, workers stopped work for 12 hours on Monday (7/9), the start
> of 7 days of rolling stoppages
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/67a4da7d-d992-4c88-97ec-34a1ec812110?](https://substack.com/redirect/67a4da7d-d992-4c88-97ec-34a1ec812110?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.

> The AWU is seeking 6% annual wage increases for 3 years, but the Queensland
> government will not budge from 3.5% in the first year, and 2.5% in each of
> the following two years. As negotiations have stalled the Queensland
> government has now applied to the QIRC for conciliation
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/58627f68-5f01-4fd0-bdf3-c63d93a21ff7?](https://substack.com/redirect/58627f68-5f01-4fd0-bdf3-c63d93a21ff7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.

> In addition to wages, workers are concerned about safety in the detention
> centres, and its effect on recruitment and retention.
> UWU - Secure Journeys
>
> Workers at immigration detention centres across the country walked off
> the job again yesterday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/dc1ac368-c1be-41d9-bd05-cf1e24cfc9c6?](https://substack.com/redirect/dc1ac368-c1be-41d9-bd05-cf1e24cfc9c6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>

> (8/9). UWU members struck from 10am to 2pm in an escalation of their
> industrial campaign following a 92% no vote against Secure Journeys' most
> recent offer. Workers are fighting for a decent pay deal, but also for
> safety. Since taking over the contract for running Australia's immigration
> detention centres they have slashed jobs impacting safety. Workers are
> calling on Secure Journeys for a fair deal and safe workplaces.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/cb221332-4111-4afd-8e8e-cef74b84565d?](https://substack.com/redirect/cb221332-4111-4afd-8e8e-cef74b84565d?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>

> ASU Victoria - Melbourne metropolitan councils
>
> More industrial action will be undertaken by ASU members at metropolitan
> Melbourne councils this week. 8 councils are currently in negotiations with
> the ASU for a multi-employer agreement. ASU members at Hume City Council
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/200bc928-11c6-4681-8300-c3106799a887?](https://substack.com/redirect/200bc928-11c6-4681-8300-c3106799a887?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>

> will be taking action from today (9/9) through to Friday (11/9). The
> council has advised residents rubbish collection may be impacted. Merri-bek
> has also been notified of industrial action taking place from 9-11
> September
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/3cc63343-176f-4fc1-ba6e-93122d29142c?](https://substack.com/redirect/3cc63343-176f-4fc1-ba6e-93122d29142c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>

> that will impact rubbish collection. The Dandenong, Keysborough and
> Springvale libraries will be closed on Friday (11/9)
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/89da0076-3288-48ad-b35f-98b75bc251bb?](https://substack.com/redirect/89da0076-3288-48ad-b35f-98b75bc251bb?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>due

> to industrial action by ASU members at the Greater Dandenong Council.
> UFU Vic - Fire Rescue Victoria
>

> On Monday (7/9), UFU members and supporters rallied outside Premier Ben
> Carroll's electorate office
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/646b18ab-acf7-4ba1-a7a1-4a8314ef85e4?](https://substack.com/redirect/646b18ab-acf7-4ba1-a7a1-4a8314ef85e4?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> in Niddire. UFU Secretary Peter Marshall and Victorian Trades Hall Council
> Secretary Luke Hilakari both addressed the rally. Corporate staff stopped
> work to attend the rally, while firefighters attended in their own time.
> Firies are demanding the new Premier return to the bargaining table with a
> decent offer, with Secretary Peter Marshall calling for a "reset" with the
> state government. UFU is demanding a 25% pay increase over 3 years
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/6aa07355-b251-4c83-b094-3f44a9edb187?](https://substack.com/redirect/6aa07355-b251-4c83-b094-3f44a9edb187?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>,
> and have previously rejected an offer from the Allan Government of a 12%
> pay increase over 4 years along with upfront one-off payments of
> approximately \$7000. The dispute between UFU and Fire Rescue Victoria has
> been going on for years at this point. This means that workers have not
> received a pay increase for approximately 5 years.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/a397e062-c07e-44ad-8360-d497f5ba0783?](https://substack.com/redirect/a397e062-c07e-44ad-8360-d497f5ba0783?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> *In short*MUA VIC - ICS Tenacious
>
> MUA members on bunkering tanker the ICS Tenacious are currently taking
> industrial action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/ea83b931-9c97-4e57-8003-83c3c7945ee7?](https://substack.com/redirect/ea83b931-9c97-4e57-8003-83c3c7945ee7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.
>
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/1227d8bc-8ee3-4650-8cc6-b744dd50a112?](https://substack.com/redirect/1227d8bc-8ee3-4650-8cc6-b744dd50a112?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> CFMEU ACT - ACT Public Sector
>
> CFMEU members employed as GSOs by the ACT government have continued their
> campaign of weekend industrial action. Last weekend (5 & 6 September);
> workers in Tuggeranong participated in the bans on rubbish collection
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/bf5a3e96-d333-4b98-8bd7-0cc148d73ce3?](https://substack.com/redirect/bf5a3e96-d333-4b98-8bd7-0cc148d73ce3?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> for the first time. This is the fifth weekend in a row rubbish collection
> bans have been in place in the ACT. Workers are fighting for a decent
> offer
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/564a3fc6-7b3d-4724-acbc-2d3c76f286f1?](https://substack.com/redirect/564a3fc6-7b3d-4724-acbc-2d3c76f286f1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> from the territory government.
> ANMF Vic - Lumus Imaging
>
> ANMF members at Lumus Imaging commenced industrial action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/038b7e5d-5511-4465-822d-d6a6db5688d9?](https://substack.com/redirect/038b7e5d-5511-4465-822d-d6a6db5688d9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>.
> Workers are fighting for an additional 11% pay increase in addition to the
> 15.24% pay increase over 4 years currently being offered by Lumus. Lumus's
> offer alone would leave nurses 20-40% worse off than industry standards.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/22bad932-3acc-465e-ad90-f7f152e36bed?](https://substack.com/redirect/22bad932-3acc-465e-ad90-f7f152e36bed?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> VAHPA - Public allied health workers
>
> On Monday (7/9), VAHPA (under its new leadership) launched its "Four
> Weeks to Fix It"
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/3b96c0de-9328-433d-8312-bb01d320045a?](https://substack.com/redirect/3b96c0de-9328-433d-8312-bb01d320045a?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM>
> campaign. The campaign aims to get a fair deal for public allied health
> workers before the state enters "caretaker mode" ahead of the November
> election. VAHPA will be organising workers to take "one coordinated action
> each week". This week's action is emailing MPs every day
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/3fb6ddc9-33f2-477f-bb1e-db32927926b6?](https://substack.com/redirect/3fb6ddc9-33f2-477f-bb1e-db32927926b6?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbhf_KD9-eM)

j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
>
> VAU - NPT
>
> VAU members at National Patient Transport commenced industrial action on
> Friday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/f47bec71-7c65-4670-b83b-a14e39684ff7?](https://substack.com/redirect/f47bec71-7c65-4670-b83b-a14e39684ff7?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> (4/9). According to a 7 news report
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/e92816f9-bd31-4beb-8bdc-05e0e3987e0e?](https://substack.com/redirect/e92816f9-bd31-4beb-8bdc-05e0e3987e0e?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>,
> the action includes stopwork actions, overtime bans, not collecting patient
> billing details and not refueling ambulances. Workers have been offered a lacklustre
> 1.4% pay increase
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/62fa432a-39b1-4446-a799-0188ff83ef99?](https://substack.com/redirect/62fa432a-39b1-4446-a799-0188ff83ef99?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> They want 8%.
>
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/6593c2a9-3e88-406b-ae7f-eb670abfc697?](https://substack.com/redirect/6593c2a9-3e88-406b-ae7f-eb670abfc697?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> MUA Tasmania - TasPorts
>
> MUA members at TasPorts will commence industrial action on Saturday
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/c010adc9-1f70-449b-9dd1-054f3b40960c?](https://substack.com/redirect/c010adc9-1f70-449b-9dd1-054f3b40960c?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> (12/9) at 6am. Workers are fighting for a decent EBA. Workers were set to
> take industrial action in August, however industrial action was withdrawn
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/15faf3c9-3c98-4359-8ec2-a113ae7b3a6b?](https://substack.com/redirect/15faf3c9-3c98-4359-8ec2-a113ae7b3a6b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> by the union to focus on negotiations.
> *PABO Watch*ASU - Jetstar
>
> ASU members at Jetstar have overwhelmingly endorsed taking industrial
> action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/667b5cca-3548-41bc-8abb-6e11ee2b169b?](https://substack.com/redirect/667b5cca-3548-41bc-8abb-6e11ee2b169b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> 82% of eligible voters participated in the ballot, and 99% of those who
> voted said yes
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/a789972d-0a06-497a-abc2-40d061f906c9?](https://substack.com/redirect/a789972d-0a06-497a-abc2-40d061f906c9?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> .
> AMWU/MEU WA - Premier Coal
>
> AMWU and MEU members at Premier Coal's Collie mine have voted in favour
> of taking industrial action
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/1dd034c0-63b3-434a-9a92-2b48ff151f5b?](https://substack.com/redirect/1dd034c0-63b3-434a-9a92-2b48ff151f5b?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>.
> This will be the last EA at the mine as transition planning is under way.
> Unions are determined to ensure a fair deal particularly in terms of pay
> and redundancy entitlements
> <[https://substack.com/redirect/da5fc85d-2f59-454e-b0b6-5e5e37a261e1?](https://substack.com/redirect/da5fc85d-2f59-454e-b0b6-5e5e37a261e1?j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM)
j=eyJ1Ijoib3dtb2wifQ.Jvk1D4o5eh2as-cVUlt0QrnwtdEnkXhZlhbF_KD9-eM>
> .
>
> That's all I've got this week! Thanks to the readers who helped me
> finalise the report this week. I appreciate your help as always. Please do
> get in touch if you have any information about disputes, union elections or
> other news.
>
> In solidarity, Sarah
>
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